Hindi, Step by Step, Root by Root

An etymology-driven curriculum, built one word at a time

Adhithya Rajasekaran

This edition compiled incrementally — new chapters added as they are written.

Copyright © Adhithya Rajasekaran. Licensed under Creative Commons Attribution-ShareAlike 4.0 International (CC BY-SA 4.0). Devanagari set in Noto Sans Devanagari (SIL Open Font License).

Preface

This book teaches Hindi one word at a time, and it teaches each word by taking it apart. It is written for someone starting from zero — who may not read a single Devanagari letter — so the script is taught *inside the word lessons themselves*: each word introduces exactly the letters it needs, so you learn to read नमस्ते *and* learn that it means "I bow to you" in the same few minutes. There is no alphabet drill to sit through first. (A reader who already knows Devanagari simply skims the "letters in this word" notes.)

Hindi's depth comes from a double inheritance. Much of its core vocabulary is **Sanskrit** — नमस्ते and धन्यवाद sit on ancient roots (*nam*, "to bow"; *dhanya*, "worthy"). But centuries of Persian as the language of courts layered on a second vocabulary, Persian and (through it) Arabic — so "thanks" is also शुक्रिया (*shukriyā*, the same Semitic root as Arabic *shukran*), and "farewell" is अलविदा (*alvidā*, "the farewell," carrying the Arabic article *al-*). The book keeps both streams in view.

How to use this book

Every numbered section is one word, or one small phrase, and takes a few minutes — the length of a queue, an errand, or the walk to the bus. Read them in order the first time through: each section stands on the ones before it, and nothing is used before it has been taught. After that the book becomes reference, and you can open it anywhere.

Say the Hindi out loud wherever you can. The prompts under *Your turn* are written to be spoken, and saying a word is most of what makes it stay. The questions under *Before you move on* carry their own answers in brackets: cover them, answer from memory, then look.

Nothing here is gated behind the alphabet. Each lesson introduces exactly the letters and sounds its own word needs, so you are reading real words from the first page rather than drilling a chart. The whole script is gathered in a reference at the back of the book — somewhere to look things up when you are curious, never a chapter to sit through first.

Released under CC BY-SA 4.0 — share it, adapt it, teach from it.

Contents

Preface **iii**

1 Greetings **1**
- 1.1 नमस्ते (namaste) 1
- 1.2 नमस्कार (namaskār) 3
- 1.3 धन्यवाद (dhanyavād) 4
- 1.4 शुक्रिया (shukriyā) 6
- 1.5 अलविदा (alvidā) 7
- 1.6 शिरोरेखा (shirorekhā) 9
- 1.7 न, म (na, ma) 10
- 1.8 अ (a) 12
- 1.9 क, त (ka, ta) 14
- 1.10 Practice 15

2 Introducing Yourself **17**
- 2.1 नाम (nām) 17
- 2.2 मेरा / मेरी / मेरे (merā / merī / mere) 18
- 2.3 है (hai) 19
- 2.4 मेरा नाम … है (merā nām … hai) 20
- 2.5 आप / तुम (āp / tum) 21
- 2.6 क्या (kyā) 22
- 2.7 आपका नाम क्या है? (āpkā nām kyā hai?) 23
- 2.8 आपसे मिलकर ख़ुशी हुई … (āpse milkar …) 24
- 2.9 ◌ा, ◌े / मात्रा (ā, e / mātrā) 25
- 2.10 ◌ि (i) 27
- 2.11 र, स (ra, sa) 28
- 2.12 मेरा नाम (merā nām) 29
- 2.13 ◌् / विराम / हलंत (virāma / halant) 30
- 2.14 स्त (sta) 31

2.15 नमस्ते (namaste) 32
2.16 नमस्ते (namaste) 34
2.17 नमस्ते (namaste) 34
2.18 Practice 35
2.19 मेरा नाम मीरा है (merā nām Mīrā hai) 36
2.20 । / पूर्ण विराम (pūrṇa virām) 36
2.21 मेरा नाम मीरा है। (merā nām Mīrā hai) 37
2.22 मेरा नाम अरुण है। (merā nām Aruṇ hai) 37
2.23 नमस्ते। मेरा नाम … (namaste. merā …) 38
2.24 नमस्ते। मेरा नाम … (namaste. merā …) 38

3 How Are You? 41
3.1 कैसा / कैसी / कैसे (kaisā / kaisī / kaise) 41
3.2 आप कैसे हैं? (āp kaise haiṁ?) 42
3.3 मैं (maiṁ) 43
3.4 हूँ (hūṁ) 44
3.5 ठीक (ṭhīk) 45
3.6 आपका स्वागत है (āpkā svāgat hai) 47
3.7 Practice 48

4 Farewells 51
4.1 फिर (phir) 51
4.2 मिलेंगे / मिलना … (mileṅge / milnā …) 52
4.3 फिर मिलेंगे (phir milenge) 53
4.4 कल मिलते हैं (kal milte haiṁ) 54
4.5 चलता हूँ / चलती हूँ … (chaltā hūṁ …) 55
4.6 Practice 56

5 The First Verbs 59
5.1 बोलना / बोल (bolnā / bol) 59
5.2 रहना / रहता / में (rahnā / rahtā / meṁ) 60
5.3 करना / काम करना … (karnā / kām …) 61
5.4 बोलता हूँ, बोलती … (boltā hūṁ, boltī …) 63
5.5 मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ (maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ) 64
5.6 Practice 65

6 Numbers One to Five 67
6.1 एक दो तीन चार पाँच (ek do tīn chār pāṁch) 67
6.2 तीन, चार (tīn, chār) 68
6.3 पाँच (pāṁch) 69

6.4 म (ma) 70
6.5 र (ra) 72

7 Yes and No 75
7.1 हाँ / जी हाँ / जी (hāṃ) 75
7.2 नहीं / जानता (nahīṃ / jāntā) 76
7.3 न (na) 78
7.4 क (ka) 80

8 Please 83
8.1 कृपया (kṛpayā) 83
8.2 ृ (ṛ) 84
8.3 अ (a) 87
8.4 े (e) 89
8.5 Practice 91

9 Sorry 93
9.1 माफ़ कीजिए / क्षमा करें (māf kījiye) 93
9.2 आ (ā) 95
9.3 प (pa) 97

10 Days of the Week 101
10.1 सोमवार मंगलवार … (somavār …) 101
10.2 शनिवार रविवार (śanivār ravivār) 103
10.3 ् ((vowel killer)) 104
10.4 ह (ha) 106

11 Four Core Colours 109
11.1 काला सफ़ेद (kālā safed) 109
11.2 लाल नीला (lāl nīlā) 110
11.3 ा (ā) 112
11.4 य (ya) 114

12 Family 117
12.1 पिता / माता … (pitā / mātā …) 117
12.2 भाई बहन (bhāī bahin) 118
12.3 त (ta) 120
12.4 ी (ī) 122

13 Head and Hand 125

13.1 सिर (sir) 125
13.2 हाथ (hāth) 126
13.3 स (sa) 127
13.4 च (ca) 129

14 Seasons 133

14.1 घी (ghī) 133
14.2 ऋतु / वसंत ग्रीष्म … (ṛtu / vasant …) 134
14.3 ◌ँ (candrabindu) 135
14.4 घ (gha) 137
14.5 ऋ (ṛ (Hindi ri)) 139
14.6 Practice 141

15 Water and Bread 143

15.1 ढोल (ḍhol) 143
15.2 पानी रोटी (pānī roṭī) 144
15.3 ष (ssa) 145
15.4 ढ (ḍha) 146

16 Months 149

16.1 जनवरी फ़रवरी मार्च … (janvarī farvarī …) 149
16.2 ◌ु (u) 150
16.3 ◌ं (ṃ) 152

17 Noon and Midnight 155

17.1 दोपहर आधी रात (dopahar ādhī rāt) 155
17.2 ल (la) 156
17.3 ◌ू (ū) 158

18 Telling Time 161

18.1 घंटा / बजना / बज … (ghaṇṭā / bajnā …) 161
18.2 ख (kha) 162
18.3 ◌ो (o) 164

19 Asking Someone's Age 167

19.1 उम्र / आयु (umr / āyu) 167
19.2 कितने साल के हो? … (kitne sāl ke ho?) 168
19.3 द (da) 169

20 Weather 173
20.1 मौसम / गर्मी है ... (mausam / garmī ...) 173
20.2 ध (dha) 175
20.3 थ (tha) 177

21 Numbers Six to Ten 181
21.1 छ (chha) 181
21.2 छह सात आठ नौ दस (chhah sāt āṭh nau das) 183
21.3 छह, नौ, दस (chhah, nau, das) 185

22 Numbers Eleven to Twenty 187
22.1 उ (u) 187
22.2 ऊन (ūn) 189
22.3 ऊ (ū) 190
22.4 ओस (os) 192
22.5 ओ (o) 192
22.6 ग्यारह बारह तेरह ... (gyārah — bīs) 195

23 Dog and Cat 199
23.1 कुत्ता (kuttā) 199
23.2 बिल्ली (billī) 200

24 Green and Yellow 203
24.1 हरा (harā) 203
24.2 पीला (pīlā) 204

25 Day 207
25.1 दिन (din) 207
25.2 ग (ga) 208

26 Night 211
26.1 रात (raat) 211
26.2 फ (pha) 212

27 Good Night 215
27.1 शुभ रात्रि (śubh rātri) 215
27.2 ट (ṭa) 216

28 Morning 221
28.1 सुबह (subah) 221
28.2 ठ (ṭha) 222

29 Evening 227
29.1 शाम (shaam) 227
29.2 ए (e) 228

30 Afternoon 231
30.1 दोपहर (dopahar) 231
30.2 ज (ja) 232

31 Good Morning 235
31.1 सुप्रभात / प्रभात (suprabhāt / prabhāt) 235

32 Good Evening 237
32.1 शुभ संध्या / साँझ (shubh sandhyā / sāñjh) 237
32.2 झ (jha) 238
32.3 श (śa) 241
32.4 शुभ संध्या / नमस्ते (shubh sandhyā / namaste) 243

33 Good Afternoon 245
33.1 शुभ दोपहर (shubh dopahar) 245
33.2 ौ (au) 246

34 Four Verbs of the Mind 249
34.1 सोचना / सोच … (sochnā / soch …) 249
34.2 समझना / समझ … (samajhnā …) 250
34.3 पढ़ना / पढ़ / पढ़ता … (paṛhnā / paṛh …) 252
34.4 लिखना / लिख … (likhnā / likh …) 253

35 Taking, Asking, Helping — and Liking 257
35.1 लेना / ले / लेता … (lenā / le / letā …) 257
35.2 व (va) 259
35.3 पूछना / पूछ / पूछता … (pūchnā / pūch …) 261
35.4 मदद करना / मदद … (madad karnā …) 262
35.5 मुझे … पसंद है (mujhe … pasand hai) 264

36 One House, Four Languages 267
36.1 घर (ghar) 267
36.2 दरवाज़ा (darvāzā) 269
36.3 कमरा (kamrā) 270
36.4 कुर्सी (kursī) 272

37 One Tea, Please 275
37.1 एक चाय दीजिए (ek chāy dījie) 275
37.2 दूध (dūdh) 277
37.3 खाना / ख़ाना (khānā / khāna) 278
37.4 किताब / पुस्तक … (kitāb / pustak …) 279

38 Six Words for Where It Hurts 283
38.1 आँख (āṁkh) 283
38.2 दाँत (danta) 285
38.3 पैर / पाँव (pair / pāṁv) 286
38.4 पेट (peṭ) 288

39 The People Around You 291
39.1 दोस्त (dost) 291
39.2 बच्चा / बच्ची / बछड़ा (bacchā / bacchī …) 293
39.3 आदमी (ādmī) 294
39.4 औरत / महिला / स्त्री (aurat / mahilā …) 296
39.5 औ (au) 297

40 Pointing, and Asking 301
40.1 यह (yah) 301
40.2 वह (vah) 302
40.3 यहाँ (yahā̃) 303
40.4 वहाँ (vahā̃) 304
40.5 कौन (kaun) 304
40.6 कहाँ (kahā̃) 305
40.7 y- / v- / k- 306

41 Describing Things 309
41.1 बड़ा (baṛā) 309
41.2 छोटा (choṭā) 310
41.3 अच्छा (acchā) 311
41.4 नया (nayā) 312
41.5 पुराना (purānā) 313
41.6 before the noun, and it AGREES 313

42 More Everyday Verbs 315
42.1 आना / आता / आती … (ānā / ātā / ātī …) 315
42.2 बैठना (baiṭhnā) 316
42.3 खड़ा होना (khaṛā honā) 317

42.4 देना (denā) 318

43 Verbs of Seeing and Saying 321
43.1 देखना / देख / देखता ... (dekhnā / dekh ...) 321
43.2 सुनना / सुन / सुनता ... (sunnā / sun ...) 322
43.3 बोलना (bolnā) 323
43.4 लिखना (likhnā) 324

44 Sons, Daughters, and Everyone Else 325
44.1 बेटा (beṭā) 325
44.2 बेटी (beṭī) 326
44.3 परिवार (parivār) 327
44.4 लोग (log) 328

45 Things You Ask For 329
45.1 फल (phal) 329
45.2 कपड़ा (kapṛā) 330
45.3 दीया (dīyā) 331
45.4 नमक (namak) 332
45.5 साबुन (sābun) 332

46 Hair, Ear, and Throat 335
46.1 बाल (bāl) 335
46.2 उँगली (uṅglī) 336
46.3 कान (kān) 337
46.4 नाक (nāk) 337
46.5 गला (galā) 338

47 Who Someone Is 341
47.1 शिक्षक (śikṣak) 341
47.2 छात्र (chātra) 342
47.3 किसान (kisān) 343
47.4 मेहमान (mehmān) 344
47.5 पड़ोसी (paṛosī) 345

48 Short Replies 347
48.1 सच (sac) 347
48.2 बस (bas) 348
48.3 ज़रूर (zarūr) 349
48.4 शायद (śāyad) 349
48.5 बिलकुल (bilkul) 350

49 Taking Your Leave 353
49.1 अभी (abhī) 353
49.2 परसों (parsoṁ) 354
49.3 सफ़र (safar) 355
49.4 निकलना (nikalnā) 356
49.5 मुलाक़ात (mulāqāt) 356

50 Courtesy Words 359
50.1 आभार (ābhār) 359
50.2 एहसान (ehsān) 360
50.3 आदर (ādar) 361
50.4 आशीर्वाद (āśīrvād) 362
50.5 प्रणाम (praṇām) 362
50.6 ण (ṇa) 363

51 Welcoming a Guest 367
51.1 फूल (phūl) 367
51.2 माला (mālā) 368
51.3 आँगन (āṁgan) 369
51.4 मेज़ (mez) 369
51.5 मिठाई (miṭhāī) 370

52 In the Kitchen 373
52.1 चावल (chāval) 373
52.2 दाल (dāl) 374
52.3 तेल (tel) 375
52.4 चीनी (chīnī) 376
52.5 सब्ज़ी (sabzī) 377

53 More of the Body 379
53.1 कंधा (kandhā) 379
53.2 घुटना (ghuṭnā) 380
53.3 माथा (māthā) 381
53.4 पीठ (pīṭh) 382
53.5 होंठ (hoṇṭh) 383

54 Animals 385
54.1 गाय (gāy) 385
54.2 घोड़ा (ghoṛā) 386
54.3 मछली (machhlī) 387

54.4 चिड़िया (chiṛiyā) 387
54.5 बकरी (bakrī) 388

55 The Sky 391
55.1 सूरज (sūraj) 391
55.2 चाँद (chā̃d) 392
55.3 तारा (tārā) 393
55.4 बादल (bādal) 393
55.5 आसमान (āsmān) 394

56 The Road 397
56.1 सड़क (saṛak) 397
56.2 गाँव (gā̃v) 398
56.3 बाज़ार (bāzār) 399
56.4 दुकान (dukān) 400
56.5 खेत (khet) 400

57 A Gift and a Feast 403
57.1 तोहफ़ा (tohfā) 403
57.2 दावत (dāvat) 404
57.3 थाली (thālī) 405
57.4 ख़ुशबू (khushbū) 405
57.5 मिठास (miṭhās) 406

58 Inside the House 409
58.1 दीवार (dīvār) 409
58.2 छत (chat) 410
58.3 खिड़की (khiṛkī) 411
58.4 सीढ़ी (sīṛhī) 412
58.5 चादर (chādar) 413

59 The Vowel You Write and Do Not Say 415
59.1 नाम (nām) 415
59.2 ◌ी (-ī) 417
59.3 ◌ु (-u) 418
59.4 ◌ै (-ai) 420
59.5 आ (ā) 420
59.6 ई (ī) 422
59.7 ◌ँ (-ṁ) 423
59.8 भ (bha) 424

59.9 य (ya) 425
59.10 ब (ba) 426
59.11 ड (ḍa) 427

60 Animals in the Yard 431
60.1 बंदर (bandar) 431
60.2 ◌़ (nuqtā) 432
60.3 साँप (sā̃p) 434
60.4 मुर्गी (murgī) 435
60.5 भैंस (bhaĩs) 436
60.6 मोर (mor) 437

61 At the Cooking Fire 439
61.1 बर्तन (bartan) 439
61.2 ज़ फ़ ख़ क़ (za fa xa qa) 440
61.3 चम्मच (chammach) 442
61.4 गिलास (gilās) 442
61.5 तवा (tavā) 443
61.6 चूल्हा (chūlhā) 444

62 What Hands Work With 447
62.1 रस्सी (rassī) 447
62.2 सूई (sūī) 448
62.3 टोकरी (ṭokrī) 449
62.4 मिट्टी (miṭṭī) 450
62.5 लकड़ी (lakṛī) 450

63 What the Body Tells You 453
63.1 भूख (bhūkh) 453
63.2 प्यास (pyās) 454
63.3 नींद (nīnd) 455
63.4 बुख़ार (bukhār) 455
63.5 दर्द (dard) 456

64 How Much and How Fast 459
64.1 अब (ab) 459
64.2 जल्दी (jaldī) 460
64.3 धीरे (dhīre) 461
64.4 कम (kam) 462
64.5 ज़्यादा (zyādā) 463

65 Asking Nicely 465

65.1 मेहरबानी (mehrabānī) 465

65.2 विनती (vintī) 466

65.3 अनुमति (anumati) 467

65.4 भरोसा (bharosā) 468

65.5 अदब (adab) 468

66 The Field and the Well 471

66.1 बीज (bīj) 471

66.2 फ़सल (fasal) 472

66.3 अनाज (anāj) 473

66.4 घास (ghās) 474

66.5 कुआँ (kuā̃) 475

67 The First Form Line: Name 477

67.1 नाम (nām) 477

67.2 A मीरा · B अरुण (A Mīrā; B Aruṇ) 478

67.3 नाम: मीरा (nām: Mīrā) 479

67.4 B to अरुण (B cue: Aruṇ) 479

67.5 नाम: ______________ 480

68 And, Or, But 483

68.1 और (aur) 483

68.2 … या … (… yā …) 484

68.3 लेकिन (lekin) 485

68.4 … और … · … या … … (… aur … · … yā … …) 486

69 Where a Clause Ends, and What Goes Inside One 489

69.1 … क्रिया अंत में (kriyā ant meṁ) 489

69.2 कि (ki) 490

69.3 … कि … (… ki …) 492

70 Able, and Willing 493

70.1 सकना / सकता (saknā / saktā) 493

70.2 चाहना / चाह … (chāhnā / chāh …) 494

70.3 … -ना, एक क्रिया … (-nā, ek kriyā ke …) 496

70.4 … सकना · … चाहना (… saknā · … chāhnā) 497

71 Why, and Because 499
71.1 क्यों (kyoṁ) 499
71.2 क्योंकि (kyoṁki) 500
71.3 क्यों? — क्योंकि ... (kyoṁ? — kyoṁki ...) 501

72 When, and Then 503
72.1 कब (kab) 503
72.2 जब ... तब ... (jab ... tab ...) 504
72.3 कब · जब · तब (kab · jab · tab) 505

73 Two Actions, One Clause 507
73.1 -कर / देखकर / करके (-kar / dekhkar ...) 507
73.2 ... -कर ... (... -kar ...) 508

74 Asking Without a Question Word 511
74.1 क्या ...? (kyā ...?) 511
74.2 आप आ सकते हैं? (āp ā sakte haiṁ?) 512
74.3 ... है ना? (... hai nā?) 513
74.4 क्या ...? · ... ना? ... (kyā ...? · ... nā? ...) 514

75 Where You Come From 517
75.1 देश (desh) 517
75.2 भारत (Bhārat) 518
75.3 शहर (shahar) 519
75.4 भाषा (bhāshā) 520
75.5 अंग्रेज़ी (angrezī) 521

76 Ways of Going 523
76.1 गाड़ी (gāṛī) 523
76.2 रेल (rel) 524
76.3 स्टेशन (sṭeshan) 525
76.4 टिकट (ṭikaṭ) 526
76.5 जाना / जाता (jānā / jātā) 527

77 After the Work Is Done 529
77.1 खेल (khel) 529
77.2 खेलना / खेलता ... (khelnā / kheltā ...) 530
77.3 क्रिकेट (kriket̤) 532
77.4 गाना (gānā) 533
77.5 आराम (ārām) 534

78 Today, and How Much 535
78.1 आज (āj) 535
78.2 भी (bhī) 536
78.3 बहुत (bahut) 537

79 What It Costs 539
79.1 पैसा (paisā) 539
79.2 रुपया (rupayā) 540
79.3 दाम (dām) 541
79.4 महँगा (mahãgā) 542
79.5 ख़रीदना (kharīdnā) 544
79.6 सौ (sau) 545

80 The Eating House 547
80.1 होटल (hoṭal) 547
80.2 नाश्ता (nāshtā) 548
80.3 बिल (bil) 549
80.4 वेटर (veṭar) 550
80.5 पीना / पीता ... (pīnā / pītā ...) 551

81 Words on the Door 553
81.1 खुला / खुलना (khulā / khulnā) 553
81.2 बंद (band) 554
81.3 प्रवेश (pravesh) 555
81.4 निकास (nikās) 556
81.5 देर (der) 557

82 First, Second, Third 559
82.1 पहला / पहली / पहले (pahlā / pahlī ...) 559
82.2 दूसरा / दूसरी (dūsrā / dūsrī) 560
82.3 तीसरा / तीसरी (tīsrā / tīsrī) 562
82.4 चौथा / चौथी (cauthā / cauthī) 563
82.5 पाँचवाँ / पाँचवीं ... (pā̃cvā̃ / pā̃cvī̃ ...) 564

83 Sixth to Tenth 567
83.1 छठा / छठी (chaṭhā / chaṭhī) 567
83.2 सातवाँ / सातवीं (sātvā̃ / sātvī̃) 568
83.3 आठवाँ / आठवीं (āṭhvā̃ / āṭhvī̃) 570
83.4 नौवाँ / नौवीं (nauvā̃ / nauvī̃) 571
83.5 दसवाँ / दसवीं (dasvā̃ / dasvī̃) 572

84 One and the Other 575
84.1 एक … दूसरा (ek … dūsrā) 575
84.2 पहला, दूसरा … (pahlā, dūsrā …) 576

85 Reading — Signs, Notices, and a First Paragraph 579
85.1 (reading) 579
85.2 (reading) 580
85.3 (reading) 581
85.4 (म र न अ प ह य त ◌् ◌ा ◌ी) 582
85.5 (स ष ल ठ ण ऋ ◌ो ◌ौ औ ज़) 583

86 Writing — With A Clock 585
86.1 (timed) 585

87 Lunch and Dinner 587
87.1 दोपहर का खाना … (dopahar kā khānā …) 587

88 Four Adjectives That Do Not Agree 591
88.1 आसान / मुश्किल (āsān / mushkil) 591
88.2 सुंदर / बदसूरत (sundar / badsūrat) 593

89 School: The Borrowed Word and the Built One 595
89.1 स्कूल (skūl) 595
89.2 विद्यालय (vidyālay) 596
89.3 स्कूल / विद्यालय (skūl / vidyālay) 598
89.4 शिक्षक स्कूल में हैं (śikṣak skūl meṁ haiṁ) 599
89.5 (नाम, कैसे, फिर) 600

90 Four Adjectives That Always Agree 603
90.1 लंबा (lambā) 603
90.2 पतला (patlā) 605
90.3 मोटा (moṭā) 606
90.4 नाटा (nāṭā) 607
90.5 बड़ा, छोटा, लंबा … (baṛā, choṭā …) 609
90.6 वह लंबी है (vah lambī hai) 610

91 Character, Not Mood 613
91.1 बुरा (burā) 613
91.2 होशियार (hośiyār) 615
91.3 मेहनती (mehnatī) 616
91.4 शर्मीला (śarmīlā) 618

91.5 मिलनसार (milansār) 619
91.6 गंभीर (gambhīr) 620
91.7 सात शब्द स्वभाव के (sāt śabd svabhāv ke) 622
91.8 वह कैसी है? (vah kaisī hai?) 623

92 Whose, And What A Postposition Does To It 627
92.1 उसका (uskā) 627
92.2 हमारा (hamārā) 629
92.3 तुम्हारा (tumhārā) 630
92.4 अपना (apnā) 631
92.5 मेरे पास (mere pās) 633
92.6 मेरे लिए (mere liye) 634
92.7 पाँच मालिक, एक नियम (pā̃ch mālik, ek ...) 636
92.8 आपके पास क्या है? (āpke pās kyā hai?) 637

93 Telling Somebody To Do Something 639
93.1 बोलो (bolo) 639
93.2 बोलिए (boliye) 641
93.3 तुम हो (tum ho) 642
93.4 मत (mat) 644
93.5 तीन स्तर, एक क्रिया (tīn star, ek kriyā) 645
93.6 यहाँ मत बैठिए (yahā̃ mat baiṭhiye) 646

94 The Pronouns, And The Article Hindi Does Not Have 649
94.1 हम (ham) 649
94.2 वे (ve) 650
94.3 हमें / तुम्हें (hamẽ / tumhẽ) 652
94.4 आपको / उसे (āpko / use) 653
94.5 बिना आर्टिकल (binā ārṭikal) 654
94.6 सर्वनाम की तालिका (sarvanām kī tālikā) 656
94.7 हम स्टेशन पर मिलेंगे (ham sṭeśan par milẽge) 657
94.8 (पेट, औरत, सीढ़ी, चादर) 658

95 The Past, And Where You Were 661
95.1 पर (par) 661
95.2 था (thā) 662
95.3 थी (thī) 664
95.4 थे (the) 665
95.5 नहीं था (nahīṃ thā) 667
95.6 बोलता था (boltā thā) 668

95.7 अतीत की तालिका (atīt kī tālikā) 669
95.8 आप कहाँ थे? (āp kahā̃ the?) 671

96 The Future, And The Two Letters It Needed 673
96.1 करूँगा (karūṅgā) 673
96.2 आऊँगा (āūṅgā) 675
96.3 आएगा (āegā) 676
96.4 आएँगे (āeṅge) 678
96.5 आओगे (āoge) 679
96.6 पाँच बजे (pā̃c baje) 680
96.7 भविष्य की तालिका (bhaviṣya kī tālikā) 682
96.8 मैं पाँच बजे आऊँगा (maiṁ pā̃c baje āūṅgā) 683

97 What Is Going On Right Now 687
97.1 कर रहा हूँ (kar rahā hū̃) 687
97.2 कर रही हूँ (kar rahī hū̃) 688
97.3 कर रहा है (kar rahā hai) 690
97.4 कर रहे हैं (kar rahe haiṁ) 691
97.5 दो वर्तमान (do vartamān) 692
97.6 अभी की तालिका (abhī kī tālikā) 694
97.7 आप क्या कर रहे हैं? (āp kyā kar rahe haiṁ?) 695

98 A Day, In The Order It Happens 699
98.1 से (se) 699
98.2 बस से (bas se) 701
98.3 उठना (uṭhnā) 702
98.4 काम (kām) 703
98.5 पहले (pahle) 705
98.6 के बाद (ke bād) 706
98.7 दिनचर्या की तालिका (dincaryā kī tālikā) 707
98.8 मेरी दिनचर्या (merī dincaryā) 709

99 The Noun, And The Ending That Means Two Things 711
99.1 बच्चे (bacce) 711
99.2 किताबें (kitābeṁ) 713
99.3 भाषाएँ (bhāṣāẽ) 714
99.4 दो आदमी (do ādmī) 716
99.5 को (ko) 717
99.6 बच्चे को (bacce ko) 719
99.7 यह किताब (yah kitāb) 720

99.8 संज्ञा की तालिका (saṁjñā kī tālikā) 722
99.9 दो भाषाएँ बोलती है (do bhāṣāẽ boltī hai) 723

100 How Much, How Well, How Big 727
100.1 थोड़ा (thoṛā) 727
100.2 अच्छा / बुरा (acchā / burā) 729
100.3 से बड़ा (se baṛā) 730
100.4 कितना (kitnā) 731
100.5 कितना अच्छा! (kitnā acchā!) 733
100.6 मात्रा की तालिका (mātrā kī tālikā) 734
100.7 हाँ, थोड़ी (hā̃, thoṛī) 736

101 Two Words Where English Has One 739
101.1 के साथ (ke sāth) 739
101.2 के बिना (ke binā) 741
101.3 घर के पास (ghar ke pās) 742
101.4 के सामने (ke sāmne) 744
101.5 के पीछे (ke pīche) 745
101.6 परिवार के लिए (parivār ke liye) 746
101.7 करने के लिए (karne ke liye) 748
101.8 संबंध की तालिका (sambandh kī tālikā) 749
101.9 दुकान कहाँ है? (dukān kahā̃ hai?) 751

102 From, Until, and Instead 753
102.1 तक (tak) 753
102.2 सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक (somvār se …) 754
102.3 सुबह से शाम तक (subah se śām tak) 756
102.4 ट्रेन (ṭren) 757
102.5 नहीं की जगह (nahīṁ kī jagah) 759
102.6 से की तालिका (se kī tālikā) 760
102.7 मैं ट्रेन से जाऊँगा (maiṁ ṭren se jāūṁgā) 762

103 What I Know and What I Want 765
103.1 मैं जानता हूँ (maiṁ jāntā hūṁ) 765
103.2 क्या आप जानते हैं? (kyā āp jānte haiṁ?) 766
103.3 चाहिए (cāhiye) 768
103.4 मुझे चाय चाहिए (mujhe cāy cāhiye) 769
103.5 चाह की तालिका (cāh kī tālikā) 771
103.6 आपको क्या चाहिए? (āpko kyā cāhiye?) 772

104 Counting Past Twenty 775
104.1 तीस चालीस (tīs cālīs) 775
104.2 पचास साठ (pacās sāṭh) 776
104.3 सत्तर अस्सी नब्बे (sattar assī nabbe) 777
104.4 गिनती की तालिका (gintī kī tālikā) 779
104.5 Practice 780

105 Speaking to Somebody 783
105.1 मीरा जी (Mīrā jī) 783
105.2 प्रिय (priya) 784
105.3 संबोधन (sambodhan) 786
105.4 प्रिय मीरा, (priya Mīrā,) 787
105.5 प्रिय अरुण, (priya Aruṇ,) 788
105.6 (स, ऋ, चादर, खाना) 789

106 Not Feeling Well 791
106.1 थकान (thakān) 791
106.2 ज़ुकाम (zukām) 792
106.3 खाँसी (khā̃sī) 793
106.4 बीमार (bīmār) 794
106.5 तबीयत (tabīyat) 794

107 At the Doctor 797
107.1 डाक्टर (ḍākṭar) 797
107.2 अस्पताल (aspatāl) 798
107.3 चोट (coṭ) 799
107.4 कमज़ोरी (kamzorī) 800
107.5 सेहत (sehat) 800

108 Fear, Anger, Sadness 803
108.1 डर (ḍar) 803
108.2 गुस्सा (gussā) 804
108.3 उदास (udās) 805
108.4 परेशान (pareśān) 806
108.5 चिंता (cintā) 806

109 Laughter and Tears 809
109.1 हँसी (hãsī) 809
109.2 आँसू (ā̃sū) 810
109.3 दुख (dukh) 811

109.4 अकेला (akelā) 812
109.5 ठंडा (ṭhaṇḍā) 812

110 Once More, Please 815
110.1 दोबारा (dobārā) 815
110.2 ज़ोर से (zor se) 816
110.3 एक मिनट (ek minaṭ) 817
110.4 रुकिए (rukie) 818
110.5 मतलब (matlab) 819

111 How Do You Say It? 821
111.1 हिंदी में (hindī meṁ) 821
111.2 कैसे कहते हैं? (kaise kahte haiṁ?) 822
111.3 दिखाइए (dikhāie) 823
111.4 सुनाई नहीं दिया (sunāī nahīṁ diyā) 824
111.5 लिख दीजिए (likh dījie) 825

112 Right, Wrong, Sure 827
112.1 सही (sahī) 827
112.2 ग़लत (ġalat) 828
112.3 पक्का (pakkā) 829
112.4 सच में? (sac meṁ?) 830
112.5 अरे (are) 830

113 Nothing, Not Yet, Maybe 833
113.1 कुछ नहीं (kuch nahīṁ) 833
113.2 अभी नहीं (abhī nahīṁ) 834
113.3 काफ़ी (kāfī) 835
113.4 वही (vahī) 836
113.5 हो सकता है (ho saktā hai) 836

114 Sorry, No Problem, Congratulations 839
114.1 माफ़ी (māfī) 839
114.2 कोई बात नहीं (koī bāt nahīṁ) 840
114.3 बधाई (badhāī) 841
114.4 शुभकामनाएँ (śubhkāmnāẽ) 842
114.5 निमंत्रण (nimantraṇ) 843

115 Come In, Here You Are 845
115.1 आइए (āie) 845
115.2 पधारिए (padhārie) 846
115.3 लीजिए (lījie) 847
115.4 शौक़ से (śauq se) 848
115.5 जी नहीं (jī nahīṁ) 849
115.6 (dialogue) 849
115.7 (dialogue) 850

116 Grandparents, and Which Side 853
116.1 दादा (dādā) 853
116.2 दादी (dādī) 854
116.3 नाना (nānā) 855
116.4 नानी (nānī) 856
116.5 चाचा (cācā) 857

117 Aunts, Uncles, In-Laws 859
117.1 मौसी (mausī) 859
117.2 बुआ (buā) 860
117.3 मामा (māmā) 861
117.4 भाभी (bhābhī) 862
117.5 ससुराल (sasurāl) 863

118 Boys, Girls, Husbands, Wives 865
118.1 लड़का (laṛkā) 865
118.2 लड़की (laṛkī) 866
118.3 पति (pati) 867
118.4 पत्नी (patnī) 868
118.5 रिश्तेदार (riśtedār) 868

119 Work and Marriage 871
119.1 नौकरी (naukrī) 871
119.2 पेशा (peśā) 872
119.3 शादी (śādī) 873
119.4 शादीशुदा (śādīśudā) 874
119.5 जन्मदिन (janmdin) 874

120 Forms and Introductions 877
120.1 हस्ताक्षर (hastākṣar) 877
120.2 पहचान (pahcān) 878

120.3 परिचय (paricay) 879
120.4 इंसान (insān) 880
120.5 मिलकर अच्छा लगा (milkar acchā lagā) 881

121 Take Care 883
121.1 ध्यान रखिए (dhyān rakhie) 883
121.2 संभलकर (sambhalkar) 884
121.3 शुभ यात्रा (śubh yātrā) 885
121.4 फिर आइएगा (phir āiegā) 886
121.5 चलिए (calie) 886

122 It's Getting Late 889
122.1 छुट्टी (chuṭṭī) 889
122.2 देर हो गई (der ho gaī) 890
122.3 आराम से (ārām se) 891
122.4 इजाज़त (ijāzat) 892
122.5 जाना है (jānā hai) 893

123 How's It Going? 895
123.1 क्या हाल है? (kyā hāl hai?) 895
123.2 सब ठीक? (sab ṭhīk?) 896
123.3 बहुत दिन हो गए (bahut din ho gae) 897
123.4 क्या चल रहा है? (kyā cal rahā hai?) 898
123.5 खाना खाया? (khānā khāyā?) 898

124 Hungry, Thirsty, Sleepy 901
124.1 भूखा (bhūkhā) 901
124.2 प्यासा (pyāsā) 902
124.3 नींद आ रही है (nīnd ā rahī hai) 903
124.4 पसीना (pasīnā) 904
124.5 सिरदर्द (sirdard) 904

125 Calm and Restless 907
125.1 शांत (śānt) 907
125.2 घबराहट (ghabrāhaṭ) 908
125.3 बेचैन (becain) 909
125.4 मन नहीं है (man nahīṁ hai) 910
125.5 मज़ा (mazā) 910

126 What Did You Say? 913
126.1 फिर से (phir se) 913
126.2 समझ नहीं आया (samajh nahīṁ āyā) 914
126.3 क्या कहा? (kyā kahā?) 915
126.4 मुझे नहीं पता (mujhe nahīṁ patā) 916
126.5 एक बार और (ek bār aur) 917

127 Not at All 919
127.1 मालूम नहीं (mālūm nahīṁ) 919
127.2 बिलकुल नहीं (bilkul nahīṁ) 920
127.3 सचमुच (sacmuc) 921
127.4 अच्छा जी (acchā jī) 922
127.5 चलेगा (calegā) 922
127.6 (dialogue) 923
127.7 (dialogue) 924

128 Letters You Have Read All Along 927
128.1 ि (i kī mātrā) 927
128.2 इ (i) 928
128.3 ञ (ña) 930
128.4 (three letters) 931
128.5 (three letters) 932

129 Lock, Pillow, Blanket, Curtain, Bucket 933
129.1 ताला (tālā) 933
129.2 तकिया (takiyā) 934
129.3 कंबल (kambal) 935
129.4 परदा (pardā) 936
129.5 बाल्टी (bālṭī) 936

130 Hammer, Nail, Scissors, Thread, Comb 939
130.1 हथौड़ा (hathauṛā) 939
130.2 कील (kīl) 940
130.3 कैंची (kaĩcī) 941
130.4 धागा (dhāgā) 942
130.5 कंघी (kaṅghī) 942

131 Towel, Broom, Box, Bag, Candle 945
131.1 तौलिया (tauliyā) 945
131.2 झाड़ू (jhāṛū) 946

131.3 डिब्बा (ḍibbā) 947
131.4 थैला (thailā) 948
131.5 मोमबत्ती (mombattī) 948

132 Matches, Small bowl, Knife, Fan, Watch 951
132.1 माचिस (māchis) 951
132.2 कटोरी (kaṭorī) 952
132.3 छुरी (churī) 953
132.4 पंखा (pankhā) 954
132.5 घड़ी (ghaṛī) 954

133 Glasses, Umbrella, Wallet, Bed frame, Bedding 957
133.1 चश्मा (caśmā) 957
133.2 छाता (chātā) 958
133.3 बटुआ (baṭuā) 959
133.4 पलंग (palaṅg) 960
133.5 बिस्तर (bistar) 960

134 Bottle, Pencil, Picture, Mirror, Ring 963
134.1 बोतल (botal) 963
134.2 पेंसिल (pensil) 964
134.3 तस्वीर (tasvīr) 965
134.4 शीशा (śīśā) 966
134.5 अंगूठी (aṅgūṭhī) 967

135 Sandal, Shoe, Sock, Shirt, Trousers 969
135.1 चप्पल (cappal) 969
135.2 जूता (jūtā) 970
135.3 मोज़ा (mozā) 971
135.4 कमीज़ (kamīz) 971
135.5 पैंट (paiṇṭ) 972

136 Kurta, Sari, Scarf, Cap, Coat 975
136.1 कुर्ता (kurtā) 975
136.2 साड़ी (sāṛī) 976
136.3 दुपट्टा (dupaṭṭā) 977
136.4 टोपी (ṭopī) 978
136.5 कोट (koṭ) 979

137 Jumper, Egg, Meat, Potato, Onion 981
137.1 स्वेटर (sveṭar) . . . 981
137.2 अंडा (aṇḍā) . . . 982
137.3 गोश्त (gośt) . . . 983
137.4 आलू (ālū) . . . 983
137.5 प्याज़ (pyāz) . . . 984

138 Garlic, Ginger, Tomato, Carrot, Cauliflower 987
138.1 लहसुन (lahsun) . . . 987
138.2 अदरक (adrak) . . . 988
138.3 टमाटर (ṭamāṭar) . . . 989
138.4 गाजर (gājar) . . . 990
138.5 गोभी (gobhī) . . . 990
138.6 (dialogue) . . . 991
138.7 (dialogue) . . . 992

139 Peas, Cucumber, Mango, Banana, Apple 995
139.1 मटर (maṭar) . . . 995
139.2 खीरा (khīrā) . . . 996
139.3 आम (ām) . . . 997
139.4 केला (kelā) . . . 998
139.5 सेब (seb) . . . 998

140 Grapes, Orange, Watermelon, Coconut, Yoghurt 1001
140.1 अंगूर (aṅgūr) . . . 1001
140.2 संतरा (santarā) . . . 1002
140.3 तरबूज़ (tarbūz) . . . 1003
140.4 नारियल (nāriyal) . . . 1004
140.5 दही (dahī) . . . 1004

141 Butter, Paneer, Honey, Chilli, Flour 1007
141.1 मक्खन (makkhan) . . . 1007
141.2 पनीर (panīr) . . . 1008
141.3 शहद (śahad) . . . 1009
141.4 मिर्च (mirc) . . . 1009
141.5 आटा (āṭā) . . . 1010

142 Samosa, Lassi, Juice, Mountain, River 1013
142.1 समोसा (samosā) . . . 1013
142.2 लस्सी (lassī) . . . 1014

142.3 जूस (jūs) 1015
142.4 पहाड़ (pahāṛ) 1015
142.5 नदी (nadī) 1016

143 Lake, Sea, Forest, Tree, Root 1019
143.1 झील (jhīl) 1019
143.2 समुद्र (samudra) 1020
143.3 जंगल (jaṅgal) 1021
143.4 पेड़ (peṛ) 1022
143.5 जड़ (jaṛ) 1022

144 Stone, Sand, Wave, Shore, Electricity 1025
144.1 पत्थर (patthar) 1025
144.2 रेत (ret) 1026
144.3 लहर (lahar) 1027
144.4 किनारा (kinārā) 1028
144.5 बिजली (bijlī) 1028

145 Storm, Fog, Snow, Wind, Lion 1031
145.1 आँधी (ā̃dhī) 1031
145.2 कोहरा (kohrā) 1032
145.3 बर्फ़ (barf) 1033
145.4 हवा (havā) 1034
145.5 शेर (śer) 1034

146 Bear, Elephant, Camel, Donkey, Sheep 1037
146.1 भालू (bhālū) 1037
146.2 हाथी (hāthī) 1038
146.3 ऊँट (ū̃ṭ) 1039
146.4 गधा (gadhā) 1040
146.5 भेड़ (bheṛ) 1040

147 Rabbit, Deer, Fox, Wolf, Crow 1043
147.1 खरगोश (khargoś) 1043
147.2 हिरन (hiran) 1044
147.3 लोमड़ी (lomṛī) 1045
147.4 भेड़िया (bheṛiyā) 1046
147.5 कौआ (kauā) 1046
147.6 (dialogue) 1047
147.7 (dialogue) 1048

148 Pigeon, Parrot, Owl, Butterfly, Fly 1049
148.1 कबूतर (kabūtar) 1049
148.2 तोता (totā) 1050
148.3 उल्लू (ullū) 1051
148.4 तितली (titlī) 1051
148.5 मक्खी (makkhī) 1052

149 Mosquito, Ant, Frog, Tortoise, Mouse 1055
149.1 मच्छर (macchar) 1055
149.2 चींटी (cīṇṭī) 1056
149.3 मेंढक (meṇḍhak) 1057
149.4 कछुआ (kachuā) 1058
149.5 चूहा (cūhā) 1058

150 Elbow, Wrist, Thumb, Fingernail, Cheek 1061
150.1 कोहनी (kohnī) 1061
150.2 कलाई (kalāī) 1062
150.3 अंगूठा (aṅgūṭhā) 1063
150.4 नाखून (nākhūn) 1064
150.5 गाल (gāl) 1064

151 Chin, Tongue, Neck, Chest, Waist 1067
151.1 ठोड़ी (ṭhoṛī) 1067
151.2 जीभ (jībh) 1068
151.3 गर्दन (gardan) 1069
151.4 छाती (chātī) 1069
151.5 कमर (kamar) 1070

152 Blood, Post office, Library, Temple, Mosque 1073
152.1 ख़ून (khūn) 1073
152.2 डाकघर (ḍākghar) 1074
152.3 पुस्तकालय (pustakālay) 1075
152.4 मंदिर (mandir) 1076
152.5 मस्जिद (masjid) 1076

153 Garden, Field, Bridge, Office, Bank 1079
153.1 बगीचा (bagīcā) 1079
153.2 मैदान (maidān) 1080
153.3 पुल (pul) 1081
153.4 दफ़्तर (daftar) 1081

153.5 बैंक (baiṅk) 1082

154 Hot, Wet, Dry, Heavy, Light 1085
154.1 गरम (garam) 1085
154.2 गीला (gīlā) 1086
154.3 सूखा (sūkhā) 1087
154.4 भारी (bhārī) 1088
154.5 हल्का (halkā) 1088

155 Soft, Hard, Clean, Dirty, Fast 1091
155.1 नरम (naram) 1091
155.2 सख़्त (sakht) 1092
155.3 साफ़ (sāf) 1093
155.4 गंदा (gandā) 1093
155.5 तेज़ (tez) 1094

156 Slow, Sour, Bitter, Salty, Spicy 1097
156.1 धीमा (dhīmā) 1097
156.2 खट्टा (khaṭṭā) 1098
156.3 कड़वा (kaṛvā) 1099
156.4 नमकीन (namkīn) 1100
156.5 तीखा (tīkhā) 1100
156.6 (dialogue) 1101
156.7 (dialogue) 1102

157 Fresh, Rich, Poor, Young, Old 1103
157.1 ताज़ा (tāzā) 1103
157.2 अमीर (amīr) 1104
157.3 ग़रीब (ġarīb) 1105
157.4 जवान (javān) 1106
157.5 बूढ़ा (būṛhā) 1106

158 Wide, Deep, High, Low, Empty 1109
158.1 चौड़ा (cauṛā) 1109
158.2 गहरा (gahrā) 1110
158.3 ऊँचा (ū̃cā) 1111
158.4 नीचा (nīcā) 1112
158.5 ख़ाली (khālī) 1112

159 Full, To sleep, To wake up, To run, To put 1115
159.1 भरा (bharā) 1115
159.2 सोना (sonā) 1116
159.3 जागना (jāgnā) 1117
159.4 दौड़ना (dauṛnā) 1118
159.5 रखना (rakhnā) 1118

160 To send, To bring, To open, To wash, To bathe 1121
160.1 भेजना (bhejnā) 1121
160.2 लाना (lānā) 1122
160.3 खोलना (kholnā) 1123
160.4 धोना (dhonā) 1124
160.5 नहाना (nahānā) 1124

161 To cook, To cut, To break, To fall, To fly 1127
161.1 पकाना (pakānā) 1127
161.2 काटना (kāṭnā) 1128
161.3 तोड़ना (toṛnā) 1129
161.4 गिरना (girnā) 1129
161.5 उड़ना (uṛnā) 1130

162 To swim, To dance, To laugh, To cry, To forget 1133
162.1 तैरना (tairnā) 1133
162.2 नाचना (nācnā) 1134
162.3 हँसना (hãsnā) 1135
162.4 रोना (ronā) 1135
162.5 भूलना (bhūlnā) 1136

163 To win, To lose, To sell, To look for, To wear 1139
163.1 जीतना (jītnā) 1139
163.2 हारना (hārnā) 1140
163.3 बेचना (becnā) 1141
163.4 ढूँढना (ḍhū̃ḍhnā) 1142
163.5 पहनना (pahannā) 1142

164 To call, To teach, To learn, To arrive, To come back 1145
164.1 बुलाना (bulānā) 1145
164.2 सिखाना (sikhānā) 1146
164.3 सीखना (sīkhnā) 1147
164.4 पहुँचना (pahũcnā) 1148

164.5 लौटना (lauṭnā) 1148

165 To catch, To touch, To explain, To play, To count 1151
165.1 पकड़ना (pakaṛnā) 1151
165.2 छूना (chūnā) 1152
165.3 समझाना (samjhānā) 1153
165.4 बजाना (bajānā) 1154
165.5 गिनना (ginnā) 1154
165.6 (dialogue) 1155
165.7 (dialogue) 1156

166 A Notice, a Message, Opening Times, an Advert, a Repair 1157
166.1 सूचना (sūcnā) 1157
166.2 संदेश (sandeś) 1158
166.3 समय (samay) 1159
166.4 विज्ञापन (vijñāpan) 1160
166.5 मरम्मत (marammat) 1161

167 Rent, a Date, a Number, a Floor, a Receipt 1163
167.1 किराया (kirāyā) 1163
167.2 तारीख़ (tārīkh) 1164
167.3 नंबर (nambar) 1165
167.4 मंज़िल (manzil) 1166
167.5 रसीद (rasīd) 1167
167.6 (dialogue) 1167
167.7 (dialogue) 1168

168 To accept, To mix, To change, To drive, To leave 1169
168.1 मानना (mānnā) 1169
168.2 मिलाना (milānā) 1170
168.3 बदलना (badalnā) 1171
168.4 चलाना (calānā) 1172
168.5 छोड़ना (choṛnā) 1172

169 To join, To reduce, To increase, To save, To escape 1175
169.1 जोड़ना (joṛnā) 1175
169.2 घटाना (ghaṭānā) 1176
169.3 बढ़ाना (baṛhānā) 1177
169.4 बचाना (bacānā) 1178

169.5 बचना (bacnā) 1178

170 To die, To live, To pass (of time), To lift, To tell (a story) 1181
170.1 मरना (marnā) 1181
170.2 जीना (jīnā) 1182
170.3 बीतना (bītnā) 1183
170.4 उठाना (uṭhānā) 1184
170.5 सुनाना (sunānā) 1184

171 To show, To be seen, To hide (something), To hide (oneself), To stop 1187
171.1 दिखाना (dikhānā) 1187
171.2 दिखना (dikhnā) 1188
171.3 छिपाना (chipānā) 1189
171.4 छिपना (chipnā) 1190
171.5 रुकना (ruknā) 1191

172 To stop (someone or something), To run away, To climb, To get down, To stroll 1193
172.1 रोकना (roknā) 1193
172.2 भागना (bhāgnā) 1194
172.3 चढ़ना (caṛhnā) 1195
172.4 उतरना (utarnā) 1196
172.5 घूमना (ghūmnā) 1197

173 To cover, To fill, To share, To choose, To ask for 1199
173.1 ढकना (ḍhaknā) 1199
173.2 भरना (bharnā) 1200
173.3 बाँटना (bā̃ṭnā) 1201
173.4 चुनना (cunnā) 1202
173.5 माँगना (mā̃gnā) 1202

174 To give back, To decorate, To look after, To improve, To weigh 1205
174.1 लौटाना (lauṭānā) 1205
174.2 सजाना (sajānā) 1206
174.3 सँभालना (sãbhālnā) 1207
174.4 सुधारना (sudhārnā) 1208
174.5 तोलना (tolnā) 1209

175 To measure, To drop, To light, To burn (by itself), To put out (a fire or light) 1211
175.1 नापना (nāpnā) 1211
175.2 गिराना (girānā) 1212
175.3 जलाना (jalānā) 1213
175.4 जलना (jalnā) 1214
175.5 बुझाना (bujhānā) 1214
175.6 (dialogue) 1215
175.7 (dialogue) 1216

176 To shake, To pull, To push, To throw, To taste 1219
176.1 हिलाना (hilānā) 1219
176.2 खींचना (khī̃cnā) 1220
176.3 धकेलना (dhakelnā) 1221
176.4 फेंकना (phẽknā) 1222
176.5 चखना (cakhnā) 1222

177 To smell, To celebrate, To grind, To boil, To fry 1225
177.1 सूँघना (sū̃ghnā) 1225
177.2 मनाना (manānā) 1226
177.3 पीसना (pīsnā) 1227
177.4 उबालना (ubālnā) 1228
177.5 तलना (talnā) 1228

178 To weave, To hit, To fight, To be afraid, To shout 1231
178.1 बुनना (bunnā) 1231
178.2 मारना (mārnā) 1232
178.3 लड़ना (laṛnā) 1233
178.4 डरना (ḍarnā) 1234
178.5 चिल्लाना (cillānā) 1234

179 To get tired, To bear, To remove, To move aside, To pass by 1237
179.1 थकना (thaknā) 1237
179.2 सहना (sahnā) 1238
179.3 हटाना (haṭānā) 1239
179.4 हटना (haṭnā) 1240
179.5 गुज़रना (guzarnā) 1240

180 Medicine, A patient, Treatment, A journey, Luggage 1243
180.1 दवा (davā) 1243
180.2 मरीज़ (marīz) 1244
180.3 इलाज (ilāj) 1245
180.4 यात्रा (yātrā) 1245
180.5 सामान (sāmān) 1246

181 A map, A way, A turn, A crossroads, A ship 1249
181.1 नक़्शा (naqśā) 1249
181.2 रास्ता (rāstā) 1250
181.3 मोड़ (moṛ) 1251
181.4 चौराहा (caurāhā) 1252
181.5 जहाज़ (jahāz) 1252

182 A boat, A seat, A salary, An owner, A labourer 1255
182.1 नाव (nāv) 1255
182.2 सीट (sīṭ) 1256
182.3 तनख़्वाह (tankhvāh) 1257
182.4 मालिक (mālik) 1257
182.5 मज़दूर (mazdūr) 1258

183 A factory, A shopkeeper, A customer, A meeting, A kitchen 1261
183.1 कारख़ाना (kārkhānā) 1261
183.2 दुकानदार (dukāndār) 1262
183.3 ग्राहक (grāhak) 1263
183.4 बैठक (baiṭhak) 1263
183.5 रसोई (rasoī) 1264
183.6 (dialogue) 1265
183.7 (dialogue) 1266

184 A floor (surface), A key, A cupboard, A mirror, Rain 1267
184.1 फ़र्श (farś) 1267
184.2 चाबी (cābī) 1268
184.3 अलमारी (almārī) 1269
184.4 आईना (āīnā) 1269
184.5 बारिश (bāriś) 1270

185 Sunshine, Cold, Heat, A storm, A leaf 1273
185.1 धूप (dhūp) 1273
185.2 ठंड (ṭhaṇḍ) 1274
185.3 गर्मी (garmī) 1275
185.4 तूफ़ान (tūfān) 1275
185.5 पत्ता (pattā) 1276

186 Anger, Love, Shame, Hope, A memory 1279
186.1 ग़ुस्सा (ġussā) 1279
186.2 प्यार (pyār) 1280
186.3 शर्म (śarm) 1281
186.4 उम्मीद (ummīd) 1281
186.5 याद (yād) 1282

187 A church, A police station, A postman, The cinema, A park 1285
187.1 गिरजाघर (girjāghar) 1285
187.2 थाना (thānā) 1286
187.3 डाकिया (ḍākiyā) 1287
187.4 सिनेमा (sinemā) 1288
187.5 पार्क (pārk) 1288

188 A button, A pocket, An enemy, An aunt (father's brother's wife), A nephew (brother's son) 1291
188.1 बटन (baṭan) 1291
188.2 जेब (jeb) 1292
188.3 दुश्मन (duśman) 1293
188.4 चाची (cācī) 1293
188.5 भतीजा (bhatījā) 1294

189 A letter, A story, A question, An answer, A mistake 1297
189.1 चिट्ठी (ciṭṭhī) 1297
189.2 कहानी (kahānī) 1298
189.3 सवाल (savāl) 1299
189.4 जवाब (javāb) 1299
189.5 ग़लती (ġaltī) 1300

190 Help, News, A newspaper, A thing, A colour 1303
190.1 मदद (madad) 1303
190.2 ख़बर (khabar) 1304

190.3 अख़बार (akhbār) 1305
190.4 चीज़ (cīz) 1306
190.5 रंग (raṅg) 1306

191 A week, A year, A century, A moment, A minute 1309
191.1 हफ़्ता (haftā) 1309
191.2 साल (sāl) 1310
191.3 सदी (sadī) 1311
191.4 पल (pal) 1311
191.5 मिनट (miniṭ) 1312

192 Every day, Sometimes, Always, Often, Never 1315
192.1 रोज़ (roz) 1315
192.2 कभी (kabhī) 1316
192.3 हमेशा (hameśā) 1317
192.4 अक्सर (aksar) 1317
192.5 कभी नहीं (kabhī nahī̃) 1318
192.6 (dialogue) 1319
192.7 (dialogue) 1320

193 A teacher, A lawyer, A soldier, A tailor, A barber 1321
193.1 अध्यापक (adhyāpak) 1321
193.2 वकील (vakīl) 1322
193.3 सिपाही (sipāhī) 1323
193.4 दर्ज़ी (darzī) 1323
193.5 नाई (nāī) 1324

194 A washerman, A cook, A driver, An engineer, A writer 1327
194.1 धोबी (dhobī) 1327
194.2 बावर्ची (bāvarcī) 1328
194.3 ड्राइवर (ḍrāivar) 1329
194.4 इंजीनियर (injīniyar) 1329
194.5 लेखक (lekhak) 1330

195 A poet, A painter, A singer, A player, A leader 1333
195.1 कवि (kavi) 1333
195.2 चित्रकार (citrakār) 1334
195.3 गायक (gāyak) 1335
195.4 खिलाड़ी (khilāṛī) 1336
195.5 नेता (netā) 1336

196 A minister, A king, A queen, A servant, A thief 1339
196.1 मंत्री (mantrī) 1339
196.2 राजा (rājā) 1340
196.3 रानी (rānī) 1341
196.4 नौकर (naukar) 1341
196.5 चोर (cor) 1342

197 A class, An examination, A lesson, Practice, A mark 1345
197.1 कक्षा (kakṣā) 1345
197.2 परीक्षा (parīkṣā) 1346
197.3 पाठ (pāṭh) 1347
197.4 अभ्यास (abhyās) 1347
197.5 अंक (aṅk) 1348

198 A word, A sentence, A meaning, Knowledge, Science 1351
198.1 शब्द (śabd) 1351
198.2 वाक्य (vākya) 1352
198.3 अर्थ (arth) 1353
198.4 ज्ञान (jñān) 1353
198.5 विज्ञान (vijñān) 1354

199 History, Mathematics, A crow, The heart, A bone 1357
199.1 इतिहास (itihās) 1357
199.2 गणित (gaṇit) 1358
199.3 कौवा (kauvā) 1359
199.4 दिल (dil) 1359
199.5 हड्डी (haḍḍī) 1360

200 Skin, A state, A capital city, A border, An island 1363
200.1 त्वचा (tvacā) 1363
200.2 राज्य (rājya) 1364
200.3 राजधानी (rājdhānī) 1365
200.4 सीमा (sīmā) 1365
200.5 द्वीप (dvīp) 1366

201 A desert, A valley, A waterfall, A pond, A mine 1369
201.1 रेगिस्तान (registān) 1369
201.2 घाटी (ghāṭī) 1370
201.3 झरना (jharnā) 1371
201.4 तालाब (tālāb) 1372

201.5 खदान (khadān) 1372
201.6 (dialogue) 1373
201.7 (dialogue) 1374

202 A cave, A palace, A fort, A tower, A garden 1377
202.1 गुफ़ा (gufā) 1377
202.2 महल (mahal) 1378
202.3 क़िला (qilā) 1379
202.4 मीनार (mīnār) 1379
202.5 बाग़ (bāg) 1380

203 A zoo, A museum, A tunnel, A bicycle, A scooter 1383
203.1 चिड़ियाघर (ciṛiyāghar) 1383
203.2 संग्रहालय (saṅgrahālay) 1384
203.3 सुरंग (suraṅg) 1385
203.4 साइकिल (sāikil) 1385
203.5 स्कूटर (skūṭar) 1386

204 A lorry, A rickshaw, An aeroplane, Petrol, A telephone 1389
204.1 ट्रक (ṭrak) 1389
204.2 रिक्शा (rikśā) 1390
204.3 हवाई जहाज़ (havāī jahāz) 1391
204.4 पेट्रोल (peṭrol) 1392
204.5 फ़ोन (phon) 1392

205 A letter, An envelope, A ticket office, A message, A conversation 1395
205.1 पत्र (patra) 1395
205.2 लिफ़ाफ़ा (lifāfā) 1396
205.3 टिकट घर (ṭikaṭ ghar) 1397
205.4 संदेसा (sandesā) 1397
205.5 बातचीत (bātcīt) 1398

206 Advice, An opinion, A thought, A lie, A promise 1401
206.1 सलाह (salāh) 1401
206.2 राय (rāy) 1402
206.3 विचार (vicār) 1403
206.4 झूठ (jhūṭh) 1404
206.5 वादा (vādā) 1404

207 A condition, A debt, Earnings, Savings, Expense 1407
207.1 शर्त (śart) 1407
207.2 क़र्ज़ (qarz) 1408
207.3 कमाई (kamāī) 1409
207.4 बचत (bacat) 1410
207.5 ख़र्च (kharc) 1410

208 A loss, A benefit, A price, A coin, A banknote 1413
208.1 नुक़सान (nuqsān) 1413
208.2 फ़ायदा (fāydā) 1414
208.3 क़ीमत (kīmat) 1415
208.4 सिक्का (sikkā) 1415
208.5 नोट (noṭ) 1416

209 A balcony, A cup, A needle, A lamp, Bread 1419
209.1 छज्जा (chajjā) 1419
209.2 प्याला (pyālā) 1420
209.3 सुई (suī) 1421
209.4 बत्ती (battī) 1421
209.5 रोटी (roṭī) 1422
209.6 (dialogue) 1423
209.7 (dialogue) 1424

210 A paratha, Khichri, Halwa, A laddu, Pickle 1425
210.1 पराठा (parāṭhā) 1425
210.2 खिचड़ी (khicṛī) 1426
210.3 हलवा (halvā) 1427
210.4 लड्डू (laḍḍū) 1427
210.5 अचार (achār) 1428

211 Chutney, Spice, Turmeric, Coriander, A lemon 1431
211.1 चटनी (caṭnī) 1431
211.2 मसाला (masālā) 1432
211.3 हल्दी (haldī) 1433
211.4 धनिया (dhaniyā) 1434
211.5 नींबू (nī̃bū) 1434

212 Ugly, Strong, Weak, Cheap, Hard 1437
212.1 भद्दा (bhaddā) 1437
212.2 मज़बूत (mazbūt) 1438

212.3 कमज़ोर (kamzor) 1439
212.4 सस्ता (sastā) 1439
212.5 कठिन (kaṭhin) 1440

213 Necessary, Dangerous, Safe, Sweet, Soft 1443
213.1 ज़रूरी (zarūrī) 1443
213.2 ख़तरनाक (khatarnāk) 1444
213.3 सुरक्षित (surakṣit) 1445
213.4 मीठा (mīṭhā) 1445
213.5 नर्म (narm) 1446

214 Smooth, Busy, Lazy, Honest, True 1449
214.1 चिकना (cikanā) 1449
214.2 व्यस्त (vyast) 1450
214.3 आलसी (ālsī) 1451
214.4 ईमानदार (īmāndār) 1451
214.5 सच्चा (saccā) 1452

215 False, Clever, Foolish, Brave, Kind 1455
215.1 झूठा (jhūṭhā) 1455
215.2 बुद्धिमान (buddhimān) 1456
215.3 मूर्ख (mūrkh) 1457
215.4 बहादुर (bahādur) 1457
215.5 दयालु (dayālu) 1458

216 A peanut, A radish, An aubergine, Okra, A papaya 1461
216.1 मूँगफली (mū̃gphalī) 1461
216.2 मूली (mūlī) 1462
216.3 बैंगन (bãigan) 1463
216.4 भिंडी (bhinḍī) 1464
216.5 पपीता (papītā) 1465

217 A pomegranate, A guava, A festival, Worship, Religion 1467
217.1 अनार (anār) 1467
217.2 अमरूद (amrūd) 1468
217.3 त्योहार (tyohār) 1469
217.4 पूजा (pūjā) 1470
217.5 धर्म (dharm) 1470
217.6 (dialogue) 1471
217.7 (dialogue) 1472

218 Society, The government, A law, A court, An election 1473
218.1 समाज (samāj) 1473
218.2 सरकार (sarkār) 1474
218.3 क़ानून (kānūn) 1475
218.4 अदालत (adālat) 1475
218.5 चुनाव (cunāv) 1476

219 A prison, Freedom, Peace, A war, An army 1479
219.1 जेल (jel) 1479
219.2 आज़ादी (āzādī) 1480
219.3 शांति (śānti) 1481
219.4 युद्ध (yuddh) 1481
219.5 सेना (senā) 1482

220 A flag, Childhood, Youth, Old age, Life 1485
220.1 झंडा (jhaṇḍā) 1485
220.2 बचपन (bacpan) 1486
220.3 जवानी (javānī) 1487
220.4 बुढ़ापा (buṛhāpā) 1488
220.5 जीवन (jīvan) 1488

221 Death, The future, The past, The present, Spring 1491
221.1 मौत (maut) 1491
221.2 भविष्य (bhaviṣya) 1492
221.3 अतीत (atīt) 1493
221.4 वर्तमान (vartamān) 1493
221.5 वसंत (vasant) 1494

222 Autumn, A reason, A result, A problem, A remedy 1497
222.1 पतझड़ (patjhaṛ) 1497
222.2 कारण (kāraṇ) 1498
222.3 नतीजा (natījā) 1499
222.4 समस्या (samasyā) 1499
222.5 उपाय (upāy) 1500

223 A habit, A hobby, A dream, Sport, A ball 1503
223.1 आदत (ādat) 1503
223.2 शौक़ (śauq) 1504
223.3 सपना (sapnā) 1505
223.4 खेलकूद (khelkūd) 1506

223.5 गेंद (gẽd) 1506

224 A bat, A win, A defeat, A team, A race 1509
224.1 बल्ला (ballā) 1509
224.2 जीत (jīt) 1510
224.3 हार (hār) 1511
224.4 टीम (ṭīm) 1511
224.5 दौड़ (dauṛ) 1512
224.6 (dialogue) 1513
224.7 (dialogue) 1514

225 To clean, To dust, To wipe, To wring, To dry 1515
225.1 साफ़ करना (sāf karnā) 1515
225.2 झाड़ना (jhāṛnā) 1516
225.3 पोंछना (põchnā) 1517
225.4 निचोड़ना (nicoṛnā) 1518
225.5 सुखाना (sukhānā) 1518

226 To dry, To go wrong, To make, To be made, To break 1521
226.1 सूखना (sūkhnā) 1521
226.2 बिगड़ना (bigaṛnā) 1522
226.3 बनाना (banānā) 1523
226.4 बनना (bannā) 1524
226.5 टूटना (ṭūṭnā) 1524

227 To tear, To tear, To bring up, To split, To sow 1527
227.1 फटना (phaṭnā) 1527
227.2 फाड़ना (phāṛnā) 1528
227.3 पालना (pālnā) 1529
227.4 चीरना (cīrnā) 1530
227.5 बोना (bonā) 1530

228 To grow, To grow, To hand over, To press, To turn 1533
228.1 उगना (ugnā) 1533
228.2 उगाना (ugānā) 1534
228.3 पकड़ाना (pakṛānā) 1535
228.4 दबाना (dabānā) 1536
228.5 घुमाना (ghumānā) 1536

229 To bend, To gather up, To spread, To spread, To be left behind 1539
229.1 मोड़ना (moṛnā) 1539
229.2 समेटना (sameṭnā) 1540
229.3 फैलाना (phailānā) 1541
229.4 फैलना (phailnā) 1542
229.5 छूटना (chūṭnā) 1543

230 To bend down, To hang, To hang, To float, To sink 1545
230.1 झुकना (jhuknā) 1545
230.2 लटकना (laṭaknā) 1546
230.3 लटकाना (laṭkānā) 1547
230.4 तैराना (tairānā) 1548
230.5 डूबना (ḍūbnā) 1548

231 To flow, To drip, To sneeze, To yawn, To cough 1551
231.1 बहना (bahnā) 1551
231.2 टपकना (ṭapaknā) 1552
231.3 छींकना (chīṅknā) 1553
231.4 जम्हाई लेना (jamhāī lenā) 1554
231.5 खाँसना (khā̃snā) 1554

232 To shiver, To smile, To scream, To whisper, To scold 1557
232.1 काँपना (kā̃pnā) 1557
232.2 मुस्कुराना (muskurānā) 1558
232.3 चीखना (cīkhnā) 1559
232.4 फुसफुसाना (phusphusānā) 1560
232.5 डाँटना (ḍā̃ṭnā) 1560

233 North, South, East, West, Right 1563
233.1 उत्तर (uttar) 1563
233.2 दक्षिण (dakṣiṇ) 1564
233.3 पूर्व (pūrv) 1565
233.4 पश्चिम (paścim) 1565
233.5 दायाँ (dāyā̃) 1566
233.6 (dialogue) 1567
233.7 (dialogue) 1568

234 Left, Straight, Upside down, The middle, A corner 1569
234.1 बायाँ (bāyā̃) 1569
234.2 सीधा (sīdhā) 1570
234.3 उल्टा (ulṭā) 1571
234.4 बीच (bīc) 1572
234.5 कोना (konā) 1572

235 Up, Down, Ahead, Behind, Inside 1575
235.1 ऊपर (ūpar) 1575
235.2 नीचे (nīce) 1576
235.3 आगे (āge) 1577
235.4 पीछे (pīche) 1578
235.5 अंदर (andar) 1578

236 Half, Whole, Double, Separate, Round 1581
236.1 आधा (ādhā) 1581
236.2 पूरा (pūrā) 1582
236.3 दुगना (dugnā) 1583
236.4 अलग (alag) 1583
236.5 गोल (gol) 1584

237 Square, Triangular, Narrow, Shallow, Stale 1587
237.1 चौकोर (caukor) 1587
237.2 तिकोना (tikoṇā) 1588
237.3 संकरा (saṅkarā) 1589
237.4 उथला (uthlā) 1589
237.5 बासी (bāsī) 1590

238 Raw, Lukewarm, Dry, Sticky, Rough 1593
238.1 कच्चा (kaccā) 1593
238.2 गुनगुना (gungunā) 1594
238.3 रूखा (rūkhā) 1595
238.4 चिपचिपा (cipcipā) 1595
238.5 खुरदुरा (khurdurā) 1596

239 Shiny, Hazy, Deserted, Crowded, Inhabited 1599
239.1 चमकदार (camakdār) 1599
239.2 धुंधला (dhũdhlā) 1600
239.3 सुनसान (sunsān) 1601
239.4 भीड़भाड़ (bhīṛbhāṛ) 1602

239.5 आबाद (ābād) 1602

240 Modern, Ancient, Local, Foreign, Local 1605
240.1 आधुनिक (ādhunik) 1605
240.2 प्राचीन (prācīn) 1606
240.3 स्थानीय (sthānīya) 1607
240.4 विदेशी (videśī) 1608
240.5 देसी (desī) 1608

241 Government, Private, Free, Valuable, Unusual 1611
241.1 सरकारी (sarkārī) 1611
241.2 निजी (nijī) 1612
241.3 मुफ़्त (muft) 1613
241.4 क़ीमती (kīmtī) 1613
241.5 अनोखा (anokhā) 1614

242 Ordinary, Special, Famous, Useless, Successful 1617
242.1 साधारण (sādhāraṇ) 1617
242.2 ख़ास (khās) 1618
242.3 मशहूर (maśhūr) 1619
242.4 बेकार (bekār) 1619
242.5 कामयाब (kāmyāb) 1620
242.6 (dialogue) 1621
242.7 (dialogue) 1622

243 Unsuccessful, Proud, Simple, Cunning, Quarrelsome 1623
243.1 नाकाम (nākām) 1623
243.2 घमंडी (ghamaṇḍī) 1624
243.3 सीधासादा (sīdhāsādā) 1625
243.4 चालाक (cālāk) 1626
243.5 झगड़ालू (jhagṛālū) 1626

244 A thousand, A hundred thousand, Ten million, Several, Both 1629
244.1 हज़ार (hazār) 1629
244.2 लाख (lākh) 1630
244.3 करोड़ (karoṛ) 1631
244.4 कई (kaī) 1632
244.5 दोनों (donõ) 1632

245 Every, All, Some, A dozen, A pair 1635
245.1 हर (har) 1635
245.2 सब (sab) 1636
245.3 कुछ (kuch) 1637
245.4 दर्जन (darjan) 1637
245.5 जोड़ा (joṛā) 1638

246 Iron, Silver, Paper, Plastic, Cotton wool 1641
246.1 लोहा (lohā) 1641
246.2 चाँदी (cā̃dī) 1642
246.3 काग़ज़ (kāgaz) 1643
246.4 प्लास्टिक (plāsṭik) 1644
246.5 रुई (rūī) 1644

247 Silk, Leather, So, If, Or 1647
247.1 रेशम (reśam) 1647
247.2 चमड़ा (cāmṛā) 1648
247.3 इसलिए (isliye) 1649
247.4 अगर (agar) 1649
247.5 या (yā) 1650

248 Only, About, Later, Soon, Suddenly 1653
248.1 सिर्फ़ (sirf) 1653
248.2 लगभग (lagbhag) 1654
248.3 बाद में (bād mẽ) 1655
248.4 जल्द ही (jald hī) 1655
248.5 अचानक (acānak) 1656

249 With, All together, A computer, A mobile phone, A document 1659
249.1 साथ (sāth) 1659
249.2 एक साथ (ek sāth) 1660
249.3 कंप्यूटर (kampyūṭar) 1661
249.4 मोबाइल (mobāil) 1662
249.5 दस्तावेज़ (dastāvez) 1662

250 A file, A safe, A stamp, A discount, Retail 1665
250.1 फ़ाइल (fāil) 1665
250.2 तिजोरी (tijorī) 1666
250.3 मोहर (mohar) 1667

250.4 छूट (chūṭ) 1667
250.5 खुदरा (khuḍrā) 1668

251 Wholesale, Scales, A kilo, A litre, A metre 1671
251.1 थोक (thok) 1671
251.2 तराज़ू (tarāzū) 1672
251.3 किलो (kilo) 1673
251.4 लीटर (līṭar) 1673
251.5 मीटर (mīṭar) 1674
251.6 (dialogue) 1675
251.7 (dialogue) 1676

252 A sack, A branch, A bud, A thorn, Mud 1677
252.1 बोरी (borī) 1677
252.2 डाली (ḍālī) 1678
252.3 कली (kalī) 1679
252.4 काँटा (kā̃ṭā) 1679
252.5 कीचड़ (kīcaṛ) 1680

253 A rainbow, An earthquake, A flood, A man, A baby 1683
253.1 इंद्रधनुष (indradhanuṣ) 1683
253.2 भूकंप (bhūkamp) 1684
253.3 बाढ़ (bāṛh) 1685
253.4 पुरुष (puruṣ) 1686
253.5 शिशु (śiśu) 1686

254 A female friend, A companion, A relative, A mother-in-law, A father-in-law 1689
254.1 सहेली (sahelī) 1689
254.2 साथी (sāthī) 1690
254.3 संबंधी (sambandhī) 1691
254.4 सास (sās) 1692
254.5 ससुर (sasur) 1692

255 A daughter-in-law, A son-in-law, A husband's younger brother, A husband's sister, A sister's husband 1695
255.1 बहू (bahū) 1695
255.2 दामाद (dāmād) 1696
255.3 देवर (devar) 1697
255.4 ननद (nanad) 1698

255.5 जीजा (jījā) 1699

256 Vomiting, A wound, A bandage, An injection, A pill 1701
256.1 उल्टी (ulṭī) 1701
256.2 घाव (ghāv) 1702
256.3 पट्टी (paṭṭī) 1703
256.4 टीका (ṭīkā) 1704
256.5 गोली (golī) 1704

257 The pulse, Jealousy, Hatred, Respect, Pride 1707
257.1 नब्ज़ (nabz) 1707
257.2 ईर्ष्या (irṣyā) 1708
257.3 घृणा (ghṛṇā) 1709
257.4 सम्मान (sammān) 1709
257.5 गर्व (garv) 1710

258 Arrogance, Patience, Courage, Faith, Loneliness 1713
258.1 अहंकार (ahaṅkār) 1713
258.2 धीरज (dhīraj) 1714
258.3 हिम्मत (himmat) 1715
258.4 विश्वास (viśvās) 1715
258.5 अकेलापन (akelāpan) 1716

259 Restlessness, A crowd, An event, An accident, Danger 1719
259.1 बेचैनी (becainī) 1719
259.2 भीड़ (bhīṛ) 1720
259.3 घटना (ghaṭnā) 1721
259.4 दुर्घटना (durghaṭnā) 1721
259.5 ख़तरा (khatrā) 1722

260 A convenience, An inconvenience, A rule, A list, A candidate 1725
260.1 सुविधा (suvidhā) 1725
260.2 असुविधा (asuvidhā) 1726
260.3 नियम (niyam) 1727
260.4 सूची (sūcī) 1727
260.5 उम्मीदवार (ummīdvār) 1728
260.6 (dialogue) 1729
260.7 (dialogue) 1730

261 A maid, A gardener, A potter, A blacksmith, A goldsmith 1731
261.1 नौकरानी (naukarānī) 1731
261.2 माली (mālī) 1732
261.3 कुम्हार (kumhār) 1733
261.4 लोहार (lohār) 1733
261.5 सुनार (sunār) 1734

262 A carpenter, A cobbler, A priest, A piece of jewellery, A bangle 1737
262.1 बढ़ई (baṛhaī) 1737
262.2 मोची (mochī) 1738
262.3 पुजारी (pujārī) 1739
262.4 गहना (gahnā) 1740
262.5 कंगन (kaṅgan) 1740

263 An earring, A bindi, A bangle, An anklet, A flute 1743
263.1 झुमका (jhumkā) 1743
263.2 बिंदी (bindī) 1744
263.3 चूड़ी (cūṛī) 1745
263.4 पायल (pāyal) 1746
263.5 बाँसुरी (bā̃surī) 1746

264 A sitar, A tabla, A bell, A toy, A doll 1749
264.1 सितार (sitār) 1749
264.2 तबला (tablā) 1750
264.3 घंटी (ghaṇṭī) 1751
264.4 खिलौना (khilaunā) 1751
264.5 गुड़िया (guṛiyā) 1752

265 A kite, A swing, A curtain, A cotton rug, A carpet 1755
265.1 पतंग (patang) 1755
265.2 झूला (jhūlā) 1756
265.3 पर्दा (pardā) 1757
265.4 दरी (darī) 1758
265.5 क़ालीन (qālīn) 1758

266 A latch, A saw, A pickaxe, A spade, A mattress 1761
266.1 चिटकनी (ciṭkanī) 1761
266.2 आरी (ārī) 1762

266.3 कुदाल (kudāl) 1763
266.4 फावड़ा (phāvṛā) 1764
266.5 गद्दा (gaddā) 1764

267 A quilt, A mosquito net, A tap, A drain, A tank 1767
267.1 रजाई (rajāī) 1767
267.2 मच्छरदानी (maccharadānī) 1768
267.3 नल (nal) 1769
267.4 नाली (nālī) 1770
267.5 टंकी (ṭaṅkī) 1770

268 Rubbish, A dustbin, Smoke, Fire, Ash 1773
268.1 कूड़ा (kūṛā) 1773
268.2 कूड़ेदान (kūṛedān) 1774
268.3 धुआँ (dhuā̃) 1775
268.4 आग (āg) 1776
268.5 राख (rākh) 1776

269 Coal, Gas, A wok, A rolling pin, A sieve 1779
269.1 कोयला (koylā) 1779
269.2 गैस (gais) 1780
269.3 कड़ाही (kaṛāhī) 1781
269.4 बेलन (belan) 1782
269.5 छलनी (chalnī) 1782
269.6 (dialogue) 1783
269.7 (dialogue) 1784

270 A grater, A lid, A jug, A water jar, A clay pot 1787
270.1 कद्दूकस (kaddūkas) 1787
270.2 ढक्कन (dhakkan) 1788
270.3 जग (jag) 1789
270.4 सुराही (surāhī) 1790
270.5 मटका (maṭkā) 1790

271 An office, Insurance, Interest, A tenant, A neighbourhood 1793
271.1 कार्यालय (kāryālay) 1793
271.2 बीमा (bīmā) 1794
271.3 ब्याज (byāj) 1795
271.4 किरायेदार (kirāyedār) 1795

271.5 मोहल्ला (mohallā) 1796

272 A lane, A street corner, A fair, A procession, A speech 1799
272.1 गली (galī) 1799
272.2 नुक्कड़ (nukkaṛ) 1800
272.3 मेला (melā) 1801
272.4 जुलूस (jalūs) 1801
272.5 भाषण (bhāṣaṇ) 1802

273 The police, A pharmacy, A patient, A disease, An illness 1805
273.1 पुलिस (pulis) 1805
273.2 दवाख़ाना (davākhānā) 1806
273.3 रोगी (rogī) 1807
273.4 रोग (rog) 1808
273.5 बीमारी (bīmārī) 1808

274 A heartbeat, Breath, An itch, A burning feeling, A swelling 1811
274.1 धड़कन (dhaṛkan) 1811
274.2 साँस (sā̃s) 1812
274.3 खुजली (khujlī) 1813
274.4 जलन (jalan) 1814
274.5 सूजन (sūjan) 1814

275 A sprain, A hiccup, A nap, Turning over, A stretch 1817
275.1 मोच (moc) 1817
275.2 हिचकी (hickī) 1818
275.3 झपकी (jhapkī) 1819
275.4 करवट (karvaṭ) 1820
275.5 अंगड़ाई (aṅgṛāī) 1820
275.6 (dialogue) 1821
275.7 (dialogue) 1822

Devanagari (reference) 1823

Glossary 1825

Review Questions 1919

Answer Key 1925

Index **1931**

Chapter 1

Greetings

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 👁 **eyes** (5) ↙ **pen** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 5 of 10 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet, thank, and take my leave in Hindi, and write by hand the first Devanagari letters those words are built from.
>
> *Greet, thank formally and casually, and take a weighty leave in Hindi from memory; name each word's heritage; then write* न, म, क *and* त *by hand, body first and bar last, and say what orders the stop families along the mouth.*

1.1 Namaste — "I bow to you"

> The first Hindi word, and the most important — a greeting that is literally a small act of reverence. You'll meet its first and last written pieces today; the middle comes next lesson.

The letters in this word

(If you already read Devanagari, skim this — it's here so the book needs no prior knowledge.) Hindi is written **left to right**, and every consonant carries a built-in **"a"** unless something changes it.

- न = "na" — the word's first letter, with its built-in *a*.
- त = "ta" — another consonant, with the same built-in *a*.

- ◌े is a **vowel sign** (a *mātrā*) that changes the built-in *a* to “e”: त + ◌े → ते = “te.”

So the word begins with न *na* and ends with ते *te*. The middle — a *ma* and a bare *s* — comes in the next lesson; the whole written word follows later in this chapter.

Two facts already: consonants carry *a*, and a *mātrā* changes the vowel. The next lesson adds the third.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Namaste = *namaḥ* (“a bow, reverence, homage”) + ते (*te*, “to you”) = literally **“reverence to you,” “I bow to you.”** The root is Sanskrit *nam*, “to bow, bend, pay homage” — the same root behind *namaskār* (next lesson) and borrowed whole into English as **namaste** and **namaskar**.

Why it’s said this way

namaste is a genuine gesture, not a neutral “hi”: it’s said with the palms pressed together (the *añjali* gesture), acknowledging the other person with respect. It works as both **hello and goodbye**, at any time of day, and it’s polite/respectful without being stiff — safe with almost anyone. (Hindi also has warmer and more casual options you’ll meet, and a whole second, Persian- flavored set of words — coming in a few lessons.)

The letters in this word

Hindi reads **left to right**, and every consonant carries a built-in “a”: न na, त ta. A vowel sign changes the vowel: ◌े makes “e” (ते = te). Say the four beats: *na · ma · s · te*. The *s* has no vowel of its own and leans straight into *te*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- its beats — na · ma · s · te → “namaste”
- read ते — “te” — and what the sign ◌े did to त (changed *a* to *e*)
- “namaste,” and mean it — “I bow to you”

Before you move on

Read it: न and ते (*na*, *te*.) What does *namaste* literally mean? ("I bow to you" — *namaḥ* + *te*.) What does a *mātrā* do to a consonant? (Changes its built-in *a*.)

1.2 Namaskār — the more formal bow

The dressier sibling of *namaste* — same root, one new piece, and the letters that finish *namaste* on the page.

What to know first

- *namaste* — you already know न, the syllable *te*, and how consonants carry "a."

The letters in this word

- म = "ma" · स = "sa."
- ◌्, the *halant*, **kills a consonant's vowel**: स् = a bare "s," which leans onto the next consonant as a **conjunct**.

So नमस् (*namas*, "a bow") reads न · म · स्. Add the last lesson's *te* and every piece of *namaste* is yours. Three facts did it: consonants carry *a*, a *mātrā* changes the vowel, a *halant* removes it.

The second half, *kār*, needs three more shapes; the whole written word waits for the end of this chapter.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Namaskār = *namaḥ* ("a bow," from root नम् *nam*, as in *namaste*) + *kāra* ("the making or doing of" — from the Sanskrit root *kṛ*, "to do, make"). So *namaskār* is literally **"the making of a bow," "the act of homage."** Where *namaste* says "bow to *you*," *namaskār* names the bow itself — a touch more formal and ceremonial.

That piece -*kāra* ("the making/doing of") is a Sanskrit building block you'll see again — e.g. in *ahaṃkāra* ("the making of 'I'" → ego). Learn it once as "the act of _____."

Why it’s said this way

namaskār is a notch more **formal** than *namaste* — common in respectful, official, or ceremonial settings, and as a courteous greeting to elders or in writing. Both are “hello”; *namaskār* wears a tie.

The letters in this word

New: म ma, स sa, and the *halant* ◌् (स् = s). Together न · म · स् spell *namas*. *Read it:* न · म · स् Say *namaskār* in its beats: na · ma · s · kā · r.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- read “नमस्” — na · ma · s — and what the *halant* under स does
- the shared root — *nam* (“bow”) in both *namaste* and *namaskār*
- which is more formal? (*namaskār*)

Before you move on

What does the piece -*kāra* mean? (“The making/doing of.”) So *namaskār* literally names what? (“The making of a bow.”) What does a *halant* do to a consonant? (Removes its built-in *a*.)

1.3 Dhanyavād — “thank you,” the Sanskrit way

“Thank you” — and the first hint of a big fact about Hindi: it has *two* vocabularies for many everyday things, one Sanskrit, one Persian. This is the Sanskrit one.

What to know first

- *namaskār* — you know the *halant*/conjunct idea and how a *mātrā* changes a vowel.

The letters in this word

New today: ध = "dha," the breathy *d* that opens the word · व = "va" · द = "da." With a *halant*, the last two spell the Sanskrit root behind the word's second half: वद् (*vad*, "to speak").

The rest — a *ya* joined to न as a conjunct, and the long *ā* of *vād* — waits, and so does the whole written word, for a later chapter. Today, say it and read ध and वद्.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Dhanyavād = *dhanya* ("worthy, blessed, fortunate") + *vāda* ("a saying, an utterance," from the Sanskrit root वद् *vad*, "to speak"). So *dhanyavād* literally offers **"an utterance of [you are] worthy/ blessed"** — a formal, almost literary way to say thanks. (*dhanya* comes from *dhana*, "wealth" — to call someone *dhanya* is to call them enriched, fortunate.)

Why it's said this way

dhanyavād is the **formal, Sanskritic** "thank you" — the one you'd write, or say in respectful or official settings. It can even feel a little *heavy* for small everyday thanks, where Hindi speakers often reach for a lighter, Persian- derived word instead — *shukriyā*, your next lesson. Holding those two side by side is the single best window into how Hindi works.

The letters in this word

New: ध dha (a breathy *d*), व va, द da. Together व · द् spell *vad*, "to speak." *Read it:* व · द् Say the whole word in its beats: dha · n · ya · vā · d.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- its beats — dha · n · ya · vā · d → "dhanyavād"
- the two pieces — *dhanya* ("worthy") + *vāda* ("saying")
- read "ध" and "वद्" — *dha*, *vad* — and which one carries the breath

Before you move on

Read it: वद् (*vad*, “to speak.”) What are the two parts of *dhanyavād*? (*dhanya* “worthy” + *vāda* “saying.”) Is it the formal or casual “thanks”? (Formal, Sanskritic — the casual one is Persian-derived, next.)

1.4 Shukriyā — “thanks,” Hindi’s other heritage

The everyday “thanks” — and it is *not* a Sanskrit word at all. It came into Hindi from Persian and, before that, Arabic. This lesson is where you meet Hindi’s second bloodstream.

What to know first

- *dhanyavād* — the formal, Sanskrit “thanks”; this is its casual counterpart.

The letters in this word

New: क = “ka,” र = “ra,” and the vowel sign ि for **“i”** (note: ि is written *before* the consonant but read *after* it).

- क् + र → क्र = “kra” (halant on क, joined to र — another conjunct).
- रि = “ri” (with the ि sign). So the middle of the word, क्रि, reads *kri*.

The opening *shu* and the closing *yā* need letters you have not met yet, so the whole written word waits for a later chapter. Today, say it and read क्रि.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Shukriyā comes, through Persian (*shukriya*), from **Arabic** *shukr* (“gratitude, thanks”) — root **sh-k-r**. It is *the same word* as the Arabic **shukran** (“thank you”): Hindi and Arabic, two utterly different languages and scripts, saying thanks with one Semitic root. No Sanskrit here at all.

> Why does Hindi have an Arabic word for “thanks”? Centuries of Persian as the language of courts and administration in South Asia poured thousands of Persian

(and, through Persian, Arabic) words into everyday Hindi/Urdu. So Hindi carries **two vocabularies**: a Sanskrit layer (*dhanyavād*, *namaste*) and a Perso-Arabic layer (*shukriyā*, and *alvidā* next). Often the Sanskrit word feels formal/literary and the Persian one feels everyday — though both are fully Hindi.

Why it’s said this way

shukriyā is the **casual, everyday** “thanks” — what you’d say to a friend, a shopkeeper, a waiter. *dhanyavād* is its formal twin. Choosing between them is choosing a register — and, quietly, a heritage.

The letters in this word

New: क ka, र ra, and the sign ि for “i” (written *before* the consonant, read *after*). With a conjunct क् + र → क्र (“kra”), the middle of the word reads क्रि → *kri*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- its beats — shu · k · ri · yā — then read “क्रि,” *kri*
- “shukriyā” — and note it shares a root with Arabic *shukran*
- formal vs casual “thanks” — *dhanyavād* / *shukriyā*

Before you move on

Where does *shukriyā* come from — Sanskrit or Persian/Arabic? (Persian, from Arabic *shukr* — same root as Arabic *shukran*.) What are Hindi’s two vocabulary layers? (Sanskrit and Perso-Arabic.)

1.5 अलविदा (alvidā) — “farewell,” and the Arabic *al-* again

A goodbye — and another Perso-Arabic word, carrying a piece of Arabic grammar you may have met from the other side.

What to know first

- *shukriyā* — Hindi's Persian/Arabic layer; here's another word from it.

The letters in this word

New: the **independent vowel** अ = "a" (used when a word *starts* with a vowel — consonants have their built-in *a*, but a standalone one needs its own letter), ल = "la," and ◌ा, the *mātrā* for long **"ā"**. Reusing व द and the ◌ि sign:

- अल = "al" · वि = "vi" (with the ◌ि sign) · दा = "dā" (द + ◌ा).

Left to right: अ · ल · वि · दा = *a-l-vi-dā* →

अलविदा = **alvidā**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अलविदा comes through Persian/Urdu from **Arabic** *al-widā^c* ("the farewell"), from the Arabic root **w-d-^{c}**, "to leave, to bid farewell." And there at the front is अल — the Arabic article **al-**, "the," the very same "the" that rode into English on *algebra* and *alcohol.* So *alvidā* is literally **"the farewell."**

Why it's said this way

alvidā carries a note of **finality** — it's the goodbye for a long or final parting, more weighted than an everyday "see you." For casual "bye," Hindi speakers more often use *namaste* again, or the English "bye," or *phir milenge* ("we'll meet again"). But *alvidā* is the word when the parting matters — and, like *shukriyā*, it quietly carries centuries of Persian in it.

The letters in this word

New: the independent vowel अ ("a," for a word that *starts* with a vowel), ल la, and the sign ◌ा for long "ā." अ · ल · वि · दा → *alvidā.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- read “अलविदा” — a · l · vi · dā
- the *al-* at the front — the Arabic “the,” as in “the farewell”
- when would you use *alvidā* vs a casual bye? (a weighty/final parting)

Before you move on

alvidā literally means what, and what’s the little *al-* doing there? (“The farewell” — *al-* is the Arabic “the.”) Sanskrit or Perso-Arabic? (Perso-Arabic.)

1.6 The line on top — Devanagari’s head-line

Look at any line of Hindi:

नमस्ते

Before any individual letter, notice the thing you cannot miss: **a horizontal line running across the top of the whole word.** Latin letters sit *on* a line. Devanagari letters **hang from** one.

You’ll want to know — The shirorekhā

That line is the शिरोरेखा (*shirorekhā*) — literally the **“head-line”**: *śiras* “head” + *rekhā* “line.”

Śiras is worth a moment. It descends from Proto-Indo-European **ḱerh$_2$*-, “head, horn” — the root behind Latin *cornu* (“horn”), Latin *cerebrum* (“brain”), Greek *kara* (“head”), and English **horn**. The line across the top of Hindi writing is, by ancestry, its **horn**.

Two habits about it, and they are the opposite of what you’d guess:

1. **You draw it last.** Write the letter’s body first, then cap it.
2. **Across a word it is one line.** Rather than capping each letter separately, write the letters and then draw a single bar over the whole word. That is why Hindi words look like they’re strung on a wire: they are.

A caveat you should have from the first lesson: this is the **common convention, not a rule**. Plenty of writers cap each letter as they go, and some draw the bar first. Stroke orders in this track are how it is usually taught, not a standard you can be wrong about.

And one note about the word *shirorekhā* itself, written शिरोरेखा: it contains a letter — ख — that this book does not give a stroke order for. Read the word; don't try to draw it. This track only asks you to hand-write letters whose stroke data actually exists, and it will say so every time that gap shows up.

Your turn

Keep नमस्ते visible. Finger-trace only its horizontal head-line once, from left edge to right edge. Then trace that same visible line once with a pencil. Do not copy the letter bodies yet. Say शिरोरेखा — **head-line** after your hand stops, and compare your traced line with the model immediately.

Before you move on

What is the line across the top called, and what does the word literally mean? (**Shirorekhā** — "**head-line**".) When is it usually drawn? (**Last** — and as **one** line across the whole word. Usually: it is the common convention, not a rule.) What ancient root sits inside *śiras*, "head"? (PIE ***ḱerh₂-***, also behind **horn**.) Next: hang your first two letters from it.

1.7 न and म — two bodies under one head-line

> You know the bar is usually drawn last. Now give it two letter bodies to cap.

You'll want to know — न — "na"

Three pieces:

1. **a left bowl** — a rounded scoop on the left.
2. **a right spine** — a vertical downstroke on the right.
3. **the top bar** — capping both. *Last.*

You’ll want to know — म — “ma”

Four movements — the same spine, but the body starts at the top:

1. **down and round** — descend, loop, sweep right.
2. **up the right spine**, without lifting.
3. **back down it.**
4. **the top bar** — last, again.

You’ll want to know — The shared frame

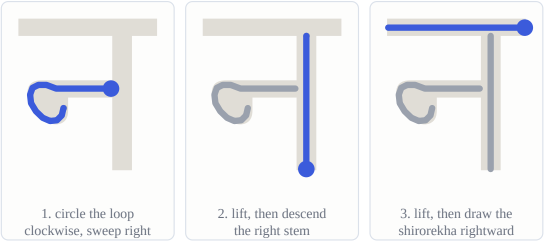
Both letters have a **vertical spine on the right**, with the distinguishing shape hanging to its left. This is Devanagari’s commonest skeleton: **spine on the right, character on the left, bar across the top**. Learn the frame once and many new letters are only a new left-hand part.

“Commonest,” not “only” — a minority of letters (द and र among them) have **no** right-hand spine at all. You will meet them as they come.

Your turn

How it is written — 2 letters, one after another

Letter 1 of 2 — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements

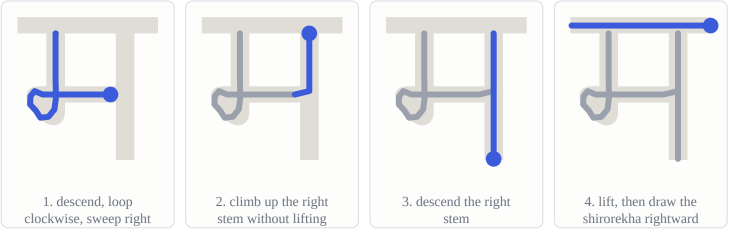


1. circle the loop clockwise, sweep right

2. lift, then descend the right stem

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Letter 2 of 2 — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



1. descend, loop clockwise, sweep right

2. climb up the right stem without lifting

3. descend the right stem

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Letter 1: stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-न-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 11 May 2009
Letter 2: stroke order after JackPotte, ‘Devanagari m म.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How these letters are written, one after another, stroke by stroke: न, म

Keep न म visible. Copy न once, looking back after any piece you need. Then copy म once the same way. Put them side by side and add one headline across both. Compare each copy with the visible model immediately. Memory is not the task yet; one careful, supported copy is enough.

Before you move on

Draw न — its three pieces? (Bowl, spine, bar.) Draw म — what makes it different? (It **starts at the top** and runs into the spine.) Where does the spine sit in both? (**On the right** — though a minority of letters have none.) Next: the vowel already hiding inside each consonant.

1.8 The vowel that is already there — the abugida

Here is the thing that trips up every English speaker, and it is better to meet it now than to be confused for a month.

क is not “k”. क is “ka”.

You’ll want to know — Consonants come with a vowel attached

In the Latin alphabet, *k* is a bare consonant and you must add a vowel to say anything. In Devanagari, every consonant **already contains** the vowel **“a”**:

letter	**says**	***not***
क	**ka**	~~k~~
न	**na**	~~n~~
म	**ma**	~~m~~
त	**ta**	~~t~~

That built-in “a” is the **inherent vowel**. You get it free, whether you want it or not — and the next two lessons are entirely about what to do when you *don’t* want it.

So the two letters you learned last lesson were never “n” and “m.” They were **na** and **ma** — and if you write them together you have already written a real syllable pair: नम, *nama*, the first half of *namaste*.

You'll want to know — What this kind of script is called

A script that works this way — consonants carrying a default vowel — is an **abugida**.

The word comes from **Ge'ez**, the old liturgical language of Ethiopia, whose script works the same way — and it is built more cleverly than "alphabet" is.

ʾä — bu — gi — da names two things at once:

- the **consonants** ʾ, b, g, d — the first four of the old **Semitic** letter order (the same order that gives Greek *alpha, beta, gamma, delta*);
- the **vowels** ä, u, i, a — the first four of Ge'ez's **vowel series**.

So the word doesn't just recite the start of a list, the way *alphabet* recites *alpha-beta*. It **demonstrates the system it names**: consonant plus vowel, consonant plus vowel, four times over. A term that performs its own definition.

(Ge'ez's own traditional recitation order is different — *hä-lä-ḥä-mä…* — so *abugida* is a scholar's coinage drawing on the inherited Semitic order, not the Ethiopian schoolroom one.)

Your turn

- *Say it:* "क is **ka**, not k"
- *Write it:* नम — two letters, **one bar across both** — "nama"
- *Say it:* "abugida — a consonant plus its built-in vowel"

Before you move on

What does क say on its own? (**"ka"** — the vowel is built in.) What is that vowel called? (The **inherent vowel**.) What kind of script is this, and where does the word come from? (An **abugida** — *ʾä-bu-gi-da*, from Ge'ez, naming four **consonants** of the old Semitic order **and** four **vowel series** at once, so the word performs its own definition.) Write नम — what does it say? (*Nama.*) Next: two more letters, and the sound-map that orders them.

1.9 क and त — two letters on a map of the mouth

> The built-in vowel means these are **ka** and **ta**, not bare *k* and *t*.
> Their shapes share the frame you already know.

You'll want to know — क — "ka"

1. **a left loop**
2. **a vertical spine** on the right
3. **the top bar** — last.

You'll want to know — त — "ta"

1. **a small left curl**
2. **a tall spine**
3. **the top bar** — last.

Same frame as before: spine right, shape left, bar on top. Only the left-hand part changes.

You'll want to know — Why the letters are in this order

The heart of the Devanagari consonant order is not a historical accident like A-B-C. Its five stop families (*vargas*) are sorted by **where in your mouth the closure happens**, starting at the soft palate and walking forward to the lips:

क (soft palate) → च (hard palate) → ट (roof, tongue curled back) → त (teeth) → प (lips)

Say those five and feel the closure travel forward. Indian phoneticians organised sounds this way well over two thousand years ago — Pāṇini's work is roughly fourth century BCE — producing a phonetics chart memorised as an alphabet long before Europe attempted the same analysis.

Two honest footnotes: this walk describes the **five stop families**, not the whole list; and this book does not give a stroke order for ट. Read it here, and wait for a source you trust before you write it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* क — “loop, spine, bar last”
- *Write it:* त — “curl, spine, bar last”
- *Say it:* “ka ... ca ... ṭa ... ta ... pa”, back to front

Before you move on

What do क and त say alone? (**Ka**, **ta** — each has an inherent vowel.) What orders the five stop families? (**Place of articulation**, from the soft palate forward to the lips.) Next: replace that built-in vowel.

1.10 Practice — the Hindi greetings and the first four letters

No new words or letters. *Read it:* each aloud, then recall its meaning and which of Hindi’s two heritages it comes from

What you’ve built

- नमस्ते *namaste* — “I bow to you” (Sanskrit *nam*, “bow”); hello & bye.
- नमस्कार *namaskār* — “the making of a bow” (Sanskrit); more formal.
- *dhanyavād* — “thanks” (Sanskrit *dhanya* “worthy” + *vāda* “saying”); formal.
- *shukriyā* — “thanks” (Persian, ← Arabic *shukr*); everyday.
- *alvidā* — “the farewell” (Persian, ← Arabic *al-widā^c*); weighty.

Two big ideas from one small chapter: **how Devanagari reads** (consonants carry *a*; a *mātrā* changes the vowel; a *halant* removes it and makes a conjunct), and **Hindi’s double heritage** — a Sanskrit layer (*namaste, dhanyavād*) and a Perso-Arabic layer (*shukriyā, alvidā*), often the formal vs. the everyday word for the same thing.

Your turn — the first letters, by hand

Write it: न, म, क, त — each body first, the bar last — then compare with the shapes in this chapter and repair one

- The line on top: its name, and when is it drawn? (**Shirorekhā**, "head-line"; **last**, one line across the word.)
- What frame do the four share? (**Spine right**, shape left, **bar on top** — म starts at the top, क with a loop, त with a curl.)
- What does क say alone? (**Ka**, not *k*: the **inherent vowel** is built in — the mark of an **abugida**, a name from Ge'ez.)
- What orders क … त? (**Where the mouth closes**, from the soft palate forward to the lips.)

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all five words from memory — the two hellos, the two thanks, and the farewell
- greet someone (*namaste*), thank them formally (*dhanyavād*) then casually (*shukriyā*), and take a weighty leave (*alvidā*)
- for each of the five, Sanskrit or Perso-Arabic?

Before you move on

Which "thanks" is Sanskrit and which is Persian? (*dhanyavād* / *shukriyā*.) What three facts let you read Devanagari? (Consonants carry *a*; a *mātrā* changes the vowel; a *halant* removes it.) Next chapter: *āp* and *tum* — Hindi's formal and informal "you" — and introducing yourself.

Chapter 2

Introducing Yourself

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 👁 **eyes** (5) ↙ **pen** (15) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 8 of 24 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give my name and ask for someone else's in Hindi, then independently write a two-sentence greeting and practice-name card in Devanagari.
>
> *With no visible model, greet a new classmate and give the practice name in two complete Devanagari sentences and repair one dimension; then hold the introduction exchange aloud, name the cousins of nām, merā, hai and kyā, and say what mātrās, the virama and conjuncts do to the letters you just wrote.*

2.1 नाम (nām) — "name," a word older than Europe

> To introduce yourself you need "name." Hindi's is one you already own in English — from before either language was born.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Devanagari.) Left to right: न (na) + ा (the long-*ā* mātrā) → ना (nā), then म (ma). Read ना · म → **nām**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाम (*nām*) ← Sanskrit नामन् (*nāman*), from Proto-Indo-European *$\mathbf{h_3}$**nómn** (its final *n* syllabic) — the *same* ancient root as:

- English **name**, Latin **nōmen** (→ English **noun**, **nom**inate), Greek *onoma*.

So Hindi *nām* and English *name* are cousins from before either language existed — one of the clearest bridges between the Indian and European branches of one family.

The letters in this word

Three letters, left to right: न (*na*), ◌ा the long-ā *mātrā* (ना = nā), म (*ma*). *Read it:* ना · म → *nām*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nām"
- the cousins — Hindi *nām*, English *name*, Latin *nōmen* → *noun*

Before you move on

What Sanskrit and PIE root is **नाम** from, and what English words share it? (*nāman* / *h_3*nómn* — *name*, *noun*, *nominate.*)

2.2 मेरा / मेरी / मेरे — "my" agrees with what is owned

The word for "my" — and, like *name*, a first-person word English shares to the root.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Devanagari.) म (ma) + ◌े (the *e*-mātrā) → मे (me); र (ra) + ◌ा (long *ā*) → रा (rā). Read मे · रा → **merā**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मेरा (*merā*, "my") is listed by CDIAL under the Sanskrit first-person base **ma-** (CDIAL 9691) — the *same ma-/me-* behind English **me**, **my**, **mine** and Latin *meus*. Hindi "my" and English "my" are, at root, one word.

Grammar Lens: “my” agrees with the noun

Hindi possessives change to match what’s owned: मेरा (*merā*, masculine), मेरी (*merī*, feminine), मेरे (*mere*, plural). *nām* is masculine → **merā nām**. (You’ll meet *merī* at your first feminine noun.)

The letters in this word

म (*ma*) + ◌े (the *e*-mātrā) → मे (me); then र (*ra*) + ◌ा (long ā) → रा (rā). *Read it:* मे · रा → *merā*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “merā”
- the cousins — *merā* / English *my*, *mine*
- the three forms — मेरा (*merā*, m.) / मेरी (*merī*, f.) / मेरे (*mere*, pl.)

Before you move on

What root is मेरा built on, and its English cousins? (*ma-* — *me*, *my*, *mine*.) Why *merā nām* and not *merī*? (*nām* is masculine.)

2.3 है (hai) — “is,” cousin of English *is*

The little verb “is” — and it’s the same “is” spoken from Ireland to India.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Devanagari.) ह (ha) + ◌ै (the *ai*-mātrā) → है (*hai*). One syllable.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

है (*hai*, “is”) ← Sanskrit अस्ति (*asti*, “is”), from Proto-Indo-European ***h$_1$es-** — the root of “to be” across the whole family:

- English **is**, German **ist**, Latin **est**, Spanish **es**, French **est**.

Hindi *hai* is the Indian cousin of the same tiny verb. “Is” really is *one* word, stretched across a continent.

Grammar Lens: the verb comes last

Hindi is **subject–object–verb**: “my name Arun **is**.” *hai* sits at the *end* of the sentence, where English puts “is” in the middle. Bank the shape — in Hindi the verb waits until the end.

The letters in this word

ह (*ha*) + ै (the *ai*-mātrā) → है (*hai*). One syllable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “hai”
- the family — *hai* / *is* / *ist* / *est* / *es*
- “merā nām Arun hai” — note *hai* at the end

Before you move on

What Sanskrit/PIE root is है from, and its cousins? (*asti* / **h$_1$es-* — *is*, *ist*, *est*, *es*.) Where does the verb sit in a Hindi sentence? (At the end.)

2.4 मेरा नाम ... है (merā nām ... hai) — “my name is...”

Assemble the three atoms you just traced — *merā*, *nām*, *hai* — into the sentence for meeting anyone.

The two words — assembled

Three atoms, each already rooted — merā (my, ← *ma-*), nām (name, ← *nāman*), hai (is, ← *asti*):

> **मेरा नाम … है** = “my name … is” = **“my name is…”**

Merā nām Arun hai. → “My name is Arun.” Slot your name into the gap; *hai* stays at the end.

Grammar Lens: subject–object–verb

Literally the Hindi is “my name Arun **is**” — the verb last. English puts “is” in the middle (“my name **is** Arun”); Hindi holds it to the end. Every Hindi sentence you build will end on its verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “merā nām … hai” with your own name
- notice the order — my / name / [name] / is

Before you move on

Give your name in Hindi. (*Merā nām … hai.*) What’s different about where “is” sits, versus English? (Hindi puts the verb *last*.)

2.5 आप / तुम (āp / tum) — “you,” respectful and familiar

> To ask someone’s name, you need “you” — and Hindi grades it in *three* levels of respect.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Devanagari.) **आप**: independent vowel **आ** (ā, word-initial) + **प** (pa) → *āp*. **तुम**: **त** (ta) + **◌ु** (the *u*-sign) + **म** (ma) → *tum.*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- तुम (*tum*, familiar “you”) ← Sanskrit *yuṣmad-*, the plural “you”, with its *t-* taken from *tvam* (CDIAL 10511); *tvam* is from PIE ***tū** — the same root as English archaic **thou**, Latin *tū*, French *tu*.

- आप (*āp*, respectful “you”) is a separate honorific word, from Sanskrit *ātman*, “self” (CDIAL 1135).

Grammar Lens: three levels of “you”

Hindi grades respect three ways: **āp** (respectful — strangers, elders), **tum** (familiar — friends, peers), **tū** (intimate or to a child; can insult if misused). The European tracks had two levels each; Hindi has three. For a first meeting, always **āp**.

The letters in this word

आप: the independent vowel आ (ā, word-initial) + प (*pa*) → *āp*. तुम: त (*ta*) + ◌ु (the *u*-sign) + म (*ma*) → *tum*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “āp” (respectful), “tum” (familiar)
- the cousin of *tum* — archaic English *thou*
- which to use with a stranger (*āp*)

Before you move on

Name Hindi’s three “you”s and when *āp* is used. (*āp* / *tum* / *tū*; *āp* for respect, strangers, first meetings.) What English word is *tum*’s cousin? (*thou*.)

2.6 क्या (kyā) — “what”

German asks a name with “how”; Hindi uses “what” — so here’s *kyā*.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Devanagari.) A **conjunct**: क (ka) loses its vowel (a *halant*) and joins य (ya) → क्य (kya); add the long-*ā* mātrā → क्या (*kyā*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क्या (*kyā*, "what") ← Sanskrit *kim* / the interrogative stem **ka-**, from PIE ***k^{w}o-** — the same question-root behind English **wh-** words (**what**, **who**, **which**) and Latin **qu-**. Hindi's question-words nearly all start with this **k-**: *kyā* (what), *kaun* (who), *kab* (when), *kyūn* (why).

The letters in this word

A **conjunct**: क (*ka*) loses its vowel (*halant*) and joins य (*ya*) → क्य (*kya*); add the long-ā mātrā → क्या (*kyā*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "kyā"
- the English *wh-* cousins — what, who, which
- the Hindi *k-* question family — kyā, kaun, kab

Before you move on

What root is क्या from, and its English cousins? (*ka- / *k^{w}o- — what, who, which.*) What sound do most Hindi question-words start with? (*k-*.)

2.7 आपका नाम क्या है? (āpkā nām kyā hai?) — "what's your name?"

Assemble the question: your + name + what + is.

The two words — assembled

- आपका (*āpkā*, "your") = आप (you) + का (*kā*, the possessive "of," the same agreeing *kā/kī/ke* that matches the noun).

आपका नाम क्या है? = literally "**your name what is?**" = "what's your name?"

Hindi keeps the verb **last** again, and simply drops the question-word *kyā* into the object slot — no reordering, no inversion.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Every word in this question is inherited: *āp* from Sanskrit *ātman*, "self" (CDIAL 1135), with -*kā*, "of"; *nām* from *nāman*; *kyā* from *kim* (CDIAL 3164); *hai*, usually traced to *asti*.

Grammar Lens: answer, and the informal version

Answer with the sentence you built: **Merā nām Arun hai.** The informal "your" swaps *āpkā* for **tumhārā**: *tumhārā nām kyā hai?*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "āpkā nām kyā hai?"
- ask, then answer — "āpkā nām kyā hai?" / "merā nām ... hai"
- the informal — "tumhārā nām kyā hai?"

Before you move on

What does **आपका नाम क्या है?** literally say, and where's the verb? ("Your name what is?"; the verb *hai* is last.) What's *āpkā* made of? (*āp* + *kā*, "you" + possessive.)

2.8 ख़ुशी (khushī) — "happiness," and "pleased to meet you"

The close to an introduction — and a word from Hindi's *other* vocabulary.

The two words

The Hindi “pleased to meet you” is आपसे मिलकर ख़ुशी हुई (*āp-se milkar khushī huī*) — literally “**having met you, happiness happened**.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The key word ख़ुशी (*khushī*, “happiness”) is **not** Sanskrit — it’s **Persian** (*khush*, “happy, pleasant”), one of the thousands of Persian words in everyday Hindi. (The dot under ख़ — a *nukta* — marks the Persian *kh* sound.) So even introducing yourself draws on Hindi’s **two** vocabularies: Sanskrit (*nām*, *hai*) and Perso-Arabic (*khushī*) — the same double heritage you met with *shukriyā* and *alvidā* in Chapter 1.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “āpse milkar khushī huī”
- the key word — *khushī* (“happiness”), a Persian word
- the two heritages — Sanskrit *nām*, Persian *khushī*

Before you move on

What does the Hindi “pleased to meet you” literally mean, and where is *khushī* from? (“Having met you, happiness happened”; Persian.) What does the *nukta* dot under ख़ mark? (A Persian/ Arabic sound.)

2.9 Mātrās — swapping the built-in vowel

Last lesson: every consonant carries a free **“a”**. So how do you write *ni*, or *mo*, or *nā*?

You **overwrite** the inherent vowel with a small mark called a **mātrā**.

You’ll want to know — The word itself

मात्रा (*mātrā*) means **“a measure”** — from the verb *mā-*, “to measure.” That root is Proto-Indo-European **meh₁-*, and it is the ancestor of English **meter**, **measure**, **immense** (“un-measurable”), and — by the oldest measuring instrument of all — **month**, the moon being what humans first counted time with.

A vowel sign is a *measure* of the syllable. The name is a description.

You’ll want to know — Two to start with

ा — the vowel **ā** (a long “aa”). A vertical bar to the **right**:

न + ा → ना (*nā*)

े — the vowel **e**. A stroke **above** the top bar:

म + े → मे (*me*)

Notice the mātrā did not *add* a vowel. It **replaced** one. न was already “na”; now it is “nā”. The inherent vowel is gone the moment a mātrā arrives.

You’ll want to know — Now write a word you already know

You have न, ा, म. That is enough for the Hindi word for “name” (Chapter 2):

न + ा + म → नाम (*nām*)

Write the three characters, then draw **one bar** across all of them.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ना — “na, then the bar to the right” — *nā*
- *Write it:* मे — “ma, then the stroke above” — *me*
- *Write it:* नाम — three characters, **one bar**, “nām”
- *Say it:* “मात्रा = a **measure**”

Before you move on

What does a mātrā do to the inherent vowel? (**Replaces** it — never adds to it.) What does the word *mātrā* mean, and what English words share its root? (“**Measure**” — *meter*, *measure*, *month*.) Where does ◌ा attach, and where does ◌े? (Right; above the bar.) Write नाम — what does it mean? (“**Name**”.) Next: the one mātrā whose position tries to fool your eye.

2.10 ◌ि — left on the page, right in the mouth

> ◌ा sits to the right and ◌े above. One Hindi vowel sign goes somewhere that will feel wrong for a while.

You’ll want to know — The famous mātrā

◌ि — the vowel **i** — is written **before** the consonant, to its **left**, but pronounced **after** it:

> श + ◌ि → शि, and that says ***śi***, not *iś*.

Read it aloud in the order you might guess and you get the wrong word. The mark *leans left* on the page and *lands right* in the mouth.

There is no satisfying modern logic behind the placement. It comes down from the script’s Brahmi ancestry and simply stuck. Your eye will learn it faster than your intuition will.

The rule to carry away:

> **A mātrā replaces the inherent vowel. And ◌ि — the only Hindi mātrā that does this — is written before the consonant it follows.**

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ◌ि + श as the visual order in शि
- *Say it:* “śi — the mark leans left and lands right”
- *Contrast:* ना *nā* · मे *me* · शि *śi*

Before you move on

शि — *śi* or *iś*? (***Śi.***) Where is ि written, and where is it pronounced? (**Before** the consonant on the page, **after** it in speech.) Does it add to the inherent vowel? (**No** — it replaces it.) Next: र and स, then your own name phrase.

2.11 र and स — a spineless letter and a possible cousin

Two more letters put every consonant in “my name” within reach.

You’ll want to know — र — “ra”, your first spineless letter

Every letter you have *written* so far has had a **vertical spine on the right**. र doesn’t:

1. **a shoulder** — a small hook at the top left.
2. **a downstroke** — falling away from it.
3. **the top bar** — last.

That’s all. A shoulder and a stroke.

र is the first of these you write, but not the only one in the script — द is spineless too, and you have already *read* it in *dhanyavād* (Chapter 1). Think of “no right-hand post” as a small family to learn, not as र’s private signature.

You’ll want to know — स — “sa”

Back to the normal frame, with a curl and a body:

1. **a left curl**
2. **a body**
3. **the right spine**
4. **the top bar** — last.

A possible very distant cousin

स and English **S** may be related — and the story is worth telling carefully, because half of it is certain and half is not.

The certain half: English **S** comes from Latin, Latin from Greek **sigma**, and Greek from the **Phoenician** letter *šin*. That western line is not in doubt.

The uncertain half: **Brahmi**, the ancestor of Devanagari, is *most likely* descended from the same Semitic family, arriving in India by way of **Aramaic**. That is the leading scholarly view, but it is not settled — some scholars argue Brahmi was an indigenous invention, and even among those who accept a Semitic source, which letter became which is disputed.

So: if the mainstream account holds, स and S share a great-great-grandparent some three thousand years back, with no family resemblance left at all. Say "probably cousins," not "cousins."

Your turn

- *Write it:* र — "shoulder, downstroke, bar" — **no spine**
- *Write it:* स — "curl, body, spine, bar"
- *Say it:* the probable cousins — "sigma · S from *šin* … and **probably** स too"

Before you move on

What makes र unlike the letters you've written so far? (**No right-hand spine** — just a shoulder and a downstroke.) Is it the only spineless letter? (**No** — द is one too, and there are a few others.) Draw स — four pieces? (Curl, body, spine, bar.) Which English letter might स be related to, and how sure are we? (**S** — certainly *šin* → sigma → S going west; the eastern leg through Aramaic to **Brahmi** is the **leading view, not settled**.) Next: assemble those letters into "my name" and let the word boundary break the head-line.

2.12 मेरा नाम — two words, two head-lines

You now know every piece of *merā nām*, "my name." This lesson only asks you to assemble them and make the word boundary visible.

You’ll want to know — Build the phrase

मेरा	म + ◌े + र + ◌ा — *merā*, “my”
नाम	न + ◌ा + म — *nām*, “name”

मेरा नाम

Two words means **two bars**. Modern Hindi separates words with an ordinary space, exactly like English. Because the shirorekhā is drawn over each word, that space appears as a **break in the line**. The gap in the bar is the result of the space, not a substitute for it.

Classical Sanskrit manuscripts often ran words together without spaces, so the bar could continue across a whole line. Modern Hindi does not ask you to copy that manuscript habit.

Your turn

Write these out:

- मेरा — four pieces, one bar
- नाम — three pieces, one bar
- मेरा नाम — two words, **two separate bars**

Before you move on

Write मेरा नाम. How many bars, and why? (**Two** — Hindi uses an ordinary **space**, and the bar breaks because of it.) Is the gap itself the space? (**No** — it is the visible result of the space.) Next: stop an inherent vowel, then use that power inside *namaste*.

2.13 The vowel killer — virama and halant

Every consonant carries a free “a.” Mātrās replace it. But what if you need **no vowel at all** — just a bare consonant?

You’ll want to know — The virama ्

् is the **virama** — a small stroke **below** the consonant that removes the inherent vowel:

क = *ka* → क् = ***k***

The name says exactly what it does. विराम (*virāma*) is “a **stopping**, a cessation” — *vi-* + *ram-*, “to rest, to come to a halt.” The vowel is told to stop.

And the word is still working elsewhere in Hindi punctuation: a full stop is पूर्ण विराम (“*complete* stop”), a comma is अल्प विराम (“*slight* stop”), a semicolon अर्ध विराम (“*half* stop”). One word, graded by how long you rest.

A naming note: *virāma* is the Sanskrit term, and the one Unicode uses. In everyday Hindi the mark is usually called the हलंत (*halant*). Same mark, two names — you’ll meet both.

Your turn

- *Write it:* क् — “क with the stroke below” — the vowel is dead
- *Say it:* “virāma — stopping; halant — the everyday Hindi name”
- *Contrast:* क *ka* → क् *k*

Before you move on

What does the virama ् do, and what does its name mean? (Kills the **inherent vowel**; *virāma* = “a **stopping**” — and a full stop in Hindi is पूर्ण विराम, a “complete stop”.) What is the mark usually called in everyday Hindi? (The **halant**.) Next: watch a stopped consonant squeeze into the one that follows.

2.14 स्त — two consonants squeezed together

A visible virama can stop a vowel. In ordinary writing, the stopped consonant often goes one step further and fuses with the consonant after it.

You’ll want to know — The usual squeeze

The fused shape is a **conjunct**:

स् + त → स्त (*sta*)

Look at स. It loses its right-hand spine, shrinks, and leans into त. For **spine-bearing** letters this is the usual move: **the first consonant gives up its spine and hands the syllable to the second**.

You’ll want to know — Spineless and irregular shapes

र has no spine to give up, so it behaves differently: as a hook above a later letter (र् + क → र्क) or as a small stroke under an earlier one (क + ◌्र → क्र). Other spineless letters, द among them, stack or take special shapes. A few common conjuncts — क्ष, त्र, ज्ञ — are irregular and must be learned whole.

This is why Devanagari seems to have so many shapes: it is not only 40-odd letters, but also the ligatures they form when they collide. Do not memorise every conjunct as a separate character. Learn to recognise the *squeeze*.

Your turn

- *Write it:* स् — स with the vowel stopped
- *Write it:* स्त — watch स **lose its spine** and lean into त
- *Trace it:* र्क and क्र — two special jobs for spineless र

Before you move on

What usually happens instead of leaving a virama visible? (The first consonant **fuses** with the next into a **conjunct**.) In स्त, what does स give up? (**Its spine**.) Why does र need different forms? (**It has no spine to give up.**) Next: use स्त inside the first greeting you learned.

2.15 नमस्ते — assemble the greeting at last

You have learned every piece separately. Now the writing track pays off in the first word of this book.

You'll want to know — Assemble नमस्ते

piece		
न	*na*	Lesson 1
म	*ma*	Lesson 1
स्	*s* — स with its vowel killed	last lesson
ते	*te* — त + the ◌े mātrā	Lessons 2 and 3

न · म · स् · ते → नमस्ते

Write it, then draw **one bar** across the whole word.

You'll want to know — What you have been writing all along

नमस्ते joins **namas** + **te**:

- **namas** — "a bow, an obeisance," from *nam-*, "**to bend**"
- **te** — "to you"

So *namaste* is literally **"a bowing to you."** It describes the physical gesture, which is why the word and folded hands go together. The greeting is the bow said aloud.

Namaskār is the same *namas* with *kāra*, "making": "**making** a bow." One root, two greetings.

Your turn

- *Write it:* स्त — the conjunct at the center
- *Write it:* ते — त plus the stroke above
- *Write it:* नमस्ते — one bar across all of it
- *Say it:* "*namas* = a **bow**, *te* = **to you**"

Before you move on

Write नमस्ते. How many bars? (**One** — it is one word.) What does it literally mean? (**A bowing to you**: *namas*, "bow," + *te*, "to you.") And *namaskār*? (The same *namas* + *kāra*, "**making** a bow.")

2.16 नमस्ते — look, hide, write, compare

Look at नमस्ते for five seconds. Point to न, म, स्, and ते. Do not copy while the model is visible.

Writing — delayed copy

- cover नमस्ते
- wait five seconds
- write it once from memory
- uncover the model and compare the four known pieces

If one piece differs, circle it and repair only that place. Repair is part of the exercise, not a failure. There is no tracing and no romanized answer model.

Before you move on

Read your repaired word aloud and remember its literal sense: **a bow to you**. Stop after one memory attempt.

2.17 One heard greeting — write what you know

Cover the answer lower on this page. You will hear one familiar greeting. No new Hindi and no new Devanagari shape is hiding in this lesson.

Writing — short dictation

Hear: namaste — “a bow to you”

Write the Devanagari word from sound alone. Do not use a visible model, romanized answer, or tracing guide. Now uncover and compare: नमस्ते. Check न, म, स्, and ते in that order. Repair one place if needed.

Before you move on

Writing one known word from sound completes this first tiny stage runway. It does not complete Hindi writing: later lessons grow into phrases, messages, and timed assessment tasks.

2.18 Chapter 2 — the introduction, whole

Every atom is built and rooted. Here's the exchange it was for.

The exchange

Hindi	**English**
merā nām Mira hai	My name is Mira.
āpkā nām kyā hai?	What's your name?
merā nām Arun hai	My name is Arun.
āpse milkar khushī huī	Pleased to meet you.

Every atom traced:

- **nām** ← Sanskrit *nāman* (English **name**, **noun**)
- **merā** ← root *ma-* (English **me**, **my**, **mine**)
- **hai** ← Sanskrit *asti* (English **is**, German *ist*, Latin *est*)
- **kyā** ← stem *ka-* (English **what**, **who**)
- **khushī** ← Persian *khush* (Hindi's second, Perso-Arabic vocabulary)

Two Hindi habits: the **verb goes last** (subject–object–verb), and "you" has **three** respect-levels (*āp / tum / tū*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the whole exchange, both voices
- your own introduction — "merā nām … hai"
- ask it back — "āpkā nām kyā hai?"

Before you move on

Give your name, ask someone else's, say you're pleased to meet them. (*Merā nām … hai. / Āpkā nām kyā hai? / …khushī huī.*) Which two words here come from Hindi's Persian vocabulary rather than Sanskrit? (*khushī* — and you'll recall *shukriyā*, *alvidā* from

Ch1.)
Next chapter: *āp kaise haiṁ?* ("how are you?") and answering with *ṭhīk* — the responding cycle.

2.19 One frame, one small choice

Write the two known words **मेरा नाम** once. Leave an ordinary space after each word. Today adds no new letter and no new grammar.

Writing — complete the visible frame

मेरा नाम _____ **है**

Choose one name already used in Chapter 2: **मीरा** or **अरुण**. Put it in the gap, then write **है**. The order stays:

1. **मेरा नाम** — my name
2. the chosen practice name
3. **है** — is

Write only one sentence. Keep four visible word groups; punctuation comes in the next tiny lesson.

Before you move on

Read the sentence once. Stop after one choice and one bounded repair.

2.20 One sentence, one stop

Read **मेरा नाम मीरा है**. Count four word groups. Do not change their order.

Writing — add only the boundary

Hindi can close this sentence with the vertical पूर्ण विराम:

मेरा नाम मीरा है।

The mark । is not part of है. Leave the word intact, then place one vertical stop after it. This lesson changes only the sentence boundary.

Write the known sentence once and add ।. Check the four spaces first, then the one stop.

> Before you move on
>
> Stop after one sentence and one single-dimension repair.

2.21 Hide the sentence; keep the order

Look for five seconds:

मेरा नाम मीरा है।

Point to the four word groups and the final stop. Do not write while the model is visible.

Writing — delayed sentence production

Cover the model. Wait ten seconds. From the meaning cue **“My name is Mira”**, write the whole Hindi sentence with no visible answer and no romanization.

Uncover it only after writing. Compare in this order: word order, spaces, spelling, then ।. Circle one differing dimension and repair only that one.

> Before you move on
>
> One delayed attempt is enough today.

2.22 Hear one known sentence; write it

Cover the answer below. The heard sentence uses only the familiar frame and the familiar practice name Arun.

Writing — sentence dictation

Hear: merā nām Aruṇ hai — “my name is Arun”

Write the Hindi sentence from sound alone. Add its final sentence stop. Do not use a visible Devanagari model or a romanized written answer.

Now uncover and compare: **मेरा नाम अरुण है।** Check word order first. If the order is right, check spelling; if spelling is right, check **।**. Repair only the first differing dimension.

> Before you move on
>
> Stop after one heard sentence.

2.23 A two-sentence card for a new classmate

You have already practised both pieces separately:

- the greeting **नमस्ते।**
- the name sentence **मेरा नाम मीरा है।**

Writing — assemble for one reader and purpose

Your reader is a **new classmate**. Your purpose is to **greet them and give the practice name**. Put the greeting first and the name second:

नमस्ते। मेरा नाम मीरा है।

Write the two separately practised pieces once. Check two sentence stops, then the space between the sentences. No new word is introduced here.

> Before you move on
>
> Next, the model disappears.

2.24 No model — greet and give the name

Close the preceding lesson. Wait ten seconds. Keep only this purpose cue:

> **Write to a new classmate. Greet them, then give the practice name Mira.**

There is no Devanagari model and no romanized answer.

Writing — independent delayed checkpoint

Write two sentences from the purpose cue. Do not reopen the model until the attempt is complete. Then compare in four separate passes:

1. two meanings in the requested order;
2. word and sentence spacing;
3. spelling;
4. one । after each sentence.

Choose the first differing pass, repair only that dimension, and stop.

Your turn — the introduction, said back

- Give your name, ask theirs, say you're pleased. (*Merā nām … hai. Āpkā nām kyā hai? Āpse milkar khushī huī.*)
- English cousins of *nām*, *merā*, *hai*, *kyā*? (**Name**, **my**, **is**, **what**.)
- Why *merā*, not *merī*? (*Nām* is masculine.) Where does *hai* go? (**Last.**)
- Which "you" for a stranger? (***Āp***.) And *khushī*'s origin? (**Persian.**)

Script — the pieces you wrote

- *Mātrā* means? What does one do? ("**A measure**"; it **replaces** the inherent vowel.)
- Where do ◌ा, ◌े and ◌ि sit? (**Right**, **above** — ◌ि before, said after.)
- Which of र and स has no spine? (र — conjuncts give it a hook or stroke.)
- What does ◌् do? (**Stops** the vowel: the *halant*.) What does स lose in स्त? (**Its spine.**)

Before you move on

This completes only the short connected pre-A1 writing bridge. It is not a timed mock and does not claim A1 or exam readiness.

Chapter 3

How Are You?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 👁 **eyes** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how someone is in Hindi, answer naturally, and return the question.
>
> *Complete HI-C03-practice, the canonical closing checkpoint, and demonstrate the chapter promise: ask how someone is in Hindi, answer naturally, and return the question.*

3.1 कैसा / कैसी / कैसे — agreeing forms of “what kind?” and “how?”

You already met *kyā* (“what”). Here is its sibling — and, like all of Hindi’s question-words, it starts with **k-**.

The letters in this word

(Skim if you read Devanagari.) क (*ka*) + ◌ै (the *ai*-mātrā) → कै (*kai*); स (*sa*) + ◌े (the *e*-mātrā) → से (*se*). Read कै · से → *kaise.*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कैसे (*kaise*, “how”) ← Sanskrit *kīdṛśa* (“of what kind”) / the interrogative stem **क-** (*ka*-), from Proto-Indo-European *k^{w}o- — the same question-root behind English **wh-** (what, who, how) and Latin **qu-**. Notice the pattern: Hindi’s question-words are nearly all **k-** words — *kyā* (what), *kaun* (who), *kab* (when), *kahāṁ* (where), *kaise* (how). Learn to hear the *k*- and you can spot a question.

Grammar Lens: कैसा agrees

The adjective form कैसा (*kaisā*) changes to match what it describes: *kaisā* (m.), *kaisī* (f.), *kaise* (m. plural / respectful). Because the respectful “you” (*āp*) takes a plural verb, “how are **you**?” uses the plural कैसे — that is the form you will use next.

The letters in this word

क (*ka*) + ◌ै (the *ai*-mātrā) → कै (*kai*); स (*sa*) + ◌े (the *e*-mātrā) → से (*se*). *Read it:* कै · से → *kaise*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “kaise”
- the agreeing set — **कैसा, कैसी, कैसे** (*kaisā, kaisī, kaise*)
- the k- question family — *kyā, kaun, kab, kahāṁ, kaise*
- which English question-words share the root (what, who, how)

Before you move on

What root do all of Hindi’s question-words share, and what English family is it cousin to? (The interrogative *k*-, PIE *$*k^w o$*-; the English *wh*- words.) Which form is masculine singular, which is feminine, and which is respectful or masculine plural? (**कैसा, कैसी, कैसे**.)

3.2 आप कैसे हैं? (āp kaise haiṁ?) — “how are you?”

Three words you already own, assembled into the first thing you ask after hello.

The letters in this word

हैं is है (*hai*, “is”) + the *anusvāra* dot ◌ं → हैं (*haiṁ*), the nasalised plural. Everything else — आप (*āp*), कैसे (*kaise*) — you have met.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आप कैसे हैं? = **आप** (*āp*, respectful "you") + **कैसे** (*kaise*, "how") + **हैं** (*haiṁ*, "are") — literally "**you how are?**" Hindi keeps the verb **last**, exactly as in Chapter 2's *merā nām … hai.* And because *āp* is grammatically plural (that is how Hindi shows respect), its verb is the plural **haiṁ**, not the singular *hai.*
आप comes from Sanskrit *ātman*, "self" (CDIAL 1135), and **कैसे** from *kīdṛśa*, "of what kind" (CDIAL 3197).

Grammar Lens: respect is plural

To an elder or a stranger: **आप कैसे हैं?** To a friend (*tum*): **तुम कैसे हो?** (*tum kaise ho?* — *ho* is the familiar "are"). To no one in particular you would never drop to *tū.* Match the "you" to the verb: *āp … haiṁ*, *tum … ho.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the respectful question — *āp kaise haiṁ?*
- the familiar version — *tum kaise ho?*
- where the verb sits (at the end)

Before you move on

Why is it *haiṁ* (plural) and not *hai* with *āp*? (Because respect in Hindi is grammatically plural — *āp* always takes the plural verb.)

3.3 मैं (maiṁ) — "I," the m- of the first person

To answer "how are you?" you first need "I." In Chapter 2 you learned *merā* ("my"); here is its owner.

The letters in this word

म (*ma*) + ै (the *ai*-mātrā) + the *anusvāra* nasal ं → मैं (*maiṁ*). One nasal syllable.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मैं (*maiṁ*, “I”) ← Sanskrit *mayā* (“by me”), on the first-person root **म-** (*ma-*) — the same root that gave you *merā* (“my”) last chapter, and the same **m-** behind English **me**, **my**, **mine** and Latin *mē*. Hindi’s “I,” its “my,” and English’s “me/my” all grow from one ancient first-person sound.

Grammar Lens: the pronoun you can often drop

Hindi verbs carry the person in their ending, so *maiṁ* is frequently left out once context is clear — much like Spanish or Latin. You will still learn it first, because the answer to *āp kaise haiṁ?* begins with it: *maiṁ …*

The letters in this word

म (*ma*) + ◌ै (*ai*) + the *anusvāra* ◌ं → मैं (*maiṃ*). One nasal syllable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “maiṁ”
- the m- family — *maiṁ* (I), *merā* (my), English *me*, *my*

Before you move on

What root links *maiṁ*, *merā*, and English *me*? (The first-person **m-**, from Sanskrit *ma-* / PIE **me-*.)

3.4 हूँ (hūṁ) — “am,” cousin of English *am*

Chapter 2 gave you *hai* (“is”). This is the same verb in the first person — “**I** am.”

The letters in this word

ह (*ha*) + ◌ू (the long-*u* mātrā) → हू (*hū*); the *chandrabindu* ◌ँ nasalises it → हूँ (*hūṁ*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हूँ (*hūṁ*, "am") ← Sanskrit अस्मि (*asmi*, "I am") — the first-person of the very root that gave you *hai*. That root, PIE ***h₁es-**, is the "to be" of the whole family: Sanskrit *asmi* → English **am**, Latin *sum*, Greek *eimi*; Sanskrit *asti* → *hai* / English *is*. So the Hindi copula lines up with English person by person: हूँ *am*, है *is*, हैं *are*.

Grammar Lens: the "to be" table so far

person	Hindi	English
I	*maiṁ hūṁ*	I am
you (resp.)	*āp haiṁ*	you are
he/she/it	*vah hai*	he/she is

The verb होना (*honā*, "to be") is the frame every sentence hangs on; you now have three of its faces.

The letters in this word

ह (*ha*) + ◌ू (long *u*) → हू (*hū*); the *chandrabindu* ◌ँ nasalises → हूँ (*hūṃ*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "hūṁ"
- the copula trio — *hūṁ* (am), *hai* (is), *haiṁ* (are)
- "maiṁ … hūṁ" — I am …

Before you move on

What Sanskrit word is *hūṁ* from, and its English cousin? (*Asmi*, "I am"; English **am** — same PIE root *$*h_1es$-*.)

3.5 ठीक (ṭhīk) — "fine," and how to answer

The word that answers "how are you?" — and does a dozen other jobs besides.

The letters in this word

ठ (*ṭha*, a **retroflex** *th* — tongue curled back to the roof of the mouth) + ◌ी (the long-*ī* mātrā) + क (*ka*) → ठीक (*ṭhīk*). The retroflex *ṭ*-*ṭh*-*ḍ* series is a hallmark of Indian languages; the tongue touches further back than for an English "t."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ठीक (*ṭhīk*) means "correct, right, fine, exactly, OK." It comes from a reconstructed **ṭhīkka*, "firm, right", probably from Sanskrit *sthita*, "standing" (CDIAL 5503). It is one of the most useful words in the language: *ṭhīk hai* ("OK / agreed"), *ṭhīk samay* ("the right time"), *sab ṭhīk?* ("all well?").

The exchange — the reply

Put it together with Chapter 3's atoms: *maiṁ ṭhīk hūṁ* — "**I am fine**." Literally "I fine am," verb last. Add thanks: *maiṁ ṭhīk hūṁ, dhanyavād.* And the whole exchange stands:

> — *āp kaise haiṁ?* ("How are you?") — *maiṁ ṭhīk hūṁ, dhanyavād.* ("I'm fine, thank you.")

The letters in this word

ठ (*ṭha*, a **retroflex** *th* — tongue curled to the roof of the mouth) + ◌ी (long *ī*) + क (*ka*) → ठीक. The retroflex *ṭ*-*ṭh*-*ḍ* series is a hallmark of Indian sound.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ṭhīk" — feel the retroflex *ṭh*
- the full reply — *maiṁ ṭhīk hūṁ*
- the casual "OK" — *ṭhīk hai*

Before you move on

Give the whole reply to *āp kaise haiṁ?*, and say where *ṭhīk* probably comes from. (*Maiṁ ṭhīk hūṁ*; from Sanskrit *sthita*, “standing”.)

3.6 आपका स्वागत है (āpkā svāgat hai) — “you’re welcome”

When someone thanks you, this is what you say back — and it hides a word Sanskrit uses whole, unchanged.

The letters in this word

The key word is स्वागत (*svāgat*): the conjunct स्व (स् *s* + व *va* → *sva*) + ग (*ga*) + त (*ta*). Add आपका (*āpkā*, “your,” from Chapter 2) and है (*hai*, “is”).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आपका स्वागत है = “your welcome is” → “**you are welcome**.” The heart of it, स्वागत (*svāgat*, “welcome”), is Sanskrit सु (*su-*, “well, good”) + आगत (*āgata*, “come”) — literally “**well come**,” exactly like English *welcome*. Two deep roots hide inside:

- *su-* “good” is the twin of Greek **eu-** (*euphoria*, *eulogy*).
- *āgata* is from the root गम् (*gam*, “to go/come”), cousin of English **come**.

Sanskrit’s own *svāgatam* is this very word, unchanged — here it is again, worn into everyday Hindi.

The letters in this word

The key word स्वागत (*svāgat*): the conjunct स्व (स् *s* + व *va* → *sva*) + ग (*ga*) + त (*ta*), with आपका (*āpkā*, “your”) and है (*hai*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “āpkā svāgat hai”

- what *svāgat* is built from (*su* "well" + *āgata* "come")
- the exchange — *dhanyavād* / *āpkā svāgat hai*

Before you move on

What does *svāgat* literally mean, and what English word matches it piece for piece? ("Well come"; English **welcome**.)

3.7 Chapter 3 — The how-are-you exchange

No new words. The whole responding cycle, assembled from atoms you now own.

The exchange

Say these aloud:

- "How are you?" (respectful) — *āp kaise haiṁ?*
- "I'm fine, thank you." — *maiṁ ṭhīk hūṁ, dhanyavād.*
- "You're welcome." — *āpkā svāgat hai.*
- the familiar version of the question — *tum kaise ho?*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Say these aloud:

- the k- question-word for "how" (*kaise*)
- "I" and "am" (*maiṁ*, *hūṁ*)
- the copula trio you now hold (*hūṁ* / *hai* / *haiṁ*)

What you've built — roots you now carry

- *kaise* ← the interrogative *k-* (PIE *$^*k^w o$-*), cousin of English *how/ what*
- *maiṁ* ← *ma-* (PIE **me-*), cousin of English *me/my*
- *hūṁ* ← Sanskrit *asmi*, cousin of English **am**

- *svāgat* ← *su* + *āgata* = “well come,” matching English **welcome**

Before you move on

A stranger asks *āp kaise haiṁ?* — give a complete, polite reply, then thank-and-welcome the exchange back. (*Maiṁ ṭhīk hūṁ, dhanyavād.* — and if thanked, *āpkā svāgat hai.*)

Chapter 4

Farewells

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 👁 **eyes** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can end a Hindi conversation politely and choose a farewell that fits the situation.
>
> *Complete HI-C04-practice, the canonical closing checkpoint, and demonstrate the chapter promise: end a Hindi conversation politely and choose a farewell that fits the situation.*

4.1 फिर (phir) — "again," the seed of "see you again"

One small word turns a goodbye from "farewell" into "**till next time**." Here it is.

The letters in this word

फ (*pha*, an aspirated *p* — a puff of breath) + ि (the *i*-mātrā, written *before* the consonant but read after) + र (*ra*) → फिर (*phir*).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फिर (*phir*) means "again, then, afterwards." It is a native Indo-Aryan adverb (the form "having turned" of a reconstructed **phirati*, "turns", CDIAL 9078) with no tidy English cognate — but its *job* is one English shares: it turns a parting into a promise. English "see you **again**," Hindi *phir milenge* ("we'll meet **again**"). The optimism is the same; only the word is Indian.

The letters in this word

फ (*pha*, an aspirated *p*) + ि (the *i*-mātrā, written before but read after) + र (*ra*) → फिर.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “phir” — mind the aspirated *ph*
- what it adds to a goodbye (“again / then”)

Before you move on

What does *phir* mean, and what does it do to a farewell? (“Again / then”; it makes the parting a promise of return.)

4.2 मिलेंगे (milenge) — “(we) will meet”

Your first future-tense verb — and the other half of “see you again.”

The letters in this word

म (*ma*) + ि→मि (*mi*); adding ल (*la*) + े completes मिले (*mile*). The *anusvāra* ं nasalises; गे (*ge*). Read the complete मिलेंगे → *milenge*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मिलेंगे (*milenge*, “we/they will meet”) is the future of the verb मिलना (*milnā*, “to meet, to be found, to get”), from Sanskrit मिल् (*mil-*, “to join, unite”) — the root behind *milan* (“a union, a meeting”), a common word and name. The ending **-एंगे** (*-enge*) is the plural future: *milenge* = “(we) will meet.”

Grammar Lens: how Hindi builds the future

Hindi marks the future with an ending on the verb stem: *mil-* (“meet”) + *-enge* (“we/they will”) → *milenge*. No helper-word like English “will” — the tense lives in the ending, the way Hindi’s person lives in *hūṁ/hai/haiṁ*.

The letters in this word

मि (*mi*) + ल (*la*) with ◌े makes मिले (*mile*); add the *anusvāra* + गे (*ge*) → मिलेंगे (*milenge*).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “milenge”
- the root and its cousin-noun (*mil-* “to join,” *milan* “a meeting”)
- how the future is marked (an ending on the stem, not a helper-word)

Before you move on

What verb is *milenge* from, and how does Hindi show “will”? (*Milnā* “to meet,” from Sanskrit *mil-*; with the ending *-enge*, not a separate word.)

4.3 फिर मिलेंगे (phir milenge) — “we’ll meet again”

The warm, everyday goodbye — the one you actually hear, far more than Chapter 1’s formal *alvidā*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फिर मिलेंगे = फिर (*phir*, “again”) + मिलेंगे (*milenge*, “we will meet”) — “**we’ll meet again**.” Where Chapter 1’s अलविदा (*alvidā*) is a grave, final farewell (and, fittingly, a **Perso-Arabic** word — *al-widā*, “the farewell”), *phir milenge* is native, everyday, and hopeful: फिर goes back to **phirati*, “turns” (CDIAL 9078), and मिलेंगे to Sanskrit *milati*, “meets” (CDIAL 10133). It is the exact sibling of the “promise of return” goodbyes across South Asia — Tamil, Bengali, Marathi all say “I’ll come again” rather than “goodbye.”

Grammar Lens: two registers of goodbye

- अलविदा (*alvidā*) — formal, final, Perso-Arabic; for long or last partings.
- फिर मिलेंगे (*phir milenge*) — everyday, warm, native; "till we meet again." Even more casual: *phir milte haiṁ* ("(we) meet again," present for a near future).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the warm goodbye — *phir milenge*
- how it differs from *alvidā* (everyday/hopeful vs. formal/final)
- the two words it's built from (*phir* + *milenge*)

Before you move on

What does *phir milenge* literally say, and when would you use it over *alvidā*? ("We'll meet again"; for everyday partings, where *alvidā* is formal and final.)

4.4 कल मिलते हैं (kal milte haiṁ) — "see you tomorrow"

A goodbye for tomorrow — built on a word that means both **tomorrow** and **yesterday**.

The letters in this word

क (*ka*) + ल (*la*) → कल (*kal*). Two of the simplest letters, one of the trickiest words.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कल (*kal*) means **both "tomorrow" and "yesterday"** — the same word for the day on either side of today. It is from Sanskrit *kalya*, "dawn, tomorrow", built on काल (*kāla*, "time") (CDIAL 3104) — the very root that sits inside Punjabi's *akāl* ("timeless"). Hindi trusts context (and the verb's tense) to tell which *kal* you mean: *kal milte haiṁ* (present-ish → "**tomorrow**"), *kal milā* (past → "**yesterday**"). कल मिलते हैं = *kal* ("tomorrow") + *milte haiṁ* ("we meet," present used for a near-certain future) → "**see you tomorrow**."

Grammar Lens: the present-for-future

milte haiṁ is literally "(we) meet" — Hindi, like English ("I'm seeing you tomorrow"), uses the present for a scheduled future. *Milte* (the habitual participle) + *haiṁ* (the "are" you learned in Chapter 3).

The letters in this word

क (*ka*) + ल (*la*) → कल (*kal*). Two simple letters, one tricky word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "kal milte haiṁ"
- the puzzle — *kal* means both **tomorrow** and **yesterday**
- the root and its Punjabi cousin (*kāla* "time"; *akāl* "timeless")

Before you move on

What two opposite days does *kal* mean, and what tells them apart? (Both tomorrow and yesterday; the sentence's tense/context.)

4.5 चलता हूँ (chaltā hūṁ) — "I'll be off"

The casual "I'm heading out" — and your first taste of how a Hindi verb changes for a man or a woman speaking.

The letters in this word

च (*ca*) + ल (*la*) + the long-*ā* mātrā → चलता (*chaltā*); with हूँ (*hūṁ*, "am," from Chapter 3). Read *chaltā hūṁ*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The phrase चलता हूँ, *chaltā hūṁ*, literally means “**I go / I move**,” used the way English says “I’ll be off / I’ll get going.” The verb is चलना (*chalnā*, “to move, walk, go”), from Sanskrit चल् (*cal-*, “to move, stir”) — the root behind *cal* (“move!”), *calan* (“circulation”), and *cañcal* (“restless”). Like Bengali *āshi* (“I come”) and Marathi *yeto*, Hindi prefers to leave by saying “I’m **moving**,” never a blunt “I’m leaving.”

Grammar Lens: the verb agrees with the speaker’s gender

- a man says चलता हूँ (*chaltā hūṁ*)
- a woman says चलती हूँ (*chaltī hūṁ*)

The *-tā* / *-tī* ending marks the speaker’s gender — a feature English has no trace of, and one you will meet again and again. (Compare Marathi *yeto* m. / *yete* f.)

The letters in this word

च (*ca*) + ल (*la*) + long *ā* → चलता (*caltā*), with हूँ (*hūṃ*).

Your turn

- *Say it (m.): chaltā hūṁ* · (f.): *chaltī hūṁ*
- *Say it:* the verb and root (*chalnā* “to move,” Sanskrit *cal-*)
- *Say it:* why Hindi says “I move” and not “I leave” (the softer, non-final parting)

Before you move on

What does *chaltā hūṁ* literally mean, and how does a woman say it? (“I go/move” = I’ll be off; *chaltī hūṁ*, with the feminine *-tī*.)

4.6 Chapter 4 — The farewells

No new words. Four ways to part, from the formal to the offhand.

Why it's said this way

Say these aloud:

- formal, final (Perso-Arabic) — *alvidā*
- everyday, "we'll meet again" — *phir milenge*
- "see you tomorrow" — *kal milte haiṁ*
- casual "I'll be off" (m./f.) — *caltā hūṁ / caltī hūṁ*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Say these aloud:

- "again" and "(we) will meet" (*phir*, *milenge*)
- the word that means BOTH tomorrow and yesterday (*kal*)
- the verb behind "I'll be off" (*calnā*, "to move")

What you've built — roots you now carry

- *milenge* ← *mil-* "to join" (*milan*, "a meeting")
- *kal* ← *kāla* "time" (cousin of Punjabi *akāl*, "timeless")
- *caltā* ← *cal-* "to move"; the *-tā/-tī* ending marks the speaker's gender
- *alvidā* ← Perso-Arabic *al-widā*, "the farewell"

Before you move on

You're leaving a friend and expect to see them next week. Which goodbye fits, and how would a woman sign off casually? (*Phir milenge*; *caltī hūṁ*.)

Chapter 5

The First Verbs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2)   👁 **eyes** (4)   🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can build short present-tense Hindi sentences with the chapter’s first verbs.
>
> *Complete HI-C05-practice, the canonical closing checkpoint, and demonstrate the chapter promise: build short present-tense Hindi sentences with the chapter’s first verbs.*

5.1 बोलना / बोल (*bolnā* / *bol*) — “to speak” and its stem

Until now, “to be.” Here is a verb that *does* something — and it comes in a shape you’ll see on every Hindi verb.

The letters in this word

ब (*ba*) + ो (the *o*-mātrā) → बो (*bo*); ल (*la*); ना (*nā*). Read बो · ल · ना → *bolnā*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बोलना (*bolnā*, “to speak”) is a native Indo-Aryan verb (from Prakrit *bolla-*, “to utter”). Notice its ending: **-ना** (*-nā*). **Every** Hindi verb, named in the dictionary, ends in *-nā* — it is the infinitive marker, Hindi’s “to _____”: *bol-nā* “to speak,” *cal-nā* “to move” (you met it in *caltā hūṁ*), *mil-nā* “to meet” (from *milenge*). Strip the *-nā* and you have the **stem** (*bol-*) that takes all the other endings.

Grammar Lens: stem + ending

The stem **बोल** (*bol-*) is where the action lives; endings pin down who and when: *bol-tā* (speaking, m.), *bol-tī* (speaking, f.), *bol-o* (speak!, familiar command). You will build every tense by adding to a stem like this.

The letters in this word

ब (*ba*) + **◌ो** (the *o*-mātrā) → **बो** (*bo*); **ल** (*la*); **ना** (*nā*). *Read it:* **बो · ल · ना** → *bolnā*

Your turn

- *Say it:* “bolnā”
- *Say it:* strip **-ना** from **बोलना**
- *Read it:* the stem **बोल** (*bol-*)
- *Say it:* the infinitive marker every Hindi verb ends in (*-nā*)
- *Say it:* three *-nā* verbs you now know (*bolnā, calnā, milnā*)

Before you move on

What ending does every Hindi infinitive carry, and what is *bolnā*’s stem? (*-nā*; the stem is *bol-*.)

5.2 रहना (rahnā) — “to live, to stay”

A second verb, so you can say where you live — and see the *stem + ending* machine work all over again.

The letters in this word

र (*ra*) + **ह** (*ha*) + **ना** (*nā*) → **रहना** (*rahnā*). The familiar infinitive **-ना**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रहना (*rahnā*, “to live, to remain, to stay”) is from Sanskrit **रह्** (*rah-*, “to remain, be left”). It covers both “reside” and “keep on”: *maiṁ Dillī meṁ rahtā hūṁ* (“I live in Delhi”), *ṭhīk rahnā* (“stay well” — a warm sign-off). Stem *rah-* + *-tā/-tī* + *honā*, exactly like *bolnā*.

Grammar Lens: “in” comes after the noun

maiṁ Dillī meṁ rahtā hūṁ (“I live in Delhi”). The little word में (*meṁ*, “in”) sits **after** Delhi, not before — Hindi uses **post**positions where English uses prepositions. “Delhi-in I live.” The verb, as ever, is last.

The letters in this word

र (*ra*) + ह (*ha*) + ना (*nā*) → रहना. The familiar infinitive -ना.

Your turn

- *Say it (m.): maiṁ Dillī meṁ rahtā hūṁ* · (f.): *… rahtī hūṁ*
- *Say it:* the root (*rah-* “to remain”)
- *Say it:* where “in” (*meṁ*) sits — after the noun, not before

Before you move on

Say “I live in Delhi,” and note what is odd (to English ears) about the word “in.” (*Maiṁ Dillī meṁ rahtā/rahtī hūṁ*; *meṁ* “in” comes **after** Delhi — a postposition.)

5.3 करना — “to do,” “to work,” and their present forms

One verb powers a thousand phrases — and its root already sits inside a word you learned back in Chapter 1.

The letters in this word

क (*ka*) + र (*ra*) + ना (*nā*) → करना (*karnā*). Simple letters, enormous reach.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

करना (*karnā*, “to do, to make”) is from Sanskrit *√kṛ* (“to do, make”) — one of the most productive roots in all of Sanskrit, and from Proto-Indo-European ***kʷer-**. You have met its family already:

- कर्म (*karma*) = “a thing **done**,” an action and its consequence.
- नमस्कार (*namaskār*) = “the **making** of a bow” (*namas* + *kār*) — the greeting from Chapter 1.
- *saṃskṛta* (“Sanskrit”) = “**put together**, perfected.”

So *karnā* is the everyday face of the root behind *karma*, *namaskār*, and the name *Sanskrit* itself.

Grammar Lens: करना makes verbs out of anything

Hindi builds countless verbs as **noun** + करना:

- काम करना (*kām karnā*) = “work-do” = “**to work**” (*kām*, “work”)
- *bāt karnā* = “talk-do” = “to converse”
- *intazār karnā* = “to wait”

So *maiṁ kām kartā hūṁ* = “I work” (lit. “I work-do am”). Learn *karnā* and you unlock a whole grammar of “do-verbs.”

The letters in this word

क (*ka*) + र (*ra*) + ना (*nā*) → करना.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “karnā”
- “I work” (m./f.) — *maiṁ kām kartā hūṁ* / *kartī hūṁ*
- the Chapter 1 word that shares its root (*namaskār* — the “making” of a bow)

Before you move on

What Sanskrit root is *karnā* from, and name two words built on it. (√*kṛ* “to do”; any two of *karma*, *namaskār*, *Sanskrit*.)

5.4 बोलता हूँ (boltā hūṁ) — one stem, and the two things Hindi makes it agree with

You have the stem *bol-*. This lesson is the machine that turns any stem into a sentence about what someone *does* — and it is the single biggest piece of leverage in this book so far, because it fits every verb you will ever meet.

What to know first

- बोलना — the infinitive, and how to strip *-nā* to get the stem.
- हूँ — "I am," the verb this template leans on.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

bol- goes back to a reconstructed **boll-*, "speak" (CDIAL 9321). The *-tā* continues the old present participle in *-nt-*, as in Prakrit *hoṁta*, "being" (CDIAL 9416).

Grammar Lens: stem + -tā/-tī/-te + honā

To say what someone does *in general*, Hindi builds three pieces in a row: the **stem**, a **participle ending**, and the **"to be" verb**.

who	**the pieces**	**the whole thing**
I (a man)	-ता *-tā* + हूँ *hūṁ*	बोलता हूँ *boltā hūṁ*
I (a woman)	-ती *-tī* + हूँ *hūṁ*	बोलती हूँ *boltī hūṁ*
āp (you, respectful)	-ते *-te* + हैं *haiṁ*	बोलते हैं *bolte haiṁ*

Strip *-nā*, add the ending, add *honā*. That is the whole rule, and it does not change from verb to verb.

Grammar Lens: the two agreements, and why they are two

This is the part worth slowing down for, because Hindi is doing **two separate jobs at once** and a beginner naturally expects one.

- -ता / -ती / -ते agrees with **gender and number**. It does not care who is speaking. A woman says *boltī* whether she is talking about herself or being addressed.
- हूँ / है / हैं agrees with **person**. It does not care about gender. *Hūṁ* is "I am" for a man and a woman alike.

So *boltī hūṁ* is not one ending chosen from a list of six. It is two choices made independently and then set side by side — feminine on the participle, first-person on the verb. Once you treat them as two dials rather than one, the whole present tense stops needing to be memorised.

English does this too, and hides it: *“I am speaking”* is also participle plus *to be*. Hindi simply puts the *to be* last, where Hindi always puts its verbs.

Your turn

- *Say it (m.):* “I speak” — *boltā hūṁ*
- *Say it (f.):* “I speak” — *boltī hūṁ*
- *Say it:* “you (respectful) speak” — *āp bolte haiṁ*
- *Say it:* which of the two endings changed when you switched from a man to a woman, and which one did not (-*tā*→-*tī* changed; *hūṁ* did not)

Before you move on

Hindi’s present habitual makes two agreements at once. Name what each of the two pieces agrees with. (-*tā*/-*tī*/-*te* agrees with gender and number; *hūṁ*/*hai*/*haiṁ* agrees with person.)

5.5 मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ (maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ) — “I speak Hindi”

Your first complete, moving sentence — subject, object, and a verb that *acts*.

The letters in this word

हिंदी (*hindī*): ह (*ha*) + ि→हि + the *anusvāra* ं + दी (*dī*). And बोलता (*boltā*) = the stem *bol*- + -ता (-*tā*), the present-habitual, masculine.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ = मैं (*maiṁ*, “I”) + हिंदी (*hindī*, “Hindi,” the object) + बोलता (*boltā*, “speak,” m.) + हूँ (*hūṁ*, “am”) → literally “**I Hindi speaking am**.” Verb-frame last, exactly as always.

The name हिंदी itself is a traveller: from सिन्धु (*sindhu*, the river Indus) → Persian *hind* (the land past that river) → *hindī* (“of Hind”). The same *sindhu* gave Greek *Indos* → English **India**, **Indus**, **Hindu**. The language is named, at two removes, after a river.

Grammar Lens: the frame you already have

The verb here is the present habitual — **stem + -tā/-tī/-te + honā** — which बोलता हूँ built one lesson ago. Nothing about it is new; this sentence is the first place you get to *use* it on a real object.

What is new is the word order: मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ puts the object *before* the verb frame, so the sentence ends on *hūṁ*. Hindi’s verb goes last, always.

Your turn

- *Say it (m.): maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ* · (f.): *maiṁ hindī boltī hūṁ*
- *Say it:* “you (resp.) speak Hindi” — *āp hindī bolte haiṁ*
- *Say it:* the river hidden in the word *hindī* (*sindhu*, the Indus)

Before you move on

Build “I speak Hindi” as a woman, and name the river behind *hindī*. (*Maiṁ hindī boltī hūṁ*; the *Sindhu*/Indus.)

5.6 Chapter 5 — The first verbs

No new words. Three verbs, one engine — build real sentences about yourself.

How to answer — build the sentences

Say these aloud:

- “I speak Hindi” (m./f.) — *maiṁ hindī boltā/boltī hūṁ*
- “I live in Delhi” — *maiṁ Dillī meṁ rahtā/rahtī hūṁ*
- “I work” — *maiṁ kām kartā/kartī hūṁ*
- “you (resp.) speak Hindi” — *āp hindī bolte haiṁ*

Grammar lens — the engine

Say these aloud:

- the ending every infinitive carries (*-nā*)
- the two agreements in a present sentence (*-tā/-tī/-te* for gender/number; *hūṁ/hai/haiṁ* for person)
- where the verb sits, and where “in” sits (verb last; *meṁ* after the noun)

What you’ve built — roots you now carry

- *bolnā* “to speak” (Prakrit *bolla-*)
- *rahnā* “to live” ← *rah-* “to remain”
- *karnā* “to do” ← √*kṛ* — the root of *karma*, *namaskār*, *Sanskrit*
- *hindī* ← *sindhu*, the river Indus

Before you move on

In one breath, tell me your language, your city, and your work in Hindi (as a woman). (*Maiṁ hindī boltī hūṁ. Maiṁ … meṁ rahtī hūṁ. Maiṁ kām kartī hūṁ.*)

Chapter 6

Numbers One to Five

Modes: **voice** (3) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from one to five in Hindi and hear the older Sanskrit shapes still sitting inside तीन, चार and पाँच.
>
> *Count* एक *to* पाँच*, trace* तीन *and* चार *back through the Prakrits to neuter Sanskrit forms, then say* पाँच *beside pañca and point to the moon-dot that is all that survives of the lost nasal consonant.*

6.1 एक, दो, तीन, चार, पाँच — the five forms

Five words, and a story about how languages age.

You'll want to know — The five

	Hindi	**said**
1	एक	*ek*
2	दो	*do*
3	तीन	*tīn*
4	चार	*chār*
5	पाँच	*pāṁch*

If you did the writing track you'll recognise some pieces: क (Lesson 2), त (Lesson 2), न (Lesson 1), र (Lesson 4), and the ा mātrā (Lesson 3).

Plenty here you haven't been taught to draw yet — ए, च, द, प, the ी and ो mātrās, and the ँ. *Read it:* these letters

You'll draw them when the writing track reaches them.

The ◌ँ over *pām̐ch* is a *chandrabindu*, “moon-dot” — it nasalises the vowel, the way French does in *bon*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

All five are tadbhavas, Sanskrit numbers reshaped by sound change: *ek* from a doubled form of *eka* (CDIAL 2462), *do* from *dva* (CDIAL 6648), *tīn* from *trīṇi* (CDIAL 5994), *chār* from *catvāraḥ* (CDIAL 4655), and *pām̐ch* from *pañca* (CDIAL 7655).

Your turn

- *Say it:* “ek, do, tīn, chār, pām̐ch”
- *Point to:* the familiar क, त, न, र and ◌ा inside the five words
- *Trace it:* the ◌ँ moon-dot over *pām̐ch*

Before you move on

Count to five in Hindi. (*Ek, do, tīn, chār, pām̐ch.*) Which mark nasalises the vowel in पाँच? (The **chandrabindu**, “moon-dot.”) Do you need to draw every unfamiliar letter today? (**No** — read them now and draw them when their stroke lessons arrive.) Next: watch the Sanskrit forms wear smooth.

6.2 तीन and चार — weight moves from consonants to vowels

The five modern forms did not jump straight from Sanskrit. The Prakrits did most of the wearing-down in between.

You’ll want to know — Put the stages side by side

Sanskrit	**→ Prakrit →**	**Hindi**
éka-	*ekka*	**ek**
dvá-	*do*	**do**
neuter *trīṇi*	*tiṇṇi*	**tīn**
neuter *catvā́ri*	*cattāri*	**chār**
páñca	*pañca*	**pām̐ch**

Three and four come from the **neuter** forms. Sanskrit also had masculine *tráyaḥ*, but Hindi *tīn* continues *trī́ṇi*. The same choice gives *catvā́ri* → *chār*.

You'll want to know — The two-step weight trade

1. ***trī́ṇi* → *tiṇṇi***: *r* is lost and **ṇ doubles** to make up the weight. Long *ī* shortens because the doubled consonant already makes the syllable heavy.
2. ***tiṇṇi* → *tīn***: the double simplifies and the **vowel lengthens** to pay for the lost consonant weight.

The vowel ends long again after being short in the middle. *Ekka* → *ek* shows the second half of the same trade.

This is not decay in a bad sense; it is what heavy use does over two thousand years. The same ancient number wore down on another continent:

	ancient	**modern**
Latin → Spanish	*quattuor*	*cuatro*
Sanskrit → Hindi	*catvā́ri*	*chār*

Same PIE word, two continents, two ordinary histories.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "trī́ṇi … ti**ṇṇ**i … t**ī**n"
- *Say it:* "catvā́ri … cattāri … **chār**"
- *Compare:* "quattuor → cuatro · catvā́ri → chār"

Before you move on

Which Sanskrit forms underlie *tīn* and *chār*? (**Neuter** *trī́ṇi* and *catvā́ri*.) What sits between Sanskrit and Hindi? (The **Prakrits**.) In *trī́ṇi* → *tiṇṇi* → *tīn*, what trades places? (The lost *r* is paid for by a **double consonant**, then the simplified double by a **long vowel**.) Next: follow the nasal that stayed inside *pāṁch*.

6.3 पाँच — the nasal moved into the vowel

Tīn moved weight between consonants and vowels. *Pāṁch* moves a whole nasal sound into the vowel itself.

You'll want to know — The nasal that stayed

Sanskrit ***pañca*** → Hindi ***pāṁch***. The **n** did not vanish; Sanskrit's *ñ* consonant became Hindi's nasalised *ā*. The ◌ँ chandrabindu records that nasality above the word.

Say *pāṁch* and *pañca* one after the other. You can hear the nasal migrating backward from its own consonant into the vowel.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "pañca … pāṁch"
- *Hum:* hold the nasal through the vowel in *pāṁch*
- *Point to:* ◌ँ, the moon-dot that records it

Your turn — the five, and how they wore down

This is the chapter's checkpoint, so gather the earlier two lessons too.

- Count from one to five. (*Ek, do, tīn, chār, pāṁch.*)
- Which Sanskrit forms gave *tīn* and *chār*, and what stood in between? (The **neuter** *trī́ṇi* and *catvā́ri*; the **Prakrits**.)
- In *trī́ṇi* → *tiṇṇi* → *tīn*, what pays for the lost *r*, and then for the lost double? (A **doubled ṇ**; then a **long vowel**.)
- Which number wore down the same way on another continent? (Latin *quattuor* → Spanish *cuatro*, beside *catvā́ri* → *chār*.)

Before you move on

Did the nasal in *pañca* disappear? (**No** — it moved into the vowel.) What records it in पाँच? (The **chandrabindu**.)

6.4 म — one character, met inside words you already say

A horizontal head-line (shirorekha) runs across the top; letters hang beneath it like laundry on a line.

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: म

म — *ma*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *m*, it is **ma**.

What it is made of:

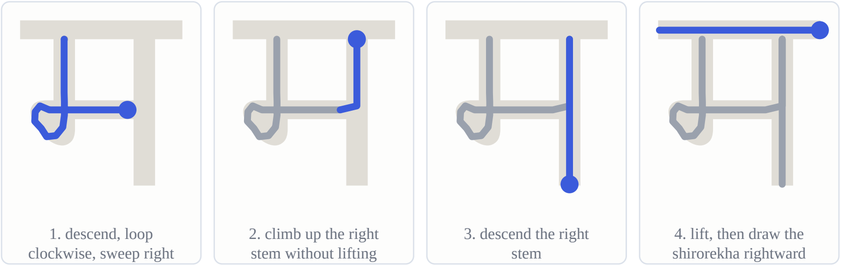
- a lower loop
- an upper loop
- right spine
- top bar

You already say these, and every one of them has म somewhere inside it:

- नमस्ते *namaste* — hello / goodbye (namaste — “I bow to you”)
- न, म *na, ma* — the first two Devanagari letters
- मेरा *merā* — my
- मेरा नाम *merā nām* — assemble my name from known letters and show word spacing as two head-lines

Writing: म — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



1. descend, loop clockwise, sweep right

2. climb up the right stem without lifting

3. descend the right stem

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after JackPotte, ‘Devanagari m म.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How म is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write म yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find म in the ones that have it

नमस्ते · न, म · शिरोरेखा

- *Trace it:* म three times, saying *ma* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find म once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — म? What sound does it carry? (***ma***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

6.5 र — one character, met inside words you already say

A horizontal head-line (shirorekha) runs across the top; letters hang beneath it like laundry on a line.

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: र

र — *ra*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *r*, it is **ra**.

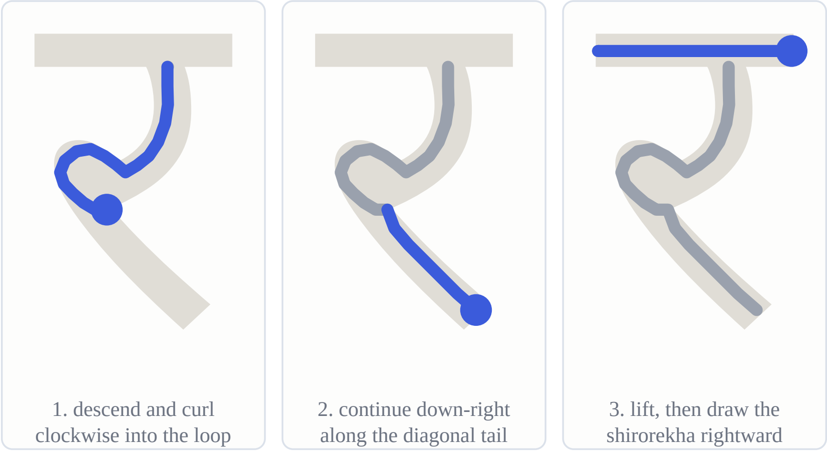
What it is made of:

- a top-to-bottom stem curling clockwise around the lower loop
- a diagonal tail
- the top shirorekhā

You already say these, and every one of them has र somewhere inside it:

- शिरोरेखा *shirorekhā* — the head-line that Devanagari letters hang from
- मेरा *merā* — my
- र, स *ra, sa* — र (ra) and स (sa)
- मेरा नाम *merā nām* — assemble my name from known letters and show word spacing as two head-lines

Writing: र



How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements

1. descend and curl clockwise into the loop

2. continue down-right along the diagonal tail

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-र-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How र is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the headline junction, descend the stem, and curl left and clockwise around the lower loop to the tail junction
- **2.** without lifting, draw the diagonal tail down-right
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows three movements; most native writers draw र in two strokes (96% of HP Labs India's native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-र-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find र in the ones that have it

  शिरोरेखा · मेरा · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* र three times, saying *ra* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find र once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — र? What sound does it carry? (***ra***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 7

Yes and No

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ✎ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say yes and no in Hindi and use नहीं to negate a whole sentence.
>
> *Answer yes with* हाँ *and politely with* जी हाँ*, then say* नहीं*, put it in front of a verb —* मैं नहीं जानता *— and hear the single PIE *ne behind no, non and nein.*

7.1 हाँ / जी हाँ / जी (hāṃ / jī hāṃ / jī) — yes / polite yes

A single open vowel, said through the nose — that's Hindi's yes.

You'll want to know — The word

हाँ = **yes**, said **hāṃ**. It's the letter ह (h) with the ◌ा sign for long *ā*, and — the key mark — the ◌ँ on top: the **chandrabindu**, the "moon-dot." It does one thing: it **nasalises** the vowel. So *hāṃ* isn't "hah" but a humming *hãã*^{n}, the sound sent up through the nose, the way French does in *bon*.

(Don't confuse the moon-dot ◌ँ with the plain dot ◌ं *anusvara* you'll see in the next word — both nasalise, but the moon-dot rides a vowel that has nothing above it, like ◌ा.)

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हाँ comes from Sanskrit *ām*, "yes", with an *h*- that CDIAL calls emphatic or taken from the verb "to be" (CDIAL 1235). The polite जी

is from *jīva*, “long live!” (CDIAL 5240).

You’ll want to know — Saying it politely

A bare *hāṃ* is a normal, friendly yes. To an elder, a stranger, or anyone you’d show respect, Hindi adds the honorific जी (*jī*):

> जी हाँ — *jī hāṃ* — “yes” (polite)

jī on its own is already a respectful “yes.” You met -*jī* on names; here it warms up a plain yes into a courteous one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “hāṃ” — let the *ā* hum through your nose
- polite — “jī hāṃ”
- spot the mark — the moon-dot ◌ँ is what nasalises it

Before you move on

How do you say yes in Hindi? (**hāṃ**, हाँ.) What does the **chandrabindu** ◌ँ do to the vowel? (**Nasalises** it — sends it through the nose.) How do you make *hāṃ* polite? (Add जी — *jī hāṃ*.) Next: the word for no.

7.2 नहीं (nahīṃ) — no / not

> Hindi’s “no” carries a sound so old it also sits inside German and Latin.

You’ll want to know — The word

नहीं = **no**, said **nahīṃ** — न (na) + ह (h) + ◌ी (long *ī*) + the ◌ं *anusvara* that nasalises the end. The heart of it is that first syllable **na**, which is Hindi’s ancient negator, straight from **Sanskrit na**.

You'll want to know — The oldest "no" you'll meet

That **na** is not just Sanskrit's — it is the same negative root that runs across nearly every Indo-European language, all descended from one ancient sound, **PIE *ne**:

from _*ne_	
Sanskrit *na*	→ Hindi **nahīṃ**
Latin *nōn*	→ Spanish **no**, French **non**
Germanic	→ German **nein**, English **no** / **not**

German's *nein* carries this exact idea ("not one"); here it is again at the other end of the family, in Hindi. The word for *no* is one of the most stubbornly unchanged things human languages have.

You'll want to know — One word, two jobs

Like Spanish *no*, **nahīṃ** is both the **answer** and the **sentence-negator**:

- **answer**: *kyā āp ṭhīk haiṁ?* — नहीं (*nahīṃ*). ("Are you well?" — "No.")
- **negator**: मैं नहीं (*nahīṃ*) जानता — "I do **not** know."

So this single word gives you both "no" and how to make a sentence negative.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "nahīṃ" — nasal at the end, from the *anusvara*
- the ancient root — "na... nōn... nein... no": one PIE *ne*
- as a negator — "maĩ nahīṃ jāntā", "I don't know"

Your turn — yes, then no

- *Kyā āp ṭhīk haiṁ?* Answer yes, then no. (***Hāṃ* ... *nahīṃ*.**)
- Which mark makes *hāṃ* hum through the nose? (The moon-dot, the *chandrabindu*.)
- Now say yes to an elder. (***Jī hāṃ*** — जी makes it courteous.)

Before you move on

How do you say no in Hindi? (**nahīṃ**, **नहीं**.) What Sanskrit word is its core, and what ancient sound is that from? (**na**, from **PIE *ne**.) Which other course words share that root? (Latin *nōn*, German *nein*, English *no/not* — and Spanish/French *no/non.*) Besides "no," what else does *nahīṃ* do? (It **negates a sentence** — *maĩ nahīṃ jāntā*, "I don't know.")

7.3 न — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: म — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: न

न — *na.*

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *n*, it is **na**.

What it is made of:

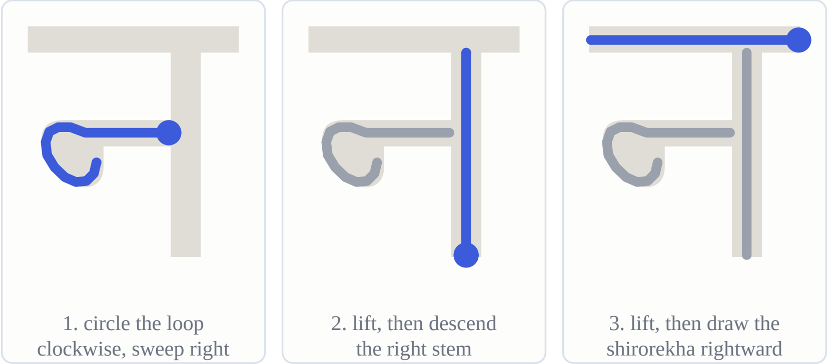
- a left bowl
- right spine
- top bar

You already say these, and every one of them has न somewhere inside it:

- **नमस्ते** *namaste* — hello / goodbye (namaste — "I bow to you")
- **न, म** *na, ma* — the first two Devanagari letters
- **मेरा नाम** *merā nām* — assemble my name from known letters and show word spacing as two head-lines
- **नमस्ते** *namaste* — assemble namaste

Writing: न — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



1. circle the loop clockwise, sweep right

2. lift, then descend the right stem

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-न-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 11 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How न *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write न yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find न in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते · न, म · शिरोरेखा

- *Trace it:* न three times, saying *na* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find न once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — न? What sound does it carry? (***na***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

7.4 क — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: र — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: क

क — *ka*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *k*, it is **ka**.

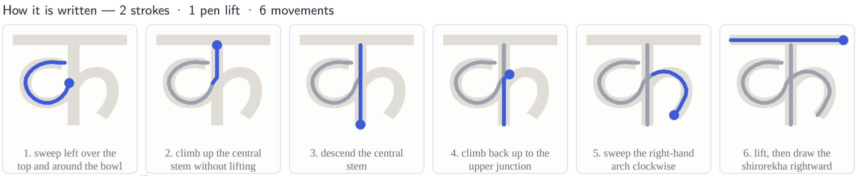
What it is made of:

- a counterclockwise left bowl
- a top-to-bottom central stem
- a right-hand arch
- the top shirorekhā

You already say these, and every one of them has क somewhere inside it:

- **नमस्कार** — hello (namaskār — more formal)
- **क, त** *ka, ta* — write ka and ta
- **क्या** *kyā* — what
- **कैसे** *kaise* — how (also **कैसा**/**कैसी**, agreeing)

Writing: क


How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 6 movements
1. sweep left over the top and around the bowl
2. climb up the central stem without lifting
3. descend the central stem
4. climb back up to the upper junction
5. sweep the right-hand arch clockwise
6. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-क-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 8 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How क *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the bowl’s upper-right junction and sweep left over the top, down around the left side, and back to the lower-right junction
- **2.** without lifting, climb up the central stem to the headline
- **3.** descend the central stem top-to-bottom
- **4.** climb back up the stem to the upper junction
- **5.** sweep the right-hand arch clockwise down to its open lower tip
- **6.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows four movements; most native writers draw क in two strokes (74% of HP Labs India’s native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-क-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 8 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find क in the ones that have it

  नमस्कार · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* क three times, saying *ka* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find क once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — क? What sound does it carry? (***ka***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 8

Please

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (4) **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say please in Hindi, both with कृपया and with the polite verb ending everyday speech actually prefers.
>
> *Complete HI-C08-checkpoint, the chapter's closing checkpoint: say कृपया and unpack it as 'of your compassion', switch to the everyday बैठिए, say why कृ is read kri, find अ and ◌े in words you already say, then write कृ, अ and मे from sound.*

8.1 कृपया (kṛpayā) — please (kindly)

> First, the word you already use to thank someone: धन्यवाद.
>
> Hindi's dictionary word for "please" is really the word **compassion** in disguise — and it's more formal than you might expect.

You'll want to know — The word

कृपया = **please**, literally "**kindly / graciously**." It's built on the Sanskrit noun कृपा (*kṛpā*), "**grace, compassion, mercy**" — so asking with *kṛpayā* means, at heart, "of your compassion."

That places Hindi in good company: **Arabic** asks *min faḍlik* ("from your **grace**"), and the Dravidian languages ask with *daya* ("**compassion**"). A whole swathe of Asia says *please* by naming the kindness it hopes for — a different instinct from French's "if it **pleases** you."

The first syllable hides a sound worth noticing: कृ is *ka* carrying the **vocalic r** (the ◌ृ mark) — *kṛ*, the same *ṛ* vowel Sanskrit and the Dravidian scripts share. The next lesson takes that mark out of this word and writes it on its own.

You'll want to know — Be honest about how it's used

Here's the catch a textbook often hides: **कृपया is formal and bookish.** You'll see it on signs and hear it in announcements ("*kṛpayā* mind the gap"), but in everyday speech Hindi speakers rarely say it. Real politeness usually rides on **the verb** instead — the respectful request ending *-iye* / *-iyegā*: *baiṭh**iye*** "please sit," *sun**iye*** "please listen." And very often, people simply say the English word **"please."**

So learn *kṛpayā* to **read** it and to be formally polite — but know that the living "please" of Hindi is baked into the verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "kṛpayā" — kṛ with the vocalic r, then -payā
- the root — "kṛpā = compassion" → "of your compassion"
- the everyday way — the verb ending: "baiṭhiye" = "please sit"

Before you move on

What is the formal Hindi word for please? (कृपया *kṛpayā*.) What does its root *kṛpā* mean, and which other languages ask the same way? (**"Grace / compassion"** — like Arabic *min faḍlik* and Dravidian *daya*.) Is *kṛpayā* what people usually say out loud? (**No** — it's formal; everyday politeness rides on the verb ending *-iye/-iyegā*, or people say English "please.")

8.2 ◌ृ — written as one vowel, said as another

You have been saying कृपया (*kṛpayā*). Its first syllable, कृ, carries the mark this lesson writes.

Before the new one: क — what sound does it carry?

Something is about to go underneath it.

Script you'll notice: ृ

ृ — a small hook below the consonant.

It is a **vowel sign**, so it attaches to a consonant rather than standing on its own, and it **replaces** the *a* built into that consonant.

Worked through: क + ृ = कृ.

Script: the name and the sound have come apart

This mark is called the **vocalic ṛ** — a vowel made out of an *r*, which is a thing Sanskrit had and Hindi does not.

So a Hindi speaker says it as *ri*. You will see कृ written and hear *kri*. The spelling records where the word came from; the mouth does something simpler.

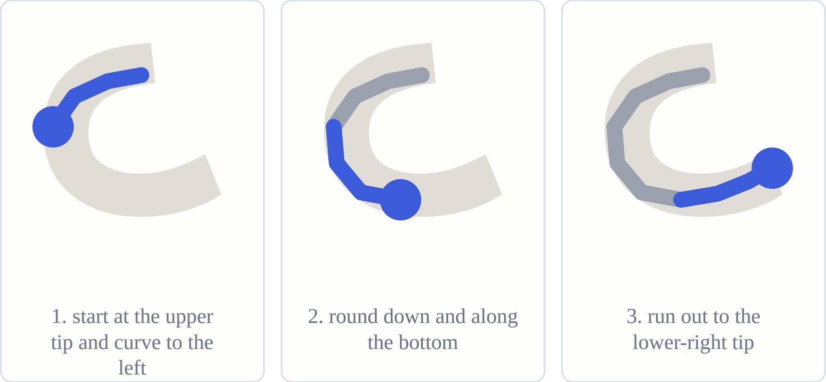
That is worth knowing early, because it explains a word that would otherwise look unreadable to you on the page and sound perfectly ordinary out loud.

written	**said**
ृ	*ri*

Nearly every word carrying this mark is one Hindi took from Sanskrit, which is why the mark is uncommon and the words that carry it are not.

Writing: ृ — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



1. start at the upper tip and curve to the left

2. round down and along the bottom

3. run out to the lower-right tip

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 52 (ृ, vocalic r sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ृ *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ृ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at क and at कृ, and say what the hook changed

  क · कृ

- *Trace it:* कृ three times, saying *kri* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* the sound this mark is named after, and the sound you actually make

Before you move on

Where does ◌ृ sit? (Below the consonant.) What does it do to the vowel already there? (Replaces it.) It is written as one vowel and said as another — which two?

8.3 अ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: न — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: अ

अ — *a*.

It is an **independent vowel** — the shape the vowel *a* takes when a word begins with it, rather than the sign it becomes inside a word.

What it is made of:

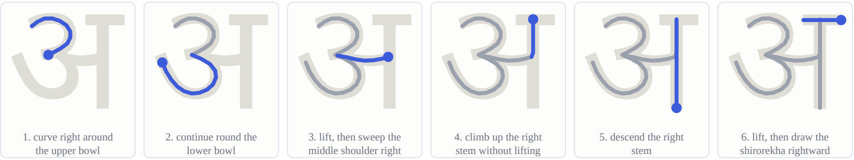
- a joined upper-and-lower left body
- a middle shoulder running into the right stem
- a right vertical stem
- the top shirorekhā

You already say these, and every one of them has अ somewhere inside it:

- अलविदा — goodbye (alvidā — a final farewell, Persian/Arabic-derived)

Writing: अ

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 6 movements


1. curve right around the upper bowl
2. continue round the lower bowl
3. lift, then sweep the middle shoulder right
4. climb up the right stem without lifting
5. descend the right stem
6. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari □ stroke order.svg’, frames 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How अ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** curve around the upper bowl, then continue down and around the lower bowl without lifting
- **2.** lift and sweep the middle shoulder right
- **3.** without lifting, climb up the right stem to the headline
- **4.** descend the right stem top-to-bottom
- **5.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2. The pen comes up 2 times and no more.

The source shows four movements; most native writers draw अ in three strokes (74% of HP Labs India’s native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the shoulder and the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari अ stroke order.svg’, frames 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find अ in the ones that have it

  अलविदा · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* अ three times, saying *a* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find अ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — अ? What sound does it carry? (***a***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

8.4 ◌े — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: क — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ◌े

◌े — *e*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *e*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

Where it sits: a stroke above the top bar.

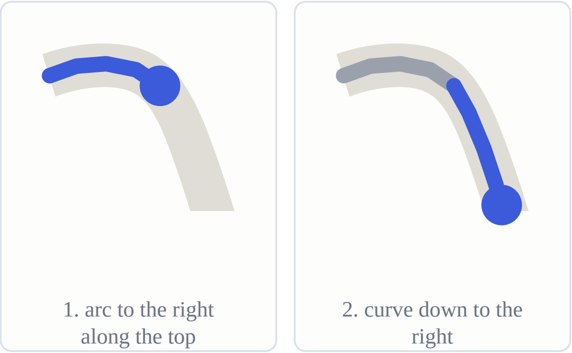
Worked through: म + ◌े = मे — *me*.

You already say these, and every one of them has ◌े somewhere inside it:

- नमस्ते *namaste* — hello / goodbye (namaste — "I bow to you")
- शिरोरेखा *shirorekhā* — the head-line that Devanagari letters hang from
- मेरा *merā* — my
- मेरा नाम *merā nām* — assemble my name from known letters and show word spacing as two head-lines

Writing: ◌े — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 movements



1. arc to the right along the top

2. curve down to the right

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 53 (े e sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ◌े is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ◌े yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ◌े in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते · शिरोरेखा

- *Trace it:* ◌े three times, saying *e* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ◌े once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ◌े? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *e* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

8.5 Chapter 8 checkpoint — please, two ways, and three marks

Nothing new here. *Please* out loud first, both ways, then the three marks this chapter put on the page.

Your turn — please, two ways

Say these aloud:

- the formal word for “please”, the one on signs and in announcements
- “please sit”, the way everyday speech asks

(*Kṛpayā*; *baiṭhiye.*)

- What does the root *kṛpā* mean, and which other languages ask the same way? (“Grace, compassion”: like Arabic *min faḍlik* and the Dravidian *daya.*)
- Is *kṛpayā* what people usually say out loud? (No: it is formal. Everyday politeness rides on the verb ending *-iye* or *-iyegā*, or on English “please”.)

Script — ◌ृ, अ and ◌े

- कृ opens कृपया. What does the hook under क do, and how does a Hindi speaker say कृ? (It replaces the *a* with the vocalic *ṛ*, which Hindi says as *ri*: *kri.*)
- अलविदा opens on अ. Why a full letter there and not a sign? (The word starts on the vowel *a*, so the vowel stands on its own.)
- Which mark turns म into मे, and where does it sit? (◌े, a stroke above the top bar.)

Read it: कृपया aloud as *kripayā*, and point to the ◌ृ
Read it: नमस्ते aloud, and point to the ◌े

Writing — from sound

Cover: the Script block above, so no model stays in view
Write it: *kri* — the hook goes under its consonant
Write it: *a* as it stands at the start of a word, then *me*
Check: against the key — कृ, अ, मे
Write it: one repaired shape, then stop

Before you move on

A guest arrives at your door. Ask them to sit, the everyday way. (*Baiṭhiye.*) That is the chapter: *please* as a word and as a verb ending, and the three marks inside the words you already say. Next chapter: *sorry*, and asking forgiveness.

Chapter 9

Sorry

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apologise in Hindi with **माफ़ कीजिए** and reach for its more formal cousin when the moment calls for it.
>
> *Say* **माफ़ कीजिए** *as 'please do forgiveness', then* **क्षमा करें** *when the setting is formal.*

9.1 माफ़ कीजिए (māf kījiye) — please forgive me / sorry

You already know the formal **कृपया** (*kṛpayā*), "please." Hindi's everyday "sorry" is built the same way you build a request: **name the kindness, ask for it to be done.**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- **माफ़** (*māf*) = "**forgiven, pardoned**" — not a native Hindi word at all! It's borrowed through **Persian** from **Arabic** عفو (^{c}*afw*), "to pardon, efface, wipe away [a wrong]." Notice the spelling: the dot under **फ** (called a **nuqtā**) turns the plain *pha* sound into **fa** — Hindi's way of writing sounds that arrived from Persian and Arabic.
- **कीजिए** (*kījiye*) = the **respectful imperative** "**please do**," from **करना** (*karnā*), "to do."

So माफ़ कीजिए is literally "**please do forgiven[-ness]**" — *please make [this] forgiven.* It's the same light-verb move you've already met: naming a state (forgiveness, kindness, compassion) and asking someone to *do* it.

You'll want to know — Be honest about register — and about English creeping in

माफ़ कीजिए is warm and genuinely everyday — but Hindi keeps a **more formal, Sanskritic** cousin for writing and ceremony: क्षमा करें (*kṣamā karēṁ*), "please grant **kṣamā**" — from Sanskrit क्षमा (*kṣamā*), "patience, forbearance, forgiveness." Where *kṛpayā* was the bookish "please," **kṣamā karēṁ** is the bookish "sorry."

And here's the honest twist: in casual conversation, many Hindi speakers simply say the **English word "sorry"** outright — it has been fully adopted into everyday Hindi, the same way English "please" sometimes stands in for *kṛpayā*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "māf" — forgiven — then "kījiye," please do
- the whole phrase — "māf kījiye" = please forgive me
- the formal cousin — "kṣamā karēṁ"

Before you move on

What does माफ़ कीजिए literally mean? (**"Please do forgiven[-ness]"** — *māf* "forgiven" + *kījiye* "please do.") Where does *māf* come from? (**Borrowed via Persian from Arabic** *ᶜafw*, "to pardon.") What's the more formal, Sanskritic cousin? (क्षमा करें *kṣamā karēṁ*, from *kṣamā* "patience/forgiveness.") What do many Hindi speakers just say instead, casually? (**The English word "sorry."**)

9.2 आ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: अ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: आ

आ — *ā*.

It is an **independent vowel** — the shape the vowel *ā* takes when a word begins with it, rather than the sign it becomes inside a word.

What it is made of:

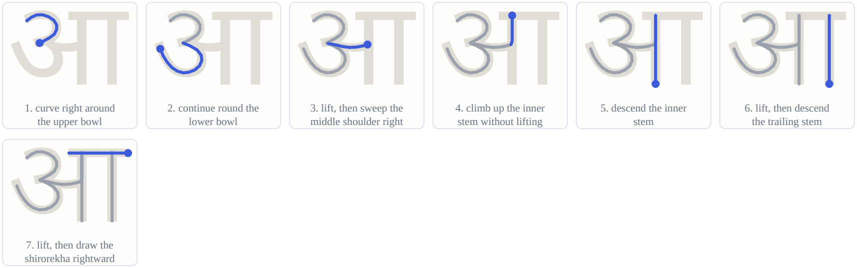
- the joined upper-and-lower left body of अ
- a middle shoulder running into the inner stem
- an inner vertical stem
- a trailing vertical stem
- the top shirorekhā

You already say these, and every one of them has आ somewhere inside it:

- **आप / तुम** — you (respectful / familiar)
- **आपका नाम क्या है?** — what's your name?
- **आप कैसे हैं?** — how are you? (respectful)
- **आपका स्वागत है** — you're welcome (also "welcome!")

Writing: आ

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 7 movements


1. curve right around the upper bowl
2. continue round the lower bowl
3. lift, then sweep the middle shoulder right
4. climb up the inner stem without lifting
5. descend the inner stem
6. lift, then descend the trailing stem
7. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari आ stroke order.svg’, frames 1–5, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How आ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** curve around the upper bowl, then continue down and around the lower bowl without lifting
- **2.** lift and sweep the middle shoulder right
- **3.** without lifting, climb up the inner stem to the headline
- **4.** descend the inner stem top-to-bottom
- **5.** lift and draw the trailing stem top-to-bottom
- **6.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 3. The pen comes up 3 times and no more.

> The source shows five movements; most native writers draw आ in four strokes (71% of HP Labs India’s native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts three times: the shoulder runs on up the inner stem and back down it.
>
> This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari आ stroke order.svg’, frames 1–5, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find आ in the ones that have it

  आप / तुम · आपका नाम क्या है? · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* आ three times, saying *ā* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find आ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — आ? What sound does it carry? (***ā***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

9.3 प — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ◌े — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: प

प — *pa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *p*, it is **pa**.

What it is made of:

- a left stem curving around the lower bowl to its upper-right junction
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

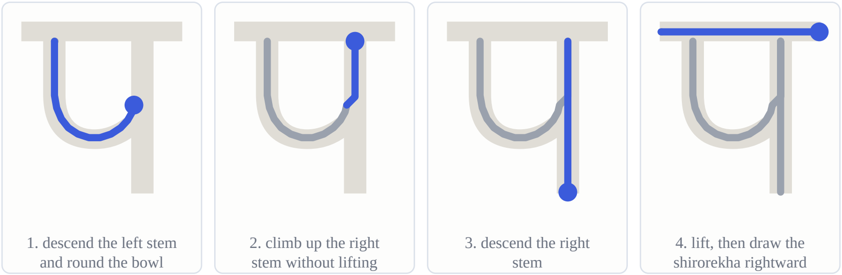
You already say these, and every one of them has प somewhere inside it:

- **आप / तुम** — you (respectful / familiar)
- **आपका नाम क्या है?** — what's your name?

- पाँच *pāṁch* — Sanskrit's nasal consonant survives inside the Hindi vowel
- कृपया *kṛpayā* — please (kṛpayā — "kindly," from kṛpā "grace/compassion")

Writing: प

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



1. descend the left stem and round the bowl

2. climb up the right stem without lifting

3. descend the right stem

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, 'Deva-प-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How प *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** descend the left stem, then curve right around the lower bowl and rise to its upper-right junction
- **2.** without lifting, climb up the right stem to the headline
- **3.** descend the right stem top-to-bottom
- **4.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows three movements; most native writers draw प in two strokes (98% of HP Labs India's native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-प-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find प in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* प three times, saying *pa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find प once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — प? What sound does it carry? (***pa***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 10

Days of the Week

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ✎ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name all seven days of the week in Hindi and say which planet each day is named for.
>
> *Recite* सोमवार *through* रविवार *end to end, name each day's deity and the Babylonian sky behind the whole planet-week, and close it with Saturn's day and the Sun's day.*

10.1 सोमवार to शुक्रवार — Hindi's own planet-week

> You've seen Spanish, Latin, and French name their weekdays for planet-gods. Here's the surprise: **Hindi does too** — with its own, independent set of gods.

You'll want to know — The pattern: [deity] + वार, "day"

Every Hindi weekday is a **deity's name** plus वार (*vār*), "**day**" (Sanskrit *vāra*):

Hindi	**literally, and its deity/planet**	**day**
सोमवार (*somavār*)	Soma's day: the **Moon**	Monday
मंगलवार (*maṅgalvār*)	Mangala's day: **Mars**	Tuesday
बुधवार (*budhvār*)	Budha's day: **Mercury**	Wednesday
गुरुवार (*guruvār*)	Guru's day: **Jupiter** (*Bṛhaspati*, called "Guru," teacher of the gods)	Thursday
शुक्रवार (*śukravār*)	Śukra's day: **Venus**	Friday

You'll want to know — Be honest about where this system came from

This is **the same seven-body idea** as Rome's planetary week — Sun, Moon, Mercury, Venus, Mars, Jupiter, Saturn — and it is **not** an isolated Indian invention: historians trace it, ultimately, to a shared source in **Babylonian astronomy**, and most accounts hold that it reached both Rome and India through the **same Hellenistic-Greek channel** of transmission (India's own horoscopic-astrology texts, like the *Yavanajātaka*, are explicitly adapted from Greek originals). The exact path and timing into India are still debated among historians of astronomy, but the system isn't a case of Rome and India copying each other directly — both are more like **cousins**, downstream of one much older shared idea of the sky.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "somavār" — Soma/Moon's day — then "maṅgalvār," Mangala/ Mars's day
- the pattern — "[deity] + vār" = [deity]'s day
- "guruvār" — Thursday — Bṛhaspati, called "Guru"

Before you move on

What does every Hindi weekday end in, and what does it mean? (वार *vār*, “day.”) Which planet is गुरुवार, and what title does its deity carry? (**Jupiter** — the deity Bṛhaspati, called “**Guru**,” teacher of the gods — an ancient title Bṛhaspati bears, not the source of the word itself.) Did Hindi borrow its planet-week from Rome? (**No** — both likely trace back through **Hellenistic Greece** to a shared **Babylonian** astronomical source, though the exact route into India is still debated.)

10.2 शनिवार and रविवार — Saturday and Sunday, no rewrite needed

You’ve met five Hindi weekdays, each a deity’s name plus वार (*vār*), “day.” The last two complete the set — and here, unlike Spanish or French, **nothing ever got renamed**.

You’ll want to know — The last two days

- शनिवार (*śanivār*) = “**Śani’s day**” — **Saturn**.
- रविवार (*ravivār*) = “**Ravi’s day**” — the **Sun** (*Ravi*, one of the Sun’s many Sanskrit names).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Both are Sanskrit compounds taken over whole, tatsamas: *śani*, “Saturn”, and *ravi*, “the Sun”, each with *vāra*, “one’s turn”, which Sanskrit also used for “day of the week” (CDIAL 11547).

You’ll want to know — Be honest about the contrast with Spanish and French

Remember: Spanish’s **sábado/domingo** and French’s **samedi/dimanche** are **not** simple planet-names — Christianity renamed both (Saturn’s day became the *Sabbath*; the Sun’s day became “*the Lord’s day*”). Hindi’s weekend went through **no such rewrite**: शनिवार and रविवार are still, today, plainly “Saturn’s day” and “Sun’s day” — the full planet-week, all seven days, standing untouched by any later religious relabeling.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "śanivār" — Saturn's day — then "ravivār," Sun's day
- the whole week — "somavār, maṅgalvār, budhvār, guruvār, śukravār, śanivār, ravivār"
- the contrast — Spanish/French renamed their weekend; Hindi never did

Your turn — the first five, from memory

- What is every weekday built from? (A **deity's name** + वार *vār*, "day.")
- Whose days are *somavār* and *śukravār*? (The **Moon**'s; **Venus**'s.)
- Did India copy its planet-week from Rome? (**No** — the two are cousins, both traced to **Babylonian** astronomy, most likely through **Hellenistic Greece**.)

Before you move on

What do शनिवार and रविवार literally mean? (**"Saturn's day"** and **"Sun's day."**) How is Hindi's weekend different from Spanish's or French's? (**No religious rewrite ever happened** — Hindi kept the plain planet-names for all seven days, while Spanish/French swapped in *Sabbath* / *Lord's day* for the weekend.)

10.3 ◌् — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: आ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ्

् — no sound of its own — it takes one away.

It is a **vowel-killer**. Every consonant in this script arrives with an *a* already inside it — that is what an abugida is. This mark takes the *a* back, leaving the bare consonant. It is how the script writes two consonants in a row.

Where it sits: a stroke below that removes the inherent ’a’ and forms a conjunct with the next consonant.

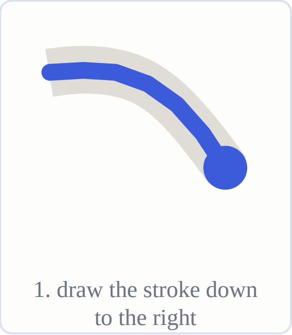
Worked through: क + ् = क् — *k*.

You already say these, and every one of them has ् somewhere inside it:

- नमस्ते *namaste* — hello / goodbye (namaste — “I bow to you”)
- क्या *kyā* — what
- स्त *sta* — a vowel-less consonant usually fuses with the next consonant into a conjunct
- नमस्ते *namaste* — assemble namaste

Writing: ् — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 1 movement



1. draw the stroke down to the right

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 61 ् virama): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ् is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ् yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ् in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते · क्या · शिरोरेखा

- *Trace it:* ् three times, and each time say what it does: **it kills the built-in *a***
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ् once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ्? What does it do to the consonant it sits on? (**Takes away the built-in *a*.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

10.4 ह — one character, met inside words you already say

> Before the new one: प — what does it do?
>
> One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ह

ह — *ha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *h*, it is **ha**.

What it is made of:

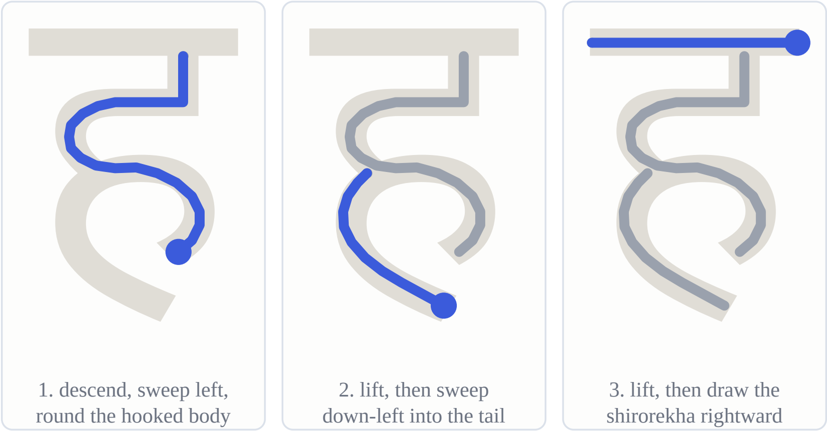
- a descending right stem joined to the leftward shoulder and clockwise hooked body
- a separate down-right outer curve and tail
- the top shirorekhā

You already say these, and every one of them has ह somewhere inside it:

- **मेरा नाम ... है** — my name is...
- **आपका नाम क्या है?** — what's your name?
- **आप कैसे हैं?** — how are you? (respectful)
- **आपका स्वागत है** — you're welcome (also "welcome!")

Writing: ह

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



1. descend, sweep left, round the hooked body

2. lift, then sweep down-left into the tail

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, 'Deva-ह-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 9 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ह is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the right stem's headline junction, descend, sweep left through the shoulder, then curve clockwise around the hooked body to its lower-right tip without lifting

- **2.** lift at the body's left junction and sweep down-left around the outer curve, then continue diagonally down-right through the tail
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2. The pen comes up 2 times and no more.

Verified three-stroke teaching form; the corroborating deskbook stages the joined first body in more component steps.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-ह-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 9 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ह in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* ह three times, saying *ha* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ह once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ह? What sound does it carry? (***ha***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 11

Four Core Colours

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ↙ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name black, white, red and blue in Hindi and say which of them came from Sanskrit and which from Persian.
>
> *Say* लाल *and* नीला *beside* काला *and* सफ़ेद, *keeping nīla and 'indigo' honestly linked by trade rather than by sound.*

11.1 काला, सफ़ेद (kālā, safed) — black and white

> Hindi's word for black has a look-alike: the Sanskrit word for **time**, and for death, sounds the same.

You'll want to know — काला — black, and a look-alike for time

काला (*kālā*) = "**black**," from Sanskrit काल (*kāla*), "**black, dark**" (CDIAL 3083), which CDIAL takes from a Dravidian word. The goddess **Kālī**, "the dark one," is named from the same word.

Sanskrit has a second काल (*kāla*), "**time**," and so "fate, death" (CDIAL 3084); as Time the destroyer it is linked with **Yama**, the god of death. CDIAL gives the two separate entries, and Monier-Williams lists them as two words. MW wonders whether "black" shares the root *kal-*, "to count," of "time," and marks the guess as uncertain. Sanskrit poetry and religious tradition still pair them: time devours everything, and that devouring is pictured as dark. That pairing is a cultural association, not the word's history.

You'll want to know — सफ़ेद — a Persian loan

सफ़ेद (*safed*) = "**white**" — borrowed from **Persian** (سفید *safēd*), the same kind of Persian-into-Hindi borrowing you've already met in माफ़ (*māf*, "forgiven," from the "sorry" lesson). Notice the नुक़्ता (*nuqtā*, the dot under फ): it turns *pha* into **fa**, the tell-tale mark of a sound that arrived from Persian or Arabic.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "kālā" — black; then the other काल, "time," a separate word
- "safed" — white, a Persian loan
- the dot — नुक़्ता under फ turns pha into fa

Before you move on

What does the other Sanskrit काल (*kāla*) mean? (**"Time"** — and so fate and death.) Is it the काल in काला? (**No** — CDIAL and MW list them as two words; the dark-and-time pairing is a cultural association.) Where does सफ़ेद come from? (**Persian** *safēd* — the same kind of loan as *māf*, "sorry.")

11.2 लाल, नीला (lāl, nīlā) — a gemstone's name, and India's dye

One more color pair, and one more Persian loan — plus a Sanskrit word connected to why English itself says "**indigo**."

You'll want to know — लाल — named for a gem, not a color

लाल (*lāl*) = "**red**" — borrowed from Persian لعل (properly *la*^{c}*l*, with a middle ^{c}*ayn* the Hindi/Persian pronunciation *lāl* smooths over), which originally named a specific **deep-red gemstone** (a ruby or spinel), and only later widened to mean the color itself. Hindi's everyday word for "red" started life as a jeweler's word.

You'll want to know — नीला — Sanskrit's dark blue, and the world's word for indigo

नीला (*nīlā*) = "**blue**," from Sanskrit नील (*nīla*), "dark blue" — also the name of the **indigo plant** and its dye. Here's the honest, careful version of a famous connection: English **"indigo"** does **not** come from *nīla* by sound change. It comes from **Greek** *indikón*, simply meaning "**the Indian** [**thing**]" — because Greek and Roman traders imported the blue dye **from India**. So *nīlā* and "indigo" aren't the same word evolving — they're two **separate** words for the same dye, one Indian (*nīla*, describing the color) and one foreign (*indikón*, describing the dye's *origin*). The connection is real, but it's a connection of **history and trade**, not of sound.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "lāl" — red, originally a gemstone's name
- "nīlā" — blue, from Sanskrit nīla
- the honest distinction — nīla and "indigo" are two different words linked by trade, not by sound

Your turn — black and white, from memory

- What else does काला's root काल *kāla* name, besides black? (**Time** — and through it the goddess **Kālī**; one root or two fused is still debated.)
- Where is *safed*, "white", from, and what does the *nuqtā* dot in its spelling do? (**Persian** *safēd*; it turns *pha* into **fa**.)

Before you move on

What did लाल originally name, before it meant "red"? (**A deep red gemstone**, borrowed from Persian.) Does English "**indigo**" come directly from Sanskrit नील *nīla*? (**No** — indigo is from Greek *indikón*, "the Indian [thing]," describing where the dye came from; *nīla* and "indigo" are two separate words connected by history, not by sound change.)

11.3 ◌ा — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ◌् — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ◌ा

◌ा — *ā*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *ā*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

Where it sits: a vertical bar to the right of the consonant.

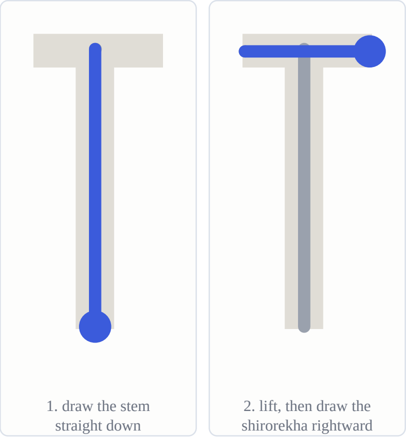
Worked through: न + ◌ा = ना — *nā*.

You already say these, and every one of them has ◌ा somewhere inside it:

- शिरोरेखा *shirorekhā* — the head-line that Devanagari letters hang from
- मेरा *merā* — my
- क्या *kyā* — what
- मेरा नाम *merā nām* — assemble my name from known letters and show word spacing as two head-lines

Writing: ा — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 2 movements



1. draw the stem straight down

2. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 47 (ा, aa sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ा *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ा yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ा in the ones that have it

  शिरोरेखा · मेरा · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* ा three times, saying *ā* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ा once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ा? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *ā* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

11.4 य — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ह — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: य

य — *ya*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *y*, it is **ya**.

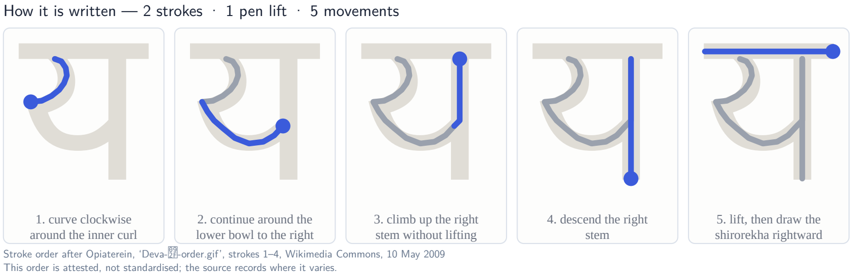
What it is made of:

- a clockwise inner curl
- a lower bowl rising to the right-stem junction
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

You already say these, and every one of them has य somewhere inside it:

- धन्यवाद — thank you (dhanyavād — formal, Sanskritic)
- शुक्रिया — thanks (shukriyā — everyday, Persian/Arabic-derived)
- क्या *kyā* — what
- कृपया *kṛpayā* — please (kṛpayā — “kindly,” from kṛpā “grace/ compassion”)

Writing: य



How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 5 movements

1. curve clockwise around the inner curl

2. continue around the lower bowl to the right

3. climb up the right stem without lifting

4. descend the right stem

5. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-य-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How य *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start beneath the headline, curve clockwise around the inner curl, and finish at the left waist
- **2.** without lifting, curve down and right around the lower bowl, and rise to the right-stem junction
- **3.** climb up the right stem to the headline
- **4.** descend the right stem top-to-bottom
- **5.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows four movements; most native writers draw य in two strokes (89% of HP Labs India’s native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-य-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find य in the ones that have it

धन्यवाद · शुक्रिया · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* य three times, saying *ya* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find य once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — य? What sound does it carry? (***ya***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 12

Family

Modes: **voice** (2) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

By the end of this chapter: I can name my father, mother, brother and sister in Hindi.

Say भाई *and* बहन *beside* पिता *and* माता*, and name which one is a true cousin of English 'brother' and which is not.*

12.1 पिता, माता (pitā, mātā) — father and mother, cousins across a huge family

You've already met Latin **pater/māter** and their English cousins **father/mother** — all descending from one ancient shared word. Hindi keeps a cousin of its own, in the very same family.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

- पिता (*pitā*) = "**father**" — Sanskrit पितृ (*pitṛ*), from the **same PIE root**, ***ph$_2$tḗr***, as Latin *pater* and English *father.*
- माता (*mātā*) = "**mother**" — Sanskrit मातृ (*mātṛ*), from ***méh$_2$tēr***, the same root as Latin *māter* and English *mother.*

So *pitā* and *father* are, at the deepest level, the **same ancient word** — reaching you here through Sanskrit rather than through Latin or Germanic, one more branch of the same very old family tree.

You'll want to know — Be honest about register — the everyday words

पिता/माता are correct, respectable Hindi — but the words you'll hear **most often in daily life** are different: बाप (*bāp*, "father," an everyday/colloquial word) and माँ (*māṁ*, "mother," universally the warm, everyday word — closer to English "mom" than "mother"). They came by different roads. बाप has nothing to do with *pitṛ*: CDIAL traces it to **bāppa*, "father", a nursery word of the baby-talk kind that it reconstructs from its descendants, with *bābū* beside it (CDIAL 9209). माँ does belong with *mātā*: CDIAL lists Hindi *mā*, "mother", under Sanskrit *mātṛ* (CDIAL 10016), worn down in speech while *mātā* kept the fuller shape.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "pitā, mātā" — the Sanskrit-descended, formal pair
- "bāp, māṁ" — the everyday, spoken pair
- the deep cousin — "pitā and father are the same ancient PIE word"

Before you move on

What are पिता and माता cousins of, in Latin and English? (**Pater/father** and **māter/mother** — all from the same PIE roots.) What are the everyday, spoken words instead? (**बाप bāp** and **माँ māṁ**.) Where do *bāp* and *māṁ* come from? (*bāp* from **bāppa*, a **nursery word**, not from *pitṛ*; *māṁ* from *mātṛ*, like *mātā*.)

12.2 भाई, बहन (bhāī, bahin) — one cousin word, one different word entirely

You've met *frāter* and *soror* as PIE cousins of "brother" and "sister." Hindi's pair has a genuine surprise hiding in it: only **one** of these two continues that ancient family.

You’ll want to know — भाई — the expected cousin

भाई (*bhāī*) = “**brother**” — from Sanskrit भ्रातृ (*bhrātṛ*), which **does** continue the same PIE root, $\boldsymbol{b^{h}r\acute{e}h_{2}t\bar{e}r}$, as Latin *frāter* and English *brother.* This one is exactly what you’d expect: one more cousin in the same old family.

You’ll want to know — बहन — NOT the expected cousin

Sanskrit did have a direct PIE-cognate word for “sister” too: स्वसृ (*svasṛ*), the very cousin of Latin *soror* and English *sister.* But that word **faded from use**. In its place, Sanskrit built a **different** word, भगिनी (*bhaginī*) — and *that* word, not *svasṛ*, is the confirmed ancestor of Hindi’s everyday बहन (*bahin*). (Where *bhaginī* itself comes from is the less certain part: it’s often explained as भग (*bhaga*, “a share, good fortune”) plus a feminine suffix, “the one who shares” — but Sanskritists don’t all agree on this, and some suspect it’s a reshaping of an older form avoiding an unrelated, indelicate sense of *bhaga.* That deeper question is worth a linguist’s extra check; the *bahin* ≠ *svasṛ* finding itself is solid.)

So Hindi’s brother/sister pair is **lopsided** in its ancestry: *bhāī* genuinely continues the ancient PIE word; *bahin* comes from an entirely different Sanskrit formation that **replaced** the PIE-cognate word before Hindi ever inherited it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “bhāī” — brother — the true PIE cousin of “brother”
- “bahin” — sister — from bhaginī, “the one who shares,” NOT from the PIE word for sister
- the asymmetry — one cousin, one completely different word

Your turn — father and mother, from memory

- Which Latin and English words are पिता and माता cousins of? (*Pater, father*; *māter, mother* — one PIE root each.)
- What do people say at home instead? (बाप *bāp* and माँ *māṁ* — also Sanskrit-descended.)

Before you move on

Does भाई continue the same ancient root as English “brother”? (**Yes** — Sanskrit *bhrātṛ* < PIE *b*^{h}*réh*$_2$*tēr*, same as Latin *frāter*.) Does बहन continue the same ancient root as English “sister”? (**No** — Sanskrit’s PIE-cognate word, *svasṛ*, faded; *bahin* comes from भगिनी *bhaginī*, an unrelated Sanskrit formation — often glossed “the one who shares,” though *bhaginī*’s own deeper origin is itself debated.)

12.3 त — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ◌ा — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: त

त — *ta*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *t*, it is **ta**.

What it is made of:

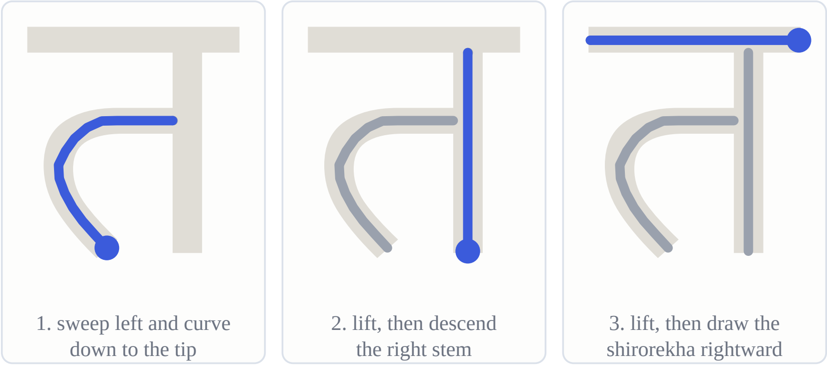
- a small left curl
- a tall spine
- top bar

You already say these, and every one of them has त somewhere inside it:

- नमस्ते *namaste* — hello / goodbye (namaste — “I bow to you”)
- क, त *ka, ta* — write ka and ta
- स्त *sta* — a vowel-less consonant usually fuses with the next consonant into a conjunct
- नमस्ते *namaste* — assemble namaste

Writing: त — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



1. sweep left and curve down to the tip

2. lift, then descend the right stem

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-0924-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How त is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write त yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find त in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते · क, त · शिरोरेखा

- *Trace it:* त three times, saying *ta* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find त once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — त? What sound does it carry? (***ta***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

12.4 ी — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: य — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ी

ी — *ī*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *ī*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

Where it sits: a curl to the right with a tail over the top bar.

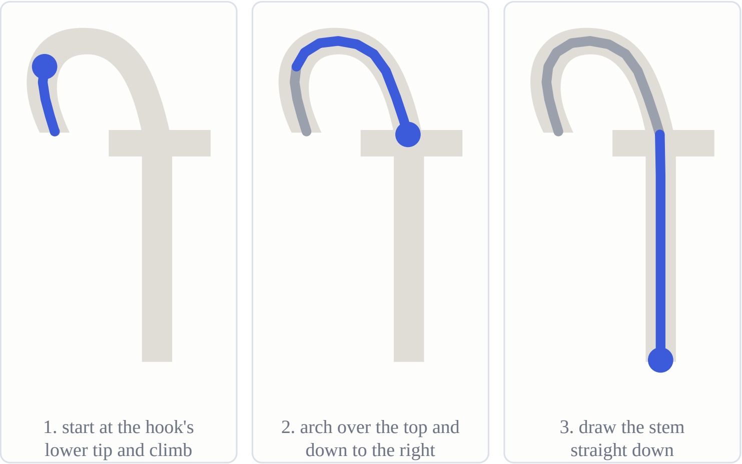
Worked through: द + ी = दी — *dī*.

You already say these, and every one of them has ी somewhere inside it:

- ख़ुशी — happiness / pleased to meet you
- ठीक — fine, well, correct — and the reply ”मैं ठीक हूँ
- मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ — I speak Hindi (gendered)
- बोलता हूँ, बोलती हूँ, बोलते हैं — the present-habitual template — stem + -tā/-tī/-te + honā

Writing: ी — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



1. start at the hook's lower tip and climb

2. arch over the top and down to the right

3. draw the stem straight down

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 49 (ी, ii sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ी is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ी yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed. The short bar on top stays grey in the strip: in a word it is part of the headline, which you draw last, once, across the whole word.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ी in the ones that have it

  ख़ुशी · ठीक · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* ी three times, saying ī as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ी once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ◌ੀ? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *ī* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 13

Head and Hand

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ↙ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the head and the hand in Hindi and trace both back to the Sanskrit words they wore down from.
>
> *Say* सिर *and the śiras it wore down from, then* हाथ*, then* हस्त*, and the shape of the change between them: the -st- cluster simplifies and the vowel lengthens.*

13.1 सिर (sir) — the head

> A short, everyday word — and, once you look, a worn-down piece of a much older Sanskrit word you may recognize from yoga or anatomy.

You'll want to know — The word

सिर (*sir*) = "**head**" — from Sanskrit शिरस् (*śiras*), "head." Centuries of everyday use wore the word down from the fuller, formal Sanskrit shape to the short, simple *sir* you use every day.

Sanskrit's *śiras* root is still alive in more formal/technical registers too — related *śīrṣa*-based vocabulary shows up in yoga and Ayurvedic anatomical terms (as in poses and positions named for the head), even while everyday Hindi kept the shorter, worn-down *sir*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “sir” — head
- the fuller Sanskrit source — “śiras”
- worn down over time — “śiras → sir”

Before you move on

What does सिर mean, and what Sanskrit word is it worn down from? (**“Head”** — from शिरस् *śiras.*) Where else does this root show up, in a more formal register? (**Yoga/anatomical terms** built on the related *śīrṣa* root.)

13.2 हाथ (hāth) — the hand

> This word looks nothing like its Sanskrit ancestor at first glance — but the change between them follows a real, traceable pattern, not a random drift.

You’ll want to know — The word

हाथ (*hāth*) = “**hand**” — from Sanskrit हस्त (*hasta*), “hand.”

You’ll want to know — The honest sound-change story

Getting from *hasta* to *hāth* isn’t one clean step — it passed through **Prakrit** (the everyday spoken languages that stood between Sanskrit and modern Hindi) along the way: Sanskrit’s **-st-** consonant cluster regularly simplified in Prakrit into a **geminate** (doubled), **aspirated** consonant (giving an intermediate form like *hattha*). Later, as that doubled consonant simplified further down to modern Hindi’s single **-th-**, the **vowel just before it lengthened** — *a* becoming **ā** — as if to make up for the sound that was lost. That’s the general shape of the change: **- st- → (Prakrit geminate aspirate) → single aspirate + a longer vowel** — a recognized pattern in how Sanskrit consonant clusters evolved into modern Hindi, not a one-off coincidence for this word alone.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “hāth” — hand
- the Sanskrit source — “hasta”
- the shape of the change — “-st- cluster → simplified consonant + longer vowel”

Your turn — the head, from memory

- What is “head”, and which Sanskrit word wore down to it? (सिर *sir*, from शिरस् *śiras*.)
- Where does the fuller root still live? (In **yoga and anatomical** terms built on the related *śīrṣa*.)

Before you move on

What does हाथ mean, and what Sanskrit word is it from? (**“Hand”** — from हस्त *hasta*.) What’s the general shape of the sound change between them? (**Sanskrit’s -st- cluster simplified** through Prakrit into a **geminate** aspirated consonant (*hattha*), which later simplified to a single consonant — and the vowel before it **lengthened** to compensate.)

13.3 स — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: त — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: स

स — *sa*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *s*, it is **sa**.

What it is made of:

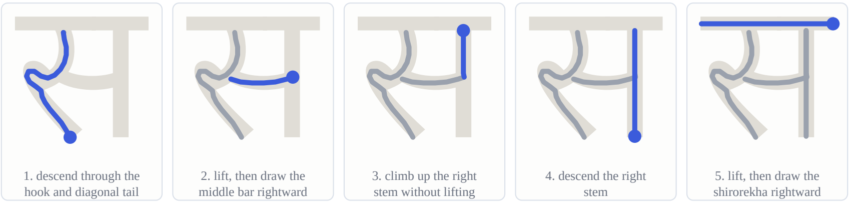
- a left curl
- a body
- right spine
- top bar

You already say these, and every one of them has स somewhere inside it:

- नमस्ते *namaste* — hello / goodbye (namaste — “I bow to you”)
- र, स *ra, sa* — र (ra) and स (sa)
- स्त *sta* — a vowel-less consonant usually fuses with the next consonant into a conjunct
- नमस्ते *namaste* — assemble namaste

Writing: स — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 5 movements



1. descend through the hook and diagonal tail

2. lift, then draw the middle bar rightward

3. climb up the right stem without lifting

4. descend the right stem

5. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after JackPotte, ‘Devanagari sस.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How स is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write स yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find स in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते · र, स · शिरोरेखा

- *Trace it:* स three times, saying *sa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find स once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — स? What sound does it carry? (***sa***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

13.4 च — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ◌ी — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: च

च — *ca*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *c*, it is **ca**.

What it is made of:

- a short upper bar joined to a rounded body opening right
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

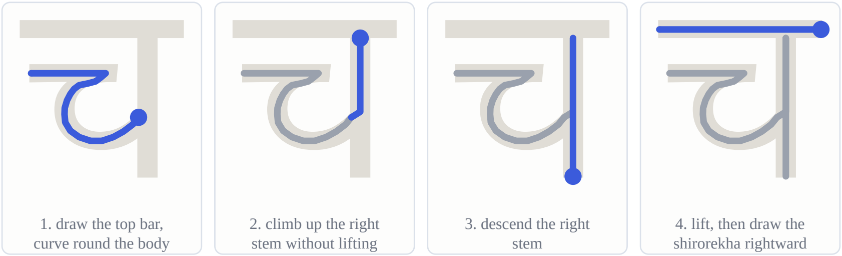
You already say these, and every one of them has च somewhere inside it:

- चलता हूँ — I'll be off (lit. "I go"), gendered
- एक दो तीन चार पाँच — one to five

- **तीन, चार** — three and four descend from Sanskrit neuter forms through Prakrit weight trades
- **पाँच** *pām̐ch* — Sanskrit's nasal consonant survives inside the Hindi vowel

Writing: च

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



1. draw the top bar, curve round the body

2. climb up the right stem without lifting

3. descend the right stem

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, 'Deva-च-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How च *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** draw the short upper bar left-to-right, turn down and left through the shoulder, then curve around the rounded body to its open right junction without lifting
- **2.** without lifting, climb up the right stem to the headline
- **3.** descend the right stem top-to-bottom
- **4.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows three movements; most native writers draw च in two strokes (76% of HP Labs India's native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-च-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find च in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* च three times, saying *ca* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find च once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — च? What sound does it carry? (***ca***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 14

Seasons

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ✎ **pen** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name all six traditional Indian seasons in Hindi, including the one the four-season frame has no word for.
>
> *Complete HI-C14-checkpoint, the chapter's closing checkpoint: say all six* ऋतु *in order and point to* वर्षा*, recall ghī, say what* ◌ँ *does and what* घ *carries, tell* ऋ *from* र*, then write* ऋ*,* घ *and* ◌ँ *from memory.*

14.1 घी (ghī) — ghee, clarified butter

> Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: घी

घी — *ghī* — "ghee, clarified butter".

Say it: *ghī*. *Look:* at its shape as you say it. The next lesson takes one piece of it, घ, and writes it on its own.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घी (*ghī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ghṛta*, "clarified butter, ghee" (CDIAL 4501).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ghī*
- *ghī*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “ghee, clarified butter”? (घी, *ghī*.)

14.2 वसंत, ग्रीष्म, वर्षा, शरद्, हेमंत, शिशिर — six seasons, not four

> European languages generally split the year into **four** seasons. Hindi’s own tradition doesn’t — it recognizes **six**, and this isn’t extra vocabulary bolted onto a four-season frame. It’s a genuinely different way of dividing the year.

You’ll want to know — The six ऋतु (ṛtu, “seasons”)

Hindi	rough Western match
वसंत (*vasant*)	spring
ग्रीष्म (*grīṣma*)	summer
वर्षा (*varṣā*)	**monsoon/rains** — no Western equivalent
शरद् (*śarad*)	autumn
हेमंत (*hemant*)	pre-winter/late autumn
शिशिर (*śiśir*)	deep winter

This six-season calendar, ऋतु (*ṛtu*), is rooted in classical Sanskrit tradition and Indian astronomy/astrology, and it maps onto the actual climate of much of the Indian subcontinent far better than a four-season frame does: the **monsoon** (*varṣā*) is a real, distinct, and hugely important season there — not a subdivision of “summer” or “autumn,” but its own season with no clean Western counterpart. And the cold season splits into **two** stages, *hemant* (the onset) and *śiśir* (deep winter), rather than being lumped into one “winter.”

ऋतु is Sanskrit *ṛtu*, “season”, taken over whole, and so are the six season names.

You'll want to know — Be honest: don't force the four-season frame onto this

It would be a mistake to just match these six words one-to-one against Spanish's four or French's four the way earlier lessons matched *tala* to *talai*. The **structure itself is different** — six real seasons, not four plus two extras. Everyday spoken Hindi *does* also use looser, more casual four-part talk about seasons (borrowing straightforwardly from the idea of "summer," "winter," etc.), but the traditional, classical ऋतु system is genuinely six-fold, and it's worth learning as its own thing rather than squeezed into someone else's frame.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all six — "vasant, grīṣma, varṣā, śarad, hemant, śiśir"
- the one with no Western match — "varṣā," the monsoon
- the honest point — six seasons is a different STRUCTURE, not extra vocabulary

Your turn — one more word from this chapter

- What is "ghee, clarified butter"? (***Ghī.***)

Before you move on

How many seasons does Hindi's traditional ऋतु calendar recognize? (**Six**, not four.) Which season has no clean Western equivalent, and why? (वर्षा *varṣā*, the **monsoon** — a real, distinct season central to the subcontinent's climate.) Is this just extra vocabulary added to a four-season frame? (**No** — it's a genuinely different structural division of the year.)

14.3 ◌ँ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: च — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ◌ँ

◌ँ — *a nasal, ridden on the syllable before it.*

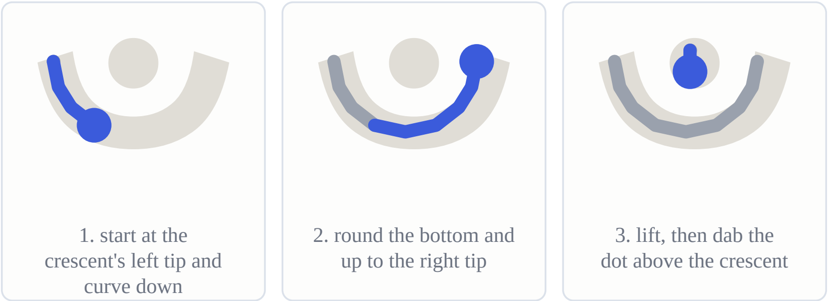
It is a **nasal vowel** mark — the vowel itself is spoken through the nose, rather than a nasal consonant being added after it.

You already say these, and every one of them has ◌ँ somewhere inside it:

- **चलता हूँ** — I'll be off (lit. "I go"), gendered
- **मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ** — I speak Hindi (gendered)
- **बोलता हूँ, बोलती हूँ, बोलते हैं** — the present-habitual template — stem + -tā/-tī/-te + honā
- **पाँच** *pām̐ch* — Sanskrit's nasal consonant survives inside the Hindi vowel

Writing: ◌ँ — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



1. start at the crescent's left tip and curve down

2. round the bottom and up to the right tip

3. lift, then dab the dot above the crescent

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 59 ँcandrabindu): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ◌ँ is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ◌ँ yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ◌ँ in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* ◌ँ three times, humming the nasal at the end of the syllable as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ◌ँ once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ◌ँ? What does it add to the syllable before it? (**A nasal.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

14.4 घ — a letter arriving before its words

Before the new one: ◌ँ — what does it do to the vowel it sits over?

This next character is one you have not met inside anything yet.

Script you'll notice: घ

घ — *gha*, with a puff of breath.

What it is made of:

- a continuous upper curl, middle hook, lower bowl, and rising right side
- a short descending lower stem
- the top shirorekhā

Script: ahead of its words, on purpose

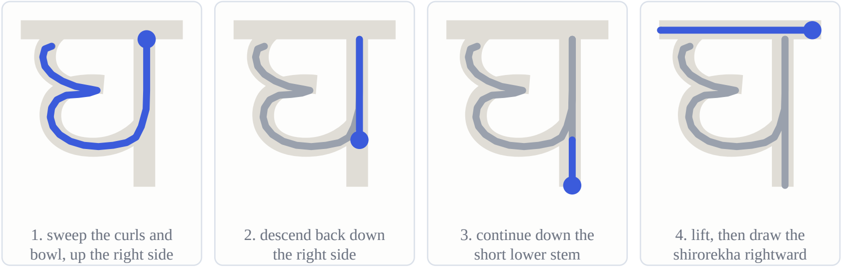
Almost every character in this book was taught out of a word you were already saying — you met the shape inside something familiar and then learned to draw it. **This one has nothing to be found inside yet.**

That is deliberate and it will not happen again after the next letter. Only two characters are still ahead of their first word; the rest of the alphabet has already been overtaken by the vocabulary, and those will have to be met the other way round.

So learn the shape and the breath now. **The word will arrive already readable**, which is the order this ought to happen in and rarely does.

Writing: घ

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



1. sweep the curls and bowl, up the right side

2. descend back down the right side

3. continue down the short lower stem

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-घ-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 9 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How घ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start below the headline at the upper-left, curve down and clockwise around the upper curl, turn back left through the middle hook, continue clockwise around the lower bowl, and rise along the right side to the headline
- **2.** without lifting, come back down the right side to the lower junction
- **3.** descend the short stem below the bowl
- **4.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows three movements; most native writers draw घ in two strokes (83% of HP Labs India’s native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-घ-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 9 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* घ three times, saying *gha* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* how many times the pen comes up (once)
- *Say it:* what is unusual about when this letter arrived

Before you move on

What sound does घ carry? (*gha*, with breath.) Have you met a word that uses it yet? (No — it arrived first.) How many pen lifts? (One.)

14.5 ऋ — the independent vowel waiting inside ऋतु

You have said ऋतु (*ṛtu*), "season". Its first letter is the one this lesson writes.

Find च in चार. Say *ca*. Then put the word away.

One new character comes next: the first letter of the word you have met.

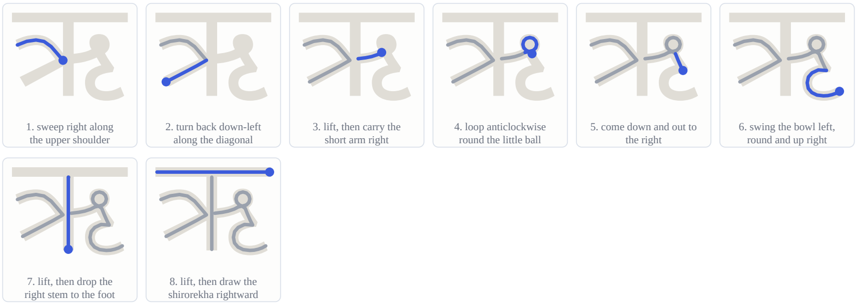
Script you'll notice: ऋ and its Hindi value

ऋ is an **independent vowel**. The careful transliteration is **ṛ**. In modern Hindi words such as ऋतु, you will normally hear it as **ri**, so ऋतु is said *ritu*. Keep both labels honest: **ṛ** tells you which inherited Devanagari vowel this is; **ri** tells you what ordinary Hindi speech does with it.

Look for the right stem and headline, then the hooked and rounded body hanging to their left. Do not confuse ऋ with र: र is the consonant *ra*; ऋ stands on its own as a vowel letter.

Writing: ऋ — supported formation

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 8 movements


1. sweep right along the upper shoulder
2. turn back down-left along the diagonal
3. lift, then carry the short arm right
4. loop anticlockwise round the little ball
5. come down and out to the right
6. swing the bowl left, round and up right
7. lift, then drop the right stem to the foot
8. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari ऋ stroke order.svg’, panels 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ऋ is written, stroke by stroke

Keep ऋ visible for this first pass.

- **1.** sweep the short upper-left shoulder right, then turn down-left through its hook
- **2.** lift and curve around the rounded middle body, continuing into the lower rightward tail
- **3.** lift and draw the right stem from top to bottom
- **4.** lift and draw the headline from left to right

Pen lifts: 3. This is one sourced learner order, not a claim that every school joins the strokes identically. Source: Saurmandal, “Devanagari ऋ stroke order.svg,” panels 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023.

- *Trace it:* ऋ twice while saying *ri*
- *Copy:* ऋ once beside the visible model
- *Point to:* the letter, then say “independent vowel — not र”

Your turn — delayed recall

Cover the model. Which independent vowel did you learn? Say *ri*, then write it once. Reopen the model only after the attempt and repair only the first differing stroke.

Before you move on

Close the model again. You have met the word *ritu*, “season.” Write its first Devanagari character from memory.

What is the careful transliteration of ऋ? (**ṛ**.) How is it normally pronounced in Hindi ऋतु? (**ri**.) Write ऋ once more without looking.

14.6 Chapter 14 checkpoint — six seasons, and ऋ from memory

Nothing new here. The seasons out loud first, then a mark and two letters on the page.

Your turn — the six seasons

- *Say it:* the six seasons, in order

(*Vasant, grīṣma, varṣā, śarad, hemant, śiśir.*)

- Which one has no Western match? (*Varṣā*, the monsoon.)
- Is this a four-season frame with two extras? (No: six seasons is a different way of dividing the year, with the cold split into *hemant* and *śiśir.*)

Your turn — one more word from this chapter

- What is “ghee, clarified butter”? (*Ghī.*)

Script — ◌ँ, घ and ऋ

- What does ◌ँ do in पाँच? (The vowel under it is said through the nose.)
- Which letter opens घी, and what sound does it carry? (घ, *gha*, with a puff of breath.)
- ऋ opens ऋतु. Is it the consonant र? (No: it is an independent vowel, written *ṛ* and said *ri* in Hindi.)

Read it: घी and ऋतु aloud, and point to the घ and the ऋ

Writing — from memory

Cover: the Script block above, so no model stays in view
Write it: the first letter of *ritu*, then the letter for *gha*
Write it: the mark that sends a vowel through the nose
Check: against the key — **ऋ**, **घ**, ◌ँ
Write it: one repaired stroke, then stop

Before you move on

Which season follows the monsoon, and which two split the cold? (*Śarad*; *hemant* and *śiśir*.) That is the chapter: six seasons, and the vowel letter that opens their name.
Next chapter: water and bread.

Chapter 15

Water and Bread

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ✎ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for water and bread in Hindi and say what पानी literally means.
>
> *Ask for* पानी *and* रोटी*, then unpack* पानी *as 'the drinkable one' — pā, to drink, plus -nīya, fit for.*

15.1 ढोल (ḍhol) — a drum

> Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: ढोल

ढोल — *ḍhol* — "a drum".

Say it: *ḍhol. Look:* at its shape as you say it. The next lesson takes one piece of it, ढ, and writes it on its own.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ढोल (*ḍhol*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ḍhola*, "large drum" (CDIAL 5608).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ḍhol*
- *ḍhol*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “a drum”? (ढोल, *ḍhol*.)

15.2 पानी, रोटी (pānī, roṭī) — water (the “drinkable thing”) and bread

> Hindi’s everyday word for water isn’t the ancient Sanskrit word you might expect — it names water by what you **do** with it, not by what it **is**.

You’ll want to know — पानी — “the drinkable thing”

पानी (*pānī*) = “**water**.” Sanskrit actually has older, more “basic” words for water — आप् (*āp*) and जल (*jala*) among them — but Hindi’s everyday word descends from neither. It comes from Sanskrit पानीय (*pānīya*), built on the verb पा (*pā*), “**to drink**,” plus a suffix meaning roughly “**fit for**.” So *pānīya*, and Hindi’s *pānī* after it, literally means “**the drinkable thing**” — water defined by its use, not named as a substance in its own right.

You’ll want to know — रोटी — bread, honestly uncertain in origin

रोटी (*roṭī*) = “**bread, flatbread**” — the everyday word for the flatbreads (roti, chapati-style breads) central to North Indian meals. Be honest: unlike *pānī*, *roṭī*’s deeper history is **not cleanly traced** back through Sanskrit the way many everyday Hindi words are. It comes through Prakrit रोट्ट (*roṭṭa*, “a kind of bread”) from Sanskrit रोटिका (*roṭikā*); beyond that, one proposal (Turner’s Indo-Aryan dictionary) tentatively links it to a root meaning “**to strike / to press or crush**” — perhaps evoking the pounding and flattening of dough — but this is genuinely uncertain, one guess among scholars rather than a settled chain. Worth knowing honestly rather than forcing a confident derivation that isn’t there.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “pānī” — water, “the drinkable thing”
- the root — “pā,” to drink, + “-nīya,” fit for
- “roṭī” — bread, flatbread

Your turn — the drum

- One more word from this chapter: what is “a drum”? (***Ḍhol***.)

Before you move on

Does पानी come from Sanskrit’s ancient water-words, *āp* or *jala*? (**No** — from पानीय *pānīya*, “the drinkable thing,” from पा *pā*, “to drink.”) Is रोटी’s etymology as clearly traced as *pānī*’s? (**No** — it traces to Prakrit *roṭṭa* < Sanskrit *roṭikā*, but beyond that the deeper root is genuinely uncertain — one proposal links it to “striking/pressing” dough, not a settled chain.)

15.3 ष — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ◌ँ — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ष

ष — *ssa*.

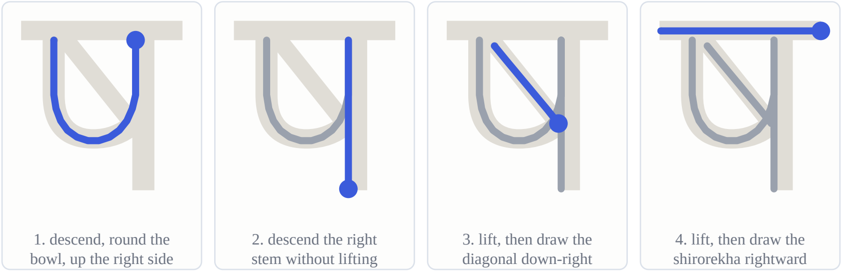
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *ss*, it is **ssa**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ष somewhere inside it:

- वसंत ग्रीष्म वर्षा शरद् हेमंत शिशिर — SIX traditional seasons, not four

Writing: ष — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 4 movements



1. descend, round the bowl, up the right side

2. descend the right stem without lifting

3. lift, then draw the diagonal down-right

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, 'Deva-ष-order.gif', strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ष *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ष yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ष in the ones that have it

  नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* ष three times, saying *ssa* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page of this chapter and find ष once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ष? What sound does it carry? (***ssa***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

15.4 ढ — one lift, and the last one to come early

Before the new one: घ — how many pen lifts did it take?

This one takes the same.

Script you’ll notice: ढ

ढ — *ḍha*, curled back and breathy.

What it is made of:

- a descending stem joined to a broad outer bowl and closed inner loop
- the top shirorekhā

Two parts, where most characters have three or four.

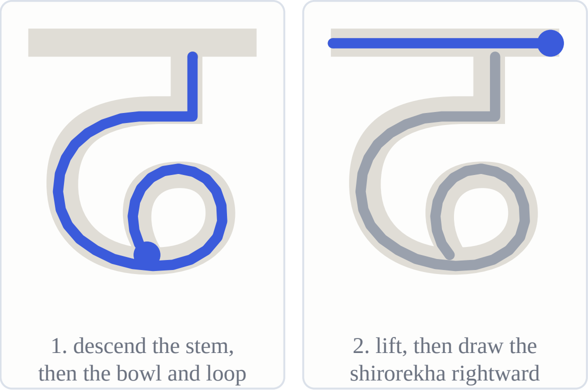
Script: the shortest build, and the last one early

One pen lift. Everything below the headline is a single unbroken run — stem, shoulder, outer bowl and inner loop without the pen leaving the paper — and then the headline goes on top. Many consonants are drawn in these two strokes; **घ**, the letter before it, was one.

It is also **the last letter you will meet before the words that use it**. From here on, every remaining character will be one you have already been reading without being shown, and each of those lessons will say so.

Writing: ढ

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 2 movements



1. descend the stem, then the bowl and loop

2. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ढ-order.gif’, strokes 1–2, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ढ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the stem’s headline junction, descend, turn left through the upper shoulder, sweep counterclockwise around the broad outer bowl, and continue counterclockwise around the closed inner loop without lifting
- **2.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

Verified two-stroke teaching form fitted to the bundled printed outline; everyday handwriting may open the inner loop.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ढ-order.gif’, strokes 1–2, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* ढ three times, lifting the pen only once each time
- *Say it:* how many pen lifts it takes, and which letter before it took the same
- *Say it:* what happens to every letter after this one

Before you move on

How many pen lifts does ढ take? (One.) Which part is drawn last? (The shirorekhā.) Will any later letter arrive before its words? (No — this is the last.)

Chapter 16

Months

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the twelve months in Hindi and explain why the festivals move against the Gregorian calendar.
>
> *Say* जनवरी *through* दिसंबर*, then name Chaitra and Vaiśākh and explain that the festivals are dated by Vikram Samvat instead.*

16.1 जनवरी to दिसंबर — borrowed names, and a second calendar underneath

> Like Arabic, Hindi doesn't have just **one** set of months — everyday civil life and traditional/religious life run on **two different calendars**.

You'll want to know — The Gregorian months — recent, borrowed

For dates, school, business, and government, Hindi uses month names borrowed straightforwardly from **English**:

जनवरी, फ़रवरी, मार्च, अप्रैल, मई, जून, जुलाई, अगस्त, सितंबर, अक्टूबर, नवंबर, दिसंबर (*janvarī, farvarī, mārc, aprail, maī, jūn, julāī, agast, sitambar, aktūbar, navambar, disambar*) — you can hear "January," "March," "August" right through the Hindi pronunciation. This is a modern civil borrowing, not an ancient Sanskrit system.

You’ll want to know — Be honest: the traditional calendar is a genuinely different structure

Hindu tradition keeps its **own**, much older lunisolar calendar — *Vikram Samvat* — with twelve **different** month names: *Chaitra, Vaiśākh, Jyeṣṭha, Āṣāḍh, Śrāvaṇ, Bhādrapad, Āśvin, Kārtik, Mārgaśīrṣ, Pauṣ, Māgh, Phālgun.*

This isn’t just a second set of labels for the same twelve solar months — these months are tied to the **six-ṛtu** seasonal calendar from the seasons lesson (in the traditional/classical scheme, each pair of Vikram Samvat months corresponds to one of the six *ṛtu*), and major festivals (Holi, Diwali, and many others) are dated by **this** calendar, not the Gregorian one — which is why their Gregorian-calendar date shifts from year to year.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “janvarī, mārc, agast” — hear the borrowed English names
- the traditional calendar — “Chaitra, Vaiśākh, Jyeṣṭha”
- the honest point — festivals shift on the Gregorian calendar because they’re dated by Vikram Samvat instead

Before you move on

Where do Hindi’s everyday civil month names come from? (**Borrowed from English** — *janvarī, mārc, agast...*) What traditional calendar runs alongside it, and what is it tied to? (**Vikram Samvat** — tied to the **six ṛtu** seasons, not the four-season Western frame.) Why do festivals like Holi and Diwali fall on different Gregorian dates each year? (**They’re dated by Vikram Samvat**, a different calendar system entirely.)

16.2 ◌ृ — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ष — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ◌ु

◌ु — *u*.

It is a **vowel sign**. It is not a letter and never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and **replaces** the *a* built into it with *u*. Replaces, not adds — the *a* is gone.

Where it sits: a small hook below the consonant.

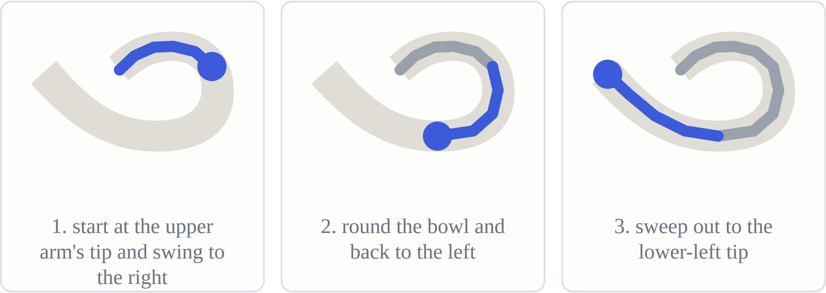
Worked through: त + ◌ु = तु — *tu*.

You already say these, and every one of them has ◌ु somewhere inside it:

- शुक्रिया — thanks (shukriyā — everyday, Persian/Arabic-derived)
- आप / तुम — you (respectful / familiar)
- ख़ुशी — happiness / pleased to meet you
- सोमवार मंगलवार बुधवार गुरुवार शुक्रवार — Monday–Friday

Writing: ◌ु — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



1. start at the upper arm's tip and swing to the right

2. round the bowl and back to the left

3. sweep out to the lower-left tip

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 50 (ु u sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ◌ु is written, stroke by stroke

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ◌ु yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real

variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ◌ु in the ones that have it

  शुक्रिया · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* ◌ु three times, saying *u* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page and find ◌ु once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ◌ु? What vowel does it put on the consonant it attaches to — and what does it take off? (**Puts *u* on; takes the built-in *a* off.**) Name one word you already say that contains it.

16.3 ◌ं — the dot above the line

The hook from before sat **below** the consonant. Say what it did.

Today's mark sits **above the head-line**, and you have been reading it since your first week.

Script you'll notice: ◌ं

◌ं — the **anusvāra**. A single dot, sitting on top of the shirorekhā.

It sends the syllable **through the nose**. It is not a vowel and it does not replace one: the vowel stays exactly as it was, and the air changes route.

Worked through: स + ◌ं = सं.

Script: you have been saying it all along

Look at the dot above the line in each of these:

- मैं — I
- हैं — are
- मिलेंगे — we will meet

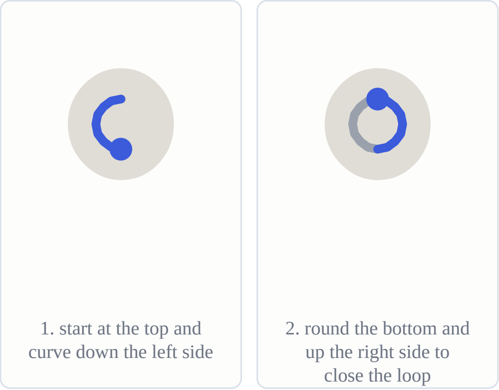
- में — in
- हिंदी — Hindi

These are not decorative words. मैं and हैं are how you say who you are and how things stand, and you have been reading that dot in them without a lesson ever naming it.

There is a second nasal mark, a crescent with a dot inside it, and which of the two a word takes depends on what else is sitting above the letter.

Writing: ं — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 2 movements



1. start at the top and curve down the left side

2. round the bottom and up the right side to close the loop

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 57 (ं anusvara): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ं is written, stroke by stroke

Draw the letter and its head-line as you already do. Then put one dot **above the line**, over the middle of the letter.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words and find the dot above the line

  मैं · हैं

- *Trace it:* मैं three times, saying *maĩ* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* whether this mark changes the vowel or the air

Before you move on

Where does ◌ं sit? (Above the head-line.) What does it change? (The route of the air, not the vowel.) Name the word for *I* that carries it.

Chapter 17

Noon and Midnight

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say noon and midnight in Hindi and explain the old three-hour pahar hidden inside दोपहर.
>
> *Say* दोपहर *as 'two pahars' and* आधी रात *as 'half night', contrasting one built on an old time-unit with one built plainly.*

17.1 दोपहर, आधी रात — noon by an old clock, midnight fully transparent

> Hindi's word for noon hides a whole traditional timekeeping system inside it — one very different from hours and minutes.

You'll want to know — दोपहर — "two pahars"

दोपहर (*dopahar*) = "**noon, midday**" — literally "**two** (*do*) + **pahar**." A पहर (*pahar*, from Sanskrit *prahara*, "a watch"; CDIAL 8900 wonders whether *prahara* is Persian *pahra*, "watch", put into Sanskrit form) is a traditional Indian unit of time, roughly **three hours** long, with the day traditionally divided into eight *pahars* (four for daytime, four for night), counted from sunrise. Noon falls right around the end of the **second** daytime *pahar* after sunrise — so *do-pahar*, "two pahars [in]," became the everyday word for midday. (This traditional pahar-based account is the standard one, though — as with any folk-timekeeping etymology this old — treat the exact number of pahars as the general shape of the story rather than a precisely dated fact.)

You’ll want to know — आधी रात — fully transparent “half night”

आधी रात (*ādhī rāt*) = “**midnight**,” literally “**half night**” — आधी (*ādhī*, “half,” in the form it takes before a feminine noun) + रात (*rāt*, “night”). No erosion, no double meaning — structurally identical to Latin’s *media nox* and Spanish’s *medianoche.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “pahar” — a traditional ~3-hour watch — then “do-pahar,” two pahars, noon
- “ādhī rāt” — half night, midnight
- the contrast — dopahar counts an old time-unit; ādhī rāt is plainly “half” + “night”

Before you move on

What does दोपहर literally mean, and what’s a *pahar*? (“**Two pahars**” — a *pahar* being a traditional ~3-hour time-unit, with noon falling around the end of the second one after sunrise.) What does आधी रात literally mean? (“**Half night**” — *ādhī* “half” + *rāt* “night,” fully transparent, like Latin’s *media nox.*)

17.2 ल — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ◌ु — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: ल

ल — *la.*

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *l*, it is **la**.

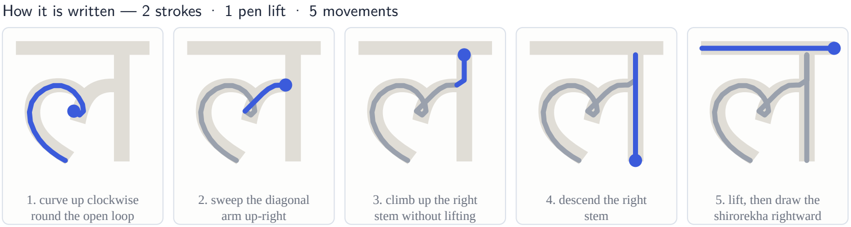
What it is made of:

- a clockwise open left loop
- an up-right diagonal arm
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

You already say these, and every one of them has ल somewhere inside it:

- अलविदा — goodbye (alvidā — a final farewell, Persian/ Arabic-derived)
- मिलेंगे *milenge* — (we) will meet
- फिर मिलेंगे — we'll meet again (goodbye)
- कल मिलते हैं — see you tomorrow (and the कल puzzle)

Writing: ल


How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 5 movements
1. curve up clockwise round the open loop
2. sweep the diagonal arm up-right
3. climb up the right stem without lifting
4. descend the right stem
5. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, 'Deva-ल-order.gif', strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 11 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ल is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the open lower-left tip, curve up and clockwise around the left loop, and finish at the inner junction
- **2.** without lifting, sweep the diagonal arm up-right to the right stem
- **3.** climb up the right stem to the headline
- **4.** descend the right stem top-to-bottom
- **5.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows four movements; most native writers draw ल in two strokes (54% of HP Labs India's native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-ल-order.gif', strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 11 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ल in the ones that have it

  अलविदा · मिलेंगे · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* ल three times, saying *la* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page and find ल once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ल? What sound does it carry? (***la***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

17.3 ◌ू — the same hook, held longer

Yesterday's dot sat above the line. Where does today's mark go?

Below — and you can already draw its shorter twin.

Script you'll notice: ◌ू

◌ू — *ū*.

It is a **vowel sign**: it attaches under a consonant and replaces the *a* built into it.

Where it sits: a **longer hook below** the consonant.

Worked through: त + ◌ू = तू.

Script: length is the whole difference

mark	vowel	hook
ु	u	short
ू	ū	long

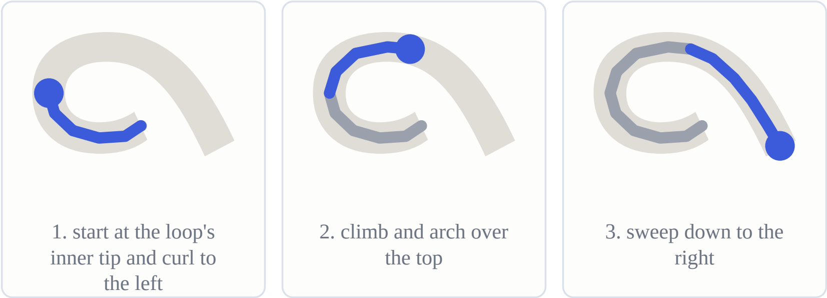
The shape is the same and the tail is longer, and so is the vowel. That matching of the writing to the sound is a small gift, and it is worth noticing because it is not always true elsewhere in the script.

Words already yours that carry the long one:

- हूँ — I am
- पूर्ण विराम — the full stop

Writing: ू — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



1. start at the loop's inner tip and curl to the left

2. climb and arch over the top

3. sweep down to the right

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 51 (ू uu sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ू *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ू yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this word and find the long hook under its first letter

  हूँ

- *Trace it:* ◌ू three times, saying *ū* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* the one thing that tells the short hook from the long one

Before you move on

Where does ◌ू sit? (Below the consonant.) How does it differ from ◌ु? (Longer hook, longer vowel.) Name the word for *I am* that carries it.

Chapter 18

Telling Time

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell someone what o'clock it is in Hindi.
>
> *Say* एक बज रहा है *and* दो बज रहे हैं *— the hour striking, exactly as the ghaṇṭā bell once did.*

18.1 घंटा / बजना — the bell and the hours that strike

Here's a word that wears its history on its sleeve: Hindi's word for "hour" is the exact same word as "bell."

You'll want to know — घंटा — bell AND hour, one word

घंटा (*ghaṇṭā*) = "**hour**" — and it means "**bell, gong**" just as commonly. It comes from Sanskrit घण्टा (*ghaṇṭā*), "bell, gong." The connection isn't a coincidence: temples, towns, and later clock towers historically marked the passing of time by **striking a bell** — the hour was announced by sound, not read off a face — so the word for the bell itself came to mean the unit of time it announced. Compare this to English **o'clock**, itself a worn-down "**of the clock**," or French's **il est ... heures**: different languages, but time-telling vocabulary keeps circling back to the *instrument* used to mark it.

Grammar Lens: बजना — “to strike, to toll”

Hindi tells the time with the verb बजना (*bajnā*), “**to strike, to toll**” — the same imagery as a bell striking the hour:

> एक बज रहा है। — “It is one o’clock.” (literally “**one is striking**”) दो बज रहे हैं। — “It is two o’clock.” (literally “**two are striking**”)

Just like Spanish switches from singular *es* to plural *son* after “one,” Hindi switches बज रहा है (singular) to बज रहे हैं (plural) once the count passes one — matching the number, not just tacking on “o’clock.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ghanṭā” — hour, also “bell”
- “ek baj raha hai” — it is one o’clock, “one is striking”
- “do baj rahe hain” — it is two o’clock, “two are striking”

Before you move on

What does घंटा literally mean besides “hour”? (**“Bell, gong”** — from Sanskrit *ghaṇṭā*.) Why did “bell” come to mean “hour”? (Because clocks/towns historically **struck a bell** to announce the hour.) What verb does Hindi use to tell the time, and what does it literally mean? (बजना, *bajnā* — “to strike, to toll,” as in *ek baj raha hai*, “one is striking.”)

18.2 ख — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: ल — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ख

ख — *kha.*

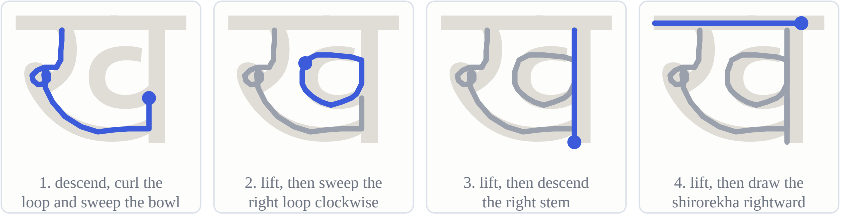
It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *kh*, it is **kha**.

You already say these, and every one of them has ख somewhere inside it:

- शिरोरेखा *shirorekhā* — the head-line that Devanagari letters hang from
- ख़ुशी — happiness / pleased to meet you

Writing: ख — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



1. descend, curl the loop and sweep the bowl

2. lift, then sweep the right loop clockwise

3. lift, then descend the right stem

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, 'Deva-ख-order.gif', strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 9 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ख *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ख yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ख in the ones that have it

  शिरोरेखा · ख़ुशी · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* ख three times, saying *kha* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page and find ख once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ख? What sound does it carry? (***kha***.)
Name one word you already say that contains it.

18.3 ो — a bar and a stroke

The last two marks went below the letter and above the line. Say which did which.

This one does **both sides at once**.

Script you'll notice: ो

ो — *o*.

It is a **vowel sign**: it attaches to a consonant and replaces the *a* built into it.

Where it sits: **the ā bar on the right, plus a stroke above the head-line**. Two pieces, one mark.

Worked through: द + ो = दो.

Script: the second number you ever counted

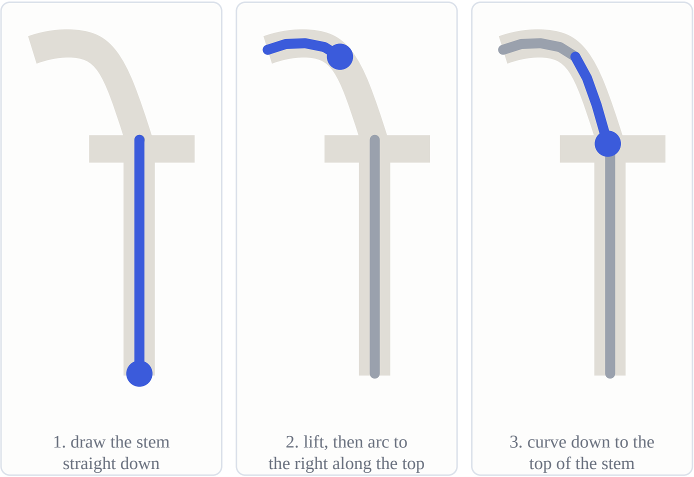
You met this mark before you could name a single letter:

- दो — two
- बोलना — to speak
- शिरोरेखा — the head-line itself

दो is the plainest example in the language: one consonant, one mark, one word. Look at it and the two pieces are easy to separate — the upright bar to the right of द, and the short stroke riding on top.

Writing: ो — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



1. draw the stem straight down

2. lift, then arc to the right along the top

3. curve down to the top of the stem

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 55 (ो, o sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ो *is written, stroke by stroke*

Follow the numbered strip: start where movement 1 begins, and let each panel show you the next movement before your pen makes it. Then write ो yourself — slowly, and larger than it is printed. The short bar on top stays grey in the strip: in a word it is part of the headline, which you draw last, once, across the whole word.

> The strip shows **where to start the character and which way to travel**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this word and name its two pieces

  दो

- *Trace it:* दो three times, saying *do* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* which side of the letter each piece of the mark sits on

Before you move on

What two pieces make ◌ो? (A bar on the right and a stroke above.) What vowel does it put on its consonant? Name the number you count that is one consonant and this mark.

Chapter 19

Asking Someone's Age

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) ✎ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask someone's age in Hindi and give my own in the belonging-to-years shape Hindi uses.
>
> *Name* उम्र *as the everyday Perso-Arabic word for age beside formal* आयु*, then ask* तुम कितने साल के हो*? and answer* मैं बीस साल का हूँ*, with* के/का *carrying the 'belonging to' work.*

19.1 उम्र / आयु — everyday and formal words for age

> You just met Arabic's *^{c}umr*. Hindi's everyday word for "age" is the **exact same word**, carried through Persian.

You'll want to know — उम्र — a Perso-Arabic loan, and a native alternative

उम्र (*umr*) = "**age**" — this is **Arabic's ^{c}umr**, borrowed into Hindi through Persian, and it's the everyday, colloquial word most Hindi speakers use. Hindi also has a fully **native Sanskrit** alternative, आयु (*āyu*, "age, lifespan"), which feels more formal or literary — a register split you've now seen several times (compare Kannada's Sanskrit-tatsama *madhyāhna* vs. Tamil's native words for the same concepts, just flipped here: the **borrowed** word is the everyday one, the **native** word is the formal one).

Your turn

- *Say it:* “umr” — age, same word as Arabic’s ^{c}umr
- *Contrast:* everyday *umr* · formal/literary *āyu*

Before you move on

What language does Hindi’s **उम्र** come from, and what’s the native Sanskrit alternative? (**Arabic** ^{c}*umr*, via Persian; native alternative is **आयु**, *āyu.*) Which one is ordinary conversational Hindi? (**Umr**.) Next: use a genitive marker to say how many years someone belongs to.

19.2 कितने साल के हो? — belonging to so many years

Languages do not agree on whether age is something you have, are, were born with, or state without a verb. Hindi gives the idea a fifth shape.

You’ll want to know — The two sentences

> **तुम कितने साल के हो?** — “How old are you?” (informal), literally “you, **of how many years, are**?” (*tum kitne sāl ke ho?*)
>
> **मैं बीस साल का हूँ।** — “I am twenty years old,” literally “I [am one] **belonging to twenty years**.” (*maiṅ bīs sāl kā hūṅ.*)

के/का (*ke/kā*) is Hindi’s **genitive postposition**, “of, belonging to.” The same marker family handles possession elsewhere: *merā ghar*, “my house.”

So Hindi does not copy Romance’s “I **have** years,” Germanic’s simple “I **am** [a number],” Latin’s “**born** + N years,” or Arabic’s verbless “my age [is] N.” It says “I am [one] **belonging to** N years,” with a genitive marker plus **होना** (*honā*, “to be”).

Your turn

- *Say it:* “tum kitne sāl ke ho?” — how old are you?
- *Say it:* “maiṅ bīs sāl kā hūṅ” — I belong to twenty years
- *Point to:* **ke/kā** — the genitive, “of/belonging to”

Your turn — the word for age

- Which word for “age” is everyday talk, and where is it from? (***Umr*** — **Arabic** *^{c}umr*, via Persian.) And the formal, native one? (**आयु** *āyu.*)

Before you move on

What does **के/का** mark? (A **genitive/possessive** relationship.) Does Hindi use Romance “have,” simple Germanic “be,” Latin “born,” or Arabic’s verbless sentence? (**None**: it says “belonging to N years” + *honā*.)

19.3 द — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: **ख** — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you’ll notice: द

द — *da.*

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *d*, it is **da**.

What it is made of:

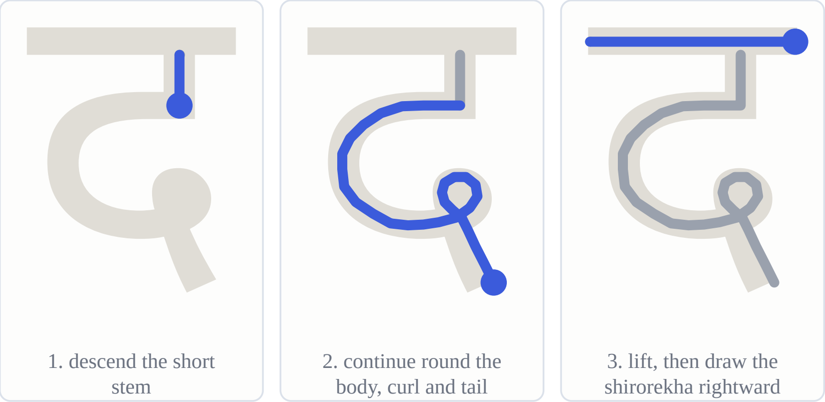
- a short top-to-bottom stem
- an outer body joined to an inward curl and down-right tail
- the top shirorekhā

You already say these, and every one of them has **द** somewhere inside it:

- **धन्यवाद** — thank you (dhanyavād — formal, Sanskritic)
- **अलविदा** — goodbye (alvidā — a final farewell, Persian/ Arabic-derived)
- **मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ** — I speak Hindi (gendered)
- **एक दो तीन चार पाँच** — one to five

Writing: द

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements


1. descend the short stem
2. continue round the body, curl and tail
3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-द-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 8 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How द is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** draw the short stem top-to-bottom
- **2.** without lifting, sweep left through the upper shoulder and around the outer body, curl inward and clockwise through the loop, then continue down-right through the tail
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows three movements; most native writers draw द in two strokes (95% of HP Labs India’s native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-द-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 8 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find द in the ones that have it

  धन्यवाद · अलविदा · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* द three times, saying *da* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page and find द once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — द? What sound does it carry? (***da***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

Chapter 20

Weather

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ↙ **pen** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what the weather is doing in Hindi and stay out of the बारिश / वर्षा false-friend trap.
>
> *Say* मौसम*, then* गर्मी है *and* ठंड है*, and keep everyday* बारिश *apart from formal* वर्षा *despite the resemblance.*

20.1 मौसम — another Perso-Arabic loan, and a false-friend trap

> You've already seen Hindi borrow *umr* from Arabic. Here's another one — and this time, English borrowed the SAME root too.

You'll want to know — मौसम — the same root as "monsoon"

मौसम (*mausam*) = "**weather**" — borrowed from Classical **Persian** موسم (*mawsim*), itself from **Arabic** مَوْسِم (*mawsim*, "season, time of year, occasion"; likely originally used by Arab sailors for seasonal winds). This is the **exact same root** that gave English **monsoon** — carried into English in the **1580s**, well before the British Raj, via **Portuguese and Dutch** traders in the Indian Ocean spice trade (Portuguese *monção*, Dutch *monssoen*, both from this same Arabic *mawsim*). So "monsoon" and Hindi's everyday word for "weather" are, quite directly, the same word.

You'll want to know — गर्मी है, ठंड है — heat and cold, native words

गर्मी है। — "It's hot." — literally "**there is heat**." (*garmī hai.*)
ठंड है। — "It's cold." — literally "**there is cold**." (*ṭhanḍ hai.*)

Both use ordinary Hindi nouns (गर्मी, "heat"; ठंड, "cold") plus है (*hai*, "is/there is") — simpler in shape than Arabic's fully verbless pattern, since Hindi still needs *hai* here.

You'll want to know — बारिश vs. वर्षा — a genuine false-friend trap

Hindi has **two** words for "rain" that sound similar enough to assume they're related — **don't** make that assumption:

- बारिश (*baarish*) — from **Persian** بارش (*bāriš*) — the everyday, colloquial word: बारिश हो रही है ("it's raining," literally "rain is happening").

- वर्षा (*varṣā*) — fully **native Sanskrit**, from वर्ष (*varṣá*, "rain"), tracing to **Proto-Indo-European** ***$h_1$wers-*** ("to rain") — cousin of Greek **hérsē** ("dew") and Old Irish **frass** ("rain-shower"). This is the more formal/literary word.

Despite the similar sound, dictionaries flag *baarish* and *varṣā* as **probably not related** — one's a Persian loan, the other a native Sanskrit inheritance from deep in the Indo-European family. A likely false-friend trap, not a confirmed doublet.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "mausam" — weather, same root as English "monsoon"

- "garmī hai. ṭhanḍ hai." — it's hot / it's cold

- "baarish hai" (everyday) vs. "varṣā" (formal) — probably NOT related despite sounding alike

Before you move on

What English word shares मौसम's exact root, and how did it reach English? (**Monsoon** — from Arabic *mawsim* via Persian, carried into English in the 1580s by Portuguese/Dutch traders, well before the British Raj.) Are बारिश and वर्षा related words? (**Probably not** — despite sounding similar, *baarish* is a Persian loan and *varṣā* is native Sanskrit; dictionaries flag them as likely unrelated.) What PIE root does वर्षा trace to, and what's its Greek cousin? (***h₁wers-***, "to rain" — cousin of Greek *hérsē*, "dew.")

20.2 ध — one character, met inside words you already say

Before the new one: द — what does it do?

One character this time. Just one — and you have been saying it for pages without knowing which mark on the page it was.

Script you'll notice: ध

ध — *dha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *dh*, it is **dha**.

What it is made of:

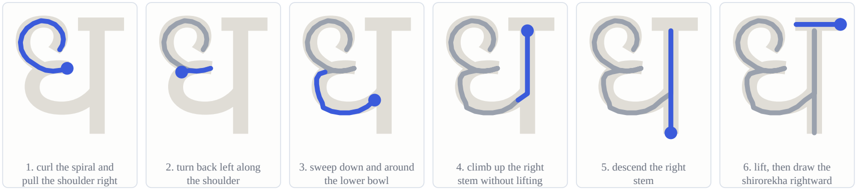
- an upper spiral ending in a rightward shoulder
- a lower bowl
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

You already say these, and every one of them has ध somewhere inside it:

- धन्यवाद — thank you (dhanyavād — formal, Sanskritic)
- सोमवार मंगलवार बुधवार गुरुवार शुक्रवार — Monday–Friday
- दोपहर आधी रात — noon (literally "two pahars," a traditional ~3-hour time unit) and midnight ("half night," fully transparent)

Writing: ध

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 6 movements


1. curl the spiral and pull the shoulder right
2. turn back left along the shoulder
3. sweep down and around the lower bowl
4. climb up the right stem without lifting
5. descend the right stem
6. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ध-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ध *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the upper spiral’s inner crossing, curl around the small opening, widen left and down around the outer loop, then sweep right through the shoulder
- **2.** without lifting, turn back left along the shoulder to the left waist
- **3.** sweep down and around the lower bowl to its right junction
- **4.** climb up the right stem to the headline
- **5.** descend the right stem top-to-bottom
- **6.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows four movements; most native writers draw ध in two strokes (81% of HP Labs India’s native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ध-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find ध in the ones that have it

धन्यवाद · नमस्ते

- *Trace it:* ध three times, saying *dha* as you finish each one
- *Look:* back at any page and find ध once more

Before you move on

Which character is this — ध? What sound does it carry? (***dha***.) Name one word you already say that contains it.

20.3 थ — the last empty seat in a row you have nearly filled

Before the new one: ध — what does it do?

One character this time. It is the fourth of four, and the other three are already yours.

Script you'll notice: थ

थ — *tha*.

It is a **consonant**, and in this script a consonant is never bare: it comes with an *a* already in it. So it is not *th*, it is **tha**.

What it is made of:

- an upper spiral joined continuously to a broad lower bowl
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

One word you already say ends in it:

- हाथ — hand (hāth)

Script: the seat थ fills

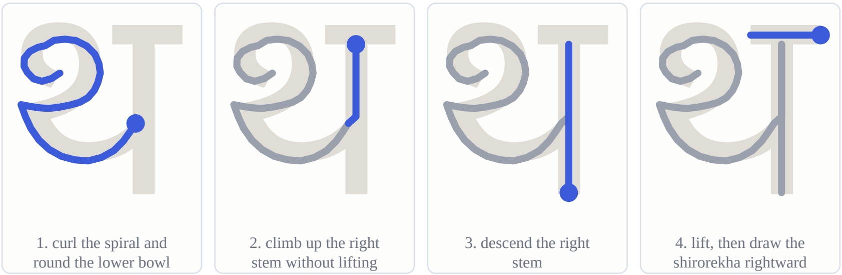
Your tongue tip touches the back of your top teeth for all four of these. Two things separate them: whether your voice is switched on, and whether a puff of breath escapes after the release.

character	sound	puff of breath
त	ta	no
थ	tha	yes
द	da	no
ध	dha	yes

You had three of the four seats and one gap. थ is the gap, and the shape tells you so: like ध, it carries a bowl and a right stem, so the eye that already finds ध will find this one.

Writing: थ

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements


1. curl the spiral and round the lower bowl
2. climb up the right stem without lifting
3. descend the right stem
4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-थ-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How थ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the upper spiral’s inner-right tip, curl clockwise around the small opening and outward to the left waist, then continue down and clockwise around the broad lower bowl to the right-stem junction without lifting
- **2.** without lifting, climb up the right stem to the headline
- **3.** descend the right stem top-to-bottom
- **4.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once.

The source shows three movements; most native writers draw थ in two strokes (72% of HP Labs India’s native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-थ-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words, and find थ in the ones that have it

  हाथ · नमस्ते · धन्यवाद

- *Trace it:* थ three times, saying *tha* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* त and then थ one after the other, with a hand in front of your mouth, until you feel the puff on the second and not the first

Before you move on

Which character is this — थ? What sound does it carry? (***tha***.) Which of the four dental characters puff, and which do not? (थ and ध puff; त and द do not.)

Chapter 21

Numbers Six to Ten

Modes: **voice** (2) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** none of the 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from six to ten in Hindi and hear the sound changes that wore the Sanskrit numerals down.
>
> *Trace ṣaṣ → chhah, nava → nau and daśa → das, naming the one change each numeral underwent.*

21.1 छ — the puff again, on a letter you already have

Before the new one: च — what sound does it carry?

You have met this arrangement once before, with त and थ. It is about to happen again.

Script you'll notice: छ

छ — *chha.*

It is the **breathy partner of च**, exactly as थ is the breathy partner of त. Say *cha*, then say it again with a puff of air behind it, and you have the difference.

What it is made of:

- a continuous upper-left loop, lower bowl, outer-right rise and inner loop
- a short upper stem
- the top shirorekhā

Script: the pattern, a second time

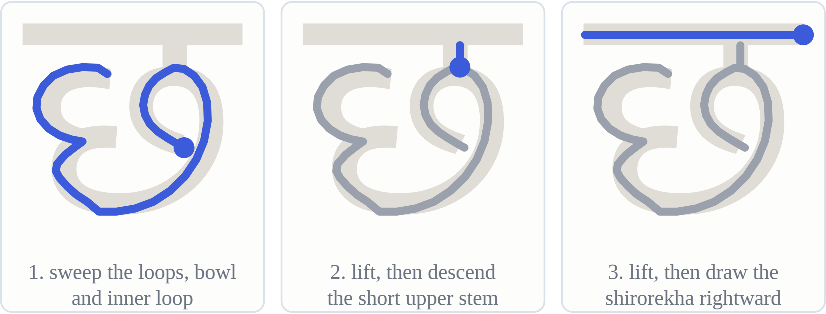
character	sound	puff of breath
च	ca	no
छ	chha	yes
त	ta	no
थ	tha	yes

Four characters, two pairs, one distinction running through both. **This script pairs its letters by breath**, and once you have heard the pair once you can expect it everywhere — there are more pairs waiting, and each will cost you less than the last.

Unlike त and थ, the two shapes here look nothing alike. The sound is paired; the drawing is not.

Writing: छ

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



1. sweep the loops, bowl and inner loop

2. lift, then descend the short upper stem

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-छ-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How छ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the upper loop’s open right tip, sweep counterclockwise around the upper-left loop, continue clockwise around the broad lower bowl, rise along the outer right side, and curl counterclockwise around the inner loop to its down-right tip without lifting
- **2.** lift and draw the short upper stem top-to-bottom
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2. The pen comes up 2 times and no more.

Verified three-stroke teaching form fitted to the bundled printed outline; everyday handwriting may divide or simplify the loops differently.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-छ-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at च and छ side by side, and say which one carries the puff

  च · छ

- *Trace it:* छ three times, saying *chha* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* the other pair in this script that works the same way

Before you move on

Which letter is छ the breathy partner of? (च.) Which earlier pair works the same way? (त and थ.) Do the two shapes resemble each other? (No — the sound is paired, the drawing is not.)

21.2 छह, सात, आठ, नौ, दस — six to ten, the same erosion twice more

You already watched *trīṇi* wear down to *tīn* in two careful steps. Two more numbers here do exactly the same thing.

You'll want to know — The five

	Hindi	said
6	छह	*chhah*
7	सात	*sāt*
8	आठ	*āṭh*
9	नौ	*nau*
10	दस	*das*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

All five are tadbhavas: *chhah* from **kṣaṭ*, a variant CDIAL reconstructs beside *ṣaṭ*, “six” (CDIAL 12803); *sāt* from *sapta* (CDIAL 13139); *āṭh* from *aṣṭā* (CDIAL 941); *nau* from *nava* (CDIAL 6984); and *das* from *daśa* (CDIAL 6227).

You’ll want to know — sapta → satta → sāt, aṣṭa → aṭṭha → āṭh — the same mechanism again

Put seven and eight beside their Sanskrit ancestors:

Sanskrit	**→ Prakrit →**	**Hindi**
saptá	*satta*	**sāt**
aṣṭá	*aṭṭha*	**āṭh**

This is the **identical two-step process** you already watched turn *trīṇi* into *tīn*:

1. The consonant cluster (*-pt-*, *-ṣṭ-*) **simplifies into a doubled consonant** (*-tt-*, *-ṭṭh-*) — the same weight, packed into one place.
2. The doubled consonant **simplifies again**, and the **vowel lengthens** to pay for what was lost — *satta* → *sāt*, *aṭṭha* → *āṭh*.

Same trade, same reason, two more numbers. This is exactly what the anchor lesson meant by “not decay in any bad sense” — it’s the standard Prakrit weight-conservation move, and by now you’ve seen it three times.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “chhah, sāt, āṭh, nau, das”
- the repeated mechanism — “saptá … satta … **sāt**” and “aṣṭá … aṭṭha … **āṭh**”

Before you move on

Count six to ten in Hindi. (*Chhah, sāt, āṭh, nau, das.*) What mechanism do *sāt* and *āṭh* share with lesson 6’s *tīn*? (**Cluster simplifies to a geminate, then the geminate simplifies again**

and the vowel lengthens — the same weight-conservation move, three numbers running.) Next: compare the three different histories inside six, nine, and ten.

21.3 छह, नौ, दस — three different paths

Seven and eight repeated a familiar weight trade. Six, nine, and ten show that not every number took the same road.

You'll want to know — ṣaṣ → chhah — a sibilant moves forward

छह (*chhah*) continues Sanskrit **ṣaṣ**, "six." The retroflex sibilant **ṣ** shifted forward into Hindi छ (*ch*). This is separate from cluster simplification, but it is still two thousand years of ordinary speech reshaping a Sanskrit word.

You'll want to know — nava → nau — a consonant dissolves

नौ (*nau*) continues Sanskrit **nava**. The **v** between vowels weakened and disappeared; the vowels on either side contracted into the diphthong *-ava-* → *-au-*. Compare *pāṁch*: there a nasal moved into the vowel; here an intervocalic consonant dissolved between two vowels.

You'll want to know — daśa → das — the quiet path

दस (*das*) continues Sanskrit **daśa** most plainly: the final vowel drops. There is no cluster to simplify and no middle consonant to lose.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "ṣaṣ … chhah" — the sibilant shifts
- "nava … nau" — *v* dissolves into a diphthong
- "daśa … das" — only the final vowel drops

Before you move on

What happened to **v** in *nava* → *nau*? (It **dissolved between vowels**, which contracted.) Which form changed least? (**Das** — only the final vowel dropped.) Count six to ten once more. (*Chhah, sāt, āṭh, nau, das.*)

Chapter 22

Numbers Eleven to Twenty

Modes: **voice** (2) **eyes** (1) **pen** (3) **Hands-free start:** none of the 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count from eleven to twenty in Hindi and spot the subtractive nineteen sitting inside the list.
>
> *Say* ओस *and* ऊन*, pick out* उ*,* ऊ *and* ओ*, count* ग्यारह *to* बीस*, then read* उन्नीस *as 'one less than twenty', the same logic as Latin's ūndēvīgintī.*

22.1 उ — the same vowel, standing on its own feet

> You already have the little hook that adds a *u* underneath a consonant. Before the new one: which mark is it, and where does it sit?

Script you'll notice: उ

उ — *u*.

This is the **independent vowel**. The hook you already know rides under a consonant and cannot stand alone. When a word **begins** with *u*, there is no consonant to hang the hook on, so the vowel gets a full letter of its own.

What it is made of:

- a joined upper bowl and lower loop
- the top shirorekhā

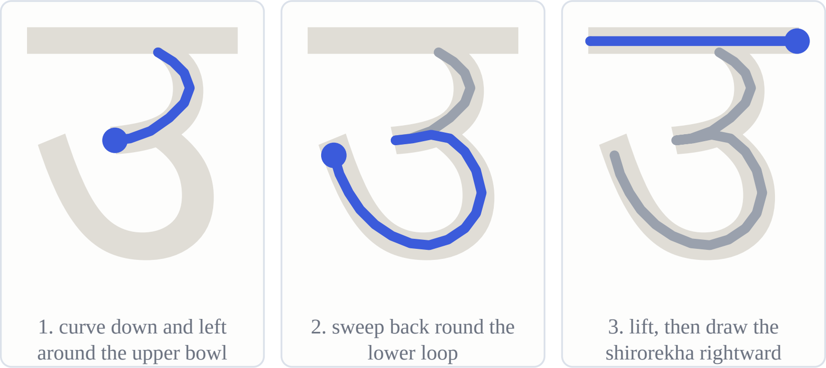
Script: two ways to write one sound

where the *u* falls	**how it is written**
under a consonant	the hook you already have
at the start of a word	उ

Both say *u*. Which one a word uses is settled by **what comes before it**, and nothing else. Every vowel in this script works this way, so learning the pair once tells you what to expect from all of them.

Writing: उ

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



1. curve down and left around the upper bowl

2. sweep back round the lower loop

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, 'Devanagari उ stroke order.svg', panels 1–2, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How उ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the headline junction, curve down and left around the upper bowl, then sweep back through the waist and around the lower loop without lifting
- **2.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The pen comes up once and no more.

Verified two-stroke teaching form; everyday handwriting may divide the bowl and loop differently.

> This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari उ stroke order.svg’, panels 1–2, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023.

Your turn

- *Trace it:* उ three times, saying *u* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* whether a word starting with *u* uses the hook or the full letter
- *Look:* at उ and say how many times the pen leaves the page

Before you move on

Why can the hook not open a word? (It has nothing to hang from.) What does उ carry? (***u***.) How many pen lifts? (One.)

22.2 ऊन (ūn) — wool

> Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You’ll want to know: ऊन

ऊन — *ūn* — “wool”.

Say it: *ūn*. *Look:* at its shape as you say it. The next lesson takes one piece of it, ऊ, and writes it on its own.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ऊन (*ūn*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ūrṇā*, “wool” (CDIAL 2424).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ūn*
- *ūn*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is “wool”? (ऊन, *ūn*.)

22.3 ऊ — the same letter, holding the note longer

Before the new one: उ — what sound does it carry, and when does a word use it instead of the hook?

Script you’ll notice: ऊ

ऊ — *ū*, the long one.

The sound is the same vowel held for longer, and the letter says so: it is **उ with one loop added on the right**.

What it is made of:

- the continuous body of उ
- a separate right-hand loop
- the top shirorekhā

Script: the pair, side by side

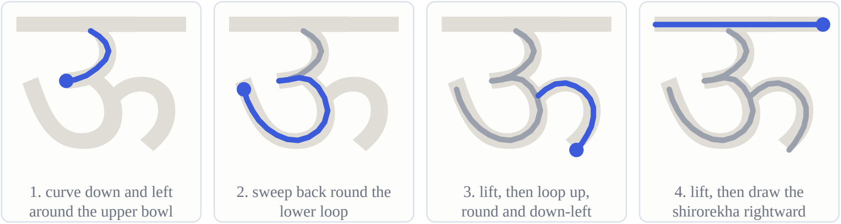
letter	sound	body
उ	u	bowl and loop
ऊ	ū	the same, plus a right loop

Put them next to each other and the extra loop is the only difference. That is not a coincidence of shape — **the script pairs short and long vowels by building the long one out of the short one**, and you will see the same trick again.

This letter is worth having before you can use it. The Hindi for *I will come* begins with a long *ū* sitting where no consonant can carry it, so the whole of the future tense waits on this one loop.

Writing: ऊ

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 4 movements



1. curve down and left around the upper bowl

2. sweep back round the lower loop

3. lift, then loop up, round and down-left

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari ऊ stroke order.svg’, panels 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ऊ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** curve down and left around the upper bowl, then sweep back through the waist and around the lower loop without lifting
- **2.** lift at the waist and sweep the right-hand loop up, around, and down-left
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2. The pen comes up 2 times and no more.

Verified three-stroke teaching form; everyday handwriting may join or simplify the loops differently.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari ऊ stroke order.svg’, panels 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023.

Your turn

- *Look:* at उ and ऊ side by side, and name the one difference

  उ · ऊ

- *Trace it:* ऊ three times, holding the vowel long as you finish each one
- *Say it:* which of the two takes more pen lifts, and how many

Before you move on

What is added to उ to make ऊ? (One loop on the right.) What does the extra loop do to the sound? (Holds it longer.) How many pen lifts does ऊ take? (Two.)

22.4 ओस (os) — dew

Before the new word: say the last thing you learned, once, out loud.

You'll want to know: ओस

ओस — *os* — "dew".

Say it: *os*. *Look:* at its shape as you say it. The next lesson takes one piece of it, ओ, and writes it on its own.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ओस (*os*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *avaśyā*, "hoar-frost, dew" (CDIAL 855).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *os*
- *os*, and what it means

Before you move on

What is "dew"? (ओस, *os*.)

22.5 ओ — a letter you can already draw most of

Before the new one: आ — what does it do? Picture its shape, and keep the picture.

Script you’ll notice: ओ

ओ — *o.*

Another independent vowel, for a word that **begins** with *o* and has no consonant to carry the mark.

What it is made of:

- the joined upper and lower bowls of आ
- a swept middle shoulder, an inner stem and a trailing stem
- **a separate arc over the top**
- the top shirorekhā

Script: what is new and what is not

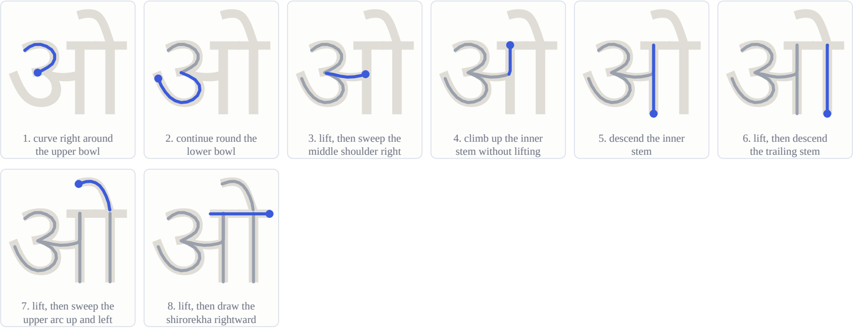
letter	**what you see**
आ	the body
ओ	the same body, with an arc above

Everything below the headline you have drawn before. **The only new mark is the arc**, and it sits above the line rather than on it, so it is easy to spot and easy to miss.

This is the third time a letter has turned out to be an old one with a piece added. That is how the script is built, and it is why the alphabet gets faster rather than slower as you go.

Writing: ओ

How it is written — 5 strokes · 4 pen lifts · 8 movements



1. curve right around the upper bowl
2. continue round the lower bowl
3. lift, then sweep the middle shoulder right
4. climb up the inner stem without lifting
5. descend the inner stem
6. lift, then descend the trailing stem
7. lift, then sweep the upper arc up and left
8. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari ओ stroke order.svg’, panels 1–6, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ओ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** curve right around the upper bowl and continue down and around the lower bowl without lifting
- **2.** lift and sweep the middle shoulder right
- **3.** without lifting, climb up the inner stem to the headline
- **4.** descend the inner stem
- **5.** lift and descend the trailing stem
- **6.** lift at the trailing stem's headline junction and sweep the upper arc upward and left
- **7.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 4. The pen comes up 4 times and no more.

> The source shows six movements; most native writers draw ओ in five strokes (60% of HP Labs India's native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts four times: the shoulder runs on up the inner stem and back down it.
>
> This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Saurmandal, 'Devanagari ओ stroke order.svg', panels 1–6, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023.

Your turn

- *Look:* at आ and ओ side by side, and name the one mark that separates them

  आ · ओ

- *Trace it:* ओ three times, saying *o* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* which part of ओ sits above the headline

Before you move on

Which letter is ओ built on? (आ.) What is added? (An arc above the line.) What have the last three letters had in common? (Each was an older letter with one piece added.)

22.6 ग्यारह, बीस — genuinely irregular, and one honest exception

First, two words from this chapter: what are *dew* and *wool*? (ओस *os*; ऊन *ūn*.) Now the teens: honestly irregular, with one echo of Latin hiding inside.

The two words — Eleven to twenty

	Hindi	said
11	ग्यारह	*gyārah*
12	बारह	*bārah*
13	तेरह	*terah*
14	चौदह	*chaudah*
15	पंद्रह	*pandrah*
16	सोलह	*solah*
17	सत्रह	*satrah*
18	अठारह	*aṭhārah*
19	उन्नीस	*unnīs*
20	बीस	*bīs*

The two words — Honest irregularity

Unlike Spanish's transparent *dieciséis-diecinueve*, Hindi's 11-18 each descend from their own Sanskrit number-word (*ekādaśa, dvādaśa, trayodaśa...*) through individually unpredictable erosion. Most end in **-rah**, a worn-down echo of Sanskrit's "-daśa" ("ten"), but each front half has to be memorized one by one, the way English speakers memorize "eleven" and "twelve".

The two words — उन्नीस

Here's the honest exception: उन्नीस (*unnīs*, 19) most likely continues Sanskrit's **own subtractive** name for 19: ऊनविंशति (*ūnaviṃśati*), "**one less than twenty**" (*ūna*, "less," + *viṃśati*, "twenty" — a shortened form of the Vedic *ekonaviṃśati*, with *eka*, "one," dropped). Sanskrit named every number ending in 9 up through 99 this way.

That is the logic of **Latin's ūndēvīgintī** ("one from twenty"), from the numbers-11-20 lesson: Indo-Aryan and Italic, separated for thousands of years, each landed on nineteen as twenty minus one.

The two words — बीस

बीस (*bīs*, "twenty") continues Sanskrit विंशति (*viṃśati*, "twenty").

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "gyārah, bārah, terah" — 11, 12, 13, each individually memorized
- "unnīs" — 19, most likely "one less than twenty" (ūnaviṃśati), echoing Latin's ūndēvīgintī
- "bīs" — twenty

Script — the chapter's three vowels

उ · ऊ · ओ

- *Point to:* *ū*, then *o*, then *u*
- What sets ऊ apart from उ, and ओ apart from आ? (A loop on the right, for the longer sound; an arc above the line.)

Before you move on

Do Hindi's numbers 11-18 follow a predictable pattern the way Spanish's teens do? (**No** — each is individually eroded from its own Sanskrit ancestor and must be memorized.) What does उन्नीस most likely preserve from Sanskrit, and what does it mean? (Sanskrit's **subtractive** *ūnaviṃśati*, "**one less than twenty**.") What Latin number from an earlier lesson uses the exact same subtractive logic? (**ūndēvīgintī**, "one from twenty" — two unrelated language families, the same idea.)

Chapter 23

Dog and Cat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a dog and a cat in Hindi and say honestly how far back each word can actually be traced.
>
> *Trace* बिल्ली *back through biḍālikā to biḍāla, then say out loud where the evidence stops being solid.*

23.1 कुत्ता — a third mystery dog-word

> Spanish has a mystery dog-word, and English/German another. Hindi genuinely gives you a **third**.

You'll want to know — कुत्ता — a third mystery, displacing Sanskrit's own PIE word

Sanskrit's actual, **inherited** word for dog was श्वान (*śvān*) — the **exact same PIE root**, ***ḱwon-***, behind Latin's *canis*, English's *hound*, and German's *Hund*. It's the **only** word for dog found in the Rigveda. But everyday Hindi doesn't use *śvān* at all — the ordinary word is कुत्ता (*kuttā*), which traces through Prakrit to a Sanskrit form, कुर्कुर (*kurkura*). Its ultimate origin is honestly **unresolved** — serious proposals split between an **onomatopoeic** origin (imitating a dog's bark) and a **non-Indo-Aryan substrate** word borrowed from an unrelated language family, with no consensus on which is right. Either way, *kuttā* quietly pushed *śvān* into rare, formal, literary use — the **exact same shape of story** as Spanish's *perro* displacing *can*, and English's *dog* displacing *hound*. Three unrelated language families, three mystery words, all crowding out the same inherited PIE word for "dog."

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “kuttā” — dog, genuinely uncertain origin, displacing Sanskrit’s own śvān
- “śvān” — the PIE-inherited word, now rare and formal

Before you move on

What was Sanskrit’s actual inherited word for “dog,” and what family does it belong to? (**श्वान**, *śvān* — same PIE root as Latin *canis*, English *hound*, German *Hund*.) Does everyday Hindi use *śvān*? (**No** — *kuttā* displaced it, echoing Spanish’s *perro* and English’s *dog*.) Is *kuttā*’s own origin settled? (**No** — genuinely disputed between an onomatopoeic origin and a non-Indo-Aryan substrate word.) Next: follow Hindi’s cat-word into a probable fourth family.

23.2 बिल्ली — a probable fourth cat-word family

Hindi’s dog-word joined three mysteries. Its cat-word probably opens a family separate from the widespread *qiṭṭ/cattus/gato/chat/Katze* story.

You’ll want to know — The route into Hindi

बिल्ली (*billī*, “cat”) traces through Sauraseni Prakrit to Sanskrit *biḍālikā*, a diminutive of *biḍāla* (“cat”).

Be honest about the deeper step: most linguists consider *biḍāla* a loanword **into Sanskrit from Dravidian**, but this is not universal. Some scholars are skeptical of the comparison; another serious proposal derives it from an unattested native compound, ***vidāla**, “that which tears apart small birds.”*

If the leading Dravidian account is right, *billī* belongs to a probable fourth cat-word family. Arabic *qiṭṭ*, Latin *cattus*, Spanish *gato*, French *chat*, and German *Katze* are usually linked to one Afro-Asiatic source; Hindi’s word would instead descend from a word Sanskrit borrowed from Dravidian.

Your turn

- *Say it:* “billī” — cat
- *Trace it: biḍāla* → *biḍālikā* → Prakrit → *billī*
- *Qualify:* “probably Dravidian, not proven”

Before you move on

Where does बिल्ली most likely come from? (**Dravidian**, via Sanskrit *biḍāla*.) Is that universally agreed? (**No** — it is the leading account with serious alternatives.) Why is this a new cat-word family? (It is probably separate from the *qiṭṭ/cattus* family.)

Chapter 24

Green and Yellow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name green and yellow in Hindi and trace पीला step by step back to Sanskrit.
>
> *Trace pīta · pītala · pīala · pīlā in order, and flag the drink-to-yellow link as uncertain rather than settled.*

24.1 हरा — a color cousin hiding in plain sight

> Hindi's green word shares deep roots with words other languages use for yellow.

You'll want to know — हरा — a hidden cousin of jaune and gelb

हरा (**harā**, "**green**") comes from **Sanskrit** हरित (**harita**, "**green, yellowish, tawny**") — a well-documented descendant of **Proto-Indo-European** **$*\acute{g}^{h}elh_{3}$-**, "**to shine**." That confirmed root is also behind **German**'s **gelb** (via Proto-Germanic **gelwaz*) and English's own "yellow" and "gold" — making Hindi's word for **GREEN** a genuine cousin of German's word for **YELLOW**. **French**'s **jaune** is usually traced to this same family too, via Latin *galbinus* — though, honestly, that particular link is **less secure** than the others: some modern Latin scholarship treats *galbus*'s origin as unknown rather than confirming the $*\acute{g}^{h}elh_{3}$- connection. So here's the honest surprise: Hindi's word for GREEN and German's word for YELLOW are, at the deepest level, **cousins** — not a contradiction, since this root originally covered a blurry “shining, yellow-to-green” zone before languages carved out different pieces of it. Sanskrit *harita* itself kept some of that blur, historically covering shades from green through yellowish and tawny, before Hindi’s *harā* settled specifically on “green.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “हरा” — green, a hidden PIE cousin of German’s gelb
- “$\acute{g}^{h}elh_{3}$- — shine, then a yellow-to-green color zone”

Before you move on

What ancient Proto-Indo-European root connects **harā** to German’s *gelb*? (**$*\acute{g}^{h}elh_{3}$-**, “to shine” — Hindi’s GREEN word is a genuine cousin of German’s YELLOW word; French’s *jaune* is usually placed in this family too, though that link is less secure.) Why can one root yield green and yellow words? (It once covered a broader **shining yellow-to-green zone**.) Next: the yellow word, whose sound history is clear, and the Sanskrit look-alike to keep apart from it.

24.2 पीला — clear sounds, and a look-alike to keep apart

> *Harā* gave a secure ancient color family. Hindi’s yellow word gives a secure sound chain, and a Sanskrit look-alike to keep out of it.

You’ll want to know — The chain

पीला (*pīlā*, “yellow”) traces through Prakrit पीअल (*pīala*) to Sanskrit पीतल (*pītala*), built on पीत (*pīta*), “yellow” (CDIAL 8233, 8230).

Sanskrit also has a *pīta* that means **“drunk, quaffed,”** from the root *pā-*, “to drink.” It is a different word. Monier-Williams lists the two as separate headwords, and CDIAL gives them separate entries (8229 and 8230): they only sound alike. MW suggests “yellow” may come from a root meaning “to swell,” after the colour of butter and oil, and marks that as possible, not settled.

What is solid is the ordinary sound history:

pīta* → *pītala* → *pīala* → *pīlā

Keep the evidence levels separate: trust the forms; do not let the look-alike into the chain.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "pīlā" — yellow
- *Trace it:* "pīta · pītala · pīala · pīlā"
- *Qualify:* "pīta, drunk, is a different word"

Before you move on

Say whether *pīta* "drunk" is the word behind **pīlā**. (**No**: it is a separate word that only sounds like *pīta* "yellow".) Then name the part that is secure. (The sound chain *pīta* → *pītala* → *pīala* → *pīlā*.)

Chapter 25

Day

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say day in Hindi and explain how दिन both is and is not related to Latin's diēs.
>
> *Say* दिन*, put it and diēs on the same PIE *dyew- root but different branches, then name* द्यु/दिव् *as the closer cousins.*

25.1 दिन (din) — "day," the same root as diēs, a different branch

> You've already met this word once, tucked inside *dopahar* ("noon," literally "two pahars" of the **day**). Now it stands alone — and its connection to Latin's *diēs* is real, but more careful than it first looks.

You'll want to know — दिन — "day"

दिन (**din**) — "**day**" — is the ordinary Hindi word for "day," already implicit in दोपहर (*dopahar*, "noon," Chapter 17).

You'll want to know — The same ultimate root as diēs — but a separate branch

Din traces to **Sanskrit** दिन (*dina*), from **Proto-Indo-Iranian** ***dinám*** — a **suffixed** formation built on **Proto-Indo-European** ***dyew-*** ("**to shine, sky**"), the same ultimate root behind **Latin**'s own **diēs**. But be careful: *din* and *diēs* aren't the closest possible cousins — they took **separate derivational paths** off that shared root. *Din*'s own closest relatives are actually the Baltic/Slavic "day"-words, **Lithuanian** *diena* and **Proto-Slavic** **_*dьnь_**. The genuinely **direct**, unsuffixed cousins of *diēs* are Sanskrit's own द्यु (*dyu*, "heaven, sky") and दिव् (*div*, "sky") — which give दिवस (*divasa*), yet another everyday Hindi word for "day." So the honest picture: *din* and *diēs* share one distant ancestor, but *dyu*/*div* are the tighter match.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "din" — "day," already met inside dopahar
- the shared root — din and Latin's diēs, same PIE root *dyew-*, "to shine," but different derivational branches
- the closer cousins — dyu, div, "heaven/sky" — the tighter, unsuffixed match for diēs

Before you move on

Where have you already met दिन before this lesson? (दोपहर, *dopahar*, "noon.") What ancient PIE root connects Hindi's **din** to Latin's **diēs**, and what does it mean? (**_*dyew-_**, "to shine, sky" — but through **separate branches**, not as the closest cousins.) Which Sanskrit words are actually the **tighter, more direct** cousins of *diēs*? (द्यु *dyu* and दिव् *div*.)

25.2 ग — the other way round

Before the new one: ढ — how many pen lifts did it take?

That one came before any word that used it. This one comes **long after**.

Script you'll notice: ग

ग — *ga*.

What it is made of:

- a counterclockwise left loop joined to an ascending stem

- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

Script: you have been reading it for twenty-two chapters

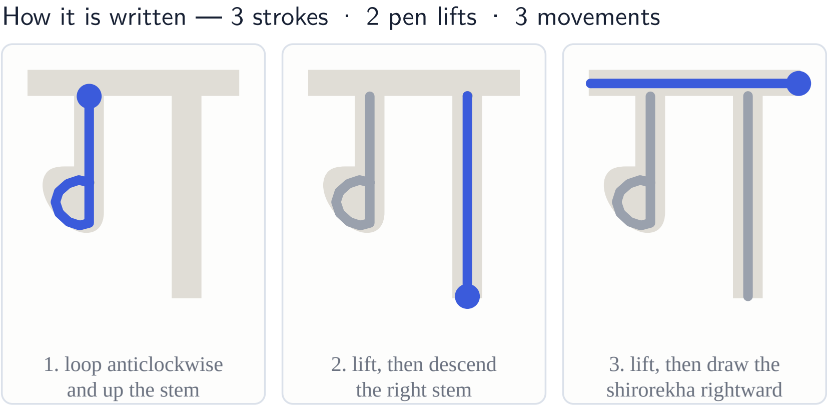
Every one of these was yours before this page:

- स्वागत — the *welcome* you were greeted with early on
- मिलेंगे — *we will meet*
- मंगलवार — Tuesday

So this is the opposite arrangement from the last two letters. They arrived before their words; **this one is late, and there is no honest way to dress that up**.

The book taught its opening by **copying whole words** — a real sentence in two chapters, which is worth a great deal — and the cost is that the letters inside those words went unnamed. You have been recognising ग by its company. Now you get the letter itself.

Writing: ग


How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements

1. loop anticlockwise and up the stem

2. lift, then descend the right stem

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, 'Deva-ग-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 9 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ग is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the loop's upper-right junction and sweep left over the top, down around the left side, back to the lower-right junction, and continue up the joined stem to the headline
- **2.** lift and draw the right stem top-to-bottom
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2. The pen comes up 2 times and no more.

> Verified three-stroke teaching form; everyday handwriting may join or simplify the body differently.
>
> This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-ग-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 9 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words and find ग in each one

  स्वागत · मंगलवार

- *Trace it:* ग three times, saying *ga* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* how long you had been reading this letter before today

Before you move on

What sound does ग carry? (*ga.*) Name a word you have said for weeks that contains it. Why is it only being drawn now? (The opening taught whole words, so the letters inside them were never named.)

Chapter 26

Night

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say night in Hindi and explain why रात and Latin's nox are not cousins at all.
>
> *Trace rātri → ratti → raat, then state the honest twist: unlike* दिन *and diēs,* रात *and nox share no root.*

26.1 रात (raat) — "night," and an honest false cousin of Latin's nox

> Last lesson, *din* turned out to be a real (if distant) cousin of Latin's *diēs*. This lesson is the mirror image: *raat* looks like it should be *nox*'s cousin too — but it genuinely isn't.

You'll want to know — रात — "night"

रात (**raat**) — "**night**" — is the word already hiding inside आधी रात (*ādhī rāt*, "midnight," Chapter 17). It comes down through a completely ordinary sound-change chain: **Sanskrit** रात्रि (*rātri*) → **Prakrit** रत्ति (*ratti*, consonant cluster simplifying) → Hindi रात (*raat*) — the same shape of erosion you've already seen in Hindi's numbers (*saptá* → *sāt*, *aṣṭá* → *āṭh*).

You'll want to know — A genuine false cousin — not a true cognate

Here's the honest twist: रात्रि (*rātri*) traces to **Proto-Indo- Iranian _*HráHtriH_**, from **Proto-Indo-European _*h$_1$reh$_1$-trih$_2$_** — built from a root meaning “**to rest, remain still**,” plus a feminine suffix. This is a **completely different** PIE root from Latin’s **nox** (from ***nók^{w}ts***, the root behind English “night” itself, German *Nacht*, Greek *nyx*). Both *rātri* and *nox* are genuine Indo-European “night” words, in related language branches — but they are **not** cousins. Unlike *din* and *diēs* last lesson, which really do share one ancestor, *raat* and *nox* just happen to both mean “night,” from two entirely separate ancient roots. Sanskrit actually **does** keep a true *nók^{w}ts* cousin of its own — नक्तम् (*naktam*, “by night”) — but it’s an archaic, adverbial word; it’s *rātri*, not *naktam*, that won the job of everyday Hindi’s *raat*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “raat” — “night,” already met inside ādhī rāt
- the sound chain — rātri → ratti → raat, the same erosion pattern as saptá → sāt
- the honest twist — raat and nox are NOT cousins, unlike din and diēs

Before you move on

Where have you already met रात before this lesson? (आधी रात, *ādhī rāt*, “midnight.”) What Sanskrit word, and what sound-change chain, gives Hindi **raat**? (रात्रि *rātri* → Prakrit *ratti* → *raat*.) Are *raat* and Latin’s *nox* true cognates, the way *din* and *diēs* are? (**No** — genuinely different PIE roots, **h$_1$reh$_1$-* “to rest” vs. **nók^{w}ts* — a false cousin, despite both meaning “night.”)

26.2 फ — the fourth breath pair

Before the new one: ग — what sound does it carry?

Now say प, then say it again with a puff of air behind it.

Script you’ll notice: फ

फ — *pha*.

It is the **breathy partner of प**, the fourth such pair you have met. What it is made of:

- a left stem joined through the lower bowl to a rising and retraced central stem
- a separate clockwise right arch
- the top shirorekhā

Script: four pairs, one idea

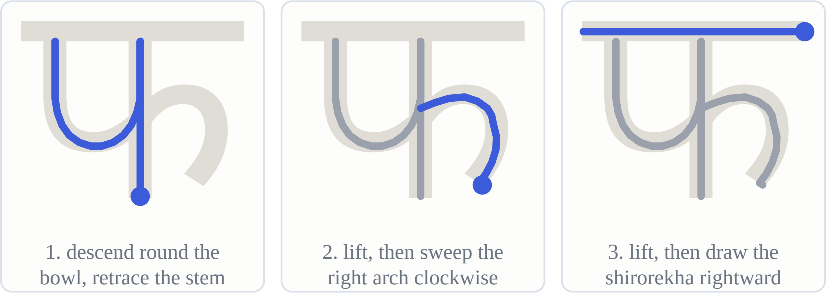
plain	**breathy**
त	थ
च	छ
ज	झ
प	फ

Four pairs now. **The distinction was learned once and each pair since has cost only a shape.**

Like ग, this one is late: फिर — *again*, in *see you again* — has been yours since the fourth chapter, and the letter opening it went unnamed until now.

Writing: फ

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



1. descend round the bowl, retrace the stem

2. lift, then sweep the right arch clockwise

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after JackPotte, 'Devanagari pʰ फ.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How फ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** descend the left stem, curve right around the lower bowl, rise along the central side to the headline, then retrace down the central stem without lifting
- **2.** lift at the central junction and sweep clockwise over and down through the open right arch
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2. The pen comes up 2 times and no more.

Verified three-stroke teaching form; another learner source stages the components differently.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: JackPotte, ‘Devanagari p^{h} फ.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at प and फ side by side, and say which one carries the puff

  प · फ

- *Trace it:* फ three times, saying *pha* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* the three earlier pairs that work the same way

Before you move on

Which letter is फ the breathy partner of? (प.) How many breath pairs have you met? (Four.) Name a word you have said since early on that begins with it. (फिर.)

Chapter 27

Good Night

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can wish someone good night in Hindi and say why the phrase uses literary रात्रि rather than everyday रात.
>
> *Say शुभ रात्रि at parting, name the raat / rātri register pair, and trace śubh from 'to shine' to 'auspicious'.*

27.1 शुभ रात्रि (śubh rātri) — "good night," the formal doublet in action

> Hindi keeps two versions of "night" side by side — one for everyday speech, one for set phrases. Here's where the formal one gets used.

You'll want to know — शुभ रात्रि — "auspicious night"

शुभ रात्रि (**śubh rātri**) — "**good night**" — literally "**auspicious night**." Notice: this uses रात्रि (*rātri*), the very Sanskrit word last lesson's *raat* descended **from** — but here, kept in its **full, unworn Sanskrit** form. This is a classic **tatsama/tadbhava doublet**: *rātri* (**tatsama**, a direct, unchanged Sanskrit borrowing) sits alongside *raat* (**tadbhava**, the same word worn down by centuries of ordinary sound change) — Hindi keeps both, one for everyday speech, one for set formal phrases like this one.

You’ll want to know — शुभ — “auspicious,” from a root meaning “to shine”

शुभ (śubh) — “**auspicious, good, fortunate**” — comes from the Sanskrit verbal root **शुभ्** (*śubh*), whose core sense is “**to be beautiful, splendid**.” This traces to a well-sourced **Proto-Indo-European** root, ***ḱewb^{h}-*** (“to be beautiful”). Some scholars propose a **further, more speculative** connection beyond that — to **(s)kewh$_1$-* (“to perceive”) or **ḱew-* (“to shine”) — but that deeper link, not the **ḱewb^{h}-* root itself, is the genuinely uncertain part. Either way, the underlying idea is a familiar one: **auspiciousness imagined as a kind of radiance or beauty** — something good “shines.”

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “śubh rātri” — “good night,” literally “auspicious night”
- the formal doublet — rātri here, raat in everyday speech
- śubh’s own root — śubh, “to shine” → “auspicious”

Before you move on

Does **शुभ रात्रि** use the everyday *raat* or the formal *rātri*? (**The formal *rātri*** — Hindi keeps both versions, one for everyday speech, one for set phrases.) What does **शुभ** literally trace back to? (A root meaning “**to be beautiful, splendid**,” PIE **ḱewb^{h}-* — auspiciousness as a kind of radiance.) Is that root itself uncertain, or is a *further* proposed connection the shakier part? (**The root **ḱewb^{h}-* itself is well-sourced** — it’s the *deeper* proposed link, to “to shine” or “to perceive,” that’s genuinely speculative.)

27.2 ट — one run, then the headline

Before the new one: फ — how many pen lifts did it take?

This one takes fewer.

Script you'll notice: ट

ट — *ṭa*.

What it is made of:

- a descending central stem joined to a counterclockwise **open** round body
- the top shirorekhā

The word *open* is doing real work there. The round part comes back up toward the stem and **stops short of meeting it**, leaving a gap at the upper right. Keep that gap when you draw it.

Script: the tongue goes back

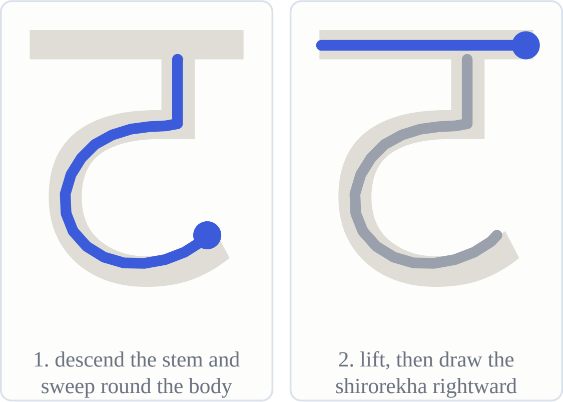
ट is a **retroflex**: the tongue curls back and taps the roof of the mouth, further back than it goes for त. Two different letters for what an English ear hears as one *t*, and Hindi uses both.

Words that were yours long before this page:

- रोटी — bread
- घंटा — an hour

Writing: ट

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 2 movements



1. descend the stem and sweep round the body

2. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ट-order.gif’, strokes 1–2, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ट is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the central stem’s headline junction, descend, turn left through the upper shoulder, and sweep counterclockwise around the open round body to its up-right tip without lifting
- **2.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. Everything below the headline is one unbroken run, and only ढ is built the same way.

> Verified two-stroke teaching form fitted to the bundled printed outline; everyday handwriting may narrow or simplify the curve differently.
>
> This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ट-order.gif’, strokes 1–2, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words and find ट in each one

  रोटी · घंटा

- *Trace it:* ट three times, saying *ṭa* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* where the gap in this letter is

Before you move on

How many pen lifts does ट take? (One.) Where does the tongue go for it, compared with त? (Further back.) Name a food you have asked for that contains it.

Chapter 28

Morning

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say morning in Hindi and recognise सुबह as a Persian-Arabic loan rather than a Sanskrit word.
>
> *Say सुबह, find the ṣ-b-ḥ root it shares with Arabic ṣabāḥ, and name the break from Sanskrit दिन and रात.*

28.1 सुबह (subah) — “morning,” and a root that also sits in Arabic

> दिन and रात were both Sanskrit words, straight through. This one breaks that pattern completely — and lands on a root that also sits inside a different language entirely.

You’ll want to know — सुबह — a real surprise: not Sanskrit at all

सुबह (**subah**) — “**morning**” — is Hindi’s everyday, ordinary word for morning. Unlike दिन (*din*) and रात (*raat*, both Sanskrit tatsama, met the last two lessons), *subah* is genuinely **borrowed**: from **Persian** صبح (*subh*), itself from **Arabic** صبح (*ṣubḥ*), built on the Arabic triliteral root ص-ب-ح (***ṣ-b-ḥ***, “dawn, to become morning”).

You'll want to know — A root that also sits inside an Arabic goodnight

Here's the honest connection: this is the **exact same** Arabic root that sits inside the Arabic goodnight خير على تصبح (*tuṣbiḥ ᶜalā khayr*, "good night," literally "may **you wake into goodness**," built on this very root). Hindi's everyday word for "morning" and Arabic's own good-night farewell — a phrase that never even mentions "night" — both trace to the **same three Arabic consonants**, ح-ب-ص, arriving in Hindi by a completely different route (via Persian) than they did staying in Arabic.

You'll want to know — Be honest: din and raat didn't prepare you for this

Don't assume every Hindi time-word will be Sanskrit just because *din* and *raat* were. *Subah* is a genuine break in the pattern — a reminder that "everyday Hindi word" and "Sanskrit tatsama" aren't the same category, even when the last two examples made it look that way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "subah" — "morning," genuinely a Persian/Arabic loan
- the shared root — ṣ-b-ḥ, the same three consonants inside Arabic's tuṣbiḥ ᶜalā khayr
- the honest break — unlike din and raat, subah is NOT Sanskrit

Before you move on

Is सुबह a Sanskrit tatsama, like दिन and रात? (**No** — a genuine Persian/Arabic loanword.) Which Arabic phrase, met earlier in this lesson, shares सुबह's exact root? (خير على تصبح, *tuṣbiḥ ᶜalā khayr*, "good night" — both trace to the Arabic root ح-ب-ص, *ṣ-b-ḥ*.)

28.2 ठ — the gap closed

Draw ट once from memory, then look at it. Where is its gap?

Close that gap and you are most of the way to today's letter.

Script you'll notice: ठ

ठ — *ṭha.*

What it is made of:

- a short top-to-bottom central stem
- a counterclockwise **closed** round body
- the top shirorekhā

letter	round body	stem
ट	open at the upper right	part of the same run
ठ	closed	part of the same run

Two differences, one you can hear and one you can only see: the breath, and the body that closes. The pen still runs from the stem into the body without lifting.

Script: the fifth breath pair

plain	breathy
त	थ
च	छ
ज	झ
प	फ
ट	ठ

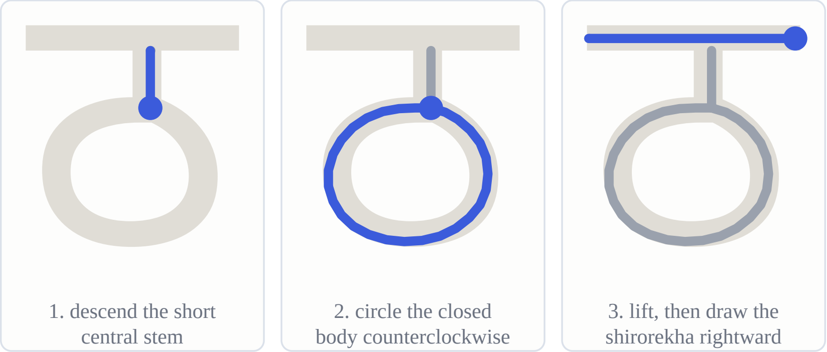
Five pairs now. The puff of breath was learned once, a long way back, and every pair since has cost only a shape.

Words that were yours long before this page:

- ठीक — fine, all right
- ठंड — cold
- आठ — eight

Writing: ठ

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements



1. descend the short central stem

2. circle the closed body counterclockwise

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, 'Deva-ठ-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ठ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** draw the short central stem top-to-bottom
- **2.** without lifting, sweep left, then counterclockwise around the closed round body back to the junction
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. The same as ट: the stem and the body are one run, and the pen comes up only for the headline.

> The source shows three movements; most native writers draw ठ in two strokes (89% of HP Labs India's native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.
>
> This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-ठ-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words and say which letter each one carries

  रोटी · ठीक

- *Trace it:* ठ three times, saying *ṭha* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* the one thing that tells the two round bodies apart

Before you move on

What separates ठ from ट on the page? (The body closes.) How many pen lifts does it take? (One.) Name the number you count to that contains it.

Chapter 29

Evening

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) ↙ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say evening in Hindi and refuse the tempting but false link between शाम and Sanskrit śyāmā.
>
> *Say* शाम*, reject the śyāmā resemblance as a false cognate, and pair it with* सुबह *as two loans from the same source.*

29.1 शाम (shaam) — "evening," and a tempting false cognate

> Last lesson's सुबह was Persian, not Sanskrit. This word is the same story — but this time there's a Sanskrit look-alike close enough to trip you up on purpose.

You'll want to know — शाम — Persian again, not Sanskrit

शाम (**shaam**) — "**evening**" — is, like *subah*, a genuine **Persian** loanword: from Persian شام (*šām*), which traces back through **Proto-Iranian** ***xšáfnyah*** to **Proto-Indo-Iranian** ***kšápā*** ("**night**"). Hindi's two everyday time-words for "morning" and "evening" both entered the language **via Persian**, not Sanskrit — though their deeper roots differ: *subah*'s traces further back to **Arabic**, while *shaam*'s is native **Indo-Iranian**, a sister branch to Sanskrit itself. Persian is what they share directly; their ultimate origins are not the same.

You'll want to know — Be careful: a tempting, but FALSE, cognate

Here's the trap: Sanskrit has its own word, श्यामा (**śyāmā**, "**dark, night-colored**"), that *looks* like it should be *shaam*'s cousin — similar sound, overlapping "darkness/night" meaning, right in the neighborhood you'd expect. It **isn't**. *Shaam* and *śyāmā* trace to **two completely separate roots** that simply converged on similar sounds and meanings by coincidence — a genuine **false cognate**, not a shared one. Don't let the resemblance fool you into inventing a connection that isn't there.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "shaam" — "evening," another genuine Persian loan
- the tempting trap — Sanskrit śyāmā looks related but ISN'T
- subah and shaam — both Persian, Hindi's whole "morning and evening" pair borrowed from the same source language

Before you move on

Is शाम Sanskrit or Persian? (**Persian** — from شام, śām, like subah.)
Is शाम related to Sanskrit श्यामा (śyāmā, "dark")? (**No** — a genuine false cognate; the resemblance is coincidental, not a shared root.)
What do subah and shaam have in common, beyond both meaning a time of day? (**Both are Persian loanwords** — Hindi's morning/evening pair, unlike din/raat, isn't Sanskrit at all.)

29.2 ए — the vowel that had only ever been a mark

Before the new one: ◌े — what does it do to the consonant it sits on?

That mark has a **standing form**, and this is it.

Script you’ll notice: ए

ए — *e*.

It is the **independent vowel**. The mark ◌े is what this sound looks like when it rides on a consonant; ए is what it looks like when it stands on its own, with no consonant to attach to.

What it is made of:

- a long left stem joined to the descending tail
- a shorter right stem with an inward hook
- the top shirorekhā

Script: two shapes, one sound

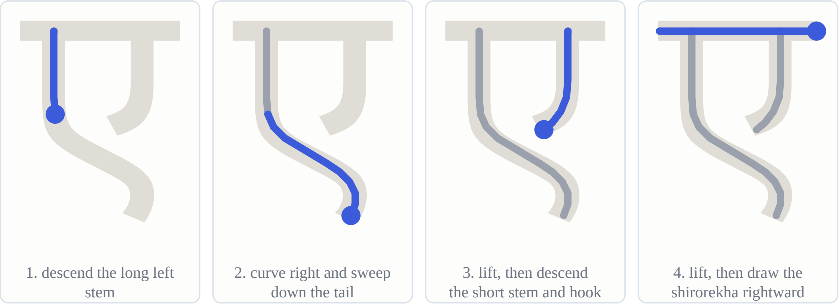
what you see	**where it stands**
◌े	on a consonant
ए	alone

Every vowel in this script works this way, and you have met the arrangement twice before with अ / ◌ा and with उ / ◌ु. **A vowel sign and its letter are the same vowel in two postures**, and which one a word uses is decided by whether a consonant is there to carry it.

ए turns up at the ends of words far more than at the beginnings, because that is where a vowel most often has nothing in front of it to ride on.

Writing: ए

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 4 movements



1. descend the long left stem

2. curve right and sweep down the tail

3. lift, then descend the short stem and hook

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari ए stroke order.svg’, panels 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ए is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** descend the left stem, curve right through the lower shoulder, and sweep down through the tail without lifting
- **2.** lift and descend the shorter right stem into its inward hook
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2. The pen comes up 2 times and no more.

Verified modern printed teaching form; everyday handwriting may simplify the curves.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari ए stroke order.svg’, panels 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the mark and the letter side by side, and say what they share

  ◌े · ए

- *Trace it:* ए three times, saying *e* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* what decides which of the two a word uses

Before you move on

What sound is ए? (*e*.) What is the sitting version of it? (◌े.) What decides which one a word uses? (Whether there is a consonant for the vowel to ride on.)

Chapter 30

Afternoon

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say afternoon in Hindi using दोपहर in its modern, widened sense.
>
> *Say* दोपहर में *for 'in the afternoon' — the Chapter 17 word doing a wider job than its etymology promises.*

30.1 दोपहर — the same word, a wider job than its etymology promised

> You already know दोपहर means "noon" — two pahars after sunrise, precisely. This lesson's honest twist is that the word doesn't stay that precise in everyday use.

You'll want to know — दोपहर — same word, a broader modern meaning

दोपहर (**dopahar**) is the exact word you met in Chapter 17, still literally "**two pahars**" (traditional ~3-hour watches, counted from sunrise) — but in **modern, everyday Hindi**, it no longer points only at that precise midday instant. Say दोपहर में (*dopahar mein*, "in the dopahar") to arrange a meeting, and you're pointing at a stretch of time — roughly **noon through late afternoon** — not a single moment. The historical etymology gave the word a very specific target (the end of the second daytime *pahar*); everyday usage has since widened that target into the general block of time most languages call "the afternoon."

You'll want to know — Be honest: etymology and modern meaning have drifted apart

This is worth sitting with: दोपहर's **literal** story still holds up the way Chapter 17 described it — "two pahars," with noon falling around the end of the second — though, as that lesson itself noted, treat the exact pahar-count as the general shape of the story rather than a precisely dated fact. Either way, the **word's job** in the language has moved on well past that etymology. This kind of drift — a word for one precise instant loosening into a name for a whole surrounding stretch of time — isn't unique to Hindi, but here it's visible because Chapter 17 showed you exactly how tight the original math was. पहर is Sanskrit *prahara*, "a watch" (CDIAL 8900), perhaps itself from Persian *pahra*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "dopahar" — the same word from Chapter 17, "two pahars"
- "dopahar mein" — "in the afternoon," a modern, widened usage
- the honest twist — the etymology stayed precise; the word's actual job widened past it

Before you move on

Is दोपहर a new word, or the same one from Chapter 17? (**The same word** — "two pahars.") Does modern Hindi use दोपहर to mean only the exact instant of noon? (**No** — it's widened to cover the whole afternoon, roughly noon through late afternoon.) Has दोपहर's etymology itself changed to match this wider modern use? (**No** — the etymology still points precisely at noon; only the word's everyday job has widened.)

30.2 ज — a letter you have been reading without being taught

Before the new one: ए — does it sit on a consonant or stand alone?

This next one is not new to your eye. It is new to your hand.

Script you'll notice: ज

ज — *ja*.

What it is made of:

- an open left hook curling clockwise around the lower bowl and continuing through the middle bar
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

Script: where it has been hiding

You have been reading this letter for a long time without anyone stopping to name it:

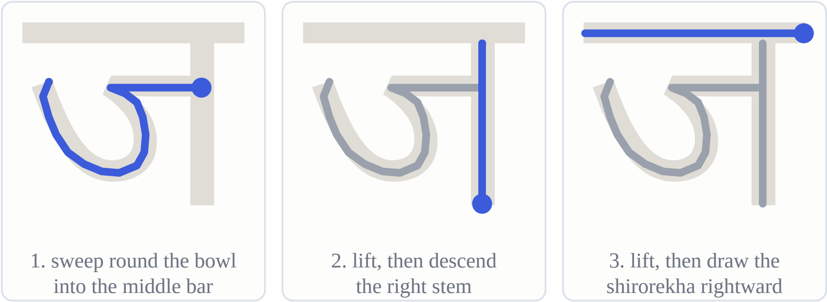
- जी — the respect-marker in जी हाँ
- जनवरी — January, and जून and जुलाई after it

That is worth saying out loud rather than passing over. A letter can appear on every other page and still never be **taught**, because the words that carry it were introduced for their meanings and the shapes inside them were left to look after themselves.

Seeing a shape often is not the same as being shown it. The first gives you a guess; the second gives you the letter.

Writing: ज

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



1. sweep round the bowl into the middle bar

2. lift, then descend the right stem

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, 'Deva-ज-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ज is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the open upper-left tip, sweep down and clockwise around the lower bowl, then rise through the inner shoulder and continue right along the middle bar to the right-stem junction without lifting
- **2.** lift and draw the right stem top-to-bottom
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2. The pen comes up 2 times and no more.

Verified three-stroke teaching form fitted to the bundled printed outline; everyday handwriting may divide the hook and bar differently.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-ज-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these words and find ज in each one

  जी · जनवरी

- *Trace it:* ज three times, saying *ja* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* how many times the pen comes up (two)

Before you move on

What sound does ज carry? (*ja.*) Name one word you already say that contains it. Had you been shown this letter before today? (No — only the words it sits inside.)

Chapter 31

Good Morning

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can wish someone good morning in Hindi and judge when सुप्रभात fits and when नमस्ते is the better choice.
>
> *Say* सुप्रभात*, split it into su + prabhāt, and set that native Sanskrit dawn against the Persian loan* सुबह*.*

31.1 सुप्रभात / प्रभात — “good morning,” built from “dawn”

> सुबह was Persian, borrowed whole. This lesson’s “good morning” isn’t built on it at all — it reaches for entirely different, native vocabulary.

The two words — सुप्रभात

सुप्रभात (**suprabhāt**) — “**good morning**” — is built from सु (*su*, “good”) plus प्रभात (*prabhāta*, “**dawn, daybreak**”) — and *prabhāta* is **native Sanskrit**, from प्रभा (*prabhā*, “light, splendour”), itself from the root भा (“to shine”) plus the preverb **प्र-** (“forth”), plus the suffix **-त** (*-ta*). This is a **completely different word** from सुबह (*subah*, HI-C28), the Persian/Arabic loan you use for the everyday noun “morning.” Hindi’s “morning” and “good morning” don’t share a root at all.

The exchange — Formal register

Here's a genuine, checked-not-assumed finding — hedged carefully, because the evidence behind it is thin: some sources describe Telugu speakers often code-switching to English "good night" instead of their own Sanskrit-descended phrase, though that claim might apply more broadly across South Asian languages, not just Telugu. सुप्रभात's own story is different again, and just as worth hedging: it skews toward **formal, written** contexts — speeches, radio, the well-known Hindi WhatsApp-forward "good morning image" culture — rather than casual spoken conversation, where नमस्ते commonly covers mornings too. That's a real formal/everyday split, but it isn't the same thing as being displaced by **English** specifically — there's no strong evidence for that particular substitution here. Don't assume every "good _____" greeting in every language follows the same displacement story; verify each one on its own, and don't flatten a hedge into a fact either way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- प्रभात (*prabhāt*) — "dawn, daybreak"
- "suprabhāt" — "good morning," su + prabhāt
- the root contrast — subah is Persian, prabhāt is native Sanskrit — completely different words
- the honest note — suprabhāt skews formal/written; नमस्ते covers casual mornings; no strong evidence of English displacement

Before you move on

Does सुप्रभात share a root with सुबह? (**No** — सुबह is Persian/Arabic; प्रभात, inside suprabhāt, is native Sanskrit, ultimately from भा, "to shine.") What does प्रभात mean by itself? (**Dawn, daybreak.**) Is सुप्रभात commonly used in casual spoken Hindi? (**Not especially** — it skews formal/written, with नमस्ते commonly covering mornings in everyday speech.) Is it being displaced by English "good morning," the way some sources (thinly) suggested for other languages' night greetings? (**No strong evidence of that** — its own story is a formal/everyday split, not an English substitution.)

Chapter 32

Good Evening

Modes: **voice** (1) **eyes** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can wish someone good evening in Hindi and choose between शुभ संध्या and नमस्ते by register.
>
> *Unpack* संध्या *as 'holding together' and* साँझ *as its doublet, pick out* श *and* झ*, then pick* शुभ संध्या *for a written evening card and* नमस्ते *for a casual 7 p.m. hello, treating the split as a tendency, not a ban.*

32.1 शुभ संध्या (shubh sandhyā) — "good evening," a twilight word with two lives

> शाम was Persian. This greeting reaches for something else again — a native Sanskrit word for the exact moment day and night meet.

You'll want to know — संध्या — "the junction of day and night"

संध्या (**sandhyā**) — "**evening, twilight**" — is **native Sanskrit**, from सम् (*sam-*, "together") + धा (*dhā*, "to hold, to place"), literally "**holding together**" — the **junction** where day and night meet. This is a genuinely different word from शाम (*shaam*, HI-C29's Persian loan): Hindi's everyday evening noun and its "good evening" greeting don't share a root, the same pattern already found for morning.

You'll want to know — साँझ — a doublet, but not a simple "casual" version

संध्या has its own Hindi **tadbhava** doublet, साँझ (**sāñjh**), worn down through Prakrit the same way रात्रि became रात (HI-C26/27). But be careful not to force that exact parallel: unlike *rātri/raat*, where the tadbhava form clearly became the everyday word and the tatsama stayed formal, sources describe साँझ as used across **both** literary/poetic **and** everyday communication — not simply "the casual one." The doublet exists; the clean formal/casual split doesn't carry over as neatly this time.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "shubh sandhyā" — "good evening," su + sandhyā
- *Say it:* sandhyā's own meaning — "holding together," the junction of day and night
- *Contrast:* tatsama *sandhyā* · evolved doublet *sāñjh*

Before you move on

What does संध्या literally mean, and what is it built from? ("**Holding together**" — सम् + धा — i.e. the junction of day and night.) Does साँझ work the same way रात्रि/रात's tatsama/tadbhava split did — one strictly formal, one strictly casual? (**No** — साँझ is used across both literary and everyday registers, not confined to one.) Next: choose between the written greeting and the casual all-day greeting.

32.2 झ — the puff, on the letter you drew last

You know साँझ (*sāñjh*), "dusk". This lesson writes its last letter.

Before the new one: ज — what sound does it carry?

You know what is coming. It has happened twice already.

Script you'll notice: झ

झ — *jha*.

It is the **breathy partner of ज**, the third such pair you have met. Say *ja*, then say it again with a puff of air behind it.

What it is made of:

- a joined short upper stem, upper bowl, lower loop, and diagonal tail
- a left-to-right middle crossbar
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

Script: the third pair

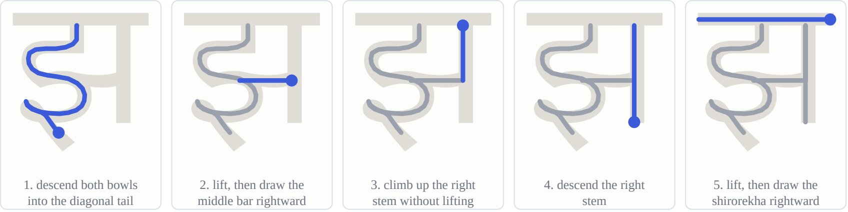
plain	breathy
त	थ
च	छ
ज	झ

Three pairs now, one distinction. **This script pairs its letters by breath**, and each pair has cost less than the last because the idea was learned once and only the shapes change.

This one arrives **before** any word that needs it — the first letter in this book to do so. There is nothing to find it inside yet. Learn the shape and the breath, and the word will arrive already readable.

Writing: झ

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 5 movements



1. descend both bowls into the diagonal tail
2. lift, then draw the middle bar rightward
3. climb up the right stem without lifting
4. descend the right stem
5. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-झ-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How झ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** descend the short upper stem, turn left and curve clockwise around the upper bowl, continue through the waist and clockwise around the lower loop, then finish down-right through the diagonal tail without lifting

- **2.** lift at the central junction and draw the middle crossbar left-to-right
- **3.** without lifting, climb up the right stem to the headline
- **4.** descend the right stem top-to-bottom
- **5.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2. The same as ज: the crossbar runs into the stem.

The source shows four movements; most native writers draw झ in three strokes (53% of HP Labs India's native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the crossbar and the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, 'Deva-झ-order.gif', strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at ज and झ side by side, and say which one carries the puff

  ज · झ

- *Trace it:* झ three times, saying *jha* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* the two earlier pairs that work the same way

Before you move on

Which letter is झ the breathy partner of? (ज.) How many pen lifts does it take? (Two.) Which word did it come from? (साँझ.)

32.3 श — the letter you have been thanking people with

The hook from before: where did it sit, and what did it replace?

Today is a whole letter, and one you have been looking at since your first page.

Script you'll notice: श

श — *śa*, the *sh* of English *ship*.

What it is made of:

- a joined upper loop, descending outer curve, lower loop and diagonal tail
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

The left-hand side is more work than most letters ask for, and it is **all one run** — the pen does not come up until the tail is finished.

Script: the third sibilant

letter	**sound**
स	*sa*
ष	*ṣa*
श	*śa*

You could already draw two of the three. **This is the last one**, and with it the hissing letters are complete.

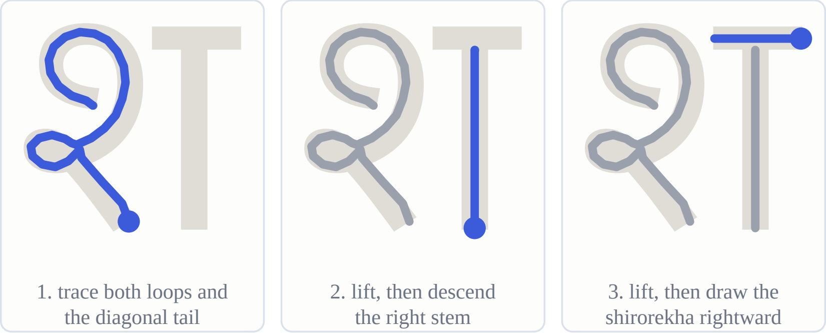
Words that have been yours from the start:

- **शुक्रिया** — thank you
- **शाम** — evening
- **शनिवार** — Saturday

The first of those was among the first words in the book, and the letter that opens it is only being drawn now. The opening chapters taught whole words, and the letters inside them went unnamed.

Writing: श

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



1. trace both loops and the diagonal tail

2. lift, then descend the right stem

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-श-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How श is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the upper loop’s lower inner tip, sweep left and clockwise around the upper loop, descend the outer curve, curl around the lower loop, and continue down-right through the diagonal tail without lifting
- **2.** lift and draw the right stem top-to-bottom
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2.

Verified three-stroke teaching form; everyday handwriting may join or simplify the body differently.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-श-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words and find श in each one

शुक्रिया · शाम

- *Trace it:* श three times, saying *śa* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* how many pen lifts the whole letter took

Before you move on

What sound does श carry? (*śa.*) Which three letters make the hissing set? Name the word of thanks it opens.

32.4 शुभ संध्या or नमस्ते? — choose by setting

Shubh sandhyā is structurally transparent. The final question is where Hindi speakers actually reach for it.

You'll want to know — Written warmth and casual speech

Like सुप्रभात, शुभ संध्या appears heavily in **written and social greeting-card culture**: greeting poetry, WhatsApp messages, and evening well-wishes. It is less likely to open an ordinary mid-conversation exchange.

नमस्ते works at any time of day, evenings included, and is more common in casual conversation than either *shubh prabhāt* or *shubh sandhyā*. The native language has divided the jobs: a Sanskrit "good _____" phrase for formal or written warmth, and another native greeting for everyday speech.

This is not English displacing a Hindi greeting. It is Hindi choosing between two of its own expressions by register and medium.

Your turn

- *Choose:* a WhatsApp evening card → शुभ संध्या
- *Choose:* greeting someone casually at 7 p.m. → नमस्ते
- *Say it:* "formal/written is a tendency, not an absolute ban"

Your turn — the evening word, from memory

- What does संध्या literally say, and from what? (**"Holding together"** — *sam-* + *dhā*, the junction of day and night.)
- What is its worn-down doublet, and is that the casual one? (साँझ *sāñjh*; **no** — it serves literary and everyday speech alike.)

Script — two letters from this chapter

शुभ संध्या · साँझ

- *Point to:* श in the greeting, then झ in साँझ
- Which letter is झ the breathy partner of, and which two complete the hissing set with श? (ज; स and ष.)

Before you move on

Where does शुभ संध्या especially thrive? (**Written and social greeting-card culture**.) Does नमस्ते genuinely work in the evening? (**Yes** — it works at any time and is common casually.) Is the distinction Hindi versus English? (**No** — it is a native register/ medium choice.)

Chapter 33

Good Afternoon

Modes: **voice** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 2 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can wish someone good afternoon in Hindi and say honestly how rarely शुभ दोपहर is actually used.
>
> *Say* शुभ दोपहर *with* दोपहर *in its widened sense, then rank it honestly below* नमस्ते/नमस्कार *for everyday afternoons.*

33.1 शुभ दोपहर (shubh dopahar) — "good afternoon," this arc's rarest greeting

> You already know दोपहर's meaning widened from "precisely noon" to "the afternoon." This greeting rides that widened sense — but it's the least commonly heard of the three you've now met.

You'll want to know — शुभ दोपहर — "good afternoon," using the widened sense

शुभ दोपहर (**shubh dopahar**) — "**good afternoon**" — pairs **शुभ** ("good") with **दोपहर** used in the **widened, modern sense** from last lesson: "the afternoon" generally, not the narrow etymological "exactly noon." Good news for consistency: this greeting confirms **दोपहर**'s widened meaning is the one people actually reach for here — nobody uses **शुभ दोपहर** to mean "good [precise instant of] noon."

शुभ is Sanskrit *śubha*, "bright, auspicious", a tatsama (CDIAL 12532).

You'll want to know — Be honest: the rarest of the three, not just another formal phrase

Here's the twist this lesson adds, verified independently rather than assumed from सुप्रभात or शुभ संध्या's pattern: of this arc's three शुभ+timeword greetings, **शुभ दोपहर is described as the rarest** in actual spoken use — even more so than the other two. Sources call it formal/written, note that casual alternatives like आपका दोपहर शुभ हो ("may your afternoon be good") exist but are themselves still uncommon, and confirm नमस्ते/नमस्कार do the real everyday greeting work across the whole afternoon, same as for morning and evening. This isn't just "another formal Sanskrit-style greeting" — it's the weakest-attested of the three, a genuine difference in **degree**, not just the same story repeated a third time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "shubh dopahar" — "good afternoon," using दोपहर's widened modern sense
- the honest ranking — of सुप्रभात, शुभ संध्या, and शुभ दोपहर, this one is the rarest in actual spoken use
- नमस्ते/नमस्कार — the real everyday greeting, covering afternoons too

Before you move on

Does शुभ दोपहर use दोपहर's narrow "noon" sense or its widened "afternoon" sense? (**The widened sense** — "good afternoon," not "good [exact] noon.") Is शुभ दोपहर the most, or least, commonly used of this arc's three शुभ+timeword greetings? (**Least** — described as the rarest of the three in actual spoken use.) What covers the real everyday afternoon greeting instead? (नमस्ते/नमस्कार.)

33.2 ौ — the same mark, one stroke more

Before the new one: झ — what sound does it carry?

Now look at दो and find the mark riding on the द. The new one is that mark with a second stroke added.

Script you'll notice: ौ

ौ — *au.*

It is a **vowel sign**, so it never stands alone: it attaches to a consonant and replaces the *a* built into it.

Where it sits: the **ā bar on the right, plus a double stroke above**.

Worked through: क + ौ = कौ — *kau.*

Script: the pair that differs by one stroke

mark	**sound**	**above the bar**
ो	o	one stroke
ौ	au	two strokes

The only difference is the count, which makes this the easiest mark in the script to misread and the easiest to fix: when you meet one, stop and count the strokes above the headline.

You already say these, and every one has ौ somewhere inside it:

- नौ — nine
- मौसम — weather
- चौदह — fourteen

Writing: ौ — copy what you see

Put your pen on ौ and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

> This book does not yet tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words and say which mark each one carries

  दो · नौ

- *Trace it:* ◌ौ three times, saying *au* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* the one thing that tells the two marks apart

Before you move on

What vowel does ◌ौ put on its consonant? (*au*.) How does it differ from ◌ो? (One more stroke above the bar.) Name a number you already say that contains it.

Chapter 34

Four Verbs of the Mind

Modes: 🚘 **voice** (1) 👁 **eyes** (3) 🚘 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I think, understand, read and write in Hindi, run all four through the present habitual, and say “Sorry, I don’t understand” when I need to.
>
> *Run* सोचना, समझना, पढ़ना *and* लिखना *through* मैं …ता/ती हूँ, *spell out* मेरा नाम *from the letters you first wrote by hand, and name the one meaning — to scratch — that four unrelated families each chose for “write”.*

34.1 सोचना — “to think,” its present forms, and an older grief

You can already run a Hindi verb: strip the **-ना**, keep the stem, add **-ता/-ती/-ते** and **होना**. Here is a verb worth running that machine on, because its history is a small shock.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सोचना (*sochnā*) = “**to think**.” It behaves itself completely: the infinitive ends in **-ना** like every Hindi verb, and the stem is **सोच-** (*soch-*). So **मैं सोचता हूँ** (*maiṁ sochtā hūṁ*, m.) / **मैं सोचती हूँ** (*sochtī*, f.) — “I think.” Respectfully, **आप सोचते हैं** (*āp sochte haiṁ*).
The stem is also a noun on its own. **सोच** (*soch*) means “**a thought**” — and, as often, “**worry**.” Hold on to that double meaning.

You'll want to know — thinking that started out as grieving

सोचना comes down from Sanskrit *śocyate*, "**is made to feel pain**" (CDIAL 12621), on the root शुच् (*śuc-*), "burn, grieve". Through Prakrit the sound softened and the sense drifted: *burn* → *be consumed by something* → *brood on it* → plain *think*. Hindi's ordinary word for thinking is an old word for sorrow that cooled down.

Be honest about the limits: शुच् has **no secure English cousin**, and inventing one would be worse than saying so.

What travels instead is the **shape** of the change. English **think** and **thank** are one Germanic root — to thank someone was to *think well of* them. Latin **pēnsāre** meant "**to weigh**," which is why English has **pensive**. Three families, and no mind-verb that began as "think."

Your turn

- *Say it (m.):* मैं सोचता हूँ (*maiṁ sochtā hūṁ*) · (f.): मैं सोचती हूँ (*maiṁ sochtī hūṁ*)
- *Say it:* "you (resp.) think" — आप सोचते हैं (*āp sochte haiṁ*)
- *Say it:* *nahīṁ* on its own, then slide it in front of the verb — मैं नहीं सोचता / सोचती (*maiṁ nahīṁ sochtā / sochtī*), "I don't think so." Hindi's negator sits **before** the verb, never after it
- *Say it:* the noun *soch*, and both things it means — a thought, and a worry

Before you move on

What did the root *śuc-* mean before it meant "think"? (**To burn, to grieve**.) Which everyday Hindi noun still carries both halves, and where does *nahīṁ* sit in *maiṁ nahīṁ sochtā*? (**सोच**, a thought *and* a worry; *nahīṁ* goes **before the verb**.) Is there an English cousin of *śuc-*? (**No**.)

34.2 समझना (samajhnā) — "to understand," which is to say "to wake up"

Sochnā got you thinking. This verb gets you the single most useful sentence a beginner owns — the one you say when you have **not** understood.

The letters in this word

स (*sa*) + म (*ma*) → सम; then झ (*jha*), the breathy pair of *ja*; then ना (*nā*). Read स · म · झ · ना → *samajhnā*. The झ is one puff of air heavier than a plain *j*, the same aspiration that separates Hindi's *k* from its *kh*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समझना (*samajhnā*) = "**to understand**." Stem **समझ-**, so मैं समझता हूँ (m.) / मैं समझती हूँ (f.), and respectfully आप समझते हैं.
Like *soch*, the bare stem is a noun: समझ (*samajh*) is "**understanding, sense, judgement**."
And the sentence to bank tonight: मैं नहीं समझता / समझती — "**I don't understand.**" Put माफ़ कीजिए in front of it and you have a complete, polite repair: *māf kījiye, maiṁ nahīṁ samajhtā* — "Sorry, I don't understand." Every word of that you already had.

You'll want to know — the root that gave the Buddha his name

The standard derivation takes समझना, *samajhnā*, back to Sanskrit सम् (*sam-*, "fully, together") + the root बुध् (*budh-*, "**to wake, to become aware**"). Older Hindi still says समुझना (*samujhnā*), and that surviving *-u-* is the fingerprint of *budh-* before it wore down.

So you already know this root in English, twice over, because English took the words whole:

- बुद्ध (*buddha*) — "**the one who woke up**." English **Buddha**.
- बोधि (*bodhi*) — the awakening itself; and बुद्धि (*buddhi*), intellect.

Further back, *budh-* rests on the reconstructed root ***bheudh-***, and its Germanic branch surfaces in English **bode**, **forebode** and **forbid** (*for-* + "announce"). Hindi's "I understand," then, is a claim to have woken up — and the Buddha's title is the same claim, made once and for all.

Your turn

- *Say it (m.): maiṁ samajhtā hūṁ* · (f.): *maiṁ samajhtī hūṁ*

- *Say it:* the repair, slowly — *māf kījiye, maiṁ nahīṁ samajhtā / samajhtī*
- *Say it: maiṁ sochtā hūṁ* then *maiṁ samajhtā hūṁ* — thinking, then getting it
- *Say it: buddha* and *bodhi*, and what *budh-* means underneath them (to wake)

Before you move on

What are the two pieces inside *samajhnā*? (सम् “fully” + बुध् “to wake.”) Say “Sorry, I don’t understand.” (*Māf kījiye, maiṁ nahīṁ samajhtā / samajhtī.*) Which famous title is built on the same root, and what does it mean? (**Buddha** — “the one who woke up.”)

34.3 पढ़ना (paṛhnā) — “to read,” and just as often “to study”

One verb, two English words. And one letter you have never had to say out loud before.

The letters in this word

प (*pa*), then ढ़, then ना (*nā*) → प · ढ़ · ना.

That middle letter is ढ (*ḍha*) wearing the **nuqtā** — the same small dot you met under फ़ in *māf*, Hindi’s mark for a sound the plain letter cannot carry. Dotted, ढ becomes a **flap**: curl the tongue back to the roof of the mouth and let it snap forward, with a breath behind it. That is **ṛh**. The word is *paṛhnā*, not *padhna*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पढ़ना (*paṛhnā*) = “**to read**” — and, with no change at all, “**to study**.”

Stem पढ़-: मैं पढ़ता हूँ (m.) / मैं पढ़ती हूँ (f.); आप पढ़ते हैं.

Two words grow straight off that stem, and both are everywhere in Indian life: पढ़ाई (*paṛhāī*) = “**studies, schooling**,” and पढ़ाना (*paṛhānā*) = “**to teach**” — literally “to cause to read.”

You'll want to know — reading, when reading meant reciting

The ancestor is Sanskrit पठति (*paṭhati*) — "**recites; reads aloud**." Not *scans a page*. Sanskrit's name for its oldest texts is श्रुति (*śruti*), "**that which is heard**": the Veda was memorised and spoken, and to "read" it was to say it. That is why one Hindi verb still covers reading and studying — for centuries they were the same act.

The sound wore down on the ordinary road: *paṭhati* → Prakrit *paḍhaï* → *paṛhnā*, the hard **ṭh** loosening between two vowels into the flap you just made.

And the honest note: **paṭh- has no secure Indo-European ancestry**. No English cousin, and possibly not an inherited Indo-Aryan word at all. Where the trail stops, this book stops with it.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the flap alone — *ṛh*, *ṛh* — then the whole word, *paṛhnā*
- *Say it (m.): maiṁ paṛhtā hūṁ* · (f.): *maiṁ paṛhtī hūṁ* — and mean both "I read" and "I study"
- *Say it:* do what the verb originally meant — recite **एक, दो, तीन, चार, पाँच, छह, सात, आठ, नौ, दस** aloud, one to ten, then say *maiṁ paṛhtā hūṁ*
- *Say it: maiṁ paṛhtā hūṁ*, then *maiṁ samajhtā hūṁ* — read it, then get it

Before you move on

What two English verbs does *paṛhnā* cover? (**Read** and **study**.) What did *paṭhati* mean, and why does that explain the pair? (**To recite aloud** — reading was saying.) Recite one to five in Hindi from memory. (*Ek, do, tīn, chār, pāṁch.*)

34.4 लिखना (likhnā) — "to write," which everywhere means "to scratch"

Reading has its verb. Here is the other half — and the chapter's four mind-verbs come back together at the end of it.

The letters in this word

ल (*la*) with the short ि → लि (*li*); then ख (*kha*); then ना (*nā*) → लि · ख · ना.

The ि is the one that runs ahead of itself: it is drawn to the **left** of ल but sounded **after** it, exactly as in हिंदी. Devanagari writes the mark first and your mouth says it second — *li*, never *il*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लिखना (*likhnā*) = "**to write**." Stem लिख-: मैं लिखता हूँ (m.) / मैं लिखती हूँ (f.); आप लिखते हैं.

Its Sanskrit ancestor is लिखति (*likhati*), and *likhati*'s first meaning is not "writes" at all. It is "**scratches, scrapes, furrows**." Writing entered the verb afterwards, once there was something to scratch a mark into.

You'll want to know — five families, one picture

Now the striking part. Ask what "write" meant before it meant writing, and the same answer comes back from languages that never borrowed it from each other:

- Sanskrit लिखति — to **scratch**.
- Latin **scrībere** — to **incise, cut**. English took **scribe**, **script**, **describe**, **manuscript** from it.
- Greek **gráphein** — to **scratch, carve**; behind **graph** and every **-graphy**. It is genuinely cousin to English **carve**.
- Old English **wrītan** — to **score, cut**; that is English **write** itself.

These are **four different roots**, not one worn four ways. Nobody handed this metaphor around. Four peoples with wax, stone, bark and bone each looked at their sharp tool and named the act after the damage it did. Hindi's verb is one of them, and it kept the older sense honestly enough that *likhati* still glosses as "scrapes."

Your turn

- *Say it (m.): maiṁ likhtā hūṁ* · (f.): *maiṁ likhtī hūṁ*

- *Say it:* the chapter in one breath — *maiṁ sochtā hūṁ, maiṁ samajhtā hūṁ, maiṁ paṛhtā hūṁ, maiṁ likhtā hūṁ*; then the same four as a woman, in *-tī*
- *Say it:* spell out **मेरा नाम**, the two words you first assembled by hand — **म**, the *e*-mātrā above it, **र**, the ā-tail; then **न**, ā, **म** — and finish with *maiṁ likhtā hūṁ*
- *Say it: likhati*, *scrībere*, *gráphein*, *wrītan* — and the one meaning all four started from (to scratch)

Before you move on

What did *likhati* mean first? (**To scratch**.) Are Sanskrit *likh-*, Latin *scrībere* and English *write* one root or four? (**Four** — the picture is shared, the word is not.) Run the chapter's four verbs in the *maiṁ … hūṁ* frame. (*Sochtā, samajhtā, paṛhtā, likhtā.*)

Chapter 35

Taking, Asking, Helping — and Liking

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I take, ask and help in Hindi, build a conjunct verb out of any noun plus करना, and say what I like the way Hindi says it — with the thing liked as the subject and me in the dative.
>
> *Say* लेना, पूछना *and* मदद करना, *then turn the sentence inside out:* मुझे रोटी पसंद है *is bread being pleasing to me, so* है *agrees with the bread and I move into* मुझे *— the same inversion Spanish and Italian reached on their own.*

35.1 लेना / ले / लेता / लेती / लेते — "to take" and its present forms

Four verbs of the mind are behind you. This chapter puts your hands back in the world — starting with the shortest verb in it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लेना (*lenā*) = "**to take**." Two syllables, and one of the most-used verbs in the language. Stem ले-: मैं लेता हूँ (m.) / मैं लेती हूँ (f.); आप लेते हैं. The pattern is regular: remove infinitive -ना, then add -ता for the masculine form, -ती for the feminine, or -ते for respectful आप and plural subjects. That gives ले → लेता / लेती / लेते.

It reaches further than English “take”. Offered a drink, a Hindi speaker answers मैं पानी लेता हूँ — “I’ll have water,” the same *lenā*. It pairs with its opposite in the fixed phrase लेन-देन (*len-den*), “**taking and giving**” — Hindi’s word for dealings, transactions, business between people.

You’ll want to know — the consonant that fell out

लेना looks too short to have a history. It has a long one. Sanskrit’s verb was लभते (*labhate*) — “**takes, obtains, receives**.” Through Prakrit *lahaï* the **-bh-** thinned to a breath and then vanished, and the two vowels left behind fused into the single **ले-** you now say. Almost the whole word eroded.

The proof is sitting in Hindi’s own vocabulary. लाभ (*lābh*) — “**profit, gain, benefit**” — was borrowed back from Sanskrit later, straight out of the books, so it never went through that erosion. Verb and noun are the same word at two different ages: one worn smooth by mouths, one preserved on the shelf.

Further out, the standard comparison lines *labh-* up with Greek **lambánein**, “to take” — and English quietly holds three of its descendants: a **syllable** is letters “taken together”; **epilepsy** is “a seizing upon”; so is **catalepsy**.

Your turn

- *Say it (m.): maiṁ letā hūṁ* · (f.): *maiṁ letī hūṁ*
- *Say it:* “you (resp.) take” — आप लेते हैं (*āp lete haiṁ*)
- *Say it:* accept a drink — *maiṁ pānī letā hūṁ*; then a meal — *maiṁ roṭī letā hūṁ*. Object first, verb last, as always
- *Say it: pānī* and what it literally means (the drinkable thing), then *roṭī*
- *Say it: lenā* and *lābh* one after the other — the same Sanskrit verb, worn down and preserved

Before you move on

Which Sanskrit verb is *lenā*, and which consonant did it lose? (लभते *labhate*; the **-bh-**.) Which Hindi noun still shows that consonant, and why? (लाभ — borrowed back from Sanskrit, so it never eroded.)

Give the stem, then the masculine, feminine, and respectful or plural forms. (ले; लेता / लेती / लेते.) Say “I’ll have water.” (*Maiṁ pānī letā / letī hūṁ.*)

35.2 व — the loop you have drawn before

Before the new one: श — how many runs did its left side take?

This one is easier, and its left side is a shape already in your hand.

Script you’ll notice: व

व — *va*, somewhere between an English *v* and *w*.

What it is made of:

- a counterclockwise left loop
- a top-to-bottom right stem
- the top shirorekhā

Look back at ग and you have seen this before: the same counterclockwise loop and the same right stem. What differs is where the loop sits and how it meets the stem.

Script: the last of the four

letter	sound
य	*ya*
र	*ra*
ल	*la*
व	***va***

These four sit between the consonants and the vowels — you shape them like consonants and they glide like vowels. Three were already yours. **This is the fourth**, and the set is complete.

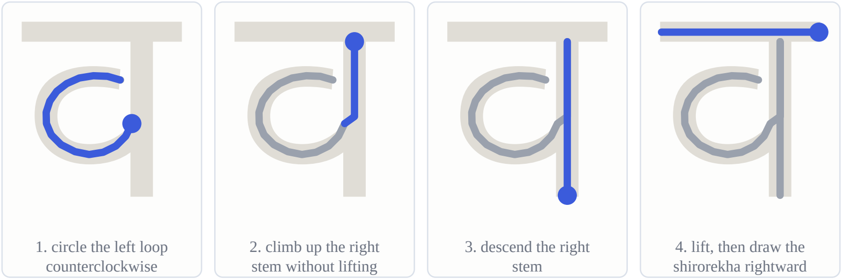
Words you have said since the beginning:

- धन्यवाद — thank you

- अलविदा — goodbye
- स्वागत — welcome
- सोमवार — Monday

Writing: व

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements



1. circle the left loop counterclockwise

2. climb up the right stem without lifting

3. descend the right stem

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after JackPotte, ‘Devanagari v व.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How व *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start at the upper-right of the body, travel left around the top, and continue counterclockwise around the loop to the right-side junction
- **2.** without lifting, climb up the right stem to the headline
- **3.** descend the right stem top-to-bottom
- **4.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 1. One fewer than श: the loop runs on into the right stem.

The source shows three movements; most native writers draw व in two strokes (69% of HP Labs India’s native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and direction, and lifts only before the headline.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: JackPotte, ‘Devanagari v व.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words and find व in each one

  धन्यवाद · अलविदा

- *Trace it:* व three times, saying *va* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* which letter you already draw that shares its loop

Before you move on

What sound does व carry? (*va*.) Which four letters glide between consonant and vowel? Name the word of thanks that ends in it.

35.3 पूछना / पूछ / पूछता / पूछती / पूछते — asking and English "pray"

You have been asking questions since chapter two. Here, at last, is the verb for doing it.

The letters in this word

प (*pa*) with the long ू hanging beneath it → पू (*pū*); then छ (*cha*), the breathy pair of *ca*; then ना (*nā*) → पू · छ · ना.

The **ū** is genuinely long, and छ takes a puff of air, one degree heavier than the च in *sochnā*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पूछना (*pūchnā*) = "**to ask**," in the sense of asking a **question**. Stem पूछ-: मैं पूछता हूँ (m.) / मैं पूछती हूँ (f.); आप पूछते हैं.
The pattern is regular: remove infinitive **-ना**, then add **-ता** for the masculine form, **-ती** for the feminine, or **-ते** for respectful आप and plural subjects. That gives पूछ → पूछता / पूछती / पूछते.
You already own a question — कितने साल के हो, "how many years are you of." Now you can name the act itself: मैं उम्र पूछता हूँ, "I ask (someone's) age." The thing asked about sits in front of the verb, where every object has gone.

You’ll want to know — asking a person, asking a god

Behind पूछना stands Sanskrit पृच्छति (*pṛcchati*, “asks”) and the reconstructed root ***prek-***, “**to ask**”:

- Latin **precārī**, “to beg, to entreat” — English **pray**, **prayer**, **deprecate**, **imprecation**.
- Latin **precārius**, “held at another’s pleasure” — English **precarious**.
- German **fragen**, Dutch **vragen** — everyday “to ask” to this day.

English’s inherited cousin, Old English **frignan**, died out; unrelated **ask** replaced it. The *prek-* word survived in English only as **pray**: asking a person and asking a god once shared a name.

Your turn

- *Say it (m.): maiṁ pūchtā hūṁ* · (f.): *maiṁ pūchtī hūṁ*
- *Say it:* “you (resp.) ask” — आप पूछते हैं (*āp pūchte haiṁ*)
- *Say it: maiṁ pūchtā hūṁ*, then *maiṁ letā hūṁ* — I ask, I take
- *Say it: pūchnā*, then **pray**, **precarious**, **fragen** — one root, three destinations

Before you move on

Which English verb is *pūchnā*’s true cousin — *ask* or *pray*? (**Pray** — *ask* is unrelated.) Give the stem, then the masculine, feminine, and respectful or plural forms. (**पूछ; पूछता / पूछती / पूछते**.) Say “I ask (someone’s) age.” (*Maiṁ umr pūchtā / pūchtī hūṁ.*)

35.4 मदद करना (madad karnā) — “to help,” and the machine that builds it

This one is not a verb. It is a noun with a verb attached — and once you spot the join, you can build hundreds more.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मदद (*madad*) is a **noun**: “**help, aid**.” On its own it does nothing. Bolt करना (*karnā*, “to do”) on the end and you have the verb मदद करना, *madad karnā* — literally “**to do help**.”
Only करना ever conjugates. The noun sits still:

- मैं मदद करता हूँ (m.) / मैं मदद करती हूँ (f.) — “I help.”
- आप मदद करते हैं — “you (resp.) help.”

This is the **conjunct verb**, and you have already used two without being told: काम करना, “to do work” = to work; and माफ़ कीजिए, “please do forgiveness” = sorry. One join, three verbs.

You’ll want to know — a stretched-out hand, and why the pattern matters

मदद is Arabic **madad**, on the root م-د-د (*m-d-d*), “**to stretch out, to extend**.” Help, in Arabic, is a thing **extended** toward you — the picture English reaches for when it *extends* a hand. It came into Hindi through **Persian**, the same road as उम्र (age) and माफ़ (forgiven).

State the gap plainly: English inherited **nothing** from *m-d-d*, and English **help** is a Germanic word unrelated to any of this. The picture is shared; the word is not.

Now why this matters more than one verb. A borrowed noun cannot be conjugated — Hindi would have to bend a foreign word through its own endings. With करना it never has to: the loan stays a frozen noun and native grammar does the work. That is how Hindi swallowed centuries of Persian and Arabic vocabulary without disturbing its verb system at all.

Your turn

- *Say it (m.): maiṁ madad kartā hūṁ* · (f.): *maiṁ madad kartī hūṁ*
- *Say it:* the three joins in a row — *kām karnā*, *māf karnā*, *madad karnā*; hear that only the second word ever moves
- *Say it: maiṁ pūchtā hūṁ*, then *maiṁ madad kartā hūṁ* — I ask, I help
- *Say it:* what *m-d-d* means underneath *madad* (to stretch out, extend)

Before you move on

Which half of *madad karnā* takes the endings? (करना — the noun never changes.) Name two conjunct verbs you had already used. (काम करना; माफ़ कीजिए.) Why does this pattern let Hindi borrow so freely? (The loan **stays a noun**; native *karnā* carries the grammar.)

35.5 पसंद (pasand) — Hindi does not like things; things please Hindi

Every verb so far let you be the one doing something. This last one takes that away.

You'll want to know — मुझे, the shape of "to me"

मुझे (*mujhe*) = "**to me**." It is what मैं ("I") becomes when the sentence will not let you be its subject. *Mujhe* is not "I."

Grammar Lens: the thing you like is the subject

मुझे रोटी पसंद है = "**I like bread**" — or, taken apart: मुझे ("to me") + रोटी ("bread") + पसंद ("pleasing") + है ("is"). "**To me, bread is pleasing.**"
रोटी is the **subject**, and that is what है agrees with. You are only the person it happens to. Hindi has no "I like bread" with *I* in front.
Two languages walked here alone: Spanish **me gusta el café** ("to me, the coffee pleases") and Italian **mi piace**. Those two are close cousins; Hindi is not, and nobody borrowed it. Two families, one decision — liking happens **to** you.

You'll want to know — a Persian word doing a verb's job

Because **पसंद is not a verb**. It is **Persian** — from پسندیدن (*pasandīdan*, "to approve, to find pleasing") — and it entered Hindi as a noun and adjective, "**liked, one's choice**." A non-verb cannot carry the person doing the liking, so the grammar put them elsewhere: मुझे.

It came by the Persian road that also gave you शाम (evening) — and see what these two chapters have shown. Hindi's verbs of the mind (*sochnā, samajhnā, paṛhnā, likhnā*) are inherited Indo-Aryan to a word, while *madad* and *pasand* — helping and liking — are borrowed. Thinking stayed home; the social vocabulary travelled.

For an active "like", Hindi uses last lesson's join: **पसंद करना**, "to do liking," nearer to "I choose, I prefer." For everyday liking, **मुझे … पसंद है**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mujhe roṭī pasand hai*, then the Hindi meaning — "to me, bread is pleasing"
- swap the thing, leaving *mujhe … pasand hai* untouched — *mujhe pānī pasand hai* · *mujhe kuttā pasand hai* · *mujhe shām pasand hai*
- the chapter end to end — *maiṁ letā hūṁ*, *maiṁ pūchtā hūṁ*, *maiṁ madad kartā hūṁ*, *mujhe roṭī pasand hai*
- *pasand karnā* beside *madad karnā* — one join, twice

Before you move on

In *mujhe roṭī pasand hai*, what is the subject? (**रोटी** — which is why it is *hai*.) What part of speech is *pasand*, and from where? (A **noun/adjective**, from **Persian** — not a verb.) Say "I like the dog," then what it literally means. (*Mujhe kuttā pasand hai* — "to me, dog is pleasing.")

Chapter 36

One House, Four Languages

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name a house, its door, a room and the chair I am offered, give each one the possessive its gender demands, and say where each of the four words came from — Sanskrit, Persian, Portuguese and Arabic.
>
> *Run* घर, दरवाज़ा, कमरा *and* कुर्सी *with the right possessive — and hear* मेरा *turn into* मेरी *at the first feminine noun, the promise chapter 2 made and never kept. Then name the four languages one room drew on, spell* कुर्सी *with its virāma and its conjunct, and say* नमस्ते *at the door coming in and* शुभ रात्रि *going out.*

36.1 घर (ghar) — "house," and the fence that came first

> You can say your name. Now say where you live — and meet the one thing every Hindi noun carries that English nouns do not.

The letters in this word

Two letters. घ (*gha*), the breathy pair of *ga*, then र (*ra*), already yours from मेरा.

र is the spineless one: no upright stroke of its own, so the शिरोरेखा, the head-line, is all that ties it to its neighbour. Both letters keep their inherent *a* → घर, *ghar*.

Grammar Lens: the word arrives with a gender

घर (*ghar*) = “**house, home**.” And it is **masculine**.

Every Hindi noun is masculine or feminine. Not the thing — the **word**: the gender is a fact about *ghar* the way its spelling is.

It is not decoration: it changes the words around the noun. Because *ghar* is masculine, “my house” is मेरा घर (*merā ghar*), the masculine मेरा, exactly as in मेरा नाम.

Whole sentence: घर मेरा है (*ghar merā hai*), “**the house is mine**.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घर comes from *ghara*, “house”, already in the Pali canon (CDIAL 4428). It is usually taken as the spoken form of Sanskrit गृह (*gṛha*), but CDIAL calls that sound change phonetically difficult: likely, not proven. Hindi kept गृह too, for formal use.

Further back, *gṛha* descends from an ancient root meaning **enclosure**, **$g^{h}erd^{h}$-** — and English holds two plain descendants of it: **yard** and **garden**. Slavic holds the *-grad* in **Belgrade**, “town.”

So, if the link holds, the oldest sense is not walls and a roof but **a fenced-in piece of ground**.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ghar* — house; then *merā ghar*; then *ghar merā hai*
- *merā nām* and *merā ghar* one after the other — the same *merā*, because both nouns are masculine
- the two letters, *gha* and *ra*, and which of them has no spine
- *gṛha*, then *ghar* — the Sanskrit shape and the worn one; then the old meaning, *enclosure*

Before you move on

Is घर masculine or feminine, and how do you know from the sentence? (**Masculine** — *merā*, not *merī*.) What did the root behind *gṛha* mean before it meant a building? (**An enclosure** — the root behind *yard* and *garden*.) Which of घ and र hangs from the head-line without a spine of its own? (र.)

36.2 दरवाज़ा (darvāzā) — the door, and the oldest word you already know

You have a house. This is what you stand at to be let into one — and it is where नमस्ते is said and where *śubh rātri* is said back.

The letters in this word

द · र · वा · ज़ा — and the ा you already write does two of the four.

The new mark is the dot under ज़: the **nuqta**. Plain ज is *ja*. Persian arrived carrying a **z** Devanagari had no letter for, so the script put a dot beneath the nearest shape and made one — ज़, *za*. The same dot makes फ़ (*fa*) and ख़, the sound in ख़ुशी.

A nuqta is a small confession in ink: *this sound came from somewhere else.*

Grammar Lens: the shape that usually tells you

दरवाज़ा (*darvāzā*) = "**door**," and it is **masculine** — so मेरा दरवाज़ा. Here is your first piece of help. A noun ending in long **-ā** is usually masculine, and *darvāzā* ends in -ा. Keep it as a lean, not a law: later chapters will show you where it fails, in both directions.

घर (*ghar*) ends in a consonant and is masculine too — so a consonant ending tells you nothing at all. That one you simply learn.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दरवाज़ा is **Persian**, دروازه (*darvāza*), and its first syllable is where this gets remarkable. Persian در (*dar*) means "**door**," and it descends from the ancient root ***dʰwer-*** — as do English **door**, Latin **forēs**, Greek **thúrā** and Sanskrit द्वार (*dvāra*).

Now the twist. Hindi *also* has द्वार (*dvār*), taken straight out of Sanskrit for formal use. So the borrowed Persian word and the learned Sanskrit one are **the same ancient word, arrived twice**, by two roads, centuries apart.

The **-vāza** part is less settled: usually connected to a Persian word for "**open**," but disputed, and worth leaving open.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *darvāzā*, then *merā darvāzā*, then *merā ghar* — one *merā*, two masculine nouns
- the arrival and the leaving at the same door — *namaste* going in, *shubh rātri* going out
- *ja*, then *za* — the letter, then the letter with the dot
- *dar*, *door*, *thúrā*, *dvāra* — one word, four languages

Before you move on

What does the dot under ज़ tell you? (That the sound is **borrowed** — Devanagari had no *z*.) Persian *dar* and English *door* — coincidence or cousins? (**Cousins**, from ***d^hwer-*** — and Hindi's own द्वार is the third.) Which ending gives you a fair guess at masculine? (**Long -ā**, as in *darvāzā*. A consonant ending, as in *ghar*, tells you nothing.)

36.3 कमरा (kamrā) — the room that is also a camera

Through the door, and into this. A short, ordinary word — which travelled to India by sea, on Portuguese ships.

The letters in this word

क · म · रा — and म (*ma*) is one of the first two letters you ever wrote, beside न.

Both of those hang from the head-line and both stand on a right-hand spine; that upright is what your eye follows along a line of Devanagari. क and र you have as well, so this word costs you nothing new — only the ा riding on the final र.

Grammar Lens: the lean holds

कमरा (*kamrā*) = "**room**," and it is **masculine** — मेरा कमरा.
Long **-ā**, masculine again, exactly as दरवाज़ा was. Three nouns in, and

the possessive has not changed once: *merā ghar*, *merā darvāzā*, *merā kamrā*.
Hold on to that flatness. It is about to break.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कमरा is neither Sanskrit nor Persian. It is **Portuguese** — **câmara**, "chamber, room" — left behind on India's western coast by the traders who ran that shore from the sixteenth century, along with चाबी (*chābī*, "key") and अलमारी (*almārī*, "cupboard").
Portuguese *câmara* is Latin **camera**, "a vaulted chamber," and Latin took it from Greek **kamára** — where the trail honestly stops; the Greek word's own origin is unknown.
Then the good part. English **camera** is that same Latin word: a *camera obscura* was literally a "dark room," and when the dark room shrank into a box the name went with it. And Hindi later borrowed it back through English as कैमरा (*kaimrā*) for the device.
So कमरा and कैमरा are the *same Latin word*, arrived twice by two different routes — the second time carrying a machine that did not exist when the first one landed.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kamrā*, then *merā kamrā*
- the three so far, in one breath — *merā ghar, merā darvāzā, merā kamrā*
- *kamrā* and *kaimrā* — one Latin word, two arrivals
- where each of the three came from — Sanskrit, Persian, Portuguese

Before you move on

Which language handed Hindi कमरा, and how did it get there? (**Portuguese**, by sea, on the western coast.) What does *kamrā* share with English *camera*? (**One Latin word**, *camera*, "vaulted chamber" — Hindi has it twice, as *kamrā* and *kaimrā*.) Say "my house, my door, my room." (*Merā ghar, merā darvāzā, merā kamrā.*)

36.4 कुर्सी (kursī) — sit down, and watch मेरा change

House, door, room — and now what you are offered once inside. This word breaks the pattern the other three set.

The letters in this word

कु · र् · सी — three old letters, क, र, स, and two working marks.

क takes ◌ु for *ku*. Then र with the **virāma**, the stroke that kills a consonant's built-in *a*: a bare र् cannot stand alone, so it fuses with the स, and the hook above स *is* that र — the fusing you met in स्त.

Then सी: the long ◌ी stands after its consonant and sounds after it, while ◌ि stands before and still sounds after. One of the two lies to your eye.

Grammar Lens: your first feminine noun

कुर्सी (*kursī*) = "**chair**," and it is **feminine**.
So मेरी कुर्सी, not *merā*. When you learnt मेरा you were told you would meet मेरी at your first feminine noun. Here it is.
Nothing about a chair is female. The gender belongs to the **word**, and it changes मेरा. Get it wrong and every word beside the noun goes wrong too.

Grammar Lens: the lean, and where it leans wrong

The rule of thumb: **long -ā tends masculine, long -ī tends feminine, a consonant ending tells you nothing.** A lean, not a law: *darvāzā*, *kamrā* and *kursī* obey it, *ghar* sits outside it, and later words will disobey it outright.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कुर्सी is **Arabic**, كرسي (*kursī*), "seat, throne," reaching Hindi through **Persian**, the road most Arabic words took.
Arabic did not invent it either. It has passed along the Near East for four thousand years: Sumerian **guza**, Akkadian **kussû**, then Ugaritic, Hebrew and Aramaic, Arabic most likely taking it from **Aramaic**. Not one family — the word crossed between unrelated families because the object did.

English **chair**? Greek **kathédra**, through Latin and French. No relation at all.
And what this chapter has done: **घर** Sanskrit, **दरवाज़ा** Persian, **कमरा** Portuguese, **कुर्सी** Arabic. One room, four languages — that is Hindi, not an accident of these four words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *merī kursī*, then *merā kamrā* — one possessive, two shapes
- the chapter — *merā ghar, merā darvāzā, merā kamrā, merī kursī*
- each word's source — Sanskrit, Persian, Portuguese, Arabic
- *namaste* at the *darvāzā*, then *shubh rātri* at the same door

Before you move on

Why **मेरी कुर्सी**? (**कुर्सी is feminine**; the possessive agrees with the noun.) How far back does *kursī* go, and did it stay in one family? (**Sumerian** — and no, it crossed unrelated families.) Name the chapter's four sources. (**Sanskrit, Persian, Portuguese, Arabic**.)

Chapter 37

One Tea, Please

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 👁 **eyes** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for tea, milk, food or a book in the words Hindi speakers actually use rather than the dictionary's, I know that कृपया belongs on a sign and दीजिए in the street, and I can name which of the four nouns take मेरी.
>
> *Ask for all four —* एक चाय दीजिए, एक दूध दीजिए, खाना दीजिए, *and the* किताब *that is* मेरी *— then unpack the Arabic root k-t-b into book, scribe and school, and place* कृपया *where it belongs, beside* पुस्तक *at the formal end of the language.*

37.1 चाय (chāy) — tea, and how to actually ask for one

You are in the chair, in the room Portuguese named. Somebody is about to offer you this — and by the end of these few minutes you will be able to ask for it yourself, in the words people actually use.

Grammar Lens: the lean fails, quietly

चाय (*chāy*) = "**tea**," and it is **feminine**.
Nothing outside the word says so. It does not end in **-ी** the way कुर्सी does; it ends in a consonant, and the lean warned you a consonant ending tells you nothing. चाय is feminine and you simply learn it — now, with the word.

You’ll want to know — how you really ask

एक चाय दीजिए (*ek chāy dījie*) — “**one tea, please**.”

दीजिए is “give” spoken to आप: the polite request form. That **-िए** ending *is* the politeness. Nothing else is needed.

Which means a correction. You learnt कृपया as “please,” and it is a real word — but it belongs to **signs, forms and station announcements**. Across a counter it lands like *kindly furnish me with tea.*

So: कृपया when you write, दीजिए when you speak. And you already have the shape — माफ़ कीजिए carries the very same **-िए**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चाय is **Chinese**. In most of China the word for the leaf is **chá**, which Persian took as چای (*chāy*) and Hindi borrowed.

Now the English word: **tea**. French **thé**, Dutch **thee** — a different sound entirely, for the identical leaf.

They are the same word. China writes it with one character everywhere, but reads that character differently: in the Hokkien of the south-eastern coast it is **tê**, and Dutch ships bought their tea *there.*

The tempting story is overland versus sea. It is wrong: Portuguese say **chá**, and Portuguese tea came by sea. The variable is **which Chinese port a trader dealt with**. Your word for tea records a harbour.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *chāy*; then *ek chāy dījie*
- the same request for water — *ek pānī dījie*
- *dījie* and *māf kījie* one after the other — hear the shared *-ie*
- *chā* and *tê* — the two Chinese pronunciations, and which one English bought

Before you move on

Is चाय masculine or feminine, and does its ending help? (**Feminine** — and no, a consonant ending never does.) Where does कृपया belong, and what carries the politeness when you speak? (**Signs**

and announcements — in speech the **-िए** of *dījie* does it.) Are *chāy* and *tea* related? (**The same Chinese word**, bought at two different ports.)

37.2 दूध (dūdh) — “milk,” which is really a verb wearing a noun’s coat

What goes into the tea. And it is named the same sly way पानी was — by what happens to it, not by what it is.

Grammar Lens: the pair that disagrees

दूध (*dūdh*) = “**milk**,” and it is **masculine**.
Which makes these two a useful pair, because they sit side by side in every cup and disagree: चाय feminine — the leaf that came by way of a Chinese port — and दूध masculine. Both end in consonants. Neither ending tells you anything. This is the ordinary state of a Hindi noun, and it is why the gender is part of the word, not an afterthought.
एक दूध दीजिए — same request, new noun.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दूध comes from Sanskrit दुग्ध (*dugdha*) — and *dugdha* is not a noun at all. It is a **past participle** of the verb दुह् (*duh-*), “to milk.” It means “**milked**.”
So the substance is named for the act. Somebody said “the milked” often enough that the adjective hardened into a thing. You have seen this exact move already: पानी is *pānīya*, “**the drinkable**.” Hindi’s two commonest liquids are both named by what is done to them.
Behind *duh-* stands the old root **d^hewg^h-**, and its meaning is broader than milk: “**to yield, to be strong, to be of use**.” Greek **teúkhein**, “to produce,” is from it, and so is English **doughty**, “stout, valiant.” One trap, since the shape invites it: English **dough** is **not** related. It comes from a different root meaning “to knead, to form.” *Dūdh* and *dough* look like cousins and are strangers.

Your turn

- *Say it: dūdh*; then *ek dūdh dījie*

- *Say it:* the disagreeing pair — *chāy* feminine, *dūdh* masculine
- *Say it:* what each one literally is — *dugdha*, "the milked"; *pānīya*, "the drinkable"
- *Say it:* *dūdh* and *dough* — and that they are not related
- *Recall:* say *lenā*, then say *pūchnā*
- *Read it:* मदद करना

Before you move on

What part of speech was *dugdha* before it was milk? (**A past participle** — "milked.") Which Hindi word plays the same trick, and how? (पानी — *pānīya*, "the drinkable thing.") Is English *dough* a cousin of *dūdh*? (**No** — different root; *doughty* is the real one.)

37.3 खाना (khānā) — "food," and the dot that separates it from a house

Drink is behind you. This is the general word for what you eat — and it has a twin on the page that means something else entirely.

The letters in this word

खा · ना — two syllables, and the ा does both.

ख (*kha*) takes ा → खा. Then न (*na*), your very first letter, takes ा → ना. The ा is the mātrā that replaces a consonant's built-in *a* with a long one, exactly as in नाम.

Two consonants, one mark used twice, and the word is yours.

Grammar Lens: one word doing two jobs

खाना (*khānā*) = "**food**," and it is **masculine** — long **-ā**, and this time the lean holds. Unlike दूध, whose name is a participle, this one is plainly a thing.

It is also the verb "**to eat**." Same spelling, same sound: the infinitive doubles as a noun, the way English says *the eating was good.*

So खाना दीजिए is "give me food," and खाना alone can be the act. Which one you mean, the sentence decides.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Both come from Sanskrit खाद् (*khād-*), “to eat” — the noun through खादन (*khādana*), “the act of eating, food,” and the verb through खादति (*khādati*), “eats.”

Now the twin. Hindi also has ख़ाना (*khāna*) — with the **nuqta** under the first letter — and it is **Persian**, خانه (*xāna*), “**house, compartment, section**.” You meet it inside दवाख़ाना (*davākhāna*), a “medicine-house”: a pharmacy.

Two unrelated words, one from Sanskrit and one from Persian, separated on the page by a single dot. And here is the honest part: **that dot is very often left off**. In ordinary printing and handwriting both are simply written खाना, and the reader is expected to sort it out from context. The nuqta tells you where a sound came from — when somebody bothers to write it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *khānā*; then *khānā dījie*
- the three requests together — *ek chāy dījie, ek dūdh dījie, khānā dījie*
- *roṭī* and *khānā* — the particular bread and the general word for food
- *khānā* and *khāna* — food and house; then *davākhāna*, the medicine-house

Before you move on

What two jobs does खाना do? (**Food**, and the verb **to eat**.) What is ख़ाना, and where does it come from? (**House, compartment** — Persian خانه, as in *davākhāna*.) Can you always tell them apart on the page? (**No** — the nuqta is often dropped, and context decides.)

37.4 किताब (kitāb) — a book, and the root it is cut from

Not something to eat — something to ask for. Its Arabic root hands you three more words free.

The letters in this word

कि · ता · ब — the first mark is the tricky one.

क with the short ि gives कि (*ki*): the ि is drawn to the left of क and sounded **after** it, never *ik*. Then ता, then ब keeping its built-in *a*.

क and त showed you Devanagari's mouth-map: क far back at the soft palate, त at the teeth. Say *ki-tā-b* and feel the tongue travel.

Grammar Lens: feminine, and no ending to prove it

किताब (*kitāb*) = "**book**," and it is **feminine** — मेरी किताब.
The second consonant-final noun to turn out feminine, after चाय. Two of this chapter's four disobey any guess their shape allows.
Which is the real lesson: **Hindi gender is information about the word, not the thing and not the spelling.**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

किताब is **Arabic**, كتاب, come by the Persian road कुर्सी took.
Arabic builds words on **three-consonant roots**, and this one is **k-t-b**, "write." Slot those three into different patterns and a family appears:

- كتاب *kitāb* — a **book**, the thing written.
- كاتب *kātib* — a **scribe**, the one writing.
- مكتب *maktab* — a **place** of writing: an office, a school.

Learn the root and you have a family, which is how much of Hindi's Perso-Arabic vocabulary is built underneath.

You'll want to know — three books, three registers

Hindi has three words for a book, and they are not synonyms — they are **registers**.

- किताब — Perso-Arabic, the ordinary word. Say this one.
- पुस्तक (*pustak*) — straight out of Sanskrit. Libraries, textbooks, formal writing.
- पोथा (*pothā*) — the inherited descendant of that Sanskrit word. Old, homely, a bit dusty.

You have met this split: कृपया is the *pustak* end of “please,” दीजिए the *kitāb* end.

And that is the chapter — चाय from a Chinese port, दूध named for what was done to it, खाना shadowed by a Persian house, किताब cut from an Arabic root.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kitāb*, then *merī kitāb*
- the chapter’s four — *merī chāy, merā dūdh, merā khānā, merī kitāb*
- the k-t-b family — *kitāb*, *kātib*, *maktab*
- *kṛpayā* for the sign; *ek chāy dījie* and *māf kījie* for the street

Before you move on

Which two words here are feminine, and does their shape say so? (चाय and किताब — no, both end in consonants.) Give the k-t-b family. (*Kitāb*, *kātib*, *maktab*.) Which word for “book” do you say, and which belongs with कृपया? (किताब — पुस्तक is the formal one.)

Chapter 38

Six Words for Where It Hurts

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 👁 **eyes** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name six parts of my body, say that one of them is not well, and tell which three are word-for-word cousins of their English translations — and which one has no traceable ancestry at all.
>
> *Say all six body words with the possessive each one demands —* मेरा सिर*,* मेरा हाथ*,* मेरी आँख*,* मेरा दाँत*,* मेरा पैर*,* मेरा पेट *— then say* मेरा पेट ठीक नहीं है*, and separate the three exact Indo-European cousins from the two words,* पेट *and* रोटी*, whose histories genuinely stop.*

38.1 आँख (āṁkh) — the eye, which is the same word in English

You have a head and a hand. Here is the part of the face — and this one is not merely *related* to its English translation. It is the same word.

The letters in this word

आँ · ख — and the mark on top is an old friend.

आ is the standalone long *ā*. Over it sits ँ, the **chandrabindu**, the moon-dot, which sends the vowel up through the nose — exactly what it does in हाँ. Then ख (*kha*), breathy, with its inherent *a* still attached.

So the word is a nasalised *ā* followed by *kh*: **āṁkh**, humming at the start.

Grammar Lens: feminine, and one you will use daily

आँख (*āṁkh*) = “**eye**,” and it is **feminine** — मेरी आँख.
Third feminine noun, third consonant ending: चाय, किताब, आँख. If you were still hoping the spelling would rescue you, let this settle it.
And it is worth the effort, because these are the words a doctor asks about. मेरी आँख ठीक नहीं है — “my eye is not well.”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आँख comes from Sanskrit अक्षि (*akṣi*), “eye” — and *akṣi* comes from the root ***h_3ek^w-***, which is one of the securest words in the whole family. Its descendants:

- Latin **oculus** — inside English **ocular**, **monocle**, **binoculars**.
- Old English **ēage**, which is English **eye** itself.
- Lithuanian **akìs**, Armenian **akn**, and Greek **ósse**, the old dual form meaning “the two eyes.”

A caution on the Greek, because the obvious candidate is a trap: **ophthalmós** is *usually* connected here, but its first part has never been explained, and serious opinion treats it as a pre-Greek word. Cite **ósse** and stay honest.
हाथ had to travel a long, battered road from *hasta*. आँख barely travelled at all — *akṣi* to *āṁkh* is a short, clean walk, and at the far end of it an English speaker is saying a version of the same word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *āṁkh*, then *merī āṁkh*
- the three body words you now have — *sir*, *hāth*, *āṁkh*
- *hāṁ* and *āṁkh* — the same moon-dot, the same hum
- *akṣi*, *oculus*, *eye* — one root, three languages

Before you move on

Is आँख masculine or feminine? (**Feminine** — *merī āṁkh.*) Which Greek word is the safe cousin, and which is the trap? (**ósse** is safe; **ophthalmós** is unexplained.) What does the ँ over the आ do, and where did you first meet it? (**Nasalises** the vowel — on हाँ.)

38.2 दाँत (dāṁt) — the tooth, and the gender trap of this chapter

Built like the last word, spelled like the last word, and the opposite gender. This is the pair learners get wrong most often.

The letters in this word

दाँ · त — three known parts and no new letter at all.

द (*da*) takes ा, and the ँ rides above the head-line for the nasal hum — the same **chandrabindu** that turns ह into हाँ, "yes." Then त (*ta*).

Both द and त are made at the **teeth** — which is the whole point of Devanagari's mouth-map. The word for *tooth* is spelled with the two consonants your tongue makes *against your teeth.* Say *dāṁt* and feel where it happens.

Grammar Lens: the trap

दाँत (*dāṁt*) = "**tooth**," and it is **masculine** — मेरा दाँत.
Now put the two side by side. आँख and दाँत: same long *ā*, same chandrabindu, same single final consonant, both parts of the body, both everyday. आँख is feminine. दाँत is masculine.
There is no rule underneath that. There is no reasoning that gets you from one to the other. This is the pair to hold up whenever you are tempted to guess: मेरी आँख, मेरा दाँत.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दाँत is Sanskrit दन्त (*danta*), from ***h$_3$dónts*** — and like *akṣi* this is one of the family's best-attested words.

- Latin **dēns**, stem *dentis* — English **dentist**, **dental**, **trident** (a "three-tooth").

- Greek **odoús** — English **odontology**.
- Old English **tōþ**, which is **tooth**.

Two body parts in a row, both plain cousins of their English translations. That is not a coincidence about eyes and teeth; it is what a core inherited vocabulary looks like from the inside.
And the older reading of ***$h_3$dónts*** makes it a participle of ***$h_3$ed-***, “to bite” — so a tooth is “**the biting one**,” which is what खाना needs it for. Same move as दूध, “the milked one”: name the thing after what happens.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *dāṁt*, then *merā dāṁt*
- the trap pair, twice — *merī āṁkh, merā dāṁt*; again
- *hāṁ*, then *dāṁt* — the same moon-dot doing the same job
- *danta*, *dēns*, *odoús*, *tooth* — one word, four languages
- the two “named for the action” words — *dugdha*, the milked; the tooth, the biting one

Before you move on

आँख and दाँत look alike — do they share a gender? (**No** — *merī āṁkh*, *merā dāṁt*.) Which English words carry the Latin form? (**Dentist**, **dental**, **trident**.) What does the older reading make a tooth? (**The biting one** — from a root meaning “to bite.”)

38.3 पैर (pair) — the foot, and the ancestor it does not have

Down from the head, past the hand, to what carries you. And this word’s obvious ancestor turns out to belong to a different Hindi word.

Grammar Lens: masculine, and the sentence that uses it

पैर (*pair*) = “**foot**,” and it is **masculine** — मेरा पैर.
The ◌ै is a single mātrā for one vowel, *ai* — not *a* then *i*. One sign, one sound, sitting above the head-line on प.
Now the sentence you would actually say to a doctor, using the नहीं you already have: मेरा पैर ठीक नहीं है — “**my foot is not well**.” Watch the नहीं sit directly before है, which is where Hindi puts its negation.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Here is the obvious guess, and it is wrong. Sanskrit has पाद (*pāda*), “foot” — long *ā*, famous, the source of English’s borrowed *pada-* words. It looks like it must be the parent of *pair*. It is not.
पाँव (*pāṁv*), Hindi’s *other* everyday word for foot, is the descendant of पाद. पैर comes from the shorter Sanskrit stem पद् (*pad-*), through Prakrit *paya*, picking up a Middle Indo-Aryan **-ra-** ending on the way. So Hindi inherited the same body part **twice**, down two different stems of the same word — and both survive, side by side, meaning the same thing.
Further back both are ***ped-***, “to walk, to tread”:

- Latin **pēs**, stem *pedis* — **pedal**, **pedestrian**, **pedicure**.
- Greek **poús**, stem *podós* — **podium**, and the eight of an **octopus**.
- Old English **fōt**, which is **foot**.

Three body words in three lessons, and every one of them is the same word your own language uses. हाथ had to be argued for through a sound change. These three simply *are* the cousins.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *pair*, then *merā pair*
- the four body words with their possessives — *merā hāth, merī āṁkh, merā dāṁt, merā pair*
- *merā pair ṭhīk nahīṁ hai* — and hear where the *nahīṁ* sits

- which Hindi word came from *pāda*, and which from *pad-* (*pāṁv*; *pair*)

Before you move on

Does पैर come from पाद? (**No** — from पद्; पाँव is the *pāda* one.) Which English words carry the Latin and Greek forms? (**Pedal**, **pedestrian**; **podium**, **octopus**.) Say "my foot is not well," and say where नहीं goes. (*Merā pair ṭhīk nahīṁ hai* — immediately before है.)

38.4 पेट (peṭ) — the belly, and a trail that genuinely stops

> Three clean cousins in a row. This one breaks the run — and the break is worth more than another neat answer.

The letters in this word

पे · ट — one known letter, one known mātrā, one consonant to feel.

प takes ◌े, the mātrā that perches on the head-line and turns the built-in *a* into *e* — the second of the two vowel signs you practised on नाम and मेरा.

Then ट: a **retroflex** *ṭ*, tongue-tip curled back, not the त of दाँत made flat against the teeth. Say *dāṁt*, then *peṭ*.

Grammar Lens: masculine, and the whole set together

पेट (*peṭ*) = "**stomach, belly**," and it is **masculine** — मेरा पेट.
Now you can answer a doctor, and exactly one of the six takes मेरी: *merā sir*, *merā hāth*, **merī āṁkh**, *merā dāṁt*, *merā pair*, *merā peṭ* — feminine company for कुर्सी and किताब.
The sentence, with नहीं in its usual place just before है: मेरा पेट ठीक नहीं है — which, said in India, means what it says and rather more.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पेट goes back to Prakrit पेट्ट (*peṭṭa*) — and there the clean line ends. The mainstream account treats it as a **Dravidian** word taken into Indo-Aryan; compare reconstructed Dravidian ***poṭṭ-**. Turner's comparative dictionary does not name Dravidian, but neither does he derive *peṭṭa* from any Sanskrit word: he only remarks that it sits close to Indo-Aryan words for "**basket**." That resemblance is a note, not a derivation, and it is often quoted as one.

So: **the origin of पेट is unsettled**, with Dravidian leading — the honesty रोटी needed, one lesson away from पानी, whose story is exact. A language is made of what people said, and some of that came from neighbours speaking something else.

There is even a fingerprint: the **retroflex** consonants, the ट you just curled your tongue for, are the feature of Indian Indo-Aryan most often credited to long contact with Dravidian.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all six — *merā sir, merā hāth, merī āṁkh, merā dāṁt, merā pair, merā peṭ*
- *merā peṭ ṭhīk nahīṁ hai*; then *merī āṁkh ṭhīk nahīṁ hai*
- every feminine noun you own — *kursī*, *chāy*, *kitāb*, *āṁkh*
- the three exact ancestries — *āṁkh*, *dāṁt*, *pair*; then the two unsettled — *peṭ*, *roṭī*

Before you move on

Where does पेट come from? (**Unsettled** — Prakrit *peṭṭa*, most likely a **Dravidian** loan; the "basket" link is a resemblance.) Of your six body words, which takes मेरी? (आँख.) Which earlier word had the same honest dead end? (रोटी, beside पानी.)

Chapter 39

The People Around You

Modes: 🎧 **voice** (3) 👁 **eyes** (1) ✎ **pen** (1) 🎧 **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the friend, the child, the man and the woman around me, I know that दोस्त takes its possessive from the person while आँख never does, and I can choose between औरत and महिला by register.
>
> *Say the whole household with every possessive right —* मेरा पिता, मेरी माता, मेरा भाई, मेरी बहन, मेरा बच्चा, मेरी बच्ची *— then* मेरा दोस्त *or* मेरी दोस्त *depending on who the friend is, and say why Arabic* ^{c}*awra does not mean "woman" even though* औरत *does.*

39.1 दोस्त (dost) — the friend, who is "the one chosen"

You can name a brother and a sister. Here is the person you picked rather than were given, and the word says exactly that.

The letters in this word

दो · स्त — an ending you have already assembled by hand.

द with ◌ो gives दो. Then स्त — स stripped of its built-in *a* by the **virāma**, fusing with त into one conjunct: the cluster inside नमस्ते, the first conjunct you ever wrote.

So मेरा दोस्त is built entirely from strokes already yours.

Grammar Lens: the noun that leans on who you mean

दोस्त (*dost*) = “**friend**,” and in the dictionary it is **masculine** — मेरा दोस्त.

But it bends. When the friend is a woman, ordinary modern Hindi says मेरी दोस्त. The word has not changed shape; the **possessive** followed the person. Both are current; neither is a mistake.

That is unlike everything so far. आँख is feminine whatever you mean. दोस्त takes its gender from **who the friend is**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दोस्त is **Persian**, دوست (*dōst*); Old Persian had **dauštā**, an agent noun, “**the one held dear**.”

Its root is ***ǵews-***, and the old meaning is not “love” but “**to taste, to try, to choose**.” Sanskrit inherited it as जुष् (*juṣ-*). Latin has **gustāre** — English **gusto**, **disgust** — and English **choose** is the same root.

So a *dōst* is one you have **tried and chosen**; the narrowing to “beloved” happened inside the Indo-Iranian branch alone.

You’ll want to know — why it starts with a d

The consonant at the front of this root came out as **z-** in Avestan and **d-** in **Old Persian**, by a regular sound law across the vocabulary.

Which is why “friend” starts with द in Persian and Hindi while its Sanskrit cousin *juṣ-* starts with something else. An initial consonant is a passport stamp: it says which road the word came by.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *merā dost* for a man, *merī dost* for a woman
- the given and the chosen — *merā bhāī, merī bahin, merā dost*
- *namaste*, then *dost* — one conjunct
- *dōst*, *juṣ-*, *gustāre*, *choose*

Before you move on

How do you say “my friend” about a woman? (मेरी दोस्त — the possessive follows the person.) What did the root behind *dōst* first mean? (**To taste, try, choose**.) Why does Persian say *d-* where Avestan says *z-*? (**A regular sound law**.)

39.2 बच्चा / बच्ची / बछड़ा — children and the inherited “yearling”

You have पिता and माता. Here is the third person at that table.

Grammar Lens: a pair you can see

बच्चा (*bacchā*) = “**child**,” **masculine** — मेरा बच्चा.
Swap the final **-◌ा** for **-◌ी** and you get बच्ची (*bacchī*), a girl child, **feminine** — मेरी बच्ची.
This is what दरवाज़ा and कुर्सी only hinted at: for *this* class of noun **-ā**/**-ī** is not a lean but the machinery, and the word changes with the person. Which is exactly what दोस्त would not do.
You already know how to ask this child’s age: **कितने साल के हो?** — how many years someone *is of*, rather than how many they *have*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बच्चा is usually traced to **Persian**, بچه (*bacca*), and the obvious story about it is wrong.
Persian *bacca* did **not** come from Sanskrit वत्स (*vatsa*), “calf.” They are **sisters**, one Indo-Iranian word down two branches, and Hindi had *already* inherited the Sanskrit one as बछड़ा (*bachṛā*), “calf” (CDIAL 11241 records it as *bacheṛā*, under *vatsatara*).
So Hindi holds both, one word by two roads, as with दरवाज़ा and द्वार, through the Persian relay that brought दोस्त.
Behind both stands ***wet-***, “**year**”: Latin **vetus**, “old,” and **vitulus**, “calf,” and English **wether**, a yearling sheep.
CDIAL offers another road: it sets Panjabi *baccā*, “child”, under Sanskrit *apatya*, “offspring” (CDIAL 424), and its addenda beside Persian *bača* (CDIAL 14226). Hindi is listed in neither, so the Persian road is usual, not settled.

On that road, a child is a **yearling**, named by age, where पिता and माता are named by relationship.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bacchā* and *bacchī*; then *merā bacchā*, *merī bacchī*
- the family — *merā pitā, merī mātā, merā bacchā*
- the two roads — *bacchā* usually from Persian, *bachṛā* inherited; one word
- *vetus*, *vitulus*, *wether* — and the meaning under all of them (year)

Before you move on

What is the feminine of बच्चा, and how does the possessive move? (बच्ची — *merā bacchā*, *merī bacchī*.) Is Persian *bacca* descended from Sanskrit *vatsa*? (**No** — they are **sisters**; Hindi's inherited cousin is बछड़ा.) What does the root mean? (**Year** — a child is a yearling.)

39.3 आदमी (ādmī) — the man, and the lean breaking backwards

The child has grown up. And this word does what none so far has — it ends in -ी and is masculine anyway.

Grammar Lens: the lean breaks the other way

आदमी (*ādmī*) = "**man, person**," and it is **masculine**. Say एक आदमी — it is also the ordinary word for "person" in general, and stays masculine doing that. Ask कितने साल के हो? of him and you are asking how many years he *is of*, the way Hindi counts age.
A warning before you reach for the possessive: मेरा आदमी is real Hindi but means what English's *my man* means. Keep एक आदमी.
The gender still shows the instant anything agrees with the noun. Put it beside कुर्सी: both end in long -ी, one is feminine, one masculine, and no reasoning takes you from the ending to the answer. Beside बच्चा /

बच्ची, where the ending *does* carry the gender, the contrast is sharper. So the lean has failed in **both** directions: **चाय** and **किताब** feminine with no **-ी**, **आदमी** masculine with one.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आदमी is **Arabic**, آدمي (*ādamī*), and it came the Persian way — the road of **कुर्सी** and **किताब**.

Now the ending. That **-ī** is not Hindi at all. It is the **Arabic ending meaning "belonging to, of the kind of."** Attach it to آدم (*Ādam*) and you get "**of Adam**." A human being, in this word, is one of Adam's.

آدم is Hebrew ***ʾādām***, and here care is needed. You have probably heard that *ʾādām* comes from ***ʾadāmāh***, "ground" — man made of earth. Genesis sets the two side by side and means you to notice: a **deliberate pun**, and a famous one.

It is not the etymology. The prevailing view links the root **ʾ-d-m** to **redness** — behind Hebrew *ʾādōm*, "red," and **Edom**. Beyond that, unsettled.

Worth keeping: **a wordplay a text makes on purpose is not where a word came from.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ādmī*, then *ek ādmī*
- *kursī* feminine, *ādmī* masculine; then *merī kursī*, and stop
- the lean, and both ways it fails — *chāy*, *kitāb*, *ādmī*
- what the **-ī** on *ādamī* means

Before you move on

कुर्सी and **आदमी** end alike — same gender? (**No**.) What is the **-ī** of *ādamī* doing? (**Arabic "belonging to"** — "of Adam.") Is *ʾādām* from the word for ground? (**No** — Genesis is making a deliberate pun; the root is usually connected to **redness**.)

39.4 औरत (aurat) — the word for “woman,” and which one to use

The last word of the chapter, and the one where Hindi hands you a choice rather than a word.

Grammar Lens: the pair, and the family complete

औरत (*aurat*) = “**woman**,” and it is **feminine**. Say एक औरत — and for the reason एक आदमी was the safe phrase, leave मेरी औरत alone: it means *my woman*, a wife. औ is one vowel letter, *au*, standing alone. Consonant ending, feminine — as चाय, किताब and आँख were. Beside it आदमी: -ी ending, masculine. Neither adult’s gender is reachable from spelling. Where you *can* hear the agreement is on the child: मेरा बच्चा, मेरी बच्ची, the yearling who takes the ending seriously.

The family: पिता, माता, *bhāī*, बहन, बच्चा, आदमी, औरत — and the chosen one, दोस्त.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

औरत is **Arabic**, عورة (*^{c}awra*), on the three-consonant root **^{c}-w-r** — built the way **k-t-b** built किताब — whose senses run to *a weak point, a gap in a defence, something left uncovered.*

Then the fact that changes what you do with all that: **Arabic ^{c}awra does not mean “woman.”** That sense is a **Persian** development. Persian moved the noun to mean a woman or a wife and handed *that* to Hindi and Urdu, on record from around 1420 — the same Persian relay that carried दोस्त.

So the harsh root sense is not a claim Arabic makes about women. It is the earlier life of a word another language repurposed.

You’ll want to know — three words, and which to say

Three words, and the choice is **register**, exactly as for किताब / पुस्तक / पोथा.

- औरत — Perso-Arabic, plain and everyday. Common in speech; some speakers avoid it formally, partly because of the origin above.
- महिला (*mahilā*) — a Sanskrit borrowing, the **respectful, public** word: signs, announcements, official prose. Its Sanskrit origin is **uncertain**; one serious proposal traces it to Dravidian.

- स्त्री (*strī*) — Sanskrit, older and literary. Secure back to Indo-Iranian, no further.

महिला where you would write, औरत where you would talk.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ek aurat*, then *ek ādmī* — neither ending gives its gender away
- *merā pitā, merī mātā, merā bhāī, merī bahin, merā bacchā, merī bacchī*
- *merā dost*, then *merī dost*
- every feminine noun you own — *kursī, chāy, kitāb, āṁkh, bacchī*

Before you move on

Does Arabic عورة mean "woman"? (**No** — that sense is **Persian**.) Which goes on a public sign, which in conversation? (महिला written; औरत spoken.) Your family, minding every possessive? (*Merā pitā, merī mātā, merā bhāī, merī bahin, merā bacchā.*)

39.5 औ — the standing form, and the longest build

You have said औरत (*aurat*), "woman". Its first letter is the one this lesson writes.

Before the new one: ौ — how does it differ from ो?

That mark has a standing form, and it is the most elaborate character in this book.

Script you'll notice: औ

औ — *au*.

Same vowel, standing on its own with no consonant to ride on. Like झ, it arrives **before** any word that needs it, so there is nothing to find it inside yet.

What it is made of:

- the joined upper and lower bowls of अ
- a middle shoulder running into the inner stem
- the inner stem
- the trailing stem
- two separate upper arcs
- the top shirorekhā

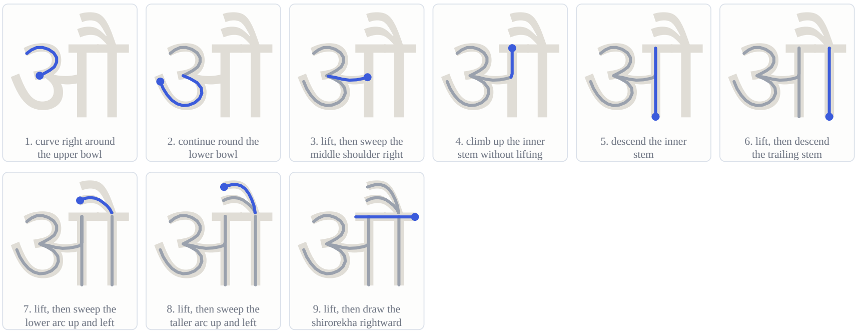
Script: built out of a letter you have

what you see	**what it is**
अ	the base, taught long ago
two upper arcs	what makes it **au**
ौ	the same vowel, riding on a consonant

The **two arcs** are the same *two* that the sitting mark carries above the bar. Whichever posture the vowel is in, **au is the one with a pair of strokes** — one idea, two shapes, and a count that decides it.

Writing: औ

How it is written — 6 strokes · 5 pen lifts · 9 movements


1. curve right around the upper bowl
2. continue round the lower bowl
3. lift, then sweep the middle shoulder right
4. climb up the inner stem without lifting
5. descend the inner stem
6. lift, then descend the trailing stem
7. lift, then sweep the lower arc up and left
8. lift, then sweep the taller arc up and left
9. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, 'Devanagari औ stroke order.svg', panels 1–7, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How औ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** curve right around the upper bowl and continue down and around the lower bowl without lifting

- **2.** lift and sweep the middle shoulder right
- **3.** without lifting, climb up the inner stem to the headline
- **4.** descend the inner stem
- **5.** lift and descend the trailing stem
- **6.** lift at the trailing stem's headline junction and sweep the lower upper arc upward and left
- **7.** lift at the same junction and sweep the taller upper arc upward and left
- **8.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 5. One more than ओ, and more than any other — take it slowly.

> The source shows seven movements; most native writers draw औ in six strokes (60% of HP Labs India's native-writer samples). This path keeps every movement in order and lifts five times; only the shoulder runs on, up the inner stem.
>
> This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Saurmandal, 'Devanagari औ stroke order.svg', panels 1–7, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023.

Your turn

- *Look:* at the mark and the letter side by side, and count the arcs on each

  ◌ौ · औ

- *Trace it:* औ once, slowly, counting the lifts
- *Say it:* which base letter you can see inside it

Before you move on

What sound is औ? (*au*.) What is its sitting form? (◌ौ.) How many pen lifts does it take? (Five — one more than ओ, the most in the book.)

Chapter 40

Pointing, and Asking

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can point at something in Hindi and ask who or where it is — and I can say what the six words have in common.
>
> *Say the near word, the far word and the question word in a row, and name the part that changed.*

40.1 यह (yah) — this one — the thing near me

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: यह

यह — *yah* — this one — the thing near me.

Say it, and picture the thing it lands on as you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever the speaker is pointing at.

Its partner, the far one, comes in the next lesson. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **y-** for near — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

यह (*yah*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *eṣa*, "this" (CDIAL 2530).

Your turn

- *Say it:* "यह" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *dūdh*
- *Read it:* आँख

Before you move on

What is *yah*? (this one — the thing near me.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**y-** — near.)

40.2 वह (vah) — that one — the thing over there

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: वह

वह — *vah* — that one — the thing over there.

Say it, and picture the thing it lands on as you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever the speaker is pointing at.

Its partner is यह *yah*, which you met in the last lesson. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **v-** for far — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वह (*vah*) is inherited. CDIAL lists it under Sanskrit *asau*, "that", and notes that the other forms of that word, built on a stem *amu-*, gave the later words for "that" (CDIAL 972).

Your turn

- *Say it:* "वह" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Read it:* दाँत

Before you move on

What is *vah*? (that one — the thing over there.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**v-** — far.)

40.3 यहाँ (yahā̃) — here — where I am

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: यहाँ

यहाँ — *yahā̃* — here — where I am.

Say it, and picture the thing it lands on as you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever the speaker is pointing at.

Its partner, the far one, comes in the next lesson. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **y-** for near — as यह and वह do, and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

यहाँ (*yahāṁ*) is inherited. CDIAL sets it beside Sanskrit *iha*, "here", as a form ultimately connected with it rather than its direct descendant (CDIAL 1605).

Your turn

- *Say it:* "यहाँ" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *khānā*

Before you move on

What is *yahā̃*? (here — where I am.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**y-** — near.)

40.4 वहाँ (vahā̃) — there — where I am not

You can already name things. This is how you POINT at them.

You'll want to know: वहाँ

वहाँ — *vahā̃* — there — where I am not.

Say it, and picture the thing it lands on as you say it. That is the whole word: it does not mean anything on its own, it means whatever the speaker is pointing at.

Its partner is यहाँ *yahā̃*, which you met in the last lesson. The two of them differ by one sound at the front — **v-** for far — and that is not a coincidence. It is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वहाँ (*vahāṁ*) pairs the stem of वह, "that", with the same place ending *-hāṁ* that यहाँ, "here", has. CDIAL has no entry for it, so its older history is uncertain.

Your turn

- *Say it:* "वहाँ" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Read it:* पैर / पाँव

Before you move on

What is *vahā̃*? (there — where I am not.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**v-** — far.)

40.5 कौन (kaun) — who? — asking about a person

You can already name things. This is how you ASK about them.

You’ll want to know: कौन

कौन — *kaun* — who? — asking about a person.

Say it with an asking voice. It points at no one: it asks your listener to name the person.

Its partner, the question word for place, comes in the next lesson, and it opens with the same **k-**. That is the pattern: the near words you know open with **y-** (यह *yah*, यहाँ *yahā̃*), the far ones with **v-** (वह *vah*, वहाँ *vahā̃*), and the asking words with **k-**. The last lesson of this chapter lays it out.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कौन (*kaun*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kaḥ punar*, literally “who, then”, which CDIAL glosses “who” (CDIAL 2575).

Your turn

- *Say it:* “कौन” three times, asking about a different person each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *kitāb / pustak / pothā*
- *Read it:* पेट

Before you move on

What is *kaun*? (who? — asking about a person.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**k-** — ask.)

40.6 कहाँ (kahā̃) — where? — asking about a place

You can already name things. This is how you ASK about them.

You’ll want to know: कहाँ

कहाँ — *kahā̃* — where? — asking about a place.

Say it with an asking voice. It points at no place: it asks your listener to point one out.

Its partner is कौन *kaun*, which you met in the last lesson: both open with **k-**, the asking sound. Its other partners, यहाँ *yahā̃* and वहाँ *vahā̃*, differ from it only at the front. That is the whole system, and the last lesson of this chapter says so.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कहाँ (*kahāṁ*) pairs the question stem *k-* of क्या and कौन with the place ending -*hāṁ* of यहाँ, "here", and वहाँ, "there". CDIAL has no entry for it, so its older history is uncertain.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "कहाँ" three times, asking about a different place each time
- it once with a word you already know after it

Before you move on

What is *kahā̃*? (where? — asking about a place.) What sound does it start with, and does that sound mean near, far, or a question? (**k-** — ask.)

40.7 y- / v- / k- — six words, one machine

Say the six words from this chapter out loud, in order. Listen to how they begin.

Grammar lens: one slot changes

You did not learn six words. You learned **three beginnings** and reused them.

meaning	**word**
near	यहाँ *yahā̃*
far	वहाँ *vahā̃*
question	कहाँ *kahā̃*

Hindi runs the same machine on different consonants: यहाँ, वहाँ, कहाँ. Change the front, and the meaning walks from **near** to **far** to **a question**. Nothing else in the word moves.

The same three beginnings run the thing-words too: यह *yah* and वह *vah* start exactly like the first two rows. This chapter did not teach you the matching question word for things — that one arrives later, and when it does you will already know what it has to start with.

This is worth more than the six words are. When you meet a new word in this family later, you will not have to be taught all three of it — you will be taught one and work out the others.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the near word, then the far word, then the question word
- *Say it:* them again for place, not for things
- *Notice:* the part that did NOT change

Before you move on

Which beginning means near? (**y-**) Far? (**v-**) And which one turns the word into a question? (**k-**)

Chapter 41

Describing Things

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can point at something in Hindi and ask who or where it is — and I can say what the six words have in common.
>
> *Say the near word, the far word and the question word in a row, and name the part that changed.*

41.1 बड़ा (baṛā) — big

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You'll want to know: बड़ा

बड़ा — *baṛā* — big.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बड़ा (*baṛā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vaḍra*, "big" (CDIAL 11225). CDIAL notes that the Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists, and doubts a link with *vṛddha*, "grown".

Your turn

- *Say it:* “बड़ा” three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *dost*
- *Read it:* यह
- *Recall:* say *vah*

Before you move on

What is *baṛā*? (**big**.) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.2 छोटा (choṭā) — small

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You’ll want to know: छोटा

छोटा — *choṭā* — small.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met बड़ा *baṛā* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छोटा (*choṭā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **choṭṭa*, “small”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5071).

Your turn

- *Say it:* “छोटा” three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it

- *Read it:* बच्चा
- *Recall:* say *yahā̃*

Before you move on

What is *choṭā*? (**small**.) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.3 अच्छा (acchā) — good

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You'll want to know: अच्छा

अच्छा — *acchā* — good.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met छोटा *choṭā* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अच्छा (*acchā*) goes back to Sanskrit *accha*, "clear, transparent" (CDIAL 142). CDIAL lists Hindi *ācḥā*, "good", and marks *acchā* itself as taken over from Punjabi. CDIAL adds that the Sanskrit word may once have meant "shadowless".

Your turn

- *Say it:* "अच्छा" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *ādmī*
- *Read it:* वहाँ

Before you move on

What is *acchā*? (**good**.) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.4 नया (nayā) — new

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You’ll want to know: नया

नया — *nayā* — new.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met अच्छा *acchā* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नया (*nayā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *naviya*, a by-form of Sanskrit *navya*, “new”, which the Rigveda uses where the metre needs an extra syllable. CDIAL lists Hindi *nayā* and its feminine *naī* under *naviya* (CDIAL 7025).

Your turn

- *Say it:* “नया” three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *aurat* / *mahilā* / *strī*, then say *kaun*

Before you move on

What is *nayā*? (**new**.) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.5 पुराना (purānā) — old — of a thing, not of a person

You can already name things. This is how you DESCRIBE them.

You'll want to know: पुराना

पुराना — *purānā* — old — of a thing, not of a person.

Put it in front of a word you already know and you have said something new. That is all an adjective does in this language.

You met नया *nayā* a moment ago. Put them side by side and nothing about either one changes.

The last lesson of this chapter gives the one rule that governs every adjective you will ever meet here.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पुराना (*purānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *purāṇa*, "ancient" (CDIAL 8283).

Your turn

- *Say it:* "पुराना" three times, picturing something different each time
- *Say it:* it once with a word you already know after it
- *Recall:* say *kahā̃*

Before you move on

What is *purānā*? (**old — of a thing, not of a person**.) Where does it go — before the word it describes, or after? (**Before.**)

41.6 before the noun, and it AGREES — five words, one rule

Say the five words from this chapter out loud, then say each one in front of a noun you already know.

Grammar lens: where an adjective goes

You did not learn five separate words. You learned **where an adjective goes**, and five words that go there.

meaning	**word**
big	बड़ा *baṛā*
small	छोटा *choṭā*
good	अच्छा *acchā*

Hindi is the one that changes: बड़ा for a masculine noun, बड़ी for a feminine one.

This is worth more than the five words are. Every noun you already know — your name, the house, the water, the day — can now take any of them in front, and every adjective you meet from here goes in the same place.

Your turn

- *Say it:* each of the five in front of a noun you already know
- *Say it:* two of them with the same noun, one after the other
- *Notice:* whether the adjective changed shape when the noun did

Before you move on

Where does an adjective go in this language? (**In front of the noun.**) Does it change shape to match the noun? (and it AGREES.)

Chapter 42

More Everyday Verbs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name four everyday actions in Hindi and recognise the infinitive ending they share.
>
> *Complete HI-C42-give and say all four verbs in order.*

42.1 आना / आता / आती / आते — to come and its present forms

A short run of everyday verbs, one at a time.

You'll want to know: आना

आना (*ānā*) — "to come".

Every Hindi infinitive ends in **-ना** (-*nā*), so this is 'to come' in the form a dictionary lists.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आना (*ānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. CDIAL lists it under *āpayati*, "causes to reach", from the verb whose old form *āpa* meant "came towards"; Prakrit already had *āvaï*, "comes" (CDIAL 1200).

What you've built

Take off **-ना** and add the endings you already know: **आता** (*ātā*, masculine), **आती** (*ātī*, feminine), **आते** (*āte*, respectful or plural). The action-chaining lesson will put **आता हूँ** after a chained action; now the form will already be yours.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ānā*
- आता / आती / आते (*ātā* / *ātī* / *āte*)
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway

Before you move on

What does आना mean? ("to come".) Give its masculine, feminine, and respectful or plural forms. (आता / आती / आते.)

42.2 बैठना (baiṭhnā) — to sit

Before the new one: what did *ānā* mean?

You'll want to know: बैठना

बैठना (*baiṭhnā*) — "to sit".

Same -ना ending. Once you see it, you can spot an infinitive anywhere in a text without knowing the verb.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बैठना (*baiṭhnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *upaviśati*, "sits down" (CDIAL 2245). The *-ṭh-* goes back to its past form *upaviṣṭa*, "seated".

What you've built

One more everyday action. Three more follow, and each reuses the ones before it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *baiṭhnā*
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway
- it after *ānā*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does बैठना mean? (“to sit”.) Say it once more.

42.3 खड़ा होना (kharạ̄ honā) — to stand

Before the new one: what did *baiṭhnā* mean?

You’ll want to know: खड़ा होना

खड़ा होना (*kharạ̄ honā*) — “to stand”.

Two words: an adjective *kharạ̄*, ’upright’, plus *honā*, ’to be’. Hindi builds many verbs this way, from a word plus a light verb.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खड़ा होना (*kharạ̄ honā*) is two inherited words. खड़ा (*kharạ̄*), “standing”, is listed by CDIAL under Sanskrit *khaḍaka*, “a bolt, a post”, for which it sets up an older sense “erect” (CDIAL 3784). The same entry reconstructs a verb **khaḍati*, “stands”, but lists only a few hill-dialect verbs under it; *kharạ̄* sits with the post. होना (*honā*), “to be, to become”, comes from Sanskrit *bhavati*, “becomes, is” (CDIAL 9416).

What you’ve built

One more everyday action. Three more follow, and each reuses the ones before it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *khaṛā honā*
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway
- it after *baiṭhnā*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does खड़ा होना mean? (“to stand”.) Say it once more.

42.4 देना (denā) — to give

Before the new one: what did *khaṛā honā* mean?

You’ll want to know: देना

देना (*denā*) — “to give”.

The plain ’give’, and one of the light verbs Hindi uses to build compounds of its own.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

देना (*denā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *dadāti*, “gives” (CDIAL 6141).

What you’ve built

One more everyday action. That closes the run: four everyday actions, each met on its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *denā*
- it again, to someone standing in a doorway
- it after *khaṛā honā*, so the two sit together

Before you move on

What does **देना** mean? (“to give”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 43

Verbs of Seeing and Saying

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name four verbs of perceiving and expressing in Hindi and recognise the infinitive ending they share.
>
> *Complete HI-C43-write and say all four verbs in order.*

43.1 देखना / देख / देखता / देखती / देखते — looking and seeing

Four verbs for taking things in and putting them out, one at a time.

You'll want to know: देखना

देखना (*dekhnā*) — "to look, to see."

Remove infinitive **-ना** to find the stem **देख-**. Add the present endings you already know: देखता (*dekhtā*, masculine), देखती (*dekhtī*, feminine), and देखते (*dekhte*, respectful or plural). Later you will use देखता हूँ with an object; now the verb form will already be yours.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

देखना (*dekhnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dekṣati*, "sees", a variant CDIAL reconstructs beside **dṛkṣati* (CDIAL 6507).

What you've built

One more regular verb. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

- *Say it: dekhnā*
- *Say it:* देख / देखता / देखती / देखते (*dekh / dekhtā / dekhtī / dekhte*)
- *Say it (m.):* मैं देखता हूँ · (f.): मैं देखती हूँ
- *Recall:* say *baṛā*, then say *choṭā*

Before you move on

What does देखना mean? ("to look, to see.") Give its stem, then the masculine, feminine, and respectful or plural forms. (देख; देखता / देखती / देखते.)

43.2 सुनना / सुन / सुनता / सुनती / सुनते — listening and hearing

Before the new one: what did *dekhnā* mean?

You'll want to know: सुनना

सुनना (*sunnā*) — "to listen, to hear".

Hindi does not separate listening from hearing; context does the work that a second verb does in English.

Remove infinitive **-ना** to find the stem सुन-. Add the present endings you already know: सुनता (*suntā*, masculine), सुनती (*suntī*, feminine), and सुनते (*sunte*, respectful or plural). Later you will say आप सुनते हैं — "you listen."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुनना (*sunnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *śṛṇoti*, "hears" (CDIAL 12598).

What you've built

One more regular verb. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

- *Say it: sunnā*
- *Say it:* सुन / सुनता / सुनती / सुनते (*sun / suntā / suntī / sunte*)
- *Say it:* "you (resp.) listen" — आप सुनते हैं (*āp sunte haiṁ*)
- *Say it:* it after *dekhnā*, so the two sit together
- *Recall:* say *acchā*

Before you move on

What does सुनना mean? ("to listen, to hear".) Give its stem, then the masculine, feminine, and respectful or plural forms. (सुन; सुनता / सुनती / सुनते.)

43.3 बोलना (bolnā) — to speak

Before the new one: what did *sunnā* mean?

You'll want to know: बोलना

बोलना (*bolnā*) — "to speak".

'To speak' as an activity. Hindi has a second verb, *kahnā*, for saying a particular thing — the difference English draws between *speak* and *say*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बोलना (*bolnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **boll*, "speak", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9321). CDIAL calls a borrowing from Dravidian very doubtful.

What you've built

One more. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

- *Say it: bolnā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* it after *sunnā*, so the two sit together
- *Recall:* say *nayā*

Before you move on

What does बोलना mean? (“to speak”.) Say it once more.

43.4 लिखना (likhnā) — to write

Before the new one: what did *bolnā* mean?

You’ll want to know: लिखना

लिखना (*likhnā*) — “to write”.

From the Sanskrit root √लिख् (*likh*), ’to scratch’ — writing named after what a stylus did to a surface, long before ink.

What you’ve built

That closes the run: look, listen, speak, write.

Your turn

- *Say it: likhnā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* it after *bolnā*, so the two sit together
- *Read it:* पुराना

Before you move on

What does लिखना mean? (“to write”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 44

Sons, Daughters, and Everyone Else

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name four more family and people words in this language.
>
> *Complete HI-C44-people and say all four words in order.*

44.1 बेटा (beṭā) — son

Before the new one: what did *likhnā* mean?

You’ll want to know: बेटा

बेटा (*beṭā*) — “son”.

The everyday word, not the Sanskrit *putra* that formal Hindi holds in reserve. Its -*ā* is the masculine ending you already met on बच्चा. Where the word itself came from is genuinely unsettled: comparative dictionaries reconstruct a Middle Indo-Aryan child-word behind it, with cousins in Punjabi, Gujarati and Marathi, and no agreed Sanskrit source.

What you’ve built

The first of four words for the people around you. Three follow, and each reuses the ones before.

Your turn

- *Say it: beṭā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* it after *likhnā*, so the two sit together
- *Recall:* say *ānā*

Before you move on

What does बेटा mean? (“son”.) Say it once more.

44.2 बेटी (beṭī) — daughter

Before the new one: what did *beṭā* mean?

You’ll want to know: बेटी

बेटी (*beṭī*) — “daughter”.

The same stem, with -*ī* in place of -*ā* — exactly the swap that turns बच्चा into बच्ची. A great deal of Hindi gender lives in that one final vowel, and this pair is the cleanest example you have met so far: nothing else in the word moves.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बेटी (*beṭī*) is the feminine of बेटा, “son”. CDIAL lists both under a reconstructed **beṭṭa*, in an entry headed **biḍḍa*, “defective”, beside Prakrit *biṭṭa*, “boy” (CDIAL 9238). No Sanskrit source is agreed.

What you’ve built

Two of four, and one vowel doing all the work.

Your turn

- *Say it: beṭī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* it after *beṭā*, and hear only the last vowel move

- *Read it:* बैठना

Before you move on

What does बेटी mean? (“daughter”.) Say it once more.

44.3 परिवार (parivār) — family

Before the new one: what did *beṭī* mean?

You’ll want to know: परिवार

परिवार (*parivār*) — “family”.

Sanskrit, and it comes apart in the hand: *pari-*, ’around’, on the root *vṛ*, ’to cover, to enclose’. Your family, in this word, is what surrounds you. The same root gives आवरण (*āvaraṇ*), ’a covering’ — one root, two very different everyday words.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

परिवार (*parivār*) is Sanskrit *parivāra*, “surroundings; followers”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 7876). Hindi narrowed it to the people around you: the family.

What you’ve built

Three of four, and a word you can take apart rather than memorise.

Your turn

- *Say it: parivār*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly, hearing *pari-* at the front
- *Say it:* it after *beṭī*, so the two sit together
- *Recall:* say *khaṛā honā*

Before you move on

What does परिवार mean? (“family”.) Say it once more.

44.4 लोग (log) — people

Before the new one: what did *parivār* mean?

You'll want to know: लोग

लोग (*log*) — "people".

Usually traced to Sanskrit लोक (*loka*), 'open space, world', which already meant 'people' in Manu: the word for the world slid across to mean the people in it. Latin *lucus*, a clearing in a forest, and *lux*, 'light', grow from the same ancient root — an open, lit space first, then whoever stands in it. Hindi hears लोग as already plural, so it needs no further ending.

The road is not the plain inherited one, though. CDIAL lists the worn-down Hindi descendants of *loka* as *loī* and *loe*, 'people', and not *log* (CDIAL 11119). *Log* keeps the shape of Prakrit *loga*, so it may be a semi-learned word, one that stayed closer to the older form than ordinary speech would have left it.

What you've built

That closes the run: son, daughter, family, and everyone else.

Your turn

- *Say it: log*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* it after *parivār*, so the two sit together
- *Read it:* देना

Before you move on

What does लोग mean? ("people".) Say it once more.

Chapter 45

Things You Ask For

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5)   🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five everyday things I might ask someone for in Hindi, and say which of them came down from Sanskrit and which walked in with Persian.
>
> *Complete HI-C45-soap and say all five words in order.*

45.1 फल (phal) — a fruit

> Before the new run of words: what did *parivār* mean, and what did *log* mean?

You'll want to know: फल

फल (*phal*) — "a fruit".

Sanskrit *phala*, which named the fruit on the tree and, in the same breath, the result of anything you did. Hindi still carries both senses: the mango in your hand and the outcome of a year's work take the same word.

English readers meet the second sense in translations of the Gita, where "the fruit of action" is a word-for-word rendering rather than a figure the translator reached for. The Persian layer of Hindi later brought *mevā* for dried fruit and nuts, so the orchard and the shop shelf can be named separately — an inherited word and a borrowed one dividing the work between them, which is a habit worth watching for.

What you've built

The first of five things you might ask someone for.

Your turn

- *Say it: phal*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: phal*, then *log*, so the new one sits beside the last one you learned
- *Recall:* say *dekhnā*

Before you move on

What does फल mean? ("a fruit".) Say it once more.

45.2 कपड़ा (kapṛā) — cloth

Before the new one: what did *phal* mean?

You'll want to know: कपड़ा

कपड़ा (*kapṛā*) — "cloth".

The plain, unceremonious word: the bolt on the shelf, the washing on the line, the shirt on your back. Behind it is Sanskrit *karpaṭa*, a rag or a patched garment, and the ड़ in the middle is what a thousand years of ordinary speech did to that *-ṭ-* caught between two vowels.

Beside it Hindi keeps *vastra*, lifted from Sanskrit untouched, which turns up on a wedding invitation rather than over a washing line. Two words, one meaning, and the register telling them apart.

What you've built

Two: a fruit and a cloth.

Your turn

- *Say it: kapṛā*

- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *phal*, then *kapṛā*, and ask for each with *kṛpayā* in front
- *Read it:* सुनना
- *Recall:* say *beṭā*

Before you move on

What does कपड़ा mean? (“cloth”.) Say it once more.

45.3 दीया (dīyā) — an oil lamp

Before the new one: what did *kapṛā* mean?

You’ll want to know: दीया

दीया (*dīyā*) — “an oil lamp”.

A small clay lamp with a wick floating in oil — the kind lit in rows along a wall at Diwali. Behind it is Sanskrit *dīpa*, ’lamp’, on the root *dīp-*, ’to blaze’.

The *p* softened away in everyday speech and left दीया behind, while the formal *dīpak* kept it. Diwali is that same *dīpāvalī*, ’a row of lamps’, worn down in the same direction: the lamps are still in the name of the festival, only harder to see.

What you’ve built

Three: a fruit, a cloth, and a lamp.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dīyā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *dīyā*, then *kapṛā*, so the two objects sit together
- *Recall:* say *bolnā*
- *Read it:* बेटी

Before you move on

What does दीया mean? (“an oil lamp”.) Say it once more.

45.4 नमक (namak) — salt

Before the new one: what did *dīyā* mean?

You’ll want to know: नमक

नमक (*namak*) — “salt”.

Persian *namak*, taken whole, and one of the plainest examples of Hindi’s second inheritance. The word that came down from Sanskrit is *lavaṇa*, and it survives mostly in careful writing and in chemistry, while the borrowed word does the cooking.

Persian salt also handed Hindi a measure of character: *namak-halāl* is someone true to the salt they have eaten at your table, and *namak-harām* is the one who is not. A pantry word doing moral work.

What you’ve built

Four, and one of them is not a thing you can hold.

Your turn

- *Say it: namak*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: namak*, then *dīyā*, then *kapṛā*, backwards down the run
- *Read it:* लिखना
- *Recall:* say *parivār*

Before you move on

What does नमक mean? (“salt”.) Say it once more.

45.5 साबुन (sābun) — soap

Before the new one: what did *namak* mean?

You’ll want to know: साबुन

साबुन (*sābun*) — “soap”.

Arabic *ṣābūn*, reaching Hindi through Persian — and behind the Arabic sits Latin *sāpō*, which the Romans had themselves borrowed from their northern neighbours, who used the stuff on their hair before anyone used it for washing.

So the word went north to south, south to east, and arrived here. English “soap” and साबुन are the same ancient word arriving by two different roads, one short and one very long.

What you’ve built

Five, and the run is closed: a fruit, cloth, a lamp, salt, soap.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sābun*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order — *phal*, *kapṛā*, *dīyā*, *namak*, *sābun*

Before you move on

What does साबुन mean? (“soap”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 46

Hair, Ear, and Throat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five more parts of the body in Hindi, and follow the wearing-down that turned each Sanskrit word into the one people say.
>
> *Complete HI-C46-throat and say all five words in order.*

46.1 बाल (bāl) — hair

> Before the new run of words: what did *namak* mean, and what did *sābun* mean?

You'll want to know: बाल

बाल (*bāl*) — "hair".

One hair, and by extension all the hair on a head. Sanskrit *vāla*, a hair or a horse's tail, stands behind it, and the turn from *v-* to *b-* is regular enough between Sanskrit and Hindi that you can use it as a rule of thumb.

Take care with its neighbour: *bāl-* also means 'child' in words borrowed straight from Sanskrit, as in *bālak*. Those are two different words that happened to fall together in sound, and only the sentence around them says which one is meant.

What you've built

The first of five more body words.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāl*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: bāl*, then *sābun*, so the washing and the washed sit together
- *Recall:* say *beṭā*
- *Read it:* फल

Before you move on

What does बाल mean? (“hair”.) Say it once more.

46.2 उँगली (uṅglī) — a finger

Before the new one: what did *bāl* mean?

You’ll want to know: उँगली

उँगली (*uṅglī*) — “a finger”.

Sanskrit *aṅgulī*, a finger, built on *aṅga*, ’a limb’. That one root supports a whole small household of hand-words: *aṅgūṭhā* is the thumb and *aṅgūṭhī* is the ring that goes on it.

The mark above the line here is doing the work the *ṅ* used to do. The nasal consonant dissolved into the vowel and left only the little moon-and-dot behind, which is the same trade you already saw inside *pāṁch*.

What you’ve built

Two of five.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṅglī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: uṅglī*, then *bāl*, picturing each as you name it
- *Read it:* बेटी
- *Recall:* say *kapṛā*

Before you move on

What does उँगली mean? (“a finger”.) Say it once more.

46.3 कान (kān) — an ear

Before the new one: what did *uṅglī* mean?

You’ll want to know: कान

कान (*kān*) — “an ear”.

Sanskrit *karṇa*, the ear — also the name of the warrior in the Mahabharata who was born wearing earrings. The path to कान is the ordinary one: the *-rṇ-* cluster collapses, the vowel that survives it lengthens, and a two-syllable word becomes one.

The same collapse is what turned *suvarṇa*, ’good colour’, into *sonā*, gold. Once you have seen it twice it stops looking like an accident and starts looking like the machine it is.

What you’ve built

Three: hair, a finger, an ear.

Your turn

- *Say it: kān*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kān*, then *uṅglī*, then *bāl*, back down the run
- *Recall:* say *parivār*
- *Read it:* दीया

Before you move on

What does कान mean? (“an ear”.) Say it once more.

46.4 नाक (nāk) — a nose

Before the new one: what did *kān* mean?

You’ll want to know: नाक

नाक (*nāk*) — “a nose”.

From Prakrit *ṇakka*, ’nose’, which CDIAL traces, with a “possibly”, to the old word *nas-*, ’nose’ (CDIAL 6909) — and *nas-* is a cousin of Latin *nāsus* and of English “nose”, so the family resemblance is probably real.

Hindi puts the nose where English puts the face: to have your नाक cut is to be humiliated, and to keep it high is to keep your honour. The idiom is old enough that the literal sense has stopped showing through.

What you’ve built

Four, and the last one is on the inside.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāk*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: nāk*, then *kān*, so the two openings of the head sit together
- *Read it:* लोग
- *Recall:* say *namak*

Before you move on

What does नाक mean? (“a nose”.) Say it once more.

46.5 गला (galā) — the throat

Before the new one: what did *nāk* mean?

You’ll want to know: गला

गला (*galā*) — “the throat”.

Sanskrit *gala*, the throat, a cousin of Latin *gula*, the gullet — the word English took twice over, once as “gullet” and once, by a longer road, as “gluttony”.

Hindi keeps the plain sense and adds the obvious extension: your गला is also your voice, and to say that it has gone is to say you have gone hoarse.

The organ and what comes out of it share one word, which is a bargain most languages strike somewhere.

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: hair, a finger, an ear, a nose, the throat.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *galā*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order — *bāl*, *uṅglī*, *kān*, *nāk*, *galā*

Before you move on

What does **गला** mean? ("the throat".) Say it once more.

Chapter 47

Who Someone Is

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what someone's work is in Hindi, and tell an inherited word for a person from a borrowed one.
>
> *Complete HI-C47-neighbour and say all five words in order.*

47.1 शिक्षक (śikṣak) — a teacher

> Before the new run of words: what did *nāk* mean, and what did *galā* mean?

You'll want to know: शिक्षक

शिक्षक (*śikṣak*) — "a teacher".

Sanskrit, and it comes apart cleanly in the hand: the root *śikṣ-*, 'to learn, to be taught', with the agent ending *-aka* — the one who brings the learning about. The same root gives *śikṣā*, education, and *śikṣit*, educated.

Everyday speech reaches for *ustād* or *guru* depending on what is being taught and by whom, but शिक्षक is the word on the school form, and the feminine *śikṣikā* is built from it by the ending alone.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शिक्षक (*śikṣak*) is Sanskrit *śikṣaka*, "one who teaches", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *śikṣā*, "learning, study", which also came down into everyday Hindi as *sīkh*, "advice" (CDIAL 12432).

What you've built

The first of five words for who someone is.

Your turn

- *Say it: śikṣak*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: śikṣak*, then *galā*, so the teacher and the voice sit together
- *Recall:* say *phal*
- *Read it:* बाल

Before you move on

What does शिक्षक mean? ("a teacher".) Say it once more.

47.2 छात्र (chātra) — a student

Before the new one: what did *śikṣak* mean?

You'll want to know: छात्र

छात्र (*chātra*) — "a student".

Sanskrit *chātra*, and the picture inside it is unexpected. *Chattra* is a parasol, and the traditional Indian etymologists read *chātra* as the one who stands in the teacher's shade. Whether that is the true history is argued about; that it is the story the tradition told is not.

The feminine is *chātrā*. The transparent alternative is *vidyārthī*, 'one who seeks knowledge', which says on its face what छात्र only hints at.

What you've built

Two: a teacher and a student.

Your turn

- *Say it: chātra*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly

- *Say it: chātra*, then *śikṣak*, the pair that needs each other
- *Recall:* say *kapṛā*, then say *uṅglī*

Before you move on

What does छात्र mean? (“a student”.) Say it once more.

47.3 किसान (kisān) — a farmer

Before the new one: what did *chātra* mean?

You’ll want to know: किसान

किसान (*kisān*) — “a farmer”.

From *kṛṣāṇa*, on the Sanskrit root *kṛṣ-*, ’to plough, to drag through the ground’ — the same root behind *kṛṣi*, agriculture. A farmer, in this word, is simply the one who drags the plough.

Latin reached for the same picture and got there with different material: *sulcus*, a furrow, is not related to *kṛṣ-* at all. Two families, no shared word, and the identical image — which is worth noticing precisely because it proves nothing about descent.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

किसान (*kisān*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kṛṣāṇa*, “ploughing” (CDIAL 3447). It is the present participle of *kṛṣati*, “ploughs”: a farmer is “the one ploughing”.

What you’ve built

Three, and each one names work rather than family.

Your turn

- *Say it: kisān*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kisān*, then *chātra*, then *śikṣak*, back down the run

- *Recall:* say *dīyā*
- *Read it:* कान

Before you move on

What does किसान mean? (“a farmer”.) Say it once more.

47.4 मेहमान (mehmān) — a guest

Before the new one: what did *kisān* mean?

You’ll want to know: मेहमान

मेहमान (*mehmān*) — “a guest”.

Persian *mihmān*, and Hindi took the whole vocabulary of hospitality along with it: *mehmān-nawāzī*, hospitality, is literally the cherishing of guests.

The inherited word is *atithi*, and it is built out of a small argument: *a-tithi*, ’without a date’ — a guest being, by definition, someone who has not told you when they are coming. Two words, two theories of the thing. One names the arrival, the other names the welcome.

What you’ve built

Four, and this one arrives at your door.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mehmān*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *mehmān*, then *kisān*, so the visitor and the host sit together
- *Read it:* नमक
- *Recall:* say *nāk*

Before you move on

What does मेहमान mean? (“a guest”.) Say it once more.

47.5 पड़ोसी (paṛosī) — a neighbour

Before the new one: what did *mehmān* mean?

You'll want to know: पड़ोसी

पड़ोसी (*paṛosī*) — "a neighbour".

It sits beside *paṛos*, the neighbourhood, and its *-ī* sounds like the ending that makes आदमी out of Adam. The history is a little different. CDIAL derives *paṛosī* from **prativeśiya*, a by-form it reconstructs beside Sanskrit *prativeśya*, "neighbour" (CDIAL 8599), so the *-ī* continues that old *-iya*. The place-word *paṛos* comes separately from Sanskrit *prativeśa*, "neighbouring" (CDIAL 8598).

Both are built on *prati-*, "towards, facing", and the verb *viś-*, "to enter, to settle". CDIAL prefers that verb to the older idea of a compound with *veśa*, "dwelling".

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: a teacher, a student, a farmer, a guest, a neighbour.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṛosī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *śikṣak*, *chātra*, *kisān*, *mehmān*, *paṛosī*
- *Recall:* say *sābun*
- *Read it:* गला

Before you move on

What does पड़ोसी mean? ("a neighbour".) Say it once more.

Chapter 48

Short Replies

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can answer someone in Hindi with one word, and pick how certain that one word sounds.
>
> *Complete HI-C48-absolutely and say all five words in order.*

48.1 सच (sac) — true

> Before the new run of words: what did *mehmān* mean, and what did *paṛosī* mean?

You'll want to know: सच

सच (*sac*) — "true".

Sanskrit *satya*, 'true, real', worn down to a single syllable — and *satya* is itself built on *sat*, the participle of the verb 'to be'. What is true, at the bottom of this word, is simply what is.

Hindi keeps the long form as well, in names and in solemn speech, so one idea can arrive dressed either way. सच is the one you say when somebody tells you something you did not expect.

What you've built

The first of five short replies.

Your turn

- *Say it: sac*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: sac*, then *paṛosī*, so the reply and the person sit together
- *Recall:* say *bāl*
- *Read it:* शिक्षक

Before you move on

What does सच mean? (“true”.) Say it once more.

48.2 बस (bas) — enough, that’s all

Before the new one: what did *sac* mean?

You’ll want to know: बस

बस (*bas*) — “enough, that’s all”.

Persian *bas*, ’enough’. One syllable that stops a pouring hand, ends a list, or closes an argument, and it does all three on tone alone.

Doubled, *bas bas*, it is the polite way to say enough while somebody is still serving you. Stretched out, it is what you say when they are plainly not listening. Very few words in the language do this much work for so little.

What you’ve built

Two, and both are one syllable.

Your turn

- *Say it: bas*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: bas*, then *sac*, one after the other, as answers
- *Recall:* say *uṅglī*, then say *chātra*

Before you move on

What does बस mean? (“enough, that’s all”.) Say it once more.

48.3 ज़रूर (zarūr) — certainly

Before the new one: what did *bas* mean?

You’ll want to know: ज़रूर

ज़रूर (*zarūr*) — “certainly”.

Arabic *ḍarūr*, ’necessity’, arriving through Persian — and the word has walked from necessity to certainty by the shortest possible route: what must be, will be. Its relative *zarūrat* is still the plain Hindi word for a need.

The dot written under the ज़ marks a sound that came in with the Persian layer rather than down from Sanskrit. The letter underneath it was already here; the dot is the passport.

What you’ve built

Three: true, enough, certainly.

Your turn

- *Say it: zarūr*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: zarūr*, then *bas*, then *sac*, back down the run
- *Recall:* say *kān*
- *Read it:* किसान

Before you move on

What does ज़रूर mean? (“certainly”.) Say it once more.

48.4 शायद (śāyad) — perhaps

Before the new one: what did *zarūr* mean?

You’ll want to know: शायद

शायद (*śāyad*) — “perhaps”.

Persian *shāyad*, ’it may be’, out of *shāyistan*, ’to be fitting, to be possible’. A whole conjugated form collapsed into a single hedge.

The inherited alternative is *sambhavataḥ*, four syllables of Sanskrit that belong to written prose and to careful speeches. When somebody is guessing out loud in a kitchen, they say शायद.

What you’ve built

Four, and this one takes a step back.

Your turn

- *Say it: śāyad*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: śāyad*, then *zarūr*, the two ends of how sure you are
- *Read it:* नाक
- *Recall:* say *mehmān*

Before you move on

What does शायद mean? (“perhaps”.) Say it once more.

48.5 बिलकुल (bilkul) — absolutely

Before the new one: what did *śāyad* mean?

You’ll want to know: बिलकुल

बिलकुल (*bilkul*) — “absolutely”.

Arabic *bi-l-kull*, ’with the whole’ — a preposition, the definite article *al-*, and *kull*, ’all’, fused into one Hindi word. That same *al-* is sitting, equally hidden, inside अलविदा.

It answers a yes-or-no question with more weight than a bare yes. Put *nahīṁ* after it and it does exactly the same for no, which makes it the most emphatic thing on this page in either direction.

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: true, enough, certainly, perhaps, absolutely.

Your turn

- *Say it: bilkul*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *sac*, *bas*, *zarūr*, *śāyad*, *bilkul*
- *Recall:* say *galā*, then say *paṛosī*

Before you move on

What does **बिलकुल** mean? ("absolutely".) Say it once more.

Chapter 49

Taking Your Leave

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say when I am leaving and when I will be back in Hindi.
>
> *Complete HI-C49-meeting and say all five words in order.*

49.1 अभी (abhī) — right now

> Before the new run of words: what did *śāyad* mean, and what did *bilkul* mean?

You'll want to know: अभी

अभी (*abhī*) — "right now".

Ab, 'now', with the emphatic *-hī* welded onto it: now and nothing but now. CDIAL traces *ab* to Sanskrit *evam eva*, 'exactly so', crossed with the pronoun stem *a-* (CDIAL 2528).

That little *-hī* is one of the most useful pieces in the language. It narrows whatever it lands on, and you will meet it stuck to other words later. Here it turns a vague present into a pointed one — not now-ish, but this moment, and no other.

What you've built

The first of five words for leaving.

Your turn

- *Say it: abhī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: abhī*, then *bilkul*, so the timing and the emphasis sit together
- *Recall:* say *śikṣak*
- *Read it:* सच

Before you move on

What does अभी mean? (“right now”.) Say it once more.

49.2 परसों (parsoṁ) — the day after tomorrow

Before the new one: what did *abhī* mean?

You’ll want to know: परसों

परसों (*parsoṁ*) — “the day after tomorrow”.

And also the day before yesterday. Like कल, which does duty for both tomorrow and yesterday, परसों counts two days out from today and leaves the direction to the sentence.

Sanskrit *paraśvas*, ’the day after tomorrow’, lies underneath (CDIAL 7799j), and the language evidently never felt the lack of two separate words. Time is being measured here by distance from now, with the direction supplied by whatever the sentence is already doing.

What you’ve built

Two, and both of them are about when.

Your turn

- *Say it: parsoṁ*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: parsoṁ*, then *abhī*, the far day beside this very moment

- *Recall:* say *chātra*
- *Read it:* बस

Before you move on

What does परसों mean? (“the day after tomorrow”.) Say it once more.

49.3 सफ़र (safar) — a journey

Before the new one: what did *parsoṁ* mean?

You’ll want to know: सफ़र

सफ़र (*safar*) — “a journey”.

Arabic *safar*, ’travel’, through Persian. The same root gives *safīr*, an ambassador — somebody sent out on a journey and expected back.

The inherited word is *yātrā*, from the Sanskrit root *yā-*, ’to go’, and it leans toward pilgrimage. So a सफ़र is the road itself, while a *yātrā* is the road with a reason at the end of it.

What you’ve built

Three: right now, the far day, a journey.

Your turn

- *Say it: safar*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: safar*, then *parsoṁ*, then *abhī*, back down the run
- *Recall:* say *kisān*
- *Read it:* ज़रूर

Before you move on

What does सफ़र mean? (“a journey”.) Say it once more.

49.4 निकलना (nikalnā) — to set out, to leave

Before the new one: what did *safar* mean?

You'll want to know: निकलना

निकलना (*nikalnā*) — "to set out, to leave".

What you say when you are on the point of walking out of a door. It is the going-out kind of action, where the thing leaves under its own steam, and it has a partner, *nikālnā*, with a long *ā*, which means to take something out.

Lengthen the vowel and the doer changes: that pairing is one of Hindi's tidiest machines, and it runs through dozens of everyday words. Sanskrit *niṣkal-*, 'to go forth', stands behind both.

What you've built

Four, and this one is something you do.

Your turn

- *Say it: nikalnā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: nikalnā*, then *safar*, the leaving and the road it opens
- *Read it:* मेहमान
- *Recall:* say *śāyad*

Before you move on

What does निकलना mean? ("to set out, to leave".) Say it once more.

49.5 मुलाक़ात (mulāqāt) — a meeting

Before the new one: what did *nikalnā* mean?

You’ll want to know: मुलाक़ात

मुलाक़ात (*mulāqāt*) — “a meeting”.

Arabic *mulāqāt*, on *laqiya*, ’to meet’, arriving through Persian. It covers everything from bumping into somebody on a street to a scheduled interview in an office.

It sits inside the ordinary parting line *phir mulāqāt hogī*, ’there will be a meeting again’ — which is what फिर मिलेंगे says using inherited material instead of borrowed. Same farewell, two vocabularies, and a speaker can pick either without changing the meaning by a hair.

What you’ve built

Five, and the run is closed: right now, the far day, a journey, setting out, a meeting.

Your turn

- *Say it: mulāqāt*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *abhī*, *parsoṁ*, *safar*, *nikalnā*, *mulāqāt*
- *Recall:* say *paṛosī*
- *Read it:* बिलकुल

Before you move on

What does मुलाक़ात mean? (“a meeting”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 50

Courtesy Words

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✎ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 5 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can thank someone in Hindi at the weight the occasion asks for.
>
> *Complete HI-C50-salutation and say all five words in order.*

50.1 आभार (ābhār) — gratitude

> Before the new run of words: what did *nikalnā* mean, and what did *mulāqāt* mean?

You'll want to know: आभार

आभार (*ābhār*) — "gratitude".

Sanskrit *ā-bhāra*, 'a load carried toward' — built on *bhṛ-*, 'to bear', which is the same ancient root as Latin *ferre* and English "bear". To be grateful, on the evidence of this word, is to be carrying a weight that somebody else put there.

It stands above धन्यवाद in formality, and well above शुक्रिया. It is the word a written speech uses, or a letter, or the last line of a printed programme.

What you've built

The first of five courtesy words.

Your turn

- *Say it: ābhār*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ābhār*, then *mulāqāt*, the thanks and the meeting it ends
- *Recall:* say *sac*, then say *abhī*

Before you move on

What does आभार mean? (“gratitude”.) Say it once more.

50.2 एहसान (ehsān) — a favour

Before the new one: what did *ābhār* mean?

You’ll want to know: एहसान

एहसान (*ehsān*) — “a favour”.

Arabic *iḥsān*, ’the doing of what is good’, on the root *ḥ-s-n*, which carries both beauty and goodness and also gives the names *ḥasan* and *ḥusn*. Persian passed it on to Hindi as the word for a kindness done to you and not forgotten.

Two phrases live on it and point opposite ways. *Ehsān mānnā* is to acknowledge a favour; *ehsān jatānā* is to keep reminding somebody that you did them one. The language leaves you in no doubt which of the two it thinks less of.

What you’ve built

Two: gratitude, and the thing it is owed for.

Your turn

- *Say it: ehsān*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ehsān*, then *ābhār*, the favour and the thanks for it
- *Read it:* बस

- *Recall:* say *parsoṁ*

Before you move on

What does एहसान mean? (“a favour”.) Say it once more.

50.3 आदर (ādar) — respect

Before the new one: what did *ehsān* mean?

You’ll want to know: आदर

आदर (*ādar*) — “respect”.

Sanskrit *ādara*, ’regard, attentiveness’, from *ā-dṛ-*, ’to heed’. Hindi carries this word inside its own machinery: the आप form is called *ādar-sūcak*, the respect-marking form.

So this is not only a word for a feeling somebody has. It is the name of a choice the language makes you make in nearly every sentence you speak, whether you have thought about it or not.

What you’ve built

Three, and this one is built into the grammar.

Your turn

- *Say it: ādar*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ādar*, then *ehsān*, then *ābhār*, back down the run
- *Recall:* say *zarūr*
- *Read it:* सफ़र

Before you move on

What does आदर mean? (“respect”.) Say it once more.

50.4 आशीर्वाद (āśīrvād) — a blessing

Before the new one: what did *ādar* mean?

You'll want to know: आशीर्वाद

आशीर्वाद (*āśīrvād*) — "a blessing".

Sanskrit *āśīr-vāda*: *āśis*, 'a wish, a prayer', joined to *vāda*, 'speech'. A blessing is literally a wish said out loud. The *s* turning into *r* before the *v* is a regular joint in Sanskrit rather than a quirk of this one word.

It travels downward. An elder gives आशीर्वाद; the younger person asks for it by bending to touch the elder's feet, and the giving is spoken over the bent head.

What you've built

Four, and this one is given rather than said.

Your turn

- *Say it: āśīrvād*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: āśīrvād*, then *ādar*, the blessing and the respect that asks for it
- *Read it:* शायद
- *Recall:* say *nikalnā*

Before you move on

What does आशीर्वाद mean? ("a blessing".) Say it once more.

50.5 प्रणाम (praṇām) — a bow, a salutation

Before the new one: what did *āśīrvād* mean?

You'll want to know: प्रणाम

प्रणाम (*praṇām*) — "a bow, a salutation".

Sanskrit *pra-ṇāma*, 'a bending forward', on *nam-*, 'to bow' — the identical root standing inside नमस्ते and नमस्कार. Three words, one gesture, three heights of formality.

प्रणाम is what a younger person says to an elder, often while bending to touch the feet, and what it expects back is आशीर्वाद. The pair of words is the pair of movements: one goes down, one comes back over the top.

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: gratitude, a favour, respect, a blessing, a bow.

Your turn

- *Say it: praṇām*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *ābhār*, *ehsān*, *ādar*, *āśīrvād*, *praṇām*
- *Recall:* say *bilkul*
- *Read it:* मुलाक़ात

Before you move on

What does प्रणाम mean? ("a bow, a salutation".) Say it once more.

50.6 ण — the last one

You have said प्रणाम (*praṇām*). The letter in its middle, before the ा, is the one this lesson writes.

Before the new one: व — which letter shares its loop?

Today's letter finishes something.

Script you'll notice: ण

ण — *ṇa.*

What it is made of:

- a joined left stem, clockwise lower bowl and inner right stem
- a separate top-to-bottom outer right stem
- the top shirorekhā

It has **two right-hand stems**, which is unusual: the inner one is the end of the body's run, and the outer one is drawn on its own.

Script: the retroflex row is complete

letter	sound
ट	*ṭa*
ठ	*ṭha*
ड	*ḍa*
ढ	*ḍha*
ण	***ṇa***

The tongue curls back for all five. ण is the nasal of that row — the same family as न, made in the retroflex place instead of against the teeth.

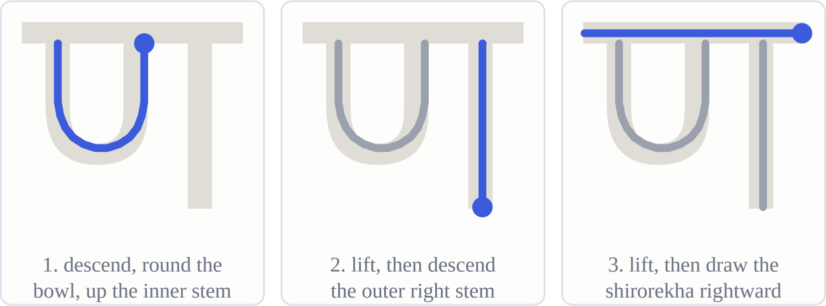
Where you have already met it — and there is **one** place:

- पूर्ण विराम — the name of the full stop

That is the term this book taught you for the mark that ends a sentence, and its letters went unnamed at the time. One sighting in the whole book so far is a fair measure of how rare this letter is in everyday words, and it is the reason it waited this long.

Writing: ण

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 3 movements



1. descend, round the bowl, up the inner stem

2. lift, then descend the outer right stem

3. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ण-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ण is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start at the left stem’s headline junction, descend, curve clockwise around the lower bowl, and rise along the inner right stem back to the headline without lifting
- **2.** lift and draw the outer right stem top-to-bottom
- **3.** lift and draw the top shirorekhā left-to-right

Pen lifts: 2.

Verified three-stroke teaching form fitted to the bundled printed outline; everyday handwriting may narrow or simplify the bowl differently.

This is one attested teaching order and not a national standard — handwriting here is taught with school-to-school variation. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ण-order.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at this phrase and find ण in it

पूर्ण विराम

- *Trace it:* ण three times, saying *ṇa* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* how many right-hand stems this letter has

Before you move on

What sound does ण carry? (*ṇa*.) Which row does it close? Which dental letter is it the retroflex partner of? (न.) Where have you read it?

Chapter 51

Welcoming a Guest

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name what a Hindi household puts in front of a guest at the door.
>
> *Complete HI-C51-sweet and say all five words in order.*

51.1 फूल (phūl) — a flower

> Before the new run of words: what did *āśīrvād* mean, and what did *praṇām* mean?

You'll want to know: फूल

फूल (*phūl*) — "a flower".

Sanskrit *phulla*, 'blossomed, opened out', from *phull-*, 'to bloom'. So the Hindi word for a flower is at bottom a word for the act of opening, with the object named after the event.

The double *ll* collapsed and paid for itself by lengthening the vowel in front of it, which is the standard trade in this family — the same bargain that gave you कान out of *karṇa*. It is also the measure of lightness: something that weighs nothing at all is *phūl jaisā*.

What you've built

The first of five things at a welcome.

Your turn

- *Say it: phūl*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: phūl*, then *praṇām*, the flower and the bow at the door
- *Recall:* say *abhī*, then say *ābhār*

Before you move on

What does फूल mean? (“a flower”.) Say it once more.

51.2 माला (mālā) — a garland

Before the new one: what did *phūl* mean?

You’ll want to know: माला

माला (*mālā*) — “a garland”.

Sanskrit *mālā*, a garland or a string of beads, and the second sense has travelled furthest: the string of a hundred and eight beads counted through the fingers is a *mālā*, and English borrowed the word back, unchanged, for that same object.

Around the neck of a guest it is a welcome. Around the frame of a photograph it is mourning. The object does not change at all; where it is hung decides everything.

What you’ve built

Two: a flower and a garland made of them.

Your turn

- *Say it: mālā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: mālā*, then *phūl*, the string and the thing it is made of
- *Read it:* परसों
- *Recall:* say *ehsān*

Before you move on

What does माला mean? (“a garland”.) Say it once more.

51.3 आँगन (āṁgan) — a courtyard

Before the new one: what did *mālā* mean?

You’ll want to know: आँगन

आँगन (*āṁgan*) — “a courtyard”.

Sanskrit *aṅgaṇa*, the open ground a house encloses — the room with no roof over it. Old town houses are built around one, and a great deal of what English would put in a living room happens there instead: the drying, the talking, the sitting with a guest.

The mark above the line marks a nasal that used to be a whole consonant, exactly as it does in *uṅglī*.

What you’ve built

Three, and this one is where you seat the guest.

Your turn

- *Say it: āṁgan*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: āṁgan*, then *mālā*, then *phūl*, back down the run
- *Recall:* say *safar*
- *Read it:* आदर

Before you move on

What does आँगन mean? (“a courtyard”.) Say it once more.

51.4 मेज़ (mez) — a table

Before the new one: what did *āṁgan* mean?

You'll want to know: मेज़

मेज़ (*mez*) — "a table".

Persian *mez*, and behind the Persian, on the usual account, Portuguese *mesa*, out of Latin *mēnsa*. Portuguese ships carried the object and its name into the Indian Ocean, which is the same route that brought कमरा in from *camera*.

There was no inherited word for a raised surface on four legs because the household had not had one; people ate and wrote and worked at floor level. The word arrived with the furniture, which is usually how that happens.

What you've built

Four, and one of them came off a ship.

Your turn

- *Say it: mez*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: mez*, then *āṁgan*, one of them standing inside the other
- *Read it:* निकलना
- *Recall:* say *āśīrvād*

Before you move on

What does मेज़ mean? ("a table".) Say it once more.

51.5 मिठाई (miṭhāī) — a sweet

Before the new one: what did *mez* mean?

You'll want to know: मिठाई

मिठाई (*miṭhāī*) — "a sweet".

From *mīṭhā*, 'sweet', with the -*āī* ending that turns a quality into a thing you can hold — sweetness first, then the sweet itself. Behind *mīṭhā* is Sanskrit *miṣṭa*, 'sweetened, relished'.

Nothing closes a welcome better: the garland at the door, the seat in the courtyard, and something sweet in the hand before anybody says why they have come.

What you've built

Five, and the run is closed: a flower, a garland, a courtyard, a table, a sweet.

Your turn

- *Say it: miṭhāī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order — *phūl*, *mālā*, *āṁgan*, *mez*, *miṭhāī*
- *Recall:* say *mulāqāt*, then spell **प्रणाम** aloud letter by letter, naming its **ण** as you reach it

Before you move on

What does **मिठाई** mean? ("a sweet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 52

In the Kitchen

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five things in a Hindi kitchen and ask for them politely.
>
> *Complete HI-C52-vegetable and say all five words in order.*

52.1 चावल (chāval) — rice

> Before the new run of words: what did the last two words of the chapter before mean?

You'll want to know: चावल

चावल (*chāval*) — "rice".

Sanskrit's own word for rice is तण्डुल (*taṇḍula*), and it is not the ancestor of this one. Where *chāval* came from is genuinely unsettled — the dictionaries record the Prakrit forms behind it without agreeing on what stands behind those.

That makes it the fourth everyday Hindi word you have met whose origin is honestly unknown, after बिल्ली, कुत्ता and पेट. It is worth noticing the pattern: the words a language uses most are not always the words whose history it kept.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चावल (*chāval*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **cāvala*, "husked rice", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4749). CDIAL suggests, with a “possibly”, that it shares a non-Aryan origin with Sanskrit *taṇḍula*, “rice”.

What you’ve built

The first of five things a kitchen is stocked with.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāval*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: chāval*, the grain the rest of the meal is served over
- *Recall:* say *ābhār*
- *Read it:* फूल

Before you move on

What does चावल mean? (“rice”.) Say it once more.

52.2 दाल (dāl) — lentils, split pulses

What did the word before this one mean?

You’ll want to know: दाल

दाल (*dāl*) — “lentils, split pulses”.

From Sanskrit दल् (*dal-*), ’to split’, through the noun दल (*dala*), ’a piece torn off’. दाल is not the name of a plant at all — it is the name of what was done to the seed.

Whole pulses are not दाल; split ones are. So the word draws its line through the middle of the lentil rather than around the outside of the species, which is why one plant can give both a दाल and a not-दाल.

What you’ve built

The second of five, and the one named after a knife rather than a plant.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāl*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: dāl*, then *chāval* — the pair that makes a meal
- *Read it:* एहसान
- *Recall:* say *mālā*

Before you move on

What does दाल mean? (“lentils, split pulses”.) Say it once more.

52.3 तेल (tel) — oil

Name the 2 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: तेल

तेल (*tel*) — “oil”.

From Sanskrit तैल (*taila*), which is built on तिल (*tila*), ’sesame’. तेल is therefore ’the sesame stuff’ — oil named after the one seed that was pressed for it.

English did the same thing by a different road: *oil* goes back to Latin *oleum*, from Greek *élaion*, ’olive oil’ — oil named after the olive. Two languages, two plants, one habit of naming the substance after whatever you happened to press.

What you’ve built

The third of five, and a word that still smells of one particular seed.

Your turn

- *Say it: tel*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: tel*, the thing the दाल is finished with

- *Recall:* say *ādar*
- *Read it:* आँगन

Before you move on

What does तेल mean? (“oil”.) Say it once more.

52.4 चीनी (chīnī) — sugar

Name the 3 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: चीनी

चीनी (*chīnī*) — “sugar”.

चीनी means, quite literally, ’Chinese’. The everyday Hindi word for sugar names the country the refining technique was associated with — the same shape as calling a thing *china* because of where it was made.

The traffic ran the other way too. English *sugar* came through Arabic *sukkar* from Sanskrit शर्करा (*śarkarā*), ’grit, gravel’ — so India exported the word for sugar to Europe and then named its own everyday sugar after China. Both halves of that are true at once.

What you’ve built

The fourth of five, and the only one that is a nationality.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *chīnī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *chīnī*, and then *chāy*, which you have had for a long time now
- *Read it:* आशीर्वाद
- *Recall:* say *mez*

Before you move on

What does चीनी mean? (“sugar”.) Say it once more.

52.5 सब्ज़ी (sabzī) — a vegetable, vegetables

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: सब्ज़ी

सब्ज़ी (*sabzī*) — "a vegetable, vegetables".

A Persian word: *sabz* means 'green', and -*ī* turns an adjective into a noun. सब्ज़ी is 'greenery' — the green things, taken together.

You have met this suffix already without being told: ख़ुशी (*khushī*), 'happiness', is *khush*, 'pleased', with the same -*ī* on the end. One ending, two words, both Persian.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सब्ज़ी (*sabzī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sabzī*, "greenness, greens". It is built on *sabz*, "green".

What you've built

The fifth of five. The kitchen is stocked.

Your turn

- *Say it: sabzī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: sabzī*, then *dāl*, then *chāval* — say the shelf in order
- *Recall:* say *praṇām*, then say *miṭhāī*

Before you move on

What does सब्ज़ी mean? ("a vegetable, vegetables".) Say it once more.

Chapter 53

More of the Body

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five more parts of the body when I say how I am.
>
> *Complete HI-C53-lip and say all five words in order.*

53.1 कंधा (kandhā) — a shoulder

> Before the new run of words: what did the last two words of the chapter before mean?

You'll want to know: कंधा

कंधा (*kandhā*) — "a shoulder".

From Sanskrit स्कन्ध (*skandha*), 'shoulder'. The initial *sk-* cluster could not survive into everyday Hindi and lost its *s*, which is the ordinary fate of a cluster like that in this family.

Skandha had a second life meaning 'the trunk of a tree' and then 'a section, a division' — the sense Buddhist texts use for the five aggregates. Hindi kept the shoulder and let the philosophy go.

What you've built

The first of five more parts of the body.

Your turn

- *Say it: kandhā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kandhā*, picturing your shoulder
- *Recall:* say *phūl*
- *Read it:* चावल

Before you move on

What does कंधा mean? (“a shoulder”.) Say it once more.

53.2 घुटना (ghuṭnā) — a knee

What did the word before this one mean?

You’ll want to know: घुटना

घुटना (*ghuṭnā*) — “a knee”.

Behind it stands a family of Sanskrit words for the ankle, *ghuṭa* and *ghuṇṭa*, though the details of how the knee-word grew out of them are not agreed on.

Be careful with this one in a dictionary: घुटना is also a verb meaning ’to be stifled’, and the two are unrelated. Hindi has a small number of these exact collisions, and the only way through is the sentence around the word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घुटना (*ghuṭnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. CDIAL lists it under **ghuṭṭa*, a form it reconstructs beside Sanskrit *ghuṭa*, “ankle”, and takes the whole family from Dravidian. It also allows a second road, through a form **ghũṭanā* built on the variant *ghuṇṭa* (CDIAL 4479).

What you’ve built

The second of five, and a word with a twin that means something else entirely.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghuṭnā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ghuṭnā*, then *kandhā* — the joint low, the joint high
- *Read it:* माला
- *Recall:* say *dāl*

Before you move on

What does घुटना mean? (“a knee”.) Say it once more.

53.3 माथा (māthā) — a forehead

Name the 2 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: माथा

माथा (*māthā*) — “a forehead”.

From Sanskrit मस्तक (*mastaka*), ’head’. The everyday word narrowed as it wore down: what meant the whole head now means the front of it.

मस्तक itself is still in Hindi, unworn, in formal and literary registers. So you have another register doublet of the kind you met with सुबह beside *prabhāt* — the same ancestor arriving twice, once eroded and everyday, once intact and bookish.

What you’ve built

The third of five, and a narrowing you can watch happen.

Your turn

- *Say it: māthā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: māthā*, and then सिर, which you met when the head was first named

- *Recall:* say *āṁgan*
- *Read it:* तेल

Before you move on

What does माथा mean? (“a forehead”.) Say it once more.

53.4 पीठ (pīṭh) — the back

Name the 3 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: पीठ

पीठ (*pīṭh*) — “the back”.

From Sanskrit *pṛṣṭi*, ’back’, a sister of पृष्ठ (*pṛṣṭha*), also “back” (CDIAL 8370). The heavy *-ṛṣṭ-* in the middle collapsed and paid for itself by lengthening the vowel in front of it.

That is the same bargain that gave you कान out of *karṇa* when the ear was named — a cluster gives way, and the vowel before it grows to keep the syllable’s weight. Once you have seen the trade twice it stops looking like an exception.

What you’ve built

The fourth of five, and the second time you have seen that trade.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *pīṭh*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *pīṭh*, then *kandhā* — the back and the shoulder above it
- *Read it:* मेज़
- *Recall:* say *chīnī*

Before you move on

What does पीठ mean? (“the back”.) Say it once more.

53.5 होंठ (hoṇṭh) — a lip

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: होंठ

होंठ (*hoṇṭh*) — "a lip".

From Sanskrit ओष्ठ (*oṣṭha*), 'lip'. Hindi added the nasal in the middle and an *h* at the front, both of which are ordinary enough in this line of descent.

Do not reach for Latin *labium* as a cousin here — it is not one. Two Indo-European languages can have perfectly ordinary words for the same body part that descend from completely different roots, which you have already met with रात beside *nox*.

What you've built

The fifth of five. That is the body, from the forehead down.

Your turn

- *Say it: hoṇṭh*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: hoṇṭh*, *māthā*, *kandhā*, *pīṭh*, *ghuṭnā* — top to bottom
- *Recall:* say *miṭhāī*
- *Read it:* सब्ज़ी

Before you move on

What does होंठ mean? ("a lip".) Say it once more.

Chapter 54

Animals

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five common animals when I say what something is called.
>
> *Complete HI-C54-goat and say all five words in order.*

54.1 गाय (gāy) — a cow

> Before the new run of words: what did the last two words of the chapter before mean?

You'll want to know: गाय

गाय (*gāy*) — "a cow".

From Sanskrit गो (*go*), 'cow' — and this one goes all the way back. The reconstructed ancestor is *g*^{w}*ṓws*, which gives Latin *bōs*, Greek *boûs*, and English *cow*.

So गाय and *cow* are the same word, separated by five thousand years and most of a continent. It is one of the cleanest cousins in this whole book: no borrowing, no detour, just two ends of one inheritance.

What you've built

The first of five animals, and a word English owns too.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāy*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: gāy*, and hear the *c-* of *cow* inside it
- *Recall:* say *chāval*
- *Read it:* **कंधा**

Before you move on

What does **गाय** mean? (“a cow”.) Say it once more.

54.2 घोड़ा (ghoṛā) — a horse

What did the word before this one mean?

You’ll want to know: घोड़ा

घोड़ा (*ghoṛā*) — “a horse”.

From Sanskrit **घोटक** (*ghoṭaka*), ’horse’ — a word whose own origin is uncertain and may not be Indo-European at all.

What makes it worth stopping on is what did *not* happen. Sanskrit had **अश्व** (*aśva*), the inherited horse-word, a straight cousin of Latin *equus* and Greek *híppos*. It lost. Everyday Hindi rides **घोड़ा**, and the ancient word survives only in names and formal compounds.

What you’ve built

The second of five, and an inherited word that was pushed out.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghoṛā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ghoṛā*, then *gāy* — the one that was replaced, the one that was not

- *Read it:* दाल
- *Recall:* say *ghuṭnā*

Before you move on

What does घोड़ा mean? (“a horse”.) Say it once more.

54.3 मछली (machhlī) — a fish

Name the 2 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: मछली

मछली (*machhlī*) — “a fish”.

From Sanskrit मत्स्य (*matsya*), ’fish’, through a Prakrit form in which the *-tsy-* cluster fused into the *-chh-* you now say.

The *-ī* on the end is the same feminine ending you have met on कुर्सी and बिल्ली, and मछली is feminine like them. The ending is doing grammatical work here, not naming anything.

What you’ve built

The third of five, and another cluster that gave way.

Your turn

- *Say it: machhlī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: machhlī*, and remember it is feminine
- *Recall:* say *tel*, then say *māthā*

Before you move on

What does मछली mean? (“a fish”.) Say it once more.

54.4 चिड़िया (chiṛiyā) — a small bird

Name the 3 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: चिड़िया

चिड़िया (*chiṛiyā*) — "a small bird".

The origin of चिड़िया is not settled. It is usually grouped with a family of words for small birds that look as though they were built from the noise a bird makes, but that is a description of the family, not a documented derivation.

It is worth saying plainly that 'sounds like a bird' is a guess and not evidence. The honest position is that this everyday word has no agreed ancestor, and that is the fifth such word you have met.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चिड़िया (*chiṛiyā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *caṭaka*, "sparrow" (CDIAL 4571). It came through a variant **ciṭaka*. CDIAL calls the word imitative of the bird's call, with similar words in Dravidian and Munda.

What you've built

The fourth of five, and a guess that this book will not make.

Your turn

- *Say it: chiṛiyā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: chiṛiyā*, small and feminine
- *Read it:* चीनी
- *Recall:* say *pīṭh*

Before you move on

What does चिड़िया mean? ("a small bird".) Say it once more.

54.5 बकरी (bakrī) — a goat

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: बकरी

बकरी (*bakrī*) — “a goat”.

From Sanskrit बर्कर (*barkara*), ’a kid, a young goat’. The masculine बकरा and feminine बकरी split the animal by sex, as Hindi does with बेटा and बेटी.

Notice what the pair does that English does not: *goat* covers both, and English has to add a word to say which. Hindi has already said it in the ending.

What you’ve built

The fifth of five. That is the yard.

Your turn

- *Say it: bakrī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: bakrī, gāy, ghoṛā, machhlī, chiṛiyā* — name them round
- *Recall:* say *sabzī*
- *Read it:* होंठ

Before you move on

What does बकरी mean? (“a goat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 55

The Sky

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five things in the sky and answer a simple question about them.
>
> *Complete HI-C55-sky and say all five words in order.*

55.1 सूरज (sūraj) — the sun

> Before the new run of words: what did the last two words of the chapter before mean?

You'll want to know: सूरज

सूरज (*sūraj*) — "the sun".

From Sanskrit सूर्य (*sūrya*), and behind that the Proto-Indo-European word for the sun, which also gives Latin *sōl*, Greek *hḗlios*, and English *sun*.

That makes सूरज a cousin of *solar* and of *sun* at once — the Latin word arriving in English through scholarship, the inherited one having been there all along. Same root, two doors.

What you've built

The first of five things overhead.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūraj*

- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *sūraj*, and hear *sol* inside it
- *Recall:* say *kandhā*
- *Read it:* गाय

Before you move on

What does सूरज mean? (“the sun”.) Say it once more.

55.2 चाँद (chā̃d) — the moon

What did the word before this one mean?

You’ll want to know: चाँद

चाँद (*chā̃d*) — “the moon”.

From Sanskrit चन्द्र (*candra*), ’shining, the moon’, on a root meaning ’to glow’. The moon is named for what it does, not for what it is.

The same root surfaces in Latin *candēre*, ’to shine white’ — which is where English gets *candle*, *candid* and *incandescent*. A candle and the moon are the same idea in two languages.

What you’ve built

The second of five, and a word that means ’the shining one’.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *chā̃d*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* *chā̃d*, then *sūraj* — night first, then day
- *Recall:* say *ghuṭnā*, then say *ghoṛā*

Before you move on

What does चाँद mean? (“the moon”.) Say it once more.

55.3 तारा (tārā) — a star

Name the 2 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: तारा

तारा (*tārā*) — "a star".

CDIAL files it under Sanskrit *tāraka*, 'belonging to the stars', a form beside *tārā*, 'fixed star' (CDIAL 5798). That family is usually traced to the reconstructed *$h_2$stḗr* — the same root as Latin *stella*, Greek *astḗr*, and English *star*. CDIAL itself compares Vedic *stṛ-*, 'star'.

So the three biggest things in the sky are, in Hindi, three separate PIE inheritances: सूरज with *sun*, चाँद with *candle*, तारा with *star*. Three for three, all genuine, which is rarer than it sounds.

What you've built

The third of five, and the third clean cousin in a row.

Your turn

- *Say it: tārā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: tārā*, and hear *star* in it
- *Recall:* say *māthā*, then say *machhlī*

Before you move on

What does तारा mean? ("a star".) Say it once more.

55.4 बादल (bādal) — a cloud

Name the 3 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: बादल

बादल (*bādal*) — "a cloud".

बादल is usually traced to a Sanskrit adjective for 'cloudy' built on वारि (*vāri*), 'water', though the route is less tidy than the three words before it and the sources do not all agree on the steps.

That is worth marking. Three clean etymologies in a row can make the fourth look clean too, and this one is not — it is probable rather than settled, and the difference matters.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बादल (*bādal*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vārdala*, "rainy day, bad weather" (CDIAL 11567).

What you've built

The fourth of five, and the first this chapter has had to hedge on.

Your turn

- *Say it: bādal*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: bādal*, and let the doubt sit there
- *Read it:* पीठ
- *Recall:* say *chiṛiyā*

Before you move on

What does बादल mean? ("a cloud".) Say it once more.

55.5 आसमान (āsmān) — the sky

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: आसमान

आसमान (*āsmān*) — "the sky".

A Persian word, *āsmān*, whose older Iranian form is a cousin of Sanskrit अश्मन् (*aśman*) — and *aśman* means 'stone'. The sky was imagined as a stone vault overhead.

Sanskrit's own everyday word for sky, आकाश (*ākāśa*), is a different word from a different root, and Hindi has both. So the sky above a Hindi speaker can be a Persian stone dome or a Sanskrit open space, depending on which word is reached for.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आसमान (*āsmān*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *āsmān*, "sky".

What you've built

The fifth of five. The sky is furnished.

Your turn

- *Say it: āsmān*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: āsmān*, and under it *sūraj*, *chā̃d*, *tārā*, *bādal*
- *Recall:* say *hoṇṭh*
- *Read it:* बकरी

Before you move on

What does आसमान mean? ("the sky".) Say it once more.

Chapter 56

The Road

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five places along the way when I take my leave.
>
> *Complete HI-C56-field and say all five words in order.*

56.1 सड़क (saṛak) — a road

> Before the new run of words: what did the last two words of the chapter before mean?

You'll want to know: सड़क

सड़क (*saṛak*) — "a road".

सड़क is an everyday word with a disputed history; the derivations offered for it do not agree, and none has become standard.

It sits oddly beside the four words after it in this chapter, which are all traceable. A chapter of five words is a fair sample of a language, and one unsettled origin in five is about the honest rate.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सड़क (*saṛak*) is inherited, but CDIAL gives two sources. It first lists the word under Sanskrit *sṛti*, "road, path" (CDIAL 13577), and in its addenda under *śaṭati*, "goes" (CDIAL 12269).

What you've built

The first of five places along the way.

Your turn

- *Say it: saṛak*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: saṛak*, the thing you set out along
- *Recall:* say *gāy*
- *Read it:* सूरज

Before you move on

What does सड़क mean? ("a road".) Say it once more.

56.2 गाँव (gā̃v) — a village

What did the word before this one mean?

You'll want to know: गाँव

गाँव (*gā̃v*) — "a village".

From Sanskrit ग्राम (*grāma*), 'village'. The *gr-* cluster simplified and the *m* left its nasality behind in the vowel as it went — which is exactly what you watched happen to पाँच when you first counted to five.

Grāma has not disappeared. It is still there, unworn, in the names of thousands of places and in the formal register, so the old form and the new one sit on the same map.

What you've built

The second of five, and the same nasal trade as पाँच.

Your turn

- *Say it: gā̃v*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: gā̃v*, and feel the nasal where the *m* used to be
- *Recall:* say *ghoṛā*
- *Read it:* चाँद

Before you move on

What does गाँव mean? (“a village”.) Say it once more.

56.3 बाज़ार (bāzār) — a market

Name the 2 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: बाज़ार

बाज़ार (*bāzār*) — “a market”.

Persian *bāzār*, a market. English borrowed the same word — *bazaar* — from the same Persian source, by way of Italian traders.

So this is not a cousin but a shared borrowing: Hindi and English both took it from Persian, separately. You met that shape with चाय, which the world took from Chinese by two different roads.

What you’ve built

The third of five, and a word English took from the same place.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāzār*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: bāzār*, on the *saṛak*
- *Recall:* say *machhlī*
- *Read it:* तारा

Before you move on

What does बाज़ार mean? (“a market”.) Say it once more.

56.4 दुकान (dukān) — a shop

Name the 3 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: दुकान

दुकान (*dukān*) — “a shop”.

An Arabic word, *dukkān*, meaning a shop or the raised bench a shopkeeper sits on, which reached Hindi through Persian.

That is the same road that brought you शुक्रिया and मुलाक़ात: Arabic word, Persian carrier, Hindi destination. By now the route should be as familiar as the words on it.

What you’ve built

The fourth of five, and a well-travelled road you have walked before.

Your turn

- *Say it: dukān*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: dukān*, in the *bāzār*
- *Recall:* say *chiṛiyā*
- *Read it:* बादल

Before you move on

What does दुकान mean? (“a shop”.) Say it once more.

56.5 खेत (khet) — a field

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: खेत

खेत (*khet*) — “a field”.

From Sanskrit **क्षेत्र** (*kṣetra*), ’field, ground’. The *kṣ*- cluster wore down to *kh*-, and what is left is one short syllable.

क्षेत्र survives beside it, intact, meaning ’a region, a domain, a field of study’ — the abstract sense. One ancestor, two descendants: the dirt and the discipline.

What you’ve built

The fifth of five. That is the way out of the village.

Your turn

- *Say it: khet*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: khet*, *g$\tilde{\bar{a}}$v*, *saṛak*, *bāzār*, *dukān* — walk it in order
- *Recall:* say *bakrī*
- *Read it:* **आसमान**

Before you move on

What does **खेत** mean? (“a field”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 57

A Gift and a Feast

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five things that go with thanks in Hindi.
>
> *Complete HI-C57-sweetness and say all five words in order.*

57.1 तोहफ़ा (tohfā) — a present

> Before the new run of words: what did the last two words of the chapter before mean?

You'll want to know: तोहफ़ा

तोहफ़ा (*tohfā*) — "a present".

An Arabic word, *tuḥfa*, 'a gift, a rarity', arriving through Persian on the same road as दुकान in the chapter before.

It carries a shade the English word does not: a *tuḥfa* is a gift that is choice, something a little rarer than what the occasion required. That shade is faint in modern Hindi but it has not gone.

What you've built

The first of five things that travel with thanks.

Your turn

- *Say it: tohfā*

- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: tohfā*, as if offering it
- *Recall:* say *sūraj*, then say *saṛak*

Before you move on

What does तोहफ़ा mean? (“a present”.) Say it once more.

57.2 दावत (dāvat) — a feast, an invitation

What did the word before this one mean?

You’ll want to know: दावत

दावत (*dāvat*) — “a feast, an invitation”.

From Arabic دعوة (*da*^{c}*wa*), ’a call, a summons, an invitation’, on the root *d*-^{c}-*w*, ’to call’.

The meaning slid from the invitation to the meal you were invited to, which is a short slide and a common one. In Hindi दावत can still be either — the calling or the eating — and the sentence decides which.

What you’ve built

The second of five, and a word that means both the calling and the meal.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāvat*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: dāvat*, and the *tohfā* you bring to it
- *Read it:* चाँद
- *Recall:* say *gā̃v*

Before you move on

What does दावत mean? (“a feast, an invitation”.) Say it once more.

57.3 थाली (thālī) — a metal platter

Name the 2 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: थाली

थाली (*thālī*) — "a metal platter".

From Sanskrit स्थाली (*sthālī*), a cooking pot or dish. The initial *sth-* cluster lost its *s*, the same simplification you watched in कंधा.

A थाली is not a plate in the English sense but the round metal tray a whole meal is laid out on at once, small bowls and all — which is why the word names a way of eating and not just an object.

What you've built

The third of five, and the thing the दावत arrives on.

Your turn

- *Say it: thālī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: thālī*, and on it the *dāl* and the *chāval*
- *Recall:* say *tārā*
- *Read it:* बाज़ार

Before you move on

What does थाली mean? ("a metal platter".) Say it once more.

57.4 ख़ुशबू (khushbū) — fragrance

Name the 3 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: ख़ुशबू

ख़ुशबू (*khushbū*) — "fragrance".

Two Persian pieces, and you already own one of them: *khush*, 'pleasant', is the *khush-* inside ख़ुशी, from the first time you were pleased to meet someone. *bū* is 'smell'. ख़ुशबू is a pleasant smell, said in the plainest way available.

Persian builds a great many words like this, and Hindi took the habit along with the words. Once you can hear the seam in the middle, a whole shelf of vocabulary stops being arbitrary.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ख़ुशबू (*khushbū*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *khushbū*, "fragrance". It is built from *khush*, "pleasant", the word inside ख़ुशी, "happiness", and *bū*, "smell".

What you've built

The fourth of five, and the first word you have been able to take apart.

Your turn

- *Say it: khushbū*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: khushbū*, and hear ख़ुशी in its first half
- *Read it:* बादल
- *Recall:* say *dukān*

Before you move on

What does ख़ुशबू mean? ("fragrance".) Say it once more.

57.5 मिठास (miṭhās) — sweetness

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: मिठास

मिठास (*miṭhās*) — "sweetness".

मीठा (*mīṭhā*, 'sweet', from Sanskrit मिष्ट *miṣṭa*) + **-आस** (*-ās*) → मिठास

The long *ī* shortens to *i*, and the ending makes an abstract noun out of the adjective, not the sweet thing but the quality itself.

मिठाई, which you met at the end of the welcome chapter, is the same stem with a different ending — the sweet you can hand someone. मिठास is what is in it. One root, one for the tray and one for the taste.

What you've built

The fifth of five. That is what goes with thanks.

Your turn

- *Say it: miṭhās*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: miṭhās*, and मिठाई beside it
- *Recall:* say *āsmān*
- *Read it:* खेत

Before you move on

What does मिठास mean? ("sweetness".) Say it once more.

Chapter 58

Inside the House

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five parts of a house when I greet someone at it.
>
> *Complete HI-C58-sheet and say all five words in order.*

58.1 दीवार (dīvār) — a wall

> Before the new run of words: what did the last two words of the chapter before mean?

You'll want to know: दीवार

दीवार (*dīvār*) — "a wall".

A Persian word, *dīvār*, 'wall'. Its older Iranian form was a compound, and the piece at the front of it is not certainly identified, so this book will name the Persian and stop there.

It is a loan and not a cousin, which is worth keeping straight: दरवाज़ा, which you already own, is Persian too, and the two of them furnish most of the outside of a Hindi house between them.

What you've built

The first of five parts of the house.

Your turn

- *Say it: dīvār*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: dīvār*, and दरवाज़ा in it
- *Recall:* say *saṛak*
- *Read it:* तोहफ़ा

Before you move on

What does दीवार mean? (“a wall”.) Say it once more.

58.2 छत (chat) — a roof

What did the word before this one mean?

You’ll want to know: छत

छत (*chat*) — “a roof”.

From a reconstructed **chatti*, ’covering’ (CDIAL 4971), on Sanskrit *chad-*, ’to cover’ — the root of छत्र (*chatra*), a parasol held over a person’s head. Roof and parasol are both coverings.

A flat छत in North India is a place people go, not only a lid: it is where washing dries and where the evening is sat out. The word covers the surface and the use at once.

What you’ve built

The second of five, and a covering that became a roof.

Your turn

- *Say it: chat*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: chat*, over the *dīvār*
- *Read it:* गाँव

- *Recall:* say *dāvat*

Before you move on

What does छत mean? (“a roof”.) Say it once more.

58.3 खिड़की (khiṛkī) — a window

Name the 2 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: खिड़की

खिड़की (*khiṛkī*) — “a window”.

The origin of खिड़की is not settled, and the derivations offered for it are guesses of varying quality rather than an agreed line.

This is the second time this book has had to say that about a piece of an ordinary house, and it will not be the last. A word being everywhere is no guarantee that its history was written down.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खिड़की (*khiṛkī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *khaṭakkikā*, “side door” (CDIAL 3770). The Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists.

What you’ve built

The third of five, and another honest gap.

Your turn

- *Say it: khiṛkī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: khiṛkī*, cut into the *dīvār*
- *Recall:* say *bāzār*, then say *thālī*

Before you move on

What does खिड़की mean? (“a window”.) Say it once more.

58.4 सीढ़ी (sīṛhī) — a staircase, a ladder

Name the 3 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: सीढ़ी

सीढ़ी (*sīṛhī*) — “a staircase, a ladder”.

सीढ़ी is traced to a Sanskrit word for a flight of steps, but the exact form behind it is disputed and the sources differ on which one it was.

The word does not distinguish a staircase from a ladder. Both are सीढ़ी, because what the word names is the going up, not the thing’s construction.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सीढ़ी (*sīṛhī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **śrīḍhi*, “resting-place, ladder”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 12709).

What you’ve built

The fourth of five, and one word for two objects.

Your turn

- *Say it: sīṛhī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: sīṛhī*, up to the *chat*
- *Read it:* दुकान
- *Recall:* say *khushbū*

Before you move on

What does सीढ़ी mean? (“a staircase, a ladder”.) Say it once more.

58.5 चादर (chādar) — a sheet

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: चादर

चादर (*chādar*) — "a sheet".

Persian *chādar*, a sheet or a veil — a single broad piece of cloth, whatever it is spread over. English borrowed it too, as *chuddar*.

So it ends the chapter the way दीवार began it: a Persian word for a plain domestic thing, taken whole. A Hindi house is furnished in two languages at once, and neither of them is hiding.

What you've built

The fifth of five. That is the house, wall to roof.

Your turn

- *Say it: chādar*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: chādar*, *sīṛhī*, *khiṛkī*, *chat*, *dīvār* — name the house
- *Recall:* say *khet*
- *Read it:* मिठास

Before you move on

What does चादर mean? ("a sheet".) Say it once more.

Chapter 59

The Vowel You Write and Do Not Say

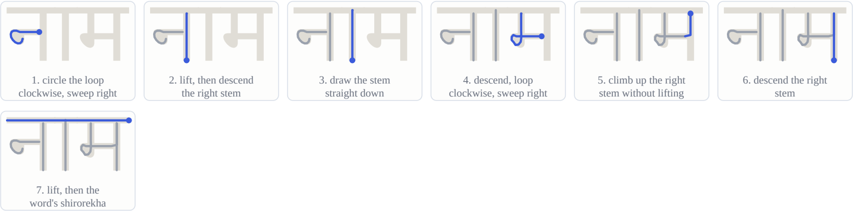
Modes: ✎ **pen** (11) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 11 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apply Hindi's word-final schwa deletion so a word I sound out letter by letter comes out the length a speaker says it, write three more matras and both forms of two vowels, nasalise with the chandrabindu, and produce the aspirated and retroflex contrasts English does not have.
>
> *The retroflex position – the single most audible foreign-accent tell in Hindi – closing a chapter that opened with the vowel Hindi writes and does not say.*

59.1 नाम — the vowel at the end of a word that you write and do not say

You already hold the whole system: inherent vowel, matra, matra position, virama and conjunct. What is left is shapes – and one rule nobody told you.

Script



How it is written — 5 strokes · 4 pen lifts · 7 movements

1. circle the loop clockwise, sweep right
2. lift, then descend the right stem
3. draw the stem straight down
4. descend, loop clockwise, sweep right
5. climb up the right stem without lifting
6. descend the right stem
7. lift, then the word's shirorekha

Stroke order after letter 1: Opiaterein, 'Deva-न-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 11 May 2009; sign 2: HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 47 (ा, aa sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012); letter 3: JackPotte, 'Devanagari m म.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009; the place of sign 2, after its consonant's body: Saurmandal, 'Devanagari आ stroke order.svg', frames 1–5, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023; the shared headline, drawn last: HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer: native writers' stored prototypes of the 33 consonants draw the headline as the last stroke in 82% of 2,706 and as the first in about 5% (MIT licence, 2012)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How नाम *is written, letter by letter, then one headline, stroke by stroke*

You know that a bare consonant carries an inherent **a**. Here is the exception that governs almost every Hindi word, and nobody tells a beginner until they have already mispronounced a hundred of them.

At the end of a word, that inherent vowel is not pronounced.

Take the word for *name*. Written out piece by piece it is न + ा + म, and reading each piece aloud gives *nā-ma*. But the word is **nām**. The final म carries an inherent *a* that Hindi simply does not say.

This is called **schwa deletion**, and it is why:

- नाम is *nām*, not *nāma*
- घर is *ghar*, not *ghara*
- राम is *Rām*, not *Rāma*

Sanskrit says the final vowel. Hindi drops it. The spelling is inherited from Sanskrit and never changed; the pronunciation moved on a thousand years ago. Both are true, and the script keeps the older one — exactly as English keeps the *k* in *knight*.

Two things follow, and the second is the useful one:

1. A word you sound out letter by letter will end one vowel too long. Trim it.
2. **This is not a special case to memorise per word.** It is the default. Say the final consonant bare unless something is written after it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* नाम
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

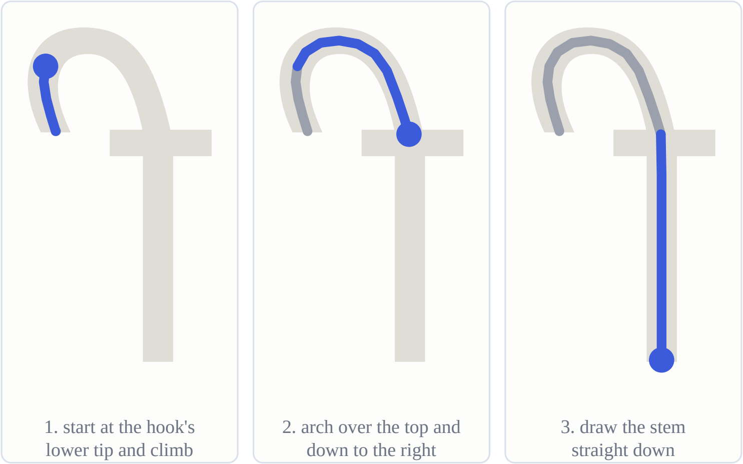
What happens to the inherent vowel at the end of a Hindi word? (**It is not pronounced.**) So how is नाम said? (***nām***, not *nāma*.) And why is the vowel still written? (The spelling is **inherited from Sanskrit**; the sound moved on.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.2 ◌ी — the long ee, and the mātrā that blocks more words than any other

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements



1. start at the hook's lower tip and climb

2. arch over the top and down to the right

3. draw the stem straight down

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 49 (ी, ii sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ◌ी is written, stroke by stroke

◌ी

ī, the long *ee* of English *see.* It stands to the **right** of its consonant, with a curve that rises and hooks back over the head-line to the left.

Keep it apart from the **ā** mātrā you already know: that one is a plain upright, this one carries the hook. In fast handwriting the hook is the only difference, and it changes the word.

Of every piece of Devanagari this book still owes you, **this one unlocks the most words** — it appears in more of the lessons ahead than any other single mark.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ◌ी
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

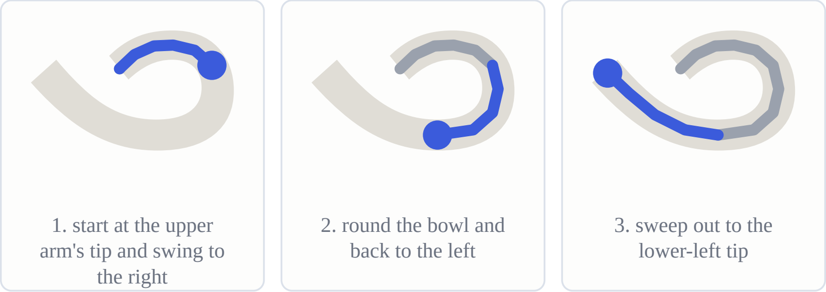
Before you move on

What sound does ◌ी add? (**ī**, the *ee* of *see.*) How do you tell it from the **ā** mātrā? (The **hook** back over the head-line.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.3 ◌ु — a mātrā that hangs BELOW the letter

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script



How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 3 movements

1. start at the upper arm's tip and swing to the right

2. round the bowl and back to the left

3. sweep out to the lower-left tip

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 50 (ु u sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ु *is written, stroke by stroke*

ु

u, the short *oo* of English *put.* And it introduces a position you have not met: it hangs **below** the consonant, tucked under its foot.

You now have mātrās in three places — to the right, above, and below. **Position is part of a character's identity**, not decoration, and a reader learns to look all the way **around** a consonant rather than only after it.

The long version of this vowel hangs below too, with an extra tail. Both are written under the letter they belong to, never beside it.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ु
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

Where does this mātrā sit? (**Below** the consonant.) How many positions have you now met? (**Three** — right, above, below.) Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.4 ◌ै — two strokes above the head-line, and one of the commonest endings in the language

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

◌ै

ai, roughly the vowel of English *cat* in most of Hindi. It sits **above** the head-line as **two** short strokes.

Its single-stroke relative is the **e** mātrā, and the difference is exactly one stroke — one stroke for *e*, two for *ai*. Miscount and you have a different word.

This one is worth the attention because of where it turns up: है, the word for *is*, ends in it, and that word appears in almost every sentence you will ever read.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ◌ै
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

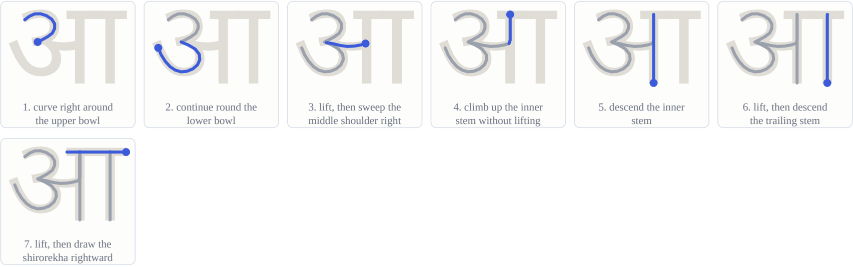
Before you move on

How many strokes above the head-line? (**Two** — one is a different vowel.) And which very common word ends in it? (है, *is*.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.5 आ — the independent vowel, for when a word begins with it

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script



How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 7 movements

1. curve right around the upper bowl

2. continue round the lower bowl

3. lift, then sweep the middle shoulder right

4. climb up the inner stem without lifting

5. descend the inner stem

6. lift, then descend the trailing stem

7. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, 'Devanagari आ stroke order.svg', frames 1–5, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How आ *is written, stroke by stroke*

आ

You know the **ā** mātrā. It only works **attached** to a consonant, so when a word *begins* with that vowel there is nothing to attach it to.

This is the character for that job: an **independent vowel**, standing on its own.

These are two different characters, not two styles of one. A font, a keyboard and this book treat them as entirely separate, and confusing them is the commonest spelling error in every Indic script. What decides which you write is **position**, not sound — this one begins a word, the mātrā rides on a consonant.

Look at the shape: it is the independent **a** with the same upright the mātrā uses added on the right. The relationship is visible, which is a rare kindness.

Your turn

- *Write it:* आ
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

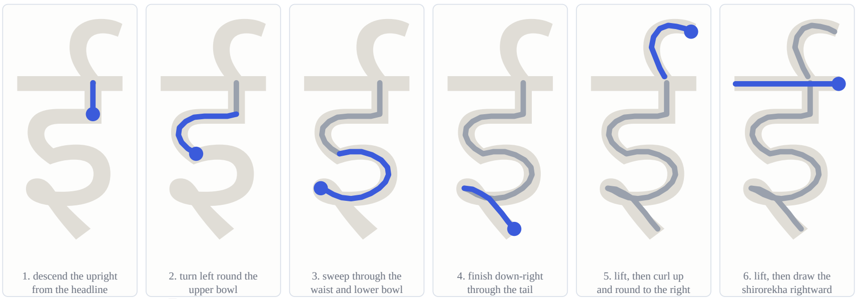
Which one begins a word? (आ.) Which rides on a consonant? (ा.)
Are they the same character? (**No**.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.6 ई — the independent form of the long ee

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 6 movements


1. descend the upright from the headline
2. turn left round the upper bowl
3. sweep through the waist and lower bowl
4. finish down-right through the tail
5. lift, then curl up and round to the right
6. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, ‘Devanagari □ stroke order.svg’, panels 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ई *is written, stroke by stroke*

ई

The same job as the last lesson, for the vowel you learned two lessons ago: this is **ī** standing on its own, for a word that begins with it.

The pattern is now visible and it is worth naming, because it repeats for every vowel in the script:

> every vowel has **two** forms — one **independent**, for the start of a word, and one **mātrā**, for riding on a consonant.

That is not two alphabets. It is one alphabet with a positional rule, and you have now met it three times.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ई
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

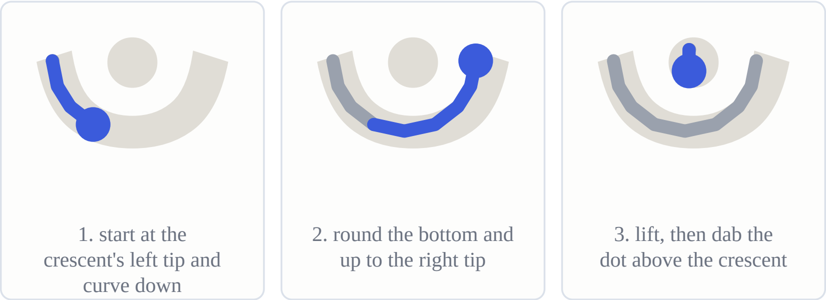
Before you move on

How many forms does a Devanagari vowel have? (**Two** — independent and mātrā.) What decides which you write? (**Position** in the word.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.7 ◌ँ — a moon and a dot that send the vowel through the nose

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script


How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 3 movements

1. start at the crescent's left tip and curve down
2. round the bottom and up to the right tip
3. lift, then dab the dot above the crescent

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 59 (ँ candrabindu): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ◌ँ is written, stroke by stroke

◌ँ

Not a vowel. The **chandrabindu** — *chandra* "moon", *bindu* "dot" — a crescent with a dot inside it, sitting above the head-line.

It does not change **which** vowel you say. It says: **send that vowel through your nose.**

English does this constantly and never writes it. Say *bad*, then *ban* — the vowel in the second is nasalised before you reach the *n*. Hindi writes what English leaves implicit, and here it is **meaning-bearing**: drop the mark and you have a different word.

You already draw the plain dot without the crescent — the anusvāra — and it does the same job. Which of the two a word takes depends on what else is sitting above the letter: where there is no room for the crescent, the plain dot does the work. Crescent plus dot, or dot alone, both mean *through the nose*.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ◌ँ
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

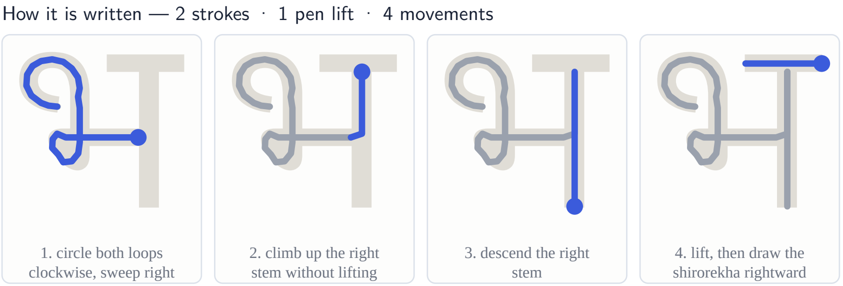
Before you move on

What does the chandrabindu do? (**Nasalises** the vowel.) Does it change which vowel you say? (**No**.) And what do its two parts mean? (**Moon** and **dot**.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.8 भ — an aspirated consonant

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script


How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 4 movements
1. circle both loops clockwise, sweep right
2. climb up the right stem without lifting
3. descend the right stem
4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after JackPotte, ‘Devanagari b^h भ.gif’, strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How भ *is written, stroke by stroke*

भ

bha — and the *h* is not decoration. This is **b** followed by a real puff of breath, and Hindi has a **separate letter** for it.

Hold your palm in front of your mouth. English *bin* gives almost no air; this letter demands a clear push. English treats the difference as an accident of emphasis; Hindi treats it as the difference between two words.

Devanagari is systematic about it: nearly every consonant has an unaspirated and an aspirated partner, written as different letters, and the aspirated one usually looks like a variation on its plain twin. **Once you know the pattern you can read half the alphabet from the other half.**

Your turn

- *Write it:* भ
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

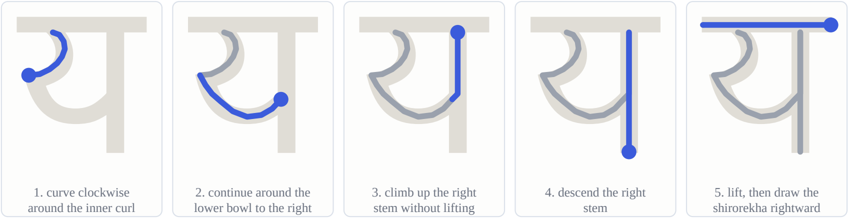
What does the *h* in *bha* mean? (A real **puff of breath**.) Does Hindi treat that as a different letter? (**Yes** — and a different word.) Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.9 य — the consonant ya

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 5 movements


1. curve clockwise around the inner curl
2. continue around the lower bowl to the right
3. climb up the right stem without lifting
4. descend the right stem
5. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-य-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How य *is written, stroke by stroke*

य

ya, the *y* of English *yes*, plus the inherent vowel.

A plain consonant with no new machinery — and by now that sentence should feel like the point rather than an apology. **Everything you learn from here is a shape.** The rules were all taught in the first script chapters: inherent vowel, mātrā, mātrā position, virama and conjunct, and the two forms of every vowel.

Your turn

- *Write it:* य
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

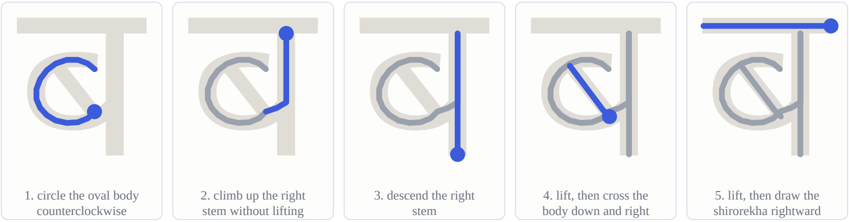
What is the inherent vowel in य? (**a** — but not at the end of a word.) And what remains to learn in this script — rules, or shapes? (**Shapes**.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.10 ब — the plain twin of an aspirated letter you already know

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

How it is written — 3 strokes · 2 pen lifts · 5 movements



1. circle the oval body counterclockwise
2. climb up the right stem without lifting
3. descend the right stem
4. lift, then cross the body down and right
5. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after JackPotte, 'Devanagari b ब.gif', strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ब is written, stroke by stroke

ब

ba — the *b* of English *bin*, with **no** puff of air.

Now put it beside the aspirated letter from a moment ago. Same family, same basic skeleton, one extra stroke on the aspirated one. That is the pattern this script uses across the whole consonant chart, and seeing it once here means you can guess at pairs you have not met.

Two letters, one distinction, and English speakers hear it as no distinction at all — which is why it is worth the whole lesson.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ब
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

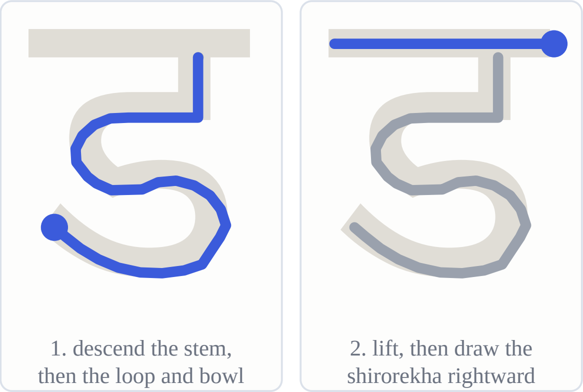
Which of the two has the puff of air? (भ.) And what is the shape relationship? (The aspirated one is a **variation on the plain twin**.)
Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

59.11 ड — a consonant made with the tongue curled back

Write the piece from the previous lesson before adding another.

Script

How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 2 movements



1. descend the stem, then the loop and bowl

2. lift, then draw the shiroreкha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-0921-order.gif’, strokes 1–2, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ड *is written, stroke by stroke*

ड

ḍa — and the dot under the transliteration is doing real work.

This is a **retroflex**: the tongue tip curls **back** and touches the roof of the mouth well behind the teeth. Hindi has a full retroflex set, and each one contrasts with a **dental** partner made with the tongue against the back of the teeth.

English has neither. Its *d* sits between the two, which is why an English speaker saying a Hindi word usually lands in the gap and is understood as neither. **This is the single most audible foreign-accent tell in Hindi**, more than any vowel.

The good news is that it is a position, not a sound to hear. Curl the tongue back and the rest follows.

Your turn

- *Write it:* ड
- *Read it:* every piece this chapter has given you so far, in order

Before you move on

Where does the tongue go for ड? (**Curled back**, behind the teeth.) What does it contrast with? (A **dental** partner, tongue against the teeth.) And where does English sit? (**Between the two** — neither.)

Source: Unicode Devanagari chart.

Chapter 60

Animals in the Yard

Modes: **voice** (5) **pen** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five more animals when I greet the house that keeps them.
>
> *Complete HI-C60-peacock and say all five words in order.*

60.1 बंदर (bandar) — a monkey

> Before the new run of words: which letter did the piece before this one give you, and where does the tongue go for it?

You'll want to know: बंदर

बंदर (*bandar*) — "a monkey".

From Sanskrit वानर (*vānara*), 'monkey', a word many readers of Sanskrit connect with वन (*vana*), 'forest' — the one who belongs to the woods. Prakrit wore it down and a nasal crept in at the front, and बंदर came out the other end.

Keep one thing straight before you travel. Persian has its own *bandar*, spelt the same in our letters, and it means a harbour — it is the *bandar* inside a dozen port names on the Indian Ocean. Two different words that happen to sound alike, not one word with two jobs.

What you've built

The first of five animals.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bandar*
- it once more, slowly
- *bandar*, then *ghoṛā*, and say which of them a house keeps on purpose

Before you move on

What does बंदर mean? (“a monkey”.) Say it once more.

60.2 ़ — the dot you have been reading and nobody named

Two letters you can draw: ड and ढ. Say each one.

Now look at बड़ा and पढ़ना. Something is under the letter in each of them that is not under the bare letter above.

Script you’ll notice: ़

़ — a single dot, sitting **below** the consonant.

It is **not a vowel sign**. A vowel sign changes the vowel a consonant carries. This one changes **the consonant itself** into a different sound, and the letter underneath keeps its shape.

Worked through: ड + ़ = ड़.

> The order is **carrier first, dot second**. The reference that defines this mark describes where the dot sits and what it combines with, not the order a hand should move in, so take carrier-first as a convention of this book rather than a rule handed down. Source: The Unicode Consortium, The Unicode Standard, Version 17.0, Core Specification, section 12.1.3 ‘Combining Marks’, U+093C Devanagari Sign Nukta, 2025.

Script: the two that flap

letter	with the dot	sound
ड	ड़	*ṛa*
ढ	ढ़	*ṛha*

The tongue taps the roof of the mouth once and flicks forward. It is a flap rather than a held sound.

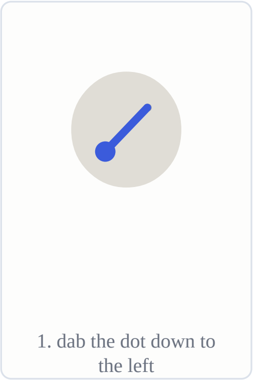
Every one of these was yours long before this page:

- बड़ा — big
- सड़क — road
- खिड़की — window
- पढ़ना — to read
- सीढ़ी — stair

Read them again and this time **the dot is part of what you are reading**. Look at where in each word the dotted letter falls.

Writing: ◌़ — follow the numbered strip

How it is written — one unbroken stroke · 1 movement



1. dab the dot down to the left

Stroke order after HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 62 (़ nukta): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012)
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ◌़ is written, stroke by stroke

Draw the consonant the way you already draw it. Then put one dot below it, under the middle of the letter, clear of the line.

Put your pen on ड़ and follow it. Copy the shape slowly and larger than it is printed.

> The strip shows **where to start the dot and which way to make it**, in one attested order. That is taught with real variation from school to school, so the strip names its source beneath it: treat it as a sound way in, not the only one.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words and find the dot in each

  सड़क · सीढ़ी

- *Trace it:* ड़ three times, saying *ṛa* as you finish each one
- *Say it:* what the dot changes — the vowel, or the consonant

Before you move on

Where does ◌़ sit? (Below the consonant.) What does it change? (The consonant, not the vowel.) Name a word you have read for weeks that carries it.

60.3 साँप (sā̃p) — a snake

Before the new one: what did *bandar* mean?

You’ll want to know: साँप

साँप (*sā̃p*) — “a snake”.

From Sanskrit सर्प (*sarpa*), ’snake’, built on सृप् (*sṛp-*), ’to creep’. The animal is named for what it does, and Latin did exactly the same thing: *serpēns* is ’the creeping one’, from the very same ancient root.

So English *serpent* and Hindi साँप are the same word, four thousand years apart, and neither of them borrowed it from the other. The *r* of सर्प melted into the *p*, and the nose-vowel you learnt to write is what is left standing where it was.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sā̃p*
- it once more, slowly
- *sā̃p*, then *bandar*, and say which one you would rather meet

Before you move on

What does साँप mean? (“a snake”.) Say it once more.

60.4 मुर्गी (murgī) — a hen

Before the new one: what did *sā̃p* mean?

You’ll want to know: मुर्गी

मुर्गी (*murgī*) — “a hen”.

Persian مرغ (*murgh*) meant a bird of any kind, and Hindi narrowed it to the one bird a household actually keeps. मुर्गा (*murgā*) is the cock, मुर्गी the hen.

This one earns its place at dawn. A मुर्गा wakes a village well before any clock does, which is a large part of why nobody in that village ever needed a घंटा to do the same job. And note what it is not: चिड़िया, which you already own, stays with the small wild birds.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मुर्गी (*murgī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *murgh*, “bird, fowl”. Hindi names the hen with *-ī* and the cock *murgā*.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *murgī*
- it once more, slowly
- *murgī*, then *chiṛiyā*, and say which one lives in the yard

Before you move on

What does मुर्गी mean? (“a hen”.) Say it once more.

60.5 भैंस (bhaĩs) — a buffalo

Before the new one: what did *murgī* mean?

You’ll want to know: भैंस

भैंस (*bhaĩs*) — “a buffalo”.

From Sanskrit महिषी (*mahiṣī*), the female of महिष (*mahiṣa*), ’buffalo’. The feminine is the form that survived into everyday Hindi, because the female is the animal a household has reason to talk about every day.

Most of the milk in North India comes from a भैंस and not from a गाय, which is the opposite of what an English speaker expects. दूध and the sweets built on it all start here.

What you’ve built

Four.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bhaĩs*
- it once more, slowly
- *bhaĩs*, then *gāy*, and say which one fills the दूध pail

Before you move on

What does भैंस mean? (“a buffalo”.) Say it once more.

60.6 मोर (mor) — a peacock

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: मोर

मोर (*mor*) — “a peacock”.

From Sanskrit मयूर (*mayūra*). The *y* dropped out, the two vowels ran together, and a three-piece word became a one-piece one — the same wearing-down you have watched happen to a dozen words by now.

मयूर itself is still alive in formal Hindi and in names, so the two forms sit side by side: the old one on a wedding card, मोर in the yard. And the yard is where you meet it — a मोर walks into a village at dusk the way a pigeon walks into a city square.

What you’ve built

Five: बंदर, साँप, मुर्गी, भैंस, मोर. Enough to name what lives around a house you are greeting.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mor*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *namaste* to whoever keeps them

Before you move on

What does मोर mean? (“a peacock”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 61

At the Cooking Fire

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) ✎ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five things at a Hindi cooking fire and ask for them politely.
>
> *Complete HI-C61-stove and say all five words in order.*

61.1 बर्तन (bartan) — a cooking vessel

> Before the new run of words: what did *mor* mean, and what did *bhaĩs* mean?

You’ll want to know: बर्तन

बर्तन (*bartan*) — “a cooking vessel”.

बर्तन is the word that goes with बरतना (*baratnā*), ’to handle, to make use of’, and behind both stands Sanskrit वृत् (*vṛt-*), ’to turn, to carry on’. A बर्तन is, quite literally, a thing in use.

That is why one word covers the whole shelf. A pot, a pan, a tray, a lid — each has its own name, and all of them together are बर्तन. Ask politely for बर्तन and you have asked for whatever the cooking needs.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of बर्तन (*bartan*) is uncertain. It is often traced to Sanskrit *vartana*, but CDIAL does not list it, and its *vartana* means “turning, rolling” (CDIAL 11354).

What you've built

The first of five things at the fire.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *bartan*
- it once more, slowly
- *bartan*, then *thālī*, and say which of them is the whole shelf

Before you move on

What does बर्तन mean? ("a cooking vessel".) Say it once more.

61.2 ज़ फ़ ख़ क़ — the same dot, a different job

The mark from before: where does it sit, and what does it change?

On ड and ढ it made a flap. On these four it does something else — it lets the letter carry a sound that came into Hindi from outside it.

Script you'll notice: ज़ फ़ ख़ क़

letter	with the dot	sound
ज	ज़	*za*
फ	फ़	*fa*
ख	ख़	*xa*
क	क़	*qa*

ज़ is the *z* of English *zoo*. फ़ is the *f* of *far*. ख़ is made further back than ख, at the soft palate. क़ is made further back than क, at the very top of the throat.

Many speakers say the plain letter for all four and are understood. The dot is still printed, so a reader has to know it.

Script: words you already say

- ज़रूर — certainly · मेज़ — table · दरवाज़ा — door
- सफ़ेद — white · सफ़र — a journey · तोहफ़ा — a gift
- ख़ुशी — happiness · ख़ुशबू — fragrance
- मुलाक़ात — a meeting

One pair you have met already. खाना and ख़ाना were taught together, and the dot between them was named there as a fact about those two words. It is the same dot, and it is doing the same job in every word on this page. That lesson also told you the truth about it: **the dot is often left off in print**, and a reader sorts the two out from context.

Writing: the dotted four — copy what you see

The letter is drawn exactly as you draw it bare. One dot goes below, clear of the line.

Put your pen on ज़ and follow it, then फ़. Copy slowly and larger than it is printed.

> This book does not tell you **where to start the character or which way to travel**. That is a real thing, taught with real variation from school to school, and it is not written down here until it can be written down with a source.

Your turn

- *Look:* at these two words and say which one means food

  खाना · ख़ाना

- *Say it:* ज़रूर and मेज़ aloud, letting the dotted letter buzz like *z*
- *Trace it:* फ़ three times, saying *fa* as you finish each one

Before you move on

Which four letters take the dot for a borrowed sound? Name the sound each one carries. What tells खाना from ख़ाना on the page?

61.3 चम्मच (chammach) — a spoon

Before the new one: what did *bartan* mean?

You'll want to know: चम्मच

चम्मच (*chammach*) — "a spoon".

Sanskrit had **चमस** (*camasa*), a wooden ladle lifted at sacrifices, and **चम्मच** sits close enough to it that the two are often printed together. The road between them is not clean, though, so this book will show you the pair and stop there.

What is certain is the shape of the modern word: a doubled *m* in the middle, and the stress landing forward. Say it twice and you will hear that it is built to be said quickly, the way the names of small everyday objects usually are.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चम्मच (*chammach*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *chamcha*, "spoon, ladle", a word Persian itself took from Turkic.

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *chammach*
- it once more, slowly
- *chammach*, then *bartan*, and say which one goes inside the other

Before you move on

What does **चम्मच** mean? ("a spoon".) Say it once more.

61.4 गिलास (gilās) — a tumbler

Before the new one: what did *chammach* mean?

You’ll want to know: गिलास

गिलास (*gilās*) — “a tumbler”.

This one is English *glass*, taken whole. It arrived with the object, the way कैमरा arrived with the camera, and Hindi gave it a vowel in the middle so that a Hindi mouth could get through the *gl-* at the front.

Watch what happened to the meaning on the way in. A Hindi गिलास is a drinking tumbler and is very often made of steel, so the English word for the material now names an object in a language where the object is usually not made of it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गिलास (*gilās*) is a loan from English *glass*.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *gilās*
- it once more, slowly
- *gilās*, then *pānī* in it

Before you move on

What does गिलास mean? (“a tumbler”.) Say it once more.

61.5 तवा (tavā) — a flat iron griddle

Before the new one: what did *gilās* mean?

You’ll want to know: तवा

तवा (*tavā*) — “a flat iron griddle”.

Usually traced to a Sanskrit word on the root तप् (*tap*-), 'to heat, to burn' — the heater. The same root is inside तपस्, the heat of hard practice, so the kitchen and the hermitage turn out to share a syllable.

A तवा is a flat iron disc over the fire, and it is what रोटी is made on. No तवा, no रोटी: the bread you met early on is defined by the surface it is cooked on as much as by the flour.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तवा (*tavā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **tapaka*, "frying pan", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5670). It is built on the verb *tap*-, "to heat".

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *tavā*
- it once more, slowly
- *tavā*, then *roṭī*, and say which one comes off the other

Before you move on

What does तवा mean? ("a flat iron griddle".) Say it once more.

61.6 चूल्हा (chūlhā) — a cooking fire

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: चूल्हा

चूल्हा (*chūlhā*) — "a cooking fire".

From Sanskrit चुल्ली (*cullī*), 'fireplace, hearth'. The oldest चूल्हा is a horseshoe of packed clay on the floor, fed with wood at the front, with the तवा sitting on top of it.

It also counts households. To say two brothers have separate चूल्हे is to say they no longer eat as one family — the fire, not the roof, is what marks where one household ends. A gas ring in a city flat inherits the word and the meaning both.

What you've built

Five: बर्तन, चम्मच, गिलास, तवा, चूल्हा. Enough to ask for what the cooking needs.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *chūlhā*
- it once more, slowly
- all five in order, then *kṛpayā* in front of it

Before you move on

What does चूल्हा mean? ("a cooking fire".) Say it once more.

Chapter 62

What Hands Work With

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five things a pair of hands works with when I say what something is called.
>
> *Complete HI-C62-wood and say all five words in order.*

62.1 रस्सी (rassī) — a rope

> Before the new run of words: what did *chūlhā* mean, and what did *tavā* mean?

You'll want to know: रस्सी

रस्सी (*rassī*) — "a rope".

From Sanskrit रश्मि (*raśmi*), which meant a cord or a rein — and also a ray of the sun. One word held both, because a ray was pictured as a thread let down from the sky.

Hindi kept the thread and let the light go: रस्सी is plain rope, the kind that draws a bucket up out of the ground. The bright half of रश्मि survives in names and in poetry, so the two halves of the old word now live in different registers.

What you've built

The first of five things hands work with.

Your turn

- *Say it: rassī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: rassī*, then *sūraj*, and say what the old word held in common
- *Recall:* say *bandar*
- *Read it:* बर्तन

Before you move on

What does रस्सी mean? (“a rope”.) Say it once more.

62.2 सूई (sūī) — a needle

Before the new one: what did *rassī* mean?

You’ll want to know: सूई

सूई (*sūī*) — “a needle”.

From Sanskrit *sūcī*, ’needle’, on सूच् (*sūc-*), ’to point out, to indicate’. A needle is named for the fact that it points.

The same root gives Hindi’s everyday word for ’information’, the one on every notice board and news bulletin — a thing pointed out to you. A tailor’s tool and a public announcement, off one small Sanskrit word about pointing.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: sūī*, then *kapṛā*, and say which one goes through the other
- *Read it:* साँप
- *Recall:* say *chammach*

Before you move on

What does सूई mean? (“a needle”.) Say it once more.

62.3 टोकरी (ṭokrī) — a basket

Before the new one: what did *sūī* mean?

You’ll want to know: टोकरी

टोकरी (*ṭokrī*) — “a basket”.

Here the trail stops early. टोकरी has no agreed Sanskrit ancestor, and the retroflex ट at the front is the sound most often credited to old contact with the Dravidian languages of the south — the same honest gap you already met under पेट.

A टोकरी is woven, usually from split cane or from the ribs of a leaf, and it is what सब्ज़ी comes home from the बाज़ार in. Light, cheap, and mended rather than replaced.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टोकरी (*ṭokrī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ṭokka*, “basket”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5477). The *-r-* is an added suffix.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭokrī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ṭokrī*, then *sabzī* in it
- *Recall:* say *murgī*
- *Read it:* गिलास

Before you move on

What does टोकरी mean? (“a basket”.) Say it once more.

62.4 मिट्टी (miṭṭī) — clay, earth

Before the new one: what did *ṭokrī* mean?

You’ll want to know: मिट्टी

मिट्टी (*miṭṭī*) — “clay, earth”.

From Sanskrit मृत्तिका (*mṛttikā*), ’earth, clay’, on मृद् (*mṛd*), ’soil’. Five syllables became two, and the meaning did not move at all.

One word does the work of two English ones. मिट्टी is the ground under a field and the material a दीया is pinched out of — and the दीया you already own is the clearest case, since it is thrown away after one night and goes back to being मिट्टी.

What you’ve built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: miṭṭī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: miṭṭī*, then *dīyā*, and say which one the other is made of
- *Read it:* भैंस
- *Recall:* say *tavā*

Before you move on

What does मिट्टी mean? (“clay, earth”.) Say it once more.

62.5 लकड़ी (lakṛī) — wood, a stick of firewood

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: लकड़ी

लकड़ी (*lakṛī*) — “wood, a stick of firewood”.

Usually traced back to Sanskrit लगुड (*laguḍa*), ’a club, a staff’, through a Prakrit form with a doubled consonant in the middle. A word for a stick you swing became the word for the stuff a stick is made of.

लकड़ी is both, in fact: the material and one piece of it. A bundle of it under the arm is what feeds the चूल्हा, which is why this word and that one turn up in the same sentence more often than any other pair in this book.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लकड़ी (*lakṛī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *lakuṭa*, “club, stick” (CDIAL 10875). It came through a variant **lakkuṭa*.

What you’ve built

Five: रस्सी, सूई, टोकरी, मिट्टी, लकड़ी. Enough to say what a working pair of hands is holding.

Your turn

- *Say it: lakṛī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then *merā nām* and your own name
- *Recall:* say *mor*
- *Read it:* चूल्हा

Before you move on

What does लकड़ी mean? (“wood, a stick of firewood”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 63

What the Body Tells You

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what my body is telling me when someone asks how I am.
>
> *Complete HI-C63-pain and say all five words in order.*

63.1 भूख (bhūkh) — hunger

> Before the new run of words: what did *lakṛī* mean, and what did *miṭṭī* mean?

You’ll want to know: भूख

भूख (*bhūkh*) — “hunger”.

From Sanskrit बुभुक्षा (*bubhukṣā*), ’the wish to eat’, built on भुज् (*bhuj-*), ’to eat, to enjoy’. The old form doubles its own first syllable, which is how Sanskrit marked wanting to do a thing rather than doing it.

So भूख was never the state of an empty stomach — it was the appetite, the wanting. A speaker says भूख belongs to them rather than that they are it, and the wanting is the thing that is owned.

What you’ve built

The first of five things a body reports.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhūkh*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: bhūkh*, then *roṭī*, and say which one settles the other
- *Recall:* say *bartan*
- *Read it:* रस्सी

Before you move on

What does भूख mean? ("hunger".) Say it once more.

63.2 प्यास (pyās) — thirst

Before the new one: what did *bhūkh* mean?

You'll want to know: प्यास

प्यास (*pyās*) — "thirst".

From Sanskrit पिपासा (*pipāsā*), 'the wish to drink', on पा (*pā-*), 'to drink' — and doubling its first syllable exactly the way बुभुक्षा does. The two words were made in the same workshop on the same day.

पा is the root under पानी, the word you have had since the water lesson: 'the drinkable one'. So प्यास and पानी are the wanting and the thing wanted, cut from a single syllable.

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: pyās*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: pyās*, then *pānī*, and say which one ends the other
- *Read it:* चम्मच
- *Recall:* say *sūī*

Before you move on

What does प्यास mean? (“thirst”.) Say it once more.

63.3 नींद (nīnd) — sleep

Before the new one: what did *pyās* mean?

You’ll want to know: नींद

नींद (*nīnd*) — “sleep”.

From Sanskrit निद्रा (*nidrā*), ’sleep’. The *r* went, the vowel picked up the nose-mark you learnt to write, and निद्रा turned into नींद without changing its meaning by a hair.

It patterns with भूख and प्यास: a speaker says नींद is coming to them, not that they are sleepy. Three states in a row that Hindi treats as visitors rather than as things you are.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: nīnd*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: nīnd*, then *rāt*, and say which one brings the other
- *Recall:* say *gilās*
- *Read it:* टोकरी

Before you move on

What does नींद mean? (“sleep”.) Say it once more.

63.4 बुख़ार (bukhār) — a fever

Before the new one: what did *nīnd* mean?

You'll want to know: बुख़ार

बुख़ार (*bukhār*) — "a fever".

An Arabic word, *bukhār*, that came in through Persian. Its plain sense is steam or vapour — the mist that comes off hot water.

Older medicine pictured a fever as exactly that: a vapour rising inside a body. The picture was wrong and the word stayed, which happens more often than not. Note the dot under the ख़, the same dot you have already met inside ख़ुशी.

What you've built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: bukhār*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: bukhār*, then *ṭhīk*, and say which one you would rather report
- *Read it:* तवा
- *Recall:* say *miṭṭī*

Before you move on

What does बुख़ार mean? ("a fever".) Say it once more.

63.5 दर्द (dard) — pain

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: दर्द

दर्द (*dard*) — "pain".

A Persian word, *dard*, and it is usually traced to a very old root meaning 'to split, to tear' — the same root that surfaces in English *tear*, in the sense of ripping cloth.

दर्द covers the ache in a घुटना and the grief in a chest with one word, and Urdu poetry leans on that double reach so hard that the word now sounds a little literary even when it is plainly medical.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दर्द (*dard*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *dard*, “pain”.

What you’ve built

Five: भूख, प्यास, नींद, बुख़ार, दर्द. Enough to answer honestly when someone asks how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: dard*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then *ṭhīk*, if you are
- *Recall:* say *chūlhā*
- *Read it:* लकड़ी

Before you move on

What does दर्द mean? (“pain”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 64

How Much and How Fast

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say how much and how fast in Hindi when I answer someone.
>
> *Complete HI-C64-more and say all five words in order.*

64.1 अब (ab) — now, from this point on

> Before the new run of words: what did *dard* mean, and what did *bukhār* mean?

You’ll want to know: अब

अब (*ab*) — “now, from this point on”.

The dictionaries do not agree on where अब came from, and this book will say so rather than invent a chain. What it does is clear enough, and that is worth more here than a pedigree.

अब draws a line: everything before it was one way, and from here on things are another. That is what separates it from अभी, which you already own — अभी is this very second, अब is from this second onward. *ab* and *abhī* look alike and do different work.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अब (*ab*) is inherited. CDIAL lists it under Sanskrit *evam eva*, “exactly so”, crossed with the pronoun stem *a-*, “this”, and lists *kab*, “when”, *tab*, “then”, and *jab*, “when”, beside it, each crossed with its own pronoun stem (CDIAL 2528).

What you've built

The first of five words of degree and pace.

Your turn

- *Say it: ab*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: ab*, then *abhī*, and say which one draws a line
- *Recall:* say *rassī*
- *Read it:* भूख

Before you move on

What does अब mean? ("now, from this point on".) Say it once more.

64.2 जल्दी (jaldī) — quickly, soon

Before the new one: what did *ab* mean?

You'll want to know: जल्दी

जल्दी (*jaldī*) — "quickly, soon".

From Persian *jald*, 'brisk, quick', itself an Arabic word, with the ending Persian hangs on such words to make a quality-word. So जल्दी began as 'quickness' and ended up doing the work of 'quickly' and 'soon' at once.

Hindi still keeps both jobs alive. जल्दी on its own tells someone to hurry; जल्दी beside a plan means it will happen before long. The word does not distinguish speed from nearness in time, and speakers hear which one from the sentence around it.

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: jaldī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: jaldī*, then *phir milenge*
- *Read it:* सूई
- *Recall:* say *pyās*

Before you move on

What does जल्दी mean? (“quickly, soon”.) Say it once more.

64.3 धीरे (dhīre) — slowly

Before the new one: what did *jaldī* mean?

You’ll want to know: धीरे

धीरे (*dhīre*) — “slowly”.

From Sanskrit धीर (*dhīra*), which meant steady, calm, firm of mind. Hindi’s word for slow is the old word for unhurried, and the compliment inside it never quite left.

Doubled — धीरे धीरे — it means ’little by little’, and that doubled form is the one you will hear most. Saying a word twice to mean a gentle continuing is one of the most useful habits Hindi has.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhīre*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: dhīre*, then *jaldī*, and say which one you would ask a speaker for

- *Recall:* say *ṭokrī*
- *Read it:* नींद

Before you move on

What does धीरे mean? (“slowly”.) Say it once more.

64.4 कम (kam) — little, not much

Before the new one: what did *dhīre* mean?

You’ll want to know: कम

कम (*kam*) — “little, not much”.

Persian *kam*, ’few, little’, taken in whole. It answers ’how much’ with a shrug downward, and it can sit in front of almost anything a speaker wants to play down.

One warning, and it is about our letters rather than about Hindi. कमरा, the room you learnt in the house arc, begins with the same two sounds and has nothing whatever to do with कम — it walked in from Portuguese. In Devanagari nobody would confuse them; in a romanization *kam* and *kamrā* sit uncomfortably close.

What you’ve built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: kam*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: kam*, then *kamrā*, and say which one is Persian
- *Read it:* मिट्टी
- *Recall:* say *bukhār*

Before you move on

What does कम mean? (“little, not much”.) Say it once more.

64.5 ज़्यादा (zyādā) — a lot, more

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: ज़्यादा

ज़्यादा (*zyādā*) — “a lot, more”.

Arabic زيادة (*ziyāda*), ’an increase’, through Persian. It is the exact counterweight of कम, and the two of them are the fastest way in Hindi to answer ’how much’ without naming a number.

The nukta under the ज़ is doing real work, the same as in ज़रूर. Drop it and you have a different consonant; keep it and you have the sound Persian and Arabic brought with the word.

What you’ve built

Five: अब, जल्दी, धीरे, कम, ज़्यादा. Enough to answer how much and how fast.

Your turn

- *Say it: zyādā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then *bilkul*
- *Recall:* say *lakṛī*
- *Read it:* दर्द

Before you move on

What does ज़्यादा mean? (“a lot, more”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 65

Asking Nicely

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask for something in Hindi with the courtesy word the occasion asks for.
>
> *Complete HI-C65-manners and say all five words in order.*

65.1 मेहरबानी (mehrabānī) — kindness

> Before the new run of words: what did *zyādā* mean, and what did *kam* mean?

You’ll want to know: मेहरबानी

मेहरबानी (*mehrabānī*) — “kindness”.

Persian *mihrbān*, ’kind’, with the quality-ending on the back of it. Under *mihrbān* is *mihr*, an old Iranian word for love and for the sun, and the god Mithra before either.

Two words in your Hindi now begin *meh-* and are not related at all: **मेहमान**, the guest, is Persian *mihmān*, a different word entirely. Same opening syllable in our letters, separate families.

What you’ve built

The first of five words for asking well.

Your turn

- *Say it: mehrabānī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: mehrabānī*, then *mehmān*, and say which one is the guest
- *Recall:* say *bhūkh*
- *Read it:* अब

Before you move on

What does मेहरबानी mean? (“kindness”.) Say it once more.

65.2 विनती (vintī) — an entreaty

Before the new one: what did *mehrabānī* mean?

You’ll want to know: विनती

विनती (*vintī*) — “an entreaty”.

Usually derived from Sanskrit विज्ञप्ति (*vijñapti*), ’a respectful making-known’, which is what a petition to a king was called. The heavy conjunct in the middle collapsed on its way through Prakrit and left विनती.

It sits above कृपया in weight. कृपया goes in front of a request the way ’please’ does; विनती is the request itself, offered from below, and it turns up in prayer and in a plea as often as in ordinary speech.

What you’ve built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: vintī*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: vintī*, then *kṛpayā*, and say which one is the asking itself
- *Read it:* प्यास
- *Recall:* say *jaldī*

Before you move on

What does विनती mean? (“an entreaty”.) Say it once more.

65.3 अनुमति (anumati) — permission

Before the new one: what did *vintī* mean?

You’ll want to know: अनुमति

अनुमति (*anumati*) — “permission”.

Sanskrit, and transparent: अनु (*anu*), ’along with, after’, plus मति (*mati*), ’thought’. Permission is thinking along with someone — agreeing in mind before agreeing in words.

It is the formal one. On a form, at a desk, or in front of anyone whose yes carries weight, अनुमति is the word; among friends nobody says it. Hindi keeps a Sanskrit word in reserve for exactly these rooms.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अनुमति (*anumati*) is Sanskrit *anumati*, “assent, permission”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: anumati*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: anumati*, then *dhanyavād*
- *Recall:* say *nīnd*
- *Read it:* धीरे

Before you move on

What does अनुमति mean? (“permission”.) Say it once more.

65.4 भरोसा (bharosā) — trust

Before the new one: what did *anumati* mean?

You’ll want to know: भरोसा

भरोसा (*bharosā*) — “trust”.

Usually built on भर (*bhara*), ’a load, a support’, from the root भृ (*bhṛ*-), ’to bear, to carry’. Trust is named as the thing that takes your weight.

That picture runs through the way the word is said, too: a speaker puts भरोसा on someone rather than in them. The load goes on top, and the person underneath either holds or does not.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भरोसा (*bharosā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **bharavaśya*, “dependence on support”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9398). It is built from *bhara*, “support”, and *vaśa*, “power, control”.

What you’ve built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: bharosā*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: bharosā*, then *dost*, and say who takes the weight
- *Read it:* बुख़ार
- *Recall:* say *kam*

Before you move on

What does भरोसा mean? (“trust”.) Say it once more.

65.5 अदब (adab) — good manners

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: अदब

अदब (*adab*) — “good manners”.

Arabic *adab*, and here is the surprise: the same word means literature. Courtesy and letters were one idea — the cultivation that makes a person fit company, whether it shows in a bow or on a page.

Guard it against आदर, which you already own. *ādar* is respect you feel and show upward; *adab* is the whole trained manner a person carries. Close in our letters, and not the same word.

What you’ve built

Five: मेहरबानी, विनती, अनुमति, भरोसा, अदब. Enough to ask for a thing at the weight the room asks for.

Your turn

- *Say it: adab*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then *dhanyavād*
- *Recall:* say *dard*
- *Read it:* ज़्यादा

Before you move on

What does अदब mean? (“good manners”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 66

The Field and the Well

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name five things in a Hindi field before I take my leave.
>
> *Complete HI-C66-well and say all five words in order.*

66.1 बीज (bīj) — a seed

> Before the new run of words: what did *adab* mean, and what did *bharosā* mean?

You’ll want to know: बीज

बीज (*bīj*) — “a seed”.

Sanskrit बीज (*bīja*), ’seed’, carried into Hindi with nothing changed but the final vowel, which the schwa rule you have just learnt takes off the end.

It reaches well past the field. बीज is the seed of a plant, the germ of an idea, and the origin of anything at all — one of a small set of Hindi words that a farmer and a philosopher both use without either sounding odd.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बीज (*bīj*) is Sanskrit *bīja*, “seed”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 9250). CDIAL lists the inherited forms of the same word as *biyā* and *bīā*.

What you've built

The first of five things a field holds.

Your turn

- *Say it: bīj*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: bīj*, then *khet*, and say which one goes into the other
- *Recall:* say *ab*
- *Read it:* मेहरबानी

Before you move on

What does बीज mean? ("a seed".) Say it once more.

66.2 फ़सल (fasal) — a crop

Before the new one: what did *bīj* mean?

You'll want to know: फ़सल

फ़सल (*fasal*) — "a crop".

Arabic *faṣl*, whose plain sense is a division or a section — a cut piece of something larger. From there it came to name a season, and from there the thing a season yields.

North India counts its year in two of them, the winter sowing and the monsoon sowing, so फ़सल names the harvest and the stretch of months that produced it at once. Ask a किसान how the फ़सल is and you have asked about the weather, the work and the money together.

What you've built

Two.

Your turn

- *Say it: fasal*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: fasal*, then *kisān*, and say who watches the other
- *Read it:* जल्दी
- *Recall:* say *vintī*

Before you move on

What does फ़सल mean? ("a crop".) Say it once more.

66.3 अनाज (anāj) — grain

Before the new one: what did *fasal* mean?

You'll want to know: अनाज

अनाज (*anāj*) — "grain".

Usually traced to Sanskrit अन्न (*anna*), 'food', through a longer form meaning 'the food that is to be eaten'. The word for food narrowed onto the one food everything else is built around.

अनाज is grain in the bulk sense — what is stored, weighed and sold. चावल is one kind of it, wheat is another, and अनाज is the sack all of them come out of.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अनाज (*anāj*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *annādya*, "food" (CDIAL 398). It is built from *anna*, "food", and *ādya*, "to be eaten".

What you've built

Three.

Your turn

- *Say it: anāj*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it: anāj*, then *chāval*, and say which one is the sack
- *Recall:* say *dhīre*
- *Read it:* अनुमति

Before you move on

What does अनाज mean? (“grain”.) Say it once more.

66.4 घास (ghās) — grass

Before the new one: what did *anāj* mean?

You’ll want to know: घास

घास (*ghās*) — “grass”.

Sanskrit घास (*ghāsa*), ’fodder’, on the root घस् (*ghas-*), ’to eat’. Grass is named from the eating end: it is not a plant, it is what an animal is given.

That is still how the word behaves. Cut घास travels home on a head or a bicycle for the भैंस and the गाय, and the lawn sense — grass you keep and do not feed to anything — is the newer, city meaning laid on top.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घास (*ghās*) is inherited from Sanskrit *ghāsa*, “food, pasture grass”, and has come down with almost no change (CDIAL 4471).

What you’ve built

Four.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghās*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly

- *Say it: ghās*, then *bhaĩs*, and say which one is waiting for the other
- *Read it:* कम
- *Recall:* say *bharosā*

Before you move on

What does घास mean? (“grass”.) Say it once more.

66.5 कुआँ (kuā̃) — a well

Name the 4 words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: कुआँ

कुआँ (*kuā̃*) — “a well”.

From Sanskrit कूप (*kūpa*), ’a pit, a well’. The *p* softened away and the vowel came through the nose, leaving a word you write with the moon-and-dot you learnt in the letters chapter.

कूप has cousins a long way west: Latin *cūpa*, a tub or a cask, is the same ancient word, and English *cup* and *coop* come down from it. A hole in the ground and a thing you drink out of, both named for being hollow.

What you’ve built

Five: बीज, फ़सल, अनाज, घास, कुआँ. Enough to name a field and the water that keeps it.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuā̃*
- *Say it:* it once more, slowly
- *Say it:* all five in order, then *phir milenge*
- *Recall:* say *zyādā*
- *Read it:* अदब

Before you move on

What does कुआँ mean? (“a well”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 67

The First Form Line: Name

Modes: ✎ **pen** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can recognise the Hindi name label and fill one requested name line from a nonverbal cue without a model.
>
> *Complete HI-A1F01-name-no-model and fill one Hindi name field from a nonverbal identity cue after separate label, selection, supported-entry, delayed-entry, spelling, spacing, and repair passes.*

67.1 नाम — the first A1 form label

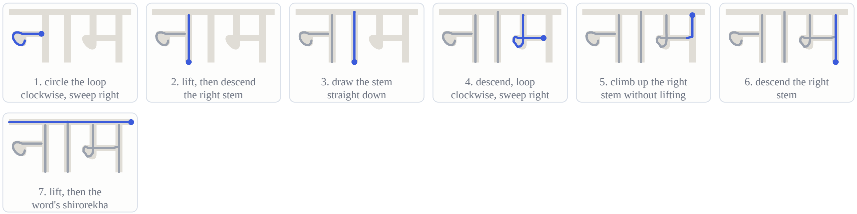
> Read the known word नाम. Say what it means, then write it once from the word you already know.

You'll want to know first — read the label

नाम: ________________

On a form, नाम asks for a name. The colon belongs to the form; it is not a Devanagari letter. Point to the label, then point to the empty answer line.

Writing — one bounded copy



How it is written — 5 strokes · 4 pen lifts · 7 movements

1. circle the loop clockwise, sweep right

2. lift, then descend the right stem

3. draw the stem straight down

4. descend, loop clockwise, sweep right

5. climb up the right stem without lifting

6. descend the right stem

7. lift, then the word's shirorekha

Stroke order after letter 1: Opiaterein, 'Deva-न-order.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 11 May 2009; sign 2: HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer, class 47 (ा, aa sign): stored online-handwriting prototypes from native writers (MIT licence, 2012); letter 3: JackPotte, 'Devanagari m म.gif', strokes 1–3, Wikimedia Commons, 29 March 2009; the place of sign 2, after its consonant's body: Saurmandal, 'Devanagari आ stroke order.svg', frames 1–5, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023; the shared headline, drawn last: HP Labs India, Lipi Toolkit, Lipi Indic Character Recognizers 4.0, Devanagari recognizer: native writers' stored prototypes of the 33 consonants draw the headline as the last stroke in 82% of 2,706 and as the first in about 5% (MIT licence, 2012)

This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How नाम *is written, letter by letter, then one headline, stroke by stroke*

Copy only नाम once, following the numbered strip: न, the stem of ा, then म, and last one head-line across the whole word. Do not add a value yet. This visible copy is supported script practice, not independent form writing.

Before you move on

Find नाम among कान · नाम · शाम without writing the other words.

67.2 Two people, two known practice names

Read both names from the earlier sentence work:

मीरा · अरुण

The two words — attach one nonverbal cue to each person

For this closed practice bank only:

- **A** → मीरा
- **B** → अरुण

Look for five seconds. Cover the Devanagari names. Point to A and recall its name; point to B and recall its name. Uncover and compare.

Your turn — select, do not copy

With the bank visible, choose the value requested by B, then the value requested by A. Do not write either one. This pass separates selection from spelling.

> **Before you move on**
>
> Stop after the two-way contrast. No third name enters this field bank.

67.3 Fill one field with the bank visible

Read the label नाम. Recall the visible bank: **A** मीरा · **B** अरुण.

Your turn — supported entry

Keep the bank visible. Card A requests its known value:

A — नाम: ________________

Select मीरा and copy it on the line. Read the completed field from label to value. This is supported entry, not independent writing evidence.

Writing — separate spelling and placement passes

First check only spelling: मी | रा. Then check one ordinary space after the colon. If one dimension differs, repair that dimension and stop.

> **Before you move on**
>
> Stop after one supported field.

67.4 Hide the bank, then fill one line

Look once: **A** मीरा · **B** अरुण. Cover the complete bank and wait ten seconds.

Writing — delayed requested entry

Keep the bank hidden. Complete only this field:

B — **नाम:** ________________

The requested value comes from memory; there is no copyable answer beside the line. Reveal the bank only after writing.

Your turn — separate repair passes

Compare in order: (1) requested person, (2) four written positions, (3) vowel marks and headline, (4) spacing after the colon. Repair the first differing dimension and stop.

> Before you move on
>
> This is one delayed choice, not the published six-field A1 form.

67.5 One no-model Hindi name field

> Close the preceding lessons. Keep only the two learned identity symbols in memory. There is no Devanagari value bank, support-language name, romanization, or completed model below.

Writing — independent controlled choice

Complete the requested field:

A — **नाम:** ________________

Choose the known value attached to A and write it from memory. Do not open an earlier lesson until the attempt is complete.

Your turn — separate repair passes

After writing, compare in four bounded passes: requested person, spelling, vowel marks/headline, then label-value placement. Repair only the first differing dimension.

Before you move on

This completes one field pattern. Five field families remain before the published six-to-eight-item A1 practical-form task can be attempted. This one-field checkpoint is untimed and does not claim full A1 readiness.

Chapter 68

And, Or, But

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can join two Hindi sentences with aur, offer a choice with yaa, and take something back with lekin.
>
> *Complete HI-R68-three-joins and fill the same slot three ways with chay and dudh: added, offered, contradicted.*

68.1 *aur* — “and”, and the letter this book owed you

> You can name two drinks: *chāy*, *dūdh.* You can ask for either. What you cannot do — after sixty-seven chapters — is put both in one sentence.

You’ll want to know: *aur*

aur — **and**

mujhe chāy aur dūdh pasand hai. — **I like tea and milk.**

aur stands BETWEEN the two things and changes neither of them. That is the whole rule, and it is why this one word is worth more than any noun in the book: every word you have learned in sixty-seven chapters just doubled its reach.

It joins two whole sentences the same way, and that is the use that matters most — a written message of thirty words is a message with *aur* in it.

aur comes down from Sanskrit *apara*, “**other, further**.” Hindi’s word for *one more* started as a word for *the other one*. Marathi did the identical thing out of a different Sanskrit word, *anya*, and English does it from the third side: *another* is *an other*.

The letters in this word — the debt is paid

Look at the headword above and **read** it. Its opening vowel is the independent *au*, and you were taught to draw it thirty-four chapters ago — the standing form with two arcs, whose sitting version rides on the **k** of *nau*.

This lesson is still written **gloss-first**, with the body in Roman letters, because it was composed while that letter was still owed and the debt was written down rather than hidden. The roman is now a crutch you no longer need: the headword is four characters you can take apart.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāy aur dūdh* — tea and milk
- *Say it: mujhe chāy aur dūdh pasand hai*
- *Say it:* which letter of *aur* you have not been taught — **the opening *au***
- *Recall:* say *bīj*
- *Read it:* फ़सल

Before you move on

Where does *aur* stand, and what does it change? (**Between the two pieces; nothing**.) What did it mean in Sanskrit? (**Other, further**.)
Sources: Wiktionary: aur.

68.2 ... या ... (*yā*) — “or”

One lesson ago you got *aur*, which adds. Say *chāy aur dūdh*. Now the word that does the opposite: it puts two things side by side and asks the listener to take exactly one.

You'll want to know: या

या — *yā* — **or**

चाय या दूध? — *chāy yā dūdh?* — **Tea or milk?**

It sits exactly where *aur* sat. The two are a matched pair: same slot, opposite job. *aur* hands you both; या makes you choose.

Two syllables of good news about the writing: या is य plus the long ा, and you have had both for a long time. Unlike *aur*, you can write this one today.

Offering a choice is a whole conversational move, not just a word. चाय या दूध? is a complete, polite offer with no verb in it at all, and it is how a host asks and how an examiner's role-play begins.

या is Sanskrit वा (*vā*), the ancient particle of alternatives, with the *v-* softened to *y-*. Latin kept the same particle as the **-ve** in *sīve*, "or if," and Marathi still carries it compounded inside किंवा — *kim* + *vā*, "what-or." One old word, three descendants.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāy yā dūdh?*
- *Say it:* the same pair with *aur*, and hear the offer become a list
- *Say it:* which of the two you can also WRITE today — या
- *Read it:* अनाज
- *Recall:* say *ghās*

Before you move on

Which of the two joining words makes the listener choose? (या.)
Which Sanskrit particle is it? (वा.)
Sources: Wiktionary: या.

68.3 लेकिन (*lekin*) — "but"

Two joining words are yours: *aur* adds, या offers. Both are agreeable. Neither can disagree with anything, and until one of them can, every sentence you build only ever confirms itself.

You’ll want to know: लेकिन

लेकिन — *lekin* — **but**

चाय है लेकिन दूध नहीं है. — *chāy hai lekin dūdh nahīṁ hai.* — **There is tea but there is no milk.**

लेकिन takes the same slot as the other two and does the one thing they cannot: it lets the second half push back against the first. Notice that neither half changed — नहीं is doing its own separate work inside the second clause, and लेकिन only says how the two halves stand to each other.

Every letter in it is one you have: ल, ◌े, क, ◌ि, न.

लेकिन is Arabic — لكن (*lākin*) — and it walked into Hindi through Persian, in the same company as शुक्रिया. Beside it Hindi keeps an inherited word for *but*, from Sanskrit परम्, “beyond.” Two words for *but*, one Persianate and one Sanskritic, is exactly what this language looks like: it almost never replaced a word, it collected a second one.

Your turn

- *Say it: chāy hai lekin dūdh nahīṁ hai*
- *Say it:* the three joiners in a row — *aur*, *yā*, *lekin*
- *Say it:* the five pieces लेकिन is written with, in the order you hear them
- *Recall:* say *kuā̃*

Before you move on

Which joining word lets the second half disagree with the first? (लेकिन.) Which language did Hindi take it from, and through which? (**Arabic, through Persian**.)
Sources: Wiktionary: लेकिन.

68.4 The same gap, three ways

Three words landed in this chapter and all three go in the same place. Name them in the order you met them, and say which one you cannot yet write.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *chāy aur dūdh*
- *chāy yā dūdh?*
- *chāy hai lekin dūdh nahīṁ hai*

Before you move on

Which one hands over both? (***aur***.) Which makes you pick? (**या**.) Which takes something back? (**लेकिन**.) Then stop.

Chapter 69

Where a Clause Ends, and What Goes Inside One

Modes: **voice** (3) **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say where a Hindi clause ends – on its verb – and hang a whole second clause on a thinking verb with ki.
>
> *Complete HI-R69-reported and say that you think the tea is good, then name the last word of each of the two halves.*

69.1 The verb goes last

Say two sentences you have had since chapter two and chapter five: **मेरा नाम मीरा है**, and **मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ**. Now listen to where each one ENDS.

Grammar Lens: a rule you have been obeying for sixty-eight chapters

Every Hindi sentence in this book puts its **verb at the end**:

- **मेरा नाम मीरा है** — my name Mira **is**
- **मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ** — I Hindi **speak**
- **घर मेरा है** — house mine **is**

You have seen this a hundred times and no lesson has ever said it out loud. It is being said now because you are about to start joining

clauses, and the moment a sentence has two halves you need to know where each half stops. **The verb is the boundary marker.** In **चाय है लेकिन दूध नहीं है**, the first **है** is what tells the ear the first clause has ended.
English is the odd one here, not Hindi. Hindi's order is subject, object, verb — so is Japanese's, so is Turkish's, and so is roughly half the world's. English puts the verb in the middle and makes it look normal.
The practical form of the rule: **when you build a Hindi sentence, decide the verb first and then say it last.** A learner who starts translating word by word from English will hit the verb too early, every time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three sentences, and stop hard on the last word of each
- where the first clause of the *lekin* sentence ends — **at the first है**
- the order Hindi uses — **subject, object, verb**

Before you move on

Where does the verb of a Hindi sentence go? (**Last**.) Why does that matter more now than it did in chapter two? (**Because a joined sentence has two halves, and the verb is what marks the end of each**.)

69.2 कि (*ki*) — "that"

Retrieve the two items before this one by name: **लेकिन**, which sets two clauses against each other, and the rule that the verb comes last. Then say **मैं सोचता हूँ** — *I think.* You have had that verb for a long time and have never once been able to say WHAT you think.

Grammar Lens: कि opens the room the thought goes into

> **मैं सोचता हूँ कि चाय ठीक है.** — *maiṁ sochtā hūṁ ki chāy ṭhīk hai.* — **I think that the tea is fine.**

Word for word: *I think* ***that*** *tea fine is.* Everything after कि is an ordinary complete Hindi sentence — **चाय ठीक है** — with its verb in the ordinary last place, doing the job of an object.

That is the trick worth seeing, and it is why the last lesson came first: you do not need any new grammar to report a thought. You need one word and a sentence you could already say. **Every sentence in this book just became something you can think, know or say *about*.**

लेकिन joins two halves as EQUALS. **कि** does something different: it puts one clause INSIDE the other, as the second verb's object. Hindi keeps the main clause first — **सोचता हूँ** comes before what is thought, never after — so the word order is the one you would say anyway.

कि is not an inherited word. It is Persian که (*ke*), taken whole, and it pushed aside the older Sanskrit-derived form in exactly this slot. Marathi imported the same word as **की**. Two languages, one borrowing, the same job.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *chāy ṭhīk hai* on its own
- *maiṁ sochtā hūṁ ki chāy ṭhīk hai*
- what changed inside the second half when you put it after कि — **nothing**

Before you move on

What goes after कि? (**A whole ordinary sentence, verb last, unchanged**.) How is कि unlike लेकिन? (**लेकिन joins two equals; कि puts one clause inside the other**.)

Sources: Wiktionary: कि.

69.3 Two clauses, two verbs, two ends

> A joined Hindi sentence has two verbs in it, and each one is the last word of its own half. Say the *lekin* sentence and name both.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *maiṁ sochtā hūṁ ki chāy ṭhīk hai*
- the two verbs in it, in order — *hūṁ*, *hai*
- *chāy aur dūdh* — and notice **aur** joins two THINGS while कि joins two CLAUSES

Before you move on

How many verbs does a कि sentence have, and where are they? (**Two — each at the end of its own half**.) Then stop.

Chapter 70

Able, and Willing

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I am able to do, what I want to do, and tell the bare-stem construction apart from the one that keeps the whole -naa form.
>
> *Complete HI-R70-can-want and produce all three unaided: I can come, I want to come, and I cannot come tomorrow.*

70.1 सकना / सकता (*saknā / saktā*) — to be able to / can

Two verbs you own: आना, to come, and बोलना, to speak. You can say that you speak. You cannot say that you **can** speak, and until you can, a whole examiner's question — *can you come tomorrow?* — has no answer.

You'll want to know: सकना

सकना — *saknā* — **to be able to; can, may**

मैं हिंदी बोल सकता हूँ. — *maiṁ hindī bol saktā hūṁ.* — **I can speak Hindi.**

Hindi has no separate words for *can*, *could*, *may* and *be able to.* All four run through this one verb, which is why it is worth more than its size.

सकना comes from Sanskrit *śaknoti*, "is able" (CDIAL 12252).

Grammar Lens: सकना never stands alone

One move does it: **strip the -ना off the first verb and put सकना behind it.**

- बोलना → बोल सकता हूँ — I can speak
- आना → आ सकता हूँ — I can come

The bare stem carries the meaning and सकना carries the grammar, so it is सकना that takes the ending and sits last, exactly where the verb belongs. सकना can never appear on its own: there is no Hindi sentence that is just *maiṁ saktā hūṁ.*
Negate it and you have the most useful excuse in the language: मैं कल नहीं आ सकता. — *I can't come tomorrow.*

Your turn

- *Say it:* बोलना (*bolnā*) → बोल सकता हूँ (*bol saktā hūṁ*), then आना (*ānā*) → आ सकता हूँ (*ā saktā hūṁ*)
- *Say it:* मैं कल नहीं आ सकता (*maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā*)
- *Say it:* which of the two verbs takes the ending — **सकना, and it goes last**
- *Recall:* say *aur*
- *Read it:* **... या ...**

Before you move on

What happens to the first verb in front of सकना? (**It drops to its bare stem**.) Can सकना be used on its own? (**No — it always needs another verb in front of it**.)
Sources: Wiktionary: सकना.

70.2 चाहना / चाह / चाहता — to want, longing, and "want"

Say मैं हिंदी बोल सकता हूँ. You can now say what you are ABLE to do. The next question an interviewer asks is what you WANT to do.

You'll want to know: चाहना

चाहना — *chāhnā* — **to want**

मैं हिंदी बोलना चाहता हूँ. — *maiṁ hindī bolnā chāhtā hūṁ.* — **I want to speak Hindi.**

Put it beside the sentence from last lesson and one letter is different, and it is the important one:

- मैं हिंदी बोल सकता हूँ — bare stem बोल
- मैं हिंदी बोलना चाहता हूँ — full infinitive बोलना

सकना takes the stem; चाहना takes the whole dictionary form. Both then sit last and take the ending themselves. Getting the two mixed up is the ordinary beginner's error, and hearing them back to back is the cure.

मैं आना चाहता हूँ — *I want to come.* Say it against मैं आ सकता हूँ and listen for the -ना.

Inside चाहना sits the noun चाह (*chāh*), "longing" or "desire." Add -ना and the noun becomes the dictionary verb: चाह → चाहना. A cousin of it is how Hindi wants a THING rather than an action; that separate construction comes in a later chapter.

चाहना comes through Prakrit *cāhaï*, "wishes", from a root of uncertain source (CDIAL 4775).

Your turn

- *Say it:* मैं हिंदी बोलना चाहता हूँ (*maiṁ hindī bolnā chāhtā hūṁ*)
- *Say it:* the pair back to back — बोल सकता हूँ (*bol saktā hūṁ*) / बोलना चाहता हूँ (*bolnā chāhtā hūṁ*)
- *Say it:* मैं आना चाहता हूँ (*maiṁ ānā chāhtā hūṁ*) against मैं आ सकता हूँ (*maiṁ ā saktā hūṁ*)
- *Say it:* चाह (*chāh*), "longing"; then चाहना (*chāhnā*), "to want"
- *Read it:* लेकिन

Before you move on

Which of the two takes the FULL **-ना** form in front of it? (**चाहना.**) Which takes the bare stem? (**सकना.**) What noun meaning "longing" sits inside **चाहना**? (**चाह.**)
Sources: Wiktionary: **चाहना**.

70.3 One verb inside another

Say both sentences from this chapter: **मैं हिंदी बोल सकता हूँ** and **मैं हिंदी बोलना चाहता हूँ.** Something is going on in the second one that is worth naming.

Grammar Lens: the -ना form is a noun

In **मैं हिंदी बोलना चाहता हूँ**, the word **बोलना** is not doing verb work. It is sitting where **किताब** sits in **मैं किताब देखता हूँ** — in the object slot. The dictionary form of a Hindi verb is also a **noun**, and it can go anywhere a noun can go:

- **मैं किताब देखता हूँ.** — **I look at the book.** — an ordinary noun object
- **मैं बोलना चाहता हूँ.** — **I want to speak.** — a VERB in the same slot

That is a bigger gift than it looks. You have sixty-nine chapters of verbs, and every single one of their **-ना** forms is now also a thing you can like, want, or talk about.
The order is unchanged, because it never changes: the inner verb comes first as a noun, the outer verb last as the verb. **सकना** is the same construction with one shortcut — it wears the **-ना** away and takes the bare stem — which is why the two lessons before this one belonged together.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *maiṁ kitāb dekhtā hūṁ*

- *maiṁ bolnā chāhtā hūṁ*
- which word in each sentence is the object — **kitāb, then bolnā**

Before you move on

What part of speech is बोलना in मैं बोलना चाहता हूँ? (**A noun, in the object slot**.) What does सकना do to that same form? (**Wears the -ना away and takes the bare stem**.)

70.4 Can, want, and cannot

One of this chapter's two verbs eats the **-ना** off the verb in front of it and one leaves it alone. Name which is which before you go on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *maiṁ ā saktā hūṁ* · *maiṁ ānā chāhtā hūṁ*
- *maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā*
- *maiṁ sochtā hūṁ ki maiṁ ā saktā hūṁ* — a clause inside a clause, with an ability inside that

Before you move on

Which of the two can never stand without another verb in front of it? (सकना.) Which one leaves that verb's **-ना** in place? (चाहना.) Then stop.

Chapter 71

Why, and Because

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask why in Hindi and answer it with a whole reason clause after kyonki, including the one an exam message needs: why I cannot come.
>
> *Complete HI-R71-reasons and take both turns unaided: ask kyon, then answer with the claim first and kyonki before the reason.*

71.1 क्यों (*kyoṁ*) — why

> Retrieve the two items before this one by name: सकना and चाहना. Then run the k- words the deixis lesson gave you — क्या, कहाँ, and *kaun.* There is one more in that family, and it is the one a listener most often wants.

You'll want to know: क्यों

> क्यों — *kyoṁ* — **why**
>
> आप क्यों नहीं आ सकते? — *āp kyoṁ nahīṁ ā sakte?* — **Why can't you come?**

क्यों goes where any Hindi question word goes: in the sentence's ordinary slot, in front of the verb — **not** dragged to the front the way English drags *why.* The rest of the sentence keeps the order it always had, verb last.

On its own, **क्यों?** is a complete turn. It is how you ask somebody to explain what they have just said, and it costs one syllable.

The deixis lesson generalised the **य-** / **व-** / **क-** system and listed the k-words. This is one of the ones it listed and did not teach. Its **क-** is the same ancient stem as **क्या** and *kaun*, and it is Latin's **qu-** in *quis* and English's **wh-** in *who* — one Indo-European **k^{w}-**, three different spellings of the same sound.

क्यों is built on Sanskrit *ka-*, the question stem behind **क्या** (CDIAL 3164).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kyoṁ?* on its own, as a whole turn
- *āp kyoṁ nahīṁ ā sakte?*
- the four k- words together — *kyā*, *kaun*, *kahāṁ*, *kyoṁ*

Before you move on

Where does **क्यों** stand in the sentence? (**In its ordinary slot, in front of the verb — not fronted**.) Which family does it belong to? (**The k- question words**.)
Sources: Wiktionary: क्यों.

71.2 क्योंकि (*kyoṁki*) — because

Ask **क्यों?** out loud. Then notice that you have no way at all to answer it. Now say **कि** — the word from the last chapter that hangs a clause on a verb. The answer is those two words stuck together.

Grammar Lens: क्यों + कि

> **मैं कल नहीं आ सकता क्योंकि मैं काम करता हूँ.** — *maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā kyoṁki maiṁ kām kartā hūṁ.* — **I can't come tomorrow because I work.**

Take the word apart: **क्योंकि** is **क्यों** + **कि**, *why-that.* Nothing is hidden in it. Hindi answers *why* by saying *why-that* and then a whole ordinary sentence, verb last, exactly as after plain **कि**.
The order is fixed and it is the useful way round: **the claim first, the**

reason second. English can lead with *because*; the ordinary Hindi sentence does not.

That example is worth memorising whole, because it is the shape of an entire exam task: a written message that says you cannot meet and why. It needs three things this book has now given you — the negation, सकना, and क्योंकि — and it needed all three.

Look at what the word is made of one more time. क्यों comes down from Sanskrit; कि was borrowed from Persian. Hindi welded them into a single conjunction and nobody notices the seam. That is this language in one word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the two pieces separately — *kyoṁ*, *ki* — then welded, *kyoṁki*
- *maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā kyoṁki maiṁ kām kartā hūṁ*
- which half of that sentence comes first — **the claim**

Before you move on

What two words is क्योंकि made of? (क्यों + कि.) Which half of a क्योंकि sentence comes first? (**The claim; the reason follows**.)
Sources: Wiktionary: क्योंकि.

71.3 Two turns: why, and because

क्योंकि is two words you already had. Say them apart, then together, then say where the verb of each half sits.

Reach back three chapters while you are here: या offers a choice and लेकिन contradicts. Neither can give a reason, which is what this chapter added.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kyoṁ?* — then *kyoṁki* ...

- *maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā kyoṁki maiṁ kām kartā hūṁ*
- *maiṁ ānā chāhtā hūṁ lekin maiṁ nahīṁ ā saktā* — the joiner and the two modal verbs in one sentence

Before you move on

Which word asks for a reason, and which gives one? (क्यों asks, क्योंकि gives.) What is the second one made of? (**The first one, plus** कि.) Then stop.

Chapter 72

When, and Then

Modes: **voice** (2) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first of 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask when with kab and set one event against another with the jab/tab frame, hearing each word's job from its first letter.
>
> *Complete HI-R72-when and run all three: ask when the listener can come, say when you feel happiness, and give a reason you cannot come.*

72.1 कब (*kab*) — when?

Run the k- words you now hold: क्या, कहाँ, क्यों, and *kaun.* One question a traveller asks more than any of those is still missing.

You'll want to know: कब

कब — *kab* — **when?**

आप कब आ सकते हैं? — *āp kab ā sakte haiṁ?* — **When can you come?**

Like every Hindi question word, कब stays in the sentence's own slot in front of the verb; nothing is fronted and nothing is reordered. Two letters, both of which you can already write.

You have had कल since chapter four — *tomorrow*, and also *yesterday*, the same word for both. कब is how you ask which day somebody means, and it is the question the whole timetable half of a listening paper is made of.

कब is Sanskrit कदा, worn down. Its two partners are coming in the next lesson, and they are the same word with different first letters.

Your turn

- *Say it: āp kab ā sakte haiṁ?*
- *Say it:* the same question with *kyoṁ* instead — *āp kyoṁ ā sakte haiṁ?*
- *Say it:* the five k- words together — *kyā*, *kaun*, *kahāṁ*, *kyoṁ*, *kab*
- *Recall:* say *saknā*
- *Read it:* चाहना

Before you move on

What does कब ask? (**When**.) Where does it stand? (**In the sentence's own slot, in front of the verb**.)
Sources: Wiktionary: कब.

72.2 जब … तब … (*jab … tab …*) — when, then

Retrieve the two items before this one by name: क्योंकि, and कब. Then say the pair the deixis lesson gave you — यह and वह, *this* and *that*, the य- shape and the व- shape. That machine is about to run again.

Grammar Lens: three first letters, one word

> जब मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ, तब आप सुनते हैं. — *jab maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ, tab āp sunte haiṁ.* — **When I speak Hindi, then you listen.**

Look at the three words side by side:

कब	when? — the question
जब	when — the clause that sets the time
तब	then — the clause that answers it

One word, three first letters. **क-** asks, **ज-** points back at something, **त-** points at it again. It is exactly the machine the deixis lesson taught with **यह** and **वह**, and Hindi is unusually tidy about it: once you have seen the pattern once you can hear which job a word is doing from its first letter alone.

Hindi says **both halves**. English drops the *then* and leaves *when I speak Hindi, I feel happiness*; Hindi keeps **तब**, and it earns its place — it is what tells the listener the first clause has finished, which matters far more in a language where every clause ends on a verb.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kab · jab · tab*
- *jab maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ, tab āp sunte haiṁ*
- which of the three asks a question — **कब**

Before you move on

What must follow a **जब** clause? (**तब**.) What do the three first letters do? (**क- asks, ज- sets the time, त- answers it**.)

Sources: Wiktionary: **जब**.

72.3 One letter tells you the job

Say **कब**, **जब**, **तब**. Then say what each first letter does, and name the other pair in the book built the same way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *āp kab ā sakte haiṁ?*
- *jab maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ, tab āp sunte haiṁ*
- *kyoṁ?* and answer it with *kyoṁki …*

Before you move on

Which of the three is a question? (**कब**.) Which two come as a pair in one sentence? (**जब and तब**.) Then stop.

Chapter 73

Two Actions, One Clause

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can chain two actions inside a single Hindi clause with -kar, conjugating only the last verb.
>
> *Complete HI-R73-chain and say the same two actions twice – joined with aur, then chained with -kar – and count the person endings in each.*

73.1 -कर / देखकर / करके — chaining actions in sequence

Say the **जब ... तब** frame. Two clauses, two verbs, a word at each end. That is a lot of scaffolding for *first this, then that* — and Hindi has a much shorter way that it uses far more often.

Grammar Lens: put -कर on the stem and the clause disappears

> **मैं किताब देखकर आता हूँ.** — *maiṁ kitāb dekhkar ātā hūṁ.* — **"I look at the book and come."** (Literally: *having looked, I come.*)

The move is the same shape as **सकना**: **take the -ना off the first verb and put -कर on the bare stem.**

- **देखना** → **देखकर** — having looked
- **करना** → **करके** — having done (this one is irregular, and it is the commonest of all)

What you get is not a second clause. It is one clause with a chained action inside it, and only the LAST verb takes a person ending. That is why Hindi reaches for it constantly: a speaker can string three actions together and conjugate once.

The order is the order of events. **देखकर आता हूँ** is look-then-come, never the other way round, so you say the actions in the sequence they happen.

The ending is the verb **करना** frozen solid. *Having looked* is literally *look-do*. Marathi does the same job with its own *-ūn*; both languages inherited the construction from Sanskrit and each reinforced it with its own material.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- **देखना** (*dekhnā*) → **देखकर** (*dekhkar*), then **करना** (*karnā*) → **करके** (*karke*)
- **मैं किताब देखकर आता हूँ** (*maiṁ kitāb dekhkar ātā hūṁ*)
- which of the two verbs carries the person ending — **the last one**

Before you move on

What does **-कर** attach to? (**The bare stem, after the -ना comes off**.) How many verbs in a **-कर** sentence take a person ending? (**One — the last**.)

Sources: Wiktionary: **कर**.

73.2 One clause or two

You now have three ways to put two actions in one sentence: *aur* between two clauses, the **जब ... तब** frame, and **-कर** inside a single clause. Only one of them conjugates just once.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *maiṁ kitāb dekhtā hūṁ aur ātā hūṁ* — two endings

- *maiṁ kitāb dekhkar ātā hūṁ* — one ending
- which of the two a Hindi speaker says more often — **the -कर one**

Before you move on

How many person endings does a **-कर** sentence carry? (**One**.) And an *aur* sentence with two verbs? (**Two**.) Then stop.

Chapter 74

Asking Without a Question Word

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 4 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can turn any statement I own into a yes-or-no question with a fronted kya, ask the same question with the voice alone, and check a fact with the naa tag.
>
> *Complete HI-R74-ask and run every joining word in the book once, then both question shapes: the one that does not know the answer and the one that expects agreement.*

74.1 क्या ...? — the yes-or-no question

Retrieve the two items before this one by name: **-कर** and **जब ... तब**. Then say **हाँ** and **नहीं** — two answers with no question.

Grammar Lens: क्या at the FRONT means nothing

> **क्या आप कल आ सकते हैं?** — *kyā āp kal ā sakte haiṁ?* — **Can you come tomorrow?**

Put **क्या** at the very front and it stops meaning *what*: it marks the sentence as a yes-or-no question and nothing else moves, because Hindi cannot invert the way English does with *can you*.
Position is the whole difference:

- **आप क्या कर सकते हैं?** — *what can you do?* — inside
- **क्या आप आ सकते हैं?** — *can you come?* — in front

Answer either with हाँ or नहीं. A language that cannot invert reaches for a particle; Persian and Russian do the same.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kyā āp kal ā sakte haiṁ?* and answer — *hāṁ* or *nahīṁ*
- the pair — *āp kyā kar sakte haiṁ? / kyā āp ā sakte haiṁ?*

Before you move on

What does क्या mean at the very front? (**Nothing — it marks a yes-or-no question**.) What else moves? (**Nothing**.)
Sources: Wiktionary: क्या.

74.2 The question that is only a voice

> Say **क्या आप आ सकते हैं?** — the question you got one lesson ago. Now say it again and leave the first word out.

The letters in this word

आप आ सकते हैं? — *āp ā sakte haiṁ?* — **Can you come?**

Word for word that is a statement. What makes it a question is the **pitch of the last two syllables going up**, and nothing else. Speakers drop क्या far more often than they use it, so this is the ordinary form and the particle is the careful one.
Say the pair and listen, do not read:

- **आप आ सकते हैं.** — flat at the end — *you can come*
- **आप आ सकते हैं?** — rising at the end — *can you come?*

Two things follow. First, you can ask any yes-or-no question in Hindi today without learning another word — every statement in this book is already a question if you lift the end of it. Second, and less comfortable: a listening paper will hand you the rise **without** the particle, so the ear has to catch it. A candidate reading only for क्या will hear a statement and answer nothing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *āp ā sakte haiṁ.* flat, then *āp ā sakte haiṁ?* rising
- the same sentence with the particle — *kyā āp ā sakte haiṁ?*
- which of the three a Hindi speaker uses most — **the rise**

Before you move on

What turns आप आ सकते हैं into a question with no extra word? (**The pitch rising at the end**.) Which form do speakers use more often, that or क्या? (**The rise**.)

74.3 … है ना? — "isn't it?"

क्या at the front asks something you do not know. Often you DO know, and want it confirmed. Different move, different word, other end.

Grammar Lens: hanging a check on the end

चाय ठीक है ना? — *chāy ṭhīk hai nā?* — **The tea is fine, isn't it?**

Take any statement you can make, put ना on the end, and it becomes a check: you say what you believe and invite the listener to agree. The answer comes back as हाँ or नहीं.
Set the two questions side by side:

- **क्या चाय ठीक है?** — *is the tea fine?* — I do not know
- **चाय ठीक है ना?** — *the tea is fine, isn't it?* — I think so; agree with me

Use the tag when you mean the particle and you have claimed to know the answer already.
One syllable buys a whole conversational turn: every sentence in this book is now something you can offer for agreement. The tag is the old negative न used as an invitation — a negative asking for a *yes*, exactly as English does in *isn't it?* and Marathi with the same syllable.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *chāy ṭhīk hai nā?* then answer yourself — *hāṁ*
- the pair — *kyā chāy ṭhīk hai? / chāy ṭhīk hai nā?*
- which one already believes the answer — **the tag**

Before you move on

What does ना on the end of a statement do? (**Asks the listener to confirm it**.) How is that different from क्या at the front? (**क्या does not know the answer; ना expects agreement**.)
Sources: Wiktionary: ना.

74.4 Everything that joins, and everything that asks

> Seven chapters ago you could name a thousand Hindi things and say nothing about two of them at once. Name the three joiners this run opened with, and say where the verb of each half goes.

Your turn — clauses underneath

Say each of the four, and after each one name what the underneath clause is doing: a content, a reason, a time, a sequence.

Your turn — the two questions

Say these aloud:

- *kyā āp kal ā sakte haiṁ?* — you do not know
- *chāy ṭhīk hai nā?* — you think you do
- *āp kab ā sakte haiṁ?* · *āp kyoṁ nahīṁ ā sakte?*
- *āp kal ā sakte haiṁ?* with no particle at all, on a rising voice

Before you move on

Which joining words treat the two halves as EQUALS? (***aur*****, या, लेकिन.) Which ones put one half UNDERNEATH the other? (कि, क्योंकि, जब … तब, -कर.) And which single word means *what* in the middle of a sentence and nothing at all at the front? (क्या.) Then stop.**

Chapter 75

Where You Come From

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what country I am in, what city I live in and what language I speak when I meet somebody.
>
> *Complete HI-C68-english and say all five words in order, then name the two languages you can put beside* भाषा*.*

75.1 देश (desh) — a country

> Two lessons back you learnt to ask with nothing but your voice, and one lesson back to hang a check on the end: say चाय ठीक है flat, then with the end lifted, then say चाय ठीक है ना? and name what each one does. You have also filled in a नाम line without a model, and a form asks for more than a name. The next five words are what it asks for.

You'll want to know: देश

देश (*desh*) — "a country".

Sanskrit देश (*deśa*) meant a place, a region, a stretch of land — and it comes from the root दिश् (*diś-*), "to point out, to show". A देश began as whatever a pointing hand took in.

That root travelled. Latin *dīcere*, "to say", and *index*, the pointing finger, grew from the same ancient root as दिश्. The finger you use to show someone where you are from is the finger the word is named after.

Every Hindi form you will ever fill in has a देश line on it, and every conversation that starts with a greeting reaches it within a minute.

What you’ve built

The first of five words for saying where you are from.

Your turn

- *Recall:* say *ghās*
- *Read it:* कुआँ, then say what it means
- *Hear: desh*, said once slowly and once at speed
- *Say it: desh*
- *Say it: yah ek desh hai nā?* — last chapter’s tag, on your new word
- *Read it:* देश, then say what it means
- *Recall:* say *kyoṁ*
- *Read it:* कब

Before you move on

What does देश mean? (“a country”.) Say it once more.

75.2 भारत (Bhārat) — India

Say *desh*. *Write it:* देश from memory

Three letters and one matra: द, then ◌े on top of it, then श. You have been taught all three.

You’ll want to know: भारत

भारत (*Bhārat*) — “India”, the country’s name in its own language.

The name is older than the country. भरत (*Bharata*) is a figure the Sanskrit epics name, and भारत is the form meaning “belonging to Bharata” — the land of his people. English *India* took a different route entirely, through Greek and Persian from सिंधु (*Sindhu*), the river.

So one country carries two names that started as two different things: a people and a river. In Hindi you will hear भारत on the news and हिंदुस्तान in the street, and both mean the same place.

What you've built

A देश and the name of one: भारत एक देश है.

Your turn

- *Read it:* कुआँ, then say it without looking
- *Say it: Bhārat*
- *Say it: Bhārat ek desh hai*
- *Say it:* the same sentence twice — flat, then with the end lifted — and then *Bhārat ek desh hai nā?*
- *Write it:* a नाम line with no model, then देश on the line under it
- *Write it:* देश once more, without looking

Before you move on

What does भारत mean? ("India".) And देश? ("a country".)

75.3 शहर (shahar) — a city, a town

> Which of the two words you have is the name of a country, and which is the word for any country at all?

You'll want to know: शहर

शहर (*shahar*) — "a city, a town".

Persian شهر (*shahr*), "city", and behind it Old Persian *xšaça*, "kingdom, dominion" — a शहर was first the seat of a king rather than a crowd of people. The same word ends dozens of place names across the region.

Set it against गाँव (*gā̃v*), the village you already own. गाँव and शहर are the pair Hindi uses for the whole of settled life, and a speaker will place themselves in one or the other within a sentence of meeting you.

A form asks for your शहर on the line under your देश.

What you've built

Three: देश, भारत, शहर. A country, its name, and the place in it you live.

Your turn

- *Hear: shahar*, then *gā̃v*
- *Say it: shahar*
- *Contrast: shahar* and *gā̃v*, and say which one is bigger

Before you move on

What does शहर mean? (“a city”.) Say it once more.

75.4 भाषा (bhāshā) — a language

Write it: शहर from memory — श, then ह, then र

No matras at all in this one — three bare letters in a row.

You’ll want to know: भाषा

भाषा (*bhāshā*) — “a language”.

Sanskrit भाषा (*bhāṣā*), “speech, what is spoken”, from भाष् (*bhāṣ-*), “to speak”. The word names the act before it names the thing: a भाषा is speaking, turned into a noun.

You have been saying मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ for a long time. भाषा is the word that lets you talk about हिंदी rather than only in it — and it is a printed line on both of the writing papers you will one day sit, right under देश and शहर.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भाषा (*bhāshā*) is Sanskrit *bhāṣā*, “speech”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 9479). Prakrit *bhāsā* already meant “speech, language”.

What you’ve built

Four of the five lines a form asks for: देश, भारत, शहर, भाषा.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhāshā*
- *Say it: hindī ek bhāshā hai*

- *Write it:* शहर once more, without looking

Before you move on

What does भाषा mean? (“a language”.) Say it once more.

75.5 अंग्रेज़ी (angrezī) — English, the language

Name the four words of this chapter so far.

You’ll want to know: अंग्रेज़ी

अंग्रेज़ी (*angrezī*) — “English”, the language.

The route is long and worth following. Portuguese traders said *inglês*; Persian took it as انگریز (*angrez*), “an Englishman”; Hindi added the ending -ी that turns a people into their language, and अंग्रेज़ी came out. The nuqta under ज़ is the *z* you learnt with the letters.

Set it beside हिंदी, which is built the same way: हिंद, the land, plus the same ending. भाषा is the word for the class of thing; हिंदी and अंग्रेज़ी are two members of it.

Both listening papers you will one day sit key on somebody speaking two of these, so the pair matters more than either word alone.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अंग्रेज़ी (*angrezī*) is usually traced, through Persian *angrez*, “an Englishman”, to Portuguese *inglês*, “English”. The -*ī* makes it “the language of the English”.

What you’ve built

Five: देश, भारत, शहर, भाषा, अंग्रेज़ी. Enough to say what country you are in, what city you live in, and what you speak.

Your turn

- *Say it: angrezī*
- *Say it: hindī aur angrezī, do bhāshā*
- *Write it:* भाषा from memory, then अंग्रेज़ी beside the printed model

- *Say it:* all five in order

Before you move on

What does **अंग्रेज़ी** mean? (“English”.) And what is the word for a language itself? (*bhāshā*.)

Chapter 76

Ways of Going

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name what carries me, ask for a ticket, and say that I am going somewhere.
>
> *Complete HI-C69-go and say all five words in order, then say that you go to the station.*

76.1 गाड़ी (gāṛī) — a vehicle; a train

> Two words back before anything new: what does *bhāshā* mean, and what is अंग्रेज़ी? The next five words are how you leave the शहर you live in.

You'll want to know: गाड़ी

गाड़ी (*gāṛī*) — "a vehicle".

From a reconstructed **gāḍḍa*, 'cart', which CDIAL tentatively links to words for a seat, such as Sanskrit *garta*, a chariot seat (CDIAL 4116). It began as the thing oxen pulled and it has taken in everything since: a car is a गाड़ी, a train is a गाड़ी, a bullock cart is a गाड़ी.

That width is the reason to learn it first. बस you already own, and बस names one thing only. गाड़ी names whatever is carrying you, so it is the word that never leaves you stuck — point at anything with wheels and गाड़ी is right.

The ड़ in the middle is the flapped retroflex, made by flicking the tongue down off the roof of the mouth. It is ड with the nuqta underneath.

What you’ve built

The first of five words for getting somewhere.

Your turn

- *Recall:* say *bhāshā*
- *Read it:* अंग्रेज़ी, then say what it means
- *Hear:* *gāṛī*, slowly, with the flap in the middle
- *Say it:* *gāṛī*
- *Contrast:* *gāṛī* and *bas*, and say which one is wider

Before you move on

What does गाड़ी mean? (“a vehicle”.) Say it once more.

76.2 रेल (rel) — the railway

Say *gāṛī*. *Write it:* गाड़ी — ग, then the ा stroke, then ड with its nuqta, then ी

Four pieces, all of them yours already.

You’ll want to know: रेल

रेल (*rel*) — “the railway”.

English *rail*, borrowed whole in the nineteenth century and spelt with the े matra, which is where an English *ay* sound usually lands in Devanagari.

रेल on its own is the system: the network, the line, the railway as an institution. The train itself is रेलगाड़ी — रेल plus the गाड़ी you learnt in the last lesson — and in speech people shorten that back to plain गाड़ी. Two words you now hold combine into the third without anything new.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रेल (*rel*) is a loan from English *rail*.

What you've built

गाड़ी and रेल, and the compound they make between them.

Your turn

- *Read it:* अंग्रेज़ी, then say it without looking
- *Say it: rel*
- *Say it: rel*, then *gāṛī*, then *relgāṛī*
- *Write it:* गाड़ी once more, without looking

Before you move on

What does रेल mean? (“the railway”.) What is a रेलगाड़ी? (“a train”.)

76.3 स्टेशन (sṭeshan) — a station

> Which of your two words names the network, and which names the thing that moves along it?

You'll want to know: स्टेशन

स्टेशन (*sṭeshan*) — “a station”.

English *station*, and it shows its seams. Hindi does not open a word with two consonants stuck together, so the writing does it the Devanagari way instead: स with the vowel-killer ◌् underneath, then ट. That stack is the same virama you met inside नमस्ते.

The retroflex ट rather than dental त is deliberate. When Hindi borrows an English *t*, it hears the English tongue as curled back, so *station* becomes स्टेशन and not स्तेशन. Every English *t* you meet in a Hindi loan will do this.

The word is painted on every platform board in the country, in Devanagari and in Latin letters side by side.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

स्टेशन (*sṭeshan*) is a loan from English *station*.

What you've built

Three: गाड़ी, रेल, स्टेशन. A vehicle, a network, and the place you wait.

Your turn

- *Read it:* स्टेशन, and find the ् that stacks the first two letters
- *Say it: sṭeshan*
- *Say it: rel sṭeshan*

Before you move on

What does स्टेशन mean? ("a station".) Say it once more.

76.4 टिकट (ṭikaṭ) — a ticket

> *Write it:* स्टेशन from memory — start with the stacked स्, then ट, then े on top, then श, then न

You'll want to know: टिकट

टिकट (*ṭikaṭ*) — "a ticket".

English *ticket*, and both of its *t* sounds land on retroflex ट for the reason the last lesson gave. The ि in the middle is the short *i* matra, and it is written **before** the letter it is sounded after — you learnt that trick when you first wrote a name.

This is the word you actually say at a window. You already know how to ask for one thing politely: एक चाय दीजिए got you a cup of tea. एक टिकट दीजिए is the same frame with a new word dropped in, and it will get you onto a train.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टिकट (*ṭikaṭ*) is a loan from English *ticket*.

What you've built

Four, and a request you can already make with the fourth.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭikaṭ*
- *Say it: ek ṭikaṭ dījie*
- *Write it:* **टिकट**, putting the ि down before the **ट** it belongs to

Before you move on

How do you ask for one ticket? (*ek ṭikaṭ dījie.*) Say it once more.

76.5 जाना (jānā) — to go

Name the four words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: जाना

जाना (*jānā*) — "to go".

Sanskrit **या** (*yā-*), "to go", is the root; Hindi turned the initial *y-* into *j-*, which it does to many inherited words, and added the **-ना** ending that every Hindi doing word carries when you name it plain.

You already own three that end the same way: **बोलना**, **देखना**, **सुनना**. The ending is the pattern, not a coincidence, and **जाना**, *jānā*, now joins them.

जाना, *jānā*, is the one doing word a traveller cannot do without. **मैं स्टेशन जाता हूँ** uses the same shape as **मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ**, which you have been saying since the early chapters — the same frame, a different word inside it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जाना (*jānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *yāti*, "goes" (CDIAL 10452). Sanskrit *y-* regularly became Hindi *j-*.

What you've built

Five: **गाड़ी**, **रेल**, **स्टेशन**, **टिकट**, **जाना**, *jānā*. A way to travel and a way to say you are going.

Your turn

- *Say it: jānā*
- *Say it: maiṁ sṭeshan jātā hūṁ*
- *Write it:* टिकट and then जाना, *jānā*, both from memory
- *Say it:* all five in order

Before you move on

What does जाना, *jānā*, mean? (“to go”.) Say that you go to the station.

Chapter 77

After the Work Is Done

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (4) 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what game I play and how I rest when somebody I have just met asks what I do.
>
> *Complete HI-C70-rest and say all five words in order, then say what game you play.*

77.1 खेल (khel) — a game

> Two words back: what does *ṭikaṭ* mean, and what is जाना? The next five words are what you do when you are not going anywhere.

You'll want to know: खेल

खेल (*khel*) — "a game".

Sanskrit खेल (*khela*), "play, sport", from a root that meant shaking or moving about. The final vowel dropped away by the schwa rule and left the bare consonant ending Hindi likes.

खेल covers more than a sport with rules. A child's game is a खेल, a match is a खेल, and a thing somebody is not taking seriously is a खेल too. When somebody you have just met asks what you do with your evenings, this is the word the answer starts from.

The ख is the aspirated one — a real puff of breath after the *k*, which is what separates खेल from क, and the difference changes the word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खेल (*khel*) is inherited from a reconstructed **khel-*, “play” (CDIAL 3918). CDIAL links it with Sanskrit *krīḍati*, “plays”: if that verb has a non-Aryan source, these forms may share it.

What you’ve built

The first of five words for the hours after work.

Your turn

- *Recall:* say *ṭikaṭ*
- *Read it:* जाना, then say what it means
- *Hear: khel*, with the breath on the first sound
- *Say it: khel*
- *Contrast: khel* said with the puff, and the same shape said without it
- *Recall:* say *desh*
- *Read it:* गाड़ी

Before you move on

What does खेल mean? (“a game”.) Say it once more.

77.2 खेलना / खेलता / खेलती / खेलते — playing in the present

Say *khel*. *Write it:* खेल — ख, then ◌े above it, then ल

You’ll want to know: खेलना

खेलना (*khelnā*) — “to play”.

The same खेल you learnt in the last lesson, with -ना on the end. That is the whole of it: Hindi makes a doing word out of a naming word by adding those two letters, and you have now watched it happen once.

Look at what that gives you. जाना was built the same way, and so were बोलना, लिखना, सुनना. Four you already own and one you have just made — the ending is a tool, not a list to memorise.

Remove **-ना** to recover **खेल-**, then add the present endings you know: खेलता (masculine), खेलती (feminine), and खेलते (respectful आप or plural). So मैं खेलता हूँ / मैं खेलती हूँ means "I play," while आप खेलते हैं means "you play."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खेलना (*khelnā*) is inherited from a reconstructed **khel-*, "play" (CDIAL 3918), the verb behind *khel*, "a game". CDIAL links it with Sanskrit *krīḍati*, "plays": if that verb has a non-Aryan source, these forms may share it.

What you've built

A game, and the doing word that comes out of it.

Your turn

- *Read it:* जाना, then say it without looking
- *Say it: khel*, then *khelnā*
- *Say it:* मैं खेलता हूँ (*maiṁ kheltā hūṁ*) if masculine; मैं खेलती हूँ (*maiṁ kheltī hūṁ*) if feminine
- *Say it:* "you (resp.) play" — आप खेलते हैं (*āp khelte haiṁ*)
- *Write it:* खेल, then add ना to the end of it
- *Read it:* भारत
- *Recall:* say *rel*

Before you move on

What does खेलना mean? ("to play".) And खेल? ("a game".) Give the masculine, feminine, and respectful or plural present forms. (खेलता / खेलती / खेलते.)

77.3 क्रिकेट (kriket) — cricket, the game

Which of your two words is the game, and which is the doing word made out of it?

You’ll want to know: क्रिकेट

क्रिकेट (*kriket*) — “cricket”.

English, borrowed whole, and written with two things you have already met. The opening क्र is क stacked on र by the same vowel-killer ◌् that stacks स्ट in स्टेशन. The final ट is retroflex, because an English *t* always lands there.

The ◌ि after the stack is the short *i* matra, and it sits to the **left** of the whole cluster even though it is sounded after it — the same preposed matra you first met in a name.

If you learn one game word in Hindi, learn this one. मैं क्रिकेट खेलता हूँ puts three of this chapter’s ideas into a single sentence.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क्रिकेट (*kriket*) is a loan from English *cricket*.

What you’ve built

Three: खेल, खेलना, क्रिकेट. A game, playing it, and one to name.

Your turn

- *Read it:* क्रिकेट, and find the ◌ि sitting to the left of the stack
- *Say it: kriket*
- *Say it: maiṁ kriket kheltā hūṁ*
- *Recall:* say *shahar*
- *Read it:* स्टेशन

Before you move on

What does क्रिकेट mean? (“cricket”.) Say that you play it.

77.4 गाना (gānā) — a song

Write क्रिकेट from memory, starting with the ि you put down first.

You’ll want to know: गाना

गाना (*gānā*) — “a song”.

Sanskrit गान (*gāna*), “singing”, from गै (*gai-*), “to sing”. The root is one of the oldest in the language and it has never stopped working.

Now notice the shape. गाना ends in -ना, exactly like खेलना — and that is not an accident. गाना is also the doing word “to sing”. One spelling, two jobs: the song, and the singing of it. Which one is meant is settled by the sentence around it and never by the word.

Hindi does this often enough that it is worth expecting rather than being surprised by. You will meet another word with the same double life before this run of chapters is out.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गाना (*gānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. CDIAL lists it under *gāpayati*, the second form it gives beside *gāyati*, “sings” (CDIAL 4135). The noun is the verb *gānā*, “to sing”, used for what is sung.

What you’ve built

Four, and the first word you have met that is two words at once.

Your turn

- *Say it: gānā*
- *Contrast: gānā* as the song, and *gānā* as the singing
- *Write it:* गाना, then खेलना under it, and look at the ending they share
- *Recall:* read भाषा, then say *ṭikaṭ*

Before you move on

What two things can गाना mean? (“a song”, and “to sing”.)

77.5 आराम (ārām) — rest, ease

Name the four words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: आराम

आराम (*ārām*) — "rest, ease".

Persian آرام (*ārām*), "quiet, calm, repose". It came in with the Persian half of the vocabulary and settled deep: आरामकुर्सी is an easy chair, built from आराम and the कुर्सी you already own.

आराम is not sleep. नींद is sleep, and you have that word. आराम is the state of not being pushed — sitting down, breathing out, nothing owed to anybody for an hour. आराम करना is what you say for taking that hour.

It is also an answer. When somebody asks आप कैसे हैं?, one ordinary reply is that you are at आराम, and it says more warmly than ठीक does.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आराम (*ārām*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *ārām*, "rest, ease".

What you've built

Five: खेल, खेलना, क्रिकेट, गाना, आराम. Enough to say what you do when the day lets go of you.

Your turn

- *Say it: ārām*
- *Say it: ārām karnā*
- *Write it:* गाना and then आराम, both from memory
- *Say it:* all five in order
- *Recall:* say *angrezī*
- *Read it:* जाना

Before you move on

What does आराम mean? ("rest".) And गाना? ("a song", or "to sing".)

Chapter 78

Today, and How Much

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 3 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can place a thing in today, add myself to it, and raise it when I ask after somebody.
>
> *Complete HI-C71-very and say all three words in order, then say something is very big and add yourself to it.*

78.1 आज (āj) — today

> Two words back: what does *gānā* mean, and what is आराम? The next five words are the small ones that hold a conversation together.

You'll want to know: आज

आज (*āj*) — "today".

Sanskrit अद्य (*adya*), "today", built from "this" and "day". Latin did exactly the same thing with *hōc diē*, "on this day", which wore down to *hodiē* and then to French *aujourd'hui* and Spanish *hoy*. Two families, the same idea, the same squeezing.

You already own कल and परसों, which reach forward and back. आज is the missing middle of that set, and it is the one you will say most.

आज आप कैसे हैं? is the greeting you have been making, with one word added that makes it about now rather than in general.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आज (*āj*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *adya*, “today” (CDIAL 242).

What you’ve built

The first of five small words that do a great deal of work.

Your turn

- *Recall:* say *gānā*
- *Read it:* आराम, then say what it means
- *Hear:* *āj*, then *kal*, then *parsoṁ*
- *Say it:* *āj*
- *Say it:* *āj āp kaise haiṁ?*
- *Recall:* say *gāṛī*
- *Read it:* रेल

Before you move on

What does आज mean? (“today”.) Say it once more.

78.2 भी (bhī) — also, too

Say *āj*. *Write it:* आज

Two letters, no matras: आ, then ज.

You’ll want to know: भी

भी (*bhī*) — “also, too”.

Sanskrit अपि (*api*), “also”, is the ancestor. The Prakrits dropped the opening vowel and left a bare *vi*; that hardened on the way into Hindi and came out as भी. Two letters at the end of two thousand years, and the meaning has not moved at all.

The thing to hold on to is where it stands: भी comes **after** the word it adds to, never before. मैं भी is "me too". आज भी is "today as well". Put it first and a Hindi ear hears nothing.

Watch out for one collision. You already own अभी, "right now", and भी is sitting inside it — but they are separate words with separate jobs, the way अब and अभी were. The eye will confuse them long before the ear does.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भी (*bhī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *api*, "also, even" (CDIAL 485).

What you've built

आज and भी, and a pair to keep apart.

Your turn

- *Read it:* आराम, then say it without looking
- *Say it: maiṁ bhī*
- *Say it: āj bhī*
- *Write it:* आज once more, then भी beside it
- *Read it:* स्टेशन
- *Recall:* say *ṭikaṭ*

Before you move on

Where does भी stand, before or after the word it adds to? (After.)

78.3 बहुत (bahut) — very, a lot

Say "me too" in Hindi, and then "today as well".

You'll want to know: बहुत

बहुत (*bahut*) — "very, a lot, much".

Sanskrit बहु (*bahu*), “much, many”. The same ancient root gave Greek *pakhús*, “thick”, so the family has always been about quantity of stuff.

बहुत goes **before** what it strengthens, which is the opposite of भी. You now have one small word that leans forward and one that leans back, and putting each on the wrong side is the commonest mistake a beginner makes with them.

Three you can say immediately, from words you already hold: बहुत बड़ा, बहुत धन्यवाद, बहुत जल्दी. That last one means “very soon” as readily as “very fast”, which is how बहुत behaves throughout: it takes the colour of whatever it is standing in front of.

Set it against कम and ज़्यादा, which you learnt for measuring. बहुत is not a comparison; it is an intensity.

What you’ve built

Three: आज, भी, बहुत. One that places the day, one that adds, one that raises.

Your turn

- *Say it: bahut baṛā*
- *Say it: bahut dhanyavād*
- *Contrast: bahut* before its word, and *bhī* after its word
- *Recall:* say *jānā*

Before you move on

What does बहुत mean? (“very”.) Say that something is very big.

Chapter 79

What It Costs

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask what something costs, say that it is expensive, and say that I am buying it.
>
> *Complete HI-C72-buy and say all five words in order, then ask what a thing costs and call it expensive.*

79.1 पैसा (paisā) — money

> Two words back: what does *bhī* mean, and what is बहुत? The next five words are what you need at a counter.

You'll want to know: पैसा

पैसा (*paisā*) — "money".

It began as a fraction. Sanskrit पाद (*pāda*) is a quarter and अंश (*aṁśa*) is a part, and the coin they named was a small share of a larger one. For a long while a पैसा was one hundredth of a rupee.

Then the small coin ate the whole idea. Today पैसा as one coin is nearly gone, and पैसा as **money in general** is what people say: *paisā nahīṁ hai* is "there is no money", about a wallet or about a country.

The ◌ै on the प is the *ai* matra, two strokes above the headline, and it is the same one inside कैसे.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पैसा (*paisā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **padāṁśa*, "quarter part", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 7761). CDIAL glosses the Hindi word "quarter anna", a small coin; from there it came to mean money.

What you've built

The first of five words for buying something.

Your turn

- *Recall:* say *bhī*
- *Read it:* बहुत, then say what it means
- *Hear: paisā*
- *Say it: paisā*
- *Read it:* पैसा, and find the ◌ै it shares with कैसे
- *Recall:* say *khel*

Before you move on

What does पैसा mean? ("money".) Say it once more.

79.2 रुपया (rupayā) — a rupee

Say *paisā*. *Write it:* पैसा — प with ◌ै above it, then स, then ◌ा

You'll want to know: रुपया

रुपया (*rupayā*) — "a rupee".

Sanskrit रूप्य (*rūpya*) is "wrought silver, a stamped coin", and it comes straight from रूप (*rūpa*), "form, shape". A rupee is a piece of metal that has been **given a shape** — the name says nothing about value and everything about the stamping.

That is worth holding beside पैसा. पैसा was named for being a fraction; रुपया was named for being formed. One word looks at how small it is, the other at how it was made.

The ◌ु under the र is the short *u* matra, hanging below the letter rather than above it.

A price is said in रुपये: दस रुपये, and you have counted to ten already.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रुपया (*rupayā*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *rūpya*, “bearing a stamp; silver” (CDIAL 10805). CDIAL lists the same word in Hindi as *rūpā*, “silver”.

What you’ve built

Money in general, and the unit it is counted in.

Your turn

- *Read it:* बहुत, then say it without looking
- *Say it: rupayā*
- *Say it: das rupaye*
- *Write it:* पैसा once more, then रुपया beside the printed model
- *Read it:* खेलना

Before you move on

What does रुपया mean? (“a rupee”.) And पैसा? (“money”.)

79.3 दाम (dām) — a price

Say the unit a price is counted in, and then say ten of them.

You’ll want to know: दाम

दाम (*dām*) — “a price”.

This one has travelled further than any word in the chapter. The Greek coin was the *drachmē*; traders carried the name east; Sanskrit wrote it द्रम्म

(*dramma*); Hindi wore it down to दाम. A Greek weight of silver ended up as the ordinary Hindi word for what a thing costs.

Now put it with a word you have had since the second chapter. क्या is “what”, and

> दाम क्या है? — *dām kyā hai?* — “what is the price?”

is a whole question, built from one new word and two you already own. This is the sentence a market runs on, and you can now say it.

Set it beside नाम and शाम, two words you own: only the first letter changes, and the word changes with it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दाम (*dām*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *dramma*, “a coin” (CDIAL 6622). CDIAL traces the Sanskrit word itself to Greek *drachmē*, through Middle Persian.

What you’ve built

Three: पैसा, रुपया, दाम — and a question you can ask with the third.

Your turn

- *Say it: dām*
- *Say it: dām kyā hai?*
- *Say it:* it again, picturing something you might buy
- *Recall:* say *kriket̤*
- *Read it:* आज

Before you move on

How do you ask what something costs? (*dām kyā hai?*) Say it once more.

79.4 महँगा (mahãgā) — expensive

Write it: दाम from memory — द, then ा, then म

Then say the question you built with it.

You’ll want to know: महँगा

महँगा (*mahãgā*) — “expensive”.

Sanskrit महार्घ (*mahārgha*): महा is “great” and अर्घ is “value, price”. So the word is “great-priced”, which is what it still means.

The moon-and-dot ◌ँ over the ह sends the vowel through the nose. Say it aloud with the nasal and without it, and you will hear that the nasal is not decoration — it is part of the word.

महँगा behaves like बड़ा and पुराना, which you already own: it comes before the thing it describes and changes its ending to agree with it. You do not have to work the agreement yet. Hear it, and notice the -आ ending it shares with those two.

बहुत महँगा puts last chapter’s word to work on this one.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

महँगा (*mahãgā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mahārgha*, “high-priced” (CDIAL 9954). It is built from *mahā*, “great”, and *argha*, “price”.

What you’ve built

Four: a price, and a judgement to pass on it.

Your turn

- *Say it: mahãgā*, with the nose in the middle
- *Say it: bahut mahãgā*
- *Write it:* महँगा, putting the ◌ँ above the ह
- *Read it:* गाना
- *Recall:* say *bhī*

Before you move on

What does महँगा mean? (“expensive”.) Say that the price is very high.

79.5 ख़रीदना (kharīdnā) — to buy

Name the four words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: ख़रीदना

ख़रीदना (*kharīdnā*) — "to buy".

Persian خریدن (*kharīdan*), "to buy", with the Persian ending swapped for the Hindi -ना you now recognise on sight. The whole Persian half of the shopping vocabulary came in this way, over centuries of trade.

The dot under the ख़ is the nuqta, and it matters. Plain ख is the aspirated *k* you met in खेल; ख़ with the dot is a scraped sound further back in the throat, the one Persian and Arabic brought with them. Many printers leave the dot off and the word still reads, but the two letters are not the same.

Put the chapter together and you can shop: दाम क्या है? to ask, बहुत महँगा to complain, and ख़रीदना for what you came to do.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ख़रीदना (*kharīdnā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kharīdan*, "to buy". Hindi took its stem *kharīd-* and added the verb ending *-nā*.

What you've built

Five: पैसा, रुपया, दाम, महँगा, ख़रीदना. Enough to stand at a counter and settle what a thing costs.

Your turn

- *Say it: kharīdnā*
- *Say it: dām kyā hai?*, then *bahut mahãgā*
- *Write it:* महँगा from memory, then ख़रीदना beside the printed model
- *Say it:* all five in order
- *Recall:* say *ārām*
- *Read it:* बहुत

Before you move on

What does ख़रीदना mean? (“to buy”.) Ask what a thing costs.

79.6 सौ — the round figure

Say the word for a rupee, and the word for buying. You can ask what a thing costs — but you cannot yet say the number the answer usually is.

You’ll want to know: सौ

सौ (*sau*) — a hundred.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सौ (*sau*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *śata*, “hundred” (CDIAL 12278).

Grammar Lens: two letters, and the number a price lands on

said	meaning
सौ	a hundred
सौ रुपये	a hundred rupees

Number first, then the thing. That is the whole construction, and both halves are now yours.

रुपये rather than रुपया, because more than one is being counted — the same bend the track has been making since the adjectives, costing nothing new here.

It is two letters, the shortest number word you will meet, and it does more work than any of the bigger ones: a price, an age, a distance, and the round figure anybody reaches for when they mean *a great many*.

Your counting still stops at बीस, so the numbers between twenty and this one are still ahead of you. सौ arrives early because a price cannot wait for them.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- सौ
- सौ रुपये
- why the last word is रुपये rather than रुपया

Before you move on

What number is सौ? How do you say *a hundred rupees*? Which comes first, the number or the thing?

Chapter 80

The Eating House

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the place I eat, the meal, the bill and the person who brings it, and say that I eat and drink.
>
> *Complete HI-C73-drink and say all five words in order, then say the eating-and-drinking pair and what each half can mean.*

80.1 होटल (hoṭal) — an eating house

> Two words back: what does *mahãgā* mean, and what is ख़रीदना? The next five words are for the place you buy a meal.

You'll want to know: होटल

होटल (*hoṭal*) — "an eating house".

English *hotel*, and behind it Latin *hospitāle*, a house for guests. The same Latin word gave English *hospital* and *hospitality*: one root for the place that takes a stranger in, whether to feed, to lodge or to heal.

Here is the part a dictionary will not tell you loudly enough. In everyday Hindi a होटल is most often somewhere you **eat**, not somewhere you sleep. A small roadside place with six tables and no rooms at all calls itself a होटल, and चाय होटल is a tea shop.

So take the word as "eating house" first and "hotel" second, and you will read far more signboards correctly.

The ◌ो is the *o* matra, a single stroke above the headline with a tail.

What you've built

The first of five words for a meal you did not cook.

Your turn

- *Recall:* say *mahãgā*
- *Read it:* ख़रीदना, then say what it means
- *Hear: hoṭal*
- *Say it: hoṭal*
- *Say it: chāy hoṭal*
- *Recall:* say *āj*
- *Read it:* पैसा

Before you move on

What does होटल usually mean on an Indian signboard? (A place to eat.)

80.2 नाश्ता (nāshtā) — breakfast

Say *hoṭal*. *Write it:* होटल — ह with ◌ो above it, then ट, then ल

You'll want to know: नाश्ता

नाश्ता (*nāshtā*) — "breakfast".

Persian ناشتا (*nāshtā*) means "not having eaten, on an empty stomach". The meal took its name from the emptiness it ends.

English did the identical thing and nobody notices any more: *breakfast* is the **breaking** of the **fast**. Two languages, no contact, the same picture — the night is a fast and the morning meal is what ends it.

The middle of the word stacks श on त with the vowel-killer ◌्, the same stack you have written in नमस्ते and read in स्टेशन.

नाश्ता is also a doing word's companion: नाश्ता करना is "to have breakfast", built the way आराम करना was.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाश्ता (*nāshtā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *nāshtā*, “not having eaten”.

What you’ve built

A place to eat, and the first meal of the day to eat there.

Your turn

- *Read it:* ख़रीदना, then say it without looking
- *Say it: nāshtā*
- *Say it: nāshtā karnā*
- *Write it:* होटल once more, then नाश्ता beside the printed model
- *Read it:* भी
- *Recall:* say *rupayā*

Before you move on

What does नाश्ता mean? (“breakfast”.) What does the Persian word say about your stomach? (That it is empty.)

80.3 बिल (bil) — the bill

Which of your two words is the place, and which is the meal?

You’ll want to know: बिल

बिल (*bil*) — “the bill”.

English *bill*, borrowed for the slip of paper and used for nothing else. Three letters: ब, the ि matra written to its left, and ल.

Now a warning your eye needs. You already hold बिलकुल, “absolutely”, and you have met बिल्ली, a cat. All three open on the same three letters and none of them is related to the others — बिलकुल is Arabic, बिल्ली is Sanskrit, बिल is English. Reading the first syllable and guessing will send you to the wrong word.

बिल दीजिए asks for it, in the same polite frame that got you a ticket and a cup of tea.

What you've built

Three: होटल, नाश्ता, बिल. A place, a meal, and what arrives afterwards.

Your turn

- *Say it: bil*
- *Say it: bil dījie*
- *Contrast: bil* and *bilkul*, and say which one is a piece of paper

Before you move on

How do you ask for the bill? (*bil dījie.*) Say it once more.

80.4 वेटर (veṭar) — a waiter

> *Write it:* बिल from memory, remembering that the ि goes down before the ल it is heard after

You'll want to know: वेटर

वेटर (*veṭar*) — "a waiter".

English *waiter*, and the spelling shows two habits you have now seen three times. The English *w* is written व, because Hindi has one letter where English splits *v* and *w*. The English *t* is written ट, retroflex, as it was in टिकट and स्टेशन.

This is the word on the sign and on the pay slip, so it is the one to be able to read. Across a table it is used far less than you would expect: people catch an eye rather than call a title, and a raised hand does the work.

So hold वेटर for reading, and expect the room itself to be quieter than the word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वेटर (*veṭar*) is a loan from English *waiter*.

What you've built

Four, and the person you ask for the fourth thing.

Your turn

- *Say it: veṭar*
- *Say it: hoṭal*, then *veṭar*, then *bil*
- *Write it:* वेटर, with व for the English w and ट for the English t
- *Read it:* बहुत
- *Recall:* say *mahãgā*

Before you move on

Which Hindi letter carries an English *w*? (व.) And an English *t*? (ट.)

80.5 पीना (pīnā) — to drink

Name the four words of this chapter so far.

You'll want to know: पीना

पीना (*pīnā*) — "to drink".

Sanskrit पिबति (*pibati*), "drinks", from a root so old that Latin *bibere*, "to drink", is the same word wearing different clothes. English *potion* and *potable* come down the Latin side of that family.

Now the pair. खाना you already own as "food" — and खाना is **also** "to eat", exactly as गाना was both the song and the singing. Put them together and Hindi has one of its most-used pairs:

> खाना — food, and to eat. पीना, *pīnā* — to drink.

मैं चाय पीता हूँ is "I drink tea", in the frame you have used all along. And मैं खाना खाता हूँ puts the word into one breath twice — once for the food, once for the eating — with nothing between them but the ending.

What you’ve built

Five: होटल, नाश्ता, बिल, वेटर, पीना, *pīnā*. A place, a meal, a bill, the person who brings it, and the two doing words that made you come in.

Your turn

- *Say it: pīnā*
- *Say it: maiṁ chāy pītā hūṁ*
- *Contrast: khānā* as the food, and *khānā* as the eating
- *Write it:* पीना, then say *pīnā* and all five of this chapter in order

Before you move on

What does पीना, *pīnā*, mean? (“to drink”.) What two things can खाना mean? (“food”, and “to eat”.)

Chapter 81

Words on the Door

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read whether a place is open or closed, find the entrance and the exit, and understand that a train is late before I take my leave.
>
> *Complete HI-C74-late and say all five words in order, then name the word an announcement uses when a train is late.*

81.1 खुला (khulā) — open

> Two words back: what does *veṭar* mean, and what is पीना? The last five words of this run are the ones painted on doors.

You'll want to know: खुला

खुला (*khulā*) — "open".

It is built from खुलना, "to open", and it names the state that opening leaves behind — the way English *opened* stands to *open*. Hindi makes these already-done forms constantly, and this is one you will meet before you are taught the pattern.

खुला (*khulā*) is the word on a shutter, a shop board, a gate and a ticket window. It is also used of a thing that is loose or unpacked: खुला (*khulā*) पैसा is loose change, coins rather than a note, which is the phrase that will save you at a counter.

The ◌ु under the ख is the short *u* matra, hanging below.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खुला (*khulā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **khull*, “to be open”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 3945).

What you’ve built

The first of five words you read rather than say.

Your turn

- *Recall:* say *veṭar*
- *Read it:* पीना, then say what it means
- *Read it:* खुला (*khulā*), as though it were painted on a shutter
- *Say it: khulā*
- *Say it: khulā paisā*
- *Recall:* say *paisā*
- *Read it:* होटल

Before you move on

What does खुला (*khulā*) mean? (“open”.) Say it once more.

81.2 बंद (band) — closed

Say *khulā*. *Write it:* खुला — ख with ◌ु beneath it, then ल, then ◌ा

You’ll want to know: बंद

बंद (*band*) — “closed”.

Persian بند (*band*), “tied, shut”, and its family is enormous. The ancient root meant “to bind”, and English *bind*, *band* and *bond* are its western cousins. A closed door is a **tied** door.

Two things to keep straight. First, बंद is not the beginning of बंदर, the monkey you met among the animals — the eye will want to join them and they are unrelated. Second, बंद stands opposite खुला (*khulā*) on exactly the same signboards, so learn them as one pair and you have read half a street.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बंद (*band*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *band*, "shut, bound".

What you've built

The pair every shutter in the country is painted with.

Your turn

- *Read it:* पीना, then say it without looking
- *Say it: khulā*, then *band*
- *Read it:* बंद, and check that it is not बंदर
- *Write it:* खुला (*khulā*) once more, then बंद beside it
- *Read it:* रुपया
- *Recall:* say *nāshtā*

Before you move on

What does बंद mean? ("closed".) And its opposite? (*khulā*.)

81.3 प्रवेश (pravesh) — entrance

Say the pair a shutter is painted with, in both orders.

You'll want to know: प्रवेश

प्रवेश (*pravesh*) — "entrance".

Two Sanskrit pieces. प्र- is "forward", and विश् (*viś*-) is "to enter". Going forward into a place: प्रवेश.

That प्र- is worth keeping. It is the same ancient piece as Latin *pro*- and English *fore*-, and once you can see it you will spot it at the front of a great many formal Hindi words.

This is a **written** register, not a spoken one. Nobody says प्रवेश to a friend at a doorway; it is painted over the door, printed on a form, and read out in a station announcement. That is the same shelf कृपया sits on — the please of signs rather than the please of counters.

The opening प्र stacks प on र with the vowel-killer, as क्र did in क्रिकेट.

What you've built

Three: खुला (*khulā*), बंद, प्रवेश. Two states of a door and one of its two labels.

Your turn

- *Read it:* प्रवेश, and find the stacked प्र
- *Say it: pravesh*
- *Say it: pravesh band hai*
- *Recall:* say *dām*
- *Read it:* बिल

Before you move on

What does प्रवेश mean? (“entrance”.) Where do you meet it, on a sign or in speech? (On a sign.)

81.4 निकास (nikās) — exit

Write it: प्रवेश from memory, starting with the stacked प्र

You'll want to know: निकास

निकास (*nikās*) — “exit”.

You have most of this word already. निकलना, “to set out, to go out”, has been yours since the chapter on leaving; निकास is what that doing word turns into when you need a noun. Going out, named.

Watch the vowel change as the noun is made: निकलना has a short *a*, निक◌ास takes the long ◌ा. Hindi lengthens a vowel to build a name out of an action often enough that you should expect it rather than be surprised.

निकास is painted opposite प्रवेश over every second doorway in a station, and the two are read together or not at all.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

निकास (*nikās*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *niṣkāsa*, "going out" (CDIAL 7485).

What you've built

Four, and the second pair of this chapter: प्रवेश and निकास.

Your turn

- *Say it: nikalnā*, then *nikās*
- *Say it: pravesh*, then *nikās*
- *Write it:* निकास, lengthening the vowel that निकलना keeps short
- *Read it:* महँगा
- *Recall:* say *veṭar*

Before you move on

What does निकास mean? ("exit".) And प्रवेश? ("entrance".)

81.5 देर (der) — lateness, a delay

Name the four words of this chapter so far, in their two pairs.

You'll want to know: देर

देर (*der*) — "lateness, a delay".

Persian دیر (*der*), "late, a long while". It is a naming word rather than a describing one: Hindi does not say "the train is late", it says the train **is with lateness**, using a small word for *with* that a later chapter teaches.

Set it against जल्दी, which you already own for speed and for earliness. जल्दी and देर are the two ends of the same measure, and a station announcement will use one or the other of them about your train.

That is where this chapter lands. Listen for देर in an announcement about गाड़ी, your train: it is the single most useful word a traveller can catch on a platform.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

देर (*der*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *der*, “late; a long time”.

What you’ve built

Five: खुला (*khulā*), बंद, प्रवेश, निकास, देर. Enough to read a door, find a way through it, and understand why the train has not come.

Your turn

- *Say it: der*
- *Say it: gāṛī*, then *der* — the two words an announcement about a late train turns on
- *Contrast: jaldī* and *der*
- *Write it:* निकास, then देर, and say all five in order
- *Recall:* say *kharīdnā*
- *Read it:* पीना

Before you move on

Which word in an announcement tells you the train is late? (*der*, lateness.) Which word sits at the other end of the same measure? (*jaldī*.)

Chapter 82

First, Second, Third

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say first to fifth in Hindi with the right ending for the noun, and say why the first four have to be learned as words and the fifth does not.
>
> *The fifth ordinal states the -van rule against the four irregular words that came before it.*

82.1 पहला (pahlā) — first

A new kind of counting starts here, so the recalls come first, at the four growing distances this book measures.

- *Recall:* say *der* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *khulā* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *the two form names, Mīrā and Aruṇ* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *deś* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *ghaṇṭā* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *harā* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You’ll want to know: पहला

पहला (*pahlā*) — “**first**”.

एक, दो, तीन answer **how many**. This answers **which one in the line**, and Hindi keeps a second set of words for that.

It agrees like any -*ā* adjective: **पहला दिन** (*pahlā din*), the first day, but **पहली किताब** (*pahlī kitāb*), the first book — feminine noun, feminine ending.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

There is no **एक** inside **पहला** (*pahlā*). It comes down from **prathilla*, a form CDIAL reconstructs beside **prathila*, “first”, and builds on Sanskrit **प्रथम** (*prathama*), a word that already meant “foremost” before Hindi existed (CDIAL 8652). The number was never part of it.

You will meet its close relative constantly: **पहले** (*pahle*) — “**before**, **earlier**, **first of all**”. **खाने से पहले** is “before eating”. So in Hindi the word for *first* and the word for *before* are the same word wearing a different ending, which is a reasonable thing for a language to decide: putting one thing before another **is** putting it first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *pahlā*
- *pahlā din* — the first day
- *pahlī kitāb* — the first book

Before you move on

Say “the first day”. (**पहला** (*pahlā*) **दिन**.) What changes in **पहली किताब**, and why? (**The ending** — *kitāb* is feminine.) And what does **पहले** mean? (**Before, earlier** — the same word.)

82.2 दूसरा (dūsrā) — second, and the other one

Recalls before the second ordinal, at the four measured distances.

- *Recall:* say *pahlā* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

- *Recall:* say *band* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *the supported name entry* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *Bhārat* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *the letter kha* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *pīlā* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: दूसरा

दूसरा (*dūsrā*) — "**second**".

दूसरा दिन (*dūsrā din*) — the second day. दूसरी किताब (*dūsrī kitāb*) — the second book.

Like *pahlā*, there is no दो visible in it, though this one does descend from the Sanskrit word for two.

You'll want to know: the other meaning

दूसरा (*dūsrā*) also means "**other**, **another**", and that is not a separate word to learn — it is the same one.

- दूसरा आदमी (*dūsrā ādmī*) — the other man.
- दूसरा घर (*dūsrā ghar*) — the other house.

Hold both senses together. A chapter two ahead turns on them: once you can say *ek* and *dūsrā* in one breath, you can say "**one ... the other**", which is a thing Hindi does with no extra machinery at all.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *dūsrā*
- *dūsrā din* — the second day
- *dūsrā ādmī* — the other man

Before you move on

Say “the second book”. (दूसरी किताब.) What is the other thing दूसरा (*dūsrā*) means? (**Other, another**.) And say “the other man”. (दूसरा (*dūsrā*) आदमी.)

82.3 तीसरा (tīsrā) — third

Recalls first, then the third.

- *Recall:* say *dūsrā* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *praveś* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *the delayed name entry* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *śahar* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *umr* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *din* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You’ll want to know: तीसरा

तीसरा (*tīsrā*) — “**third**”.

तीसरा दिन (*tīsrā din*), तीसरी किताब (*tīsrī kitāb*).

Say तीन and then तीसरा and you can hear the number this time — the first ordinal where you can. And say *dūsrā, tīsrā* together: they rhyme, because they share an ending, **-सरा**, that they share with nothing else in the language.

Two words with a private ending is not a pattern; it is a pair. The next lesson goes a third way, and the one after that finally states a rule.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तीसरा (*tīsrā*) comes from a reconstructed **triḥsara*, “triple”, built on Sanskrit *tris*, “three times” (CDIAL 6018). दूसरा (*dūsrā*) comes the same way from **dviḥsara*, “twofold” (CDIAL 6676).

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *tīsrā*
- the join — *tīn* → *tīsrā*
- the pair — *dūsrā, tīsrā*

Before you move on

Say the third day. (तीसरा दिन.) Which number can you hear inside it? (तीन.) And how many words share the -सरा ending? (**Two** — *dūsrā* and *tīsrā*.)

82.4 चौथा (cauthā) — fourth

Recalls first, then the fourth.

- *Recall:* say *tīsrā* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *nikās* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *cāhnā* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *bhāṣā* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *kitne sāl ke ho?* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *rāt* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: चौथा

चौथा (*cauthā*) — "**fourth**".

चौथा दिन (*cauthā din*), चौथी किताब (*cauthī kitāb*).

चार is four, and *cauthā* comes from Sanskrit चतुर्थ (*caturtha*) — you can hear the four, but the ending is **-था**, not the **-सरा** of the last two.

Count what has happened. Four ordinals, and four different shapes: *pahlā* from a word that never meant one, *dūsrā* and *tīsrā* sharing a private ending, and now *cauthā* with an ending of its own. Nothing so far has generalised.

That is the honest state of it, and it is also the good news: these four are the whole of the memorising. The next lesson states the rule, and it holds for everything after — with one hole, which gets a lesson of its own.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *cauthā*
- the join — *cār* → *cauthā*
- the four so far — *pahlā, dūsrā, tīsrā, cauthā*

Before you move on

Say the fourth day. (चौथा (*cauthā*) दिन.) What ending does it take? (-था, not the -सरा of the last two.) And how many of the ordinals have to be learned as separate words? (**Four** — and you now have them.)

82.5 पाँचवाँ (pā̃cvā̃) — fifth, and the rule at last

Recalls first, then the fifth — and the ending that ends the memorizing.

- *Recall:* say *cauthā* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *der* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *the infinitive as an object* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *aṅgrezī* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *the letter da* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *śubh rātri* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You’ll want to know: पाँचवाँ

पाँचवाँ (*pā̃cvā̃*) — “**fifth**”.

पाँचवाँ दिन (*pā̃cvā̃ din*), पाँचवीं किताब (*pā̃cvī̃ kitāb*).

Two nasal hooks in one word: one over the पाँ, one over the वाँ. The chandrabindu you learned in the writing chapters is doing both.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पाँचवाँ (*pāṁcvāṁ*) comes from Sanskrit *pañcama*, “fifth” (CDIAL 7669), the ordinal built on *pañca*, “five”.

Grammar Lens: the number, plus -वाँ

पाँच → पाँचवाँ (*pā̃cvā̃*). Nothing is taken away and nothing is reshaped: the cardinal stands whole and **-वाँ** goes on the end.
It goes on doing that for every number above five. बीस gives बीसवाँ, twentieth; सौ gives सौवाँ, hundredth. The four words before this one were the exceptions, and you met them first because a learner needs *first* and *second* on the first day and cannot wait for a rule.
One number after this breaks it. Everything else obeys.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *pā̃cvā̃* — two nasal hooks
- the rule — *pā̃c* + *-vā̃*
- *bīs* → *bīsvā̃*, twentieth

Before you move on

How is an ordinal made from five upward? (**The plain number, plus -वाँ**.) How many nasal hooks are in पाँचवाँ (*pā̃cvā̃*)? (**Two**.) And say “twentieth”. (बीसवाँ.)

Chapter 83

Sixth to Tenth

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count in order all the way to tenth in Hindi, and say why chhatha is the one number the rule does not reach.
>
> *The tenth closes the series and carries the ending past ten, so there is no second list to learn.*

83.1 छठा (chaṭhā) — the one hole in the rule

Recalls open the chapter, at the four measured distances.

- *Recall:* say *pā̃cvā̃* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *pahlā* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kyoṁ* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *gāṛī* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *mausam* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *subah* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: छठा

छठा (*chaṭhā*) — "**sixth**".

छठा दिन (*chaṭhā din*), छठी किताब (*chaṭhī kitāb*).

The last lesson gave you a rule one lesson ago and this is where it fails. छह is six, and the sixth is **not** *chhahvā̃*. It is छठा (*chaṭhā*), with a retroflex ठ that comes from nowhere in the cardinal.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Sanskrit had षष्ठ (*ṣaṣṭha*) for sixth, and Hindi inherited it directly, worn down to *chaṭhā*. It never went through the -वाँ machinery because it was already there when the machinery was built.

Which is the ordinary shape of this kind of hole: a rule spreads through a language and the words that are said most often resist it longest, because they are already known and nobody has to work them out. English does the same thing — *went* is not *goed* for exactly this reason. So the ordinals are five inherited words and one ending: *pahlā, dūsrā, tīsrā, cauthā, chaṭhā*, and **-वाँ** for everything else. That is the whole system, and the rest of this chapter is the ending doing its work.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *chaṭhā* — retroflex *ṭh*
- not *chhahvā̃* — the rule does not reach it
- the five that are words — *pahlā, dūsrā, tīsrā, cauthā, chaṭhā*

Before you move on

Say the sixth day. (छठा (*chaṭhā*) दिन.) Why is it not *chhahvā̃*? (**It was inherited whole** from Sanskrit *ṣaṣṭha*, before the -वाँ rule existed.) And how many ordinals are separate words? (**Five**.)

83.2 सातवाँ (sātvā̃) — seventh

Recalls first, then the seventh.

- *Recall:* say *chaṭhā* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

- *Recall:* say *dūsrā* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kyoṁki* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *rel* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *the letter dha* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *śām* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: सातवाँ

सातवाँ (*sātvā̃*) — "**seventh**".

सातवाँ दिन (*sātvā̃ din*), सातवीं किताब (*sātvī̃ kitāb*).

सात stands whole and **-वाँ** goes on. After the hole at six the ending runs without interruption, and it will keep running for the rest of the number line.

Notice what you are now doing: you are not learning a word, you are applying something. Say *sāt* and the seventh follows from it without a second act of memory. That is what a rule buys, and it is why the four irregular ones were worth meeting first — they were the price, and it has been paid.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सातवाँ (*sātvāṁ*) comes from Sanskrit *saptama*, "seventh" (CDIAL 13151), the ordinal built on *sapta*, "seven".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *sātvā̃*
- the rule — *sāt* + *-vā̃*
- *sātvī̃ kitāb* — the seventh book

Before you move on

Say the seventh day. (सातवाँ (*sātvā̃*) दिन.) What happens to सात on the way? (**Nothing** — it stands whole.) And what changes for a feminine noun? (सातवीं.)

83.3 आठवाँ (āṭhvā̃) — eighth

Recalls first, then the eighth.

- *Recall:* say *sātvā̃* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *tīsrā* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kab* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *sṭeśan* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *chhah, sāt, āṭh, nau, das* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *dopahar* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: आठवाँ

आठवाँ (*āṭhvā̃*) — “**eighth**”.

आठवाँ दिन (*āṭhvā̃ din*), आठवीं किताब (*āṭhvī̃ kitāb*).

आठ + -वाँ. The retroflex ठ of the cardinal is kept exactly as it is — the ending arrives after it and changes nothing on its way.

Hold *chaṭhā* and *āṭhvā̃* side by side and hear the difference. Both have a retroflex ठ; in the sixth it belongs to the ordinal and not to the cardinal, and in the eighth it belongs to the cardinal and the ordinal borrowed nothing.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आठवाँ (*āṭhvāṁ*) comes from Sanskrit *aṣṭama*, “eighth” (CDIAL 937), the ordinal built on *aṣṭā*, “eight”.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *āṭhvā̃*
- the rule — *āṭh* + *-vā̃*
- *āṭhvī̃ kitāb* — the eighth book
- *chaṭhā* against *āṭhvā̃* — one is a word, one is a sum

Before you move on

Say the eighth day. (आठवाँ (*āṭhvā̃*) दिन.) What happened to the *ṭh* of *āṭh*? (**Nothing** — the ending follows it.) What changes for a feminine noun? (आठवीं.) And which of *chaṭhā* and *āṭhvā̃* had to be memorised? (***Chaṭhā***.)

83.4 नौवाँ (nauvā̃) — ninth

Recalls first, then the ninth.

- *Recall:* say *āṭhvā̃* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *cauthā* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *the verb at the end* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ṭikaṭ* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *where chhah, nau and das came from* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *suprabhāt* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: नौवाँ

नौवाँ (*nauvā̃*) — "**ninth**".
नौवाँ दिन (*nauvā̃ din*), नौवीं किताब (*nauvī̃ kitāb*).

नौ ends in a vowel where *sāt* and *āṭh* ended in consonants, and **-वाँ** attaches anyway. That is worth one sentence of attention: an ending that does not care what the word before it ends in is a **suffix**, not a reshaping — it is added, not fused.

Compare *cauthā*, where *cār* had to change shape to accept its ending. That is a fused form. This is not. Same language, two different ages of word-making, and you can hear which is which.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नौवाँ (*nauvāṁ*) comes from Sanskrit *navama*, "ninth" (CDIAL 7006), the ordinal built on *nava*, "nine".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *nauvā̃*
- the rule — *nau* + -*vā̃*, after a vowel
- *nauvī̃ kitāb* — the ninth book
- *cauthā* is fused; *nauvā̃* is added

Before you move on

Say the ninth day. (नौवाँ (*nauvā̃*) दिन.) What does नौ end in, and does the ending care? (**A vowel**, and **no**.) What changes for a feminine noun? (नौवीं.) And which of *cauthā* and *nauvā̃* was fused rather than added? (***Cauthā***.)

83.5 दसवाँ (dasvā̃) — tenth

Recalls first, then the tenth, which closes the series.

- *Recall:* say *nauvā̃* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *pā̃cvā̃* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *ki* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back

- *Recall:* say *jānā* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *gyārah to bīs* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *śubh sandhyā* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: दसवाँ

दसवाँ (*dasvā̃*) — "**tenth**".

दसवाँ दिन (*dasvā̃ din*), दसवीं किताब (*dasvī̃ kitāb*).

That is the ten. Say them in order — *pahlā, dūsrā, tīsrā, cauthā, pā̃cvā̃, chaṭhā, sātvā̃, ā̃ṭhvā̃, nauvā̃, dasvā̃* — and count what you actually had to learn: **five words and one ending**.

And ten is not a boundary. ग्यारहवाँ is eleventh, बीसवाँ twentieth, सौवाँ hundredth. There is no second list above ten and no third above a hundred; the ending you learned at five reaches every number you will ever say.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दसवाँ (*dasvāṁ*) comes from Sanskrit *daśama*, "tenth" (CDIAL 6233), the ordinal built on *daśa*, "ten".

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *dasvā̃*
- *dasvī̃ kitāb* — the tenth book
- the ten in order, *pahlā* to *dasvā̃*
- past ten — *gyārahvā̃, bīsvā̃, sauvā̃*

Before you move on

Say the tenth day. (दसवाँ (*dasvā̃*) दिन.) What changes for a feminine noun? (दसवीं.) Now say the ten in order. (***Pahlā*** through ***dasvā̃***.) How much had to be learned as words? (**Five** — and one ending for the rest.) And say "eleventh". (ग्यारहवाँ.)

Chapter 84

One and the Other

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say one thing and the other with ek and dusra, and tell that apart from naming a thing's place in a line.
>
> *The ordinals and ek … dusra worked on the same set, so the difference between naming a place and sorting two things is done rather than stated.*

84.1 एक … दूसरा (ek … dūsrā) — one and the other

Recalls open the chapter's last stretch, at the four measured distances.

- *Recall:* say *dasvā̃* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays
- *Recall:* say *chaṭhā* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *jab … tab …* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *-kar* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *kuttā* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *when to say śubh sandhyā* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

Grammar Lens: one, and the other

> **एक … दूसरा** — “**one … the other**”. **एक किताब नई है, दूसरी पुरानी।** — One book is new, the other old. **एक आदमी यहाँ है, दूसरा वहाँ।** — One man is here, the other there.

The second ordinal lesson said to hold both senses of **दूसरा** together, and this is why. Hindi needs no third word to say “one … the other”: it puts **एक** in the first half and **दूसरा** in the second, and the second sense of *dūsrā* does the rest.
Both halves agree with what they name, so a feminine noun gives **एक … दूसरी**.
That is a thing worth having. Sorting two of anything — two books, two men, two roads — needs this and nothing else.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *ek … dūsrā*
- *ek kitāb merī hai, dūsrī uskī* — one book is mine, the other is his
- *ek ādmī andar thā, dūsrā bāhar*

Before you move on

How does Hindi say “one … the other”? (**एक … दूसरा** — no third word.) Which sense of *dūsrā* is doing the work? (**Other**, not *second*.) And what changes for a feminine noun? (**दूसरी**.)

84.2 Putting things in order — the ordinals and एक … दूसरा together

Recalls first, and then the work of the last three chapters: everything in one place.

- *Recall:* say *ek … dūsrā* — **R1**, one lesson back, before it decays

- *Recall:* say *sātvā̃* — **R2**, the first real retrieval, five to fifteen lessons back
- *Recall:* say *saknā* — **R3**, durable, twenty to sixty lessons back
- *Recall:* say *kyā …?* — **R3**, a second word from the same distance
- *Recall:* say *billī* — **R4**, recognition at distance, eighty lessons back or more
- *Recall:* say *śubh dopahar* — **R4**, a second word from the same distance

You'll want to know: two ways of ordering

You have ten ordinals, an ending that makes the rest, and **एक … दूसरा**. They do two different jobs, and the difference is easiest to feel on one small set.

Three books on a shelf:

- **पहली किताब**, **दूसरी किताब**, **तीसरी किताब** — the first, second and third. Each one is named by **where it sits**, and the naming works however many there are.
- **एक किताब नई है, दूसरी पुरानी।** — One is new, the other old. Nothing is numbered; two things are **sorted against each other**, and this only works when there are two.

So: **पहले** the first, and after it the second. Say the three books in order, then say the two-book version, and you have used both systems on the same shelf.

पहला दिन, **दूसरा दिन**, **तीसरा दिन** — and if you can say those, you can say the fortieth, because the ending does not stop.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three books — *pahlī, dūsrī, tīsrī kitāb*
- the two books — *ek kitāb merī hai, dūsrī uskī*
- *pahlā din, dūsrā din, tīsrā din*

Before you move on

What does an ordinal name? (**Where a thing sits in a line**.) What does *ek … dūsrā* do instead? (**Sorts two things against each other**.) And how many things does that second one work for? (**Two**.)

Chapter 85

Reading — Signs, Notices, and a First Paragraph

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read Devanagari off a sign, a notice, and a short paragraph, without translating word by word.
>
> *Seventy-eight words of Hindi in a row, and not one of them new — the first time the track asks for a whole paragraph at once.*

85.1 (reading) — six signs

Every word below, you have already been taught. Not one of them is new.

What is new is that nobody is going to tell you which one is coming.

Read this

प्रवेश निकास खुला बंद दुकान स्टेशन

Read down the list once. Do not sound each letter out — look at the whole word and let it arrive.
Now again, and notice which ones came instantly and which ones you had to assemble. Both are fine. The difference is what practice removes.

Why it's said this way

प्रवेश and निकास are the two you will meet at every door in India, and they are worth knowing by shape rather than by letter, because you usually read them while walking.

A sign is the one kind of Hindi that gives you no sentence to lean on — no verb at the end, no है to tell you what is going on. One word, and it has to carry everything.

That is why this is the place reading starts. Six words is not much to hold, and holding them without help is the whole exercise.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six words down the list, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many of the six were new? (**None.**)

What was new, then? (**Nobody said them first.** You read them.)

85.2 (reading) — six notices

The last lesson gave you single words. This one gives each word something to stand on.

Still nothing new — the same signs, with है behind them.

Read this

दुकान बंद है। स्टेशन खुला है। यहाँ पानी है। टिकट यहाँ है। प्रवेश यहाँ है। कृपया धीरे।

Read it: the six notices down once, without stopping

Read it: the six notices again, and this time notice you did not have to work out what was shut

The notice said so.

Why it's said this way

दुकान बंद है। Three words, and the last one is the verb. Hindi puts it there every time, so the end of a notice is where you find out whether something *is* or *is not*.

That is worth more than it looks. It means you can read the first two words of any notice, guess, and then have your guess confirmed or corrected by the last word — which is exactly how a fluent reader reads.

The last line breaks the pattern: कृपया धीरे। No verb at all. Signs drop the verb when nobody could mistake the meaning, and *please, slowly* needs no help.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the six notices, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

Where does a Hindi notice keep its verb? (**At the end.**)
And how many new words were in these six lines? (**None.**)

85.3 (reading) — the first paragraph

Six words, then six lines. Now a whole paragraph.

Ninety-one words, and the rule has not changed: not one of them is new.

Read this

मेरा नाम अरुण है। मैं भारत में रहता हूँ। मेरा घर छोटा है, लेकिन अच्छा है। घर में एक कमरा, एक दरवाज़ा और दो खिड़की हैं। सुबह मैं चाय और दूध पीता हूँ। फिर मैं रोटी खाता हूँ। आज मैं बाज़ार जाता हूँ, क्योंकि मुझे फल पसंद हैं। बाज़ार में एक दुकान है। वहाँ एक आदमी काम करता है। वह मेरा दोस्त है। वह हिंदी बोलता है। वह किताब पढ़ता है, लेकिन वह रात में दुकान में काम करता है। फिर मैं घर आता हूँ। रात में मैं किताब पढ़ता हूँ।

Read it: the passage once, without stopping or translating
Read it: the passage again, and notice how little work it took

Why it’s said this way

Look at what is holding it together, because it is not vocabulary.
और adds. लेकिन holds two true things apart. क्योंकि gives a reason. फिर puts one thing after another. Each of those was a chapter, and each was small.
This is the first time the track has asked you to hold a whole paragraph at once — and the reason it can is that everything in it was paid for, one chapter at a time.

Your turn

- *Say it:* the paragraph aloud, once, without stopping

Twice through:

Before you move on

How many words in that paragraph were new to you? (**None.**)
And what made it readable? (Everything in it had already been **paid for**, one chapter at a time.)

85.4 (म र न अ प ह य त ◌् ◌ा ◌ी) — eleven, and three kinds of thing

Two letters from the book’s first script pages. Read म, then न, and name each.

Script: eight letters, one killer, two hangers

They arrived one or two per chapter and no page has gathered them. Sorted by what kind of thing each one is:

kind	pieces
consonants — each carries a built-in *a*	म *ma* · र *ra* · न *na* · प *pa* · ह *ha* · य *ya* · त *ta*
a standing vowel	अ *a* — the full-size letter, for when a word opens on the vowel
the killer	◌् — removes the built-in *a*
hangers	◌ा *ā* · ◌ी *ī* — replace the built-in *a*

अ is the one worth pausing on, because it is the same sound the consonants already carry. A consonant has *a* inside it; अ is what you write when there is no consonant to put it in.

Your turn

The three marks, cold, and what each does to the letter it touches.

Read these aloud:

- ◌् — say what it takes away
- ◌ा — say what it replaces, and with what
- ◌ी — the same, and say how it differs from the one above

All three depend on one fact: a bare consonant is not silent. It already has a vowel, and these either remove it or swap it.

Before you move on

What vowel is inside a bare Devanagari consonant? (**A short *a*.**) What does ◌् do? (**Removes it.**) And when do you need अ rather than relying on that built-in vowel? (**When the word opens on the vowel.**)

85.5 (स ष ल ठ ण ऋ ◌ो ◌ौ औ ज़) — the thin eleven

Read स, then ल. Two consonants you have been reading for a long time without being asked for them by name.

Script: five consonants, and the retroflex row they belong to

letter	sound	what marks it
स	*sa*	the plain sibilant
ल	*la*	the plain lateral
ष	*ṣa*	**retroflex** — tongue curled back
ठ	*ṭha*	**retroflex**, with breath behind it
ण	*ṇa*	**retroflex** nasal

Three of the five are retroflex, and that is the group worth seeing together: Hindi distinguishes a whole row of consonants made with the tongue curled back against the roof of the mouth from the dental row made against the teeth. The difference is inaudible to most English speakers at first and load-bearing in Hindi.

Your turn: a vowel written like a letter, and a dot

- *Read it:* ऋ — inherited from Sanskrit, a vowel that behaves like a consonant. Hindi says it *ri*
- *Write it:* ऋ once, from memory
- *Read it:* औ and ◌ौ — the same vowel standing alone, then hanging off a consonant
- *Read it:* ◌ो — the hanger for *o*

औ against ◌ौ is the pairing the whole system runs on: a vowel gets a full-size letter when nothing precedes it and a hanging sign when a consonant does.

Before you move on

What does the dot under ज़, फ़, ख़, क़ tell you? (**The sound is borrowed** — Persian or Arabic, and not native to Devanagari.)
Which of the eleven is a vowel that behaves like a consonant? (ऋ.)
Name the retroflex nasal. (ण.)

Chapter 86

Writing — With A Clock

Modes: ✎ **pen** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none (1 lesson).

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can complete the A1 writing paper's two tasks inside its published twenty minutes, filling every form field and keeping the message between thirty and forty words.
>
> *Complete HI-W10-a1-con-reloj: seven minutes for the form and thirteen for the message, then count the words and check the form for blanks before mistakes.*

86.1 The same form, with a clock

You have done this writing with as long as you liked.

A task you can only do untimed is not yet a task you can do. Here are the conditions the assessment actually publishes.

Writing — timed production

What the contract publishes. This track's A1 writing paper runs **20 minutes** and holds **two** tasks:

- a practical form asking for **six to eight** completed fields, worth 40 of the paper's 100 points;
- a message for a named reader and a stated purpose, **30 to 40 words**, worth the other 60.

Those numbers are read out of `task-shapes/a1.json`, the same file the assessment contract points at. They are not invented here.

Notice what the split says before you write a word: the **message is worth more than the form**, and it is the shorter of the two. Time spent perfecting a field is time taken from the part that scores.

Give the form its share and no more: **seven minutes**, starting now. Fill every field. A blank field scores nothing and cannot be argued with.

Now the message: **thirteen minutes**, thirty to forty words, to one named reader.

When the time is up, stop even if a line is unfinished. An unfinished paper is information. An untimed one is not.

Before you move on

Count the words in your message. **Under thirty** and the task is half done; **well past forty** and you spent time the paper did not give you. Both are worth learning from your own clock rather than from an examiner.

Then check the form, and check it for **blanks before mistakes**. A field with a wrong answer can still earn something; a field left empty cannot.

This is the last of the seven writing stages. Everything before it asked you to produce the language. This one asks whether you can produce it **when the conditions are not yours to choose** — which is the only version of the question an assessment ever asks.

Chapter 87

Lunch and Dinner

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** its only lesson.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name all three meals of the day, and say which one is a borrowed word and which two are phrases Hindi builds from a time plus khana.
>
> *Say all three meals in order, morning to night, and name the odd one out: nashta is borrowed whole, while dopahar ka khana and rat ka khana are built from a time the learner already has plus khana.*

87.1 दोपहर का खाना / रात का खाना — the two meals you already know the words for

> You have खाना (*khānā*), "food". You have दोपहर (*dopahar*) and रात (*rāt*). Before reading on, guess what दोपहर का खाना is.

You'll want to know: दोपहर का खाना and रात का खाना

दोपहर का खाना (*dopahar kā khānā*) — "lunch." रात का खाना (*rāt kā khānā*) — "dinner."

You guessed them, and that is the point of putting them here rather than in a word list. Neither is a new word. Each is **a time you already have, plus का, plus the food-word you already have** — "the afternoon's food", "the night's food."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The transparency runs deeper than the compound.

दोपहर is itself two pieces you can see: दो (“two”) + पहर, a traditional watch of roughly three hours. Two watches into the day is noon — the word is a clock reading that turned into a time of day.

रात comes from Sanskrit रात्रि (*rātri*), the formal word that shows up in शुभ रात्रि (“good night”). The everyday रात is the same word worn down by use, which is why the greeting sounds more ceremonious than the noun.

So a three-word phrase for “dinner” contains a number, an obsolete time unit, and a Sanskrit noun — and a learner who has met all three can read it cold.

Grammar Lens: the pattern, not the pair

Set the day’s three meals beside each other:

meal	**Hindi**	**what it is built from**
breakfast	नाश्ता	its own word, borrowed whole
lunch	दोपहर का खाना	a time + का + खाना
dinner	रात का खाना	a time + का + खाना

नाश्ता is the odd one out: a single borrowed noun with no parts to see. The other two are phrases Hindi builds on demand. That asymmetry is worth noticing because it keeps recurring — Hindi borrows a whole word where it has one, and builds a transparent phrase where it does not.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “दोपहर का खाना” — *dopahar kā khānā*, lunch
- “रात का खाना” — *rāt kā khānā*, dinner
- all three meals in order, morning to night (नाश्ता, दोपहर का खाना, रात का खाना)

Before you move on

Which of the three meal names is a single borrowed word rather than a built phrase? (नाश्ता.) What is दोपहर made of, and what does it add up to? (दो “two” + पहर a three-hour watch — two watches in, so noon.)

Chapter 88

Four Adjectives That Do Not Agree

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** both lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say easy, difficult, beautiful and ugly, and tell from an adjective's ending whether it will change to match its noun.
>
> *Name all four adjectives and say which of them would change ending before a feminine noun: none, because a Hindi adjective bends only when it ends in -aa.*

88.1 आसान / मुश्किल — easy, difficult, and two words that refuse to agree

> You know that काला changes its ending to match the noun and सफ़ेद never does. Before reading on: which of those two do you expect a word borrowed from Persian to behave like?

You'll want to know: आसान and मुश्किल

आसान (*āsān*) — "easy." मुश्किल (*mushkil*) — "difficult."

Both are borrowed, and both behave like सफ़ेद: they sit in front of the noun and **do not change ending for anything**. Whatever the noun's gender or number, the adjective is the same shape you learned.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आसान comes from Persian *āsān*, “easy” — a plain everyday word in both languages, with no complication to report, which is fitting.

मुश्किल is the more interesting half. It is Arabic *mushkil*, from the root ش-ك-ل (*sh-k-l*), which is about **form and shape**. A *mushkil* thing is one whose shape is unclear — something you cannot make out the outline of. The same root gives *shakl*, “shape,” a word many Hindi speakers also use.

So “difficult” in Hindi is not “heavy” or “hard” but **“hard to make out.”** That is a different metaphor from the English one, and worth carrying with you.

Grammar Lens: which adjectives bend, and why

Line the four up:

adjective	origin	changes ending?
काला	Sanskrit, ends in **-आ**	yes
सफ़ेद	Persian loan	no
आसान	Persian loan	no
मुश्किल	Arabic loan	no

There is a pattern under this, and it is about shape rather than about borrowing. A Hindi adjective bends when it ends in **-आ**; otherwise it stays put. Loanwords land on the “no” side so often because they mostly arrive ending in a consonant.

That means you do not have to remember a list. **Listen for the ending.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “आसान” — *āsān*, easy
- “मुश्किल” — *mushkil*, difficult
- whether either one would change its ending in front of a feminine noun (no — neither ends in **-आ**)

Before you move on

What shape does a Hindi adjective need before it will bend? (An ending in -आ.) What is the literal idea inside मुश्किल? (Something whose *shape* is unclear — from the Arabic root for form.)

88.2 सुंदर / बदसूरत — beautiful, ugly, and a prefix you already own

You met सुप्रभात as "good morning." Say it again and listen to the first syllable. You are about to meet it a second time, in a word that has nothing to do with mornings.

You'll want to know: सुंदर and बदसूरत

सुंदर (*sundar*) — "beautiful." बदसूरत (*badsūrat*) — "ugly."

Neither ends in -आ, so neither bends. You can put both to work with what you learned last lesson and nothing else.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुंदर opens with Sanskrit सु- — the prefix meaning "good, well." It is the same सु- sitting at the front of सुप्रभात ("good dawn"). Once you have noticed it, you will keep finding it: सु- marks the favourable version of whatever follows.

बदसूरत is two borrowings glued together. बद is Persian for "bad," and सूरत is Arabic *ṣūrat*, "face" or "form." Ugly, in Hindi, is literally **"bad-faced."**

> बद and English *bad* look like the same word and are not related. The resemblance is one of the most famous coincidences in etymology — two unconnected languages landing on nearly the same sound for nearly the same meaning. Enjoy it, and do not build a rule on it.

So the pair is built from opposite halves of Hindi's vocabulary: सुंदर is Sanskrit through and through, बदसूरत is Persian plus Arabic. The language names beauty with its inherited words and ugliness with its borrowed ones, which is an accident of history rather than a judgement, but it is a useful one to notice — it tells you which dictionary each word's relatives live in.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "सुंदर" — *sundar*, beautiful
- "बदसूरत" — *badsūrat*, ugly
- which of the four adjectives you now have would change ending in front of a feminine noun (none of them — not one ends in **-आ**)

Before you move on

Where have you seen **सु-** before this lesson, and what does it do? (In **सुप्रभात** — it marks the good version of what follows.) What are the two pieces of **बदसूरत**, and what do they add up to? (Persian **बद** "bad" plus Arabic **सूरत** "face" — bad-faced.)

Chapter 89

School: The Borrowed Word and the Built One

Modes: **voice** (4) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name the school in both registers, say who is in it, and tell which of the two words belongs on a sign and which in a spoken sentence.
>
> *Say where the teacher and the student are using the casual word, then read the sign that calls the same building by the formal one.*

89.1 स्कूल (skūl) — the building the teacher and the student were always in

Say शिक्षक and *chātra*. You have had both of them for a long time. Now say the place they meet — and notice that you cannot yet.

You'll want to know: स्कूल

स्कूल (*skūl*) — "school". Masculine.

Write it: स्कूल once

स + ◌् + क gives the conjunct स्क, then ◌ू above the ल... no: the ◌ू belongs to क, so it is स्कू and then ल. Three pieces, one of them a conjunct you have seen before.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

This one is borrowed straight from English, and the English word has a joke inside it that Hindi inherited without asking.

English *school* comes from Latin *schola*, from Greek **skholḗ** — which meant **leisure**. Free time. The hours you did not have to work.

The Greeks thought study was what a person did with their leisure, so the word for time off slid across to mean the place you spend it learning. Every language that borrowed it borrowed the joke: Spanish *escuela*, German *Schule*, Russian *shkola*, and now Hindi स्कूल.

So when you say *skūl*, you are saying a Greek word for "spare time" that has travelled through Latin, English and into Devanagari without anyone noticing what it used to mean.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "स्कूल" — *skūl*
- the teacher, the student, and the school, in that order (शिक्षक, *chātra*, स्कूल)
- what the Greek ancestor of this word meant (leisure)

Before you move on

What did **skholḗ** mean before it meant school? (Leisure — the time you did not have to work.) Which two people did this track already know how to name before it could name the building? (शिक्षक and *chātra*.)

89.2 विद्यालय (vidyālay) — an abode of knowledge

You have स्कूल, borrowed whole. Hindi also has its own word, built out of two pieces you can take apart. Guess which register it belongs to before reading on — the sign above the gate, or the sentence a child says?

You'll want to know: विद्यालय

विद्यालय (*vidyālay*) — "school", masculine, and noticeably more formal than स्कूल. It is what you read on the gate, on a form, in a newspaper. A child telling you where they are going says *skūl.*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Two Sanskrit pieces, joined the way Sanskrit joins everything:

> विद्या (*vidyā*) — "knowledge" — plus आलय (*ālaya*) — "abode". An abode of knowledge.

आलय is productive on its own: *himālaya* is हिम ("snow") + आलय — the abode of snow. You already know that mountain's name; now you know it is a compound, and the second half is sitting in this word too. And विद्या rests on the root विद् (*vid*), "to know" — which is one of the furthest-travelled roots in any language on earth:

- Sanskrit वेद (*veda*) — knowledge, the name of the oldest texts.
- Latin *vidēre* "to see", giving **vid**eo, **vis**ion, e**vid**ence.
- English **wit**, **wis**dom, and the *-wise* in *likewise.*

So *vidyālay* and the English word *wit* are built on the same ancient syllable. The borrowed स्कूल carried a Greek word for leisure into Hindi; the native विद्यालय was here all along, and its root reaches English by a different road entirely.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "विद्यालय" — *vidyālay*
- which of the two words goes on the gate and which a child says
- the other famous compound ending in आलय, and what its first half means (हिमालय — हिम, snow)

Before you move on

What are the two pieces of विद्यालय? (विद्या knowledge + आलय abode.) Which English word for cleverness comes from the same root as विद्या? (*Wit* — and *wisdom* with it.)

89.3 स्कूल or विद्यालय — the same building, two registers

Both words mean school. Say each one, and decide which you would write on an official form.

Grammar Lens: borrowed whole, or built from parts

This is the third time this pattern has turned up, and it is worth naming:

meaning	borrowed whole	built from parts
a meal	नाश्ता	दोपहर का खाना
a school	स्कूल	विद्यालय

Hindi keeps both kinds and uses them at different heights. The borrowed word is what people say; the built word is what institutions write. Neither is more correct, and a learner who only has one of them will sound wrong in half the situations they meet.

Note which way round it falls here: the **borrowed** word is the casual one. That is not a rule — it is what happened to these two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the casual word, then the formal one
- the student, and where the student goes, casually (*chātra*, स्कूल)
- what विद्यालय is made of, in two pieces

Before you move on

Which of the two would appear on a gate, and which in a child's sentence? (विद्यालय on the gate, स्कूल in the sentence.) Which other pair in this book splits the same way? (नाश्ता and दोपहर का खाना.)

89.4 शिक्षक स्कूल में हैं — the building, with people in it

A place you can name is not yet a place you can put somebody in. Say where the teacher is, out loud, before reading on.

Read this

Every word here is one you have met:

> शिक्षक स्कूल में हैं। *chātra* भी स्कूल में हैं। विद्यालय बड़ा है।

Three short lines, and the third one changes register on purpose: the sign over the door calls the building विद्यालय, even though the two sentences before it called the same building स्कूल.

Grammar Lens: why the reading paper cares

This matters beyond the vocabulary. An exam reading paper is built out of signs, forms and notices — exactly the places where the **formal** word appears — while the listening paper is built out of people talking, where the **casual** word does.
A candidate who knows only स्कूल can follow the conversation and stall on the sign. A candidate who knows only विद्यालय does the reverse.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "शिक्षक स्कूल में हैं।"
- the same sentence about the student (*chātra*)
- the third line, with the formal word (विद्यालय बड़ा है।)

Before you move on

Which of the two school words would you expect on a sign in a reading paper, and which in a spoken exchange? (विद्यालय on the sign, स्कूल in the exchange.) Say where the student is.

89.5 (नाम, कैसे, फिर) — the opening of the book, eighty chapters later

Ask a stranger their name, respectfully. Then say the word for **again**.

You'll want to know: why this page gives you no cues

The opening chapters built the four moves that open and close a meeting. Every page since leaned on them; none asked you to produce them cold. An examiner will, so this page names a move and waits.

The exchange — four of them, by what each one does

the move	what you produce
open	the greeting, and the answer to a thank-you
trade names	the question, your answer, the pleased-to-meet-you
ask after them	the how-are-you, and a reply
close	one of three farewells, chosen by formality

Cover the right-hand column; the left one is the whole cue.

Grammar Lens: कैसा, कैसी, कैसे — the one that bends

कैसा masculine singular, कैसी feminine, कैसे for a respectful आप or a masculine plural.
That last cell is why आप कैसे हैं? takes कैसे for one person: आप counts as plural whoever it points at, and adjective and verb follow it.

You'll want to know: आपका स्वागत है, and where ख़ुशी belongs

One phrase, two moments: it answers a thank-you (*you're welcome*) and greets an arrival (*welcome*), with no change to the Hindi. आपसे मिलकर ख़ुशी हुई is narrower — the first minute, nowhere else.

Why it's said this way

what you say	how it lands	who it is for
अलविदा	final, weighty	a long parting
फिर मिलेंगे	warm, ordinary	almost anyone
चलता हूँ / चलती हूँ	casual, spoken	people you know

फिर on its own means *again* or *then*, and it turns the middle row into a promise of a further meeting rather than an ending. चलता हूँ announces your own going, so its ending matches whoever speaks.

Your turn

Both sides, out loud, page covered.

Say these aloud:

- the opening — greet, and answer a thank-you
- the name trade, both sides
- the how-are-you to an elder, and a reply
- the close, all three ways
- आपका स्वागत है answering thanks, then opening a door
- कैसा, कैसी, कैसे, and what each is for

Before you move on

Which farewell announces your own going rather than the meeting's end, and which ending does कैसा take after आप? (चलता हूँ; कैसे, since आप counts as plural.)

Chapter 90

Four Adjectives That Always Agree

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe a person as tall, short, thin or stout, and make each adjective agree, because all four end in -aa.
>
> *Say the same sentence about a man and about a woman, and hear that vah and hai never move while the adjective carries the whole gender load.*

90.1 लंबा — tall and long are the same word, and this one bends

> The last chapter gave you four adjectives and **not one of them changed its ending**. Say आसान and remember why it stayed put. This chapter gives you three that do the opposite, and you can hear it coming from the ending.

You'll want to know: लंबा

लंबा (*lambā*) — "tall," and also "long."

Hindi does not split those two. A person is *lambā*, a road is *lambā*, a film is *lambā*. English keeps three words for one measurement and chooses between them by what the thing is doing: **tall** if it stands up, **long** if it lies down, **lengthy** if it is made of time. Hindi measures the distance and stops there.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लंबा is Sanskrit लम्ब (*lamba*), “hanging down, drooping.” The idea began as *what dangles* — and a thing that dangles is measured by how far down it reaches.

CDIAL glosses the Sanskrit word “pendent”, and notes that Sanskrit already used it for “long” in compounds (CDIAL 10951).

Grammar Lens: this one ends in -आ, so it bends

Nothing new here — the shape you already learned, meeting a new word:

shape	**masculine singular**	**feminine**
ends in -आ	लंबा	लंबी
ends in a consonant	आसान	आसान

लंबा ends in -आ, so it behaves like काला: *lambā* for a man, *lambī* for a woman, *lambe* for more than one man.

This is the whole reason the easy-and-difficult lesson and this one belong next to each other. That one gave you four adjectives that never move, and every one of them ended in a consonant. These three all end in -आ, and every one of them moves. Nothing has to be memorised — listen for the last sound.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “लंबा” — *lambā*, tall
- the form you would use about a woman (*lambī*)
- “लंबा दिन” — a long day, the same word doing the other job

Before you move on

How many English words does लंबा cover? (At least three: tall, long, lengthy.) What did the Sanskrit root mean? (Hanging down.) What tells you this adjective will bend? (It ends in -आ.)

90.2 पतला — thin, and a root that fell over

Say लंबा and its feminine form. The next word has the same ending, so you already know what it will do.

You'll want to know: पतला

पतला (*patlā*) — "thin."

It works for a person, for a sheet of paper, and for a soup that has too much water in it. English needs *thin*, *slim*, *slender* and *watery* for that range; Hindi uses one word and lets the noun decide which English word you would have reached for.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पतला goes back to Sanskrit *pattrala*, "leafy", which CDIAL takes to have meant "leaf-like, thin" (CDIAL 7736). It is built on पत्र (*pattra*), "leaf" (first "wing-feather"), from the root पत् (*pat*), "to fly". A thin thing is as flat as a leaf.

The leaf word is still in everyday Hindi:

word	what it is
पत्ता (*pattā*)	a leaf
patjhaṛ	autumn: *pat*, "leaf", with *jhaṛ*, "fall"

Autumn in Hindi is named exactly the way American English names it: **fall**. Two languages that never discussed it reached for the same picture.

Grammar Lens: the second of the three

adjective	masculine	feminine
लंबा	लंबा	लंबी
पतला	पतला	पतली

Same ending, same behaviour, no exception to learn. This is what a rule that actually works looks like: you were told the shape, and every new word that has the shape does the thing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "पतला" — *patlā*, thin
- the feminine form (*patlī*)
- *lambā aur patlā* — tall and thin, both bending the same way
- what Hindi calls autumn, and what it literally means (*patjhaṛ*, the leaf-fall)

Before you move on

What did *pattrala*, behind **पतला**, mean? (Leafy, leaf-like.) What is a thin thing, by that picture? (Something as flat as a leaf.) Which English name for autumn matches the Hindi one? (*Fall.*)

90.3 मोटा — thick, and the word that refuses to be only about people

Say **पतला** and its feminine. The word in this lesson is its opposite, and it ends the same way.

You'll want to know: मोटा

मोटा (*moṭā*) — "thick, stout, heavy."

Set it against **पतला** and the pair covers the whole range at once:

thing	पतला	मोटा
a person	slim	stout
a rope	thin	thick
a book	slim	fat
a voice	reedy	deep

That last row is the one to keep. A **मोटी आवाज़** is a *deep* voice, not a fat one — the metaphor runs from the thickness of the string to the lowness of the note, exactly as it does on any instrument.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मोटा comes from a reconstructed **mōṭṭa*, one of a group of related forms that CDIAL heads **muṭṭa*, "defective" (CDIAL 10187): words for things stumpy, blunt or lumpish. CDIAL glosses the Hindi word "fat", and it means something **thick, with body to it**.

Hindi extends it to mean **rough or approximate**, which follows from the same picture: a मोटा estimate is one drawn with a thick line rather than a thin one, so it has no fine detail. English does this with **broadly**, and the metaphor is identical.

Grammar Lens: all three of them, and the rule holds

adjective	masculine	feminine
लंबा	लंबा	लंबी
पतला	पतला	पतली
मोटा	मोटा	मोटी

Three words, one ending, one behaviour. Against the four from the last chapter — none of which ended in -आ and none of which moved — that is the cleanest demonstration this book can give you that the ending is the rule.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "मोटा" — *moṭā*, thick
- the feminine form (*moṭī*)
- *patlā aur moṭā* — the pair
- what a मोटी आवाज़ is (a deep voice)

Before you move on

What does मोटा mean when it describes a voice? (Deep.) And when it describes an estimate? (Rough, approximate.) Does it bend? (Yes — it ends in -आ.)

90.4 नाटा — the gap that a word you already knew could not fill

You have लंबा for tall. Reach for its opposite using a word you already know, and then go on to find out why that reach does not work.

You’ll want to know: नाटा

नाटा (*nāṭā*) — “short, of a person’s height.”

The obvious guess is *choṭā*, and the obvious guess is wrong — not because it is rude, but because it means something else.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

This is the clearest case in the chapter of a word existing because another word is busy:

word	about a thing	about a person
choṭā	small	**younger**
नाटा	—	**short in height**

Choṭā bhāī is a younger brother regardless of how tall he is. Hindi took the size word for a person’s age and left the height meaning without an owner, and नाटा is what filled the hole.

CDIAL traces it to a reconstructed **naṭṭa*, “defective”, one of its groups of words for things stunted or lacking, and glosses the Hindi word “short, dwarfish” (CDIAL 6935).

A note on using it. नाटा is plain rather than polite, and about a person it can land as blunt. When you want neutral, Hindi says *qad meṅ choṭā*, “short in height” — which spells out the *height* part that *choṭā* on its own leaves ambiguous. Recognise नाटा; reach for the longer phrase.

Grammar Lens: the fourth of four, and the rule has not moved

adjective	masculine	feminine
लंबा	लंबा	लंबी
पतला	पतला	पतली
मोटा	मोटा	मोटी
नाटा	नाटा	नाटी

Four words for the shape of a person, all four ending in -आ, all four bending. You can now answer a question about anyone’s build without once needing to remember which words agree.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “नाटा” — *nāṭā*, short
- the feminine form (*nāṭī*)
- *lambā* and its real opposite, rather than the one you first reached for
- the neutral phrase for short in height (*qad meṅ choṭā*)

Before you move on

Why can *choṭā* not mean *short* about a person? (About a person it means *younger*.) What does CDIAL reconstruct behind नाटा? (**naṭṭa*, “defective”: something stunted.)

90.5 chhah ākār — six shapes, and the two that were only ever about things

Name the four new adjectives with their feminine forms before reading on.

Grammar Lens: which ones a person can be

You had two size words already, and they were taught about objects. The four new ones are the ones a person gets described with:

adjective	**feminine**	**used of a person?**
बड़ा	बड़ी	as *elder*, not as *large*
choṭā	*choṭī*	as *younger*, not as *small*
लंबा	लंबी	yes — tall
नाटा	नाटी	yes — short in height
पतला	पतली	yes — thin
मोटा	मोटी	yes — stout

The first two rows are the ones worth pausing on. बड़ा and *choṭā* applied to a person almost always mean **older** and **younger**, not big and small — *baṛā bhāī* is an elder brother, whatever his height. So the track could size a box long before it could describe a body, which is why these four were needed — and why *nāṭā* had to be a separate word rather than a reuse of *choṭā*.

All six end in **-आ**. All six bend. That is not a coincidence: size and shape words are old inherited vocabulary, and inherited Hindi adjectives are the ones that kept the ending.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all six in the masculine, then all six in the feminine
- which two mean *older* and *younger* when they describe a person
- *lambā aur patlā*, then the same about a woman
- the one that also means *deep*, about a voice (*moṭā*)

Before you move on

What does **बड़ा भाई** mean — a big brother or an elder one? (An elder one.) Which of the six bend? (All of them: every one ends in **-आ**.)

90.6 वह लंबी है — the sentence that makes you choose the ending

Say **लंबा** and **पतला**. In a list they sit still. In a sentence about a real person they will not.

Grammar Lens: the ending is chosen by who you are talking about

about	sentence	the ending
a man	**वह लंबा है**	**-आ**
a woman	**वह लंबी है**	**-ई**

वह does not change. **है** does not change. The adjective carries the whole load, which is the opposite of English, where *he* and *she* do the work and *tall* never moves.

That is worth saying plainly: in English the pronoun tells you the gender and the adjective is inert. In Hindi the pronoun is silent about it and the adjective tells you. A listener who misses the ending has missed the information.

Read this

Read it: the lines below aloud
Every word has been taught:

वह लंबी है। वह पतली है। वह लंबा है। वह मोटा है। वह नाटा है।

Five sentences, two people, and the only thing telling you which is which is the last letter of the adjective.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "वह लंबा है" and then "वह लंबी है", hearing only the ending move
- the same pair with पतला
- the same pair with मोटा
- the same pair with नाटा
- two sentences describing someone you know

Before you move on

In वह लंबी है, which word tells you the person is a woman? (The adjective — वह is the same for both.) What would the masculine sentence be? (वह लंबा है.)

Chapter 91

Character, Not Mood

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 👁 **eyes** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what a person is like rather than how they feel today, using seven disposition adjectives and predicting from the ending alone which of them change for a woman.
>
> *Answer the question what is he or she like, noticing that kaisaa itself bends, so the gender is announced in the question before any adjective arrives.*

91.1 बुरा — bad, and the phrase you will hear it in first

> You have had *acchā* for a long time and have never had its opposite. Say it, then notice that you cannot yet say the other thing.

You'll want to know: बुरा

बुरा (*burā*) — "bad."

It ends in **-आ**, so by now you know without being told: *burā*, *burī*, *bure*. The shape rule you learned about size words works on character words too, because it was never about meaning.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बुरा is the word inside one of the most-heard sentences in everyday Hindi:

बुरा मत मानो — *burā mat māno* — “don’t take it badly.”

Literally: *do not consider it bad.* It is what a speaker adds after saying something blunt, and it is closer to English **“no offence”** than to any apology. You will hear it long before you need to produce it, so recognising it is worth more right now than being able to build it.
A second everyday one: बुरा लगना — *burā lagnā*, “to feel hurt,” literally *to strike one as bad.* Hindi describes being offended as something the remark does, not something you do.
बुरा comes from a reconstructed **bura*, “defective” (CDIAL 9289).

Grammar Lens: a pair that behaves identically

adjective	**masculine**	**feminine**
acchā	*acchā*	*acchī*
बुरा	बुरा	बुरी

Both inherited, both ending in **-आ**, both bending. The pair is the easiest one in the chapter, and the rest of the chapter is where it stops being easy: four of the six words ahead do **not** bend.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “बुरा” — *burā*, bad
- the feminine form (*burī*)
- *acchā aur burā* — the pair
- what *burā mat māno* means (roughly, “no offence”)

Before you move on

What does Hindi’s “no offence” literally say? (Do not consider it bad.) Does बुरा bend? (Yes — it ends in **-आ**.) And **मोटा**, from the last chapter? (Also yes — same ending, same behaviour.)

91.2 होशियार — holding your wits, which is a compliment and a warning at once

Say आसान. It ends in a consonant and never bends. The word in this lesson ends in a consonant too — so predict what it will do before reading on.

You'll want to know: होशियार

होशियार (*hośiyār*) — "clever, sharp, alert."

It ends in र, a consonant, so it does not bend. *Ek hośiyār laṛkā*, *ek hośiyār laṛkī* — the adjective is the same shape for both.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Persian, and built from two pieces:

- होश (*hoś*) — consciousness, one's senses, one's wits
- **-यार** (-*yār*) — holding, keeping

So a *hośiyār* person is one who **keeps hold of their senses**. Not one who knows a great deal — one who is *awake*.

That is why the word does double duty. Called out sharply, **होशियार!** means **"look out!"** — the Indian Railways used it as the standard shouted warning. The same word praises a bright child and stops a man walking into a moving cart, because both are about being alert.

होश on its own is worth keeping. *Hoś meṅ ānā* is "to come to one's senses," and *hoś uṛnā* is literally "for one's wits to fly away" — to be stunned.

Grammar Lens: the first one that does not bend

adjective	masculine	feminine
बुरा	बुरा	बुरी
होशियार	होशियार	होशियार

The difference is not that one is about character and the other about worth. It is the last letter, and nothing else. बुरा is inherited and ends in **-आ**; होशियार is Persian and ends in a consonant.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “होशियार” — *hośiyār*, clever
- the form you would use about a woman (the same one)
- what **होशियार!** shouted on a platform means (*look out*)
- what the two pieces of the word mean (*wits* and *holding*)

Before you move on

What does होश mean on its own? (One’s senses or wits.) Why does होशियार not bend? (It ends in a consonant, not in **-आ**.)

91.3 मेहनती — an ending that makes a person out of a thing

Say होशियार. It ends in a consonant and stays put. This word ends in **-ई**, which is a third shape, and it also stays put — for a different reason.

You’ll want to know: मेहनती

मेहनती (*mehnatī*) — “hard-working, industrious.”

It is built out of a noun you can see inside it: मेहनत (*mehnat*), “hard work, toil,” plus the ending **-ई**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मेहनत is Arabic *miḥna*, which did not start out meaning honest labour. It meant a **trial, an ordeal, a testing** — the thing that puts a person through it. Work became the name for the ordeal, which is a judgement about work that several languages independently agreed on. The **-ई** on the end is one of the most useful endings in Hindi. Attach it to a noun and you get *the person characterised by that thing*:

noun	**the person**
मेहनत — toil	मेहनती — one who toils
शरम — shame	शर्मीला — one who feels it
ज़रूरत — need	ज़रूरी — necessary

It is the same job English does with **-y** in *wealthy*, *greedy*, *speedy* — and, in fact, the very same job Persian does with **-ī** in *Hindī*, "belonging to Hind."

Grammar Lens: the third shape, and why it also stays put

ending	**example**	**changes for a woman?**
-आ	**बुरा**	yes, to **-ई**
consonant	**होशियार**	no
-ई	**मेहनती**	no

The reason the third row does not move is worth seeing rather than memorising: the feminine ending an **-आ** adjective changes *to* is **-ई**. A word that already ends in **-ई** has nowhere to go. It is not an exception — it is the rule arriving at a word that is already there.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "**मेहनती**" — *mehnatī*, hard-working
- the noun hiding inside it (*mehnat*)
- the feminine form (the same one — it already ends in **-ई**)
- *hośiyār aur mehnatī* — clever and hard-working, neither one moving

Before you move on

What did Arabic *miḥna* mean before it meant work? (A trial or ordeal.) Why does an **-ई** adjective not change for a woman? (**-ई** is already the feminine ending; there is nowhere further to go.)

91.4 शर्मीला — the ending that turns a feeling into a character

Say मेहनती. You saw an ending build a person out of a noun. The same thing happens here with a different ending, and this one bends.

You’ll want to know: शर्मीला

शर्मीला (*śarmīlā*) — “shy, bashful.”

Built from a noun and an ending: शरम / शर्म (*śaram*, “shame, modesty”) + **-ईला** → शर्मीला.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The ending **-ईला** is not the same as the **-ई** of *mehnatī*, and the difference is exactly the difference this chapter is about.

-ई says *has this thing*. **-ईला** says *is made of this thing* — it builds a settled quality, a disposition rather than an episode:

noun	**with -ईला**
शरम — shame	शर्मीला — shy by nature
रंग — colour	रंगीला — colourful, flamboyant
नशा — intoxication	नशीला — intoxicating

That is why शर्मीला is the right word for an exam question about character. Someone can *feel* shame at a moment; a *śarmīlā* person is one for whom it is a standing trait. This is settled character, not mood — the distinction the whole chapter turns on.

शर्म itself came into Hindi from Persian *šarm*. It only sounds like English **shame**: the English word is Germanic, and no shared root is established.

Grammar Lens: back to the bending shape

adjective	**masculine**	**feminine**
बुरा	बुरा	बुरी
मेहनती	मेहनती	मेहनती
शर्मीला	शर्मीला	शर्मीली

-ईला ends in **-आ**, so the rule applies as usual and the word bends. The long ending does not protect it: look at the **last letter**, always.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "शर्मीला" — *śarmīlā*, shy
- the feminine form (*śarmīlī*)
- the noun inside it (*śaram*)
- the difference between feeling ashamed once and being *śarmīlā*

Before you move on

What does the ending **-ईला** add that **-ई** does not? (A settled quality rather than merely having the thing.) Does **शर्मीला** bend? (Yes — it ends in **-आ**.)

91.5 मिलनसार — the opposite of shy, built out of a word you have had for ages

Say **शर्मीला**. Now think of the opposite kind of person — the one who is easy with strangers. Hindi builds that word out of something you learned in order to say goodbye.

You'll want to know: मिलनसार

मिलनसार (*milansār*) — "sociable, friendly, easy to get on with."

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Two pieces, and you already have the first:

- **मिलन** (*milan*) — a meeting, from **मिलना**, "to meet" — the verb inside *phir milenge*, the farewell you learned early
- **-सार** (*-sār*) — a Persian ending meaning *inclined toward, full of*

So a *milansār* person is **inclined toward meeting**. Hindi names the trait after the act rather than after the feeling, which is a plainer way

to describe a person than English manages: *sociable* goes back to Latin *socius*, a companion, and is a noun about a relationship; *milansār* is a verb about what someone actually does.
The **-सार** ending is rare enough to be worth flagging as a small set rather than a rule to apply. You will meet **शर्मसार** (*śarmsār*), "ashamed" — built on the same *śaram* as the last lesson.

Grammar Lens: a consonant ending, so it stands still

adjective	masculine	feminine
शर्मीला	शर्मीला	शर्मीली
होशियार	होशियार	होशियार
मिलनसार	मिलनसार	मिलनसार

The pair **शर्मीला** / **मिलनसार** is the sharpest demonstration in the chapter: two opposite traits, and one bends while the other does not. Meaning has nothing to do with it. Only the last letter does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "**मिलनसार**" — *milansār*, sociable
- the verb hiding inside it (*milnā*, to meet)
- the form for a woman (the same one)
- *śarmīlā aur milansār* — and hear that only the first one could move

Before you move on

What verb is inside **मिलनसार**? (*Milnā*, to meet.) Why does it not bend while **शर्मीला** does? (It ends in a consonant; **शर्मीला** ends in **-आ**.)

91.6 गंभीर — deep, which is how three separate languages say serious

You learned that **मोटा** describes a *deep* voice. Hold on to that idea of depth — this lesson takes it somewhere else entirely.

You’ll want to know: गंभीर

गंभीर (*gambhīr*) — “serious, grave, solemn.”

It ends in र, a consonant, so it does not bend.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Sanskrit गम्भीर, and its first meaning was **deep** — of water, of a well, of a voice.

What is striking is how many unrelated languages reached for *depth* or *weight* when they needed a word for gravity of manner:

language	word	first meaning
Hindi	गंभीर	deep
Latin	gravis	heavy
English	profound	deep

A serious person, in all three, is one you cannot see the bottom of.

Hindi still uses the literal sense freely: a *gambhīr* river is a deep one, and a *gambhīr* illness is a grave one.

One useful distinction, and it is the same one English draws. A *gambhīr* person is solemn and weighty. A *gambhīr* situation is dangerous. The word does not decide which; the noun does.

Grammar Lens: all six, sorted by ending

ending	the words	feminine
-आ	बुरा, शर्मीला	बुरी, शर्मीली
consonant	होशियार, मिलनसार, गंभीर	unchanged
-ई	मेहनती	unchanged

Two bend and four do not, and you can sort them without knowing what a single one means.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “गंभीर” — *gambhīr*, serious
- the form for a woman (the same one)
- *gambhīr aur mehnatī* — two words, neither one moving

- what a गंभीर river is (a deep one)

Before you move on

What did गंभीर first mean? (Deep.) Which Latin word for heavy took the same path to “serious”? (*Gravis.*) Does it bend? (No — it ends in a consonant.)

91.7 सात शब्द स्वभाव के — seven words, three endings, and one pair of opposites

Name as many of the seven as you can before reading the table. Aim for five.

Grammar Lens: the ending decides, and the meaning never does

All seven, sorted by what their last letters allow:

word	meaning	feminine
acchā	good	*acchī*
बुरा	bad	बुरी
शर्मीला	shy	शर्मीली
होशियार	clever	होशियार
मिलनसार	sociable	मिलनसार
गंभीर	serious	गंभीर
मेहनती	hard-working	मेहनती

Read the third column against the first. Where the two differ, the word moves for a woman; where they are identical, it does not. Three move and four stay.

Grammar Lens: where each word came from

The split is not random, and seeing why makes the endings predictable:

source	**the words**	**ends in**
inherited from Sanskrit	*acchā*, बुरा, गंभीर	mostly -आ
Persian	होशियार, मिलनसार, शर्मीला	mostly a consonant
Arabic through Persian	मेहनती	-ई

Inherited words are the ones that kept the -आ ending, because they are the ones that went through the whole sound history of the language. Borrowed words arrived later, in whatever shape the lending language had them, and mostly that shape ended in a consonant. गंभीर is the exception that proves it is a tendency rather than a law: it is inherited from Sanskrit and still ends in a consonant. So the origin explains the pattern — the **ending** is what you act on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three that move, in their feminine forms
- the four that stay put
- the one pair of outright opposites (*acchā* and *burā*)
- the two that describe how a person is with strangers (*śarmīlā* and *milansār*)

Before you move on

Which of the seven is inherited and still refuses to bend? (गंभीर.) Why does मेहनती not bend? (It already ends in -ई, which is where a bending adjective would go.)

91.8 वह कैसी है? — the question the seven were assembled to answer

Say होशियार and मेहनती. Two words no reference letter could do without, and the track had neither until now.

Grammar Lens: the question word bends too

कैसा is itself an -आ word, so the question agrees before the answer does:

about	question	a possible answer
a man	वह कैसा है?	वह गंभीर है।
a woman	वह कैसी है?	वह शर्मीली है।

Notice what that means in practice. The gender is announced **in the question**, before any adjective arrives. A listener who catches only *kaisī* already knows a woman is being asked about — and knows that any bending adjective in the answer must end in -ई.

Read this

Read it: the lines below aloud
Every word has been taught:

> — आपकी बहन कैसी है? — वह होशियार है। वह मेहनती भी है। वह शर्मीली है। — आपका भाई कैसा है? — वह मिलनसार है। वह गंभीर भी है।

Five adjectives in that exchange, and only शर्मीली had to change its ending. The other four were decided by their own last letters rather than by who was being described — which is the entire point of the chapter, put into one conversation.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “वह कैसी है?” and answer it with two of the seven
- the same answer about a man, changing only what can change
- “वह मिलनसार है” and then the feminine version, and hear that nothing moved
- *acchā* and *burā*, the one outright pair of opposites among the seven
- one sentence about somebody you know

Before you move on

In **वह कैसी है?**, what has already told you a woman is being asked about? (The question word itself — **कैसी**, not **कैसा**.) Which adjectives in the answer would have to follow suit? (Only the ones ending in **-आ**.)

Chapter 92

Whose, And What A Postposition Does To It

Modes: 🚘 **voice** (7) 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚘 **Hands-free start:** the first 6 of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say whose something is for any owner, use apna when the owner is the subject, and say what I have, using the oblique form a postposition demands.
>
> *Ask what somebody has and answer, noticing that no word in either line means have and that every possessive has bent to -e because a postposition follows it.*

92.1 uskā — one word for his, her and its

> You have had *merā*, *merī*, *mere* since the second chapter. Say all three. You have been able to say whose something is for exactly one person: your own.

You'll want to know: uskā

uskā — "his," "her," or "its."

Hindi does not choose between those three, and the reason is the point of the lesson: **the possessive agrees with the thing owned, not with the owner.**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उसका (*uskā*) is *us*, the form वह, “that”, takes before an ending, with the possessive -*kā*. CDIAL lists *us* under Sanskrit *asau*, “that” (CDIAL 972).

Grammar Lens: English agrees with the owner, Hindi with the thing

This is the single biggest difference between the two systems, and it runs the opposite way from what an English speaker expects:

	what decides the form
English *his* / *her*	the **owner**’s gender
Hindi *uskā* / *uskī*	the **owned thing**’s gender

So *uskā* before a masculine noun and *uskī* before a feminine one — and whether the owner is a man or a woman changes nothing at all. A sentence with *uskī kitāb* tells you the book is feminine and tells you **nothing** about whose it is.

This is not a new rule. It is the **-आ** agreement you already have, doing its ordinary job: *uskā* ends in **-आ**, so it bends like every other **-आ** word in the book.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *uskā* — his, her, or its
- the form before a feminine noun (*uskī*)
- *merā* and *uskā* one after the other, and hear the same ending
- what *uskī* tells you about the owner (nothing)

Before you move on

Does *uskā* mean *his* or *her*? (Either — Hindi does not distinguish.) What decides between *uskā* and *uskī*? (The gender of the thing owned.)

92.2 हमारा — our, and the places Hindi prefers it to “my”

Say *merā* and *uskā*. Both end the same way and bend the same way, so the next word brings no new grammar — only a new owner.

You’ll want to know: हमारा

हमारा (*hamārā*) — “our.”

Built on the pronoun for *we*: हम (*ham*) + a possessive ending → हमारा. The pronoun gets its own lesson soon. Before a feminine noun it is *hamārī*; before a plural or an oblique it is *hamāre*, exactly as *merā* behaves.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हमारा (*hamārā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *asmāka*, “ours” (CDIAL 988). CDIAL notes an added *-r-* element.

Grammar Lens: where Hindi says “our” and English says “my”

The grammar is easy; the usage is the thing worth carrying:

talking about	English habit	Hindi habit
the house you grew up in	my house	**hamārā** ghar
your family	my family	**hamārā** parivār
your country	my country	**hamārā** deś

A Hindi speaker describing their family will very often say *hamārā parivār* where an English speaker says *my family*, because the thing is understood as belonging to the household rather than to the speaker. Neither is wrong in either language — but the preference is real, and a listening paper will play you the Hindi one.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *hamārā* — our
- the form before a feminine noun (*hamārī*)

- the word for *we* that it is built on (*ham*)
- *hamārā parivār*, and notice that an English speaker would have said *my*

Before you move on

What pronoun is *hamārā* built on? (*Ham*, we.) Which of *uskā* and *hamārā* tells you something about the owner? (*Hamārā* — it says the owner is a group including the speaker.)

92.3 तुम्हारा — your, at the middle level of three

Say *hamārā*. You have had *āpkā* for *your* since early on. This lesson gives you the other one, and says when each is right.

You'll want to know: तुम्हारा

तुम्हारा (*tumhārā*) — "your," said to someone you are familiar with. Built on तुम (*tum*), the middle of Hindi's three *you*s.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तुम्हारा (*tumhārā*) is inherited. It comes from *yuṣmāka*, the possessive of the Sanskrit plural "you", with its *t-* taken from *tuvam*, the singular "you" (CDIAL 10511).

Grammar Lens: three levels, and the possessive that goes with each

pronoun	possessive	who
आप *āp*	*āpkā*	a stranger, an elder, anyone respected
तुम *tum*	**tumhārā**	a friend, a sibling, a younger colleague
तू *tū*	*terā*	intimate, or rude — rarely the right choice for a learner

The safe default for a learner is आप, and the reason is asymmetric: using *āp* with a close friend sounds a little formal, while using *tum*

with a stranger or an elder sounds **rude**. One error is a small stiffness; the other is an offence.
But *tumhārā* is not optional to know. A listening paper is full of friends talking to each other, and it is the form they use.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *tumhārā* — your, to a friend
- the form before a feminine noun (*tumhārī*)
- the pronoun it is built on (*tum*)
- which of the two *your*s you would use with somebody's grandmother (*āpkā*)

Before you move on

Which pronoun is *tumhārā* built on? (*Tum*.) Which of the two mistakes costs more — *āp* to a friend, or *tum* to an elder? (*Tum* to an elder; the other is only a little formal.)

92.4 अपना — the word that takes over when the owner is the subject

Say *merā* and *tumhārā*. Now try to say "I do my work" in Hindi using *merā*, and go on to find out why that sentence is wrong.

You'll want to know: अपना

अपना (*apnā*) — "one's own."

When the owner of a thing is **the subject of the same sentence**, Hindi replaces the ordinary possessive with *apnā*. This is a requirement rather than a preference:

wrong	*maiṅ **merā** kām kartā hūṅ*
right	*maiṅ **apnā** kām kartā hūṅ*

Both would be “I do my work.” The first is what an English speaker builds, and a Hindi ear hears it as a mistake straight away.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अपना (*apnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ātmanaka*, “own”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 1135). It is built on *ātman*, “self”, the word behind the respectful *āp*, “you”.

Grammar Lens: one word covering every person

The saving is large, because *apnā* does not care who the subject is:

subject	**English**	**Hindi**
I	my own	**apnā**
you	your own	**apnā**
he or she	their own	**apnā**
we	our own	**apnā**

Four English possessives, one Hindi word. It still agrees with the thing owned in the ordinary way — *apnā kām*, *apnī kitāb*, *apne dost* — because it ends in **-आ** like all the others.

And it removes a real ambiguity. *Vah* ***uskī*** *kitāb paṛhtā hai* means he reads **somebody else’s** book; *vah* ***apnī*** *kitāb paṛhtā hai* means he reads **his own**. English *he reads his book* cannot tell those apart without more words.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *apnā* — one’s own
- *maiṅ apnā kām kartā hūṅ*, and stop yourself from reaching for *merā*
- the difference between *apnī kitāb* and *uskī kitāb*
- the form before a plural or an oblique (*apne*)

Before you move on

When does *apnā* replace the ordinary possessive? (When the owner is the subject of the sentence.) Whose book is *uskī kitāb* when the subject is *he*? (Somebody else's.)

92.5 मेरे पास — Hindi has no word for "have"

Say *merā*, *merī*, *mere*. You have had all three since the second chapter. This lesson shows you that the third one has a second job nobody mentioned.

You'll want to know: मेरे पास

मेरे पास (*mere pās*) — "I have." Literally: **near me**.

पास (*pās*) means "near, at hand." Hindi has no verb meaning *to have*, so possession is built out of location:

> मेरे पास एक किताब है। *mere pās ek kitāb hai* — "Near me there is a book" = **I have a book.**

The thing owned is the **subject** of that sentence, which is why *hai* agrees with *kitāb* and not with the speaker.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

pās, "near", comes from Sanskrit *pārśva*, "side", whose form *pārśve* already meant "near" (CDIAL 8118).

Grammar Lens: mere is not the plural here

This is the part that repays attention. You learned *mere* as the **plural** of *merā*. It is also the **oblique** — the form a word takes in front of a postposition — and the two happen to look identical:

phrase	**why *mere***
mere dost	plural — my friends
mere pās	oblique — *pās* is a postposition

So *mere pās* is not "my nears." It is *merā* bending because something stands after it. Every **-आ** possessive does this: *uskā* → *uske pās*, *hamārā* → *hamāre pās*, *apnā* → *apne pās*.

That single habit — **-आ** becomes **-ए** in front of a postposition — is worth more than the phrase itself, because it governs every postposition in the language.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mere pās ek kitāb hai* — I have a book
- the same about him or her (*uske pās*)
- the same about us (*hamāre pās*)
- the same about the subject's own (*apne pās*)
- what *mere* is doing in *mere pās* — plural, or oblique? (oblique)

Before you move on

What does *mere pās* literally say? (Near me.) What agrees with *hai* in *mere pās ek kitāb hai*? (*Kitāb* — the thing owned is the subject.) What happens to an **-आ** possessive before a postposition? (It becomes **-ए**.)

92.6 मेरे लिए — the same bend, in front of a different postposition

Say *mere pās*. Say why it is *mere* and not *merā*. The word in this lesson works the same way, which is the whole point of putting them together.

You'll want to know: मेरे लिए

मेरे लिए (*mere liye*) — "for me." *mere sāth* — "with me."

Three phrases, one shape. The possessive goes oblique and the postposition follows:

phrase	**meaning**
mere pās	near me — *I have*
mere liye	for me
mere *sāth*	with me

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मेरे लिए (*mere liye*) is *mere*, "my", with *liye*, "for". *liye* is usually explained as a form of *lenā*, "to take", which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *labhate*, "catches, takes" (CDIAL 10948).

Grammar Lens: the pattern generalises to every person

Once the bend is automatic, the whole grid follows without memorising a single new form:

owner	**oblique**	**with *liye***
I	mere	mere liye
he, she	uske	uske liye
we	hamāre	hamāre liye
the subject's own	apne	apne liye

The last row is the one both practice papers reach for. Phrases like *apne dost ke sāth* — "with one's own friend" — put three of this chapter's ideas in four words: the reflexive possessive, the oblique bend, and a two-word postposition.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *mere liye* — for me
- *mere sāth* — with me
- the same two about him or her (*uske liye*, *uske sāth*)
- *apne dost ke sāth*, and name the three things happening in it

Before you move on

Why is it *mere liye* and not *merā liye*? (A postposition follows, so the possessive goes oblique.) What is the oblique of *apnā*? (*Apne.*)

92.7 pā̃ch mālik, ek niyam — five owners, and one bend that covers them all

Name as many possessives as you can before reading the table. Aim for five.

Grammar Lens: the whole grid

Every one of these ends in **-आ**, so every one bends the same way:

owner	**masculine**	**feminine**
my	merā	merī
your (respectful)	āpkā	āpkī
your (familiar)	tumhārā	tumhārī
his, her, its	uskā	uskī
our	hamārā	hamārī
the subject's own	apnā	apnī

Six forms in the first column and not one of them is irregular. The agreement is with the **thing owned** throughout, which is why nothing in the middle column tells you anything about the owner.

Grammar Lens: the bend, and the two jobs of -ए

Put a postposition after any of them and the **-आ** becomes **-ए**:

direct	**before a postposition**
merā	**mere** pās
uskā	**uske** liye
hamārā	**hamāre** ghar meṅ
apnā	**apne** dost ke *sāth*

The form **-ए** therefore has two jobs, and the sentence tells you which:

- *mere dost* — no postposition follows, so this is the **plural**: my friends.
- *mere pās* — a postposition follows, so this is the **oblique**: near me.

Nothing in the spelling distinguishes them. What comes next does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all six possessives in the masculine, then all six in the feminine
- the one that replaces the others when the owner is the subject (*apnā*)
- *mere pās*, *uske pās*, *hamāre pās* in a run
- which job **-ए** is doing in *mere dost*, and which in *mere pās*

Before you move on

What does a possessive agree with — the owner or the thing owned? (The thing owned.) What are the two jobs of the **-ए** ending? (Plural, and oblique before a postposition.)

92.8 आपके पास क्या है? — asking what somebody has, without a verb for having

Say *mere pās ek kitāb hai.* Now turn it into a question addressed to somebody you would call *āp*, and notice that *āpkā* will have to bend.

Grammar Lens: the question bends too

	sentence
question	आपके पास क्या है?
answer	मेरे पास एक किताब है।

Āpkā becomes *āpke* for the same reason *merā* becomes *mere*: **पास** stands after it. The question and the answer are the identical construction with the owner swapped.

There is no verb for *have* anywhere in either line. **है** is the ordinary copula, and it is agreeing with *kitāb*.

Read this

Read it: the lines below aloud
Every word has been taught:

— आपके पास क्या है? — मेरे पास एक किताब है। — तुम्हारे पास क्या है? — मेरे पास एक कलम है। — हमारे घर में क्या है? — हमारे घर में सब है।

Six lines, three different owners, and the same bend in every one of them: *āpke*, *tumhāre*, *hamāre* — every possessive ending in **-ए** because a postposition stands after it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *āpke pās kyā hai?* and answer it about yourself
- the same question to a friend, using the familiar possessive (*tumhāre pās*)
- *apne dost ke sāth*, and say why it is *apne* rather than *apnā*
- one true sentence about something you have

Before you move on

Which word in *mere pās ek kitāb hai* means *have*? (None — the construction is *near me there is*.) Why is it *āpke pās* rather than *āpkā pās*? (*Pās* is a postposition, so the possessive goes oblique.)

Chapter 93

Telling Somebody To Do Something

Modes: 🚘 **voice** (5) 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚘 **Hands-free start:** the first 4 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can give a command at the right level of politeness, say you are at the familiar level, tell somebody not to do something, and read the negative notices a public sign is made of.
>
> *Read a public notice and say the same thing as a friend would say it, noticing that a sign is at the aap level because it addresses a stranger.*

93.1 बोलो — a command at the level you already know how to choose

Say *tumhārā.* You learned that Hindi has three levels of *you* and that the possessive changes with each. Say the verb *bolnā.* This chapter does the same thing to the verb.

You'll want to know: बोलो

बोलो (*bolo*) — "speak," said to somebody you would call तुम.
Take the verb, drop the **-ना**, add **-o**:

bolnā → **bol** → **bolo**

The same operation on any verb: *karnā* → *karo*, *sunnā* → *suno*, *calnā* → *calo.*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बोलो (*bolo*) is the verb **बोलना**, “to speak”, with the command ending *-o*. CDIAL traces the verb to a reconstructed **boll-*, “speak” (CDIAL 9321).

Grammar Lens: the command carries the level, and nothing else has to

This is the part that makes the imperative economical. In English a command is one word for everybody — *speak* — and politeness has to be added around it: *speak*, *please speak*, *would you mind speaking*. In Hindi the **verb ending itself** carries the level:

level	**the form**	**to whom**
तुम	बोलो	a friend, a sibling
आप	boliye	a stranger, an elder
तू	bol	intimate, or rude

You already know how to choose between those three, because you chose between *tumhārā*, *āpkā* and *terā* the same way. The pronoun does not even have to be said: **बोलो** on its own tells the listener which one you meant.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “**बोलो**” — *bolo*, speak
- the two steps that build it from *bolnā*
- *suno* and *karo*, built the same way
- who you would say *bolo* to, and who you would not

Before you move on

How is *bolo* built from *bolnā*? (Drop the **-ना**, add **-o**.) Which of the three *you*s does it belong to? (*Tum*.) Does the pronoun have to be spoken? (No — the ending says it.)

93.2 बोलिए — the ending you have been saying for eighty chapters

> Say *māf kījiye*. You learned it as one lump meaning “sorry.” Say it again and listen to the end of the second word.

You’ll want to know: बोलिए

बोलिए (*boliye*) — “please speak,” said to somebody you would call आप. The ending is **-iye**, on the same stem as before:

bolnā → **bol** → **boliye**

And now the lump comes apart. कीजिए is *karnā*, “to do,” with this same ending: *kar* + *-iye*. *Māf kījiye* is literally **“please do forgiveness.”** You have been giving a respectful command since the ninth chapter without knowing it was one.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बोलिए (*boliye*) is the verb बोलना, “to speak”, with the respectful ending *-iye*. CDIAL traces the verb to a reconstructed **boll-*, “speak” (CDIAL 9321).

Grammar Lens: politeness is built in, not added on

	command	how politeness is carried
English	speak	by adding *please*
Hindi तुम	बोलो	by the ending
Hindi आप	बोलिए	by the ending

बोलिए already contains the respect, so it needs no *kṛpayā*. Adding one is not wrong — it is warmer, the way *would you mind* is warmer than *please* — but the bare form is complete and polite on its own.
A stem ending in a vowel lengthens slightly before **-iye**: *karnā* gives **kījiye**, not *kariye*, and *denā* gives **dījiye**. Those two are the ones you will meet most, and you already had the first.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "बोलिए" — *boliye*, please speak
- *bolo* and *boliye* one after the other, and name who each is for
- what *māf kījiye* literally asks for (please do forgiveness)
- whether *boliye* needs *kṛpayā* in front of it (no)

Before you move on

What ending makes the respectful command? (**-iye**.) What verb is hiding inside *kījiye*? (*Karnā*, to do.) Which of *bolo* and *boliye* would you use with a stranger? (*Boliye*.)

93.3 तुम हो — the copula that was hiding inside one question

Say *tumhārā*. You can name the *tum* level and command at it. Say "you are" at that level, and notice you have never been given the word.

You'll want to know: तुम हो

तुम हो (*tum ho*) — "you are," at the *tum* level.
हो is the copula that goes with तुम, and nothing else takes it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तुम हो (*tum ho*) is two inherited words. *tum* comes from *yuṣmad-*, the Sanskrit plural "you", with its *t-* from the singular *tuvam* (CDIAL 10511). *ho* is a form of *honā*, "to be", from Sanskrit *bhavati*, "becomes, is" (CDIAL 9416).

Grammar Lens: the copula, completed

You have had the others for a long time. Here they are together, which is the first time the set has been complete:

subject	copula
मैं	हूँ
तुम	हो
आप	हैं
वह	है

Four forms and no irregularity beyond having to learn them. हो is the one that was missing, and it was missing in an awkward way: the track has been saying it inside the age question all along, as a lump, without the form ever standing on its own.

Now it can. *Tum acchhe ho*, *tum śarmīle ho* — any of the character adjectives you have, at the familiar level.

Grammar Lens: matching the level all the way through

A sentence has to keep one level from end to end:

level	copula	command
तुम	हो	बोलो
आप	हैं	बोलिए

Mixing them — *āp ho*, or *tum boliye* — is the error a listener notices at once, in the way an English speaker notices *you was*.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the four copula forms with their subjects
- “तुम हो”, and then the same meaning at the *āp* level
- a sentence describing a friend, keeping the *tum* level throughout
- why *āp ho* sounds wrong

Before you move on

Which subject takes हो? (*Tum*, and only *tum*.) What goes wrong in *tum boliye*? (The pronoun is at one level and the verb at another.)

93.4 मत — the word Hindi keeps for saying “don’t”

> Say *bolo* and *boliye*. Now say the opposite of each — and notice that the negative you already know is not the one Hindi uses here.

You’ll want to know: मत

मत (*mat*) — “don’t,” and it goes **in front of the verb**:

> मत बोलिए — *mat boliye* — please don’t speak. मत बोलो — *mat bolo* — don’t speak.

Hindi has a negative for statements, which you already have, and a **separate one reserved for commands**. Using the statement negative to tell somebody not to do something is the mistake an English speaker makes, because English uses *not* for both.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मत (*mat*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mā*, “don’t (forbidding)” (CDIAL 9981). CDIAL notes that *mā* went with commands and wishes, which is the job *mat* still does.

Grammar Lens: the sign you will actually meet it on

A negative command is what a public notice **is**. This is the shape:

notice	**meaning**
यहाँ मत बैठिए	please do not sit here

Three pieces, and you have all three: *yahā̃* here, *mat* don’t, *baiṭhiye* the respectful command from *baiṭhnā*, built with the ending from the last lesson.

Notice the politeness level. A public sign addresses a stranger, so it uses the आप form — which is why a reading paper’s notices are full of **-iye** and why that ending was worth taking apart.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “मत बोलो” and “मत बोलिए”, and name who each is for
- “यहाँ मत बैठिए”, and take it apart into its three pieces
- where *mat* stands relative to the verb (in front)
- why a public sign uses the **-iye** form

Before you move on

Which negative does Hindi keep for commands? (मत.) Where does it stand? (In front of the verb.) Why do public notices use the respectful ending? (A sign addresses a stranger.)

93.5 tīn star, ek kriyā — three levels running through everything

Say the command for “speak” at both levels you can now use, and name who each one is for.

Grammar Lens: the same choice, made four times

The level is not a fact about the verb. It is a fact about **who you are talking to**, and every part of the sentence agrees to it:

level	possessive	copula
तू	तेरा	है
तुम	तुम्हारा	हो
आप	आपका	हैं

level	command	negative command
तू	बोल	मत बोल
तुम	बोलो	मत बोलो
आप	बोलिए	मत बोलिए

Read each row straight across. Choosing a person picks the whole row, and every cell in it follows. That is the saving: one decision, not four. The तू row is there for recognition. A learner should read it and not produce it — it is intimate between close friends and insulting to anyone else, and the risk of getting it wrong is much larger than the benefit of using it.

Grammar Lens: how each command is built

level	from *bolnā*	ending
तू	बोल	the bare stem
तुम	बोलो	**-o**
आप	बोलिए	**-iye**

Three endings, one stem. And as the table above showed, मत is the same word at every level — the negative does not change with politeness, only the verb does.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the *tum* row straight across — possessive, copula, command
- the *āp* row the same way
- *suno* and *suniye*, built from *sunnā* with the two endings
- the negative of each command you have made

Before you move on

What does choosing a level of *you* decide? (A whole row — possessive, copula and command together.) Which row should a learner read but not use? (तू.) Does the negative change with the level? (No — *mat* is the same at all three.)

93.6 यहाँ मत बैठिए — a notice is the whole chapter in three words

Say the negative command word and the respectful ending. A public sign is made of nothing else.

Grammar Lens: why a notice is always at the aap level

A sign does not know who is reading it, so it addresses a stranger — and a stranger takes आप. That single fact explains the shape of almost every notice a reading paper prints:

on the sign	**at the tum level it would be**
यहाँ मत बैठिए	यहाँ मत बैठो

The second is what a friend says to you. The first is what a wall says to everybody, which is why **-iye** is worth more to a reader than **-o**.

Read this

Read it: the three notices aloud
Every word has been taught:

यहाँ मत बैठिए। यहाँ मत बोलिए। कृपया सुनिए।

Three notices, and the pattern is identical in all three: the respectful ending, with *mat* in front when the notice forbids and nothing in front when it asks.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "यहाँ मत बैठिए", and translate it
- the same notice as a friend would say it to you
- a notice telling people not to speak
- why a sign uses *āp* rather than *tum*
- "तुम हो", and say which of the two notices above matches that level

Before you move on

Why is a public notice at the *āp* level? (It addresses a stranger.) What turns an asking notice into a forbidding one? (*Mat*, in front of the verb.)

Chapter 94

The Pronouns, And The Article Hindi Does Not Have

Modes: 🚘 **voice** (6) 👁 **eyes** (2) 🚘 **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can use the whole subject-pronoun set including we and they, choose the right oblique pronoun for the person I am addressing, and stop reaching for a word to translate the.
>
> *Read the station sentence a mock paper prints, notice that no word for the appears in it, and ask the liking question at both levels of address.*

94.1 हम — the word that was already inside hamārā

> Say *hamārā*. You learned it as “our” and were told what it was built on. Say that word on its own — you have been carrying it for a chapter without being given it.

You’ll want to know: हम

हम (*ham*) — “we.”

The possessive chapter said *hamārā* was built on हम, and there the matter rested. Here is the word itself.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हम (*ham*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *asmad*, “we, us (the base of the plural forms)” (CDIAL 986).

Grammar Lens: where Hindi says “we” and English says “I”

हम does a second job that has no English equivalent. In much ordinary speech it stands in for मैं, “I,” when the speaker is being modest or speaking as part of a household:

said	**usually means**
ham jāte haiṅ	we go — or, often, *I go*
hamārā ghar	our house — or *my house*

This is the same instinct that made *hamārā parivār* the natural way to say “my family.” A Hindi speaker places themselves inside a group by default where an English speaker steps out of it.
A listening paper will play you *ham* where you expect *maiṅ*, and nothing marks the difference but context.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “हम” — *ham*, we
- the possessive built on it (*hamārā*)
- *ham* and *maiṅ* one after the other
- why a speaker might choose *ham* when talking about themselves

Before you move on

What possessive is built on हम? (*Hamārā.*) What else can *ham* mean besides “we”? (*I*, said modestly or as part of a household.)

94.2 वे — they, and the respect that looks like a plural

Say वह and हम. You can point at one person and you can include yourself in a group. Say “they,” and notice the gap.

You'll want to know: वे

वे (*ve*) — "they."

It is the plural of वह, and the relationship is visible: the same word with a different vowel.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वे (*ve*) is the plural partner of वह, "that". CDIAL lists *vah* under Sanskrit *asau*, "that" (CDIAL 972), but does not list *ve* itself.

Grammar Lens: the plural that is also a courtesy

The same habit you met with आप appears here. Hindi shows respect by using a **plural** form for one person:

form	**about**
वह	one person, familiar or neutral
वे	several people — **or one person spoken of with respect**

So *ve ā rahe haiṅ* can be "they are coming" or "he is coming," said of someone senior. This is the third time the pattern has appeared: *āp* for a respected listener, the **-iye** command for a respected listener, and now *ve* for a respected third person.

In everyday speech many speakers say वो for both *vah* and *ve*. Recognise it; in writing, use the forms above.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "वे" — *ve*, they
- वह and वे together, and hear that only the vowel moves
- the two things *ve* can mean
- the other place Hindi uses a plural to show respect (*āp*)

Before you move on

What is वे the plural of? (वह.) What else can it mean about one person? (Respect.) What do many speakers say for both in conversation? (*Vo.*)

94.3 हमें / तुम्हें — what mujhe was all along

Say *mujhe ... pasand hai.* You learned it as a frame for saying what you like. Say the first word on its own and ask what it actually is.

You'll want to know: हमें and तुम्हें

हमें (*hamẽ*) — "to us." तुम्हें (*tumhẽ*) — "to you," at the *tum* level.

Mujhe is the same kind of word: मैं in its oblique form, meaning *to me*. The liking frame was never a lump — it was a pronoun in a case, and now the rest of the set arrives with it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हमें / तुम्हें (*hamẽ / tumhẽ*) is *ham*, "we", and *tum*, "you", with an ending -*ẽ*, "to". CDIAL lists *ham* under the Sanskrit plural base *asmad-* (CDIAL 986) and *tum* under *yuṣmad-* (CDIAL 10511).

Grammar Lens: the same bend, a third time

subject	**oblique**	**meaning**
मैं	*mujhe*	to me
हम	हमें	to us
तुम	तुम्हें	to you

The possessive chapter bent **-आ** to **-ए** in front of a postposition. The imperative chapter bent the verb to match the listener. Here the pronoun itself bends, and the ending it takes is the nasal **-ें**.
That is three separate systems doing the same thing, which is the reason Hindi rewards a learner who looks for patterns rather than lists: the language keeps asking the same question — *what stands after this word?* — and answering it the same way.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “हमें” and “तुम्हें”
- *mujhe … pasand hai*, and then the same frame about *us*
- what *mujhe* actually is, now that you can see the set
- the three subjects and their oblique forms in a run

Before you move on

What is *mujhe* the oblique of? (मैं.) What ending do these oblique pronouns take? (The nasal -ें.) How would you say “we like it”? (*Hamẽ … pasand hai.*)

94.4 āpko / use — the paradigm closes

Say *hamẽ* and *tumhẽ*. Two corners of the set are filled. Say the respectful one and the third-person one, and notice you cannot yet.

You’ll want to know: āpko and use

आपको (*āpko*) — “to you,” respectfully. *use* — “to him, to her.”

These two are built differently from the last pair. Instead of the nasal ending they take a postposition, *ko*, meaning *to*:

आप + को → आपको

Use is the worn-down version of the same thing: *us* + *ko*, squeezed together by centuries of use, exactly as *maiṁ* + *ko* became *mujhe*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आपको / उसे (*āpko* / *use*) is *āp*, “you”, with *ko*, “to”, and *us*, “him, her”, with the ending *-e*. *āp* comes from Sanskrit *ātman*, “self” (CDIAL 1135); CDIAL lists *us* under *asau*, “that” (CDIAL 972).

Grammar Lens: the whole set, at last

subject	**oblique**
मैं	*mujhe*
हम	हमें
तुम	तुम्हें
आप	आपको
वह	*use*

Five forms, and only the first and the last look irregular — because they are the two that wore down. The middle three still show their parts.

वे has one too — *unhẽ* — built the same way, which the review lesson adds.

Note that the level you learned to choose in the possessive and imperative chapters is here too: *tumhẽ* to a friend, *āpko* to a stranger. The same decision, for the fourth time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "आपको", and name the two pieces it is built from
- *use*, and say which subject it belongs to
- all five obliques in a run
- which one you would use asking a stranger what they like

Before you move on

What postposition is inside *āpko*? (*ko*, *to*.) Which two of the five wore down until their parts stopped showing? (*Mujhe* and *use*.)

94.5 binā ārṭikal — the word Hindi does not have

Say वह, "that." Now try to say "the book" in Hindi, and go on when you find you have no word for *the*.

You'll want to know: there is no article

Hindi has no article. No word for *the*, and no word for *a*.

This is the largest single structural difference between Hindi and English, and it is worth being told once rather than discovered slowly:

> किताब — *kitāb* — can mean **a book** or **the book**.

The bare noun covers both. Nothing is missing from the sentence; the slot the English article fills does not exist.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

binā comes from Sanskrit *vinā*, "without" (CDIAL 11772); *ārṭikal* is English *article*.

Grammar Lens: what does the work instead

Hindi has three ways to be more specific when it needs to be, and you have all three already:

want to say	**Hindi reaches for**	**example**
a book, one book	एक	ek kitāb
that book, the one there	वह	vah kitāb
plain "book"	nothing at all	kitāb

एक is the numeral *one*, pressed into service when indefiniteness matters — which is why *ek chāy dījiye* is "a tea, please" rather than a fixed café formula. It was a number the whole time.

वह points, and pointing is how Hindi says *the* when *the* really means *that particular one.*

Most of the time neither is needed, and this is the habit to build: **do not reach for a word to translate *the*.** There isn't one, and putting *vah* in every place English puts *the* sounds as odd as saying *that book* in English every time you mean *the book.*

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- *kitāb*, and give both English meanings it covers
- *ek kitāb*, and say what *ek* is doing

- *vah kitāb*, and say when you would choose it
- what you should do when you want to say "the" (nothing)
- *āpko ek kitāb pasand hai*, and notice there is still no article in it

Before you move on

How many articles does Hindi have? (None.) What was *ek* before it marked indefiniteness? (The numeral *one*.) What is the commonest correct translation of English *the*? (Nothing at all.)

94.6 sarvanām kī tālikā — subject and oblique, side by side

Name the five subject pronouns and as many obliques as you can, before reading the table.

Grammar Lens: the table, complete

subject	**oblique**
मैं	*mujhe*
हम	हमें
तुम	तुम्हें
आप	आपको
वह	*use*
वे	*unhẽ*

Two of the obliques visibly carry *ko*, *to*: *āpko* plainly (आप + को → आपको), *use* after wear. Three take the nasal ending. The set is small and none of it is arbitrary once you know that a postposition is hiding in each one.

Grammar Lens: the fourth appearance of one decision

system	**at the tum level**	**at the āp level**
possessive	तुम्हारा	आपका
copula	हो	हैं
command	बोलो	बोलिए
oblique pronoun	तुम्हें	आपको

Four systems, one decision. Choosing how to address someone settles all four at once, which is why the grid has been worth building across three chapters rather than learning four unrelated lists.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the six subject pronouns
- the obliques that take *ko*, and the ones that take the nasal
- the *tum* row across all four systems
- how many articles Hindi has, and what does the work instead

Before you move on

Which postposition shows plainly in *āpko*? (*ko*, *to*.) How many systems does the level decision now settle? (Four.) What translates English *the*? (Nothing.)

94.7 हम स्टेशन पर मिलेंगे — the sentence the paper actually prints

Say हम. Until this chapter the track could not say it, and a reading item that opens with it was unreadable from the first word.

Read this

Read it: the lines below aloud
Every word has been taught:

हम स्टेशन पर मिलेंगे। वे भी आ रहे हैं।

Two sentences. Note what is **not** in the first one: no word for *the* in front of *sṭeśan*, because there is none to put there. An English speaker reads "we will meet at **the** station" and supplies the article themselves.

Grammar Lens: choosing between the obliques in a real question

asking	form
a friend	तुम्हें क्या पसंद है?
a stranger	आपको क्या पसंद है?

The frame is the one the track has had since its liking chapter. What is new is that the pronoun in it can now change — it was never a fixed phrase, and the first word was always a pronoun in a case.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "हम स्टेशन पर मिलेंगे"
- what an English reader adds that the Hindi does not contain
- the liking question to a friend, then to a stranger
- one sentence about what you and somebody else will do, using *ham*

Before you move on

What word for *the* appears before *sṭeśan*? (None — Hindi has no article.) Which oblique would you use asking a stranger? (*Āpko.*)

94.8 (पेट, औरत, सीढ़ी, चादर) — five pockets nobody returned to

Two words from the chapter that furnished a house: the one you climb, and the one you spread on a bed.

You’ll want to know: why these five

Most of this book circles back on itself, so a word meets you five times over and you end up owning it. Five things escaped that. दोपहर का खाना and रात का खाना are the clearest — say both now.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पेट goes back to Prakrit पेट्ट, and there the clean line ends. The mainstream account takes it as **Dravidian**; Turner declines that and offers no Sanskrit source either. So: **unsettled, Dravidian leading** — and the **retroflex ट** is itself the feature most credited to that contact.

Grammar Lens: औरत — three things to hold

what you need	**the answer**
its gender	feminine, though the ending does not say so
its source	Arabic عورة (*^{c}awra*), root **^{c}-w-r**, senses near *a gap*
the sense *woman*	from **Persian**, handed on around 1420
which to say	औरत spoken, महिला public, स्त्री literary

The middle rows belong together: the harsh root sense is the earlier life of a word Persian repurposed, not a claim Arabic makes about women. And मेरी औरत means *my wife*, in a register most avoid.

You’ll want to know: सीढ़ी and चादर

सीढ़ी (*sīṛhī*) is a staircase and also a ladder — you go up both in steps. चादर (*chādar*) is a sheet, from Persian *chādar*, a broad piece of cloth; English took it as *chuddar*.

You’ll want to know: the नाम field, twice over

The A1 form ladder gave you one field under two conditions, and the difference is the point.

condition	**beside the line**	**what it proves**
supported	the bank **A** मीरा · **B** अरुण, visible	you read the label and copy its value
delayed	nothing; the bank is covered	the spelling came from memory

An exam form gives you the second.

Your turn

Cover: everything above

- *Say it:* the two named meals, and what each is built from
- *Say it:* the word for a staircase, and its second sense
- *Say it:* the word for a sheet
- *Say it:* which of औरत, महिला, स्त्री goes on a public sign
- *Say it:* the gender of औरत, and whether its ending told you
- *Say it:* where the trail behind पेट stops
- *Write it:* नाम: अरुण, nothing to copy

Before you move on

Which language gave औरत the sense *woman*, the one it came from or the one it travelled through? (**Persian.**) Which meal is रात का खाना?

Chapter 95

The Past, And Where You Were

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 👁 **eyes** (2) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 5 of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say where I was and what I used to do, put the sentence in the negative, and use the postposition that pins a person to a place.
>
> *Ask where somebody was and answer for yourself, using the exact sentence the first practice paper prints as reading item 14 and moving it one step into the past.*

95.1 पर — the word that follows the place instead of leading it

You can name **घर** and **स्टेशन**. Try to say *at home* — and notice that you have the place and no way to stand in it.

You'll want to know: पर

पर (*par*) — "at," pinning you to one point.
घर पर — at home. **स्टेशन पर** — at the station.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

English sets *at* in front of the place. Hindi sets **पर** behind it:

English	**Hindi**
at home	घर पर
at the station	स्टेशन पर

That ordering is why these words are called **post**positions. Every one of them trails its noun, so once you have the noun you know exactly where the small word goes.

What पर wants is a **point** rather than an interior — a house you are at, a platform you are standing on. A place you are *inside* reaches for a different small word, which arrives later.

पर is usually traced to Sanskrit *upari*, “above, upon”.

Grammar Lens: where the pieces land

sentence	meaning
मैं घर पर हूँ।	I am at home.
वह स्टेशन पर है।	He is at the station.

Person, then place, then the small word, then the verb. The verb goes last and stays last, which is the shape every Hindi sentence you have met so far has had.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “घर पर” — at home
- “मैं घर पर हूँ”
- “वह स्टेशन पर है”
- whether पर goes before or after the place it marks

Before you move on

Where does पर sit, before the place or after it? (After.) Say *at the station.* (स्टेशन पर.)

95.2 था — one word swapped, and the sentence is behind you

Say *I am at home* in Hindi. Now try to say where you were an hour ago, and watch the sentence stop at its last word.

You’ll want to know: था

था (*thā*) — “was,” spoken by or about a male subject.

Every other word in the sentence stays where it is. Take out the present-tense word, put था in its place, and you have moved:

now	**earlier**
मैं घर पर हूँ।	मैं घर पर था।
वह स्टेशन पर है।	वह स्टेशन पर था।

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

था is worn down from Sanskrit स्थित (*sthita*), “standing, situated.” To have been somewhere was, once, to have been standing there.

English arrives at the same picture along a different road. *Station* comes from Latin *stāre*, to stand — and Latin *stāre* and Sanskrit *sthā-* are the same inherited word, separated long before either language was written down. The Hindi for *was* and the English for *station* are distant relatives.

Grammar Lens: two present words, one past word

subject	**now**	**earlier**
मैं	हूँ	था
वह	है	था

In the present, the verb changes to match **who** you are talking about. In the past it stops caring about that. One word covers both rows — which is a small mercy, and a short-lived one, because the next lesson shows what the past listens to instead.

Your turn

- *Look:* at था and name the character carrying its first sound (थ), the one you met in हाथ
- *Say it:* “था” — *thā*, was
- *Say it:* “मैं घर पर था”
- *Say it:* “वह स्टेशन पर था”

- *Say it:* which word in मैं घर पर हूँ you replace, and which words you leave alone

Before you move on

How many words change when you move मैं घर पर हूँ into the past? (One.) What did the Sanskrit ancestor of था mean? (Standing, situated.)

95.3 थी — the ending you have bent a dozen times, arriving somewhere new

था ends in -आ. Before reading on: what has every other word ending in -आ done when a woman was the subject?

You'll want to know: थी

थी (*thī*) — "was," spoken by or about a female subject.

speaker	**earlier**
a man	मैं घर पर था।
a woman	मैं घर पर थी।

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

This is not a new pattern. It is the oldest one you have:

masculine	**feminine**
काला	काली
बोलता	बोलती
था	थी

A word ending in -आ swaps that ending for -ई. You learned it on adjectives, met it again on the habitual verb, and here it is a third time. The past copula behaves like an adjective because, historically, it once was one — a participle meaning *situated*, agreeing with whoever was situated.

था comes from Sanskrit *sthita*, "standing, settled" (CDIAL 13768).

Grammar Lens: what each tense listens to

tense	listens to the person	listens to gender
present	yes (हूँ, है, हैं)	no
past	no	yes (था, थी)

The two tenses divide the work differently, and neither one asks you to track both at once. A woman says थी whether she is talking about herself or about another woman.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “थी” — *thī*, was
- “मैं घर पर थी”
- “वह स्टेशन पर थी”
- the two endings that mark the pair, and one adjective that shows them

Before you move on

Which ending replaces -आ for a female subject? (-ई.) Does the present-tense verb bend for gender the way था does? (No — that is what is new here.)

95.4 थे — the third ending, and the politeness you have already paid for

You have था and थी for one person. Name the pronoun for *we*, and guess which ending a group will want.

You’ll want to know: थे

थे (*the*) — “were.”

subject	earlier
हम	हम घर पर थे।
वे	वे स्टेशन पर थे।
आप	आप कहाँ थे?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

-ए is the plural ending on the same family of words as -आ and -ई, so थे sits beside था and थी without being a new thing to learn.

The row worth pausing on is the last one. आप takes थे even when you are speaking to exactly one person, for the same reason it takes हैं for one person: the polite level in Hindi is built out of plural forms. Asking a single guest आप कहाँ थे*?* is grammatically a question to a crowd, and that is the courtesy.

For a group of women, थे adds a nasal and becomes थीं — worth recognising on a page now, and not worth drilling yet.

था comes from Sanskrit *sthita*, “standing, settled” (CDIAL 13768).

Grammar Lens: the level decision, once more

system	at the तुम level	at the आप level
copula now	हो	हैं
command	बोलो	बोलिए
copula earlier	थे	थे

The past does not split the two levels at all: तुम and आप both take थे. One fewer decision, in the one place you might have expected another.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “थे” — *the*, were
- “हम घर पर थे”
- “वे स्टेशन पर थे”
- the question *where were you?* to one person you address as आप

Before you move on

Which ending does आप take in the past, for one person? (थे.) Why does a single person get a plural word? (The polite level is built out of plurals.)

95.5 नहीं था — saying where you were not

Where does नहीं stand in a present-tense sentence? Put it there in a past-tense one and check yourself against what follows.

You'll want to know: नहीं था

नहीं था (*nahīṃ thā*) — "was not."

नहीं keeps the seat it has always had: directly in front of the verb, at the end of the sentence.

present	**past**
मैं घर पर नहीं हूँ।	मैं घर पर नहीं था।
वह स्टेशन पर नहीं है।	वह स्टेशन पर नहीं थी।

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

English rebuilds the sentence to negate it: *I am at home* becomes *I am **not** at home*, and *I was* becomes *I was not* — but *I go* has to become *I do not go*, with a helper verb appearing out of nowhere.

Hindi asks for none of that. One word, one seat, every tense. Learning the past costs you nothing extra here, because there was nothing extra to learn.

नहीं comes from Sanskrit *nahi*, "surely not" (CDIAL 7035), and था from *sthita*, "standing" (CDIAL 13768).

Grammar Lens: the seat in front of the verb

sentence	**who is speaking**
मैं घर पर नहीं था।	a man
मैं घर पर नहीं थी।	a woman
हम घर पर नहीं थे।	a group

नहीं never changes shape. Everything that bends in these three lines bends after it, not because of it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "मैं घर पर नहीं था"
- the same sentence as a woman would say it
- "हम स्टेशन पर नहीं थे"
- which word in the sentence नहीं stands in front of

Before you move on

Does नहीं take a different shape in the past? (No.) Where does it stand? (Immediately before the verb, which is at the end.)

95.6 बोलता था — what you used to do

Say *I speak Hindi.* Then look at the last word of it and ask what you would put there instead.

You'll want to know: बोलता था

बोलता था (*boltā thā*) — "used to speak."

now	earlier
मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ।	मैं हिंदी बोलता था।

One word replaced, and the habit is one you no longer have.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Two pieces, two jobs:

piece	its job
बोलता	this happens repeatedly
हूँ / था	and it happens **now** / it happened **then**

-ता carries the habit. The word after it carries the time. They were

never welded together, which is why moving the sentence into the past costs a single swap rather than a new conjugation.
English needs a whole phrase for this — *used to* — and Hindi needs one letter's worth of change.
था comes from Sanskrit *sthita*, "standing" (CDIAL 13768).

Grammar Lens: both halves bend

speaker	**earlier**
a man	मैं हिंदी बोलता था।
a woman	मैं हिंदी बोलती थी।

Both words end in -आ for a man and both swap to -ई for a woman. They move together, so you are still tracking one decision rather than two.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "मैं हिंदी बोलता था"
- the same sentence as a woman would say it
- which piece carries the habit and which carries the time
- *I did not use to speak Hindi*, putting नहीं in its usual seat

Before you move on

How many words change between बोलता हूँ and बोलता था? (One.)
What does the -ता ending tell you, in either tense? (That the action is a habit rather than a single event.)

95.7 atīt kī tālikā — the past, on one page

Name all three past endings and say who each one belongs to, before you look at the table.

Grammar Lens: the three endings

subject	earlier
मैं, वह — a man	था
मैं, वह — a woman	थी
हम, वे, आप, तुम	थे

Three words, and their endings are -आ, -ई and -ए — the same three you have been bending adjectives with since the colours.

Grammar Lens: the swap, in every sentence you own

now	earlier
मैं घर पर हूँ।	मैं घर पर था।
वह स्टेशन पर है।	वह स्टेशन पर था।
मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ।	मैं हिंदी बोलता था।

One word out, one word in. The place phrase, the postposition पर and the word order all sit still while the tense moves around them.

Grammar Lens: with नहीं

sentence	meaning
हम घर पर नहीं थे।	We were not at home.
वे स्टेशन पर नहीं थे।	They were not at the station.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three past endings in order
- “मैं घर पर था” and then the same thing as a woman
- “आप कहाँ थे?”
- “मैं हिंदी बोलता था”
- any one of those four with नहीं added in the right seat

Before you move on

Which past word does आप take? (थे.) Which side of the place does पर go? (After it.) Which piece of बोलता था carries the habit? (-ता.)

95.8 आप कहाँ थे? — the paper's own sentence, one step into the past

Read it: the sentence and say what it means before going on

मैं घर पर हूँ।

Grammar Lens: the sentence a paper prints

That line is reading item 14 of the first practice paper, word for word. Until this chapter it had one unreadable piece in it, and the piece was पर.

Now take one step:

the paper's line	one step back
मैं घर पर हूँ।	मैं घर पर था।

Everything that made the first line readable makes the second line readable too.

The exchange

— आप कहाँ थे? — मैं घर पर था।

Three things are doing their job at once here. कहाँ asks for a place. पर attaches the answer to one. थे is the past word आप takes, and था is the one the answer needs, because the answer is about one man speaking for himself.

A woman answering the same question says मैं घर पर थी, and the question itself does not change: the asker does not know yet who will answer.

How to answer — three ways

Answer the question three ways, out loud:

- you were at home
- you were at the station

- you were not at home

Then ask it of somebody you address as आप, and listen for which of था, थी or थे comes back.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “आप कहाँ थे?”
- “मैं घर पर था”
- “मैं स्टेशन पर नहीं था”
- the answer a woman would give to the same question

Before you move on

Which past word does the question to आप use? (थे.) Which one does a man use to answer about himself? (था.) Which word in the answer puts him at a place? (पर.)

Chapter 96

The Future, And The Two Letters It Needed

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 6 of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I will do, what somebody else will do, and arrange to meet at a named hour.
>
> *Read reading item 8 of the first practice paper word for word – main panch baje aunga – and answer the same question as a conversation at the aap level.*

96.1 करूँगा — the third tense, and the one with no helper word

You can say what you do and what you did. Say the stem of *to do*, and hold it — the next tense attaches to it rather than standing beside it.

You'll want to know: करूँगा

करूँगा (*karūṅgā*) — "I will do," said by a man. करूँगी (*karūṅgī*) — the same, said by a woman.

The stem is **कर-**. Everything after it is the tense.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Three pieces, and each one has a job:

piece	what it carries
कर-	the action
-ऊँ-	who is acting — *I*
-गा / -गी	the future itself, agreeing with the speaker

English needs a second word for this: *I **will** do.* Hindi has none. The tense is welded onto the verb, the way the person is welded into *hūṁ* and *hai*.

You have met the **-गा** family once before, in the farewell *milenge*, where the plural **-एंगे** was named as the future ending. That was one cell of a grid. This chapter is the grid.

कर- is from Sanskrit *karoti*, “does” (CDIAL 2814); the **-गा** is usually traced to *gata*, “gone”.

Grammar Lens: the piece that comes from the old subjunctive

-गा is not a random syllable. It comes from Sanskrit **गत** (*gata*), “gone” — the participle of *to go.* A future in Hindi is built out of a word meaning **gone**, which is the same instinct behind English *I am going to do it.*

speaker	form
a man	करूँगा
a woman	करूँगी

Only the last letter moves, and it moves the way every **-आ** / **-ई** pair in this language moves.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “करूँगा” — *karūṅgā*, I will do
- the same as a woman would say it
- the three pieces, and what each one carries
- how many words English needs for this, and how many Hindi needs

Before you move on

Which piece carries the future? (**-गा**, agreeing as **-गी**.) What did its Sanskrit ancestor mean? (*Gone*.) How many separate words does Hindi use to say *will*? (None — it is an ending.)

96.2 आऊँगा — the same ending, and the letter that was waiting for it

Say *I will do*. Now take the stem of *to come* and try to put the same ending on it — and listen for what happens when two vowels meet.

You'll want to know: आऊँगा

आऊँगा (*āūṅgā*) — "I will come," said by a man. आऊँगी (*āūṅgī*) — the same, said by a woman.

Nothing new has been added. The stem **आ-** has taken the ending you learned one lesson ago.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

stem	**first person, future**
कर-	करूँगा
आ-	आऊँगा

The ending is identical. What changes is how it has to be **written**, and that is worth a moment.

कर- ends in a consonant, so the long *ū* rides underneath it as the small mark you have used for a long time. **आ-** ends in a vowel, so there is nothing to ride on — and the *ū* has to be written as a **full letter of its own**.

The stem **आ-** is listed by CDIAL under Sanskrit *āpayati*, "causes to reach" (CDIAL 1200).

Grammar Lens: the letter arrives where it was promised

Find: ऊ inside the word

आ ऊँ गा

That is the letter you were told was coming — the one with the extra loop on the right — and this is the word it was waiting for. A vowel that opens a syllable needs the full letter, and the first-person future of every vowel-stem verb puts one there.
The same thing happens to *to go*:

verb	**I will**
आना	आऊँगा
जाना	जाऊँगा

Both of these appear on a practice paper, in the first scored part.

Your turn

- *Say it:* “आऊँगा” — *āūṅgā*, I will come
- *Say it:* the same as a woman would say it
- *Look:* at आऊँगा and put your finger on the letter ऊ
- *Say it:* why this word needs the full letter where *karūṅgā* needs only a mark

Before you move on

What decides whether the long *ū* is a mark or a full letter? (Whether the stem ends in a consonant or a vowel.) Say *I will go*. (*Jāūṅgā* — जाऊँगा.)

96.3 आएगा — the ending that tells you who, not when

You can say *I will come*. Think of somebody else and try to say it about them — and notice which part of the word has to move.

You’ll want to know: आएगा

आएगा (*āegā*) — “he will come.” आएगी (*āegī*) — “she will come.”
वह आएगा। — He will come. वह आएगी। — She will come.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Set the two first persons beside the third:

who	ending
मैं	-ऊँगा
वह	-एगा

The **-गा** has not moved. It is the piece in front of it that changed, from **-ऊँ-** to **-ए-**, and that piece is the one carrying the person.

So the future has the same division of labour the present had: **one slot for who, one slot for when.** Learning the tense is learning that the two slots are separate.

The **-गा** is usually traced to Sanskrit *gata*, "gone".

Grammar Lens: the form a paper prints

This is the commonest future in reading material, because most sentences on a page are about somebody other than the reader:

sentence	meaning
वह आएगा।	He will come.
वह जाएगी।	She will go.

A bus, a train or a shop takes the same ending as a person, and the gender of the **noun** decides which one. A practice paper prints *the bus will come* with **-एगी**, because **बस** is feminine.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "वह आएगा" — he will come
- "वह आएगी" — she will come
- which slot changed between *āūṅgā* and *āegā*, and which stayed
- "वह जाएगी"

Before you move on

Which piece of the future word says *who*? (The one before **-गा**.) Which piece says *when*? (**-गा** itself.) What ending does a feminine noun take? (-एगी.)

96.4 आएँगे — the ending you have been saying since the first goodbye

Say the farewell that means *see you again.* The last two syllables of it are about to become a rule.

You'll want to know: आएँगे

आएँगे (*āeṅge*) — "we will come," "they will come," and "you will come" to somebody you address as आप.

हम आएँगे। — We will come. आप कब आएँगे? — When will you come?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

You met this ending in your fourth chapter, inside मिलेंगे — *we will meet.* It was named there as the plural future, and it was true, but it was one word. Now it is a slot you can fill:

stem	plural future
मिल-	मिलेंगे
आ-	आएँगे
कर-	करेंगे

The farewell was never a lump. It was this ending, on a verb meaning *to meet.*

The -गे is usually traced to Sanskrit *gata*, "gone".

Grammar Lens: आप takes the plural, again

subject	future
हम	आएँगे
वे	आएँगे
आप	आएँगे

आप takes the plural ending even for one person, for the reason it has taken a plural everywhere else: the polite level in this language is built out of plural forms. That is now the fifth system in which one decision about how you address somebody settles the whole row.

For a group of women, the ending nasalises differently and becomes आएँगी — worth recognising, because a practice paper asks आप कब आएँगी*?* of a woman.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "हम आएँगे" — we will come
- "आप कब आएँगे?" — when will you come?
- the farewell, and then name the ending inside it
- "हम करेंगे"

Before you move on

Which ending does आप take in the future? (The plural one.) Which familiar farewell is built from it? (*Milenge.*) What was that farewell really made of? (A stem plus this ending.)

96.5 आओगे — the तुम row, and a vowel that has shown up before

Say the command you would give a friend using तुम. Hold on to the vowel at its end — the future is about to reuse it.

You'll want to know: आओगे

आओगे (*āoge*) — "you will come," to somebody you address as तुम. करोगे (*karoge*) — "you will do," at the same level.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The तुम level has a vowel of its own, and you have already used it:

where	**form**
the command	बोलो
the future	आओगे

Both are **-ओ**. That is not two facts to learn — it is one vowel that belongs to **तुम** wherever it appears, and you have had it since the commands chapter.
The **-गे** is usually traced to Sanskrit *gata*, “gone”.

Grammar Lens: where the full letter shows up again

The same writing question as the first person, and the same answer:

stem	**you will**
कर-	करोगे
आ-	आओगे

करोगे carries the *o* as a mark on the consonant. **आओगे** cannot, because **आ-** is a vowel, so the *o* is written as the full letter **ओ** — the one built on **आ** with an arc above it.
Two vowel-stem words in one chapter, two full letters, and the same rule producing both.

Your turn

- *Say it:* “**तुम आओगे**” — you will come
- *Say it:* “**तुम करोगे**”
- *Look:* at **आओगे** and put your finger on the letter **ओ**
- *Say it:* the same question at the **आप** level instead

Before you move on

Which vowel belongs to the **तुम** level? (**-ओ**.) Where else have you used it? (On the command.) Why does *āoge* need the full letter and *karoge* does not? (The stem ends in a vowel, so nothing can carry the mark.)

96.6 पाँच बजे — reading the hour, and arranging to meet at it

You can say what the clock is doing — the verb that strikes. Now try to say *at five*, and notice that telling the time and fixing a time are not the same job.

You'll want to know: पाँच बजे

पाँच बजे (*pā̃c baje*) — "at five o'clock."
मैं पाँच बजे आऊँगा। — I will come at five.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बजे comes from the verb you already have — the one meaning *to strike, to toll*, because clocks and towns once marked the hour by striking a bell.

What is new is the **shape** of it. You learned it as something the clock is doing right now. This form is not doing anything: it sits beside a number and turns it into a **time to meet at**.

what it does	**the form**
tells you the hour	the striking form you know
fixes a time to act	बजे

There is no separate word for *at*. The number plus बजे is the whole of it.

The verb comes from Sanskrit *vādyate*, "is made to sound" (CDIAL 11513).

Grammar Lens: where it stands in the sentence

sentence	**meaning**
मैं पाँच बजे आऊँगा।	I will come at five.
वह चार बजे आएगी।	She will come at four.

The time phrase goes **after the person and before the verb**, in the same seat the place phrase took. Hindi keeps the verb at the end and fills the middle with whatever the sentence needs.

Both practice papers ask for exactly this pairing — a number, बजे, and a future verb — in the first scored part.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "पाँच बजे" — at five

- “मैं पाँच बजे आऊँगा”
- the same sentence as a woman would say it
- which word Hindi uses for *at*, and hear that there is none

Before you move on

Which verb is **बजे** from? (The one meaning *to strike.*) How does Hindi say *at* in front of a clock time? (It does not — the number plus **बजे** carries it.) Where does the time phrase stand? (After the person, before the verb.)

96.7 bhaviṣya kī tālikā — the future, on one page

Name the ending for *I* and the ending for *he*, and say which piece of each one is the tense, before you look at the table.

Grammar Lens: the grid

subject	**with आ-**
मैं	आऊँगा / आऊँगी
तुम	आओगे
वह	आएगा / आएगी
हम, वे, आप	आएँगे / आएँगी

Four rows, one verb, and **-गा** in every single cell. What moves is the vowel in front of it, and that vowel is the person.

Grammar Lens: two slots, three tenses

tense	**how it is built**
now	stem + -ता + हूँ / है
earlier	stem + -ता + था
later	stem + person vowel + -गा

The first two share a shape: the habit is in **-ता** and the time is in the word after it. The future is the odd one out — it has **no separate word at all**, and packs the person and the tense into one ending.

Grammar Lens: where the full letters appear

stem ends in	how the vowel is written
a consonant (कर-)	a mark on the letter
a vowel (आ-, जा-)	a full letter — ऊ or ओ

That is the whole reason two new letters were needed before this chapter could be written.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all four rows of the grid, top to bottom
- the same grid with **कर-** instead of **आ-**
- “मैं पाँच बजे आऊँगा”
- which two forms need a full letter, and why

Before you move on

Which piece is in every cell of the grid? (**-गा**.) Which tense uses no separate word for time? (The future.) How does Hindi say *at five*? (*Pā̃c baje* — no word for *at*.)

96.8 मैं पाँच बजे आऊँगा — the item the paper prints

Read it: the sentence out loud before going on

मैं पाँच बजे आऊँगा।

Grammar Lens: four words, four things you were taught

That line is reading item 8 of the first practice paper, word for word. Until this chapter two of its four words were unreadable.

word	what it does
मैं	who
पाँच बजे	when
आऊँगा	the verb, carrying the tense

The answer the paper wants is *I will come at five*, and the two wrong answers offered are past and present. **The only thing telling them apart is the ending on the last word.**

The exchange

The second paper asks the same thing as a conversation:

> — आप कब आएँगे? — चार बजे।

आएँगे because the question is to somebody addressed as आप. The answer needs no verb at all: a number and बजे is a complete reply, the way *at four* is in English.

How to answer

Say each of these out loud:

- you will come at five
- you will go by train, not by bus
- she will come in ten minutes

The second and third are items 13 and 11 of the same papers. All three are the same shape: a person, a circumstance, and a verb whose ending does the work.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "मैं पाँच बजे आऊँगा"
- the same sentence as a woman would say it
- "आप कब आएँगे?" and answer it with two words
- "वह आएगी"

Before you move on

Which single word in the paper’s line tells you it is the future? (आऊँगा — its ending.) How many words does a full answer to *when* need? (Two — the number and बजे.) Which ending does a question to आप take? (The plural, आएँगे.)

Chapter 97

What Is Going On Right Now

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (6) 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 5 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say what I am doing at this moment, ask somebody else what they are doing, and keep that apart from what I do in general.
>
> *Ask what somebody is doing at the aap level and answer for yourself, then say the same thing as a habit rather than as a moment.*

97.1 कर रहा हूँ — one word slid into the middle

> Say *I do* — the habit. Now try to say what you are doing **at this moment**, and notice the habit form does not quite mean it.

You'll want to know: कर रहा हूँ

कर रहा हूँ (*kar rahā hū̃*) — "I am doing," right now, said by a man.

Three words: the bare stem, then रहा, then the copula you have had since your third chapter.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

piece	what it carries
कर	the action, bare
रहा	that it is in progress
हूँ	who, and that it is now

रहा is the past participle of रहना, “to stay, to remain.” So the sentence says, almost literally, *doing — having stayed — I am.* The action is pictured as one you are **still inside**.

English does the same thing from a different angle: *I am doing* uses a participle too, and *I remain at work* is the same metaphor spelled out. रहना comes from a reconstructed **rahati*, “remains” (CDIAL 10666).

Grammar Lens: the stem is bare, and that is the point

Look at what happens to the verb in each tense:

what you say	**the verb**
I do (habit)	करता
I am doing (now)	कर

The habit puts an ending on the stem. The continuous **takes the ending off** and puts a separate word after it instead. Nothing else in the sentence moves.

That means the pattern works on **any** verb you know. Take the stem, add रहा, keep the copula: बोल रहा हूँ, जा रहा हूँ, खा रहा हूँ.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “कर रहा हूँ” — I am doing
- “बोल रहा हूँ”
- the three pieces, and what each one carries
- what रहना means on its own

Before you move on

Which word carries *in progress*? (रहा.) What shape is the verb stem in? (Bare — the habit ending comes off.) What does रहना mean by itself? (To stay, to remain.)

97.2 कर रही हूँ — which of the three words listens

रहा ends in -आ. Before reading on, guess what it does when a woman is speaking, and guess which of the other two words joins in.

You'll want to know: कर रही हूँ

कर रही हूँ (*kar rahī hū̃*) — "I am doing," said by a woman.

One letter has changed, and it is in the middle word.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

speaker	**the three words**
a man	कर रहा हूँ
a woman	कर रही हूँ

The stem stays bare either way. The copula हूँ is about *who is speaking* rather than about gender, so it does not move. Only रहा bends, and it bends the way every -आ word you have met bends.

That is the tidiest arrangement you have seen yet: **one word per job, and only the one that describes the action listens to gender.**

रही is a form of रहना, from a reconstructed **rahati*, "remains" (CDIAL 10666).

Grammar Lens: the same ending, a fourth time

masculine	**feminine**
काला	काली
बोलता	बोलती
था	थी
रहा	रही

Four places, one alternation. Every time a Hindi word ends in -आ and describes somebody, -ई is what it becomes for a woman — and by now you should expect it before you are told.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "कर रही हूँ" — I am doing
- both forms one after the other, and hear the one letter
- "बोल रही हूँ"

- which of the three words does not care about gender, and why

Before you move on

Which of the three words bends? (The middle one, रहा / रही.) Why does the copula stay put? (It is about who, not about gender.) What is the fourth pair on the list? (रहा / रही.)

97.3 कर रहा है — two words doing two different jobs

Say *I am doing.* Now think of somebody else and change only what has to change.

You'll want to know: कर रहा है

वह कर रहा है। — He is doing (it). वह कर रही है। — She is doing (it).

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Only the **last** word moved when the subject changed from *I* to *he*:

subject	middle	last
मैं	रहा / रही	हूँ
वह	रहा / रही	है

Two independent dials. The middle word answers *what is the subject like* and the last word answers *which person is it.* Turning one does nothing to the other, which is why you can build any combination without a table to memorise.

रहा is a form of रहना, from a reconstructed **rahati*, "remains" (CDIAL 10666).

Grammar Lens: it works on things as well as people

sentence	meaning
वह जा रहा है।	He is going.
वह आ रही है।	She is coming.

A noun that is not a person still has a gender, and the middle word follows the noun rather than any person. That is how the weather sentence you learned long ago was put together — the rain is feminine, so the middle word ended in **-ई** — and the review lesson takes it apart.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “वह कर रहा है”
- the same about a woman
- which word changed when you moved from *I* to *he*
- “वह जा रहा है”

Before you move on

Which word answers *which person*? (The last one.) Which answers *what is the subject like*? (The middle one.) Do the two ever interfere? (No — they are separate dials.)

97.4 कर रहे हैं — both dials turned to plural

You have two dials: the middle word and the last. Say the pronoun for *we*, and guess what a group does to each dial.

You’ll want to know: कर रहे हैं

हम कर रहे हैं। — We are doing (it). **आप क्या कर रहे हैं?** — What are you doing?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

This time **both** words move:

subject	**middle**	**last**
मैं	रहा	हूँ
वह	रहा	है
हम, वे, आप	रहे	हैं

रहे is the plural of the same **-आ** / **-ई** / **-ए** set. हैं is the plural copula. Nothing here is new — it is the two dials you already have, both turned one notch.

At the तुम level the last word is हो: तुम क्या कर रहे हो*?*
रहे is a form of रहना, from a reconstructed **rahati*, “remains” (CDIAL 10666).

Grammar Lens: the question a listening paper asks

level	the question
आप	आप क्या कर रहे हैं?
तुम	तुम क्या कर रहे हो?

What are you doing? is one of the commonest openings in spoken Hindi, and the whole difference between the two rows is the last word. That is the level decision again, settling one more system.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “हम कर रहे हैं”
- “आप क्या कर रहे हैं?”
- the same question at the *tum* level
- which two words moved, and which stayed bare

Before you move on

What is the plural of रहा? (रहे.) Which word separates the *āp* question from the *tum* one? (The last — हैं against हो.) What shape is the stem in, still? (Bare.)

97.5 do vartamān — the habit and the moment

Say both forms of *to do* that you now have — the habit and the one in progress — and try to say in English what separates them.

You'll want to know: the pair

Hindi	English
मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ।	I speak Hindi.
मैं हिंदी बोल रहा हूँ।	I am speaking Hindi.

The first is a **fact about you**. The second is a **report about this minute**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

This distinction is worth pausing on, because English speakers have it and most European learners of Hindi do not. French, German and Spanish all translate both of those lines with a single present tense; Hindi and English each keep two.

So the good news is that **your instinct is already right**. Where English says *I am doing*, Hindi says कर रहा हूँ. Where English says *I do*, Hindi says करता हूँ. Translate the shape, not the words.

One caution. Hindi leans on the habit form in a place English does not: for something happening in the near future that is already arranged, Hindi is happy with the habitual, where English reaches for *I am*.

वर्तमान is Sanskrit *vartamāna*, "existing, present", a tatsama.

Grammar Lens: which word in the sentence tells you

form	the shape of the verb
habit	stem + -ता, then the copula
in progress	bare stem, then रहा, then the copula

The copula is in both, so it tells you nothing. What decides it is whether the stem carries -ता or stands bare with रहा behind it.

अभी — the word for *right now* — sits comfortably with the second and strangely with the first, which is the quickest way to hear the difference.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ" — the fact
- "मैं हिंदी बोल रहा हूँ" — the minute

- which one you would use to answer *what are you doing?*
- the one that takes अभी without sounding odd

Before you move on

Which form states a fact about you? (The habit, with -ता.) Which reports this minute? (The one with रहा.) Does the copula help you tell them apart? (No — it is in both.)

97.6 abhī kī tālikā — two dials, and two sentences you already knew

Name the three pieces of a continuous sentence, and say which two of them move, before you look at the table.

Grammar Lens: the grid

subject	middle and last
मैं (m)	रहा हूँ
मैं (f)	रही हूँ
वह (m)	रहा है
वह (f)	रही है
हम, वे, आप	रहे हैं
तुम	रहे हो

The stem in front of all of them is **bare**, every time. Six rows and not one of them touches the verb.

Grammar Lens: two sentences that were built this way all along

You have been saying this pattern for a long time without being given it:

sentence	what it is
एक बज रहा है	*baj-* bare, रहा, है
बारिश हो रही है	*ho-* bare, रही, है

Neither was a lump. The clock one is masculine and the rain one is feminine, which is the only difference between them, and it is the middle word that shows it — exactly as the grid above says it should.

Grammar Lens: against the habit

form	**the verb**
habit	बोलता हूँ
in progress	बोल रहा हूँ
earlier habit	बोलता था

Three tenses off one stem, and the only thing you have to look at is what sits immediately after it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all six rows of the grid
- the clock sentence, and name its three pieces
- the rain sentence, and say why its middle word ends in **-ई**
- the habit and the continuous of *to speak*, one after the other

Before you move on

What shape is the stem in, in every row? (Bare.) Why does the rain sentence use रही? (*Bārish* is feminine.) What separates the habit from the continuous? (What sits after the stem.)

97.7 आप क्या कर रहे हैं? — the question, and four ways to answer it

You have क्या for *what*. Put it in front of the plural continuous and you have the question this lesson is about.

The exchange

— आप क्या कर रहे हैं? — मैं हिंदी बोल रहा हूँ।

Three things are at work. क्या asks. रहे हैं is the plural because the question is to somebody addressed as आप. The answer drops back to रहा

हूँ, because the answer is about one man speaking for himself — a woman answers बोल रही हूँ, and the question does not change, because the asker does not know yet who will answer.

How to answer

Answer it four ways, out loud:

- you are speaking Hindi
- you are going home
- you are eating
- and then say what you do **in general**, rather than now

The fourth one is the trap and the test. *What are you doing?* takes the continuous; *what do you do?* takes the habit, and the two questions sound nearly the same in English.

Grammar Lens: what a listening paper does with this

what you hear	**what it tells you**
...रहा है	one man, right now
...रही है	one woman, right now
...रहे हैं	more than one, or आप

The middle word is doing almost all the work, and it sits at the end of the sentence where a listener hears it last. Train the ear on those three shapes and a personal-account listening item becomes three decisions instead of one guess.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “आप क्या कर रहे हैं?”
- “मैं हिंदी बोल रहा हूँ”
- the answer a woman would give
- the same sentence as a habit rather than as a moment

Before you move on

Why is the question रहे हैं and the answer रहा हूँ? (The question is to आप; the answer is about one person.) Which word carries the gender? (The middle one.) Which form answers *what do you do?* (The habit.)

Chapter 98

A Day, In The Order It Happens

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 6 of 8 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can describe my daily routine in order – what time I get up, how I travel, where I go, and what happens before and after.
>
> *Read a four-sentence daily routine in which every word is taught, then say your own, and say it again as the other gender changing nothing but the endings.*

98.1 से — where you came from, and what you came by

You have पर for being *at* a place. Try to say you came *from* one, and notice you have the place and no way to leave it.

You'll want to know: से

से (*se*) — "from," and also "by."
घर से — from home. हाथ से — by hand.
Like पर, it trails its noun.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

English splits this into two words and Hindi does not:

English	Hindi
from home	घर से
by hand	हाथ से

Both are the same idea seen from two angles. **Where something starts** and **what it travels through** are, to Hindi, one relation: the thing *proceeds from* the noun. A journey proceeds from your house; an action proceeds from your hand.

Once you see that, the second use stops being a second word to learn. A vehicle you travel in takes से for exactly the same reason your hand does.

CDIAL traces से to Sanskrit *sahita*, “together with” (CDIAL 13310), and lists it under *sama*, “equal”, too (CDIAL 13173).

Grammar Lens: two postpositions, one habit

postposition	what it marks
पर	at a point
से	from it, or by way of it

Both trail the noun, both are one syllable, and neither has an English word sitting in the same place. That is the whole class: **the small word comes second**, and knowing the noun tells you where to put it.

A question you will be asked in a speaking interview turns on this word: आप कहाँ से हैं*?* — where are you from?

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “घर से” — from home
- “हाथ से” — by hand
- “आप कहाँ से हैं?”
- what the two uses have in common

Before you move on

Which side of the noun does से sit on? (After it.) What single idea covers *from* and *by*? (The thing proceeds from the noun.) Which question in a speaking interview needs it? (आप कहाँ से हैं?)

98.2 बस से — the same three letters, twice over

You already read बस as a reply meaning *enough, that's all.* Now meet it in बस से and notice it cannot possibly mean that here.

You'll want to know: बस से

बस — the vehicle. बस से — by bus.
मैं बस से स्कूल जाता हूँ। — I go to school by bus.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

These are **two different words** that happen to be spelled alike:

word	**where it comes from**	**what it means**
बस	Persian *bas*	enough, that's all
बस	English *bus*	the vehicle

The first has been in the language for centuries. The second arrived with the vehicle, and English had shortened it from *omnibus* — Latin for **"for everybody"** — which is a fair description of a bus and a strange thing to find inside three Devanagari letters.

Nothing marks them apart on the page. **The sentence does the work**: a reply on its own is the old word, and a noun with a postposition behind it is the vehicle.

Grammar Lens: reading the one from the other

what you see	**which word**
बस।	enough
बस से	by bus

The moment से follows it, it is a thing you can travel in. That is the sort of decision a reading paper tests without ever saying so, and you now make it from the shape of the sentence rather than from the word.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “बस से” — by bus
- “मैं बस से स्कूल जाता हूँ”
- the other word spelled the same, and what it means
- what tells the two apart in a sentence

Before you move on

What did English shorten *bus* from? (*Omnibus*, Latin for *for everybody*.) How do you know which बस you are reading? (From what stands around it — a postposition behind it means the vehicle.)

98.3 उठना — where a day starts

> You can say सुबह and you can build a habit with **-ता**. Try to say what you do first every morning, and find the verb missing.

You’ll want to know: उठना

उठना (*uṭhnā*) — to get up, to rise.

मैं सुबह उठता हूँ। — I get up in the morning. मैं सुबह सात बजे उठती हूँ। — I get up at seven in the morning.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The stem is **उठ-**, and it opens with a vowel where no consonant can carry the mark — so the word begins with the **full letter** उ, which is why this is the first word in the track to start that way.

The verb is broader than English *get up*. It covers a person leaving a bed, a person standing from a chair, smoke rising, and a price going up. What all of those share is **movement away from the ground**, and Hindi treats that as one action.

Its opposite, बैठना, is *to sit* — the same idea in the other direction. उठना comes from a reconstructed **ut-sthāti*, "stands up" (CDIAL 1900).

Grammar Lens: it takes the endings you already have

what you mean	**the form**
I get up (habit)	उठता हूँ
I am getting up	उठ रहा हूँ
I used to get up	उठता था
I will get up	उठूँगा

Four tenses on one new stem, and you had all four endings before you had the verb. That is what a stem costs you now: **one word, and the whole grid comes with it.**

Your turn

- *Say it:* "मैं सुबह उठता हूँ"
- *Say it:* the same as a woman would say it
- *Say it:* "मैं सुबह सात बजे उठती हूँ"
- *Look:* at उठना and name the letter it opens with

Before you move on

What do a person, smoke and a price have in common in this verb? (They all move away from the ground.) Why does the word open with a full letter? (There is no consonant to carry the mark.) What is its opposite? (बैठना, to sit.)

98.4 काम — the noun that was there all along

You learned काम करना long ago as one expression meaning *to work*. Say it, and then ask yourself what the first half of it means on its own.

You’ll want to know: काम

काम (*kām*) — work, a job, a task.
काम पर — at work. मैं काम पर जाता हूँ। — I go to work.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

काम करना was never one word. It is काम plus करना — literally *to do work* — and Hindi builds an enormous number of verbs this way: a noun, plus the verb *to do*.

the pattern	what it makes
काम + करना	to work
a noun + करना	to do that noun

Knowing this turns a memorised phrase into a **machine**. Any noun you meet can be handed to करना, and the result is usually the verb a learner would otherwise look up separately.

The word comes from Sanskrit कर्म (*karma*), “act, deed” — the same word English borrowed whole. A *karma* is a thing done, and a काम is a thing to do.

Grammar Lens: which postposition a workplace takes

sentence	meaning
मैं काम पर जाता हूँ।	I go to work.
मैं बस से काम पर जाता हूँ।	I go to work by bus.

पर for the place you end up at, से for what carries you there. Both of them trail their nouns, and the verb stays at the end however many of them you stack in front of it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “काम” — work
- “मैं काम पर जाता हूँ”
- “मैं बस से काम पर जाता हूँ”
- what *karma* means, and how it is the same word

Before you move on

What is *kaam karnaa* made of? (The noun काम plus करना.) Which postposition marks the workplace? (पर.) Which English word is the same Sanskrit root? (*Karma.*)

98.5 पहले — putting one thing in front of another

You can say that you get up and that you go to work. Try to say **which of the two happens first**, and notice the track has never given you a way.

You'll want to know: पहले

पहले (*pahle*) — first, beforehand, earlier.
पहले मैं उठता हूँ। — First I get up.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पहला is *first*, the ordinal, and पहले is the same word in the shape an adverb takes — the **-ए** ending you have now met on adjectives, on the past copula and on the continuous.
It does two jobs, and the difference is where it stands:

position	**what it means**
in front of the sentence	first, to begin with
after a time word	before that time

सुबह से पहले is *before morning* — the time word, से, then पहले. That is the second use, and it is why this lesson comes after the one on से.
पहला comes from a reconstructed **prathila*, "first" (CDIAL 8652).

Grammar Lens: sequencing a day

sentence	**meaning**
पहले मैं उठता हूँ।	First I get up.
मैं काम पर जाता हूँ।	I go to work.

Two sentences and an order between them. That is the whole of what a one-minute spoken description needs — and until this word existed, every sentence in such a description floated free of the others.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “पहले” — first
- “पहले मैं उठता हूँ”
- the ordinal it comes from
- “सुबह से पहले”

Before you move on

Which ordinal is पहले built on? (पहला, first.) What decides whether it means *first* or *before*? (Where it stands.) What must come in front of it for the second use? (A time word and से.)

98.6 के बाद — the other end of the pair

You have पहले for *first.* Guess its partner, and then go on to see what Hindi makes you put in front of it.

You’ll want to know: के बाद

बाद (*bād*) — after. In a sentence it almost always arrives as के बाद.
काम के बाद — after work.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बाद comes from Arabic بعد ($ba^{c}d$), “after” — a plain borrowing that kept its job exactly.
What is Hindi’s own is the के in front of it. A two-part postposition like this one is built out of the possessive you already have: *the after **of** work.* Hindi has a shelf of these, and they all share the shape:

shape	example
noun + के + a word	काम के बाद

So के बाद is not a new kind of thing. It is the possessive का / के / की you met with *uskā* and *hamārā*, put to work as glue.

Grammar Lens: the pair, and a day in order

what you mean	the shape
first	पहले
before X	X से पहले
after X	X के बाद

Notice the asymmetry: *before* takes से and *after* takes के. There is no tidy reason to give you; it is a pair of fixed habits, and the way to keep them apart is to say each one a few times rather than to reason about it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "काम के बाद" — after work
- "काम से पहले" — before work
- both one after the other, and hear which small word goes with which
- what language बाद was borrowed from

Before you move on

Which small word goes with बाद? (के.) Which goes with पहले? (से.) What is के doing there? (It is the possessive, used as glue — *the after of work.*)

98.7 dincaryā kī tālikā — a day, in the order it happens

Name the verb a day starts with and the noun you travel to, before you look at the table.

Grammar Lens: the six

word	what it adds to a day
उठना	the action it starts with
काम	the place it goes to
बस	what carries you there
से	from, and by
पहले	which of two came first
के बाद	which came second

Four of the six are not vocabulary in the ordinary sense. They are **joints**: things that let two sentences be put in a relation instead of standing side by side.

Grammar Lens: the three small words, side by side

small word	what it marks
पर	at a point
से	from it, or by way of it
के बाद	later than it

All three trail their noun. That is now the whole postposition habit, and the only thing left to learn about any new one is which meaning it carries.

Grammar Lens: a day, assembled

sentence	meaning
पहले मैं सुबह उठता हूँ।	First I get up in the morning.
मैं बस से काम पर जाता हूँ।	I go to work by bus.
काम के बाद मैं घर आता हूँ।	After work I come home.

Three sentences, in order, every word of which is yours.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the three sentences in order
- the three small words, and what each one marks
- which small word goes with पहले and which with बाद

- the two words spelled **बस**, and how a sentence tells them apart

Before you move on

Which side of a noun does every postposition sit on? (After it.) Which small word does *before* take, and which does *after* take? (से and के.) What does से mean besides *from*? (*By* — what carries you.)

98.8 मेरी दिनचर्या — the minute you are asked to fill

Say what time you get up, using the clock word from the future chapter. That is the first line of what follows.

Read this

पहले मैं सुबह सात बजे उठती हूँ। मैं बस से काम पर जाती हूँ। काम के बाद मैं घर आती हूँ। घर पर मैं हिंदी बोलती हूँ।

Four sentences, and **every word in them is one you have been taught**. *Read it:* the four sentences twice — once for meaning, once listening for how the joints do the work

Grammar Lens: what is holding it together

joint	what it does
पहले	opens the sequence
से	names what carries her
पर	names where she ends up
के बाद	hooks sentence three to sentence two

Take those four out and you have four unrelated statements. Put them back and you have a **description**, which is what the one-minute task is graded on.

How to answer

Say your own, out loud, in four sentences:

- what time you get up

- how you travel, and where to
- what you do after that
- what you do once you are home

Say it a second time and change nothing but the endings, as the other gender would. The habit endings and the joints stay exactly where they are.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “पहले मैं सुबह सात बजे उठता हूँ”
- “मैं बस से काम पर जाता हूँ”
- “काम के बाद मैं घर आता हूँ”
- all four sentences straight through, as your own day

Before you move on

Which four words turn four statements into a description? (पहले, से, पर, के बाद.) Which tense is a routine told in? (The habit, with -ता.) What changes when a woman says the same day? (Only the endings.)

Chapter 99

The Noun, And The Ending That Means Two Things

Modes: **voice** (8) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can make any A1 noun plural, read the oblique form a noun takes in front of a postposition, and put a demonstrative in front of a noun.
>
> *Read the clause a practice paper prints in a personal account – do bhaashaaen boltii hai – and tell a plural -e apart from an oblique one by the postposition behind it.*

99.1 बच्चे — more than one, and an ending you have seen four times

You can say **बच्चा** for one child. Try to say *children*, and notice the track has taught you a great many words and never how to have two of anything.

You’ll want to know: बच्चे

बच्चे (*bacce*) — children.
एक बच्चा — one child. **दो बच्चे** — two children.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The ending moved from **-आ** to **-ए**, and you have watched that happen four times already:

where	**singular**	**plural or masculine-plural**
adjectives	काला	काले
the habitual	बोलता	बोलते
the past copula	था	थे
a noun	बच्चा	बच्चे

Nouns bend the same way adjectives do, which is not a coincidence: to Hindi they are the same kind of word wearing the same endings. Learning noun plurals is not a new system — it is the one system arriving at a new place.

This applies to **masculine nouns ending in -आ** and to those only. A noun shaped otherwise does something else, and the next lessons take those in turn.

बच्चा itself is the loan usually traced to Persian *bacca*, “child”.

Grammar Lens: what changes with it

sentence	**meaning**
बच्चा लंबा है।	The child is tall.
बच्चे लंबे हैं।	The children are tall.

Three words moved and the reason is one. The noun went plural, so the adjective followed it and the copula followed the adjective. **Agreement travels outward** from the noun, and once the noun is right the rest is automatic.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “एक बच्चा” and then “दो बच्चे”
- “बच्चे लंबे हैं”
- which other words in the sentence had to move, and why
- the four places you have met the **-आ / -ए** change

Before you move on

What does a masculine **-आ** noun do in the plural? (Ends in **-ए**.) Which other words follow it? (The adjective and the copula.) Is this a new system? (No — it is the adjective ending arriving on a noun.)

99.2 किताबें — nothing to change, so something is added

बच्चा ends in **-आ** and swapped it for **-ए**. **किताब** ends in a consonant. Ask yourself what there is to swap.

You'll want to know: किताबें

किताबें (*kitābeṁ*) — books.
एक किताब — one book. **दो किताबें** — two books.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

A word with no vowel at the end has nothing to exchange, so Hindi **adds** a syllable: **-एँ**, the same **-ए** as before with a nasal on it.

shape of the noun	how it makes a plural
ends in -आ	swaps the ending for -ए
ends in a consonant	adds -एँ

That is the whole difference, and it follows from the shape rather than from a list to memorise: **change what is there, or add where nothing is.**

Feminine nouns ending in a consonant, like **किताब**, are much the commonest case, and the nasal is what your ear should catch.

किताब is Arabic *kitāb*, "book", which reached Hindi through Persian.

Grammar Lens: the nasal you already write

The mark over the ending is the **anusvāra**, which you have been writing since **हैं** and **मिलेंगे**. It is doing the same job here that it does there: this is a plural, and the nasal is the sign of it.

singular	**plural**
किताब	किताबें
रात	रातें

Say both aloud and let the nasal fall on the last syllable rather than swallowing it — that is what a listening paper is asking you to hear.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “एक किताब” and then “दो किताबें”
- the plural of रात
- what a consonant-final noun adds, and why it adds rather than swaps
- the plural of बच्चा, to hear the two side by side

Before you move on

What does a consonant-final noun add? (-एँ.) Why does it add instead of swapping? (There is no final vowel to swap.) Which mark carries the plural? (The nasal you already write in हैं.)

99.3 भाषाएँ — an -आ ending that does not behave like the others

भाषा ends in -आ, exactly like बच्चा. Guess its plural from that, and then go on to find out why the guess is wrong.

You’ll want to know: भाषाएँ

भाषाएँ (*bhāṣāẽ*) — languages.

दो भाषाएँ — two languages. That phrase is printed in a practice paper, in a personal account: *she speaks two languages.*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भाषा is **feminine**, and that is the whole story. The **-आ** → **-ए** swap belongs to **masculine** nouns; a feminine noun **adds** instead, exactly as किताब did.

noun	**gender**	**plural**
बच्चा	masculine	बच्चे
किताब	feminine	किताबें
भाषा	feminine	भाषाएँ

So the question to ask a noun is **not** "how does it end" on its own. It is **gender first, ending second** — and the two feminine rows do the same thing despite ending differently.

The ए is written as a full letter here rather than as a mark, because भाषा ends in a vowel and there is nothing for a mark to sit on. That is the same rule that gave you आऊँगा and आओगे.

भाषा is Sanskrit *bhāṣā*, "speech", a tatsama (CDIAL 9479).

Grammar Lens: the three shapes, in the order to ask them

ask this	**then this**
is it masculine?	-आ swaps to -ए
is it feminine?	it adds a nasal ending

Two questions and you have the plural of any A1 noun. The number in front — दो, तीन — does not change either way; Hindi marks the plural on the noun, not on the numeral.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "दो भाषाएँ" — two languages
- the plurals of बच्चा, किताब and भाषा in a row
- which question you ask a noun first
- why the ए is a full letter in this word

Before you move on

Why does भाषा not become भाषे? (It is feminine; the swap is for masculine nouns.) What do both feminine nouns do? (Add a nasal ending.) Which question comes first? (Gender.)

99.4 दो आदमी — the plural you cannot see

आदमी is masculine and ends in -ई, not -आ. You have a rule for -आ and a rule for feminine nouns. Notice this word fits neither.

You'll want to know: दो आदमी

एक आदमी — one man. दो आदमी — two men.
The word **does not change**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

A masculine noun that does **not** end in -आ has no plural form at all. It stands still, and the sentence around it does the work:

what tells you	**how**
the numeral	दो, तीन
the verb	हैं rather than है
an adjective	लंबे rather than लंबा

दो आदमी लंबे हैं। — Two men are tall. The noun is the only word in that sentence with nothing to show for it.

This is worth expecting rather than being surprised by, because a reading paper will give you an unchanged noun and ask you to count.

The number lives in the sentence, not always in the word.

आदमी is an Arabic word, *ādamī*, “human”, borrowed through Persian.

Grammar Lens: the whole plural system, now complete

noun	plural
बच्चा (m, -आ)	बच्चे
आदमी (m, other)	आदमी
किताब (f)	किताबें
भाषा (f)	भाषाएँ

Four rows and every A1 noun you will meet is in one of them. Two of the four add a nasal, one swaps a vowel, and one does nothing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “एक आदमी” and then “दो आदमी”
- “दो आदमी लंबे हैं”
- the three things in that sentence that tell you it is plural
- all four rows of the table

Before you move on

What does a masculine noun ending in **-ई** do in the plural? (Nothing.) So what tells you there is more than one? (The numeral, the verb and any adjective.) How many shapes does the whole system have? (Four.)

99.5 को — the word that was inside आपको

Say आपको. Say it slowly, in two pieces, and you have already said this lesson’s word.

You’ll want to know: को

को (*ko*) — “to,” and the marker a definite or human object wears.
आदमी को — to the man, and also *the man* when he is the thing acted on.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

You met it fused. आपको is आप + को, and it was named as such when the oblique pronouns arrived. Here it stands on its own, in front of a noun instead of a pronoun, and it is the third postposition the track now has.

It does two jobs that English keeps apart:

job	example
a recipient	आदमी को — *to* the man
a definite or human object	आदमी को — the man, as the thing acted on

The second is the strange one to an English ear. English marks a direct object by word order and nothing else. Hindi puts को on an object when it is a **person** or a **particular** thing, and leaves it bare otherwise. Spanish does the same with **a** before a human object, so the demand is not unique to Hindi — only the marker is.

CDIAL lists को under Sanskrit *kakṣa*, “armpit” (CDIAL 14342): “at the side of” became “to”.

Grammar Lens: three postpositions, one habit

postposition	what it marks
पर	at a point
से	from it, or by way of it
को	to it, or it as a definite object

All three trail the noun. All three are one syllable. And all three do something to the noun in front of them, which is what the next lesson is about.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “आदमी को” — to the man
- आपको slowly, in its two pieces
- the two jobs को does
- the three postpositions you now have, and what each marks

Before you move on

What is आपको made of? (आप plus को.) When does a direct object take को? (When it is a person, or a particular thing.) Which European language marks a human object the same way? (Spanish, with **a**.)

99.6 बच्चे को — the same ending, and this time it is not a plural

You know बच्चे as *children*. Take बच्चे को and notice it cannot mean *to the children* and *one child* at the same time — so which is it?

You'll want to know: बच्चे को

बच्चे को — **to the child**. One child.

A noun standing in front of a postposition changes shape, and for a masculine -आ noun that shape is -ए — the same ending the plural uses.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

This is **not a new rule**. It is the one the possessives taught you, arriving on a noun:

word	plain	in front of a postposition
मेरा	मेरा	मेरे पास
उसका	उसका	उसके बाद
बच्चा	बच्चा	बच्चे को

Hindi calls this shape the **oblique**. Every -आ word in the language wears it — possessives, adjectives, and now nouns — and it is always the same -ए.

So the track has taught this bend four times on four kinds of word, and this is the fourth and last kind.

बच्चा is usually traced to Persian *bacca*, “child”.

Grammar Lens: how to tell the two -ए apart

what you see	what it is
बच्चे हैं	plural — nothing follows the noun
बच्चे को	singular oblique — a postposition follows

The postposition is the whole signal. If one is standing behind the noun, the **-ए** is oblique and the noun may well be singular. If nothing is, the **-ए** is a plural.
A plural *in front of* a postposition takes yet another shape, which is one step past A1 — recognise **बच्चों को** on a page and leave it there for now.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "**बच्चे को**" — to the child
- "**बच्चे हैं**" — and say how many children that is
- what tells you which **बच्चे** you are reading
- the possessive pair that bends the same way

Before you move on

How many children is **बच्चे को**? (One.) What forces the noun into that shape? (The postposition behind it.) Which earlier words wore the same **-ए**? (The possessives, in front of a postposition.)

99.7 यह किताब — the same word, one step to the left

You have **यह** and **वह** as answers to *which one* — standing alone, meaning *this one* and *that one*. Try putting one in front of a noun.

You’ll want to know: यह किताब

यह किताब — this book. वह आदमी — that man.

Nothing is added and nothing bends. The word you already have is placed in front of a noun, and that is the whole of it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

how it stands	what it means
यह	this one
यह किताब	this book

English does exactly the same thing with the same two words — *this* is a pronoun in *this is mine* and a determiner in *this book* — so there is nothing here to translate differently. The reason it needs saying is that the track taught these words **only** as standalone answers, and a reading paper uses them in front of nouns far more often.

There is a second reason it matters. Hindi has no article, so यह and वह are what a writer reaches for when *the* would have been enough in English. A sentence that begins वह आदमी is often best read as *the man* rather than *that man.*

CDIAL lists यह under Sanskrit *eṣa*, “this” (CDIAL 2530).

Grammar Lens: what fills the space before a noun

in front of the noun	what it does
nothing	a book, or the book
एक	one book, a book
यह / वह	this book, that book

Three choices and the reader picks from context. That is the whole of Hindi definiteness at this level, and it is why the track has spent no time on articles: **there are none to spend it on.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “यह किताब” — this book
- “वह आदमी” — that man, or the man
- the same two words standing alone, as answers

- the three things that can stand in front of a Hindi noun

Before you move on

What changes when यह moves in front of a noun? (Nothing — it is placed there.) Why does Hindi lean on these two words more than English does? (It has no article.) How is वह आदमी often best read? (*The man.*)

99.8 saṁjñā kī tālikā — the noun, on one page

Name the first question you ask a noun before making it plural, and say why it comes first.

Grammar Lens: the four plurals

noun	plural
बच्चा (m, -आ)	बच्चे
आदमी (m, other)	आदमी
किताब (f, consonant)	किताबें
भाषा (f, -आ)	भाषाएँ

Gender first, ending second. One row swaps a vowel, two add a nasal, and one does nothing at all.

Grammar Lens: the ending that means two things

what you see	how many	why
बच्चे लंबे हैं	more than one	nothing follows the noun
बच्चे को	one	a postposition follows

The postposition is the signal. That is the single most useful thing in this chapter, because **-ए** is everywhere and a reader who cannot tell the two apart will miscount every sentence that has one.

Grammar Lens: the space in front of the noun

before the noun	after the noun
nothing, एक, यह, वह	पर, से, को

A Hindi noun phrase is a noun with an optional word in front and an optional word behind. Everything this chapter taught fits in that one picture.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all four plurals in a row
- “बच्चे को” and “बच्चे लंबे हैं”, and say how many children each has
- the three postpositions, and the three things that go in front
- “दो भाषाएँ” and “यह किताब”

Before you move on

What tells you an -ए is oblique rather than plural? (A postposition behind it.) Which two rows add a nasal? (Both feminine ones.) Which noun shape does nothing at all? (A masculine noun not ending in -आ.)

99.9 दो भाषाएँ बोलती है — counting from one word

Read it: the line and say how many languages, before going on

दो भाषाएँ बोलती है।

Grammar Lens: the line a paper prints

That clause is lifted from a personal account in the second practice paper. Until this chapter, भाषाएँ was an unreadable shape.

word	what it does
दो	the number
भाषाएँ	the noun, carrying the plural nasal
बोलती है	the habit, and the speaker is a woman

Two things say *plural* here and neither is the verb: the numeral and the ending on the noun. **The verb agrees with the person, not with the count.**

The exchange

The other half of the chapter, in two lines that look almost alike:

> — बच्चे कहाँ हैं? — बच्चे को घर भेजा।

The first बच्चे is a plural and the second is one child in the oblique. **Nothing but the postposition separates them**, and a reader who misses it counts wrong.

How to answer

Say each of these out loud, as a plural:

- one child, then two children
- one book, then two books
- one language, then two languages
- one man, then two men

The fourth is the one that sounds wrong and is right. Say it twice.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “दो भाषाएँ बोलती है”
- which two words in it carry the plural
- “बच्चे को”, and say how many children
- “यह किताब” and “वह आदमी”

Before you move on

Does the verb tell you how many? (No — it agrees with the person.) What separates a plural बच्चे from an oblique one? (A postposition behind it.) Which noun shape shows no plural at all? (A masculine noun not ending in **-आ**.)

Chapter 100

How Much, How Well, How Big

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can hedge an answer, say that something was done well or badly, compare two things, ask a quantity and pay a compliment.
>
> *Answer the listening item the first practice paper sets – haan, thodii – and say why the ending rather than the word is what the item tests.*

100.1 थोड़ा — the honest yes

> Somebody asks whether you speak Hindi. You can say yes and you can say no. Try to say **a little**, which is the true answer, and find you cannot.

You'll want to know: थोड़ा

थोड़ा (*thoṛā*) — a little, a bit, some.

हाँ, थोड़ी। — Yes, a little. That two-word answer is a listening item on a practice paper.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

It ends in **-आ**, so it bends like every other word that does:

what is being hedged	**the form**
a masculine thing	**थोड़ा**
a feminine thing	**थोड़ी**

That is why the paper's answer is **थोड़ी** rather than **थोड़ा** — the question was about **हिंदी**, and *hindī* is feminine. The hedge agrees with what it hedges, not with the person speaking.

This catches English speakers out, because *a little* in English is a fixed lump that never changes. Here it is an adjective, and adjectives agree.

थोड़ा comes from Sanskrit *stoka*, "a drop; a little" (CDIAL 13720).

Grammar Lens: where it stands

sentence	**meaning**
मैं थोड़ी हिंदी बोलता हूँ।	I speak a little Hindi.
हाँ, थोड़ी।	Yes, a little.

In front of the noun, like any adjective. And on its own as a complete answer, where the noun it agrees with is the one the question named. A hedge is worth more at this level than it looks. **It is the difference between claiming fluency and being believed**, and an examiner hears the difference.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "**थोड़ा**" and then "**थोड़ी**"
- "**मैं थोड़ी हिंदी बोलता हूँ**"
- "**हाँ, थोड़ी**" — and say why it is not **थोड़ा**
- the same answer as a woman would say the whole sentence

Before you move on

Why is the paper's answer **थोड़ी**? (*Hindī* is feminine, and the hedge agrees with what it hedges.) Does English change *a little* the same way? (No — it is a fixed lump there.)

100.2 अच्छा / बुरा — well and badly, from words you already own

You have अच्छा for *good* and बुरा for *bad*. English needs two different words to say *well* and *badly*. Guess what Hindi needs.

You'll want to know: the manner use

अच्छा is also *well*. बुरा is also *badly*.

वह अच्छा बोलता है। — He speaks well. वह बुरा बोलता है। — He speaks badly.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

English keeps two shelves of words — *good* / *well*, *bad* / *badly* — and puts **-ly** on the second shelf. Hindi keeps one. The same word describes a thing or describes an action, and its position in the sentence says which:

where it stands	**what it describes**
beside a noun	the thing — a **good** book
in front of a verb	the action — speaks **well**

So *he is good* and *he speaks well* use the same word in Hindi, and an English speaker's instinct to reach for a second form is the thing to unlearn.

अच्छा is also where you can now read the letter छ, which arrived a moment ago in the alphabet. It sits in the middle of the word. *Find:* छ in अच्छा

बुरा comes from a reconstructed **bura*, "defective" (CDIAL 9289).

Grammar Lens: it still agrees

speaker	**sentence**
a man	वह अच्छा बोलता है।
a woman	वह अच्छी बोलती है।

Even doing the work of an English adverb, it is still an adjective, so it still bends. English adverbs never do, which is the second half of the same instinct to unlearn.

The ordinary spoken way to say *well* is also अच्छी तरह, "in a good manner" — useful to recognise, and the bare adjective is enough to produce.

Your turn

- *Say it:* “वह अच्छा बोलता है” — he speaks well
- *Say it:* “वह बुरा बोलता है” — he speaks badly
- *Say it:* the same pair as a woman would say them
- *Look:* at अच्छा and put your finger on the letter छ

Before you move on

How many words does Hindi need for *good* and *well*? (One.) What tells you which job it is doing? (Where it stands.) Does it still bend for gender when it means *well*? (Yes — it is still an adjective.)

100.3 से बड़ा — bigger, with no word for *-er*

You have बड़ा and छोटा. Try to say that one thing is *bigger than* another, and notice English changed the adjective to do it.

You’ll want to know: से बड़ा

आदमी बच्चे से बड़ा है। — The man is bigger than the child.
The adjective **does not change**. The thing compared against takes से.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

English has two machines for this — **-er** on short adjectives and *more* in front of long ones — and both are extra grammar. Hindi has neither:

English	**Hindi**
bigger **than** X	X से बड़ा
smaller **than** X	X से छोटा

The postposition you learned for *from* and *by* is doing this too, and the logic holds: the comparison **proceeds from** the thing measured against. Measured **from** that book, this one is big.

So there is no comparative form to learn in this language. **There is one more use of a word you already have.**

से comes from Sanskrit *sahita*, “together with” (CDIAL 13310), or perhaps *sama* (CDIAL 13173).

Grammar Lens: word order, and the reason the note was wrong

slot	what goes in it
first	the thing being described
second	what it is measured against, plus से
third	the adjective, then the verb

Note what बच्चे से is doing there: that is the oblique from the last chapter, earning its keep the very next time a postposition turns up. English puts *than X* **after** the adjective; Hindi puts it **before**. That reversal is the only thing to drill, and it follows from the rule that has held since the first sentence you read: **the verb goes last, and everything else queues in front of it.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “आदमी बच्चे से बड़ा है”
- “बच्चा आदमी से छोटा है” — the same fact from the other end
- what happens to the adjective in a Hindi comparison (nothing)
- which side of the adjective the compared thing sits on

Before you move on

What marks the thing compared against? (से.) Does the adjective change? (No.) Where does the compared thing stand, against English? (Before the adjective rather than after it.)

100.4 कितना — a word let out of one sentence

Say the question you learned for asking somebody’s age. One word in it means something on its own, and you have never used it anywhere else.

You'll want to know: कितना

कितना (*kitnā*) — how much, how many.
कितनी किताबें? — How many books?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

You met it inside the age question, where it was one syllable of a memorised lump. It is a word, and it behaves like every **-आ** word in this language:

what is being counted	the form
a masculine thing	कितना
a feminine thing, or a plural	कितनी

कितनी किताबें is feminine and plural, so the question word bends to match its noun — which is the same agreement you have now seen on adjectives, verbs, the past copula, the continuous and the hedge.

Hindi does not split *how much* from *how many.* English needs two phrases because it sorts nouns into countable and uncountable; Hindi asks one question and lets the noun answer.

कितना comes from a reconstructed **kiyatta*, "how great" (CDIAL 3167).

Grammar Lens: the shape of a quantity question

question	answer
कितनी किताबें?	दो किताबें।
कितनी हिंदी?	थोड़ी।

The second pair is the one a listening paper sets: a quantity question, and a hedge for an answer. Both words in that exchange bend to the same feminine noun, which is why they rhyme.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "कितनी किताबें?" — how many books?
- an answer with a number
- "कितनी हिंदी?" and answer it with the hedge
- the age question, and name the word inside it you now own

Before you move on

How many words does Hindi use for *how much* and *how many*? (One.) Why is it कितनी in front of किताबें? (The noun is feminine and plural.) Where had you already been saying it? (Inside the age question.)

100.5 कितना अच्छा! — a question that has stopped asking

You have कितना for *how much* and अच्छा for *good*. Put them together and listen to what the pair wants to be.

You'll want to know: कितना अच्छा!

कितना अच्छा! — How good! How lovely!
कितनी अच्छी किताब! — What a good book!

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Nothing has been added. This is the question word in front of an adjective, with the question taken out of it.

what you say	what it is
कितना अच्छा है?	how good is it?
कितना अच्छा!	how good!

The difference is the verb and the voice. Drop है, let the pitch fall at the end, and a question becomes an exclamation. English does the identical thing — *how good is it?* against *how good!* — so there is nothing new to translate, only a habit to notice.
कितना comes from a reconstructed **kiyatta*, "how great" (CDIAL 3167).

Grammar Lens: it still agrees, both words at once

what is being admired	what you say
a masculine thing	कितना अच्छा!
a feminine thing	कितनी अच्छी!

Both words move together, because both are **-आ** words and both are

agreeing with the same noun. That is why the phrase rhymes with itself in either gender, and the rhyme is a useful check: if the two endings do not match, one of them is wrong.
This is the commonest way a Hindi speaker pays a compliment, and it costs you nothing you did not already have.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "कितना अच्छा!" — how good!
- "कितनी अच्छी किताब!" — what a good book!
- the question form of the same phrase
- what you take away to turn the question into the exclamation

Before you move on

What is removed to make the exclamation? (The verb, and the rising voice.) How many words bend in कितनी अच्छी? (Both.) What does the rhyme tell you? (That the two endings agree — if they do not match, one is wrong.)

100.6 mātrā kī tālikā — degree, on one page

Name the word that hedges an answer and the word that asks a quantity, and say what the two have in common.

Grammar Lens: the five

what you want to do	what you say
hedge an answer	थोड़ा / थोड़ी
describe how an action went	अच्छा / बुरा
measure one thing against another	X से बड़ा
ask a quantity	कितना / कितनी
admire something	कितना अच्छा!

Every one of the five ends in -आ and bends. That is the thread through the chapter, and it means none of them is a new kind of word

— they are adjectives doing five different jobs.

Grammar Lens: what Hindi does without

English has	**Hindi has**
good **and** well	one word
how much **and** how many	one word
bigger, more interesting	the adjective, unchanged

Three places where English carries extra machinery and Hindi carries none. A learner coming the other way has to build those distinctions; you get to drop them.

Grammar Lens: से, doing a third job

use	**example**
from	घर से
by way of	बस से
measured against	आदमी से बड़ा

One postposition, three jobs, and the same idea under all three: the thing **proceeds from** the noun. A comparison starts at the thing you measure against.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- all five rows of the first table
- “आदमी बच्चे से बड़ा है”
- “कितनी अच्छी किताब!”
- the three jobs से now does

Before you move on

What do all five words in this chapter have in common? (They end in -आ and bend.) Does a Hindi adjective change to make a comparison? (No.) How many jobs does से now do? (Three.)

100.7 हाँ, थोड़ी — two words, and one of them is the test

You have हाँ for yes and the hedge from this chapter. Put them together and you have a complete answer.

The exchange

— क्या आप हिंदी बोलती हैं? — हाँ, थोड़ी।

That answer is a listening item on the first practice paper. Two words, and **the second one carries the whole thing**: a bare *hā̃* would claim fluency, and *thoṛī* is what makes the answer true.

The ending is not decoration either. It is थोड़ी and not थोड़ा because *hindī* is feminine — so a listener who hears the wrong ending hears a speaker who has not noticed what they are talking about.

How to answer

Say each of these out loud:

- yes, a little
- I speak a little Hindi
- he speaks well
- what a good book!

Every one of the four ends in a word that had to agree with something. Say them again and listen for the ending each time rather than for the word.

Grammar Lens: the chapter in one sentence

what a paper asks	**what it is testing**
how much do you speak?	the hedge, and its ending
how well does he speak?	an adjective doing an adverb's job
which is bigger?	से, and an unchanged adjective

Three questions, and none of them needs a word you did not already half have. **This chapter added five words and no new machinery.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “हाँ, थोड़ी”
- why the ending is **-ई** and not **-आ**
- “वह अच्छा बोलता है”
- “आदमी बच्चे से बड़ा है”

Before you move on

Which of the two words in the answer carries the meaning? (थोड़ी — *hā̃* alone would overclaim.) Why that ending? (*Hindī* is feminine.) What marks the thing a comparison measures against? (से.)

Chapter 101

Two Words Where English Has One

Modes: **voice** (5) **eyes** (4) **Hands-free start:** the first 2 of 9 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say who I am with and without, place a thing in front of, behind or near a landmark, say who something is for, and say what I am doing something in order to do.
>
> *Answer a directions question with a landmark rather than a distance, and say which of the three place words would be the wrong answer to a question about side.*

101.1 के साथ — with, in two words

> Say *his* and *her* in Hindi, and notice that both were the same word wearing different endings. Now try to say **with my friend**, and notice that English needs exactly one word to do it.

You’ll want to know: के साथ

मैं दोस्त के साथ हूँ। — I am with a friend.

English spends one word on this. Hindi spends **two**, and only the second one is new.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

sāth, “with”, comes from Sanskrit *sārthena*, “in company with”, the instrumental case of *sārtha*, “caravan, company”; CDIAL lists the Hindi word under that case form (CDIAL 13364).

The two words

Take the phrase apart and something familiar falls out:

piece	**what it is**
दोस्त	the noun
के	**उसका's ending**, standing on its own
साथ	the new word — *company*

So दोस्त के साथ is, piece by piece, *the friend's company.* Hindi is not reaching for a preposition at all. It is building a possessive and then naming the relation as a thing.

That is why the first word is के and never का: a possessive agrees with what follows it, and साथ is masculine and standing in front of a further word, so it takes the oblique ending you met on nouns one chapter ago.

Grammar Lens: a shape, not a word

Write it: the shape below, once

The rest of this chapter is the same shape six more times:

slot	**contents**
1	the noun
2	के
3	the relation word

अपने दोस्त के साथ — *with my own friend* — puts अपना in slot 1's ordinary spot, bent to अपने because a postposition is coming. Everything in front of a postposition bends. That has now been true of possessives, of pronouns and of nouns, and it is true here.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "मैं दोस्त के साथ हूँ"
- "अपने दोस्त के साथ"
- which of the two words is the new one
- why the first word is के and not का

Before you move on

How many words does Hindi use for *with*? (Two.) Which one is new? (साथ.) What is the other one? (The possessive ending, in its oblique form.)

101.2 के बिना — the opposite, for the price of one word

Say *with a friend* in Hindi. Now say it again and listen to how much of it you would have to change to mean the opposite.

You'll want to know: के बिना

चाय के बिना — without tea.

One word changed. The shape did not move.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

binā comes from Sanskrit *vinā*, "without" (CDIAL 11772).

The two words

slot 3	the whole phrase	English
साथ	दोस्त के साथ	with a friend
बिना	चाय के बिना	without tea

This is what the shape buys. Once slot 3 is a **swappable position**, every new relation costs exactly one word instead of a new piece of grammar — and this chapter is going to swap it five more times.

English does not work this way. *With* and *without* look related because one is built out of the other, but *in front of* and *behind* are unrelated words that share nothing. In Hindi all of them share के, and that is the part that is doing the grammatical work.

Grammar Lens: two ways to write it

बिना is the one relation word in this chapter that is also allowed to stand **in front of** its noun — बिना चाय के is said too, and means the same thing.

Learn the slot-3 version. It is the one that matches everything else you are about to meet, and a reader who knows the ordinary order will still understand the other one when a paper prints it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “चाय के बिना”
- “दोस्त के बिना”
- the one slot that changed between *with* and *without*
- the word that stayed put in the middle

Before you move on

What is *without tea*? (चाय के बिना.) Which slot carries the meaning? (The third.) Which slot carries the grammar? (The second — के.)

101.3 घर के पास — the word that was hiding in *I have*

Say *I have* in Hindi. Now look at the two words you said and ask what the second one actually means, because so far you have never been told.

You’ll want to know: के पास

दुकान घर के पास है। — The shop is near the house.
पास means *near*. It has meant *near* the whole time.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ghar comes from *ghara*, “house”, which CDIAL finds hard to derive from Sanskrit *gṛha* (CDIAL 4428); *pās*, “near”, from *pārśva*, “side”, whose form *pārśve* meant “near” (CDIAL 8118).

The two words

phrase	word for word	the job it does
मेरे पास	near me	I **have**
घर के पास	near the house	it is **nearby**

The same three slots, and the same slot-3 word. What changed is only what sits in slot 1 — a person or a place.

So Hindi says *having* by saying **nearness**, and the physical sense you are meeting now is the original one. A language with no verb for *have* reached for the nearest true thing: whatever is beside you is, for practical purposes, yours. The possessive chapter taught you the borrowed meaning first because it is the one a beginner needs first. This is the meaning it was borrowed from.

Grammar Lens: a place answer

You have been able to **ask** where something is for sixty chapters. This is the first shape that lets you **answer** with anything more exact than a room:

question	answer
दुकान कहाँ है?	घर के पास।

An A1 listening paper does this constantly, because *near* is how people actually give directions — not in metres, but relative to a landmark both speakers already know.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “दुकान घर के पास है”
- what पास means on its own
- “मेरे पास” and the job it does
- why a language with no verb for *have* might use this word

Before you move on

What does पास mean? (Near.) Which slot does it occupy? (The third.) Which of its two jobs did you learn first, and which came first in the language? (Having, then nearness — the other way round.)

101.4 के सामने — in front of

Say *near the house*. Now say the word for a railway station. You are one word away from the sentence an A1 listening paper is most likely to set you.

You'll want to know: के सामने

दुकान स्टेशन के सामने है। — The shop is in front of the station.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

sāmne is a form of *sāmnā*, "the front", a tadbhava of Sanskrit *saṁmukha*, "facing" (CDIAL 12982).

The two words

Hindi	English
स्टेशन के पास	near the station
स्टेशन के सामने	in front of the station

English changed from one word to three. Hindi changed from one word to one.

Notice what सामने does not do. It ends in **-ए**, which on an adjective would be an ending that agrees with something — but this word never changes, whoever or whatever is in front of whatever. **A slot-three word is fixed.** The bending in this shape all happens in slot 2, and slot 2 is already done before slot 3 arrives.

Grammar Lens: front of what

English *in front of* is ambiguous in a way Hindi's is not. *In front of the station* can mean the near side of the building, or it can mean a position further along the road. के सामने means the first: **facing it, across from it, on the side you would stand to look at it.** That is the reading a direction-giver intends, and the reading an exam item expects.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “दुकान स्टेशन के सामने है”
- “दुकान स्टेशन के पास है” — the weaker claim
- whether सामने ever changes its ending
- which slot does all the bending in this shape

Before you move on

What is *in front of the station*? (स्टेशन के सामने.) Does the third word agree with anything? (No — it is fixed.) Which side of a building does it put you on? (Facing it.)

101.5 के पीछे — behind

Say *in front of the station.* Then say the word for a table, which you have had since the chapter on furniture.

You’ll want to know: के पीछे

कुर्सी मेज़ के पीछे है। — The chair is behind the table.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

pīche, “behind”, is a tadbhava: CDIAL lists it under a reconstructed **paśca*, “hinder part”, as an old case form that replaced Sanskrit *paścāt* (CDIAL 7990).

The two words

Three place words, and they do not all do the same kind of job:

slot-three word	what it tells you
पास	**how far** — close, no direction
सामने	**which side** — facing
पीछे	**which side** — away

पास answers a different question from the other two, and mixing them is the commonest way to get a direction item wrong. A shop can be **near** a station and still be **behind** it; it cannot be in front of it and behind it at once.

Grammar Lens: the one glyph worth pausing on

पीछे carries छ, the breathy partner of च that the previous chapter taught. This is its first outing in an ordinary word rather than a number, and it is worth saying slowly: the breath belongs to the छ, not to the vowel either side of it.

Get that wrong and you say a different word. The pair च / छ does the same work here that त / थ does elsewhere, and both pairs punish the same inattention.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “कुर्सी मेज़ के पीछे है”
- “कुर्सी मेज़ के सामने है”
- which of the three place words says nothing about direction
- the two facts a listener gets from पीछे that पास withholds

Before you move on

What is *behind the table*? (मेज़ के पीछे.) Which place word gives distance without direction? (पास.) Which two are opposite ends of one axis? (सामने and पीछे.)

101.6 परिवार के लिए — for, with a noun in front

Say *for me* in Hindi — you have had it since the possessive chapter. Then say the word for a family.

You’ll want to know: के लिए

यह परिवार के लिए है। — This is for the family.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

liye, “for”, is usually explained as a form of *lenā*, “to take”, which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *labhate*, “takes” (CDIAL 10948).

The two words

मेरे लिए was taught as a phrase to memorise. It was never a phrase. It was this shape with a possessive in slot 1:

slot 1	**slot 2**	**slot 3**
मेरे	—	लिए
परिवार	के	लिए

The top row has no separate slot 2 because मेरे already **is** the possessive, bent. When slot 1 is a noun instead, the possessive has to be supplied, and के is what supplies it.

That is the whole difference between the two rows, and it is the same difference that runs through this chapter: a pronoun carries its own के inside itself, a noun does not.

Grammar Lens: what *for* covers

के लिए covers two things English also puts under *for*:

sense	**example**
who benefits	यह परिवार के लिए है।
what something is meant to do	यह चाय के लिए है।

The second sense is the one the next lesson builds on, because a **purpose** is usually an action rather than a thing, and an action needs one more change before it can stand in slot 1.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “यह परिवार के लिए है”
- “यह मेरे लिए है”
- why the second one has no के in it
- the two senses के लिए carries

Before you move on

What is *for the family*? (परिवार के लिए.) Why does मेरे लिए lack a middle word? (The pronoun is already carrying the possessive.) What is still missing before you can say *for doing* something? (A change to the verb.)

101.7 करने के लिए — in order to

Say the infinitive *to do*. Now say *for the family*. To put the first inside the second, one of them has to bend — and by now you can guess which.

You'll want to know: करने के लिए

मैं काम करने के लिए जाता हूँ। — I go in order to work.
करना became करने. Nothing else moved.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Look at the ending that changed, and then look at where you have seen that change before:

kind of word	**plain**	**before a postposition**
possessive	मेरा	मेरे
demonstrative possessive	उसका	उसके
own	अपना	अपने
noun	बच्चा	बच्चे
infinitive	करना	करने

Five kinds of word, one ending, one trigger. The infinitive is the **last** of the five, and it needs no new rule at all: **-ना** ends in **-आ**, so it bends exactly as बच्चा does.

The reason it can bend like a noun is that in Hindi it **is** one. करना is both *to do* and *the doing*, which is why it could already sit where a noun sits. A word that behaves like a noun bends like a noun.

करना goes back to Sanskrit *karoti*, "does" (CDIAL 2814). लिए is usually explained as a form of लेना, "to take".

Grammar Lens: where the purpose goes

slot	contents
1	who
2	the purpose: काम करने के लिए
3	the main verb, last

English puts the purpose **after** the verb — *I go to work.* Hindi puts it **before** — because the verb goes last, and that has not changed since the first sentence you read.

So the order reverses, and the reversal is the only thing to practise. The pieces themselves are all old.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "मैं काम करने के लिए जाता हूँ"
- what करना turns into, and what it turns into it for
- the five kinds of word that wear this ending
- which end of the sentence a Hindi purpose sits at

Before you move on

What is *in order to work*? (काम करने के लिए.) What made करना bend? (A postposition was coming.) Why can an infinitive bend like a noun? (Because it is one.)

101.8 sambandh kī tālikā — relation, on one page

Name the word for *with* and the word for *in front of*, and say what the two phrases have in the middle.

Grammar Lens: the six

slot 3	English	what it does
साथ	with	company
बिना	without	absence
पास	near	distance

Grammar Lens: and the other three

slot 3	English	what it does
सामने	in front of	facing side
पीछे	behind	far side
लिए	for	benefit or purpose

Six words, and **not one of them is a new piece of grammar**. Each is a noun sitting in a possessive phrase. दोस्त के साथ is *the friend's company* and घर के पास is *the house's nearness*, and Hindi is content to leave it at that.

Grammar Lens: the one word that never changes

Slot 2 is के every single time, whatever stands on either side of it.

slot 1	slot 2	slot 3
दोस्त	के	साथ
घर	के	पास
करने	के	लिए

It is के rather than का or की because there is a further word coming, and a possessive in front of a further word goes oblique. That is the same rule the noun chapter taught and the same rule the possessive chapter taught, applied a third time.

When slot 1 is a pronoun, slot 2 disappears into it: मेरे पास, मेरे लिए. The के is still there — it is the -ए you can hear on मेरे.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “चाय के बिना”
- “मेज़ के पीछे”

- “काम करने के लिए”
- the one word that sits in slot 2 every time

Before you move on

How many slots does a Hindi relation phrase have? (Three.) Which slot is always the same? (The second.) What happens to that slot when slot 1 is a pronoun? (It fuses into the pronoun’s own ending.)

101.9 दुकान कहाँ है? — answering with a landmark

Ask where the shop is. You have been able to ask this for a long time, and until this chapter you could not answer it.

The exchange

speaker	Hindi
A	दुकान कहाँ है?
B	स्टेशन के सामने है।
A	स्टेशन के पास?
B	हाँ, पास है।

B’s first answer gives a **side**; the second gives only a **distance**. B is not repeating — B is conceding the weaker claim, because A asked for less.

How to answer

Find the **landmark** — the noun before के — then take the word after it, because that word alone carries the relation.

पास gives distance and no side. सामने and पीछे give a side and no distance. Do not upgrade पास into a side.

Grammar Lens: the chapter in one sentence

Hindi has no prepositions. It has **possessive phrases whose head noun names a relation**.
मैं दोस्त के साथ काम करने के लिए जाता हूँ। — Two relation phrases, one sentence, three slots each.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “दुकान कहाँ है?”
- “स्टेशन के सामने है”
- “मैं दोस्त के साथ काम करने के लिए जाता हूँ”
- which of the place words would be a wrong answer to *which side?*

Before you move on

Where in a relation phrase does the landmark sit? (Before के.) Which word carries the relation? (The one after के.) Which relation word tells you nothing about direction? (पास.)

Chapter 102

From, Until, and Instead

Modes: **voice** (6) **eyes** (1) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a span of days or hours with a marker on each end, name a second way of travelling, and correct somebody's guess by naming the option they got wrong and then the right one.
>
> *Read the correction a practice paper prints – bas se nahiin, tren se – and say which side of the negative holds the true answer, then tell a span se from a means se in one sentence carrying both.*

102.1 तक — where it stops

> Say the word that marks where something comes **from**. Then say *at five o'clock*. One of those two words has been doing its job alone.

You'll want to know: तक

पाँच बजे तक — until five o'clock.
से marks a **start**. तक marks a **stop**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

word	what it marks
से	the point something begins at
तक	the point something ends at

Both are **postpositions**, so both come **after** the word they attach to.

English puts *until* in front and Hindi puts तक behind, and that is not a quirk of this word — it is the same fact about the language that put के in the middle of every phrase in the last chapter.
तक also stretches across space, not only time: घर तक is *as far as the house*. One word covers both, because a stopping point is a stopping point whether you measure it in hours or in streets.
तक comes from Sanskrit *tāvatka*, built on *tāvant*, “so much” (CDIAL 5805).

Grammar Lens: it does not have to be a pair

पाँच बजे तक on its own is a complete and ordinary thing to say. It names only the end, and leaves the beginning to be understood — usually *now*.
That matters because the next lesson pairs the two words, and a reader who has only ever seen the pair will not recognise तक standing by itself on a sign or in a notice, which is where it most often appears.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “पाँच बजे तक”
- “घर तक”
- which of से and तक marks the end
- which side of its noun a Hindi postposition stands on

Before you move on

What does तक mark? (The stopping point.) Where does it stand? (After its word.) Does it need से to be present? (No.)

102.2 सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक — a span, marked at both ends

Say the first and last weekdays of the working week. Then say the word that marks a stopping point.

You’ll want to know: से ... तक

सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक — from Monday to Friday.

Two days, and **each one carries its own marker**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

CDIAL traces *se*, “from”, to Sanskrit *sahita*, “accompanied by” (CDIAL 13310), and lists it under *sama* too (CDIAL 13173); *tak*, “until”, comes from *tāvatka* (CDIAL 5805).

The two words

piece	job
सोमवार से	start here
शुक्रवार तक	stop here

English builds a span out of *from* and *to* standing **in front of** their days. Hindi builds it out of से and तक standing **behind** theirs.

The shape looks harder than it is, because both halves are already familiar and neither is doing anything new. What is new is only that **they are allowed to appear together**, and that when they do, the whole thing is one idea rather than two.

Grammar Lens: order is not optional

The से half comes first. Always, and for the same reason English says *from Monday to Friday* and not the other way round: a span is told in the direction it runs.

What Hindi does **not** copy is the position of the markers. Read the pair as two small packages rather than as one long phrase:

[सोमवार से] [शुक्रवार तक]

Read it that way and a longer span — a written account of somebody’s week — comes apart at the right seams the first time.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक”
- the marker the first day carries

- the marker the last day carries
- which half of the span is said first

Before you move on

How many markers does a Hindi span carry? (Two — one on each end.) Where do they stand? (After their days.) Which end is named first? (The start.)

102.3 सुबह से शाम तक — the same frame, smaller units

Say *morning* and *evening*, the two Persian loanwords you met early on. Then guess how a span between them is built.

You'll want to know: सुबह से शाम तक

सुबह से शाम तक — from morning until evening.

If you guessed, you guessed right. Nothing about the frame changed.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

subah is Arabic *ṣubḥ*, “morning”, through Persian (Lane, root *ṣ-b-ḥ*); *śām* is usually traced to Persian *shām*, “evening”; *se* and *tak* are inherited (CDIAL 13310, 5805).

The two words

what is spanned	Hindi
days	सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक
parts of a day	सुबह से शाम तक
clock hours	दस बजे से पाँच बजे तक

Three different units, one frame. से and तक do not care what they are attached to, and that is worth noticing because English does not always manage it either — *from ten to five* is fine, but *from Monday until Friday* and *until the house* pull on different senses of the same word.

Grammar Lens: the clock row is two packages, not four words

दस बजे से is one package and पाँच बजे तक is another. Each already had its own marker — बजे — before the span marker arrived, so the clock row stacks **two** postposition-like endings on one side.
Read it inside out:
दस → दस बजे (*at ten*) → दस बजे से (*from ten*)
Nothing is being negotiated between them. Each step adds one word to the right of what came before, which is the direction this language always builds in.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "सुबह से शाम तक"
- "दस बजे से पाँच बजे तक"
- what changed in the frame between days and hours (nothing)
- the two packages inside the clock span

Before you move on

Does the span frame change when the units change? (No.) What sits between दस and से? (बजे.) Which direction does the phrase grow in? (Rightwards, one word at a time.)

102.4 ट्रेन — a word that travelled with the thing

Say *by bus*. Say *station*. You have had a station for a while without a second way of reaching it.

You'll want to know: ट्रेन

ट्रेन से — by train.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Both of your vehicles are borrowed words, and they are borrowed the same way:

Hindi	**from**	**by ...**
बस	English *bus*	बस से
ट्रेन	English *train*	ट्रेन से

The से that makes them *by bus* and *by train* is the one already taught for means — the same word that says *from*, and that this chapter has been using for the start of a span.

Look at the first letter. ट is the retroflex one, made with the tongue curled back — and it is used here because English *t* in *train* sounds, to a Hindi ear, much more like ट than like the dental त. That is the regular habit for English loanwords, and it is why ट्रेन and not त्रेन.

Grammar Lens: a word Hindi also has its own name for

Hindi does have an inherited word for a railway train, and an A1 reader will still meet ट्रेन far more often — on a board, in a timetable, in the middle of an ordinary sentence about getting to work.

Learn the borrowed one first because it is the one that is said. The other is worth recognising later, when reading formal notices is the task.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “ट्रेन से”
- “बस से”
- the word that makes both of them mean *by*
- why the first letter is the curled-back one

Before you move on

What is *by train*? (ट्रेन से.) Which त-family letter does it start with, and why? (The retroflex ट, because that is what English *t* sounds like here.) What else has से done in this chapter? (Marked the start of a span.)

102.5 nahīṁ kī jagah — how much the negative takes back

Say *by bus* and *by train*. Now imagine somebody has guessed the first one and you need to give them the second.

You'll want to know: X से नहीं, Y से

बस से नहीं, ट्रेन से। — Not by bus — by train.

नहीं stands between the two options, and the one it rejects is the one **before** it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

nahīṁ comes from Sanskrit *nahi*, "surely not" (CDIAL 7035); *jagah*, "place", is usually traced to Persian *jāygāh*.

The two words

Read the frame as three beats:

beat	contents
1	the wrong option, with its own से
2	नहीं
3	the right option, with its own से

Each option keeps its marker. That is the part to watch, because English drops the second one — *not by bus, by train* has one *by*, and Hindi has two से. A sentence with only one से is not this frame.

Grammar Lens: what नहीं is negating

In every sentence so far, नहीं has stood in front of the verb and denied the whole thing. Here it stands after a noun-plus-postposition and denies **only that phrase**.

what is denied	example
the whole sentence	मैं नहीं जाता
one option in it	बस से नहीं, ट्रेन से

So the position of नहीं tells a reader how much of the sentence is being taken back — and getting it wrong turns a correction into a refusal. The English speaker's instinct is to reach for a word like *but*; **this frame has no word in the middle beyond the negative itself**, and the comma carries the pause.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "बस से नहीं, ट्रेन से"
- "ट्रेन से नहीं, बस से" — the correction the other way round
- which option नहीं rejects, the one before or the one after
- how many times से appears (twice)

Before you move on

Which option does नहीं deny? (The one before it.) How many से does the frame need? (Two — one per option.) What does the position of नहीं tell you in general? (How much of the sentence is being denied.)

102.6 se kī tālikā — five jobs, one word

Name two things से has done before this chapter, and the word that has now joined it.

Grammar Lens: everything से does

job	example
from a place	स्टेशन से
by a means	ट्रेन से
measured against	बच्चे से बड़ा
the start of a span	सोमवार से
one option in a correction	बस से नहीं

Five jobs and no change of form. से **never bends**, whatever it is doing and whatever stands in front of it — unlike का, which had to become के the moment another word followed.

The reason is worth keeping: का is a possessive and possessives agree, while से is a plain postposition and has nothing to agree with.

Grammar Lens: the partner, and where it stands

span	start	stop
days	सोमवार से	शुक्रवार तक
parts of a day	सुबह से	शाम तक
clock hours	दस बजे से	पाँच बजे तक

तक can stand alone — पाँच बजे तक needs no से. से can stand alone too. The pair is a choice, not a requirement.

Grammar Lens: the one place two से are compulsory

बस से नहीं, ट्रेन से।

English keeps one *by* and lets it cover both halves. Hindi gives each option its own से, because each option is a complete phrase in its own right and नहीं sits between two complete phrases rather than inside one. Count the से when you read a correction. Two means a swap is being offered; one means something else is going on.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक"
- "सुबह से शाम तक"

- “बस से नहीं, ट्रेन से”
- the number of jobs से now has (five)

Before you move on

Does से ever change its form? (No.) Does तक need से? (No.) How many से does a correction need? (Two.)

102.7 मैं ट्रेन से जाऊँगा — reading a correction in a paper

Say *I will do.* Then say the verb for going. The future ending you learned on one verb attaches to any stem, and this is the sentence that wants it.

The exchange

speaker	Hindi
A	आप बस से जाएँगे?
B	मैं बस से नहीं, ट्रेन से जाऊँगा।

B does two things at once: rejects A’s guess and supplies the replacement, in one sentence with one verb at the end of it.

How to answer

Find नहीं first. Everything before it is what is being denied; everything after it up to the verb is what replaces it.

Then check the count: **two से** means a swap. An item that asks *how will B travel* is answered by the phrase **after** the negative, and the commonest wrong answer is the phrase before it — which is exactly why the paper prints the rejected option first.

Grammar Lens: the chapter in one sentence

से marks a start and तक marks a stop, and between them they carry both a week and a working day:
मैं सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक ट्रेन से जाऊँगा।
Two से in that sentence, doing **different** jobs — the first opens a span,

the second names a means. Neither is a mistake, and telling them apart is a matter of looking for a तक further along.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "मैं बस से नहीं, ट्रेन से जाऊँगा"
- "मैं सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक ट्रेन से जाऊँगा"
- which phrase answers *how will B travel*
- how to tell a span से from a means से

Before you move on

Which side of नहीं holds the true answer? (The side after it.) What tells you a से opens a span? (A तक further along.) What is *by train*? (ट्रेन से.)

Chapter 103

What I Know and What I Want

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 👁 **eyes** (1) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say that I know something rather than only that I do not, ask somebody whether they know, and ask for a thing at a counter.
>
> *Answer the counter question aapko kyaa chaahiye with mujhe chaay chaahiye, and say which of the three words carries the information.*

103.1 मैं जानता हूँ — the half that was missing

Say *I do not know* — you have had that sentence since the chapter on नहीं. Now try to say the opposite of it.

You'll want to know: जानता

मैं जानता हूँ। — I know.

Nothing about that is new except the permission.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

You have been saying मैं नहीं जानता for a very long time. The negative lesson used it as its example sentence, and everything in it was explained except the last word.

what you had	what you have now
मैं नहीं जानता	मैं जानता हूँ

Take नहीं out and one thing has to come back: हूँ. A Hindi present needs its *to be* on the end, and the negative sentence dropped it — which is ordinary and which is why the affirmative does not look like the negative with a word removed.

The verb is जानना, and its ज is the letter drawn two chapters before this one. It was on the page long before that, inside जी and आज.

जानना comes from Sanskrit *jānāti*, "knows" (CDIAL 5193).

Grammar Lens: a word carried and never handed over

This is worth naming because it is a real gap and not a quirk of your memory. The negative lesson's **headword** names *jāntā* and glosses it as the masculine present of *to know* — but everything that lesson actually teaches is about नहीं: its Sanskrit root, its Indo-European cousins, its two jobs.

The word rode along in an example and was never handed over. You could deny knowing something and not claim it, which is a strange shape for a vocabulary to have.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "मैं जानता हूँ"
- "मैं नहीं जानता"
- which word comes back when the negative goes away
- the infinitive this form is built from

Before you move on

What is *I know*? (मैं जानता हूँ.) What did the negative version leave off? (हूँ.) Which half of this verb did you have first? (The denial.)

103.2 क्या आप जानते हैं? — asking it

Say *I know.* Then say the little word that turns a Hindi statement into a yes-or-no question.

You'll want to know: जानते हैं

क्या आप जानते हैं? — Do you know?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

Every piece is old and the assembly is regular:

piece	job
क्या	marks the whole thing as a question
आप	the respectful *you*
जानते	the verb, agreeing with आप
हैं	*to be*, also agreeing with आप

आप is grammatically plural, which is why both the verb and *to be* take their plural endings even when you are speaking to one person. That is not a new rule — it is the same respect-as-plural the track has used since the second chapter, turning up on a new verb.

जानना comes from Sanskrit *jānāti*, "knows" (CDIAL 5193).

Grammar Lens: where क्या sits

क्या goes at the **front**, and the rest of the sentence keeps its ordinary order behind it. English reshuffles a question — *you know* becomes *do you know* — and Hindi does not move anything at all.

So a yes-or-no question costs **one word and no rearrangement**, which makes it one of the cheapest things in the language to build once you can say the statement.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "क्या आप जानते हैं?"
- "मैं जानता हूँ" — the answer
- why the verb is जानते and not जानता
- where क्या stands in the sentence

Before you move on

What turns a statement into a yes-or-no question? (क्या, at the front.) Does anything else move? (No.) Why is आप followed by plural endings? (It is grammatically plural, however many people you mean.)

103.3 चाहिए — wanting a thing rather than an action

Say the verb for wanting, the one you met with सकना. Then try to use it to want a **cup of tea** rather than to want to *do* something.

You'll want to know: चाहिए

चाहिए — *is wanted, is needed.*

It is built from the same root as चाहना, and it does a job that verb cannot.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

form	what follows it
चाहता / चाहती	another **verb**
चाहिए	a **thing**

चाहना wants an action. It was taught alongside the rule that a Hindi verb can swallow another verb whole, and that is exactly what it does: *I want **to go***.

चाहिए wants a noun. *I want **tea***. English uses one word for both jobs and hides the difference; Hindi uses two forms and makes it visible.

The other difference is that **चाहिए does not change**. It has no masculine and feminine, no singular and plural — the same five letters whoever is speaking and whatever is wanted. After a chapter of endings that agree with everything in sight, that is a relief worth noticing.

चाहिए comes from a reconstructed **cāh*, "desire", whose source CDIAL calls uncertain (CDIAL 4775).

Grammar Lens: the ए on the end

The word ends in ए, the standing vowel drawn a few chapters back — not the sitting mark ◌े, because there is no consonant after हि for the vowel to ride on.
That is the rule from the letter lesson doing its first real work: **which of the two shapes a word uses is decided by whether a consonant is there to carry the vowel**, and a word ending in a vowel sound has nothing behind it.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “चाहिए”
- which of the two forms takes a thing after it
- which takes an action after it
- why the last letter is the standing ए

Before you move on

What does चाहिए take after it? (A thing.) What does चाहता take? (Another verb.) Does चाहिए change for gender or number? (No — never.)

103.4 मुझे चाय चाहिए — the wanter is not the subject

Say *I like tea* in Hindi. Look at the first word you said, and keep it in mind.

You’ll want to know: मुझे ... चाहिए

मुझे चाय चाहिए। — I want tea.
Not मैं. मुझे — *to me.*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

CDIAL lists *mujh*, “me”, under the Sanskrit first-person base *ma-* (CDIAL 9691), and *cāh*, “wish”, under a reconstructed **cāh*, “see, desire”, of uncertain source (CDIAL 4775).

The two words

This is the liking sentence again, with one word swapped:

Hindi	word for word
मुझे चाय पसंद है	to me, tea is pleasing
मुझे चाय चाहिए	to me, tea is wanted

The person is in the dative both times, and the thing is what the sentence is really about. Hindi treats wanting and liking as things that **happen to** you rather than things you **do**, and puts the person on the receiving end of both.

That is not a Hindi peculiarity. The proxy language reaches the same shape in *me gusta*, and Italian in *mi piace* — three languages in two unrelated families building the same idea the same way. What makes Hindi’s version worth a lesson is that चाहिए extends it to **wanting**, where those languages switch back to an ordinary verb.

Grammar Lens: what agrees with what

चाहिए does not change, so there is nothing to agree. The sentence has no word that bends, which is unusual enough to be a useful landmark: **if you hear चाहिए, stop looking for agreement.**
And मुझे carries झ, the breathy partner drawn a few chapters back. It was in your mouth from the liking chapter onwards and only recently on your hand.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “मुझे चाय चाहिए”
- “मुझे चाय पसंद है”
- which word is **not** मैं, and why

- what in the sentence agrees with anything (nothing)

Before you move on

What is *I want tea*? (मुझे चाय चाहिए.) Which case is the wanter in? (The dative — *to me*.) Which other sentence you know puts the person there? (The liking one.)

103.5 cāh kī tālikā — wanting, on one page

Name the two forms of the wanting verb, and say what each one wants after it.

Grammar Lens: one root, two forms

form	what follows	example
चाहता / चाहती	a **verb**	मैं जाना चाहता हूँ
चाहिए	a **thing**	मुझे चाय चाहिए

Ask what comes next, not what it means. Both translate into English as *want*, so the meaning will not tell the two apart — the shape of what follows will, every time.

Grammar Lens: who sits where

sentence	the person is
मैं जाना चाहता हूँ	मैं — the subject
मुझे चाय चाहिए	मुझे — the dative
मुझे चाय पसंद है	मुझे — the dative

Two of the three put the person on the receiving end, and the one that does not is the one where the person is genuinely doing something — going. **Wanting a thing and liking a thing happen to you; wanting to act is something you do**, and Hindi draws that line with the case of the first word.

Grammar Lens: the verb that was only ever denied

what you can now say	what you had before
मैं जानता हूँ	only मैं नहीं जानता
क्या आप जानते हैं?	nothing

The affirmative needed no new grammar at all — it needed somebody to introduce the word, which the negative lesson used and never taught.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- “मुझे चाय चाहिए”
- “मैं जानता हूँ”
- “क्या आप जानते हैं?”
- the question that tells the two wanting forms apart

Before you move on

Which wanting form takes a noun? (चाहिए.) Which case is its wanter in? (The dative.) Does चाहिए ever bend? (No.)

103.6 आपको क्या चाहिए? — answering at a counter

Say *to you* in its respectful form, and the word that marks a question. Both have been yours for a while.

The exchange

speaker	Hindi
A	आपको क्या चाहिए?
B	मुझे चाय चाहिए।

The two lines are the **same sentence with the person swapped** — आपको for मुझे — and क्या standing where the answer will go.

How to answer

A listening item built on this keys on **the noun between the two fixed words**. Everything else in B's reply is predictable:

1. The first word is the **dative person** — it tells you who, not what.
2. The last word is चाहिए — it never changes, so it carries no information.
3. **The answer is whatever sits between them.**

That is why the item is answerable even if the middle word is the only one you catch. Listen to the middle.

Grammar Lens: the chapter in one sentence

Hindi puts the person on the **receiving end** of wanting, and gives the wanting word **no endings at all** — so the sentence's whole meaning lives in the noun in the middle and the case of the word in front. **क्या आप जानते हैं?** works the other way round: there the endings do all the agreeing, because somebody is genuinely doing the knowing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- "आपको क्या चाहिए?"
- "मुझे चाय चाहिए"
- which word in the answer carries the information
- what changed between the question and the answer

Before you move on

Where in the answer is the information? (The noun in the middle.) What does चाहिए tell you? (Nothing — it never changes.) What replaces क्या when the question is answered? (The thing wanted.)

Chapter 104

Counting Past Twenty

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can count the tens from twenty to ninety, and say a price out loud.
>
> *Say pachaas rupaye, then tiis, chaaliis, sattar and sau rupaye, and say which of the two words carries the number.*

104.1 तीस चालीस — two rungs past where the counting stopped

> Count from ग्यारह to बीस. Then stop, because that is where your counting has ended until now.

You’ll want to know: तीस, चालीस

तीस (*tīs*) — thirty.
चालीस (*cālīs*) — forty.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तीस चालीस (*tīs cālīs*) is two tadbhavas, words inherited and reshaped by sound change. *tīs* comes from Sanskrit *triṁśat*, “thirty” (CDIAL 6015), and *cālīs* from *catvāriṁśat*, “forty” (CDIAL 4656).

Grammar Lens: the tens are the part worth learning

number	word
20	बीस
30	तीस
40	चालीस

Say those three in a row and the family resemblance is audible: –ीस at the end of all of them. It is the same ending, worn down from the same Sanskrit word for ten, and it will carry you as far as fifty.

तीन is three and तीस is thirty. चार is four and चालीस is forty. The openings are not identical to the small numbers, but they are close enough to hold on to, and that is the most help Hindi gives with numbers at this size.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- बीस, तीस, चालीस — three times, as a run
- the small number each of the two new words leans on
- the ending all three share

Before you move on

Which number is तीस? Which is चालीस? Which three of them so far end in the same sound?

104.2 पचास साठ — where the pattern stops helping

Say **बीस, तीस, चालीस**. Listen to the ending they share.

You'll want to know: पचास, साठ

पचास (*pacās*) — fifty.
साठ (*sāṭh*) — sixty.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पचास साठ (*pacās sāṭh*) is two tadbhavas, words inherited and reshaped by sound change. *pacās* comes from Sanskrit *pañcāśat*, “fifty” (CDIAL 7682), and *sāṭh* from *ṣaṣṭi*, “sixty” (CDIAL 12804).

Grammar Lens: one keeps the ending, one drops it

number	word	the shared ending
40	चालीस	yes
50	पचास	a worn version
60	साठ	gone

पचास still leans on पाँच, the five you have counted since the opening chapters, and it still carries a trace of that ending. साठ leans on छह and keeps nothing else.

That is the shape of the rest of this chapter: the words get less helpful as the numbers get bigger. Knowing that in advance is worth more than a rule that would not hold.

पचास is the one to hold on to hardest. It is the price on a tea stall sign and the age of somebody’s father, and it is the most common of the four so far.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- बीस, तीस, चालीस, पचास, साठ — the whole run
- which of the five keeps least of the shared ending
- the small number पचास leans on

Before you move on

Which number is पचास? Which is साठ? Which of the two still sounds like the ending you have been hearing?

104.3 सत्तर अस्सी नब्बे — the last three rungs

Say पचास and साठ. One of them kept the old ending and one dropped it.

You’ll want to know: सत्तर, अस्सी, नब्बे

सत्तर (*sattar*) — seventy.
अस्सी (*assī*) — eighty.
नब्बे (*nabbe*) — ninety.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सत्तर अस्सी नब्बे (*sattar assī nabbe*) is three tadbhavas. *sattar* comes from Sanskrit *saptati*, “seventy” (CDIAL 13143), *assī* from *aśīti*, “eighty” (CDIAL 911), and *nabbe* from *navati*, “ninety” (CDIAL 6995).

Grammar Lens: each one leans on a number you already count

small number	ten times it
सात	सत्तर
आठ	अस्सी
नौ	नब्बे

Go down the left of that table and you are counting seven, eight, nine — which you have done since early on. Go down the right and you are counting seventy, eighty, ninety.

The opening consonant survives in all three, and that is the whole of the help on offer. Beyond the first sound, each word has been worn into its own shape and has to be met as a word.

Say the pairs across, one after another: *sāt, sattar. āṭh, assī. nau, nabbe.* Hearing them together is what makes them stick.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- सात — सत्तर, आठ — अस्सी, नौ — नब्बे, as three pairs
- the whole run from बीस to नब्बे
- what the three new words keep from their small numbers

Before you move on

Which number is सत्तर? Which is अस्सी? Which is नब्बे? Which small number does each one lean on?

104.4 गिनती की तालिका — eight rungs, and what sits between them

Say the last of the three words you met, the one for ninety.

Grammar Lens: the ladder

number	word
20	बीस
30	तीस
40	चालीस
50	पचास
60	साठ
70	सत्तर
80	अस्सी
90	नब्बे

Eight words, on top of the hundred you already say. Every price, every age and every house number you are likely to meet sits on or between them.

Grammar Lens: what sits between them

Here is the honest part, and it is better to hear it than to guess wrong. **Hindi puts the small number first.** Twenty-five is *five-twenty*: पच्चीस (*paccīs*) opens with the sound of पाँच. Twenty-two is बाईस (*bāīs*) and opens with दो's vowel.

That order is the opposite of English, and it is the one thing about the in-between numbers a learner can rely on.

What a learner cannot rely on is reassembling them. पच्चीस is not पाँच and बीस stuck together in any way you could work out from the pieces — the two halves have worn into each other. Each of the numbers between the rungs is its own word, and they are met one at a time, over a long while.

So: **recognise** the shape, know the small number is in front, and learn the rungs cold. That is the part that pays.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the eight rungs in order, without stopping

- them backwards, from नब्बे down to बीस
- which end of पच्चीस holds the small number

Before you move on

How many rungs did this chapter add? Which comes first in पच्चीस, the five or the twenty? Can you build twenty-five out of its two pieces? (No — it has to be learned as a word.)

104.5 पचास रुपये — a price, said out loud

Say the word for a rupee. You learned where its name came from — a piece of metal that has been given a shape.

Grammar Lens: put the two together

पचास रुपये — *fifty rupees.*

Number first, then the thing. That is the whole construction, and you have both halves already: the number arrived in this chapter and the rupee arrived a long way back.

रुपये rather than रुपया, because more than one is being counted. That bend is the same one the track has been making since the adjectives, and it costs nothing new here.

Grammar Lens: the prices you can now read

said	**meaning**
तीस रुपये	thirty rupees
चालीस रुपये	forty rupees
पचास रुपये	fifty rupees
सत्तर रुपये	seventy rupees
सौ रुपये	a hundred rupees

Five prices, and between them most of what a tea stall, a bus fare or a bag of vegetables will ask of you.

This is what the counting was for. A number on its own is a recitation; a number in front of a thing is a price, an age or an address, and that is where the nine rungs stop being a list and start being useful.

Your turn

- *Say it:* पचास रुपये
- *Say it:* तीस रुपये, चालीस रुपये, सत्तर रुपये, then सौ रुपये
- *Say it:* why the last word is रुपये rather than रुपया
- *Listen:* for the number first and the thing second

Before you move on

How do you say *fifty rupees*? Which comes first, the number or the thing? Which form does the rupee take when it is counted?

Chapter 105

Speaking to Somebody

Modes: **voice** (3) **eyes** (1) **pen** (2) **Hands-free start:** the first 3 of 6 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can address somebody by name, in speech and on paper, and write a short message to a named reader.
>
> *Write the whole message to a named reader from a purpose cue alone: the opening line that names them, two sentences underneath, and your own name at the foot.*

105.1 मीरा जी — putting a name in front of somebody

> Say the small word you learned that turns a bare हाँ into a polite one.

You’ll want to know: मीरा जी

मीरा जी (*Mīrā jī*) — how you address somebody called Mira.
A name, then **जी**. That is the whole of it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मीरा जी (*Mīrā jī*) puts the respectful *jī* after a name. CDIAL traces *jī*, “a word of assent or respect”, to Sanskrit *jīva*, “long live!”, the command form of *jīvati*, “lives” (CDIAL 5240).

Grammar Lens: the word you already had, in a new position

what you say	what it does
जी हाँ	makes a yes polite
मीरा जी	makes a name an address

जी has been in your mouth since the early chapters, doing politeness work after a yes. Behind a name it does the same work in a different place: it turns somebody being *talked about* into somebody being *talked to*.

Hindi has no separate ending for this the way some languages do. **The position is the grammar** — the name comes first, जी follows it, and nothing else in the sentence changes.

It works for anybody you would use आप with, which is most people you have not known since childhood. With a close friend or a child, the bare name on its own is the ordinary thing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- मीरा जी
- अरुण जी
- which of the two words carries the respect
- what changes in the rest of the sentence (nothing)

Before you move on

How do you address somebody called Mira? Which word goes first, the name or जी? Where had you met जी before this?

105.2 प्रिय — the word a letter starts with

Address somebody called Mira out loud. Today's word does the same work on the page.

You'll want to know: प्रिय

प्रिय (*priya*) — *dear*.

It goes **before** the name: प्रिय मीरा.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

प्रिय (*priya*) is Sanskrit *priya*, "beloved", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 8974). CDIAL lists the inherited forms of the same word, such as *piyā*, "beloved".

Grammar Lens: the opposite side of the name

written	**said**
प्रिय मीरा	मीरा जी

One goes in front and one goes behind, which is worth noticing because it is the kind of thing a reader gets backwards once and then remembers. प्रिय is an adjective describing the person, so it leads; जी is an honorific attached to them, so it follows.

प्रिय belongs to writing. Saying it to somebody's face is the sort of thing that would make them look up. A note, a card or a letter is where it lives, and that is the one place this chapter is heading.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- प्रिय मीरा
- the spoken version of the same address
- which of the two words comes before the name

Before you move on

What does प्रिय mean? Which side of the name does it sit on? Is it for speaking or for writing?

105.3 संबोधन — two openings, one question to pick between them

Say the word a written message opens with, and say which side of the name it sits on.

Grammar Lens: the two side by side

where	what you say or write
out loud	मीरा जी
on paper	प्रिय मीरा

One question chooses between them: **are you speaking or writing?** Answer it and the opening is decided, along with which side of the name the extra word goes on.

Grammar Lens: what the two have in common

Neither of them changes the sentence that follows. Hindi marks address by putting a word beside the name rather than bending anything, so whatever you were going to say stays exactly as it was and the opening sits in front of it.

That is worth holding on to, because a great deal of what this track has taught you does the opposite. Endings agree, vowels shorten, verbs bend for who is speaking. **Address is the corner of the grammar that asks nothing of the rest of the sentence.**

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the opening for somebody called Arun, out loud
- the opening for a note to Arun
- which of the two puts its extra word after the name
- what changes in the sentence after the opening (nothing)

Before you move on

Which question picks the opening for you? Which of the two belongs to the page rather than the mouth? What does the rest of the sentence do when an opening is added? (Nothing.)

105.4 प्रिय मीरा — a page with somebody at the top of it

Say the written opening for a reader called Mira. Then recall the upright stroke that closes a Hindi sentence.

Writing: the three parts, with the model in front of you

A short Hindi message has three parts stacked down the page:

प्रिय मीरा,

नमस्ते। कल मिलते हैं।

— अरुण

Copy it once, keeping the three parts on their three lines.

Every word of that is something you have written before. **What is new is the arrangement** — two sentences you could already produce, lifted onto a page that now has a reader at the top of it and a writer at the bottom.

Grammar Lens: why the opening earns its own line

part	what it carries
प्रिय मीरा,	who is being written to
नमस्ते। कल मिलते हैं।	what is being said
— अरुण	who is writing

The opening is not a sentence and takes no । after it. A comma does that work, which is the one piece of punctuation here that behaves the way English punctuation does.

The two sentences underneath keep their । each. Being inside a message leaves the end of a Hindi sentence exactly as it was.

Before you move on

What are the three parts of a message? Which of them takes a comma rather than a ।? Who goes at the foot of the page?

105.5 No model — a whole message to a named reader

Close the preceding lesson. Wait ten seconds. Name the three parts of a message to yourself without looking at them.

Writing: produce the message from the cue alone

There is no Devanagari model and no romanized answer below. Keep only this cue:

> **Write to Arun. Greet him, then say you will meet tomorrow. Put your own practice name at the foot.**

Write all three parts from memory. Then compare in four separate passes:

1. three parts present, in order;
2. the comma after the opening and one । after each sentence;
3. spelling and vowel marks;
4. the name at the foot.

Choose the first differing pass, repair only that dimension, and stop.

Before you move on

Which part of a message names the reader? Which takes a comma rather than a ।? Whose name sits at the foot?
This is the short message the A1 writing task asks for in outline. It is not a timed mock, and its length is well under what that task sets.

105.6 (स, ऋ, चादर, खाना) — the last page, and a second look at ten things

Two characters, cold. Read स, then ऋ, and name the sound each one carries.

What you've built, and what this page does with it

Everything here has appeared twice in your reading: once where it was taught, and once on a retrieval page in this final stretch. A second pass is where memory starts holding without the book, and the widest gap on offer runs from the opening pages to this one.

Script: स and ऋ — one you read, one you also draw

स is *sa*, carrying the built-in short vowel every bare consonant has. You have read it inside words since the early script pages without once being asked to name it alone.

ऋ differs in two ways. It is an **independent vowel** — a full-size letter, for a vowel with no consonant to sit on — and your hand has to produce it, not only your eye. It sounds like *ri* in modern Hindi, and it opens ऋतु, *season*.

- *Read it:* स, and name the vowel inside it
- *Write it:* ऋ, without looking back at this line

You'll want to know: चादर, and the two meals

what you want	the Hindi	how it is put together
a sheet	चादर	one Persian word, taken whole
lunch	दोपहर का खाना	the afternoon's food
dinner	रात का खाना	the night's food

Say the bottom two aloud rather than reading them. Their difficulty was never vocabulary — every piece was yours already — but assembly at speed, when somebody asks what you ate.

The exchange — four of them, unprompted

The book opened with four, and an examiner opens with the same four:

1. the greeting, and the answer to a thank-you
2. the name trade, both sides, ending with the pleased-to-meet-you
3. the how-are-you, and a reply that returns it
4. the close — the final farewell, the warm one, or the casual one

No cue beyond those labels. Run each one whole, out loud, both parts.

Your turn

Page covered.

- *Say it:* the two named meals, in either order
- *Say it:* the word for a sheet
- *Write it:* ऋ
- *Read it:* स, and name it
- *Say it:* exchange 2 above, both sides
- *Say it:* exchange 3 above, both sides
- *Say it:* exchange 1, then exchange 4, back to back

Before you move on

Which of the two characters here is a vowel that stands on its own, and which meal is दोपहर का खाना? (ऋ; lunch.) Write ऋ one last time, then close the book.

Chapter 106

Not Feeling Well

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am tired, have a cold or a cough, or am ill, and ask how someone is feeling.
>
> *Complete HI-C106-tabiyat: say what is wrong and ask how someone feels.*

106.1 थकान (thakān) — tiredness

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a fever, then the Hindi for pain.

You’ll want to know: थकान

थकान (*thakān*) — “tiredness”.

आज बहुत थकान है — “I am very tired today”, literally “today there is a lot of tiredness”. The बहुत and आज are both yours already.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

थकान (*thakān*) is built on *thaknā*, “to get tired”, with the ending -*ān*. CDIAL lists *thaknā* under a reconstructed **sthakk*, “stop, halt”, and calls its link with *sthā*-, “to stand”, probable but not clear (CDIAL 13737).

What you’ve built

A first word for how the body feels at the end of a day.

Your turn

- *Say it: thakān*
- *Say it: thakān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āj bahut thakān hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a fever, then the Hindi for pain, then say *thakān* again

Before you move on

What does **थकान** mean? (“Tiredness”.) Say it once more.

106.2 ज़ुकाम (zukām) — a cold, a runny nose

Before the new one: say the Hindi for pain, then the Hindi for tiredness.

You’ll want to know: ज़ुकाम

ज़ुकाम (*zukām*) — “a cold”, the kind with a runny nose.

मुझे ज़ुकाम है — “I have a cold”, literally “to me there is a cold”. The person sits in **मुझे**, as in **मुझे चाय चाहिए**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ज़ुकाम (*zukām*) is a loan from Arabic *zukām*, “a cold, catarrh”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *z-k-m* (Lane).

What you’ve built

An illness, in the to-me frame you already use for wanting.

Your turn

- *Say it: zukām*
- *Say it: zukām*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe zukām hai*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for pain, then the Hindi for tiredness, then say *zukām* again

Before you move on

What does ज़ुकाम mean? (“A cold, a runny nose”.) Say it once more.

106.3 खाँसी (khā̃sī) — a cough

Before the new one: say the Hindi for tiredness, then the Hindi for a cold.

You’ll want to know: खाँसी

खाँसी (*khā̃sī*) — “a cough”. It is feminine.
मुझे खाँसी है — “I have a cough”. Same frame, new word in the middle.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खाँसी (*khāṁsī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kāsa*, “cough” (CDIAL 3138). CDIAL notes the *kh-* as imitating the sound.

What you’ve built

A second complaint in the same frame.

Your turn

- *Say it: khā̃sī*
- *Say it: khā̃sī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe khā̃sī hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for tiredness, then the Hindi for a cold, then say *khā̃sī* again

Before you move on

What does खाँसी mean? (“A cough”.) Say it once more.

106.4 बीमार (bīmār) — ill, sick

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cold, then the Hindi for a cough.

You'll want to know: बीमार

बीमार (*bīmār*) — "ill, sick".

मैं बीमार हूँ — "I am ill". This one describes you, so it takes **मैं … हूँ**, not **मुझे**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बीमार (*bīmār*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *bīmār*, "ill, sick".

What you've built

The difference between having an illness and being ill.

Your turn

- *Say it: bīmār*
- *Say it: bīmār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maiṁ bīmār hūṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cold, then the Hindi for a cough, then say *bīmār* again

Before you move on

What does बीमार mean? ("Ill, sick".) Say it once more.

106.5 तबीयत (tabīyat) — health, how one is feeling

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cough, then the Hindi for ill.

You’ll want to know: तबीयत

तबीयत (*tabīyat*) — “how one is feeling”, one’s health on the day.

आपकी तबीयत कैसी है? — “how are you feeling?”, the question to ask someone who has been ill. तबीयत ठीक नहीं है — “I am not well”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तबीयत (*tabīyat*) is a loan from Arabic *ṭabī^{c}a*, “nature, temperament”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṭ-b-^{c}* (Lane).

What you’ve built

The question after how are you, when you know someone has been unwell.

Your turn

- *Say it: tabīyat*
- *Say it: tabīyat*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *āpkī tabīyat kaisī hai?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cough, then the Hindi for ill, then say *tabīyat* again

Before you move on

What does तबीयत mean? (“Health, how one is feeling”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 107

At the Doctor

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5)   🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk to a doctor, find a hospital, say I am hurt or feel weak, and talk about health.
>
> *Complete HI-C107-sehat: a visit to the doctor, from injury to health.*

107.1 डाक्टर (ḍākṭar) — a doctor

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for ill, then the Hindi for how one is feeling.

You’ll want to know: डाक्टर

डाक्टर (*ḍākṭar*) — “a doctor”, English borrowed whole.

डाक्टर कहाँ हैं? — “where is the doctor?”, with the respectful plural **हैं** for a person you are asking after.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डाक्टर (*ḍākṭar*) is a loan from English *doctor*.

What you’ve built

The person to ask for.

Your turn

- *Say it: ḍākṭar*
- *Say it: ḍākṭar*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *ḍākṭar kahā̃ haiṁ?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for ill, then the Hindi for how one is feeling, then say *ḍākṭar* again

Before you move on

What does डाक्टर mean? (“A doctor”.) Say it once more.

107.2 अस्पताल (aspatāl) — a hospital

Before the new one: say the Hindi for how one is feeling, then the Hindi for a doctor.

You’ll want to know: अस्पताल

अस्पताल (*aspatāl*) — “a hospital”.

It is English *hospital*, reshaped to fit Hindi sounds. **अस्पताल कहाँ है?** — “where is the hospital?”

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अस्पताल (*aspatāl*) is a loan from English *hospital*.

What you’ve built

A place to ask the way to when it matters.

Your turn

- *Say it: aspatāl*
- *Say it: aspatāl*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *aspatāl kahā̃ hai?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for how one is feeling, then the Hindi for a doctor, then say *aspatāl* again

Before you move on

What does अस्पताल mean? (“A hospital”.) Say it once more.

107.3 चोट (coṭ) — an injury, a hurt

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a doctor, then the Hindi for a hospital.

You’ll want to know: चोट

चोट (*coṭ*) — “an injury, a hurt”. It is feminine.
मुझे चोट लगी है — “I have been hurt”, literally “a hurt has struck me”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चोट (*coṭ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *cuṭati*, “cuts off” (CDIAL 4857). CDIAL reconstructs a further sense, “strikes”, and a variant **coṭṭ-*, and takes the group to be of non-Aryan origin.

What you’ve built

A way to say you are hurt.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *coṭ*
- *Say it:* *coṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe coṭ lagī hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a doctor, then the Hindi for a hospital, then say *coṭ* again

Before you move on

What does चोट mean? (“An injury, a hurt”.) Say it once more.

107.4 कमज़ोरी (kamzorī) — weakness

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a hospital, then the Hindi for an injury.

You'll want to know: कमज़ोरी

कमज़ोरी (*kamzorī*) — "weakness".

It opens on the कम you know, "little": weakness is having little strength.

कमज़ोरी लग रही है — "I feel weak".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कमज़ोरी (*kamzorī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kamzor*, "weak". It is built from *kam*, "little", and *zor*, "strength", with -*ī* making a noun.

What you've built

Weakness, built on a word you know.

Your turn

- *Say it: kamzorī*
- *Say it: kamzorī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kamzorī lag rahī hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a hospital, then the Hindi for an injury, then say *kamzorī* again

Before you move on

What does कमज़ोरी mean? ("Weakness".) Say it once more.

107.5 सेहत (sehat) — health, fitness

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an injury, then the Hindi for weakness.

You’ll want to know: सेहत

सेहत (*sehat*) — “health”, the long-term kind.

तबीयत is how you feel today; सेहत is how healthy you are. सेहत अच्छी है — “the health is good”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सेहत (*sehat*) is a loan from Arabic *ṣiḥḥa*, “health, soundness”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṣ-ḥ-ḥ* (Lane).

What you’ve built

A doctor, a hospital, an injury, weakness, and health itself.

Your turn

- *Say it: sehat*
- *Say it: sehat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sehat acchī hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an injury, then the Hindi for weakness, then say *sehat* again

Before you move on

What does सेहत mean? (“Health, fitness”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 108

Fear, Anger, Sadness

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am afraid, angry, sad or troubled, and tell someone not to worry.
>
> *Complete HI-C108-chinta: name a feeling and answer someone else's.*

108.1 डर (ḍar) — fear

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for weakness, then the Hindi for health.

You'll want to know: डर

डर (*ḍar*) — "fear".
मुझे डर लग रहा है — "I am scared", literally "fear is striking me". Feelings take the मुझे frame.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डर (*ḍar*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *dara*, "fear" (CDIAL 6186).

What you've built

The first feeling.

Your turn

- *Say it: ḍar*
- *Say it: ḍar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe ḍar lag rahā hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for weakness, then the Hindi for health, then say *ḍar* again

Before you move on

What does डर mean? (“Fear”.) Say it once more.

108.2 गुस्सा (gussā) — anger

Before the new one: say the Hindi for health, then the Hindi for fear.

You’ll want to know: गुस्सा

गुस्सा (*gussā*) — “anger”.

मुझे गुस्सा आया — “I got angry”, literally “anger came to me”, on the आना you know.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गुस्सा (*gussā*) is a loan from Arabic *ghuṣṣa*, “a choking; grief”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *gh-ṣ-ṣ* (Lane). In Hindi it came to mean “anger”.

What you’ve built

A feeling that comes to you.

Your turn

- *Say it: gussā*
- *Say it: gussā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe gussā āyā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for health, then the Hindi for fear, then say *gussā* again

Before you move on

What does गुस्सा mean? (“Anger”.) Say it once more.

108.3 उदास (udās) — sad

Before the new one: say the Hindi for fear, then the Hindi for anger.

You’ll want to know: उदास

उदास (*udās*) — “sad”.
मैं उदास हूँ — “I am sad”. Like **बीमार**, it describes you, so it takes **मैं … हूँ**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उदास (*udās*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *udāsa*, “indifference”, from *ud-ās-*, “to sit apart”. CDIAL does not list it.

What you’ve built

An honest answer on a bad day.

Your turn

- *Say it: udās*
- *Say it: udās*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maiṁ udās hūṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for fear, then the Hindi for anger, then say *udās* again

Before you move on

What does उदास mean? (“Sad”.) Say it once more.

108.4 परेशान (pareśān) — troubled, bothered

Before the new one: say the Hindi for anger, then the Hindi for sad.

You'll want to know: परेशान

परेशान (*pareśān*) — "troubled, bothered, upset".
आप परेशान क्यों हैं? — "why are you upset?", with the क्यों you know.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

परेशान (*pareśān*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *parēshān*, "scattered; distressed".

What you've built

A question to ask a friend who looks upset.

Your turn

- *Say it: pareśān*
- *Say it: pareśān*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *āp pareśān kyoṁ haiṁ?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for anger, then the Hindi for sad, then say *pareśān* again

Before you move on

What does परेशान mean? ("Troubled, bothered".) Say it once more.

108.5 चिंता (cintā) — worry

Before the new one: say the Hindi for sad, then the Hindi for troubled.

You’ll want to know: चिंता

चिंता (*cintā*) — “worry”. It is feminine.
चिंता मत कीजिए — “don’t worry”, with the मत that forbids.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चिंता (*cintā*) is Sanskrit *cintā*, “thought, care”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 4816).

What you’ve built

Fear, anger, sadness, trouble, and a way to calm them.

Your turn

- *Say it: cintā*
- *Say it: cintā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cintā mat kījie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sad, then the Hindi for troubled, then say *cintā* again

Before you move on

What does चिंता mean? (“Worry”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 109

Laughter and Tears

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about laughter and tears, sorrow, being alone, and something cold to drink.
>
> *Complete HI-C109-thanda: moods, and one plain comfort.*

109.1 हँसी (hãsī) — laughter

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for troubled, then the Hindi for worry.

You’ll want to know: हँसी

हँसी (*hãsī*) — “laughter”. It is feminine.

मुझे हँसी आ गई — “I burst out laughing”, literally “laughter came to me”, like anger.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हँसी (*hãsī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *hasita*, “laughter” (CDIAL 14023).

What you’ve built

Laughter, which comes to you like anger does.

Your turn

- *Say it: hãsī*
- *Say it: hãsī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe hãsī ā gaī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for troubled, then the Hindi for worry, then say *hãsī* again

Before you move on

What does हँसी mean? (“Laughter”.) Say it once more.

109.2 आँसू (ā̃sū) — tears

Before the new one: say the Hindi for worry, then the Hindi for laughter.

You’ll want to know: आँसू

आँसू (*ā̃sū*) — “tears”, a teardrop.

आँख is the eye you know; आँसू is what it sheds. Both open on the same nasal आँ.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आँसू (*āṁsū*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *aśru*, “tear” (CDIAL 919). CDIAL notes that the word took a nasal vowel early, as the word for “eye” did.

What you’ve built

Tears, beside the eye.

Your turn

- *Say it: ā̃sū*
- *Say it: ā̃sū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ā̃sū*, then *ā̃kh*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for worry, then the Hindi for laughter, then say *ā̃sū* again

Before you move on

What does आँसू mean? (“Tears”.) Say it once more.

109.3 दुख (dukh) — sorrow, grief

Before the new one: say the Hindi for laughter, then the Hindi for tears.

You’ll want to know: दुख

दुख (*dukh*) — “sorrow, grief”.

मुझे दुख है — “I am sorry”, said in sympathy, when someone tells you bad news. It is not the माफ़ कीजिए of an apology.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दुख (*dukh*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *duḥkha*, “difficulty, pain” (CDIAL 6375). CDIAL notes that *duḥkha* was formed after *sukha*, “ease”.

What you’ve built

The sympathy sorry, apart from the apology sorry.

Your turn

- *Say it: dukh*
- *Say it: dukh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe dukh hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for laughter, then the Hindi for tears, then say *dukh* again

Before you move on

What does दुख mean? (“Sorrow, grief”.) Say it once more.

109.4 अकेला (akelā) — alone

Before the new one: say the Hindi for tears, then the Hindi for sorrow.

You'll want to know: अकेला

अकेला (*akelā*) — "alone". A woman says अकेली.
मैं अकेला हूँ — "I am alone". It opens on एक, "one", worn down.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अकेला (*akelā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ekkala*, "alone", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 2506). It is built on *eka*, "one".

What you've built

Alone, from the word for one.

Your turn

- *Say it: akelā*
- *Say it: akelā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maiṁ akelā hūṁ*, then *maiṁ akelī hūṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for tears, then the Hindi for sorrow, then say *akelā* again

Before you move on

What does अकेला mean? ("Alone".) Say it once more.

109.5 ठंडा (ṭhaṇḍā) — cold, cool

Before the new one: say the Hindi for sorrow, then the Hindi for alone.

You'll want to know: ठंडा

ठंडा (*ṭhaṇḍā*) — "cold, cool", of a thing.

ठंडा पानी — "cold water", the first comfort offered to a guest on a hot day.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ठंडा (*ṭhaṇḍā*) comes from a reconstructed **ṭhaṇḍha*, "cold", which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *stabdha*, "stiff, solidified", tracing the sense from "firm" through "sluggish" to "cold" (CDIAL 13676). DEDR compares Dravidian words for "cool", such as Tamil *taṇ* (DEDR 3045).

What you've built

Laughter, tears, sorrow, alone, and something cold to drink.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭhaṇḍā*
- *Say it: ṭhaṇḍā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭhaṇḍā pānī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sorrow, then the Hindi for alone, then say *ṭhaṇḍā* again

Before you move on

What does ठंडा mean? ("Cold, cool".) Say it once more.

Chapter 110

Once More, Please

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask someone to say it again or louder, to wait a minute, and what something means.
>
> *Complete HI-C110-matlab: keep a conversation going when you cannot follow it.*

110.1 दोबारा (dobārā) — again, a second time

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for alone, then the Hindi for cold.

You'll want to know: दोबारा

दोबारा (*dobārā*) — "again, a second time".
दोबारा बोलिए — "please say it again". It is दो, "two", and बार, "a time".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दोबारा (*dobārā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *dobāra*, "twice, a second time". It is built from *do*, "two", and *bār*, "a time".

What you've built

The repair a beginner needs most.

Your turn

- *Say it: dobārā*
- *Say it: dobārā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dobārā bolie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for alone, then the Hindi for cold, then say *dobārā* again

Before you move on

What does दोबारा mean? (“Again, a second time”.) Say it once more.

110.2 ज़ोर से (zor se) — loudly

Before the new one: say the Hindi for cold, then the Hindi for again.

You’ll want to know: ज़ोर से

ज़ोर से (*zor se*) — “loudly”, literally “with force”.

थोड़ा ज़ोर से बोलिए — “please speak a little louder”, with the softening थोड़ा.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ज़ोर से (*zor se*) is *zor*, “force”, with *se*, “with”. *zor* is usually traced to Persian *zōr*, “strength”; *se* is inherited (CDIAL 13310).

What you’ve built

Again, and louder.

Your turn

- *Say it: zor se*
- *Say it: zor se*, once more
- *Say it:* say *thoṛā zor se bolie*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for cold, then the Hindi for again, then say *zor se* again

Before you move on

What does ज़ोर से mean? (“Loudly”.) Say it once more.

110.3 एक मिनट (ek minaṭ) — one minute, a moment

Before the new one: say the Hindi for again, then the Hindi for loudly.

You’ll want to know: एक मिनट

एक मिनट (*ek minaṭ*) — “one minute”, said the way English says “a moment”. English *minute*, borrowed, after the एक you count with.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

एक मिनट (*ek minaṭ*) is *ek*, “one”, from Sanskrit *eka* (CDIAL 2462), and *minaṭ*, English *minute*.

What you’ve built

A way to buy time while you find the word.

Your turn

- *Say it: ek minaṭ*
- *Say it: ek minaṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ek minaṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for again, then the Hindi for loudly, then say *ek minaṭ* again

Before you move on

What does एक मिनट mean? (“One minute, a moment”.) Say it once more.

110.4 रुकिए (rukie) — please wait, please stop

Before the new one: say the Hindi for loudly, then the Hindi for one minute.

You’ll want to know: रुकिए

रुकिए (*rukie*) — “please wait”, “please stop”.

रुक (*ruk*, the stem of the verb “to stop”) + *-ie*, the respectful ending of बोलिए → रुकिए. **रुकिए, एक मिनट** — “wait, one minute”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रुकिए (*rukie*) is the verb *ruknā*, “to stop”, with the respectful ending *-ie*. CDIAL lists *ruknā* under a reconstructed **rokk*, “stop”, whose link with Sanskrit *rudh-*, “to obstruct”, it calls not clear (CDIAL 10827).

What you’ve built

Wait, one minute, again, louder.

Your turn

- *Say it: rukie*
- *Say it: rukie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rukie, ek minaṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for loudly, then the Hindi for one minute, then say *rukie* again

Before you move on

What does रुकिए mean? (“Please wait, please stop”.) Say it once more.

110.5 मतलब (matlab) — meaning

Before the new one: say the Hindi for one minute, then the Hindi for please wait.

You'll want to know: मतलब

मतलब (*matlab*) — "meaning".

धीरे का मतलब क्या है? — "what does *dhīre* mean?". Put any word in front of **का मतलब क्या है?** and it becomes the question that turns any speaker into a teacher.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मतलब (*matlab*) is a loan from Arabic *maṭlab*, "something sought, an aim", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṭ-l-b* (Lane). Hindi uses it for what a word aims at: its meaning.

What you've built

Again, louder, one minute, wait, what does it mean.

Your turn

- *Say it: matlab*
- *Say it: matlab*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *dhīre kā matlab kyā hai?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for one minute, then the Hindi for please wait, then say *matlab* again

Before you move on

What does **मतलब** mean? ("Meaning".) Say it once more.

Chapter 111

How Do You Say It?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask how to say something in Hindi, ask to be shown or to have it written down, and say I could not hear.
>
> *Complete HI-C111-likh-dijie: a learner's toolkit of questions.*

111.1 हिंदी में (hindī meṁ) — in Hindi

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for please wait, then the Hindi for meaning.

You'll want to know: हिंदी में

हिंदी में (*hindī meṁ*) — "in Hindi".

It is में, "in", the word you met on रहना, after the name of the language.
अंग्रेज़ी में — "in English".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हिंदी में (*hindī meṁ*) is *hindī* with *meṁ*, "in". *hindī* is usually traced to Persian *hindī*, "of Hind", the land beyond the Indus; *meṁ* comes from Sanskrit *madhye*, "in, among", a form of *madhya*, "middle" (CDIAL 9804).

What you've built

A way to name the language you want an answer in.

Your turn

- *Say it: hindī meṁ*
- *Say it: hindī meṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hindī meṁ*, then *aṅgrezī meṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for please wait, then the Hindi for meaning, then say *hindī meṁ* again

Before you move on

What does हिंदी में mean? ("In Hindi".) Say it once more.

111.2 कैसे कहते हैं? (kaise kahte haiṁ?) — how do you say it?

Before the new one: say the Hindi for meaning, then the Hindi for in Hindi.

You'll want to know: कैसे कहते हैं?

कैसे कहते हैं? (*kaise kahte haiṁ?*) — "how does one say it?".

हिंदी में 'book' कैसे कहते हैं? — "how do you say 'book' in Hindi?". **कहना** is "to say".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

kahnā, "to say", comes from Sanskrit *kathayati*, "converses with, describes" (CDIAL 2703).

What you've built

The one question that lets you learn from anyone.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaise kahte haiṁ?*
- *Say it: kaise kahte haiṁ?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *hindī meṁ 'book' kaise kahte haiṁ?*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for meaning, then the Hindi for in Hindi, then say *kaise kahte haiṁ?* again

Before you move on

What does कैसे कहते हैं? mean? (“How do you say it?”.) Say it once more.

111.3 दिखाइए (dikhāie) — please show me

Before the new one: say the Hindi for in Hindi, then the Hindi for how do you say it.

You’ll want to know: दिखाइए

दिखाइए (*dikhāie*) — “please show me”.

It is built on देखना, “to see”: to show is to *make someone see.*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दिखाइए (*dikhāie*) is *dikhānā*, “to show”, the causing form of देखना, “to see”, with the respectful ending *-ie*. CDIAL traces the “see” verbs to a reconstructed **dṛkṣati*, “sees” (CDIAL 6507).

What you’ve built

A request for when words run out.

Your turn

- *Say it: dikhāie*
- *Say it: dikhāie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dikhāie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for in Hindi, then the Hindi for how do you say it, then say *dikhāie* again

Before you move on

What does दिखाइए mean? (“Please show me”.) Say it once more.

111.4 सुनाई नहीं दिया (sunāī nahīṁ diyā) — I could not hear it

Before the new one: say the Hindi for how do you say it, then the Hindi for please show me.

You'll want to know: सुनाई नहीं दिया

सुनाई नहीं दिया (*sunāī nahīṁ diyā*) — "I could not hear it", literally "hearing was not given".

It is built on सुनना, "to hear". Pair it with a fix: ज़ोर से बोलिए.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुनाई नहीं दिया (*sunāī nahīṁ diyā*) is *sunāī*, "hearing", *nahīṁ*, "not", and *diyā*, "gave". *sunāī* is built on *sunnā*, "to hear", from Sanskrit *śṛṇoti*, "hears" (CDIAL 12598); CDIAL lists *diyā* under *datta*, "given" (CDIAL 6140).

What you've built

An honest reason to ask again.

Your turn

- *Say it: sunāī nahīṁ diyā*
- *Say it: sunāī nahīṁ diyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sunāī nahīṁ diyā, zor se bolie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for how do you say it, then the Hindi for please show me, then say *sunāī nahīṁ diyā* again

Before you move on

What does सुनाई नहीं दिया mean? ("I could not hear it".) Say it once more.

111.5 लिख दीजिए (likh dījie) — please write it down

Before the new one: say the Hindi for please show me, then the Hindi for I could not hear it.

You’ll want to know: लिख दीजिए

लिख दीजिए (*likh dījie*) — “please write it down (for me)”.

लिखना is “to write”; दीजिए adds “for me”, as in एक चाय दीजिए.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लिख दीजिए (*likh dījie*) is *likh*, “write”, from Sanskrit *likhati*, “scratches, writes” (CDIAL 11048), with *dījie*, the respectful command of *denā*, “to give” (CDIAL 6141).

What you’ve built

In Hindi, how do you say it, show me, I could not hear, write it down.

Your turn

- *Say it: likh dījie*
- *Say it: likh dījie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *likh dījie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for please show me, then the Hindi for I could not hear it, then say *likh dījie* again

Before you move on

What does लिख दीजिए mean? (“Please write it down”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 112

Right, Wrong, Sure

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say something is right or wrong, ask if someone is sure, react with really? and oh!
>
> *Complete HI-C112-are: reactions and judgements.*

112.1 सही (sahī) — right, correct

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for I could not hear it, then the Hindi for please write it down.

You'll want to know: सही

सही (*sahī*) — "right, correct".
  सही दाम — "the right price". Said alone, **सही!** agrees: "right!".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सही (*sahī*) is a loan from Arabic *ṣaḥīḥ*, "sound, correct", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṣ-ḥ-ḥ* (Lane).

What you've built

A word for getting it right.

Your turn

- *Say it: sahī*
- *Say it: sahī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sahī!*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for I could not hear it, then the Hindi for please write it down, then say *sahī* again

Before you move on

What does सही mean? (“Right, correct”.) Say it once more.

112.2 ग़लत (ġalat) — wrong, incorrect

Before the new one: say the Hindi for please write it down, then the Hindi for right.

You’ll want to know: ग़लत

ग़लत (*ġalat*) — “wrong”.
The opposite of सही. यह ग़लत है — “this is wrong”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ग़लत (*ġalat*) is a loan from Arabic *ghalaṭ*, “an error”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *gh-l-ṭ* (Lane).

What you’ve built

Right and wrong, as a pair.

Your turn

- *Say it: ġalat*
- *Say it: ġalat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yah ġalat hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for please write it down, then the Hindi for right, then say *ġalat* again

Before you move on

What does ग़लत mean? (“Wrong, incorrect”.) Say it once more.

112.3 पक्का (pakkā) — sure, certain; firm

Before the new one: say the Hindi for right, then the Hindi for wrong.

You’ll want to know: पक्का

पक्का (*pakkā*) — “sure, certain”, and of a thing, “firm, ripe”.
पक्का? — “for sure?”. **पक्का!** — “definitely!”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पक्का (*pakkā*) goes back to Sanskrit *pakva*, “cooked, ripe” (CDIAL 7621). CDIAL marks the Hindi form as taken over from Punjabi; “firm, sure” grew out of “ripe, mature”.

What you’ve built

A question and an answer in one word.

Your turn

- *Say it: pakkā*
- *Say it: pakkā*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *pakkā?*, then answer *pakkā!*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for right, then the Hindi for wrong, then say *pakkā* again

Before you move on

What does पक्का mean? (“Sure, certain; firm”.) Say it once more.

112.4 सच में? (sac meṁ?) — really?

Before the new one: say the Hindi for wrong, then the Hindi for sure.

You'll want to know: सच में?

सच में? (*sac meṁ?*) — "really?", literally "in truth?".
सच is the "true" you know, with **में**, "in".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सच में? (*sac meṁ?*) is *sac*, "truth", with *meṁ*, "in". *sac* comes from Sanskrit *satya*, "true" (CDIAL 13112), and *meṁ* from *madhye*, "in, among" (CDIAL 9804).

What you've built

A way to show surprise.

Your turn

- *Say it: sac meṁ?*
- *Say it: sac meṁ?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *sac meṁ?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for wrong, then the Hindi for sure, then say *sac meṁ?* again

Before you move on

What does सच में? mean? ("Really?".) Say it once more.

112.5 अरे (are) — oh!, hey!

Before the new one: say the Hindi for sure, then the Hindi for really.

You’ll want to know: अरे

अरे (*are*) — “oh!”, “hey!”, a cry of surprise.
अरे, सच में? — “oh, really?”. It is informal: use it with friends.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अरे (*are*) is inherited from Sanskrit *are*, “a call to someone”, and has come down with almost no change (CDIAL 621). Sanskrit already had it in its oldest prose.

What you’ve built

Right, wrong, sure, really, oh: five reactions.

Your turn

- *Say it: are*
- *Say it: are*, once more
- *Say it:* say *are, sac meṁ?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sure, then the Hindi for really, then say *are* again

Before you move on

What does **अरे** mean? (“Oh!, hey!”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 113

Nothing, Not Yet, Maybe

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can answer with nothing, not yet, that’s enough, that’s the one, and maybe.
>
> *Complete HI-C113-ho-sakta-hai: five short answers that close a question.*

113.1 कुछ नहीं (kuch nahīṁ) — nothing

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for really, then the Hindi for oh.

You’ll want to know: कुछ नहीं

कुछ नहीं (*kuch nahīṁ*) — “nothing”.

क्या हुआ? — कुछ नहीं. — “what happened? — nothing”. It ends on the नहीं you know.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कुछ नहीं (*kuch nahīṁ*) is two tadbhavas. *kuch*, “something”, comes from Sanskrit *kiṁcid*, “anything”, taking its *-ch-* from the masculine *kaścid* (CDIAL 3144); *nahīṁ* comes from *nahi*, “surely not” (CDIAL 7035).

What you’ve built

An answer that closes a question kindly.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuch nahīṁ*
- *Say it: kuch nahīṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuch nahīṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for really, then the Hindi for oh, then say *kuch nahīṁ* again

Before you move on

What does कुछ नहीं mean? (“Nothing”.) Say it once more.

113.2 अभी नहीं (abhī nahīṁ) — not yet, not now

Before the new one: say the Hindi for oh, then the Hindi for nothing.

You’ll want to know: अभी नहीं

अभी नहीं (*abhī nahīṁ*) — “not yet”, “not now”.

Two words you own: अभी, “right now”, and नहीं.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अभी नहीं (*abhī nahīṁ*) is *abhī*, “right now”, with *nahīṁ*, “not”. CDIAL lists *ab* and *abhī* under Sanskrit *evam eva*, “exactly so”, crossed with the pronoun stem *a-* (CDIAL 2528); *nahīṁ* comes from *nahi*, “surely not” (CDIAL 7035).

What you’ve built

An answer from two old words.

Your turn

- *Say it: abhī nahīṁ*
- *Say it: abhī nahīṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *abhī nahīṁ*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for oh, then the Hindi for nothing, then say *abhī nahīṁ* again

Before you move on

What does अभी नहीं mean? (“Not yet, not now”.) Say it once more.

113.3 क़ाफ़ी (kāfī) — enough; quite

Before the new one: say the Hindi for nothing, then the Hindi for not yet.

You’ll want to know: क़ाफ़ी

क़ाफ़ी (*kāfī*) — “enough”, and before an adjective, “quite”.

बस, क़ाफ़ी है — “that’s enough”, with the बस you know. क़ाफ़ी अच्छा — “quite good”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क़ाफ़ी (*kāfī*) is a loan from Arabic *kāfī*, “sufficient”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *k-f-y* (Lane).

What you’ve built

Enough, and quite.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāfī*
- *Say it: kāfī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bas, kāfī hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for nothing, then the Hindi for not yet, then say *kāfī* again

Before you move on

What does क़ाफ़ी mean? (“Enough; quite”.) Say it once more.

113.4 वही (vahī) — that very one, the same

Before the new one: say the Hindi for not yet, then the Hindi for enough.

You'll want to know: वही

वही (*vahī*) — "that very one", "the same".

It is वह, "that", with ही, "exactly". When someone names what you meant: हाँ, वही!

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वही (*vahī*) is वह, "that", with the emphatic -*hī*: "that one and no other". CDIAL lists *vah* under Sanskrit *asau*, "that" (CDIAL 972).

What you've built

That one, exactly.

Your turn

- *Say it: vahī*
- *Say it: vahī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hā̃, vahī!*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for not yet, then the Hindi for enough, then say *vahī* again

Before you move on

What does वही mean? ("That very one, the same".) Say it once more.

113.5 हो सकता है (ho saktā hai) — maybe, it could be

Before the new one: say the Hindi for enough, then the Hindi for that very one.

You’ll want to know: हो सकता है

हो सकता है (*ho saktā hai*) — “maybe”, literally “it can be”.

It is **होना**, “to be”, and the **सकना** of “can”. Compare **शायद**, “perhaps”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हो सकता है (*ho saktā hai*) is “it can be”. *ho* is a form of *honā*, “to be”, from Sanskrit *bhavati* (CDIAL 9416), and *saknā*, “to be able”, comes from *śaknoti*, “is able” (CDIAL 12252).

What you’ve built

Nothing, not yet, enough, that one, maybe.

Your turn

- *Say it: ho saktā hai*
- *Say it: ho saktā hai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ho saktā hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for enough, then the Hindi for that very one, then say *ho saktā hai* again

Before you move on

What does **हो सकता है** mean? (“Maybe, it could be”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 114

Sorry, No Problem, Congratulations

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5)   🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can apologise, answer an apology, congratulate, give good wishes, and talk about an invitation.
>
> *Complete HI-C114-nimantran: the courtesies that come around a visit.*

114.1 माफ़ी (māfī) — an apology, pardon

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for that very one, then the Hindi for maybe.

You'll want to know: माफ़ी

माफ़ी (*māfī*) — "an apology, pardon", the noun.

माफ़ी चाहता हूँ — "I beg your pardon" (a woman says चाहती). It shares its root with माफ़ कीजिए.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

माफ़ी (*māfī*) is *māf* with *-ī*. *māf* is usually traced, through Persian, to Arabic *mu*^{c}*āf*, "excused, let off", on the root ^{c}*-f-w*, "to pardon" (Lane). The same *māf* is inside *māf kījie*, "forgive me".

What you've built

The apology as a thing you ask for.

Your turn

- *Say it: māfī*
- *Say it: māfī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māfī cāhtā hūṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for that very one, then the Hindi for maybe, then say *māfī* again

Before you move on

What does माफ़ी mean? ("An apology, pardon".) Say it once more.

114.2 कोई बात नहीं (koī bāt nahīṁ) — no problem, never mind

Before the new one: say the Hindi for maybe, then the Hindi for an apology.

You'll want to know: कोई बात नहीं

कोई बात नहीं (*koī bāt nahīṁ*) — "no problem", "never mind", literally "no matter".

It is the answer to माफ़ कीजिए, and to thanks for a small favour.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कोई बात नहीं (*koī bāt nahīṁ*) is "not any matter". *koī* comes from Sanskrit *kaścid*, "someone, anyone" (CDIAL 2967), and *bāt*, "matter, talk", from *vārttā*, "tidings, business" (CDIAL 11564).

What you've built

The answer to an apology.

Your turn

- *Say it: koī bāt nahīṁ*
- *Say it: koī bāt nahīṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* answer *māf kījie* with *koī bāt nahīṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for maybe, then the Hindi for an apology, then say *koī bāt nahīṁ* again

Before you move on

What does **कोई बात नहीं** mean? (“No problem, never mind”.) Say it once more.

114.3 बधाई (badhāī) — congratulations

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an apology, then the Hindi for no problem.

You’ll want to know: बधाई

बधाई (*badhāī*) — “congratulations”.
बधाई हो! — “congratulations!”, for an exam passed, a new job, a birth.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बधाई (*badhāī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vardhāpayati*, “increases, gladdens, congratulates” (CDIAL 11383). CDIAL glosses the Hindi word “congratulations on the birth of a child”.

What you’ve built

Praise for good news.

Your turn

- *Say it: badhāī*
- *Say it: badhāī*, once more

- *Say it:* say *badhāī ho!*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an apology, then the Hindi for no problem, then say *badhāī* again

Before you move on

What does बधाई mean? (“Congratulations”.) Say it once more.

114.4 शुभकामनाएँ (śubhkāmnāẽ) — good wishes

Before the new one: say the Hindi for no problem, then the Hindi for congratulations.

You’ll want to know: शुभकामनाएँ

शुभकामनाएँ (*śubhkāmnāẽ*) — “good wishes”.

It opens on the शुभ of शुभ रात्रि, “auspicious”. आपको शुभकामनाएँ — “good wishes to you”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शुभकामनाएँ (*śubhkāmnāẽ*) is two Sanskrit words taken over whole, tatsamas: *śubha*, “auspicious, good”, and *kāmanā*, “a wish”, with the Hindi plural ending.

What you’ve built

Wishes for what is coming, beside congratulations for what is done.

Your turn

- *Say it: śubhkāmnāẽ*
- *Say it: śubhkāmnāẽ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āpko śubhkāmnāẽ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for no problem, then the Hindi for congratulations, then say *śubhkāmnāẽ* again

Before you move on

What does शुभकामनाएँ mean? (“Good wishes”.) Say it once more.

114.5 निमंत्रण (nimantraṇ) — an invitation

Before the new one: say the Hindi for congratulations, then the Hindi for good wishes.

You’ll want to know: निमंत्रण

निमंत्रण (*nimantraṇ*) — “an invitation”, the formal word.

निमंत्रण के लिए धन्यवाद — “thank you for the invitation”, with के लिए and धन्यवाद.

A written invitation has the three parts of the short message you learned to write: the line that names the reader, **प्रिय मीरा,**; the sentences under it; and the writer’s name at the foot.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

निमंत्रण (*nimantraṇ*) is Sanskrit *nimantraṇa*, “invitation”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. CDIAL lists its verb, *nimantrayate*, “invites”, whose inherited forms survive as *nyotnā*, “to invite” (CDIAL 7235).

What you’ve built

Sorry, no problem, congratulations, wishes, and thanks for an invitation.

Your turn

- *Say it: nimantraṇ*
- *Say it: nimantraṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nimantraṇ ke lie dhanyavād*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for congratulations, then the Hindi for good wishes, then say *nimantraṇ* again

Before you move on

What does **निमंत्रण** mean? (“An invitation”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 115

Come In, Here You Are

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can welcome a guest in, offer something, answer by all means, and say no politely.
>
> *Complete HI-R115-second-pass-courtesy: courtesies and reactions, from cold.*

115.1 आइए (āie) — please come (in)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for good wishes, then the Hindi for an invitation.

You'll want to know: आइए

आइए (*āie*) — "please come", "come in".

It is आना, "to come", with the respectful **-इए**. **आइए, आइए!** — doubled, it is a warm welcome at the door.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आइए (*āie*) is the respectful command of आना, "to come". CDIAL lists the verb under Sanskrit *āpayati*, "causes to reach" (CDIAL 1200).

What you've built

A welcome at the door.

Your turn

- *Say it: āie*
- *Say it: āie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āie, āie!*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for good wishes, then the Hindi for an invitation, then say *āie* again

Before you move on

What does आइए mean? (“Please come (in)”.) Say it once more.

115.2 पधारिए (padhārie) — please come (formal)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an invitation, then the Hindi for please come in.

You’ll want to know: पधारिए

पधारिए (*padhārie*) — “please come”, in its most formal, honouring form.

The everyday *āie* comes first in this chapter; पधारिए is what you say to an honoured guest.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पधारिए (*padhārie*) is the respectful command of *padhārnā*, “to come, to grace with one’s presence”. CDIAL lists it under a reconstructed **paddhārayati*, “steps”, perhaps from *pad*, “foot”, and *dhārayati*, “holds” (CDIAL 7768).

What you’ve built

A second welcome, for an honoured guest.

Your turn

- *Say it: padhārie*
- *Say it: padhārie*, once more

- *Say it:* say *padhārie*, then *āie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an invitation, then the Hindi for please come in, then say *padhārie* again

Before you move on

What does **पधारिए** mean? (“Please come (formal)”.) Say it once more.

115.3 लीजिए (lījie) — please take; here you are

Before the new one: say the Hindi for please come in, then the Hindi for please come, formally.

You’ll want to know: लीजिए

लीजिए (*lījie*) — “please take”, “here you are”, as you hand something over.

It is **लेना**, “to take”, with the respectful ending of **बोलिए**. **चाय लीजिए** — “have some tea”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लीजिए (*lījie*) is the respectful command of *lenā*, “to take”. CDIAL lists *lenā* under Sanskrit *labhate*, “catches, takes” (CDIAL 10948).

What you’ve built

An offer as you hand it over.

Your turn

- *Say it: lījie*
- *Say it: lījie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cāy lījie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for please come in, then the Hindi for please come, formally, then say *lījie* again

Before you move on

What does लीजिए mean? (“Please take; here you are”.) Say it once more.

115.4 शौक़ से (śauq se) — by all means, gladly

Before the new one: say the Hindi for please come, formally, then the Hindi for here you are.

You’ll want to know: शौक़ से

शौक़ से (*śauq se*) — “by all means”, “gladly”, literally “with pleasure”.

The answer when someone asks if they may: **क्या मैं बैठ सकता हूँ?** — **शौक़ से!**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शौक़ से (*śauq se*) is “with relish”. *śauq* comes from Arabic *shawq*, “longing, desire”, which reached Hindi through Persian; its root is *sh-w-q* (Lane). *se* is inherited (CDIAL 13310).

What you’ve built

A generous yes.

Your turn

- *Say it: śauq se*
- *Say it: śauq se*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śauq se!*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for please come, formally, then the Hindi for here you are, then say *śauq se* again

Before you move on

What does शौक़ से mean? (“By all means, gladly”.) Say it once more.

115.5 जी नहीं (jī nahīṁ) — no, politely

Before the new one: say the Hindi for here you are, then the Hindi for by all means.

You'll want to know: जी नहीं

जी नहीं (*jī nahīṁ*) — "no", said politely.

It pairs with the जी हाँ you know: जी makes either answer respectful.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जी नहीं (*jī nahīṁ*) is *jī*, the respectful word that CDIAL traces to Sanskrit *jīva*, "long live!" (CDIAL 5240), with *nahīṁ*, "not", from *nahi*, "surely not" (CDIAL 7035).

What you've built

Come in, please come, here you are, by all means, and a polite no.

Your turn

- *Say it: jī nahīṁ*
- *Say it: jī nahīṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jī nahīṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for here you are, then the Hindi for by all means, then say *jī nahīṁ* again

Before you move on

What does जी नहीं mean? ("No, politely".) Say it once more.

115.6 A visit, start to finish — a second pass

A guest is at your door. Welcome them in, and hand them a cup of tea.

Grammar Lens: the respectful ending

word	from
āie	come
लीजिए	take
पधारिए	arrive, formally

One ending turns a verb into a polite request, as it did for बोलिए.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- you bumped into someone: beg their pardon; they answer “no problem”
- congratulate a friend; then send them good wishes
- thank someone for an invitation
- a guest asks to sit: say “by all means”; offered more food, say a polite no

Before you move on

An apology? (माफ़ी.) No problem? (कोई बात नहीं.) Congratulations? (बधाई.) Good wishes? (शुभकामनाएँ.) An invitation? (निमंत्रण.) Come in? (*āie*.) Please come, formally? (पधारिए.) Here you are? (लीजिए.) By all means? (शौक़ से.) A polite no? (जी नहीं.)

115.7 Reacting and answering — a second pass

Someone gives an answer. Tell them it is right; then tell them it is wrong.

Grammar Lens: two words you already had, joined

answer	built from
कुछ नहीं	something + not
अभी नहीं	right now + not
सच में?	truth + in
वही	that + exactly

Most short answers are two small words you already own, put side by side.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- react to surprising news: oh, really?
- ask if someone is sure; answer “definitely”
- asked what happened, say nothing; asked if you have finished, say not yet
- say that’s enough; say “that’s the one”; say maybe
- answer a request with “by all means”, then with a polite no

Before you move on

Right? (सही.) Wrong? (ग़लत.) Sure? (पक्का.) Really? (सच में?) Oh? (अरे.) Nothing? (कुछ नहीं.) Not yet? (अभी नहीं.) Enough? (काफ़ी.) That very one? (वही.) Maybe? (हो सकता है.)

Chapter 116

Grandparents, and Which Side

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name my four grandparents and my father's younger brother, and say which side of the family each is on.
>
> *Complete HI-C116-chacha: introduce the family, side by side.*

116.1 दादा (dādā) — grandfather, the father's father

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for by all means, then the Hindi for a polite no.

You'll want to know: दादा

दादा (*dādā*) — "grandfather", your FATHER's father.

English has one word for both grandfathers; Hindi has two, and says which side of the family you mean. मेरे दादा — "my grandfather", with the respectful plural मेरे.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दादा (*dādā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dādda*, "father or other elderly relative", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6261).

What you've built

A grandfather, on your father's side.

Your turn

- *Say it: dādā*
- *Say it: dādā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mere dādā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for by all means, then the Hindi for a polite no, then say *dādā* again

Before you move on

What does दादा mean? ("Grandfather, the father's father".) Say it once more.

116.2 दादी (dādī) — grandmother, the father's mother

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a polite no, then the Hindi for the father's father.

You'll want to know: दादी

दादी (*dādī*) — "grandmother", your father's mother.

It pairs with दादा: the -ई ending marks the woman, as in बच्ची beside बच्चा.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दादी (*dādī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dādda*, "father or other elderly relative", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6261). *dādī* is its feminine.

What you've built

The father's side, both grandparents.

Your turn

- *Say it: dādī*
- *Say it: dādī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mere dādā aur merī dādī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a polite no, then the Hindi for the father's father, then say *dādī* again

Before you move on

What does **दादी** mean? ("Grandmother, the father's mother".) Say it once more.

116.3 नाना (nānā) — grandfather, the mother's father

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the father's father, then the Hindi for the father's mother.

You'll want to know: नाना

नाना (*nānā*) — "grandfather", your MOTHER's father.

So **दादा** and **नाना** are both "grandfather" in English, and never the same man in Hindi.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाना (*nānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **nānna*, "a term of respect for an older relative", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 7059). CDIAL compares Sanskrit *nanā*, "mother".

What you've built

A grandfather, on your mother's side.

Your turn

- *Say it: nānā*
- *Say it: nānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mere nānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the father's father, then the Hindi for the father's mother, then say *nānā* again

Before you move on

What does नाना mean? ("Grandfather, the mother's father".) Say it once more.

116.4 नानी (nānī) — grandmother, the mother's mother

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the father's mother, then the Hindi for the mother's father.

You'll want to know: नानी

नानी (*nānī*) — "grandmother", your mother's mother.

नानी का घर — "grandmother's house", the mother's family home, where many summer holidays are spent.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नानी (*nānī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **nānna*, "a term of respect for an older relative", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 7059). *nānī* is its feminine. CDIAL compares Sanskrit *nanā*, "mother".

What you've built

All four grandparents, each with a name of their own.

Your turn

- *Say it: nānī*
- *Say it: nānī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nānī kā ghar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the father's mother, then the Hindi for the mother's father, then say *nānī* again

Before you move on

What does **नानी** mean? ("Grandmother, the mother's mother".) Say it once more.

116.5 चाचा (cācā) — uncle, the father's younger brother

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the mother's father, then the Hindi for the mother's mother.

You'll want to know: चाचा

चाचा (*cācā*) — "uncle", your father's younger brother.

Like the grandparents, an uncle's name says whose brother he is. **मेरे चाचा** — "my uncle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चाचा (*cācā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **cācca*, "uncle", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4734). CDIAL suggests, with a query, a nursery word.

What you've built

Four grandparents and an uncle: the family says which side.

Your turn

- *Say it: cācā*

- *Say it: cācā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mere cācā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the mother's father, then the Hindi for the mother's mother, then say *cācā* again

Before you move on

What does **चाचा** mean? ("Uncle, the father's younger brother".) Say it once more.

Chapter 117

Aunts, Uncles, In-Laws

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can name aunts and uncles on both sides, a brother's wife, and the home of the in-laws.
>
> *Complete HI-C117-sasural: the rest of the family, named by side.*

117.1 मौसी (mausī) — aunt, the mother's sister

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for the mother's mother, then the Hindi for the father's younger brother.

You'll want to know: मौसी

मौसी (*mausī*) — "aunt", your mother's sister.

It is often explained as **माँ जैसी**, "like a mother": the aunt closest to a mother's place.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मौसी (*mausī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mātuḥṣvasṛ*, "mother's sister" (CDIAL 10001). It is built from *mātṛ*, "mother", and *svasṛ*, "sister".

What you've built

An aunt, on your mother's side.

Your turn

- *Say it: mausī*
- *Say it: mausī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *merī mausī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the mother's mother, then the Hindi for the father's younger brother, then say *mausī* again

Before you move on

What does मौसी mean? ("Aunt, the mother's sister".) Say it once more.

117.2 बुआ (buā) — aunt, the father's sister

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the father's younger brother, then the Hindi for the mother's sister.

You'll want to know: बुआ

बुआ (*buā*) — "aunt", your father's sister.

मौसी and बुआ are both "aunt" in English; in Hindi the side of the family decides.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बुआ (*buā*) is close to the Hindi words *phūphī* and *phūā*, "father's sister", which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **phupphī* (CDIAL 9089). CDIAL does not list *buā* itself, so its exact path is uncertain.

What you've built

Both aunts, and the side each belongs to.

Your turn

- *Say it: buā*
- *Say it: buā*, once more

- *Say it:* say *merī mausī aur merī buā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the father's younger brother, then the Hindi for the mother's sister, then say *buā* again

Before you move on

What does बुआ mean? ("Aunt, the father's sister".) Say it once more.

117.3 मामा (māmā) — uncle, the mother's brother

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the mother's sister, then the Hindi for the father's sister.

You'll want to know: मामा

मामा (*māmā*) — "uncle", your mother's brother.

Beside चाचा, the father's brother, it completes the uncles you meet most.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मामा (*māmā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *māma*, "uncle" (CDIAL 10055). CDIAL calls it a nursery word and notes similar words in Dravidian.

What you've built

An uncle on your mother's side.

Your turn

- *Say it: māmā*
- *Say it: māmā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mere māmā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the mother's sister, then the Hindi for the father's sister, then say *māmā* again

Before you move on

What does मामा mean? (“Uncle, the mother’s brother”.) Say it once more.

117.4 भाभी (bhābhī) — sister-in-law, a brother’s wife

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the father’s sister, then the Hindi for the mother’s brother.

You’ll want to know: भाभी

भाभी (*bhābhī*) — “sister-in-law”, specifically your brother’s wife.

It shares its start with भाई, “brother”: she is named through him.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भाभी (*bhābhī*) comes from a reconstructed **bhābbha-*, which CDIAL calls a nursery word; it lists Hindi *bhābhī*, “elder brother’s wife” (CDIAL 9453a).

What you’ve built

A relative by marriage, named through your brother.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhābhī*
- *Say it: bhābhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *merī bhābhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the father’s sister, then the Hindi for the mother’s brother, then say *bhābhī* again

Before you move on

What does भाभी mean? (“Sister-in-law, a brother’s wife”.) Say it once more.

117.5 ससुराल (sasurāl) — the in-laws' home

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the mother's brother, then the Hindi for a brother's wife.

You'll want to know: ससुराल

ससुराल (*sasurāl*) — "the in-laws' home", the family a person marries into.
वह ससुराल गई है — "she has gone to her in-laws' home".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ससुराल (*sasurāl*) is built on *sasur*, "father-in-law", which comes from Sanskrit *śvaśura* (CDIAL 12753), with the place ending *-āl*.

What you've built

Aunts, uncles, a sister-in-law, and the home of the in-laws.

Your turn

- *Say it: sasurāl*
- *Say it: sasurāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sasurāl*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the mother's brother, then the Hindi for a brother's wife, then say *sasurāl* again

Before you move on

What does ससुराल mean? ("The in-laws' home".) Say it once more.

Chapter 118

Boys, Girls, Husbands, Wives

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can talk about a boy or a girl, a husband or a wife, and a relative.
>
> *Complete HI-C118-rishtedar: the people in an introduction.*

118.1 लड़का (laṛkā) — a boy; a son

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a brother's wife, then the Hindi for the in-laws' home.

You'll want to know: लड़का

लड़का (*laṛkā*) — "a boy", and in a family, "a son".
बेटा is "son" as a family word; लड़का is any boy.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लड़का (*laṛkā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **laḍikka*, "child", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 10924). CDIAL calls the group a "defective" word for children and notes similar formations in Munda.

What you've built

A boy, beside the word for son you know.

Your turn

- *Say it: laṛkā*
- *Say it: laṛkā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ek laṛkā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a brother's wife, then the Hindi for the in-laws' home, then say *laṛkā* again

Before you move on

What does लड़का mean? ("A boy; a son".) Say it once more.

118.2 लड़की (laṛkī) — a girl; a daughter

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the in-laws' home, then the Hindi for a boy.

You'll want to know: लड़की

लड़की (*laṛkī*) — "a girl", and in a family, "a daughter".

The **-ई** ending marks the girl, as in **दादी** beside **दादा**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लड़की (*laṛkī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **laḍikka*, "child", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 10924). *laṛkī* is the feminine of *laṛkā*, "boy". CDIAL notes similar formations in Munda.

What you've built

Boy and girl as a pair.

Your turn

- *Say it: laṛkī*
- *Say it: laṛkī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ek laṛkā, ek laṛkī*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the in-laws' home, then the Hindi for a boy, then say *laṛkī* again

Before you move on

What does लड़की mean? ("A girl; a daughter".) Say it once more.

118.3 पति (pati) — a husband

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a boy, then the Hindi for a girl.

You'll want to know: पति

पति (*pati*) — "a husband".
मेरे पति — "my husband", with the respectful plural मेरे.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पति (*pati*) is Sanskrit *pati*, "master, husband", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 7727).

What you've built

A husband.

Your turn

- *Say it: pati*
- *Say it: pati*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mere pati*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a boy, then the Hindi for a girl, then say *pati* again

Before you move on

What does पति mean? ("A husband".) Say it once more.

118.4 पत्नी (patnī) — a wife

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a girl, then the Hindi for a husband.

You'll want to know: पत्नी

पत्नी (*patnī*) — "a wife".

It is built on **पति**, with the **-ई** that marks a woman. **मेरी पत्नी** — "my wife".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पत्नी (*patnī*) is Sanskrit *patnī*, "mistress, wife", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 7742). It is the feminine of *pati*, "master, husband".

What you've built

Husband and wife, one built on the other.

Your turn

- *Say it: patnī*
- *Say it: patnī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *merī patnī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a girl, then the Hindi for a husband, then say *patnī* again

Before you move on

What does पत्नी mean? ("A wife".) Say it once more.

118.5 रिश्तेदार (riśtedār) — a relative

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a husband, then the Hindi for a wife.

You’ll want to know: रिश्तेदार

रिश्तेदार (*riśtedār*) — “a relative”.

रिश्ता is “a relationship”, and **-दार** is “one who has”: a relative is one who has a tie to you. **वह मेरा रिश्तेदार है** — “he is my relative”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रिश्तेदार (*riśtedār*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *rishtadār*, “a relative”. It is built from *rishta*, “thread, tie”, and *-dār*, “holder”.

What you’ve built

Boy, girl, husband, wife, relative: the people an introduction reaches for.

Your turn

- *Say it: riśtedār*
- *Say it: riśtedār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vah merā riśtedār hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a husband, then the Hindi for a wife, then say *riśtedār* again

Before you move on

What does **रिश्तेदार** mean? (“A relative”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 119

Work and Marriage

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask and answer about a job, a profession, a wedding, being married, and a birthday.
>
> *Complete HI-C119-janmdin: the questions that come after a name.*

119.1 नौकरी (naukrī) — a job

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a wife, then the Hindi for a relative.

You’ll want to know: नौकरी

नौकरी (*naukrī*) — “a job”, employment.
 आपकी नौकरी कहाँ है? — “where is your job?”, “where do you work?”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नौकरी (*naukrī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *naukar*, “servant”, which Persian took from Mongolic *nökör*, “companion”. The -*ī* makes it the servant’s work: a job.

What you’ve built

The second question after a name.

Your turn

- *Say it: naukrī*
- *Say it: naukrī*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *āpkī naukrī kahā̃ hai?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a wife, then the Hindi for a relative, then say *naukrī* again

Before you move on

What does नौकरी mean? (“A job”.) Say it once more.

119.2 पेशा (peśā) — a profession

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a relative, then the Hindi for a job.

You’ll want to know: पेशा

पेशा (*peśā*) — “a profession”, a trade.

नौकरी is the job you hold; पेशा is what you are by trade. आपका पेशा क्या है?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पेशा (*peśā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *pesha*, “craft, profession”.

What you’ve built

A job, and the profession behind it.

Your turn

- *Say it: peśā*
- *Say it: peśā*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *āpkā peśā kyā hai?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a relative, then the Hindi for a job, then say *peśā* again

Before you move on

What does पेशा mean? (“A profession”.) Say it once more.

119.3 शादी (śādī) — a wedding, marriage

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a job, then the Hindi for a profession.

You’ll want to know: शादी

शादी (*śādī*) — “a wedding”, and “marriage”.
शादी कब है? — “when is the wedding?”, with the **कब** you know.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शादी (*śādī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *shādī*, “joy, festivity”. Hindi narrowed it to the happiest festivity: a wedding.

What you’ve built

A wedding, and the question everyone asks about it.

Your turn

- *Say it: śādī*
- *Say it: śādī*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *śādī kab hai?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a job, then the Hindi for a profession, then say *śādī* again

Before you move on

What does शादी mean? (“A wedding, marriage”.) Say it once more.

119.4 शादीशुदा (śādīśudā) — married

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a profession, then the Hindi for a wedding.

You'll want to know: शादीशुदा

शादीशुदा (*śādīśudā*) — "married".

It is शादी with -शुदा, "having been done". **क्या आप शादीशुदा हैं?** — "are you married?".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शादीशुदा (*śādīśudā*) is a compound made in Hindustani from Persian parts: *shādī*, "joy", which Hindi uses for a wedding, and *shuda*, "become".

What you've built

A question you will be asked early and often.

Your turn

- *Say it: śādīśudā*
- *Say it: śādīśudā*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *kyā āp śādīśudā haiṁ?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a profession, then the Hindi for a wedding, then say *śādīśudā* again

Before you move on

What does शादीशुदा mean? ("Married".) Say it once more.

119.5 जन्मदिन (janmdin) — a birthday

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a wedding, then the Hindi for married.

You'll want to know: जन्मदिन

जन्मदिन (*janmdin*) — "a birthday", literally "birth-day".

दिन is the day you know. जन्मदिन की शुभकामनाएँ — "happy birthday", with the good wishes you have.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जन्मदिन (*janmdin*) is "birth-day". *janm* is Sanskrit *janman*, "birth", taken over as a learned loan (CDIAL 5113), and *din* comes from *dina*, "day" (CDIAL 6328).

What you've built

A job, a profession, a wedding, married, a birthday.

Your turn

- *Say it: janmdin*
- *Say it: janmdin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *janmdin kī śubhkāmnāẽ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a wedding, then the Hindi for married, then say *janmdin* again

Before you move on

What does जन्मदिन mean? ("A birthday".) Say it once more.

Chapter 120

Forms and Introductions

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can sign a form, talk about an identity card, introduce myself, and say it was nice to meet someone.
>
> *Complete HI-C120-milkar: from the form to the handshake.*

120.1 हस्ताक्षर (hastākṣar) — a signature

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for married, then the Hindi for a birthday.

You'll want to know: हस्ताक्षर

हस्ताक्षर (*hastākṣar*) — "a signature", literally "hand-letters".

हाथ and this word's हस्त- are the same old word for hand. यहाँ हस्ताक्षर कीजिए — "please sign here".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हस्ताक्षर (*hastākṣar*) is a tatsama compound, taken over whole from Sanskrit: *hasta*, "hand", and *akṣara*, "letter, syllable". A signature is "the hand's letters".

What you've built

A signature, built on the word for hand.

Your turn

- *Say it: hastākṣar*
- *Say it: hastākṣar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yahā̃ hastākṣar kījie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for married, then the Hindi for a birthday, then say *hastākṣar* again

Before you move on

What does **हस्ताक्षर** mean? (“A signature”.) Say it once more.

120.2 पहचान (pahcān) — identity; recognition

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a birthday, then the Hindi for a signature.

You’ll want to know: पहचान

पहचान (*pahcān*) — “identity”, and “recognition”.

पहचान + **पत्र** (*patra*, “a paper, a document”) → **पहचान पत्र**, “an identity card”.

The same word is the knowing-again of a familiar face.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पहचान (*pahcān*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *pratyabhijānāti*, “recognizes” (CDIAL 8637). *pahcān* is the noun of the verb *pahcānnā*, “to recognize”.

What you’ve built

What a form asks you to prove.

Your turn

- *Say it: pahcān*
- *Say it: pahcān*, once more

- *Say it:* say *pahcān patra*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a birthday, then the Hindi for a signature, then say *pahcān* again

Before you move on

What does **पहचान** mean? (“Identity; recognition”.) Say it once more.

120.3 परिचय (paricay) — an introduction

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a signature, then the Hindi for identity.

You’ll want to know: परिचय

परिचय (*paricay*) — “an introduction”.
अपना परिचय दीजिए — “please introduce yourself”, with the **अपना** you know.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

परिचय (*paricay*) is Sanskrit *paricaya*, “acquaintance with”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 7807).

What you’ve built

A request to hear who someone is.

Your turn

- *Say it: paricay*
- *Say it: paricay*, once more
- *Say it:* say *apnā paricay dījie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a signature, then the Hindi for identity, then say *paricay* again

Before you move on

What does **परिचय** mean? (“An introduction”.) Say it once more.

120.4 इंसान (insān) — a human being, a person

Before the new one: say the Hindi for identity, then the Hindi for an introduction.

You’ll want to know: इंसान

इंसान (*insān*) — “a human being, a person”.

अच्छा इंसान — “a good person”, with **अच्छा**. **आदमी** is a man; **इंसान** is anyone.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

इंसान (*insān*) is a loan from Arabic *insān*, “human being”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ʾ-n-s* (Lane).

What you’ve built

A word for anyone at all.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *insān*
- *Say it:* *insān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *acchā insān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for identity, then the Hindi for an introduction, then say *insān* again

Before you move on

What does **इंसान** mean? (“A human being, a person”.) Say it once more.

120.5 मिलकर अच्छा लगा (milkar acchā lagā) — nice to meet you

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an introduction, then the Hindi for a person.

You'll want to know: मिलकर अच्छा लगा

मिलकर अच्छा लगा (*milkar acchā lagā*) — "nice to meet you", literally "having met, it felt good".

It is the everyday cousin of **आपसे मिलकर ख़ुशी हुई**, built on the same **मिलना**, "to meet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मिलकर अच्छा लगा (*milkar acchā lagā*) is "having met, it felt good". *milnā*, "to meet", comes from Sanskrit *milati*, "meets" (CDIAL 10133), and *lagnā*, "to strike one as", from *lagyati*, "adheres to" (CDIAL 10895).

What you've built

A signature, an identity, an introduction, a person, and the goodbye after meeting.

Your turn

- *Say it: milkar acchā lagā*
- *Say it: milkar acchā lagā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *milkar acchā lagā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an introduction, then the Hindi for a person, then say *milkar acchā lagā* again

Before you move on

What does **मिलकर अच्छा लगा** mean? ("Nice to meet you".) Say it once more.

Chapter 121

Take Care

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can tell someone to take care and go carefully, wish them a good journey, ask them to come again, and say let’s go.
>
> *Complete HI-C121-chalie: leave a visit well.*

121.1 ध्यान रखिए (dhyān rakhie) — take care

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a person, then the Hindi for nice to meet you.

You’ll want to know: ध्यान रखिए

ध्यान रखिए (*dhyān rakhie*) — “take care”, literally “keep attention”.
अपना ध्यान रखिए — “take care of yourself”, the kindest goodbye.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ध्यान रखिए (*dhyān rakhie*) is “keep attention”. *dhyān* is Sanskrit *dhyāna*, “meditation”, a tatsama (CDIAL 6889), and *rakhnā*, “to keep”, comes from *rakṣati*, “guards” (CDIAL 10547).

What you’ve built

The kindest thing to say at the door.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhyān rakhie*
- *Say it: dhyān rakhie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *apnā dhyān rakhie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a person, then the Hindi for nice to meet you, then say *dhyān rakhie* again

Before you move on

What does **ध्यान रखिए** mean? (“Take care”.) Say it once more.

121.2 संभलकर (sambhalkar) — carefully

Before the new one: say the Hindi for nice to meet you, then the Hindi for take care.

You’ll want to know: संभलकर

संभलकर (*sambhalkar*) — “carefully”, “steadily”.

संभलकर जाना — “go carefully”, said to someone setting out after dark or in the rain.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

संभलकर (*sambhalkar*) is *sambhalnā*, “to steady oneself”, with -*kar*, “having”. CDIAL lists the verb under Sanskrit *saṁbharati*, “brings together”, and its causing form “maintains” (CDIAL 12961).

What you’ve built

A second way to wish someone safe.

Your turn

- *Say it: sambhalkar*
- *Say it: sambhalkar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sambhalkar jānā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for nice to meet you, then the Hindi for take care, then say *sambhalkar* again

Before you move on

What does **संभलकर** mean? (“Carefully”.) Say it once more.

121.3 शुभ यात्रा (śubh yātrā) — have a good journey

Before the new one: say the Hindi for take care, then the Hindi for carefully.

You’ll want to know: शुभ यात्रा

शुभ यात्रा (*śubh yātrā*) — “have a good journey”.

शुभ is the auspicious of **शुभ रात्रि**; **यात्रा** is “a journey”, a formal cousin of **सफ़र**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शुभ यात्रा (*śubh yātrā*) is two Sanskrit words taken over whole, tatsamas: *śubha*, “auspicious, good”, and *yātrā*, “journey”.

What you’ve built

A wish for someone setting off.

Your turn

- *Say it: śubh yātrā*
- *Say it: śubh yātrā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śubh yātrā!*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for take care, then the Hindi for carefully, then say *śubh yātrā* again

Before you move on

What does **शुभ यात्रा** mean? (“Have a good journey”.) Say it once more.

121.4 फिर आइएगा (phir āiegā) — do come again

Before the new one: say the Hindi for carefully, then the Hindi for a good journey.

You'll want to know: फिर आइएगा

फिर आइएगा (*phir āiegā*) — "do come again".

फिर is "again", and आइएगा is an extra-polite आइए, a request for later rather than now.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फिर आइएगा (*phir āiegā*) is *phir*, "again", and *āiegā*, the polite future of आना, "to come". CDIAL lists *phir* under a reconstructed **phirati*, "turns", whose old form became an adverb (CDIAL 9078).

What you've built

An invitation to return.

Your turn

- *Say it: phir āiegā*
- *Say it: phir āiegā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phir āiegā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for carefully, then the Hindi for a good journey, then say *phir āiegā* again

Before you move on

What does फिर आइएगा mean? ("Do come again".) Say it once more.

121.5 चलिए (calie) — let's go, shall we

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a good journey, then the Hindi for come again.

You'll want to know: चलिए

चलिए (*calie*) — “let's go”, “shall we”.

It is चलना with the respectful ending of बोलिए, the verb inside चलता हूँ, “I'll be off”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चलिए (*calie*) is the respectful command of *calnā*, “to move, go”, which comes from Sanskrit *calati*, “goes away” (CDIAL 4715).

What you've built

Take care, carefully, a good journey, come again, let's go.

Your turn

- *Say it: calie*
- *Say it: calie*, once more
- *Say it:* say *calie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a good journey, then the Hindi for come again, then say *calie* again

Before you move on

What does चलिए mean? (“Let's go, shall we”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 122

It’s Getting Late

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say it has got late and I have to go, ask leave politely, and talk about a holiday.
>
> *Complete HI-C122-jana-hai: excuse yourself politely.*

122.1 छुट्टी (chuṭṭī) — a holiday, a day off, leave

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for come again, then the Hindi for let’s go.

You’ll want to know: छुट्टी

छुट्टी (*chuṭṭī*) — “a holiday”, “a day off”, “leave from work”.
आज छुट्टी है — “today is a holiday”, with the आज you know.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छुट्टी (*chuṭṭī*) goes back to a reconstructed **kṣuṭyate*, “is released” (CDIAL 3707). CDIAL marks *chuṭṭī*, “leave”, as taken over into Hindi from Punjabi.

What you’ve built

A day off.

Your turn

- *Say it: chuṭṭī*
- *Say it: chuṭṭī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āj chuṭṭī hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for come again, then the Hindi for let's go, then say *chuṭṭī* again

Before you move on

What does छुट्टी mean? ("A holiday, a day off, leave".) Say it once more.

122.2 देर हो गई (der ho gaī) — it has got late

Before the new one: say the Hindi for let's go, then the Hindi for a holiday.

You'll want to know: देर हो गई

देर हो गई (*der ho gaī*) — "it has got late", "I am late".

देर is the lateness you know; हो गई is "has become". The first reason to leave.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

देर हो गई (*der ho gaī*) is "lateness has gone and become". *der* is usually traced to Persian *der*, "late", while *ho* and *gaī* are forms of the inherited verbs "to be" (CDIAL 9416) and "to go" (CDIAL 10452).

What you've built

A reason to go.

Your turn

- *Say it: der ho gaī*
- *Say it: der ho gaī*, once more

- *Say it:* say *der ho gaī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for let's go, then the Hindi for a holiday, then say *der ho gaī* again

Before you move on

What does देर हो गई mean? ("It has got late".) Say it once more.

122.3 आराम से (ārām se) — take it easy; comfortably

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a holiday, then the Hindi for it has got late.

You'll want to know: आराम से

आराम से (*ārām se*) — "comfortably", and as a parting, "take it easy".

आराम is the rest you know, with से, "with". आराम से बैठिए — "sit comfortably"; at the door, आराम से alone is "take it easy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आराम से (*ārām se*) is "with ease". *ārām* is usually traced to Persian *ārām*, "rest", and *se*, "with", is inherited (CDIAL 13310).

What you've built

An unhurried goodbye.

Your turn

- *Say it: ārām se*
- *Say it: ārām se*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ārām se*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a holiday, then the Hindi for it has got late, then say *ārām se* again

Before you move on

What does आराम से mean? (“Take it easy; comfortably”.) Say it once more.

122.4 इजाज़त (ijāzat) — permission, leave to go

Before the new one: say the Hindi for it has got late, then the Hindi for take it easy.

You’ll want to know: इजाज़त

इजाज़त (*ijāzat*) — “permission”.

अब इजाज़त दीजिए — “now please give me leave to go”, the most courteous way to excuse yourself from a host.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

इजाज़त (*ijāzat*) is a loan from Arabic *ijāza*, “permission”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *j-w-z* (Lane).

What you’ve built

A formal way out of a room.

Your turn

- *Say it: ijāzat*
- *Say it: ijāzat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ab ijāzat dījie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for it has got late, then the Hindi for take it easy, then say *ijāzat* again

Before you move on

What does इजाज़त mean? (“Permission, leave to go”.) Say it once more.

122.5 जाना है (jānā hai) — (I) have to go

Before the new one: say the Hindi for take it easy, then the Hindi for permission to go.

You'll want to know: जाना है

जाना है (*jānā hai*) — "have to go".
मुझे जाना है — "I have to go", with the person in मुझे. जाना is "to go".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जाना है (*jānā hai*) is "to go is", that is, "I must go". *jānā* comes from Sanskrit *yāti*, "goes" (CDIAL 10452).

What you've built

A holiday, it's late, take it easy, leave to go, I have to go.

Your turn

- *Say it: jānā hai*
- *Say it: jānā hai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe jānā hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for take it easy, then the Hindi for permission to go, then say *jānā hai* again

Before you move on

What does जाना है mean? ("(I) have to go".) Say it once more.

Chapter 123

How’s It Going?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can greet someone the everyday way: how’s it going, all well, long time, what’s up, have you eaten.
>
> *Complete HI-C123-khana-khaya: everyday greetings.*

123.1 क्या हाल है? (kyā hāl hai?) — how’s it going?

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for permission to go, then the Hindi for I have to go.

You’ll want to know: क्या हाल है?

क्या हाल है? (*kyā hāl hai?*) — “how’s it going?”, “how are things?”. हाल is “condition, state”. Friendlier than **आप कैसे हैं?**

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

hāl comes from Arabic *ḥāl*, “state, condition”, through Persian; its root is *ḥ-w-l* (Lane).

What you’ve built

An everyday opener.

Your turn

- *Say it: kyā hāl hai?*
- *Say it: kyā hāl hai?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *kyā hāl hai?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for permission to go, then the Hindi for I have to go, then say *kyā hāl hai?* again

Before you move on

What does क्या हाल है? mean? ("How's it going?".) Say it once more.

123.2 सब ठीक? (sab ṭhīk?) — all well?

Before the new one: say the Hindi for I have to go, then the Hindi for how's it going.

You'll want to know: सब ठीक?

सब ठीक? (*sab ṭhīk?*) — "all well?", "everything fine?".
सब is "all", and ठीक is the "fine" you know. The answer: **हाँ, सब ठीक**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सब ठीक? (*sab ṭhīk?*) is "all fine?". *sab*, "all", comes from Sanskrit *sarva*, "all, whole" (CDIAL 13276).

What you've built

A two-word greeting and its answer.

Your turn

- *Say it: sab ṭhīk?*
- *Say it: sab ṭhīk?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *sab ṭhīk?*, then answer *hā̃, sab ṭhīk*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for I have to go, then the Hindi for how's it going, then say *sab ṭhīk?* again

Before you move on

What does सब ठीक? mean? (“All well?”.) Say it once more.

123.3 बहुत दिन हो गए (bahut din ho gae) — it’s been a long time

Before the new one: say the Hindi for how’s it going, then the Hindi for all well.

You’ll want to know: बहुत दिन हो गए

बहुत दिन हो गए (*bahut din ho gae*) — “it’s been a long time”, literally “many days have become”.

बहुत and दिन are both yours already.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बहुत दिन हो गए (*bahut din ho gae*) is “many days have become”. *bahut* comes from Sanskrit *bahutva*, “abundance” (CDIAL 9190), and *din* from *dina*, “day” (CDIAL 6328).

What you’ve built

A greeting for someone you have not seen in a while.

Your turn

- *Say it: bahut din ho gae*
- *Say it: bahut din ho gae*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bahut din ho gae!*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for how’s it going, then the Hindi for all well, then say *bahut din ho gae* again

Before you move on

What does बहुत दिन हो गए mean? (“It’s been a long time”.) Say it once more.

123.4 क्या चल रहा है? (kyā cal rahā hai?) — what's going on?

Before the new one: say the Hindi for all well, then the Hindi for it's been a long time.

You'll want to know: क्या चल रहा है?

क्या चल रहा है? (*kyā cal rahā hai?*) — "what's going on?", "what's up?".

It is **चलना**, "to go, to move", in the right-now form: what is moving in your life?

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

calnā, "to move, go", comes from Sanskrit *calati*, "goes away" (CDIAL 4715).

What you've built

A friendly opener.

Your turn

- *Say it: kyā cal rahā hai?*
- *Say it: kyā cal rahā hai?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *kyā cal rahā hai?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for all well, then the Hindi for it's been a long time, then say *kyā cal rahā hai?* again

Before you move on

What does क्या चल रहा है? mean? ("What's going on?".) Say it once more.

123.5 खाना खाया? (khānā khāyā?) — have you eaten?

Before the new one: say the Hindi for it's been a long time, then the Hindi for what's going on.

You'll want to know: खाना खाया?

खाना खाया? (*khānā khāyā?*) — "have you eaten?".

खाना is both "food" and "to eat": you *ate the eating.* Around a mealtime it is a greeting and a kindness.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खाना खाया? (*khānā khāyā?*) is "food, eaten?". The noun *khānā*, "food", comes from Sanskrit *khādana*, "food" (CDIAL 3867), and the verb from *khādati*, "chews, eats" (CDIAL 3865).

What you've built

How's it going, all well, long time, what's up, have you eaten.

Your turn

- *Say it: khānā khāyā?*
- *Say it: khānā khāyā?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *khānā khāyā?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for it's been a long time, then the Hindi for what's going on, then say *khānā khāyā?* again

Before you move on

What does **खाना खाया**? mean? ("Have you eaten?".) Say it once more.

Chapter 124

Hungry, Thirsty, Sleepy

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am hungry, thirsty or sleepy, that I am sweating, and that I have a headache.
>
> *Complete HI-C124-sirdard: say what the body needs.*

124.1 भूखा (bhūkhā) — hungry

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for what's going on, then the Hindi for have you eaten.

You'll want to know: भूखा

भूखा (*bhūkhā*) — "hungry". A woman says भूखी.
It is भूख, "hunger", made into a description. मैं भूखा हूँ — "I am hungry".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भूखा (*bhūkhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **bubhukṣaka*, "hungry", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9284). It is built on the Sanskrit "wish to eat", *bubhukṣā*.

What you've built

Hunger, made into how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhūkhā*
- *Say it: bhūkhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maiṁ bhūkhā hūṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for what's going on, then the Hindi for have you eaten, then say *bhūkhā* again

Before you move on

What does भूखा mean? ("Hungry".) Say it once more.

124.2 प्यासा (pyāsā) — thirsty

Before the new one: say the Hindi for have you eaten, then the Hindi for hungry.

You'll want to know: प्यासा

प्यासा (*pyāsā*) — "thirsty". A woman says प्यासी.
The same move: प्यास, "thirst", becomes प्यासा.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

प्यासा (*pyāsā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **pipāsaka*, "thirsty", a form CDIAL reconstructs beside Sanskrit *pipāsita* (CDIAL 8200).

What you've built

Thirst, made into how you are.

Your turn

- *Say it: pyāsā*
- *Say it: pyāsā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maiṁ pyāsā hūṁ*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for have you eaten, then the Hindi for hungry, then say *pyāsā* again

Before you move on

What does प्यासा mean? (“Thirsty”.) Say it once more.

124.3 नींद आ रही है (nīnd ā rahī hai) — I’m sleepy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for hungry, then the Hindi for thirsty.

You’ll want to know: नींद आ रही है

नींद आ रही है (*nīnd ā rahī hai*) — “I’m sleepy”, literally “sleep is coming”.

नींद is the sleep you know. Sleep *comes* to you, the way anger and laughter do.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नींद आ रही है (*nīnd ā rahī hai*) is “sleep is coming”. *nīnd* comes from Sanskrit *nidrā*, “sleep” (CDIAL 7200).

What you’ve built

Sleep, which comes to you.

Your turn

- *Say it: nīnd ā rahī hai*
- *Say it: nīnd ā rahī hai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe nīnd ā rahī hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for hungry, then the Hindi for thirsty, then say *nīnd ā rahī hai* again

Before you move on

What does नींद आ रही है mean? (“I’m sleepy”.) Say it once more.

124.4 पसीना (pasīnā) — sweat

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for thirsty, then the Hindi for I'm sleepy.

You'll want to know: पसीना

पसीना (*pasīnā*) — "sweat".

बहुत पसीना आ रहा है — "I'm sweating a lot", literally "a lot of sweat is coming".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पसीना (*pasīnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **prasvidana*, "sweating", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 8895). CDIAL also allows *prasvinna*, "sweated".

What you've built

Sweat, in the coming frame.

Your turn

- *Say it: pasīnā*
- *Say it: pasīnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bahut pasīnā ā rahā hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for thirsty, then the Hindi for I'm sleepy, then say *pasīnā* again

Before you move on

What does पसीना mean? ("Sweat".) Say it once more.

124.5 सिरदर्द (sirdard) — a headache

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for I'm sleepy, then the Hindi for sweat.

You’ll want to know: सिरदर्द

सिरदर्द (*sirdard*) — “a headache”.

It is सिर, “head”, and दर्द, “pain”, both yours already. मुझे सिरदर्द है — “I have a headache”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सिरदर्द (*sirdard*) joins two sources: *sir*, “head”, from Sanskrit *śiras* (CDIAL 12452), and *dard*, “pain”, usually traced to Persian *dard*.

What you’ve built

Hungry, thirsty, sleepy, sweat, and a headache.

Your turn

- *Say it: sirdard*
- *Say it: sirdard*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe sirdard hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for I’m sleepy, then the Hindi for sweat, then say *sirdard* again

Before you move on

What does सिरदर्द mean? (“A headache”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 125

Calm and Restless

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say I am calm, nervous or restless, that I don't feel like it, and that I enjoyed something.
>
> *Complete HI-C125-maza: moods, good and uneasy.*

125.1 शांत (śānt) — calm, peaceful

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for sweat, then the Hindi for a headache.

You'll want to know: शांत

शांत (*śānt*) — "calm, peaceful", of a person or a place.
 शांत रहिए — "please stay calm".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शांत (*śānt*) is Sanskrit *śānta*, "calm", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 12390).

What you've built

Calm.

Your turn

- *Say it: śānt*
- *Say it: śānt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śānt rahie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sweat, then the Hindi for a headache, then say *śānt* again

Before you move on

What does शांत mean? (“Calm, peaceful”.) Say it once more.

125.2 घबराहट (ghabrāhaṭ) — nervousness, panic

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a headache, then the Hindi for calm.

You’ll want to know: घबराहट

घबराहट (*ghabrāhaṭ*) — “nervousness”, a flutter of panic.
मुझे घबराहट हो रही है — “I’m feeling nervous”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घबराहट (*ghabrāhaṭ*) is the noun of *ghabrānā*, “to panic”. CDIAL lists Hindi *ghābrā*, “startled”, under a reconstructed **ghabbhara*, “confused” (CDIAL 4427).

What you’ve built

The opposite of calm.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghabrāhaṭ*
- *Say it: ghabrāhaṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe ghabrāhaṭ ho rahī hai*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a headache, then the Hindi for calm, then say *ghabrāhaṭ* again

Before you move on

What does **घबराहट** mean? (“Nervousness, panic”.) Say it once more.

125.3 बेचैन (becain) — restless, uneasy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for calm, then the Hindi for nervousness.

You’ll want to know: बेचैन

बेचैन (*becain*) — “restless, uneasy”.
बे- is “without”, and **चैन** is “peace”: restless is *without peace*.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बेचैन (*becain*) is “without ease”. *be-* is the Persian “without”; *cain*, “ease, rest”, is of uncertain origin, and CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

A word that shows its parts.

Your turn

- *Say it: becain*
- *Say it: becain*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maiṁ becain hūṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for calm, then the Hindi for nervousness, then say *becain* again

Before you move on

What does **बेचैन** mean? (“Restless, uneasy”.) Say it once more.

125.4 मन नहीं है (man nahīṁ hai) — I don't feel like it

Before the new one: say the Hindi for nervousness, then the Hindi for restless.

You'll want to know: मन नहीं है

मन नहीं है (*man nahīṁ hai*) — "I don't feel like it", literally "there is no mind for it".

मन is "mind, heart". आज खाने का मन नहीं है — "I don't feel like eating today".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मन नहीं है (*man nahīṁ hai*) is "the mind is not there". *man*, "mind, heart", comes from Sanskrit *manas*, "mind" (CDIAL 9822).

What you've built

A gentle refusal.

Your turn

- *Say it: man nahīṁ hai*
- *Say it: man nahīṁ hai*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āj man nahīṁ hai*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for nervousness, then the Hindi for restless, then say *man nahīṁ hai* again

Before you move on

What does मन नहीं है mean? ("I don't feel like it".) Say it once more.

125.5 मज़ा (mazā) — fun, enjoyment

Before the new one: say the Hindi for restless, then the Hindi for I don't feel like it.

You’ll want to know: मज़ा

मज़ा (*mazā*) — “fun, enjoyment”.

मज़ा आया — “I enjoyed it”, literally “fun came”. It comes to you, like laughter.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मज़ा (*mazā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *maza*, “taste, relish”.

What you’ve built

Calm, nervous, restless, not in the mood, and fun.

Your turn

- *Say it: mazā*
- *Say it: mazā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mazā āyā!*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for restless, then the Hindi for I don’t feel like it, then say *mazā* again

Before you move on

What does **मज़ा** mean? (“Fun, enjoyment”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 126

What Did You Say?

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can ask what someone said, ask for it once more, and say I did not understand or do not know.
>
> *Complete HI-C126-ek-bar-aur: keep a conversation going when you are lost.*

126.1 फिर से (phir se) — once more, over again

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for I don’t feel like it, then the Hindi for fun.

You’ll want to know: फिर से

फिर से (*phir se*) — “once more”, “from the start again”.
फिर से बोलिए — “please say it again”, a softer cousin of दोबारा.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फिर से (*phir se*) is *phir*, “again”, with *se*. CDIAL lists *phir* under a reconstructed **phirati*, “turns” (CDIAL 9078).

What you’ve built

A second way to ask again.

Your turn

- *Say it: phir se*
- *Say it: phir se*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phir se bolie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for I don't feel like it, then the Hindi for fun, then say *phir se* again

Before you move on

What does फिर से mean? ("Once more, over again".) Say it once more.

126.2 समझ नहीं आया (samajh nahīṁ āyā) — I didn't understand

Before the new one: say the Hindi for fun, then the Hindi for once more.

You'll want to know: समझ नहीं आया

समझ नहीं आया (*samajh nahīṁ āyā*) — "I didn't understand", literally "understanding did not come".

समझ is "understanding", from समझना. It comes, or it doesn't.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समझ नहीं आया (*samajh nahīṁ āyā*) is "understanding did not come". *samajh* comes from Sanskrit *saṁbudhyate*, "wakes up, understands" (CDIAL 12959).

What you've built

The honest sentence every learner needs.

Your turn

- *Say it: samajh nahīṁ āyā*

- *Say it: samajh nahīṁ āyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samajh nahīṁ āyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for fun, then the Hindi for once more, then say *samajh nahīṁ āyā* again

Before you move on

What does समझ नहीं आया mean? (“I didn’t understand”.) Say it once more.

126.3 क्या कहा? (kyā kahā?) — what did you say?

Before the new one: say the Hindi for once more, then the Hindi for I didn’t understand.

You’ll want to know: क्या कहा?

क्या कहा? (*kyā kahā?*) — “what did you say?”.

कहा is the past of **कहना**, “to say”. Short, and fine among friends; with a stranger, add **जी**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क्या कहा? (*kyā kahā?*) is “what was said?”. *kahnā*, “to say”, comes from Sanskrit *kathayati*, “converses with, describes” (CDIAL 2703).

What you’ve built

A quick request to hear it again.

Your turn

- *Say it: kyā kahā?*
- *Say it: kyā kahā?*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *kyā kahā?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for once more, then the Hindi for I didn’t understand, then say *kyā kahā?* again

Before you move on

What does क्या कहा? mean? (“What did you say?”.) Say it once more.

126.4 मुझे नहीं पता (mujhe nahīṁ patā) — I don’t know

Before the new one: say the Hindi for I didn’t understand, then the Hindi for what did you say.

You’ll want to know: मुझे नहीं पता

मुझे नहीं पता (*mujhe nahīṁ patā*) — “I don’t know”, literally “to me there is no knowing”.

The person sits in मुझे, the way it does for wanting and liking.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मुझे नहीं पता (*mujhe nahīṁ patā*) is “to me no knowledge”. The origin of *patā*, “knowledge, address”, is uncertain; CDIAL does not list it, though it lists *patyānā*, “to trust”, under Sanskrit *pratyaya*, “belief” (CDIAL 8640).

What you’ve built

An honest answer to a question you cannot answer.

Your turn

- *Say it: mujhe nahīṁ patā*
- *Say it: mujhe nahīṁ patā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mujhe nahīṁ patā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for I didn’t understand, then the Hindi for what did you say, then say *mujhe nahīṁ patā* again

Before you move on

What does मुझे नहीं पता mean? (“I don’t know”.) Say it once more.

126.5 एक बार और (ek bār aur) — one more time

Before the new one: say the Hindi for what did you say, then the Hindi for I don’t know.

You’ll want to know: एक बार और

एक बार और (*ek bār aur*) — “one more time”.

एक, “one”, बार, “time”, और, “more”. एक बार और बोलिए — “say it one more time”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

एक बार और (*ek bār aur*) is “one time more”. *bār* comes from Sanskrit *vāra*, “one’s turn” (CDIAL 11547), and *aur*, “more”, from *apara*, “other” (CDIAL 434).

What you’ve built

Once more, didn’t understand, what did you say, don’t know, one more time.

Your turn

- *Say it: ek bār aur*
- *Say it: ek bār aur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ek bār aur bolie*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for what did you say, then the Hindi for I don’t know, then say *ek bār aur* again

Before you move on

What does एक बार और mean? (“One more time”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 127

Not at All

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can answer with don't know, not at all, truly, is that so, and that'll do.
>
> *Complete HI-R127-second-pass-repair: repair and short answers, from cold.*

127.1 मालूम नहीं (mālūm nahīṁ) — don't know

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for I don't know, then the Hindi for one more time.

You'll want to know: मालूम नहीं

मालूम नहीं (*mālūm nahīṁ*) — "don't know", "no idea".

मालूम is "known". It says what मुझे नहीं पता says, with a different word for knowing.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मालूम नहीं (*mālūm nahīṁ*) is "not known". *mālūm* comes from Arabic *ma*^{c}*lūm*, "known", which reached Hindi through Persian; its root is ^{c}*-l-m* (Lane).

What you've built

A second I don't know.

Your turn

- *Say it: mālūm nahīṁ*
- *Say it: mālūm nahīṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mālūm nahīṁ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for I don't know, then the Hindi for one more time, then say *mālūm nahīṁ* again

Before you move on

What does मालूम नहीं mean? ("Don't know".) Say it once more.

127.2 बिलकुल नहीं (bilkul nahīṁ) — not at all

Before the new one: say the Hindi for one more time, then the Hindi for don't know.

You'll want to know: बिलकुल नहीं

बिलकुल नहीं (*bilkul nahīṁ*) — "not at all", "absolutely not".

बिलकुल is the "absolutely" you know; with नहीं it turns a no all the way down.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बिलकुल नहीं (*bilkul nahīṁ*) is *bilkul*, "absolutely", with *nahīṁ*, "not". *bilkul* is Arabic *bi-l-kull*, "with the whole"; *kull*, "all", is on the root *k-l-l* (Lane).

What you've built

The strongest no.

Your turn

- *Say it: bilkul nahīṁ*
- *Say it: bilkul nahīṁ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bilkul nahīṁ*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for one more time, then the Hindi for don't know, then say *bilkul nahīṁ* again

Before you move on

What does बिलकुल नहीं mean? ("Not at all".) Say it once more.

127.3 सचमुच (sacmuc) — truly, really

Before the new one: say the Hindi for don't know, then the Hindi for not at all.

You'll want to know: सचमुच

सचमुच (*sacmuc*) — "truly, really".

It opens on the सच you know. **सचमुच?** — "really?", a stronger **सच में?**.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सचमुच (*sacmuc*) is *sac*, "true", from Sanskrit *satya* (CDIAL 13112), followed by a rhyming *muc*. CDIAL does not list the pair, and *muc* has no clear source.

What you've built

Truly.

Your turn

- *Say it: sacmuc*
- *Say it: sacmuc*, once more
- *Say it:* ask *sacmuc?*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for don't know, then the Hindi for not at all, then say *sacmuc* again

Before you move on

What does सचमुच mean? ("Truly, really".) Say it once more.

127.4 अच्छा जी (acchā jī) — is that so?; all right then

Before the new one: say the Hindi for not at all, then the Hindi for truly.

You'll want to know: अच्छा जी

अच्छा जी (*acchā jī*) — "is that so?", or "all right then", by tone.

अच्छा is the "good" you know; alone it already means "oh, I see". जी makes it polite.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अच्छा जी (*acchā jī*) is *acchā*, "good", which goes back to Sanskrit *accha*, "clear", and reached Hindi through Punjabi (CDIAL 142), with the respectful *jī*, from *jīva*, "long live!" (CDIAL 5240).

What you've built

A polite way to show you are listening.

Your turn

- *Say it: acchā jī*
- *Say it: acchā jī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *acchā jī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for not at all, then the Hindi for truly, then say *acchā jī* again

Before you move on

What does अच्छा जी mean? ("Is that so?; all right then".) Say it once more.

127.5 चलेगा (calegā) — that'll do, that works

Before the new one: say the Hindi for truly, then the Hindi for is that so.

You’ll want to know: चलेगा

चलेगा (*calegā*) — “that’ll do”, “that works”, literally “it will go”.

It is चलना, “to go”, in the future. Offered a choice, चलेगा accepts it without fuss.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चलेगा (*calegā*) is the future of *calnā*, “to move, go”, which comes from Sanskrit *calati*, “goes away” (CDIAL 4715). “It will go” means “it will do”.

What you’ve built

Don’t know, not at all, truly, is that so, that’ll do.

Your turn

- *Say it: calegā*
- *Say it: calegā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *calegā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for truly, then the Hindi for is that so, then say *calegā* again

Before you move on

What does चलेगा mean? (“That’ll do, that works”.) Say it once more.

127.6 When you are lost, and short answers — a second pass

You did not understand. Say so, and ask for it once more.

Grammar Lens: two ways to say I don’t know

phrase	**literally**
मुझे नहीं पता	to me, no knowing
मालूम नहीं	not known

Both keep the knower out of the subject slot, the way Hindi does for wanting.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- ask what someone said; ask for it one more time
- say you don't know, two ways
- say "not at all"; then "truly?"
- show you are listening politely; accept a plan with "that'll do"

Before you move on

Once more? (फिर से.) Didn't understand? (समझ नहीं आया.) What did you say? (क्या कहा?) I don't know? (मुझे नहीं पता.) One more time? (एक बार और.) Don't know? (मालूम नहीं.) Not at all? (बिलकुल नहीं.) Truly? (सचमुच.) Is that so? (अच्छा जी.) That'll do? (चलेगा.)

127.7 What the body needs, and how you feel — a second pass

You have walked all afternoon. Say you are hungry, and thirsty.

Grammar Lens: things that come to you

phrase	**literally**
नींद आ रही है	sleep is coming
पसीना आ रहा है	sweat is coming
मज़ा आया	fun came

Sleep, sweat and fun all *come* to you, on आना.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- say you are sleepy; say you have a headache

- say you are sweating a lot
- ask a nervous friend to stay calm; say you feel restless
- say you don't feel like it today; then that you enjoyed it
- a friend offers a plan: "is that so?" then "that'll do"

Before you move on

Hungry? (भूखा.) Thirsty? (प्यासा.) Sleepy? (नींद आ रही है.) Sweat? (पसीना.) A headache? (सिरदर्द.) Calm? (शांत.) Nervousness? (घबराहट.) Restless? (बेचैन.) Not in the mood? (मन नहीं है.) Fun? (मज़ा.)

Chapter 128

Letters You Have Read All Along

Modes: 👁 **eyes** (2) ✎ **pen** (3) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** none of the 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can write the short i sign, the letter i and the letter nya, and find each one in a word I already say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 128: I can write the short i sign, the letter i and the letter nya, and find each one in a word I already say.*

128.1 ि (i kī mātrā) — the short i sign in शुक्रिया

> Before the new one: write ड and ़ once each, and name them.
>
> Now say शुक्रिया (*shukriyā*), “thanks”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you’ll notice: ि

ि — the short *i* sign.

It is inside शुक्रिया (*shukriyā*), “thanks”, one of the first words in this book. Look at क्रि: the sign stands **before** the consonants and is said **after** them, *kri*. It is the one Hindi vowel sign written ahead of the sound it follows.

Writing: ि

Put your pen on ि and follow its line. Copy the shape you can see — slowly, and larger than it is printed.

This book does not yet tell you **where to start this letter or which way to travel**. It is not written down here until it can be written down with a source. Copying what is in front of you needs no such source, and it is how the shape gets into your hand in the meantime.

Your turn

- *Look:* at शुक्रिया and point at ◌ि inside it
- *Trace it:* ◌ि three times, saying *i* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ◌ु, then ◌ि, from memory
- *Read it:* शुक्रिया aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ◌ि? (**i kī mātrā**, *i*.) Which word did it come from? (शुक्रिया, *shukriyā*, "thanks".)

128.2 इ (i) — the letter inside दिखाइए

Before the new one: write ◌ु and ◌ि once each, and name them.

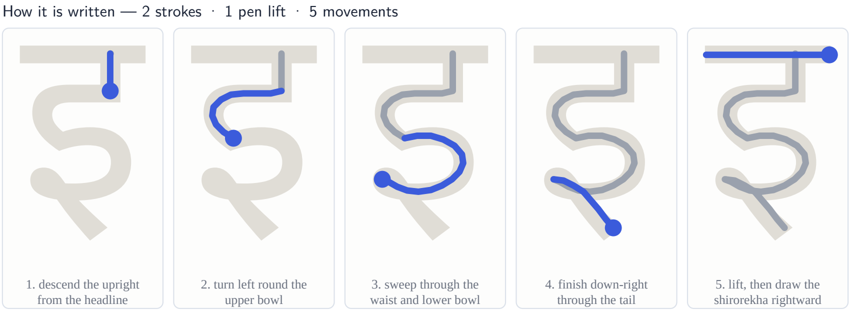
Now say दिखाइए (*dikhāie*), "please show me". You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

Script you'll notice: इ

इ — the letter *i*.

It is inside दिखाइए (*dikhāie*), "please show me". After ◌ा comes another vowel, and a vowel that follows a vowel has no consonant to ride on, so it is written as its own letter. ◌ि, from the last lesson, is the same vowel as a sign.

Writing: इ


How it is written — 2 strokes · 1 pen lift · 5 movements
1. descend the upright from the headline
2. turn left round the upper bowl
3. sweep through the waist and lower bowl
4. finish down-right through the tail
5. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Saurmandal, 'Devanagari इ stroke order.svg', panels 1–2, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How इ *is written, stroke by stroke*

- **1.** start here: descend the upright from the headline
- **2.** turn left and curve around the upper bowl without lifting
- **3.** without lifting, sweep right through the waist and around the lower bowl
- **4.** finish down-right through the tail without lifting
- **5.** lift, then draw the shirorekha left-to-right — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 1.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Saurmandal, 'Devanagari इ stroke order.svg', panels 1–2, Wikimedia Commons, 5 August 2023.

Your turn

- *Look:* at दिखाइए and point at इ inside it
- *Trace it:* इ three times, saying *i* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* ि, then इ, from memory
- *Read it:* दिखाइए aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — इ? (**i**, *i*.) Which word did it come from? (दिखाइए, *dikhāie*, “please show me”.)

128.3 ञ (ña) — the letter hidden inside ज्ञ

Before the new one: write ि and इ once each, and name them.

Now say संज्ञा (*saṁjñā*), “noun”. You have read it for a long time. This lesson takes one letter out of it and puts it in your hand.

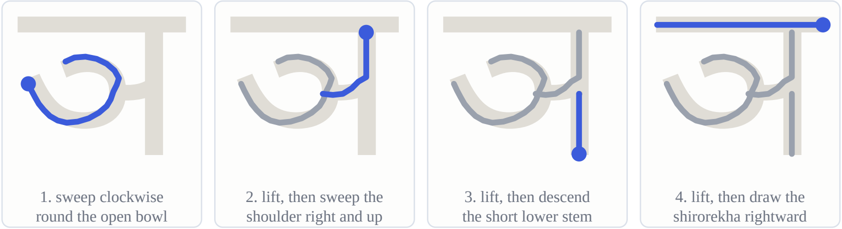
Script you’ll notice: ञ

ञ — *ña*, a nasal made where *j* is made.

It is hidden inside संज्ञा (*saṁjñā*), “noun”. The joined letter ज्ञ is ज and ञ written as one, and Hindi says the pair *gy*. You have been reading ञ inside that join without seeing it on its own.

Writing: ञ

How it is written — 4 strokes · 3 pen lifts · 4 movements



1. sweep clockwise round the open bowl

2. lift, then sweep the shoulder right and up

3. lift, then descend the short lower stem

4. lift, then draw the shirorekha rightward

Stroke order after Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ञ-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009
This order is attested, not standardised; the source records where it varies.

How ञ is written, stroke by stroke

- **1.** start here: sweep clockwise around the open-left bowl
- **2.** lift, then sweep the shoulder right and rise to the headline
- **3.** lift, then descend the short lower stem
- **4.** lift, then draw the shirorekha left-to-right — and only now lift

Pen lifts: 3.

Stroke order is one attested teaching order; hands and teachers vary. Source: Opiaterein, ‘Deva-ञ-order.gif’, strokes 1–4, Wikimedia Commons, 10 May 2009.

Your turn

- *Look:* at संज्ञा and point at ञ inside it
- *Trace it:* ञ three times, saying *ñ* as you finish each one
- *Write it:* इ, then ञ, from memory
- *Read it:* संज्ञा aloud once more

Before you move on

Which letter is this — ञ? (**ña**, *ñ*.) Which word did it come from? (संज्ञा, *saṁjñā*, “noun”.)

128.4 (three letters) — From the letter to the word — a first pass

Say शुक्रिया (*shukriyā*), then write the letter it gave you.

Your turn

letter	name	the word it came from
ि	*i kī mātrā*	शुक्रिया *shukriyā*
इ	*i*	दिखाइए *dikhāie*
ञ	*ña*	संज्ञा *saṁjñā*

- *Write it:* each letter in the table from memory, then check it
- *Say it:* the word each one came from
- *Read it:* each word in the table aloud, and point at its letter

Before you move on

Which word did each letter come from? (ि from शुक्रिया; इ from दिखाइए; ञ from संज्ञा.)

128.5 (three letters) — From the word back to the letter — a second pass

Write ञ without looking, then say the word it came from.

Your turn

letter	**name**	**the word it came from**
ि	*i kī mātrā*	शुक्रिया *shukriyā*
इ	*i*	दिखाइए *dikhāie*
ञ	*ña*	संज्ञा *saṁjñā*

- *Say it:* each word in the table, then write the letter it gave you without looking
- *Write it:* each letter once more, slowly, larger than it is printed

Before you move on

Say each word in the table once more, and name the letter you took from it.

Chapter 129

Lock, Pillow, Blanket, Curtain, Bucket

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a lock, a pillow, a blanket, a curtain and a bucket.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 129: I can say a lock, a pillow, a blanket, a curtain and a bucket.*

129.1 ताला (tālā) — a lock

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for is that so?; all right then, then the Hindi for that'll do, that works.
>
> Build two answers about yourself: मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ and मैं भारत में रहता हूँ.

You'll want to know: ताला

ताला — *tālā* — "a lock".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ताला (*tālā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *tāla*, "latch, bolt" (CDIAL 5749). CDIAL compares a Tamil word for "bar, bolt, latch".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tālā*
- *Say it: tālā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tālā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for is that so?; all right then, then the Hindi for that'll do, that works, then say *tālā* again

Before you move on

What does ताला mean? ("A lock".) Say it once more.

129.2 तकिया (takiyā) — a pillow

Before the new one: say the Hindi for that'll do, that works, then the Hindi for a lock.

You'll want to know: तकिया

तकिया — *takiyā* — "a pillow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तकिया (*takiyā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *takya*, "pillow, support", which Persian took from Arabic, on the root *w-k-ʾ*, "to lean" (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: takiyā*
- *Say it: takiyā*, once more

- *Say it:* say *takiyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for that'll do, that works, then the Hindi for a lock, then say *takiyā* again

Before you move on

What does तकिया mean? ("A pillow".) Say it once more.

129.3 कंबल (kambal) — a blanket

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lock, then the Hindi for a pillow.

Build रहना from its pieces: र, ह, ना.

You'll want to know: कंबल

कंबल — *kambal* — "a blanket".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कंबल (*kambal*) goes back to Sanskrit *kambala*, "woollen blanket" (CDIAL 2771). CDIAL marks the Hindi form as taken over from Punjabi, and mentions a possible Austroasiatic source for the Sanskrit word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kambal*
- *Say it: kambal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kambal*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lock, then the Hindi for a pillow, then say *kambal* again

Before you move on

What does कंबल mean? (“A blanket”.) Say it once more.

129.4 परदा (pardā) — a curtain

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pillow, then the Hindi for a blanket.

You’ll want to know: परदा

परदा — *pardā* — “a curtain”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

परदा (*pardā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *parda*, “curtain, veil”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pardā*
- *Say it: pardā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pardā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pillow, then the Hindi for a blanket, then say *pardā* again

Before you move on

What does परदा mean? (“A curtain”.) Say it once more.

129.5 बाल्टी (bālṭī) — a bucket

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a blanket, then the Hindi for a curtain.

You’ll want to know: बाल्टी

बाल्टी — *bālṭī* — “a bucket”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बाल्टी (*bālṭī*) is usually traced to Portuguese *balde*, “bucket”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bālṭī*
- *Say it: bālṭī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bālṭī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a blanket, then the Hindi for a curtain, then say *bālṭī* again

Before you move on

What does बाल्टी mean? (“A bucket”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 130

Hammer, Nail, Scissors, Thread, Comb

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a hammer, a nail, scissors, thread and a comb.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 130: I can say a hammer, a nail, scissors, thread and a comb.*

130.1 हथौड़ा (hathauṛā) — a hammer

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a curtain, then the Hindi for a bucket.

You'll want to know: हथौड़ा

हथौड़ा — *hathauṛā* — “a hammer”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हथौड़ा (*hathauṛā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **hastakūṭa*, “hand hammer”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 14028). It is built from *hasta*, “hand”, and *kūṭa*, “hammer”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hathauṛā*
- *Say it: hathauṛā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hathauṛā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a curtain, then the Hindi for a bucket, then say *hathauṛā* again

Before you move on

What does हथौड़ा mean? (“A hammer”.) Say it once more.

130.2 कील (kīl) — a nail (to hammer)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bucket, then the Hindi for a hammer.

You’ll want to know: कील

कील — *kīl* — “a nail (to hammer)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कील (*kīl*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kīla*, “stake, peg” (CDIAL 3202). CDIAL notes that both an Indo-European and a non-Aryan source have been proposed.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kīl*
- *Say it: kīl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kīl*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bucket, then the Hindi for a hammer, then say *kīl* again

Before you move on

What does कील mean? (“A nail (to hammer)”.) Say it once more.

130.3 कैंची (kaĩcī) — scissors

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a hammer, then the Hindi for a nail.

You’ll want to know: कैंची

कैंची — *kaĩcī* — “scissors”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कैंची (*kaĩcī*) is usually traced, through Persian *qaichī*, “scissors”, to Turkish.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaĩcī*
- *Say it: kaĩcī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaĩcī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a hammer, then the Hindi for a nail, then say *kaĩcī* again

Before you move on

What does कैंची mean? (“Scissors”.) Say it once more.

130.4 धागा (dhāgā) — thread

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a nail, then the Hindi for scissors.

You'll want to know: धागा

धागा — *dhāgā* — "thread".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धागा (*dhāgā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dhāgga*, "thread", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6770). Where **dhāgga* came from is not settled: CDIAL says it was possibly crossed with *dhara*, "a flock of raw cotton", but points as well to a second thread-word, **trāgga*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhāgā*
- *Say it: dhāgā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhāgā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a nail, then the Hindi for scissors, then say *dhāgā* again

Before you move on

What does धागा mean? ("Thread".) Say it once more.

130.5 कंघी (kaṅghī) — a comb

Before the new one: say the Hindi for scissors, then the Hindi for thread.

You’ll want to know: कंघी

कंघी — *kaṅghī* — “a comb”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कंघी (*kaṅghī*) goes back to Sanskrit *kaṅkata*, “comb” (CDIAL 2598). CDIAL marks the Hindi forms as taken over from Punjabi, and calls the Sanskrit word’s Indo-European origin doubtful.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṅghī*
- *Say it: kaṅghī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṅghī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for scissors, then the Hindi for thread, then say *kaṅghī* again

Before you move on

What does कंघी mean? (“A comb”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 131

Towel, Broom, Box, Bag, Candle

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a towel, a broom, a box, a bag and a candle.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 131: I can say a towel, a broom, a box, a bag and a candle.*

131.1 तौलिया (tauliyā) — a towel

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for thread, then the Hindi for a comb.

You’ll want to know: तौलिया

तौलिया — *tauliyā* — “a towel”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तौलिया (*tauliyā*) is usually traced to Portuguese *toalha*, “towel”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tauliyā*

- *Say it: tauliyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tauliyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for thread, then the Hindi for a comb, then say *tauliyā* again

Before you move on

What does तौलिया mean? (“A towel”.) Say it once more.

131.2 झाड़ू (jhāṛū) — a broom

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a comb, then the Hindi for a towel.

You’ll want to know: झाड़ू

झाड़ू — *jhāṛū* — “a broom”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झाड़ू (*jhāṛū*) is built on *jhāṛnā*, “to sweep, shake off”, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **jhāṭayati*, “shakes down” (CDIAL 5328).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhāṛū*
- *Say it: jhāṛū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhāṛū*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a comb, then the Hindi for a towel, then say *jhāṛū* again

Before you move on

What does झाड़ू mean? (“A broom”.) Say it once more.

131.3 डिब्बा (ḍibbā) — a box

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a towel, then the Hindi for a broom.

Say तीन, चार and पाँच, then the path behind the first: *trīṇi*, then *tiṇṇi*, then तीन.

You’ll want to know: डिब्बा

डिब्बा — *ḍibbā* — “a box”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डिब्बा (*ḍibbā*) belongs with Hindi *ḍabbā* and *ḍibbī*, “box”, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **ḍabba*, “box”, and its variant **ḍibba* (CDIAL 5528). CDIAL takes the group to be non-Aryan, perhaps Dravidian.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḍibbā*
- *Say it:* *ḍibbā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍibbā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a towel, then the Hindi for a broom, then say *ḍibbā* again

Before you move on

What does डिब्बा mean? (“A box”.) Say it once more.

131.4 थैला (thailā) — a bag

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a broom, then the Hindi for a box.

You'll want to know: थैला

थैला — *thailā* — "a bag".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

थैला (*thailā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *sthavi*, "sack, bag" (CDIAL 13746). The *-l-* is an added suffix; the Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: thailā*
- *Say it: thailā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *thailā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a broom, then the Hindi for a box, then say *thailā* again

Before you move on

What does थैला mean? ("A bag".) Say it once more.

131.5 मोमबत्ती (mombattī) — a candle

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a box, then the Hindi for a bag.

You'll want to know: मोमबत्ती

मोमबत्ती — *mombattī* — "a candle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मोमबत्ती (*mombattī*) is "wax-wick". *mom*, "wax", is usually traced to Persian *mom*, and *battī*, "wick", comes from Sanskrit *varti*, "wick" (CDIAL 11359).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mombattī*
- *Say it: mombattī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mombattī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a box, then the Hindi for a bag, then say *mombattī* again

Before you move on

What does **मोमबत्ती** mean? ("A candle".) Say it once more.

Chapter 132

Matches, Small bowl, Knife, Fan, Watch

Modes: 🚘 **voice** (5) 🚘 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say matches, a small bowl, a knife, a fan and a watch.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 132: I can say matches, a small bowl, a knife, a fan and a watch.*

132.1 माचिस (māchis) — matches

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bag, then the Hindi for a candle.

You'll want to know: माचिस

माचिस — *māchis* — "matches".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

माचिस (*māchis*) is a loan from English *matches*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: māchis*
- *Say it: māchis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *māchis*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bag, then the Hindi for a candle, then say *māchis* again

Before you move on

What does माचिस mean? ("Matches".) Say it once more.

132.2 कटोरी (kaṭorī) — a small bowl

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a candle, then the Hindi for matches.

You'll want to know: कटोरी

कटोरी — *kaṭorī* — "a small bowl".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कटोरी (*kaṭorī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **kaṭṭora*, "cup", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 2648).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭorī*
- *Say it: kaṭorī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭorī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a candle, then the Hindi for matches, then say *kaṭorī* again

Before you move on

What does कटोरी mean? (“A small bowl”.) Say it once more.

132.3 छुरी (churī) — a knife

Before the new one: say the Hindi for matches, then the Hindi for a small bowl.

You’ll want to know: छुरी

छुरी — *churī* — “a knife”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छुरी (*churī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kṣurī*, “knife, dagger” (CDIAL 3727). It is the feminine of *kṣura*, “razor”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: churī*
- *Say it: churī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *churī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for matches, then the Hindi for a small bowl, then say *churī* again

Before you move on

What does छुरी mean? (“A knife”.) Say it once more.

132.4 पंखा (pankhā) — a fan

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a small bowl, then the Hindi for a knife.

Walk one **दिन**: **दोपहर**, two *pahars*, now the whole afternoon, then **रात**, and **आधी रात**, half the night.

You'll want to know: पंखा

पंखा — *pankhā* — "a fan".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पंखा (*pankhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *pakṣa*, "wing, feather; fan" (CDIAL 7627). CDIAL notes the nasal and asks whether *puṅkha*, "feathered end of an arrow", crossed with it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pankhā*
- *Say it: pankhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pankhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a small bowl, then the Hindi for a knife, then say *pankhā* again

Before you move on

What does **पंखा** mean? ("A fan".) Say it once more.

132.5 घड़ी (ghaṛī) — a watch, a clock

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a knife, then the Hindi for a fan.

Name the week by its sky: **सोमवार**, the Moon's day, through **शनिवार**, Saturn's, and **रविवार**, the Sun's. It is the same seven-body week Rome kept.

You'll want to know: घड़ी

घड़ी — *ghaṛī* — "a watch, a clock".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घड़ी (*ghaṛī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ghaṭī*, "pot, water-clock" (CDIAL 4406). A *ghaṭī* was a small pot that sank as it filled, timing a short period.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghaṛī*
- *Say it: ghaṛī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghaṛī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a knife, then the Hindi for a fan, then say *ghaṛī* again

Before you move on

What does **घड़ी** mean? ("A watch, a clock".) Say it once more.

Chapter 133

Glasses, Umbrella, Wallet, Bed frame, Bedding

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say glasses, an umbrella, a wallet, a bed frame and bedding.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 133: I can say glasses, an umbrella, a wallet, a bed frame and bedding.*

133.1 चश्मा (caśmā) — glasses, spectacles

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a fan, then the Hindi for a watch.

Say the twelve borrowed months, जनवरी to दिसंबर. An older calendar still runs beside them.

You'll want to know: चश्मा

चश्मा — *caśmā* — "glasses, spectacles".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चश्मा (*caśmā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *chashma*, "spring, fountain", built on *chashm*, "eye". The sense "spectacles" grew up in India.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caśmā*
- *Say it: caśmā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caśmā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a fan, then the Hindi for a watch, then say *caśmā* again

Before you move on

What does चश्मा mean? ("Glasses, spectacles".) Say it once more.

133.2 छाता (chātā) — an umbrella

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a watch, then the Hindi for glasses.

You'll want to know: छाता

छाता — *chātā* — "an umbrella".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छाता (*chātā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *chattra*, "parasol" (CDIAL 4972).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chātā*
- *Say it: chātā*, once more

- *Say it:* say *chātā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a watch, then the Hindi for glasses, then say *chātā* again

Before you move on

What does छाता mean? (“An umbrella”.) Say it once more.

133.3 बटुआ (baṭuā) — a wallet, a purse

Before the new one: say the Hindi for glasses, then the Hindi for an umbrella.

You’ll want to know: बटुआ

बटुआ — *baṭuā* — “a wallet, a purse”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of बटुआ (*baṭuā*) is uncertain. CDIAL lists a Bihari *baṭuā*, “metal dish”, under **vartu*, “something round” (CDIAL 11364), but not this word for a purse.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baṭuā*
- *Say it: baṭuā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baṭuā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for glasses, then the Hindi for an umbrella, then say *baṭuā* again

Before you move on

What does बटुआ mean? (“A wallet, a purse”.) Say it once more.

133.4 पलंग (palaṅg) — a bed frame

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an umbrella, then the Hindi for a wallet.

You'll want to know: पलंग

पलंग — *palaṅg* — "a bed frame".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पलंग (*palaṅg*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *palyaṅka*, "bed" (CDIAL 7964). CDIAL notes that this form, with *-ṅg*, spread from the north-west.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: palaṅg*
- *Say it: palaṅg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *palaṅg*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an umbrella, then the Hindi for a wallet, then say *palaṅg* again

Before you move on

What does पलंग mean? ("A bed frame".) Say it once more.

133.5 बिस्तर (bistar) — bedding, a bed

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a wallet, then the Hindi for a bed frame.

You’ll want to know: बिस्तर

बिस्तर — *bistar* — “bedding, a bed”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बिस्तर (*bistar*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *bistar*, “bedding, bed”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bistar*
- *Say it: bistar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bistar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a wallet, then the Hindi for a bed frame, then say *bistar* again

Before you move on

What does बिस्तर mean? (“Bedding, a bed”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 134

Bottle, Pencil, Picture, Mirror, Ring

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a bottle, a pencil, a picture, a mirror and a ring.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 134: I can say a bottle, a pencil, a picture, a mirror and a ring.*

134.1 बोतल (botal) — a bottle

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bed frame, then the Hindi for bedding.
>
> Order three things two ways: पहली, दूसरी, तीसरी, then एक ... दूसरा. Count on to नौवाँ and दसवाँ.

You’ll want to know: बोतल

बोतल — *botal* — “a bottle”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बोतल (*botal*) is usually traced to English *bottle*; some trace it to Portuguese *botelha*, “bottle”, which reached India first. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: botal*
- *Say it: botal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *botal*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bed frame, then the Hindi for bedding, then say *botal* again

Before you move on

What does बोतल mean? ("A bottle".) Say it once more.

134.2 पेंसिल (pensil) — a pencil

Before the new one: say the Hindi for bedding, then the Hindi for a bottle.

Say the four mind verbs and what each first meant: लिखना, to scratch; पढ़ना, to recite; समझना, to wake up to; सोचना, to burn.

You'll want to know: पेंसिल

पेंसिल — *pensil* — "a pencil".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पेंसिल (*pensil*) is a loan from English *pencil.*

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pensil*
- *Say it: pensil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pensil*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for bedding, then the Hindi for a bottle, then say *pensil* again

Before you move on

What does **पेंसिल** mean? (“A pencil”.) Say it once more.

134.3 तस्वीर (tasvīr) — a picture

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bottle, then the Hindi for a pencil.

You’ll want to know: तस्वीर

तस्वीर — *tasvīr* — “a picture”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तस्वीर (*tasvīr*) is a loan from Arabic *taṣwīr*, “a picturing, a portrait”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṣ-w-r* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tasvīr*
- *Say it: tasvīr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tasvīr*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bottle, then the Hindi for a pencil, then say *tasvīr* again

Before you move on

What does तस्वीर mean? (“A picture”.) Say it once more.

134.4 शीशा (śīśā) — a mirror, glass

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pencil, then the Hindi for a picture.

You’ll want to know: शीशा

शीशा — *śīśā* — “a mirror, glass”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शीशा (*śīśā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *shīsha*, “glass”. It is a different word from Hindi *sīsā*, “lead”, which comes from Sanskrit *sīsa* (CDIAL 13445).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śīśā*
- *Say it: śīśā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śīśā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pencil, then the Hindi for a picture, then say *śīśā* again

Before you move on

What does शीशा mean? (“A mirror, glass”.) Say it once more.

134.5 अंगूठी (aṅgūṭhī) — a ring

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a picture, then the Hindi for a mirror.

You'll want to know: अंगूठी

अंगूठी — *aṅgūṭhī* — "a ring".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अंगूठी (*aṅgūṭhī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **aṅguṣṭhiya*, "of the thumb", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 138). It is built on *aṅguṣṭha*, "thumb": a ring was "the thumb's thing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṅgūṭhī*
- *Say it: aṅgūṭhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṅgūṭhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a picture, then the Hindi for a mirror, then say *aṅgūṭhī* again

Before you move on

What does अंगूठी mean? ("A ring".) Say it once more.

Chapter 135

Sandal, Shoe, Sock, Shirt, Trousers

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a sandal, a shoe, a sock, a shirt and trousers.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 135: I can say a sandal, a shoe, a sock, a shirt and trousers.*

135.1 चप्पल (cappal) — a sandal, a slipper

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mirror, then the Hindi for a ring.

You’ll want to know: चप्पल

चप्पल — *cappal* — “a sandal, a slipper”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of चप्पल (*cappal*) is uncertain, and CDIAL has no entry for it. DEDR, under Dravidian words for “sandal” such as Telugu *ceppu*, adds “Cf. H. cappal” (DEDR 1963): a comparison, not a settled source.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cappal*
- *Say it: cappal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cappal*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mirror, then the Hindi for a ring, then say *cappal* again

Before you move on

What does चप्पल mean? (“A sandal, a slipper”.) Say it once more.

135.2 जूता (jūtā) — a shoe

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a ring, then the Hindi for a sandal.

You’ll want to know: जूता

जूता — *jūtā* — “a shoe”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जूता (*jūtā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *yukta*, “joined, yoked” (CDIAL 10479). CDIAL lists *jūtā*, “shoe”, here: the shoe as the thing fastened on.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jūtā*
- *Say it: jūtā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jūtā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a ring, then the Hindi for a sandal, then say *jūtā* again

Before you move on

What does जूता mean? (“A shoe”.) Say it once more.

135.3 मोज़ा (mozā) — a sock

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sandal, then the Hindi for a shoe.

You’ll want to know: मोज़ा

मोज़ा — *mozā* — “a sock”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मोज़ा (*mozā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *mōza*, “sock, stocking”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mozā*
- *Say it: mozā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mozā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sandal, then the Hindi for a shoe, then say *mozā* again

Before you move on

What does मोज़ा mean? (“A sock”.) Say it once more.

135.4 कमीज़ (kamīz) — a shirt

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a shoe, then the Hindi for a sock.

You’ll want to know: कमीज़

कमीज़ — *kamīz* — “a shirt”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कमीज़ (*kamīz*) is a loan from Arabic *qamīṣ*, “shirt”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *q-m-ṣ* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kamīz*
- *Say it: kamīz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kamīz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a shoe, then the Hindi for a sock, then say *kamīz* again

Before you move on

What does कमीज़ mean? (“A shirt”.) Say it once more.

135.5 पैंट (paiṇṭ) — trousers

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sock, then the Hindi for a shirt.

You’ll want to know: पैंट

पैंट — *paiṇṭ* — “trousers”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पैंट (*paiṇṭ*) is a loan from English *pants*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paiṇṭ*
- *Say it: paiṇṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paiṇṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sock, then the Hindi for a shirt, then say *paiṇṭ* again

Before you move on

What does पैंट mean? ("Trousers".) Say it once more.

Chapter 136

Kurta, Sari, Scarf, Cap, Coat

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a kurta, a sari, a scarf, a cap and a coat.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 136: I can say a kurta, a sari, a scarf, a cap and a coat.*

136.1 कुर्ता (kurtā) — a kurta

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a shirt, then the Hindi for trousers.
>
> Say हरा and पीला, green and yellow, two colour words Hindi inherited.

You'll want to know: कुर्ता

कुर्ता — *kurtā* — "a kurta".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कुर्ता (*kurtā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kurta*, "a long shirt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kurtā*
- *Say it: kurtā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kurtā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a shirt, then the Hindi for trousers, then say *kurtā* again

Before you move on

What does कुर्ता mean? ("A kurta".) Say it once more.

136.2 साड़ी (sāṛī) — a sari

Before the new one: say the Hindi for trousers, then the Hindi for a kurta.

Say the colours and their stories: लाल, a red gem's name; नीला, indigo's dark blue; सफ़ेद, a Persian loan.

You'll want to know: साड़ी

साड़ी — *sāṛī* — "a sari".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

साड़ी (*sāṛī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *śāṭī*, "strip of cloth, garment" (CDIAL 12381). CDIAL notes that the word also travelled west, to Pashto and to Persian *shāl*, the source of English *shawl*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāṛī*
- *Say it: sāṛī*, once more

- *Say it:* say *sāṛī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for trousers, then the Hindi for a kurta, then say *sāṛī* again

Before you move on

What does साड़ी mean? (“A sari”.) Say it once more.

136.3 दुपट्टा (dupaṭṭā) — a scarf, a dupatta

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a kurta, then the Hindi for a sari.

You’ll want to know: दुपट्टा

दुपट्टा — *dupaṭṭā* — “a scarf, a dupatta”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दुपट्टा (*dupaṭṭā*) is built from *du-*, “two”, and *paṭṭā*, “a strip of cloth”: a cloth of two breadths. CDIAL lists Hindi *paṭṭī*, “strip of cloth”, under Sanskrit *paṭṭa*, “cloth”, probably of non-Aryan source (CDIAL 7700). It also reconstructs **dupaṭṭikā*, “two cloths” (CDIAL 6413), but lists no Hindi form under it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dupaṭṭā*
- *Say it: dupaṭṭā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dupaṭṭā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a kurta, then the Hindi for a sari, then say *dupaṭṭā* again

Before you move on

What does दुपट्टा mean? (“A scarf, a dupatta”.) Say it once more.

136.4 टोपी (ṭopī) — a cap, a hat

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sari, then the Hindi for a scarf.

You’ll want to know: टोपी

टोपी — *ṭopī* — “a cap, a hat”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टोपी (*ṭopī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ṭoppa*, “hat, covering”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5481). CDIAL calls a link with Sanskrit *āṭopa*, “swelling”, very doubtful.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ṭopī*
- *Say it:* *ṭopī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭopī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sari, then the Hindi for a scarf, then say *ṭopī* again

Before you move on

What does टोपी mean? (“A cap, a hat”.) Say it once more.

136.5 कोट (koṭ) — a coat

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a scarf, then the Hindi for a cap.

You'll want to know: कोट

कोट — *koṭ* — “a coat”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कोट (*koṭ*) is a loan from English *coat*. It is a different word from Hindi *koṭ*, “fort”, from Sanskrit *koṭṭa* (CDIAL 3500).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koṭ*
- *Say it: koṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a scarf, then the Hindi for a cap, then say *koṭ* again

Before you move on

What does कोट mean? (“A coat”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 137

Jumper, Egg, Meat, Potato, Onion

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a jumper, an egg, meat, a potato and an onion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 137: I can say a jumper, an egg, meat, a potato and an onion.*

137.1 स्वेटर (sveṭar) — a jumper

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cap, then the Hindi for a coat.

You'll want to know: स्वेटर

स्वेटर — *sveṭar* — "a jumper".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

स्वेटर (*sveṭar*) is a loan from English *sweater*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sveṭar*

- *Say it: svețar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *svețar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cap, then the Hindi for a coat, then say *svețar* again

Before you move on

What does स्वेटर mean? (“A jumper”.) Say it once more.

137.2 अंडा (aṇḍā) — an egg

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a coat, then the Hindi for a jumper.

Greet the day through: सुप्रभात, शुभ दोपहर, शुभ संध्या. Then say सुबह से शाम तक, from सुबह to शाम.

You’ll want to know: अंडा

अंडा — *aṇḍā* — “an egg”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अंडा (*aṇḍā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *āṇḍa*, “egg” (CDIAL 1111). CDIAL records the view that the word is of Munda origin, and asks, with a query, whether the form *aṇḍā* began in western Hindi.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṇḍā*
- *Say it: aṇḍā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṇḍā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a coat, then the Hindi for a jumper, then say *aṇḍā* again

Before you move on

What does अंडा mean? (“An egg”.) Say it once more.

137.3 गोश्त (gośt) — meat

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a jumper, then the Hindi for an egg.

You’ll want to know: गोश्त

गोश्त — *gośt* — “meat”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गोश्त (*gośt*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *gōsht*, “meat”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gośt*
- *Say it: gośt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gośt*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a jumper, then the Hindi for an egg, then say *gośt* again

Before you move on

What does गोश्त mean? (“Meat”.) Say it once more.

137.4 आलू (ālū) — a potato

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an egg, then the Hindi for meat.

You'll want to know: आलू

आलू — *ālū* — "a potato".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आलू (*ālū*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ālu*, "an edible root" (CDIAL 1388). When the potato came to India, it took the name of an older root vegetable.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ālū*
- *Say it: ālū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ālū*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an egg, then the Hindi for meat, then say *ālū* again

Before you move on

What does आलू mean? ("A potato".) Say it once more.

137.5 प्याज़ (pyāz) — an onion

Before the new one: say the Hindi for meat, then the Hindi for a potato.

You'll want to know: प्याज़

प्याज़ — *pyāz* — "an onion".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

प्याज़ (*pyāz*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *piyāz*, "onion".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pyāz*
- *Say it: pyāz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pyāz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for meat, then the Hindi for a potato, then say *pyāz* again

Before you move on

What does **प्याज़** mean? ("An onion".) Say it once more.

Chapter 138

Garlic, Ginger, Tomato, Carrot, Cauliflower

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say garlic, ginger, a tomato, a carrot and a cauliflower.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 138: I can say garlic, ginger, a tomato, a carrot and a cauliflower.*

138.1 लहसुन (lahsun) — garlic

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a potato, then the Hindi for an onion.

You'll want to know: लहसुन

लहसुन — *lahsun* — "garlic".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लहसुन (*lahsun*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *laśuna*, "garlic" (CDIAL 10990).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lahsun*
- *Say it: lahsun*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lahsun*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a potato, then the Hindi for an onion, then say *lahsun* again

Before you move on

What does लहसुन mean? (“Garlic”.) Say it once more.

138.2 अदरक (adrak) — ginger

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an onion, then the Hindi for garlic.

You’ll want to know: अदरक

अदरक — *adrak* — “ginger”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अदरक (*adrak*) goes back to Sanskrit *ārdraka*, “fresh ginger” (CDIAL 1341). CDIAL lists the inherited Hindi form as *ādā*; *adrak* keeps more of the Sanskrit shape, so it was probably taken over later and lightly reshaped, a semi-tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: adrak*
- *Say it: adrak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *adrak*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an onion, then the Hindi for garlic, then say *adrak* again

Before you move on

What does अदरक mean? (“Ginger”.) Say it once more.

138.3 टमाटर (ṭamāṭar) — a tomato

Before the new one: say the Hindi for garlic, then the Hindi for ginger.

You’ll want to know: टमाटर

टमाटर — *ṭamāṭar* — “a tomato”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टमाटर (*ṭamāṭar*) is a loan from English *tomato*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭamāṭar*
- *Say it: ṭamāṭar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭamāṭar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for garlic, then the Hindi for ginger, then say *ṭamāṭar* again

Before you move on

What does टमाटर mean? (“A tomato”.) Say it once more.

138.4 गाजर (gājar) — a carrot

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for ginger, then the Hindi for a tomato.

You’ll want to know: गाजर

गाजर — *gājar* — “a carrot”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गाजर (*gājar*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *gārjara*, “carrot” (CDIAL 4140). The Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *gājar*
- *Say it:* *gājar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gājar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for ginger, then the Hindi for a tomato, then say *gājar* again

Before you move on

What does गाजर mean? (“A carrot”.) Say it once more.

138.5 गोभी (gobhī) — a cauliflower

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tomato, then the Hindi for a carrot.

You’ll want to know: गोभी

गोभी — *gobhī* — “a cauliflower”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गोभी (*gobhī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *gojihvikā*, “a kind of plant” (CDIAL 4270). The Sanskrit name means “cow’s tongue”; CDIAL glosses the Hindi word “cabbage”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gobhī*
- *Say it: gobhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gobhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tomato, then the Hindi for a carrot, then say *gobhī* again

Before you move on

What does गोभी mean? (“A cauliflower”.) Say it once more.

138.6 The house and things you use — a first pass

Say the words for a carrot and a cauliflower.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a lock, a pillow, a blanket, a curtain, a bucket
- a hammer, a nail, scissors, thread, a comb
- a towel, a broom, a box, a bag, a candle
- matches, a small bowl, a knife, a fan, a watch
- glasses, an umbrella, a wallet, a bed frame, bedding

Before you move on

A lock? (ताला, *tālā.*) A pillow? (तकिया, *takiyā.*) A blanket? (कंबल, *kambal.*) A curtain? (परदा, *pardā.*) A bucket? (बाल्टी, *bālṭī.*) A hammer? (हथौड़ा, *hathauṛā.*) A nail? (कील, *kīl.*) Scissors? (कैंची, *kaĩcī.*) Thread? (धागा, *dhāgā.*) A comb? (कंघी, *kaṅghī.*) A towel? (तौलिया, *tauliyā.*) A broom? (झाड़ू, *jhāṛū.*) A box? (डिब्बा, *ḍibbā.*) A bag? (थैला, *thailā.*) A candle? (मोमबत्ती, *mombattī.*) Matches? (माचिस, *māchis.*) A small bowl? (कटोरी, *kaṭorī.*) A knife? (छुरी, *churī.*) A fan? (पंखा, *pankhā.*) A watch? (घड़ी, *ghaṛī.*) Glasses? (चश्मा, *caśmā.*) An umbrella? (छाता, *chātā.*) A wallet? (बटुआ, *baṭuā.*) A bed frame? (पलंग, *palaṅg.*) Bedding? (बिस्तर, *bistar.*)

138.7 Things you carry and wear — a second pass

Say the words for a bottle and a pencil.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a bottle, a pencil, a picture, a mirror, a ring
- a sandal, a shoe, a sock, a shirt, trousers
- a kurta, a sari, a scarf, a cap, a coat
- a jumper, an egg, meat, a potato, an onion
- garlic, ginger, a tomato, a carrot, a cauliflower

Before you move on

A bottle? (बोतल, *botal.*) A pencil? (पेंसिल, *pensil.*) A picture? (तस्वीर, *tasvīr.*) A mirror? (शीशा, *śīśā.*) A ring? (अंगूठी, *aṅgūṭhī.*) A sandal? (चप्पल, *cappal.*) A shoe? (जूता, *jūtā.*) A sock? (मोज़ा, *mozā.*) A shirt? (कमीज़, *kamīz.*) Trousers? (पैंट, *paiṇṭ.*) A kurta? (कुर्ता, *kurtā.*) A sari? (साड़ी, *sāṛī.*) A scarf? (दुपट्टा, *dupaṭṭā.*) A cap? (टोपी, *ṭopī.*) A coat? (कोट, *koṭ.*) A jumper? (स्वेटर, *sveṭar.*) An egg? (अंडा, *aṇḍā.*) Meat? (गोश्त, *gośt.*) A potato? (आलू, *ālū.*) An onion? (प्याज़, *pyāz.*) Garlic? (लहसुन, *lahsun.*) Ginger? (अदरक, *adrak.*) A tomato? (टमाटर,

ṭamāṭar.) A carrot? (**गाजर**, *gājar.*) A cauliflower? (**गोभी**, *gobhī.*)

Chapter 139

Peas, Cucumber, Mango, Banana, Apple

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say peas, a cucumber, a mango, a banana and an apple.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 139: I can say peas, a cucumber, a mango, a banana and an apple.*

139.1 मटर (maṭar) — peas

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a carrot, then the Hindi for a cauliflower.

You'll want to know: मटर

मटर — *maṭar* — "peas".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मटर (*maṭar*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **maṭṭara*, "pea", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9724).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṭar*
- *Say it: maṭar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṭar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a carrot, then the Hindi for a cauliflower, then say *maṭar* again

Before you move on

What does मटर mean? (“Peas”.) Say it once more.

139.2 खीरा (khīrā) — a cucumber

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cauliflower, then the Hindi for peas.

You’ll want to know: खीरा

खीरा — *khīrā* — “a cucumber”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खीरा (*khīrā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kṣīraka*, “a fragrant plant” (CDIAL 3697). It is built on *kṣīra*, “milk”; the Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khīrā*
- *Say it: khīrā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khīrā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cauliflower, then the Hindi for peas, then say *khīrā* again

Before you move on

What does खीरा mean? (“A cucumber”.) Say it once more.

139.3 आम (ām) — a mango

Before the new one: say the Hindi for peas, then the Hindi for a cucumber.

Say मुझे चाय पसंद है. पसंद is not a verb, and मुझे means *to me*.

You’ll want to know: आम

आम — *ām* — “a mango”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आम (*ām*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *āmra*, “mango tree; its fruit” (CDIAL 1268).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ām*
- *Say it: ām*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ām*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for peas, then the Hindi for a cucumber, then say *ām* again

Before you move on

What does आम mean? (“A mango”.) Say it once more.

139.4 केला (kelā) — a banana

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cucumber, then the Hindi for a mango.

You'll want to know: केला

केला — *kelā* — "a banana".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

केला (*kelā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kadala*, "the banana plant" (CDIAL 2712). CDIAL takes the Sanskrit word from an Austroasiatic language.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kelā*
- *Say it: kelā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kelā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cucumber, then the Hindi for a mango, then say *kelā* again

Before you move on

What does केला mean? ("A banana".) Say it once more.

139.5 सेब (seb) — an apple

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mango, then the Hindi for a banana.

You'll want to know: सेब

सेब — *seb* — "an apple".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सेब (*seb*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sēb*, “apple”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: seb*
- *Say it: seb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *seb*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mango, then the Hindi for a banana, then say *seb* again

Before you move on

What does सेब mean? (“An apple”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 140

Grapes, Orange, Watermelon, Coconut, Yoghurt

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say grapes, an orange, a watermelon, a coconut and yoghurt.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 140: I can say grapes, an orange, a watermelon, a coconut and yoghurt.*

140.1 अंगूर (aṅgūr) — grapes

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a banana, then the Hindi for an apple.

You'll want to know: अंगूर

अंगूर — *aṅgūr* — "grapes".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अंगूर (*aṅgūr*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *angūr*, "grape".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṅgūr*
- *Say it: aṅgūr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṅgūr*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a banana, then the Hindi for an apple, then say *aṅgūr* again

Before you move on

What does अंगूर mean? (“Grapes”.) Say it once more.

140.2 संतरा (santarā) — an orange

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an apple, then the Hindi for grapes.

Count छह to दस, then ग्यारह to बीस, and by tens सत्तर, अस्सी, नब्बे. Which one is *one less than twenty*? (उन्नीस.)

You’ll want to know: संतरा

संतरा — *santarā* — “an orange”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of संतरा (*santarā*) is uncertain. It is often linked with the Portuguese town of Sintra, once written *Cintra*, but no source settles it, and CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: santarā*
- *Say it: santarā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *santarā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an apple, then the Hindi for grapes, then say *santarā* again

Before you move on

What does **संतरा** mean? (“An orange”.) Say it once more.

140.3 तरबूज़ (tarbūz) — a watermelon

Before the new one: say the Hindi for grapes, then the Hindi for an orange.

You’ll want to know: तरबूज़

तरबूज़ — *tarbūz* — “a watermelon”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तरबूज़ (*tarbūz*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *tarbuz*, “watermelon”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tarbūz*
- *Say it: tarbūz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tarbūz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for grapes, then the Hindi for an orange, then say *tarbūz* again

Before you move on

What does **तरबूज़** mean? (“A watermelon”.) Say it once more.

140.4 नारियल (nāriyal) — a coconut

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an orange, then the Hindi for a watermelon.

You'll want to know: नारियल

नारियल — *nāriyal* — "a coconut".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नारियल (*nāriyal*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *nārikela*, "coconut palm and fruit" (CDIAL 7075). CDIAL, after Bloch, takes the Sanskrit word from a Dravidian compound, comparing Tamil *nāri*, "fibre", and *kēḷi*, "coconut palm".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāriyal*
- *Say it: nāriyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāriyal*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an orange, then the Hindi for a watermelon, then say *nāriyal* again

Before you move on

What does नारियल mean? ("A coconut".) Say it once more.

140.5 दही (dahī) — yoghurt

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a watermelon, then the Hindi for a coconut.

You’ll want to know: दही

दही — *dahī* — “yoghurt”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दही (*dahī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *dadhi*, “thick sour milk” (CDIAL 6146).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dahī*
- *Say it: dahī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dahī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a watermelon, then the Hindi for a coconut, then say *dahī* again

Before you move on

What does दही mean? (“Yoghurt”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 141

Butter, Paneer, Honey, Chilli, Flour

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say butter, paneer, honey, a chilli and flour.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 141: I can say butter, paneer, honey, a chilli and flour.*

141.1 मक्खन (makkhan) — butter

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a coconut, then the Hindi for yoghurt.

You'll want to know: मक्खन

मक्खन — *makkhan* — “butter”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मक्खन (*makkhan*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mrakṣaṇa*, “rubbing in; ointment, oil” (CDIAL 10378). Butter was first “the thing rubbed in”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: makkhan*
- *Say it: makkhan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *makkhan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a coconut, then the Hindi for yoghurt, then say *makkhan* again

Before you move on

What does **मक्खन** mean? (“Butter”.) Say it once more.

141.2 पनीर (panīr) — paneer, cottage cheese

Before the new one: say the Hindi for yoghurt, then the Hindi for butter.

You’ll want to know: पनीर

पनीर — *panīr* — “paneer, cottage cheese”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पनीर (*panīr*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *panīr*, “cheese”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: panīr*
- *Say it: panīr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *panīr*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for yoghurt, then the Hindi for butter, then say *panīr* again

Before you move on

What does पनीर mean? (“Paneer, cottage cheese”.) Say it once more.

141.3 शहद (śahad) — honey

Before the new one: say the Hindi for butter, then the Hindi for paneer.

You’ll want to know: शहद

शहद — *śahad* — “honey”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शहद (*śahad*) is a loan from Arabic *shahd*, “honey”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *sh-h-d* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śahad*
- *Say it: śahad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śahad*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for butter, then the Hindi for paneer, then say *śahad* again

Before you move on

What does शहद mean? (“Honey”.) Say it once more.

141.4 मिर्च (mirc) — a chilli

Before the new one: say the Hindi for paneer, then the Hindi for honey.

You’ll want to know: मिर्च

मिर्च — *mirc* — “a chilli”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मिर्च (*mirc*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **maricca*, a by-form CDIAL reconstructs beside Sanskrit *marīca*, “peppercorn” (CDIAL 9875). The plain *marīca* gave Hindi a different word, *mirī*, “black pepper”. CDIAL takes the Sanskrit word from an Austroasiatic language. When the chilli came to India, it took the name of black pepper.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mirc*
- *Say it: mirc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mirc*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for paneer, then the Hindi for honey, then say *mirc* again

Before you move on

What does मिर्च mean? (“A chilli”.) Say it once more.

141.5 आटा (āṭā) — flour

Before the new one: say the Hindi for honey, then the Hindi for a chilli.

You’ll want to know: आटा

आटा — *āṭā* — “flour”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आटा (*āṭā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ārta*, “flour”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 1338). CDIAL compares Persian *ārd*, “flour”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *āṭā*
- *Say it:* *āṭā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āṭā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for honey, then the Hindi for a chilli, then say *āṭā* again

Before you move on

What does आटा mean? (“Flour”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 142

Samosa, Lassi, Juice, Mountain, River

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a samosa, lassi, juice, a mountain and a river.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 142: I can say a samosa, lassi, juice, a mountain and a river.*

142.1 समोसा (samosā) — a samosa

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a chilli, then the Hindi for flour.

You'll want to know: समोसा

समोसा — *samosā* — "a samosa".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समोसा (*samosā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sanbosa*, "a fried pastry".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samosā*
- *Say it: samosā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samosā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a chilli, then the Hindi for flour, then say *samosā* again

Before you move on

What does समोसा mean? (“A samosa”.) Say it once more.

142.2 लस्सी (lassī) — lassi, a yoghurt drink

Before the new one: say the Hindi for flour, then the Hindi for a samosa.

You’ll want to know: लस्सी

लस्सी — *lassī* — “lassi, a yoghurt drink”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लस्सी (*lassī*) goes back to a reconstructed **lassī*, “buttermilk”, which CDIAL builds from Punjabi and Lahnda *lassī* and Sindhi *lasī* (CDIAL 10998). It lists no Hindi form, and it gives no older source.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lassī*
- *Say it: lassī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lassī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for flour, then the Hindi for a samosa, then say *lassī* again

Before you move on

What does लस्सी mean? (“Lassi, a yoghurt drink”.) Say it once more.

142.3 जूस (jūs) — juice

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a samosa, then the Hindi for lassi.

You’ll want to know: जूस

जूस — *jūs* — “juice”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जूस (*jūs*) is a loan from English *juice*. It is a different word from Hindi *jūs*, “broth”, from Sanskrit *yūṣa* (CDIAL 10521).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jūs*
- *Say it: jūs*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jūs*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a samosa, then the Hindi for lassi, then say *jūs* again

Before you move on

What does जूस mean? (“Juice”.) Say it once more.

142.4 पहाड़ (pahāṛ) — a mountain

Before the new one: say the Hindi for lassi, then the Hindi for juice.

You’ll want to know: पहाड़

पहाड़ — *pahāṛ* — “a mountain”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पहाड़ (*pahāṛ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **pāhāḍa*, “rock, hill”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 8141). CDIAL connects it, probably, with Sanskrit *pāṣāṇa*, “stone”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pahāṛ*
- *Say it: pahāṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pahāṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for lassi, then the Hindi for juice, then say *pahāṛ* again

Before you move on

What does पहाड़ mean? (“A mountain”.) Say it once more.

142.5 नदी (nadī) — a river

Before the new one: say the Hindi for juice, then the Hindi for a mountain.

Name the six seasons, not four: वसंत, ग्रीष्म, वर्षा, शरद्, हेमंत, शिशिर.

You’ll want to know: नदी

नदी — *nadī* — “a river”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नदी (*nadī*) is Sanskrit *nadī*, “river”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nadī*
- *Say it: nadī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nadī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for juice, then the Hindi for a mountain, then say *nadī* again

Before you move on

What does नदी mean? (“A river”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 143

Lake, Sea, Forest, Tree, Root

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a lake, the sea, a forest, a tree and a root.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 143: I can say a lake, the sea, a forest, a tree and a root.*

143.1 झील (jhīl) — a lake

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mountain, then the Hindi for a river.

You’ll want to know: झील

झील — *jhīl* — “a lake”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झील (*jhīl*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **jhilla*, “swamp, lake”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5392).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhīl*
- *Say it: jhīl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhīl*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mountain, then the Hindi for a river, then say *jhīl* again

Before you move on

What does **झील** mean? (“A lake”.) Say it once more.

143.2 समुद्र (samudra) — the sea

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a river, then the Hindi for a lake.

You’ll want to know: समुद्र

समुद्र — *samudra* — “the sea”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समुद्र (*samudra*) is Sanskrit *samudra*, “sea”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 13236).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samudra*
- *Say it: samudra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samudra*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a river, then the Hindi for a lake, then say *samudra* again

Before you move on

What does समुद्र mean? (“The sea”.) Say it once more.

143.3 जंगल (jaṅgal) — a forest

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lake, then the Hindi for the sea.

You’ll want to know: जंगल

जंगल — *jaṅgal* — “a forest”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जंगल (*jaṅgal*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jāṅgala*, “arid, sparse in trees” (CDIAL 5177). CDIAL notes a likely non-Aryan origin. The sense moved from “waste land” to “forest”, and English took it back as *jungle*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jaṅgal*
- *Say it: jaṅgal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jaṅgal*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lake, then the Hindi for the sea, then say *jaṅgal* again

Before you move on

What does जंगल mean? (“A forest”.) Say it once more.

143.4 पेड़ (peṛ) — a tree

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the sea, then the Hindi for a forest.

You'll want to know: पेड़

पेड़ — *peṛ* — "a tree".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पेड़ (*peṛ*) is inherited, but only as far back as a reconstruction. CDIAL's addenda set up **peḍa*, "tree", from Punjabi and Hindi *peṛ* (CDIAL 8377a), and give it no Sanskrit source. It is a different word from *peṛ*, "lump" (CDIAL 8377).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *peṛ*
- *Say it:* *peṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the sea, then the Hindi for a forest, then say *peṛ* again

Before you move on

What does पेड़ mean? ("A tree".) Say it once more.

143.5 जड़ (jaṛ) — a root

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a forest, then the Hindi for a tree.

You'll want to know: जड़

जड़ — *jaṛ* — "a root".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जड़ (*jaṛ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jaṭā*, "twisted hair; fibrous root" (CDIAL 5086). CDIAL weighs a Dravidian and a Munda source for the word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jaṛ*
- *Say it: jaṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jaṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a forest, then the Hindi for a tree, then say *jaṛ* again

Before you move on

What does जड़ mean? ("A root".) Say it once more.

Chapter 144

Stone, Sand, Wave, Shore, Electricity

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a stone, sand, a wave, a shore and electricity.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 144: I can say a stone, sand, a wave, a shore and electricity.*

144.1 पत्थर (patthar) — a stone

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tree, then the Hindi for a root.

You’ll want to know: पत्थर

पत्थर — *patthar* — “a stone”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पत्थर (*patthar*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *prastara*, “anything strewn; flat surface; stone” (CDIAL 8857).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: patthar*
- *Say it: patthar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *patthar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tree, then the Hindi for a root, then say *patthar* again

Before you move on

What does पत्थर mean? (“A stone”.) Say it once more.

144.2 रेत (ret) — sand

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a root, then the Hindi for a stone.

You’ll want to know: रेत

रेत — *ret* — “sand”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रेत (*ret*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *retra*, “perfumed powder” (CDIAL 10816). CDIAL doubts a suggested Munda source; the Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ret*
- *Say it: ret*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ret*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a root, then the Hindi for a stone, then say *ret* again

Before you move on

What does रेत mean? (“Sand”.) Say it once more.

144.3 लहर (lahar) — a wave

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a stone, then the Hindi for sand.

You’ll want to know: लहर

लहर — *lahar* — “a wave”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लहर (*lahar*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *laharī*, “large wave” (CDIAL 10999).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lahar*
- *Say it: lahar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lahar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a stone, then the Hindi for sand, then say *lahar* again

Before you move on

What does लहर mean? (“A wave”.) Say it once more.

144.4 किनारा (kinārā) — a shore, a bank

Before the new one: say the Hindi for sand, then the Hindi for a wave.

You’ll want to know: किनारा

किनारा — *kinārā* — “a shore, a bank”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

किनारा (*kinārā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kinār*, “edge, shore”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kinārā*
- *Say it: kinārā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kinārā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sand, then the Hindi for a wave, then say *kinārā* again

Before you move on

What does किनारा mean? (“A shore, a bank”.) Say it once more.

144.5 बिजली (bijlī) — electricity; lightning

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a wave, then the Hindi for a shore.

You’ll want to know: बिजली

बिजली — *bijlī* — “electricity; lightning”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बिजली (*bijlī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vidyullatā*, "forked lightning" (CDIAL 11745). It is built from *vidyut*, "lightning", and *latā*, "creeper": lightning as a forking vine. The sense "electricity" came later.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bijlī*
- *Say it: bijlī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bijlī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a wave, then the Hindi for a shore, then say *bijlī* again

Before you move on

What does बिजली mean? ("Electricity; lightning".) Say it once more.

Chapter 145

Storm, Fog, Snow, Wind, Lion

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a storm, fog, snow, wind and a lion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 145: I can say a storm, fog, snow, wind and a lion.*

145.1 आँधी (ā̃dhī) — a storm

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a shore, then the Hindi for electricity; lightning.

You'll want to know: आँधी

आँधी — *ā̃dhī* — "a storm".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आँधी (*āṁdhī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *andhikā*, "night" (CDIAL 390). It is built on *andha*, "blind, dark".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ā̃dhī*
- *Say it: ā̃dhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ā̃dhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a shore, then the Hindi for electricity; lightning, then say *ā̃dhī* again

Before you move on

What does आँधी mean? (“A storm”.) Say it once more.

145.2 कोहरा (kohrā) — fog

Before the new one: say the Hindi for electricity; lightning, then the Hindi for a storm.

Say मौसम, the weather, then गर्मी है and ठंड है.

You’ll want to know: कोहरा

कोहरा — *kohrā* — “fog”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कोहरा (*kohrā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **kuha*, “fog, mist”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 3386).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kohrā*
- *Say it: kohrā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kohrā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for electricity; lightning, then the Hindi for a storm, then say *kohrā* again

Before you move on

What does कोहरा mean? (“Fog”.) Say it once more.

145.3 बर्फ़ (barf) — snow, ice

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a storm, then the Hindi for fog.

Name the six seasons, not four: वसंत, ग्रीष्म, वर्षा, शरद्, हेमंत, शिशिर.

You’ll want to know: बर्फ़

बर्फ़ — *barf* — “snow, ice”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बर्फ़ (*barf*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *barf*, “snow, ice”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: barf*
- *Say it: barf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *barf*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a storm, then the Hindi for fog, then say *barf* again

Before you move on

What does बर्फ़ mean? (“Snow, ice”.) Say it once more.

145.4 हवा (havā) — wind, air

Before the new one: say the Hindi for fog, then the Hindi for snow.

You'll want to know: हवा

हवा — *havā* — "wind, air".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हवा (*havā*) is a loan from Arabic *hawāʾ*, "air", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *h-w-y* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: havā*
- *Say it: havā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *havā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for fog, then the Hindi for snow, then say *havā* again

Before you move on

What does हवा mean? ("Wind, air".) Say it once more.

145.5 शेर (śer) — a lion

Before the new one: say the Hindi for snow, then the Hindi for wind.

You'll want to know: शेर

शेर — *śer* — "a lion".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शेर (*śer*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sher*, “lion, tiger”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śer*
- *Say it: śer*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śer*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for snow, then the Hindi for wind, then say *śer* again

Before you move on

What does **शेर** mean? (“A lion”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 146

Bear, Elephant, Camel, Donkey, Sheep

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a bear, an elephant, a camel, a donkey and a sheep.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 146: I can say a bear, an elephant, a camel, a donkey and a sheep.*

146.1 भालू (bhālū) — a bear

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for wind, then the Hindi for a lion.
>
> Say बिल्ली, and the older Sanskrit word behind it, *biḍāla*.

You'll want to know: भालू

भालू — *bhālū* — "a bear".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भालू (*bhālū*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *bhallūka*, "bear" (CDIAL 9415). CDIAL gives an Indo-European source as possible and mentions a proposed Austroasiatic one.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhālū*
- *Say it: bhālū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhālū*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for wind, then the Hindi for a lion, then say *bhālū* again

Before you move on

What does भालू mean? ("A bear".) Say it once more.

146.2 हाथी (hāthī) — an elephant

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lion, then the Hindi for a bear.

You'll want to know: हाथी

हाथी — *hāthī* — "an elephant".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हाथी (*hāthī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *hastin*, "having hands; elephant" (CDIAL 14039). The elephant was "the one with a hand", its trunk.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hāthī*

- *Say it: hāthī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hāthī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lion, then the Hindi for a bear, then say *hāthī* again

Before you move on

What does हाथी mean? (“An elephant”.) Say it once more.

146.3 ऊँट (ū̃ṭ) — a camel

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bear, then the Hindi for an elephant.

You’ll want to know: ऊँट

ऊँट — *ū̃ṭ* — “a camel”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ऊँट (*ūṁṭ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *uṣṭra*, “buffalo; camel” (CDIAL 2387).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ū̃ṭ*
- *Say it: ū̃ṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ū̃ṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bear, then the Hindi for an elephant, then say *ū̃ṭ* again

Before you move on

What does ऊँट mean? (“A camel”.) Say it once more.

146.4 गधा (gadhā) — a donkey

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an elephant, then the Hindi for a camel.

You’ll want to know: गधा

गधा — *gadhā* — “a donkey”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गधा (*gadhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *gardabha*, “ass” (CDIAL 4054).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gadhā*
- *Say it: gadhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gadhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an elephant, then the Hindi for a camel, then say *gadhā* again

Before you move on

What does गधा mean? (“A donkey”.) Say it once more.

146.5 भेड़ (bheṛ) — a sheep

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a camel, then the Hindi for a donkey.

You’ll want to know: भेड़

भेड़ — *bheṛ* — “a sheep”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भेड़ (*bheṛ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *bheḍra*, “ram” (CDIAL 9606). CDIAL takes the word, after Przyluski, from an Austroasiatic language.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bheṛ*
- *Say it: bheṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bheṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a camel, then the Hindi for a donkey, then say *bheṛ* again

Before you move on

What does भेड़ mean? (“A sheep”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 147

Rabbit, Deer, Fox, Wolf, Crow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a rabbit, a deer, a fox, a wolf and a crow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 147: I can say a rabbit, a deer, a fox, a wolf and a crow.*

147.1 खरगोश (khargoś) — a rabbit

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a donkey, then the Hindi for a sheep.

You’ll want to know: खरगोश

खरगोश — *khargoś* — “a rabbit”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खरगोश (*khargoś*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *khargōsh*, “hare”. It is built from *khar*, “donkey”, and *gōsh*, “ear”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khargoś*
- *Say it: khargoś*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khargoś*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a donkey, then the Hindi for a sheep, then say *khargoś* again

Before you move on

What does **खरगोश** mean? (“A rabbit”.) Say it once more.

147.2 हिरन (hiran) — a deer

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sheep, then the Hindi for a rabbit.

You’ll want to know: हिरन

हिरन — *hiran* — “a deer”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हिरन (*hiran*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *hariṇa*, “deer” (CDIAL 13982). It is built on *hari*, “yellow”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hiran*
- *Say it: hiran*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hiran*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sheep, then the Hindi for a rabbit, then say *hiran* again

Before you move on

What does हिरन mean? (“A deer”.) Say it once more.

147.3 लोमड़ी (lomṛī) — a fox

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a rabbit, then the Hindi for a deer.

You’ll want to know: लोमड़ी

लोमड़ी — *lomṛī* — “a fox”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लोमड़ी (*lomṛī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **lompaṭa*, the third of the fox-words in CDIAL’s entry for Sanskrit *lomaṭaka*, “fox”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 11153). CDIAL adds that these words are possibly blends of an older **lopi-* with *loman*, “body hair”, and *lūma*, “tail”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lomṛī*
- *Say it: lomṛī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lomṛī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a rabbit, then the Hindi for a deer, then say *lomṛī* again

Before you move on

What does लोमड़ी mean? (“A fox”.) Say it once more.

147.4 भेड़िया (bheṛiyā) — a wolf

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a deer, then the Hindi for a fox.

You'll want to know: भेड़िया

भेड़िया — *bheṛiyā* — "a wolf".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भेड़िया (*bheṛiyā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **bheḍriya*, "sheep-killer", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9608b). It is built on *bheḍra*, "ram".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bheṛiyā*
- *Say it: bheṛiyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bheṛiyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a deer, then the Hindi for a fox, then say *bheṛiyā* again

Before you move on

What does भेड़िया mean? ("A wolf".) Say it once more.

147.5 कौआ (kauā) — a crow

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a fox, then the Hindi for a wolf.

You'll want to know: कौआ

कौआ — *kauā* — "a crow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कौआ (*kauā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kāka*, "crow" (CDIAL 2993). CDIAL notes that the word imitates the bird's call.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kauā*
- *Say it: kauā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kauā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a fox, then the Hindi for a wolf, then say *kauā* again

Before you move on

What does कौआ mean? ("A crow".) Say it once more.

147.6 Clothes and food — a first pass

Say the words for a wolf and a crow.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- peas, a cucumber, a mango, a banana, an apple
- grapes, an orange, a watermelon, a coconut, yoghurt
- butter, paneer, honey, a chilli, flour
- a samosa, lassi, juice, a mountain, a river

Before you move on

Peas? (मटर, *maṭar.*) A cucumber? (खीरा, *khīrā.*) A mango? (आम, *ām.*) A banana? (केला, *kelā.*) An apple? (सेब, *seb.*) Grapes? (अंगूर, *aṅgūr.*) An orange? (संतरा, *santarā.*) A watermelon? (तरबूज़, *tarbūz.*) A coconut? (नारियल, *nāriyal.*) Yoghurt? (दही, *dahī.*) Butter? (मक्खन, *makkhan.*) Paneer? (पनीर, *panīr.*) Honey? (शहद, *śahad.*) A chilli? (मिर्च, *mirc.*) Flour? (आटा, *āṭā.*) A samosa? (समोसा, *samosā.*) Lassi? (लस्सी, *lassī.*) Juice? (जूस, *jūs.*) A mountain? (पहाड़, *pahāṛ.*) A river? (नदी, *nadī.*)

147.7 Food and nature — a second pass

Say the words for a lake and the sea.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a lake, the sea, a forest, a tree, a root
- a stone, sand, a wave, a shore, electricity; lightning
- a storm, fog, snow, wind, a lion
- a bear, an elephant, a camel, a donkey, a sheep
- a rabbit, a deer, a fox, a wolf, a crow

Before you move on

A lake? (झील, *jhīl.*) The sea? (समुद्र, *samudra.*) A forest? (जंगल, *jaṅgal.*) A tree? (पेड़, *peṛ.*) A root? (जड़, *jaṛ.*) A stone? (पत्थर, *patthar.*) Sand? (रेत, *ret.*) A wave? (लहर, *lahar.*) A shore? (किनारा, *kinārā.*) Electricity; lightning? (बिजली, *bijlī.*) A storm? (आँधी, *ā̃dhī.*) Fog? (कोहरा, *kohrā.*) Snow? (बर्फ़, *barf.*) Wind? (हवा, *havā.*) A lion? (शेर, *śer.*) A bear? (भालू, *bhālū.*) An elephant? (हाथी, *hāthī.*) A camel? (ऊँट, *ū̃ṭ.*) A donkey? (गधा, *gadhā.*) A sheep? (भेड़, *bheṛ.*) A rabbit? (खरगोश, *khargoś.*) A deer? (हिरन, *hiran.*) A fox? (लोमड़ी, *lomṛī.*) A wolf? (भेड़िया, *bheṛiyā.*) A crow? (कौआ, *kauā.*)

Chapter 148

Pigeon, Parrot, Owl, Butterfly, Fly

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a pigeon, a parrot, an owl, a butterfly and a fly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 148: I can say a pigeon, a parrot, an owl, a butterfly and a fly.*

148.1 कबूतर (kabūtar) — a pigeon

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a wolf, then the Hindi for a crow.

You'll want to know: कबूतर

कबूतर — *kabūtar* — "a pigeon".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कबूतर (*kabūtar*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kabūtar*, "pigeon".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kabūtar*

- *Say it: kabūtar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kabūtar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a wolf, then the Hindi for a crow, then say *kabūtar* again

Before you move on

What does कबूतर mean? ("A pigeon".) Say it once more.

148.2 तोता (totā) — a parrot

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a crow, then the Hindi for a pigeon.

Order three things two ways: पहली, दूसरी, तीसरी, then एक … दूसरा. Count on to नौवाँ and दसवाँ.

You'll want to know: तोता

तोता — *totā* — "a parrot".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तोता (*totā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *ṭūṭī*, "parrot".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: totā*
- *Say it: totā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *totā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a crow, then the Hindi for a pigeon, then say *totā* again

Before you move on

What does तोता mean? (“A parrot”.) Say it once more.

148.3 उल्लू (ullū) — an owl

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pigeon, then the Hindi for a parrot.

You’ll want to know: उल्लू

उल्लू — *ullū* — “an owl”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उल्लू (*ullū*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ulūka*, “owl” (CDIAL 2359).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ullū*
- *Say it: ullū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ullū*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pigeon, then the Hindi for a parrot, then say *ullū* again

Before you move on

What does उल्लू mean? (“An owl”.) Say it once more.

148.4 तितली (titlī) — a butterfly

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a parrot, then the Hindi for an owl.

You’ll want to know: तितली

तितली — *titlī* — “a butterfly”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of तितली (*titlī*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: titlī*
- *Say it: titlī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *titlī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a parrot, then the Hindi for an owl, then say *titlī* again

Before you move on

What does तितली mean? (“A butterfly”.) Say it once more.

148.5 मक्खी (makkhī) — a fly

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an owl, then the Hindi for a butterfly.

You’ll want to know: मक्खी

मक्खी — *makkhī* — “a fly”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मक्खी (*makkhī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *makṣikā*, “fly, bee” (CDIAL 9696).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: makkhī*
- *Say it: makkhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *makkhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an owl, then the Hindi for a butterfly, then say *makkhī* again

Before you move on

What does मक्खी mean? ("A fly".) Say it once more.

Chapter 149

Mosquito, Ant, Frog, Tortoise, Mouse

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a mosquito, an ant, a frog, a tortoise and a mouse.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 149: I can say a mosquito, an ant, a frog, a tortoise and a mouse.*

149.1 मच्छर (macchar) — a mosquito

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a butterfly, then the Hindi for a fly.

You’ll want to know: मच्छर

मच्छर — *macchar* — “a mosquito”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मच्छर (*macchar*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *matsara*, “mosquito, fly” (CDIAL 9757). The Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists; CDIAL suggests it was named for its humming.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: macchar*
- *Say it: macchar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *macchar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a butterfly, then the Hindi for a fly, then say *macchar* again

Before you move on

What does मच्छर mean? ("A mosquito".) Say it once more.

149.2 चींटी (cīṇṭī) — an ant

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a fly, then the Hindi for a mosquito.

You'll want to know: चींटी

चींटी — *cīṇṭī* — "an ant".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of चींटी (*cīṇṭī*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cīṇṭī*
- *Say it: cīṇṭī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cīṇṭī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a fly, then the Hindi for a mosquito, then say *cīṇṭī* again

Before you move on

What does चींटी mean? (“An ant”.) Say it once more.

149.3 मेंढक (meṇḍhak) — a frog

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mosquito, then the Hindi for an ant.

You’ll want to know: मेंढक

मेंढक — *meṇḍhak* — “a frog”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मेंढक (*meṇḍhak*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *maṇḍūka*, “frog” (CDIAL 9746). CDIAL does not list the Hindi form, and notes that words for “frog” took many irregular shapes, partly through taboo.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: meṇḍhak*
- *Say it: meṇḍhak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *meṇḍhak*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mosquito, then the Hindi for an ant, then say *meṇḍhak* again

Before you move on

What does मेंढक mean? (“A frog”.) Say it once more.

149.4 कछुआ (kachuā) — a tortoise

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an ant, then the Hindi for a frog.

You'll want to know: कछुआ

कछुआ — *kachuā* — "a tortoise".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कछुआ (*kachuā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kacchapa*, "turtle, tortoise" (CDIAL 2619).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kachuā*
- *Say it: kachuā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kachuā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an ant, then the Hindi for a frog, then say *kachuā* again

Before you move on

What does कछुआ mean? ("A tortoise".) Say it once more.

149.5 चूहा (cūhā) — a mouse

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a frog, then the Hindi for a tortoise.

Say तीन, चार and पाँच, then the path behind the first: *trīṇi*, then *tiṇṇi*, then तीन.

You’ll want to know: चूहा

चूहा — *cūhā* — “a mouse”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चूहा (*cūhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **cūha*, “rat, mouse”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4899).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cūhā*
- *Say it: cūhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cūhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a frog, then the Hindi for a tortoise, then say *cūhā* again

Before you move on

What does चूहा mean? (“A mouse”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 150

Elbow, Wrist, Thumb, Fingernail, Cheek

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an elbow, a wrist, a thumb, a fingernail and a cheek.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 150: I can say an elbow, a wrist, a thumb, a fingernail and a cheek.*

150.1 कोहनी (kohnī) — an elbow

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tortoise, then the Hindi for a mouse.
>
> Build two answers about yourself: मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ and मैं भारत में रहता हूँ.

You'll want to know: कोहनी

कोहनी — *kohnī* — “an elbow”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कोहनी (*kohnī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kaphoṇi*, “elbow” (CDIAL 2757). CDIAL prefers a Munda source for the Sanskrit word to a Dravidian one.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kohnī*
- *Say it: kohnī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kohnī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tortoise, then the Hindi for a mouse, then say *kohnī* again

Before you move on

What does **कोहनी** mean? ("An elbow".) Say it once more.

150.2 कलाई (kalāī) — a wrist

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mouse, then the Hindi for an elbow.

You'll want to know: कलाई

कलाई — *kalāī* — "a wrist".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कलाई (*kalāī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kalācī*, "forearm" (CDIAL 2930). The Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kalāī*

- *Say it: kalāī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kalāī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mouse, then the Hindi for an elbow, then say *kalāī* again

Before you move on

What does कलाई mean? (“A wrist”.) Say it once more.

150.3 अंगूठा (aṅgūṭhā) — a thumb

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an elbow, then the Hindi for a wrist.

You’ll want to know: अंगूठा

अंगूठा — *aṅgūṭhā* — “a thumb”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अंगूठा (*aṅgūṭhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *aṅguṣṭha*, “thumb” (CDIAL 137).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṅgūṭhā*
- *Say it: aṅgūṭhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṅgūṭhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an elbow, then the Hindi for a wrist, then say *aṅgūṭhā* again

Before you move on

What does अंगूठा mean? (“A thumb”.) Say it once more.

150.4 नाखून (nākhūn) — a fingernail

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a wrist, then the Hindi for a thumb.

You’ll want to know: नाखून

नाखून — *nākhūn* — “a fingernail”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाखून (*nākhūn*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *nākhun*, “fingernail”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nākhūn*
- *Say it: nākhūn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nākhūn*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a wrist, then the Hindi for a thumb, then say *nākhūn* again

Before you move on

What does नाखून mean? (“A fingernail”.) Say it once more.

150.5 गाल (gāl) — a cheek

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a thumb, then the Hindi for a fingernail.

You’ll want to know: गाल

गाल — *gāl* — “a cheek”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गाल (*gāl*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *galla*, “cheek” (CDIAL 4089). CDIAL notes the view that it comes from Dravidian.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāl*
- *Say it: gāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gāl*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a thumb, then the Hindi for a fingernail, then say *gāl* again

Before you move on

What does **गाल** mean? (“A cheek”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 151

Chin, Tongue, Neck, Chest, Waist

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the chin, the tongue, the neck, the chest and the waist.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 151: I can say the chin, the tongue, the neck, the chest and the waist.*

151.1 ठोड़ी (ṭhoṛī) — the chin

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a fingernail, then the Hindi for a cheek.

You’ll want to know: ठोड़ी

ठोड़ी — *ṭhoṛī* — “the chin”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ठोड़ी (*ṭhoṛī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *tuṇḍa*, “beak, snout” (CDIAL 5853). CDIAL calls the word certainly non-Aryan and probably Munda.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭhoṛī*
- *Say it: ṭhoṛī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭhoṛī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a fingernail, then the Hindi for a cheek, then say *ṭhoṛī* again

Before you move on

What does ठोड़ी mean? (“The chin”.) Say it once more.

151.2 जीभ (jībh) — the tongue

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cheek, then the Hindi for the chin.

You’ll want to know: जीभ

जीभ — *jībh* — “the tongue”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जीभ (*jībh*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jihvā*, “tongue” (CDIAL 5228).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jībh*
- *Say it: jībh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jībh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cheek, then the Hindi for the chin, then say *jībh* again

Before you move on

What does जीभ mean? (“The tongue”.) Say it once more.

151.3 गर्दन (gardan) — the neck

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the chin, then the Hindi for the tongue.

You’ll want to know: गर्दन

गर्दन — *gardan* — “the neck”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गर्दन (*gardan*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *gardan*, “neck”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gardan*
- *Say it: gardan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gardan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the chin, then the Hindi for the tongue, then say *gardan* again

Before you move on

What does गर्दन mean? (“The neck”.) Say it once more.

151.4 छाती (chātī) — the chest

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the tongue, then the Hindi for the neck.

You'll want to know: छाती

छाती — *chātī* — "the chest".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छाती (*chātī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **chātti*, "chest, breast", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5014).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chātī*
- *Say it: chātī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chātī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the tongue, then the Hindi for the neck, then say *chātī* again

Before you move on

What does छाती mean? ("The chest".) Say it once more.

151.5 कमर (kamar) — the waist

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the neck, then the Hindi for the chest.

You'll want to know: कमर

कमर — *kamar* — "the waist".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कमर (*kamar*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kamar*, "waist".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kamar*
- *Say it: kamar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kamar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the neck, then the Hindi for the chest, then say *kamar* again

Before you move on

What does कमर mean? ("The waist".) Say it once more.

Chapter 152

Blood, Post office, Library, Temple, Mosque

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say blood, a post office, a library, a temple and a mosque.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 152: I can say blood, a post office, a library, a temple and a mosque.*

152.1 ख़ून (khūn) — blood

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for the chest, then the Hindi for the waist.

You'll want to know: ख़ून

ख़ून — *khūn* — "blood".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ख़ून (*khūn*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *khūn*, "blood".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khūn*
- *Say it: khūn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khūn*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the chest, then the Hindi for the waist, then say *khūn* again

Before you move on

What does ख़ून mean? ("Blood".) Say it once more.

152.2 डाकघर (ḍākghar) — a post office

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for the waist, then the Hindi for blood.

You'll want to know: डाकघर

डाकघर — *ḍākghar* — "a post office".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डाकघर (*ḍākghar*) is "post-house": *ḍāk*, "the post", from a reconstructed **ḍakka*, "relay, post", which CDIAL asks may belong with **ḍakk*, "shout" (CDIAL 5519), with *ghar*, "house", from *ghara* (CDIAL 4428).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ḍākghar*
- *Say it: ḍākghar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍākghar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the waist, then the Hindi for blood, then say *ḍākghar* again

Before you move on

What does डाकघर mean? (“A post office”.) Say it once more.

152.3 पुस्तकालय (pustakālay) — a library

Before the new one: say the Hindi for blood, then the Hindi for a post office.

Say the four mind verbs and what each first meant: लिखना, to scratch; पढ़ना, to recite; समझना, to wake up to; सोचना, to burn.

You’ll want to know: पुस्तकालय

पुस्तकालय — *pustakālay* — “a library”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पुस्तकालय (*pustakālay*) is a tatsama compound, taken over whole from Sanskrit: *pustaka*, “book”, and *ālaya*, “abode”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pustakālay*
- *Say it: pustakālay*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pustakālay*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for blood, then the Hindi for a post office, then say *pustakālay* again

Before you move on

What does पुस्तकालय mean? (“A library”.) Say it once more.

152.4 मंदिर (mandir) — a temple

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a post office, then the Hindi for a library.

Name the week by its sky: **सोमवार**, the Moon's day, through **शनिवार**, Saturn's, and **रविवार**, the Sun's. It is the same seven-body week Rome kept.

You'll want to know: मंदिर

मंदिर — *mandir* — "a temple".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मंदिर (*mandir*) is Sanskrit *mandira*, "house, palace, temple", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mandir*
- *Say it: mandir*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mandir*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a post office, then the Hindi for a library, then say *mandir* again

Before you move on

What does **मंदिर** mean? ("A temple".) Say it once more.

152.5 मस्जिद (masjid) — a mosque

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a library, then the Hindi for a temple.

You’ll want to know: मस्जिद

मस्जिद — *masjid* — “a mosque”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मस्जिद (*masjid*) is a loan from Arabic *masjid*, “place of prostration, mosque”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *s-j-d* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: masjid*
- *Say it: masjid*, once more
- *Say it:* say *masjid*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a library, then the Hindi for a temple, then say *masjid* again

Before you move on

What does **मस्जिद** mean? (“A mosque”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 153

Garden, Field, Bridge, Office, Bank

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a garden, a field, a bridge, an office and a bank.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 153: I can say a garden, a field, a bridge, an office and a bank.*

153.1 बगीचा (bagīcā) — a garden

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a temple, then the Hindi for a mosque.

You’ll want to know: बगीचा

बगीचा — *bagīcā* — “a garden”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बगीचा (*bagīcā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *bāghcha*, “small garden”. It is built on *bāgh*, “garden”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bagīcā*
- *Say it: bagīcā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bagīcā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a temple, then the Hindi for a mosque, then say *bagīcā* again

Before you move on

What does बगीचा mean? (“A garden”.) Say it once more.

153.2 मैदान (maidān) — a field, a ground

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mosque, then the Hindi for a garden.

You’ll want to know: मैदान

मैदान — *maidān* — “a field, a ground”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मैदान (*maidān*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *maidān*, “open ground”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maidān*
- *Say it: maidān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maidān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mosque, then the Hindi for a garden, then say *maidān* again

Before you move on

What does मैदान mean? (“A field, a ground”.) Say it once more.

153.3 पुल (pul) — a bridge

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a garden, then the Hindi for a field.

You’ll want to know: पुल

पुल — *pul* — “a bridge”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पुल (*pul*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *pul*, “bridge”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pul*
- *Say it: pul*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pul*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a garden, then the Hindi for a field, then say *pul* again

Before you move on

What does पुल mean? (“A bridge”.) Say it once more.

153.4 दफ़्तर (daftar) — an office

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a field, then the Hindi for a bridge.

Say the twelve borrowed months, जनवरी to दिसंबर. An older calendar still runs beside them.

You'll want to know: दफ़्तर

दफ़्तर — *daftar* — "an office".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दफ़्तर (*daftar*) is usually traced, through Persian, to Arabic *daftar*, "register, account book" (Lane), a word Arabic itself took from Greek.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: daftar*
- *Say it: daftar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *daftar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a field, then the Hindi for a bridge, then say *daftar* again

Before you move on

What does दफ़्तर mean? ("An office".) Say it once more.

153.5 बैंक (baiṅk) — a bank

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bridge, then the Hindi for an office.

You'll want to know: बैंक

बैंक — *baiṅk* — "a bank".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बैंक (*baiṅk*) is a loan from English *bank*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baiṅk*
- *Say it: baiṅk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baiṅk*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bridge, then the Hindi for an office, then say *baiṅk* again

Before you move on

What does बैंक mean? ("A bank".) Say it once more.

Chapter 154

Hot, Wet, Dry, Heavy, Light

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say hot, wet, dry, heavy and light.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 154: I can say hot, wet, dry, heavy and light.*

154.1 गरम (garam) — hot, warm

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an office, then the Hindi for a bank.
>
> Walk one दिन: दोपहर, two *pahars*, now the whole afternoon, then रात, and आधी रात, half the night.

You’ll want to know: गरम

गरम — *garam* — “hot, warm”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गरम (*garam*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *garm*, “warm, hot”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: garam*
- *Say it: garam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *garam*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an office, then the Hindi for a bank, then say *garam* again

Before you move on

What does गरम mean? (“Hot, warm”.) Say it once more.

154.2 गीला (gīlā) — wet

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bank, then the Hindi for hot.

You’ll want to know: गीला

गीला — *gīlā* — “wet”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गीला (*gīlā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **grilla*, “wet, damp”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4386). CDIAL calls a further link with **gr̥dla* very doubtful.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gīlā*
- *Say it: gīlā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gīlā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bank, then the Hindi for hot, then say *gīlā* again

Before you move on

What does गीला mean? ("Wet".) Say it once more.

154.3 सूखा (sūkhā) — dry

Before the new one: say the Hindi for hot, then the Hindi for wet.

You'll want to know: सूखा

सूखा — *sūkhā* — "dry".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सूखा (*sūkhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *śuṣka*, "dried" (CDIAL 12548).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūkhā*
- *Say it: sūkhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sūkhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for hot, then the Hindi for wet, then say *sūkhā* again

Before you move on

What does सूखा mean? ("Dry".) Say it once more.

154.4 भारी (bhārī) — heavy

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for wet, then the Hindi for dry.

You'll want to know: भारी

भारी — *bhārī* — "heavy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भारी (*bhārī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *bhārika*, "forming a load, heavy" (CDIAL 9465). It is built on *bhāra*, "load".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bhārī*
- *Say it:* *bhārī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhārī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for wet, then the Hindi for dry, then say *bhārī* again

Before you move on

What does भारी mean? ("Heavy".) Say it once more.

154.5 हल्का (halkā) — light (in weight)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for dry, then the Hindi for heavy.

You'll want to know: हल्का

हल्का — *halkā* — "light (in weight)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हल्का (*halkā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *laghu*, “light” (CDIAL 10896). CDIAL notes that its *l* and *h* swapped places and that it took an added -*k*-.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: halkā*
- *Say it: halkā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *halkā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for dry, then the Hindi for heavy, then say *halkā* again

Before you move on

What does हल्का mean? (“Light (in weight)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 155

Soft, Hard, Clean, Dirty, Fast

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say soft, hard, clean, dirty and fast.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 155: I can say soft, hard, clean, dirty and fast.*

155.1 नरम (naram) — soft

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for heavy, then the Hindi for light.
>
> Describe with words that never bend: आसान, मुश्किल, सुंदर, बदसूरत.

You’ll want to know: नरम

नरम — *naram* — “soft”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नरम (*naram*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *narm*, “soft”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naram*
- *Say it: naram*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naram*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for heavy, then the Hindi for light, then say *naram* again

Before you move on

What does नरम mean? (“Soft”.) Say it once more.

155.2 सख़्त (sakht) — hard

Before the new one: say the Hindi for light, then the Hindi for soft.

You’ll want to know: सख़्त

सख़्त — *sakht* — “hard”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सख़्त (*sakht*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sakht*, “hard, firm”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sakht*
- *Say it: sakht*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sakht*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for light, then the Hindi for soft, then say *sakht* again

Before you move on

What does सख़्त mean? (“Hard”.) Say it once more.

155.3 साफ़ (sāf) — clean

Before the new one: say the Hindi for soft, then the Hindi for hard.

You’ll want to know: साफ़

साफ़ — *sāf* — “clean”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

साफ़ (*sāf*) is a loan from Arabic *ṣāfī*, “pure, clear”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṣ-f-w* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāf*
- *Say it: sāf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sāf*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for soft, then the Hindi for hard, then say *sāf* again

Before you move on

What does साफ़ mean? (“Clean”.) Say it once more.

155.4 गंदा (gandā) — dirty

Before the new one: say the Hindi for hard, then the Hindi for clean.

You'll want to know: गंदा

गंदा — *gandā* — "dirty".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गंदा (*gandā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *ganda*, "stinking, foul".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gandā*
- *Say it: gandā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gandā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for hard, then the Hindi for clean, then say *gandā* again

Before you move on

What does गंदा mean? ("Dirty".) Say it once more.

155.5 तेज़ (tez) — fast, sharp

Before the new one: say the Hindi for clean, then the Hindi for dirty.

You'll want to know: तेज़

तेज़ — *tez* — "fast, sharp".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तेज़ (*tez*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *tēz*, "sharp, swift".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tez*
- *Say it: tez*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tez*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for clean, then the Hindi for dirty, then say *tez* again

Before you move on

What does तेज़ mean? (“Fast, sharp”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 156

Slow, Sour, Bitter, Salty, Spicy

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say slow, sour, bitter, salty and spicy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 156: I can say slow, sour, bitter, salty and spicy.*

156.1 धीमा (dhīmā) — slow, low

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for dirty, then the Hindi for fast.

You'll want to know: धीमा

धीमा — *dhīmā* — "slow, low".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धीमा (*dhīmā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dhīmma*, "slow", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6814). CDIAL asks whether it is related to **ḍhīmma*, "lump".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhīmā*
- *Say it: dhīmā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhīmā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for dirty, then the Hindi for fast, then say *dhīmā* again

Before you move on

What does **धीमा** mean? (“Slow, low”.) Say it once more.

156.2 खट्टा (khaṭṭā) — sour

Before the new one: say the Hindi for fast, then the Hindi for slow.

Say **मुझे चाय पसंद है**. **पसंद** is not a verb, and **मुझे** means *to me*.

You’ll want to know: खट्टा

खट्टा — *khaṭṭā* — “sour”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खट्टा (*khaṭṭā*) goes back to Sanskrit *khaṭṭa*, “sour”, a word known only from the old word-lists (CDIAL 3777). CDIAL marks the Hindi form as taken over from Punjabi, and asks whether *khaṭṭa* is connected with *kaṭu*, “bitter”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khaṭṭā*
- *Say it: khaṭṭā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khaṭṭā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for fast, then the Hindi for slow, then say *khaṭṭā* again

Before you move on

What does खट्टा mean? (“Sour”.) Say it once more.

156.3 कड़वा (kaṛvā) — bitter

Before the new one: say the Hindi for slow, then the Hindi for sour.

You’ll want to know: कड़वा

कड़वा — *kaṛvā* — “bitter”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कड़वा (*kaṛvā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kaṭuka*, “pungent, bitter” (CDIAL 2641). CDIAL lists the Hindi form as *kaṛuā*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṛvā*
- *Say it: kaṛvā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṛvā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for slow, then the Hindi for sour, then say *kaṛvā* again

Before you move on

What does कड़वा mean? (“Bitter”.) Say it once more.

156.4 नमकीन (namkīn) — salty

Before the new one: say the Hindi for sour, then the Hindi for bitter.

You'll want to know: नमकीन

नमकीन — *namkīn* — "salty".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नमकीन (*namkīn*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *namakīn*, "salty". It is built on *namak*, "salt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: namkīn*
- *Say it: namkīn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *namkīn*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sour, then the Hindi for bitter, then say *namkīn* again

Before you move on

What does नमकीन mean? ("Salty".) Say it once more.

156.5 तीखा (tīkhā) — spicy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for bitter, then the Hindi for salty.

You'll want to know: तीखा

तीखा — *tīkhā* — "spicy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तीखा (*tīkhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *tīkṣṇa*, “sharp; hot, pungent” (CDIAL 5839).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tīkhā*
- *Say it: tīkhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tīkhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for bitter, then the Hindi for salty, then say *tīkhā* again

Before you move on

What does तीखा mean? (“Spicy”.) Say it once more.

156.6 Nature, animals and the body — a first pass

Say the words for salty and spicy.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a pigeon, a parrot, an owl, a butterfly, a fly
- a mosquito, an ant, a frog, a tortoise, a mouse
- an elbow, a wrist, a thumb, a fingernail, a cheek
- the chin, the tongue, the neck, the chest, the waist

Before you move on

A pigeon? (कबूतर, *kabūtar.*) A parrot? (तोता, *totā.*) An owl? (उल्लू, *ullū.*) A butterfly? (तितली, *titlī.*) A fly? (मक्खी, *makkhī.*) A mosquito? (मच्छर, *macchar.*) An ant? (चींटी, *cīṇṭī.*) A frog? (मेंढक, *meṇḍhak.*) A tortoise? (कछुआ, *kachuā.*) A mouse? (चूहा, *cūhā.*) An elbow? (कोहनी, *kohnī.*) A wrist? (कलाई, *kalāī.*) A thumb? (अंगूठा, *aṅgūṭhā.*) A fingernail? (नाखून, *nākhūn.*) A cheek? (गाल, *gāl.*) The chin? (ठोड़ी, *ṭhoṛī.*) The tongue? (जीभ, *jībh.*) The neck? (गर्दन, *gardan.*) The chest? (छाती, *chātī.*) The waist? (कमर, *kamar.*)

156.7 The body and places — a second pass

Say the words for blood and a post office.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- blood, a post office, a library, a temple, a mosque
- a garden, a field, a bridge, an office, a bank
- hot, wet, dry, heavy, light
- soft, hard, clean, dirty, fast
- slow, sour, bitter, salty, spicy

Before you move on

Blood? (ख़ून, *khūn.*) A post office? (डाकघर, *ḍākghar.*) A library? (पुस्तकालय, *pustakālay.*) A temple? (मंदिर, *mandir.*) A mosque? (मस्जिद, *masjid.*) A garden? (बगीचा, *bagīcā.*) A field? (मैदान, *maidān.*) A bridge? (पुल, *pul.*) An office? (दफ़्तर, *daftar.*) A bank? (बैंक, *baiṅk.*) Hot? (गरम, *garam.*) Wet? (गीला, *gīlā.*) Dry? (सूखा, *sūkhā.*) Heavy? (भारी, *bhārī.*) Light? (हल्का, *halkā.*) Soft? (नरम, *naram.*) Hard? (सख़्त, *sakht.*) Clean? (साफ़, *sāf.*) Dirty? (गंदा, *gandā.*) Fast? (तेज़, *tez.*) Slow? (धीमा, *dhīmā.*) Sour? (खट्टा, *khaṭṭā.*) Bitter? (कड़वा, *kaṛvā.*) Salty? (नमकीन, *namkīn.*) Spicy? (तीखा, *tīkhā.*)

Chapter 157

Fresh, Rich, Poor, Young, Old

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say fresh, rich, poor, young and old.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 157: I can say fresh, rich, poor, young and old.*

157.1 ताज़ा (tāzā) — fresh

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for salty, then the Hindi for spicy.

You'll want to know: ताज़ा

ताज़ा — *tāzā* — "fresh".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ताज़ा (*tāzā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *tāza*, "fresh".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tāzā*

- *Say it:* *tāzā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tāzā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for salty, then the Hindi for spicy, then say *tāzā* again

Before you move on

What does ताज़ा mean? (“Fresh”.) Say it once more.

157.2 अमीर (amīr) — rich

Before the new one: say the Hindi for spicy, then the Hindi for fresh.

You’ll want to know: अमीर

अमीर — *amīr* — “rich”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अमीर (*amīr*) is a loan from Arabic *amīr*, “commander, prince”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ʾ-m-r* (Lane). Hindi uses it for someone rich.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *amīr*
- *Say it:* *amīr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *amīr*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for spicy, then the Hindi for fresh, then say *amīr* again

Before you move on

What does **अमीर** mean? (“Rich”.) Say it once more.

157.3 ग़रीब (ġarīb) — poor

Before the new one: say the Hindi for fresh, then the Hindi for rich.

You’ll want to know: ग़रीब

ग़रीब — *ġarīb* — “poor”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ग़रीब (*ġarīb*) is a loan from Arabic *gharīb*, “a stranger”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *gh-r-b* (Lane). Hindi uses it for “poor”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ġarīb*
- *Say it: ġarīb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ġarīb*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for fresh, then the Hindi for rich, then say *ġarīb* again

Before you move on

What does **ग़रीब** mean? (“Poor”.) Say it once more.

157.4 जवान (javān) — young

Before the new one: say the Hindi for rich, then the Hindi for poor.

Describe with words that never bend: आसान, मुश्किल, सुंदर, बदसूरत.

You'll want to know: जवान

जवान — *javān* — "young".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जवान (*javān*) is usually taken as a loan from Persian *javān*, "young". That may not be the whole story: CDIAL lists a Hindi *juwān*, "a youth", under **yuvāna*, "young", a form it builds on the Sanskrit *yuvan*, "young" (CDIAL 10510). So Hindi may have this word by an inherited road as well as a borrowed one.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: javān*
- *Say it: javān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *javān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for rich, then the Hindi for poor, then say *javān* again

Before you move on

What does जवान mean? ("Young".) Say it once more.

157.5 बूढ़ा (būṛhā) — old (of people)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for poor, then the Hindi for young.

You’ll want to know: बूढ़ा

बूढ़ा — *būṛhā* — “old (of people)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बूढ़ा (*būṛhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **buḍḍha*, “old”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9271). CDIAL notes that the initial *b*- rules out direct descent from Sanskrit *vṛddha*, “grown old”, though that word may have influenced it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: būṛhā*
- *Say it: būṛhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *būṛhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for poor, then the Hindi for young, then say *būṛhā* again

Before you move on

What does बूढ़ा mean? (“Old (of people)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 158

Wide, Deep, High, Low, Empty

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say wide, deep, high, low and empty.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 158: I can say wide, deep, high, low and empty.*

158.1 चौड़ा (cauṛā) — wide

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for young, then the Hindi for old.

You'll want to know: चौड़ा

चौड़ा — *cauṛā* — "wide".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चौड़ा (*cauṛā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ca-uḍa*, "wide, open", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4534). CDIAL suggests, with a "possibly", that it was built on *cau-*, "four".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cauṛā*
- *Say it: cauṛā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cauṛā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for young, then the Hindi for old, then say *cauṛā* again

Before you move on

What does **चौड़ा** mean? (“Wide”.) Say it once more.

158.2 गहरा (gahrā) — deep, dark (of colour)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for old, then the Hindi for wide.

Say the colours and their stories: **लाल**, a red gem’s name; **नीला**, indigo’s dark blue; **सफ़ेद**, a Persian loan.

You’ll want to know: गहरा

गहरा — *gahrā* — “deep, dark (of colour)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गहरा (*gahrā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *gabhīra*, “deep, solemn” (CDIAL 4024).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gahrā*
- *Say it: gahrā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gahrā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for old, then the Hindi for wide, then say *gahrā* again

Before you move on

What does **गहरा** mean? (“Deep, dark (of colour)”.) Say it once more.

158.3 ऊँचा (ū̃cā) — high, tall

Before the new one: say the Hindi for wide, then the Hindi for deep.

You’ll want to know: ऊँचा

ऊँचा — *ū̃cā* — “high, tall”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ऊँचा (*ūṁcā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ucca*, “tall, lofty” (CDIAL 1634). CDIAL calls the influence of *udañc*, “turned upwards”, on the nasal very doubtful.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ū̃cā*
- *Say it:* *ū̃cā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ū̃cā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for wide, then the Hindi for deep, then say *ū̃cā* again

Before you move on

What does **ऊँचा** mean? (“High, tall”.) Say it once more.

158.4 नीचा (nīcā) — low

Before the new one: say the Hindi for deep, then the Hindi for high.

You'll want to know: नीचा

नीचा — *nīcā* — "low".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नीचा (*nīcā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *nīca*, "low" (CDIAL 7540). CDIAL explains its -*c*- as shaped after its opposite, *ucca*, "high".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nīcā*
- *Say it: nīcā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nīcā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for deep, then the Hindi for high, then say *nīcā* again

Before you move on

What does नीचा mean? ("Low".) Say it once more.

158.5 ख़ाली (khālī) — empty

Before the new one: say the Hindi for high, then the Hindi for low.

You'll want to know: ख़ाली

ख़ाली — *khālī* — "empty".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ख़ाली (*khālī*) is a loan from Arabic *khālī*, “empty”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *kh-l-w* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khālī*
- *Say it: khālī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khālī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for high, then the Hindi for low, then say *khālī* again

Before you move on

What does ख़ाली mean? (“Empty”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 159

Full, To sleep, To wake up, To run, To put

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say full, to sleep, to wake up, to run and to put.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 159: I can say full, to sleep, to wake up, to run and to put.*

159.1 भरा (bharā) — full

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for low, then the Hindi for empty.

You'll want to know: भरा

भरा — *bharā* — "full".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भरा (*bharā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *bharati*, "bears, fills" (CDIAL 9397). *bharā*, "full", is the past form of *bharnā*, "to fill".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bharā*
- *Say it: bharā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bharā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for low, then the Hindi for empty, then say *bharā* again

Before you move on

What does भरा mean? (“Full”.) Say it once more.

159.2 सोना (sonā) — to sleep

Before the new one: say the Hindi for empty, then the Hindi for full.

You’ll want to know: सोना

सोना — *sonā* — “to sleep”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सोना (*sonā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *svapati*, “sleeps” (CDIAL 13902). It is a different word from *sonā*, “gold”, from Sanskrit *suvarṇa* (CDIAL 13519).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sonā*
- *Say it: sonā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sonā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for empty, then the Hindi for full, then say *sonā* again

Before you move on

What does सोना mean? (“To sleep”.) Say it once more.

159.3 जागना (jāgnā) — to wake up, to stay awake

Before the new one: say the Hindi for full, then the Hindi for to sleep.

You’ll want to know: जागना

जागना — *jāgnā* — “to wake up, to stay awake”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जागना (*jāgnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jāgrati*, “are awake” (CDIAL 5175).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jāgnā*
- *Say it: jāgnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jāgnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for full, then the Hindi for to sleep, then say *jāgnā* again

Before you move on

What does जागना mean? (“To wake up, to stay awake”.) Say it once more.

159.4 दौड़ना (dauṛnā) — to run

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to sleep, then the Hindi for to wake up.

You'll want to know: दौड़ना

दौड़ना — *dauṛnā* — "to run".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दौड़ना (*dauṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *dravati*, "runs" (CDIAL 6624). CDIAL notes an added -*ḍ*-.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *dauṛnā*
- *Say it:* *dauṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dauṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to sleep, then the Hindi for to wake up, then say *dauṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does दौड़ना mean? ("To run".) Say it once more.

159.5 रखना (rakhnā) — to put, to keep

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to wake up, then the Hindi for to run.

You'll want to know: रखना

रखना — *rakhnā* — "to put, to keep".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रखना (*rakhnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *rakṣati*, "guards" (CDIAL 10547).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rakhnā*
- *Say it: rakhnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rakhnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to wake up, then the Hindi for to run, then say *rakhnā* again

Before you move on

What does रखना mean? ("To put, to keep".) Say it once more.

Chapter 160

To send, To bring, To open, To wash, To bathe

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to send, to bring, to open, to wash and to bathe.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 160: I can say to send, to bring, to open, to wash and to bathe.*

160.1 भेजना (bhejnā) — to send

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to run, then the Hindi for to put.
>
> Say four everyday verbs once each: लेना, देना, पूछना, मदद करना.

You’ll want to know: भेजना

भेजना — *bhejnā* — “to send”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भेजना (*bhejnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **bhejj*, “send”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9603). CDIAL rejects a derivation from *visarjayati*, “sends off”, and offers two possible sources, neither certain.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhejnā*
- *Say it: bhejnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhejnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to run, then the Hindi for to put, then say *bhejnā* again

Before you move on

What does भेजना mean? ("To send".) Say it once more.

160.2 लाना (lānā) — to bring

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to put, then the Hindi for to send.

You'll want to know: लाना

लाना — *lānā* — "to bring".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लाना (*lānā*) is inherited. CDIAL lists it under Sanskrit *labhate*, "catches, takes", crossed with forms of *dadāti*, "gives" (CDIAL 10948): to bring is to take and give.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lānā*
- *Say it: lānā*, once more

- *Say it:* say *lānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to put, then the Hindi for to send, then say *lānā* again

Before you move on

What does लाना mean? (“To bring”.) Say it once more.

160.3 खोलना (kholnā) — to open

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to send, then the Hindi for to bring.

You’ll want to know: खोलना

खोलना — *kholnā* — “to open”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खोलना (*kholnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **kholl*, “to open”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 3945).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kholnā*
- *Say it: kholnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kholnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to send, then the Hindi for to bring, then say *kholnā* again

Before you move on

What does खोलना mean? (“To open”.) Say it once more.

160.4 धोना (dhonā) — to wash

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to bring, then the Hindi for to open.

You'll want to know: धोना

धोना — *dhonā* — "to wash".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धोना (*dhonā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dhauvati*, "washes", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6886). CDIAL notes that this form replaced Sanskrit *dhāvati*, "washes".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhonā*
- *Say it: dhonā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhonā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to bring, then the Hindi for to open, then say *dhonā* again

Before you move on

What does धोना mean? ("To wash".) Say it once more.

160.5 नहाना (nahānā) — to bathe

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to open, then the Hindi for to wash.

You’ll want to know: नहाना

नहाना — *nahānā* — “to bathe”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नहाना (*nahānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *snāti*, “bathes” (CDIAL 13786).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nahānā*
- *Say it: nahānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nahānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to open, then the Hindi for to wash, then say *nahānā* again

Before you move on

What does नहाना mean? (“To bathe”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 161

To cook, To cut, To break, To fall, To fly

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to cook, to cut, to break, to fall and to fly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 161: I can say to cook, to cut, to break, to fall and to fly.*

161.1 पकाना (pakānā) — to cook

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to wash, then the Hindi for to bathe.

You’ll want to know: पकाना

पकाना — *pakānā* — “to cook”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पकाना (*pakānā*) is the causing form of *paknā*, “to be cooked, to ripen”, which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *pakva*, “cooked, ripe” (CDIAL 7621).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pakānā*
- *Say it: pakānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pakānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to wash, then the Hindi for to bathe, then say *pakānā* again

Before you move on

What does पकाना mean? (“To cook”.) Say it once more.

161.2 काटना (kāṭnā) — to cut

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to bathe, then the Hindi for to cook.

You’ll want to know: काटना

काटना — *kāṭnā* — “to cut”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

काटना (*kāṭnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kartati*, “cuts” (CDIAL 2854).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāṭnā*
- *Say it: kāṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to bathe, then the Hindi for to cook, then say *kāṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does काटना mean? (“To cut”.) Say it once more.

161.3 तोड़ना (toṛnā) — to break

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to cook, then the Hindi for to cut.

You’ll want to know: तोड़ना

तोड़ना — *toṛnā* — “to break”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तोड़ना (*toṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *troṭayati*, “breaks, tears” (CDIAL 6079).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: toṛnā*
- *Say it: toṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *toṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to cook, then the Hindi for to cut, then say *toṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does तोड़ना mean? (“To break”.) Say it once more.

161.4 गिरना (girnā) — to fall

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to cut, then the Hindi for to break.

You’ll want to know: गिरना

गिरना — *girnā* — “to fall”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गिरना (*girnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **girati*, “drips, falls”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4159).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: girnā*
- *Say it: girnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *girnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to cut, then the Hindi for to break, then say *girnā* again

Before you move on

What does गिरना mean? (“To fall”.) Say it once more.

161.5 उड़ना (uṛnā) — to fly

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to break, then the Hindi for to fall.

You’ll want to know: उड़ना

उड़ना — *uṛnā* — “to fly”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उड़ना (*uṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *uḍḍayate*, “flies up”, which CDIAL lists as the second form in its entry for *uḍḍīyate*, “flies up”

(CDIAL 1697).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṛnā*
- *Say it: uṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to break, then the Hindi for to fall, then say *uṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does उड़ना mean? (“To fly”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 162

To swim, To dance, To laugh, To cry, To forget

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to swim, to dance, to laugh, to cry and to forget.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 162: I can say to swim, to dance, to laugh, to cry and to forget.*

162.1 तैरना (tairnā) — to swim

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to fall, then the Hindi for to fly.

You'll want to know: तैरना

तैरना — *tairnā* — "to swim".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तैरना (*tairnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *tirate*, "crosses over" (CDIAL 5821). CDIAL rejects a Dravidian source proposed by Bloch, and explains the *ai* as a blend with another verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tairnā*
- *Say it: tairnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tairnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to fall, then the Hindi for to fly, then say *tairnā* again

Before you move on

What does **तैरना** mean? (“To swim”.) Say it once more.

162.2 नाचना (nācnā) — to dance

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to fly, then the Hindi for to swim.

You’ll want to know: नाचना

नाचना — *nācnā* — “to dance”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाचना (*nācnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *nṛtyati*, “dances” (CDIAL 7583).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nācnā*
- *Say it: nācnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nācnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to fly, then the Hindi for to swim, then say *nācnā* again

Before you move on

What does नाचना mean? (“To dance”.) Say it once more.

162.3 हँसना (hãsnā) — to laugh

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to swim, then the Hindi for to dance.

You’ll want to know: हँसना

हँसना — *hãsnā* — “to laugh”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हँसना (*hãsnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *hasati*, “laughs” (CDIAL 14021).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hãsnā*
- *Say it: hãsnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hãsnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to swim, then the Hindi for to dance, then say *hãsnā* again

Before you move on

What does हँसना mean? (“To laugh”.) Say it once more.

162.4 रोना (ronā) — to cry

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to dance, then the Hindi for to laugh.

You’ll want to know: रोना

रोना — *ronā* — “to cry”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रोना (*ronā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *roditi*, “weeps” (CDIAL 10840).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ronā*
- *Say it: ronā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ronā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to dance, then the Hindi for to laugh, then say *ronā* again

Before you move on

What does रोना mean? (“To cry”.) Say it once more.

162.5 भूलना (bhūlnā) — to forget

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to laugh, then the Hindi for to cry.

You’ll want to know: भूलना

भूलना — *bhūlnā* — “to forget”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भूलना (*bhūlnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **bhull*, “err, forget”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9538).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhūlnā*
- *Say it: bhūlnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhūlnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to laugh, then the Hindi for to cry, then say *bhūlnā* again

Before you move on

What does भूलना mean? ("To forget".) Say it once more.

Chapter 163

To win, To lose, To sell, To look for, To wear

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to win, to lose, to sell, to look for and to wear.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 163: I can say to win, to lose, to sell, to look for and to wear.*

163.1 जीतना (jītnā) — to win

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to cry, then the Hindi for to forget.

You'll want to know: जीतना

जीतना — *jītnā* — "to win".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जीतना (*jītnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jita*, "won, conquered" (CDIAL 5224).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jītnā*
- *Say it: jītnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jītnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to cry, then the Hindi for to forget, then say *jītnā* again

Before you move on

What does **जीतना** mean? (“To win”.) Say it once more.

163.2 हारना (hārnā) — to lose (a game)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to forget, then the Hindi for to win.

Say **मैं हिंदी बोलता था**, then ask a friend **तुम आओगे?**

You’ll want to know: हारना

हारना — *hārnā* — “to lose (a game)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हारना (*hārnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *hārayati*, “causes to be taken; loses” (CDIAL 14061).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hārnā*
- *Say it: hārnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hārnā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to forget, then the Hindi for to win, then say *hārnā* again

Before you move on

What does हारना mean? (“To lose (a game)”.) Say it once more.

163.3 बेचना (becnā) — to sell

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to win, then the Hindi for to lose.

You’ll want to know: बेचना

बेचना — *becnā* — “to sell”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बेचना (*becnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **vetyayati*, “makes a price”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 12100). CDIAL builds it on *vetana*, “wages, price”, and calls other proposals less probable.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: becnā*
- *Say it: becnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *becnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to win, then the Hindi for to lose, then say *becnā* again

Before you move on

What does बेचना mean? (“To sell”.) Say it once more.

163.4 ढूँढना (ḍhū̃ḍhnā) — to look for

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to lose, then the Hindi for to sell.

You'll want to know: ढूँढना

ढूँढना — *ḍhū̃ḍhnā* — "to look for".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ढूँढना (*ḍhūṁḍhnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ḍhūṇḍh*, "seek", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6839).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḍhū̃ḍhnā*
- *Say it:* *ḍhū̃ḍhnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍhū̃ḍhnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to lose, then the Hindi for to sell, then say *ḍhū̃ḍhnā* again

Before you move on

What does ढूँढना mean? ("To look for".) Say it once more.

163.5 पहनना (pahannā) — to wear

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to sell, then the Hindi for to look for.

You'll want to know: पहनना

पहनना — *pahannā* — "to wear".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पहनना (*pahannā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **pinahati*, “ties on”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 8198).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pahannā*
- *Say it: pahannā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pahannā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to sell, then the Hindi for to look for, then say *pahannā* again

Before you move on

What does **पहनना** mean? (“To wear”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 164

To call, To teach, To learn, To arrive, To come back

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to call, to teach, to learn, to arrive and to come back.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 164: I can say to call, to teach, to learn, to arrive and to come back.*

164.1 बुलाना (bulānā) — to call

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to look for, then the Hindi for to wear.

You'll want to know: बुलाना

बुलाना — *bulānā* — "to call".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बुलाना (*bulānā*) is the causing form of बोलना, "to speak": to call someone is to make them speak back. CDIAL lists both under a reconstructed **boll-*, "speak" (CDIAL 9321).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bulānā*
- *Say it: bulānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bulānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to look for, then the Hindi for to wear, then say *bulānā* again

Before you move on

What does बुलाना mean? (“To call”.) Say it once more.

164.2 सिखाना (sikhānā) — to teach

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to wear, then the Hindi for to call.

You’ll want to know: सिखाना

सिखाना — *sikhānā* — “to teach”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सिखाना (*sikhānā*) is the causing form of *sīkhnā*, “to learn”: to teach is to make someone learn. CDIAL lists both under Sanskrit *śikṣate*, “learns” (CDIAL 12430).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sikhānā*
- *Say it: sikhānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sikhānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to wear, then the Hindi for to call, then say *sikhānā* again

Before you move on

What does सिखाना mean? (“To teach”.) Say it once more.

164.3 सीखना (sīkhnā) — to learn

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to call, then the Hindi for to teach.

You’ll want to know: सीखना

सीखना — *sīkhnā* — “to learn”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सीखना (*sīkhnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *śikṣate*, “learns” (CDIAL 12430).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sīkhnā*
- *Say it: sīkhnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sīkhnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to call, then the Hindi for to teach, then say *sīkhnā* again

Before you move on

What does सीखना mean? (“To learn”.) Say it once more.

164.4 पहुँचना (pahũcnā) — to arrive

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to teach, then the Hindi for to learn.

You'll want to know: पहुँचना

पहुँचना — *pahũcnā* — "to arrive".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पहुँचना (*pahũcnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *prabhūta*, "much, great" (CDIAL 8716). Prakrit made a verb of it, "is strong, reaches", and Hindi kept "to reach".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pahũcnā*
- *Say it: pahũcnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pahũcnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to teach, then the Hindi for to learn, then say *pahũcnā* again

Before you move on

What does पहुँचना mean? ("To arrive".) Say it once more.

164.5 लौटना (lauṭnā) — to come back

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to learn, then the Hindi for to arrive.

You’ll want to know: लौटना

लौटना — *lauṭnā* — “to come back”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of लौटना (*lauṭnā*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lauṭnā*
- *Say it: lauṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lauṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to learn, then the Hindi for to arrive, then say *lauṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does लौटना mean? (“To come back”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 165

To catch, To touch, To explain, To play, To count

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to catch, to touch, to explain, to play and to count.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 165: I can say to catch, to touch, to explain, to play and to count.*

165.1 पकड़ना (pakaṛnā) — to catch, to hold

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to arrive, then the Hindi for to come back.

You'll want to know: पकड़ना

पकड़ना — *pakaṛnā* — "to catch, to hold".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पकड़ना (*pakaṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **pakkaḍ*, "seize", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 7619). CDIAL calls a link with Sanskrit *pragṛhṇāti*, "holds", obscure and doubtful.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pakaṛnā*
- *Say it: pakaṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pakaṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to arrive, then the Hindi for to come back, then say *pakaṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does पकड़ना mean? (“To catch, to hold”.) Say it once more.

165.2 छूना (chūnā) — to touch

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to come back, then the Hindi for to catch.

You’ll want to know: छूना

छूना — *chūnā* — “to touch”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छूना (*chūnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *chupati*, “touches” (CDIAL 5055).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūnā*
- *Say it: chūnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chūnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to come back, then the Hindi for to catch, then say *chūnā* again

Before you move on

What does छूना mean? (“To touch”.) Say it once more.

165.3 समझाना (samjhānā) — to explain

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to catch, then the Hindi for to touch.

You’ll want to know: समझाना

समझाना — *samjhānā* — “to explain”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समझाना (*samjhānā*) is the causing form of *samajhnā*, “to understand”: to explain is to make someone understand. CDIAL lists the verb under Sanskrit *saṁbudhyate*, “wakes up, understands” (CDIAL 12959).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samjhānā*
- *Say it: samjhānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samjhānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to catch, then the Hindi for to touch, then say *samjhānā* again

Before you move on

What does समझाना mean? (“To explain”.) Say it once more.

165.4 बजाना (bajānā) — to play (an instrument), to ring

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to touch, then the Hindi for to explain.

You'll want to know: बजाना

बजाना — *bajānā* — "to play (an instrument), to ring".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बजाना (*bajānā*) is the causing form of *bajnā*, "to sound", which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *vādyate*, "is made to sound" (CDIAL 11513).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bajānā*
- *Say it: bajānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bajānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to touch, then the Hindi for to explain, then say *bajānā* again

Before you move on

What does बजाना mean? ("To play (an instrument), to ring".) Say it once more.

165.5 गिनना (ginnā) — to count

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to explain, then the Hindi for to play.

You'll want to know: गिनना

गिनना — *ginnā* — "to count".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गिनना (*ginnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *gaṇayati*, "counts" (CDIAL 3993).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ginnā*
- *Say it: ginnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ginnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to explain, then the Hindi for to play, then say *ginnā* again

Before you move on

What does गिनना mean? ("To count".) Say it once more.

165.6 Places and describing words — a first pass

Say the words for to play and to count.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- fresh, rich, poor, young, old
- wide, deep, high, low, empty
- full, to sleep, to wake up, to run, to put
- to send, to bring, to open, to wash, to bathe

Before you move on

Fresh? (ताज़ा, *tāzā.*) Rich? (अमीर, *amīr.*) Poor? (ग़रीब, *ġarīb.*) Young? (जवान, *javān.*) Old? (बूढ़ा, *būṛhā.*) Wide? (चौड़ा, *cauṛā.*) Deep? (गहरा, *gahrā.*) High? (ऊँचा, *ū̃cā.*) Low? (नीचा, *nīcā.*) Empty? (ख़ाली, *khālī.*) Full? (भरा, *bharā.*) To sleep? (सोना, *sonā.*) To wake up? (जागना, *jāgnā.*) To run? (दौड़ना, *dauṛnā.*) To put? (रखना, *rakhnā.*) To send? (भेजना, *bhejnā.*) To bring? (लाना, *lānā.*) To open? (खोलना, *kholnā.*) To wash? (धोना, *dhonā.*) To bathe? (नहाना, *nahānā.*)

165.7 Verbs — a second pass

Say the words for to cook and to cut.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to cook, to cut, to break, to fall, to fly
- to swim, to dance, to laugh, to cry, to forget
- to win, to lose, to sell, to look for, to wear
- to call, to teach, to learn, to arrive, to come back
- to catch, to touch, to explain, to play, to count

Before you move on

To cook? (पकाना, *pakānā.*) To cut? (काटना, *kāṭnā.*) To break? (तोड़ना, *toṛnā.*) To fall? (गिरना, *girnā.*) To fly? (उड़ना, *uṛnā.*) To swim? (तैरना, *tairnā.*) To dance? (नाचना, *nācnā.*) To laugh? (हँसना, *hãsnā.*) To cry? (रोना, *ronā.*) To forget? (भूलना, *bhūlnā.*) To win? (जीतना, *jītnā.*) To lose? (हारना, *hārnā.*) To sell? (बेचना, *becnā.*) To look for? (ढूँढना, *ḍhū̃ḍhnā.*) To wear? (पहनना, *pahannā.*) To call? (बुलाना, *bulānā.*) To teach? (सिखाना, *sikhānā.*) To learn? (सीखना, *sīkhnā.*) To arrive? (पहुँचना, *pahũcnā.*) To come back? (लौटना, *lauṭnā.*) To catch? (पकड़ना, *pakaṛnā.*) To touch? (छूना, *chūnā.*) To explain? (समझाना, *samjhānā.*) To play? (बजाना, *bajānā.*) To count? (गिनना, *ginnā.*)

Chapter 166

A Notice, a Message, Opening Times, an Advert, a Repair

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read a notice, a short message, opening times, an advert and a repair note, and act on what they say.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 166: I can read a notice, a short message, opening times, an advert and a repair note, and act on what they say.*

166.1 सूचना (sūcnā) — a notice, information

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to play (an instrument), to ring, then the Hindi for to count.

You’ll want to know: सूचना

सूचना — *sūcnā* — “a notice, information”.
Read it: the notice on the door

The notice on the door says आज दुकान बंद है। (*āj dukān band hai.*) The shop is closed today, so come back *kal.*

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सूचना (*sūcnā*) is Sanskrit *sūcanā*, “pointing out, information”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *sūc-*, “to point out”, the root of *sūcī*, “needle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūcnā*
- *Say it: sūcnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sūcnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to play (an instrument), to ring, then the Hindi for to count, then say *sūcnā* again

Before you move on

What does सूचना mean? (“A notice, information”.) Say it once more.

166.2 संदेश (sandeś) — a message

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to count, then the Hindi for a notice.

You’ll want to know: संदेश

संदेश — *sandeś* — “a message”.

Read it: the message

The message says कल सुबह दस बजे दफ़्तर। (*kal subah das baje daftar.*) The office, tomorrow at ten in the morning: be there at ten.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

संदेश (*sandeś*) is Sanskrit *saṁdeśa*, “message, information”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 12904). CDIAL lists the inherited form of the same word as *sā̃desā*, “news”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sandeś*
- *Say it: sandeś*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sandeś*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to count, then the Hindi for a notice, then say *sandeś* again

Before you move on

What does संदेश mean? (“A message”.) Say it once more.

166.3 समय (samay) — time, opening hours

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a notice, then the Hindi for a message.

You’ll want to know: समय

समय — *samay* — “time, opening hours”.

Read it: the opening times

The opening times say दुकान सुबह नौ बजे से शाम छह बजे तक। (*dukān subah nau baje se śām chah baje tak.*) Nine in the morning until six in the evening: go before six.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समय (*samay*) is Sanskrit *samaya*, “meeting; agreement; time”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 13185). CDIAL marks Hindi *samā* as probably, and *samai* as certainly, taken from Sanskrit too.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samay*

- *Say it: samay*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samay*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a notice, then the Hindi for a message, then say *samay* again

Before you move on

What does समय mean? (“Time, opening hours”.) Say it once more.

166.4 विज्ञापन (vijñāpan) — an advertisement

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a message, then the Hindi for time.

You’ll want to know: विज्ञापन

विज्ञापन — *vijñāpan* — “an advertisement”.
Read it: the advert
The advert says कमरा ख़ाली है। पानी और बिजली। (*kamrā khālī hai. pānī aur bijlī.*) A room is free, with water and electricity.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

विज्ञापन (*vijñāpan*) is Sanskrit *vijñāpana*, “making known”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vijñāpan*
- *Say it: vijñāpan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vijñāpan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a message, then the Hindi for time, then say *vijñāpan* again

Before you move on

What does विज्ञापन mean? (“An advertisement”.) Say it once more.

166.5 मरम्मत (marammat) — a repair

Before the new one: say the Hindi for time, then the Hindi for an advertisement.

You’ll want to know: मरम्मत

मरम्मत — *marammat* — “a repair”.

Read it: the note

The note says बिजली की मरम्मत कल सुबह दस बजे। (*bijlī kī marammat kal subah das baje.*) The electricity is being repaired tomorrow at ten, so plan the morning without it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मरम्मत (*marammat*) is a loan from Arabic *maramma*, “a repairing”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *r-m-m* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: marammat*
- *Say it: marammat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *marammat*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for time, then the Hindi for an advertisement, then say *marammat* again

Before you move on

What does मरम्मत mean? (“A repair”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 167

Rent, a Date, a Number, a Floor, a Receipt

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can read the rent, a date, a room number, a floor and a receipt in a short notice.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 167: I can read the rent, a date, a room number, a floor and a receipt in a short notice.*

167.1 किराया (kirāyā) — rent, a fare

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an advertisement, then the Hindi for a repair.

You’ll want to know: किराया

किराया — *kirāyā* — “rent, a fare”.
Read it: the advert
The advert says **कमरा ख़ाली है। किराया: पाँच सौ रुपये।** (*kamrā khālī hai. kirāyā: pā̃c sau rupaye.*) The rent is five hundred rupees.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

किराया (*kirāyā*) is a loan from Arabic *kirāˀ*, “hire, rent”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *k-r-y* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kirāyā*
- *Say it: kirāyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kirāyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an advertisement, then the Hindi for a repair, then say *kirāyā* again

Before you move on

What does किराया mean? ("Rent, a fare".) Say it once more.

167.2 तारीख़ (tārīkh) — a date

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a repair, then the Hindi for rent.

You'll want to know: तारीख़

तारीख़ — *tārīkh* — "a date".

Read it: the note

The note says तारीख़ पाँच, सुबह नौ बजे। (*tārīkh pā̃c, subah nau baje.*) The fifth, at nine in the morning.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तारीख़ (*tārīkh*) is a loan from Arabic *tārīkh*, "a dating, a date", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ʾ-r-kh* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tārīkh*
- *Say it: tārīkh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tārīkh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a repair, then the Hindi for rent, then say *tārīkh* again

Before you move on

What does तारीख़ mean? (“A date”.) Say it once more.

167.3 नंबर (nambar) — a number

Before the new one: say the Hindi for rent, then the Hindi for a date.

You’ll want to know: नंबर

नंबर — *nambar* — “a number”.
Read it: the sign
The sign says कमरा नंबर बीस। (*kamrā nambar bīs.*) Room twenty.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नंबर (*nambar*) is a loan from English *number*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nambar*
- *Say it: nambar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nambar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for rent, then the Hindi for a date, then say *nambar* again

Before you move on

What does नंबर mean? (“A number”.) Say it once more.

167.4 मंज़िल (manzil) — a floor, a storey

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a date, then the Hindi for a number.

You’ll want to know: मंज़िल

मंज़िल — *manzil* — “a floor, a storey”.

Read it: the sign

The sign says **कमरा नंबर बीस, दूसरी मंज़िल।** (*kamrā nambar bīs, dūsrī manzil.*) Room twenty is on the second floor: go up.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मंज़िल (*manzil*) is a loan from Arabic *manzil*, “a stopping place, a dwelling”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *n-z-l* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: manzil*
- *Say it: manzil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *manzil*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a date, then the Hindi for a number, then say *manzil* again

Before you move on

What does मंज़िल mean? (“A floor, a storey”.) Say it once more.

167.5 रसीद (rasīd) — a receipt

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a number, then the Hindi for a floor.

You'll want to know: रसीद

रसीद — *rasīd* — "a receipt".

Read it: the receipt

The receipt says **रसीद: किराया पाँच सौ रुपये, तारीख़ पाँच।** (*rasīd: kirāyā pā̃c sau rupaye, tārīkh pā̃c.*) Five hundred rupees of rent, paid on the fifth: keep it.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रसीद (*rasīd*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *rasīd*, "arrived; a receipt".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rasīd*
- *Say it: rasīd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rasīd*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a number, then the Hindi for a floor, then say *rasīd* again

Before you move on

What does **रसीद** mean? ("A receipt".) Say it once more.

167.6 Notices and messages — a first pass

Say the words for a floor and a receipt.

Your turn

- *Say it:* a notice, a message, time, an advertisement, a repair

Before you move on

A notice? (सूचना, *sūcnā.*) A message? (संदेश, *sandeś.*) Time? (समय, *samay.*) An advertisement? (विज्ञापन, *vijñāpan.*) A repair? (मरम्मत, *marammat.*)

167.7 Rent, dates and rooms — a second pass

Say the words for rent and a date.

Your turn

- *Say it:* rent, a date, a number, a floor, a receipt

Before you move on

Rent? (किराया, *kirāyā.*) A date? (तारीख़, *tārīkh.*) A number? (नंबर, *nambar.*) A floor? (मंज़िल, *manzil.*) A receipt? (रसीद, *rasīd.*)

Chapter 168

To accept, To mix, To change, To drive, To leave

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to accept, to mix, to change, to drive and to leave.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 168: I can say to accept, to mix, to change, to drive and to leave.*

168.1 मानना (mānnā) — to accept, to agree, to believe

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a floor, a storey, then the Hindi for a receipt.

You'll want to know: मानना

मानना — *mānnā* — "to accept, to agree, to believe".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मानना (*mānnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *manyate*, "thinks, honours; agrees" (CDIAL 9857).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mānnā*
- *Say it: mānnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mānnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a floor, a storey, then the Hindi for a receipt, then say *mānnā* again

Before you move on

What does मानना mean? (“To accept, to agree, to believe”.) Say it once more.

168.2 मिलाना (milānā) — to mix, to introduce

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a receipt, then the Hindi for to accept.

You’ll want to know: मिलाना

मिलाना — *milānā* — “to mix, to introduce”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मिलाना (*milānā*) is the causing form of *milnā*, “to meet”: to mix or introduce is to make things meet. *milnā* comes from Sanskrit *milati*, “meets” (CDIAL 10133).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: milānā*
- *Say it: milānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *milānā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a receipt, then the Hindi for to accept, then say *milānā* again

Before you move on

What does मिलाना mean? (“To mix, to introduce”.) Say it once more.

168.3 बदलना (badalnā) — to change

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to accept, then the Hindi for to mix.

You’ll want to know: बदलना

बदलना — *badalnā* — “to change”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बदलना (*badalnā*) is a loan from Arabic *badal*, “a substitute, an exchange”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *b-d-l* (Lane). Hindi made a verb of it with *-nā*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: badalnā*
- *Say it: badalnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *badalnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to accept, then the Hindi for to mix, then say *badalnā* again

Before you move on

What does बदलना mean? (“To change”.) Say it once more.

168.4 चलाना (calānā) — to drive, to run (a machine)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to mix, then the Hindi for to change.

You'll want to know: चलाना

चलाना — *calānā* — "to drive, to run (a machine)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चलाना (*calānā*) is the causing form of *calnā*, "to move, go": to drive is to make something go. *calnā* comes from Sanskrit *calati*, "goes away" (CDIAL 4715).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: calānā*
- *Say it: calānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *calānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to mix, then the Hindi for to change, then say *calānā* again

Before you move on

What does **चलाना** mean? ("To drive, to run (a machine)".) Say it once more.

168.5 छोड़ना (choṛnā) — to leave, to let go

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to change, then the Hindi for to drive.

You’ll want to know: छोड़ना

छोड़ना — *choṛnā* — “to leave, to let go”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छोड़ना (*choṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kṣoṭayati*, “throws” (CDIAL 3747). The Sanskrit word is known only from a list of verb roots.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: choṛnā*
- *Say it: choṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *choṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to change, then the Hindi for to drive, then say *choṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does छोड़ना mean? (“To leave, to let go”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 169

To join, To reduce, To increase, To save, To escape

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to join, to reduce, to increase, to save and to escape.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 169: I can say to join, to reduce, to increase, to save and to escape.*

169.1 जोड़ना (joṛnā) — to join, to add

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to drive, then the Hindi for to leave.

You'll want to know: जोड़ना

जोड़ना — *joṛnā* — "to join, to add".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जोड़ना (*joṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **yoṭayati*, "joins", one of a family of forms CDIAL reconstructs from their descendants under **yuṭati*, "is joined" (CDIAL 10496). The plain **yuṭati* gave Hindi the intransitive *juṛnā*, "to be joined". CDIAL calls the whole family's link with Sanskrit *yuj-*, "to join", obscure.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: joṛnā*
- *Say it: joṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *joṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to drive, then the Hindi for to leave, then say *joṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does जोड़ना mean? ("To join, to add".) Say it once more.

169.2 घटाना (ghaṭānā) — to reduce, to subtract

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to leave, then the Hindi for to join.

You'll want to know: घटाना

घटाना — *ghaṭānā* — "to reduce, to subtract".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घटाना (*ghaṭānā*) is the causing form of *ghaṭnā*, "to decrease", which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **ghaṭṭati*, "decreases, is wanting" (CDIAL 4415).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghaṭānā*
- *Say it: ghaṭānā*, once more

- *Say it:* say *ghaṭānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to leave, then the Hindi for to join, then say *ghaṭānā* again

Before you move on

What does घटाना mean? (“To reduce, to subtract”.) Say it once more.

169.3 बढ़ाना (baṛhānā) — to increase, to raise

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to join, then the Hindi for to reduce.

You’ll want to know: बढ़ाना

बढ़ाना — *baṛhānā* — “to increase, to raise”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बढ़ाना (*baṛhānā*) is the causing form of *baṛhnā*, “to increase, grow”, which comes from Sanskrit *vardhate*, “grows, increases” (CDIAL 11376).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baṛhānā*
- *Say it: baṛhānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baṛhānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to join, then the Hindi for to reduce, then say *baṛhānā* again

Before you move on

What does बढ़ाना mean? (“To increase, to raise”.) Say it once more.

169.4 बचाना (bacānā) — to save, to rescue

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to reduce, then the Hindi for to increase.

You’ll want to know: बचाना

बचाना — *bacānā* — “to save, to rescue”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बचाना (*bacānā*) is the causing form of *bacnā*, “to escape”: to save is to make someone escape. CDIAL lists both under Sanskrit *vañcati*, “moves”, whose causing form meant “escapes from” (CDIAL 11208).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bacānā*
- *Say it: bacānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bacānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to reduce, then the Hindi for to increase, then say *bacānā* again

Before you move on

What does बचाना mean? (“To save, to rescue”.) Say it once more.

169.5 बचना (bacnā) — to escape, to be saved

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to increase, then the Hindi for to save.

You’ll want to know: बचना

बचना — *bacnā* — “to escape, to be saved”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बचना (*bacnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vañcati*, “moves; escapes from” (CDIAL 11208).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bacnā*
- *Say it: bacnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bacnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to increase, then the Hindi for to save, then say *bacnā* again

Before you move on

What does बचना mean? (“To escape, to be saved”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 170

To die, To live, To pass (of time), To lift, To tell (a story)

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to die, to live, to pass (of time), to lift and to tell (a story).
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 170: I can say to die, to live, to pass (of time), to lift and to tell (a story).*

170.1 मरना (marnā) — to die

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to save, then the Hindi for to escape.

You’ll want to know: मरना

मरना — *marnā* — “to die”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मरना (*marnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *marate*, “will die” (CDIAL 9871). CDIAL calls direct descent from this old form possible, even probable.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: marnā*
- *Say it: marnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *marnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to save, then the Hindi for to escape, then say *marnā* again

Before you move on

What does मरना mean? (“To die”.) Say it once more.

170.2 जीना (jīnā) — to live

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to escape, then the Hindi for to die.

You’ll want to know: जीना

जीना — *jīnā* — “to live”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जीना (*jīnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jīvati*, “is alive” (CDIAL 5241).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīnā*
- *Say it: jīnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jīnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to escape, then the Hindi for to die, then say *jīnā* again

Before you move on

What does जीना mean? (“To live”.) Say it once more.

170.3 बीतना (bītnā) — to pass (of time)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to die, then the Hindi for to live.

You’ll want to know: बीतना

बीतना — *bītnā* — “to pass (of time)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बीतना (*bītnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vṛtta*, “turned; passed (of time)” (CDIAL 12069).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bītnā*
- *Say it: bītnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bītnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to die, then the Hindi for to live, then say *bītnā* again

Before you move on

What does बीतना mean? (“To pass (of time)”.) Say it once more.

170.4 उठाना (uṭhānā) — to lift, to pick up

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to live, then the Hindi for to pass.

You'll want to know: उठाना

उठाना — *uṭhānā* — "to lift, to pick up".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उठाना (*uṭhānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ut-sthāpayati*, "raises", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 1903). It is built on *sthā-*, "to stand": to lift is to make something stand up.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uṭhānā*
- *Say it: uṭhānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uṭhānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to live, then the Hindi for to pass, then say *uṭhānā* again

Before you move on

What does उठाना mean? ("To lift, to pick up".) Say it once more.

170.5 सुनाना (sunānā) — to tell (a story), to recite

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to pass, then the Hindi for to lift.

You’ll want to know: सुनाना

सुनाना — *sunānā* — “to tell (a story), to recite”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुनाना (*sunānā*) is the causing form of *sunnā*, “to hear”: to tell a story is to make someone hear it. *sunnā* comes from Sanskrit *śṛṇoti*, “hears” (CDIAL 12598).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sunānā*
- *Say it: sunānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sunānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to pass, then the Hindi for to lift, then say *sunānā* again

Before you move on

What does सुनाना mean? (“To tell (a story), to recite”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 171

To show, To be seen, To hide (something), To hide (oneself), To stop

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to show, to be seen, to hide (something), to hide (oneself) and to stop.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 171: I can say to show, to be seen, to hide (something), to hide (oneself) and to stop.*

171.1 दिखाना (dikhānā) — to show

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to lift, then the Hindi for to tell.

You'll want to know: दिखाना

दिखाना — *dikhānā* — "to show".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दिखाना (*dikhānā*) is the causing form of देखना, "to see": to show is to make someone see. CDIAL traces the verb to a reconstructed **dṛkṣati*, "sees" (CDIAL 6507).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dikhānā*
- *Say it: dikhānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dikhānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to lift, then the Hindi for to tell, then say *dikhānā* again

Before you move on

What does दिखाना mean? ("To show".) Say it once more.

171.2 दिखना (dikhnā) — to be seen, to appear

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to tell, then the Hindi for to show.

You'll want to know: दिखना

दिखना — *dikhnā* — "to be seen, to appear".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दिखना (*dikhnā*) is listed by CDIAL beside *dīkhnā*, "is seen", under a reconstructed **dṛkṣati*, "sees", crossed with Prakrit *dīsaï*, "is seen" (CDIAL 6507).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dikhnā*

- *Say it: dikhnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dikhnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to tell, then the Hindi for to show, then say *dikhnā* again

Before you move on

What does दिखना mean? (“To be seen, to appear”.) Say it once more.

171.3 छिपाना (chipānā) — to hide (something)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to show, then the Hindi for to be seen.

You’ll want to know: छिपाना

छिपाना — *chipānā* — “to hide (something)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छिपाना (*chipānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **chipp*, “press, cover, hide”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4994). *chipānā* is the causing form of *chipnā*, “to hide oneself”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chipānā*
- *Say it: chipānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chipānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to show, then the Hindi for to be seen, then say *chipānā* again

Before you move on

What does छिपाना mean? (“To hide (something)”.) Say it once more.

171.4 छिपना (chipnā) — to hide (oneself)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to be seen, then the Hindi for to hide.

You’ll want to know: छिपना

छिपना — *chipnā* — “to hide (oneself)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छिपना (*chipnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **chipp*, “press, cover, hide”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4994).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chipnā*
- *Say it: chipnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chipnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to be seen, then the Hindi for to hide, then say *chipnā* again

Before you move on

What does छिपना mean? (“To hide (oneself)”.) Say it once more.

171.5 रुकना (ruknā) — to stop, to wait

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to hide, then the Hindi for to hide.

You'll want to know: रुकना

रुकना — *ruknā* — "to stop, to wait".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रुकना (*ruknā*) is listed by CDIAL beside *roknā*, "to stop someone", under a reconstructed **rokk*, "stop"; CDIAL calls its link with Sanskrit *rudh-*, "to obstruct", not clear (CDIAL 10827).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ruknā*
- *Say it: ruknā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ruknā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to hide, then the Hindi for to hide, then say *ruknā* again

Before you move on

What does रुकना mean? ("To stop, to wait".) Say it once more.

Chapter 172

To stop (someone or something), To run away, To climb, To get down, To stroll

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to stop (someone or something), to run away, to climb, to get down and to stroll.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 172: I can say to stop (someone or something), to run away, to climb, to get down and to stroll.*

172.1 रोकना (roknā) — to stop (someone or something)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to hide, then the Hindi for to stop.

You'll want to know: रोकना

रोकना — *roknā* — "to stop (someone or something)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रोकना (*roknā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **rokk*, "stop", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 10827). CDIAL calls its link with Sanskrit *rudh-*, "to obstruct", not clear.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: roknā*
- *Say it: roknā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *roknā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to hide, then the Hindi for to stop, then say *roknā* again

Before you move on

What does **रोकना** mean? ("To stop (someone or something)".) Say it once more.

172.2 भागना (bhāgnā) — to run away

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to stop, then the Hindi for to stop.

You'll want to know: भागना

भागना — *bhāgnā* — "to run away".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भागना (*bhāgnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *bhagna*, "broken, defeated", the past participle that CDIAL lists in its entry for *bhajyate*, "is broken" (CDIAL 9361). Bloch linked the sense "flee" with a different old verb; CDIAL finds that unnecessary, since "broken" could come to mean "routed, fled".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhāgnā*
- *Say it: bhāgnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhāgnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to stop, then the Hindi for to stop, then say *bhāgnā* again

Before you move on

What does **भागना** mean? (“To run away”.) Say it once more.

172.3 चढ़ना (caṛhnā) — to climb, to board

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to stop, then the Hindi for to run away.

You’ll want to know: चढ़ना

चढ़ना — *caṛhnā* — “to climb, to board”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चढ़ना (*caṛhnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **caḍhati*, “rises”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4578).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caṛhnā*
- *Say it: caṛhnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caṛhnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to stop, then the Hindi for to run away, then say *caṛhnā* again

Before you move on

What does चढ़ना mean? (“To climb, to board”.) Say it once more.

172.4 उतरना (utarnā) — to get down, to get off

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to run away, then the Hindi for to climb.

You’ll want to know: उतरना

उतरना — *utarnā* — “to get down, to get off”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उतरना (*utarnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *uttarati*, “passes over; descends” (CDIAL 1770). CDIAL traces the sense from “crosses over” through “lands” to “gets down”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: utarnā*
- *Say it: utarnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *utarnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to run away, then the Hindi for to climb, then say *utarnā* again

Before you move on

What does उतरना mean? (“To get down, to get off”.) Say it once more.

172.5 घूमना (ghūmnā) — to stroll, to wander

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to climb, then the Hindi for to get down.

You’ll want to know: घूमना

घूमना — *ghūmnā* — “to stroll, to wander”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घूमना (*ghūmnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ghummati*, “revolves”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4485).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghūmnā*
- *Say it: ghūmnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghūmnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to climb, then the Hindi for to get down, then say *ghūmnā* again

Before you move on

What does घूमना mean? (“To stroll, to wander”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 173

To cover, To fill, To share, To choose, To ask for

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to cover, to fill, to share, to choose and to ask for.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 173: I can say to cover, to fill, to share, to choose and to ask for.*

173.1 ढकना (ḍhaknā) — to cover

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to get down, then the Hindi for to stroll.

You’ll want to know: ढकना

ढकना — *ḍhaknā* — “to cover”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ढकना (*ḍhaknā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ḍhakk*, “cover”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5574).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ḍhaknā*
- *Say it: ḍhaknā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍhaknā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to get down, then the Hindi for to stroll, then say *ḍhaknā* again

Before you move on

What does ढकना mean? (“To cover”.) Say it once more.

173.2 भरना (bharnā) — to fill

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to stroll, then the Hindi for to cover.

You’ll want to know: भरना

भरना — *bharnā* — “to fill”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भरना (*bharnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *bharati*, “bears, brings; fills” (CDIAL 9397).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bharnā*
- *Say it: bharnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bharnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to stroll, then the Hindi for to cover, then say *bharnā* again

Before you move on

What does **भरना** mean? (“To fill”.) Say it once more.

173.3 बाँटना (bā̃ṭnā) — to share, to divide

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to cover, then the Hindi for to fill.

You’ll want to know: बाँटना

बाँटना — *bā̃ṭnā* — “to share, to divide”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बाँटना (*bāṁṭnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vaṇṭati*, “shares” (CDIAL 11238). The Sanskrit verb is known only from a list of verb roots.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bā̃ṭnā*
- *Say it: bā̃ṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bā̃ṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to cover, then the Hindi for to fill, then say *bā̃ṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does **बाँटना** mean? (“To share, to divide”.) Say it once more.

173.4 चुनना (cunnā) — to choose

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to fill, then the Hindi for to share.

You’ll want to know: चुनना

चुनना — *cunnā* — “to choose”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चुनना (*cunnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *cinoti*, “heaps up, collects” (CDIAL 4814). CDIAL explains the *u* as taken from other verbs.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cunnā*
- *Say it: cunnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cunnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to fill, then the Hindi for to share, then say *cunnā* again

Before you move on

What does चुनना mean? (“To choose”.) Say it once more.

173.5 माँगना (mā̃gnā) — to ask for

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to share, then the Hindi for to choose.

You’ll want to know: माँगना

माँगना — *mā̃gnā* — “to ask for”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

माँगना (*māṁgnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mārgati*, “seeks, requests” (CDIAL 10074). It is built on *mārga*, “path”: to seek was “to track”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mā̃gnā*
- *Say it: mā̃gnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mā̃gnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to share, then the Hindi for to choose, then say *mā̃gnā* again

Before you move on

What does **माँगना** mean? (“To ask for”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 174

To give back, To decorate, To look after, To improve, To weigh

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to give back, to decorate, to look after, to improve and to weigh.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 174: I can say to give back, to decorate, to look after, to improve and to weigh.*

174.1 लौटाना (lauṭānā) — to give back

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to choose, then the Hindi for to ask for.

You'll want to know: लौटाना

लौटाना — *lauṭānā* — "to give back".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लौटाना (*lauṭānā*) is the causing form of *lauṭnā*, "to come back": to give back is to make something return. The origin of *lauṭnā* is uncertain, and CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lauṭānā*
- *Say it: lauṭānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lauṭānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to choose, then the Hindi for to ask for, then say *lauṭānā* again

Before you move on

What does लौटाना mean? ("To give back".) Say it once more.

174.2 सजाना (sajānā) — to decorate

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to ask for, then the Hindi for to give back.

You'll want to know: सजाना

सजाना — *sajānā* — "to decorate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सजाना (*sajānā*) is a tadbhava, inherited and reshaped by sound change. CDIAL lists it, as the causing form of *sājnā*, "to prepare, decorate", under Sanskrit *sajjayati*, "equips, prepares" (CDIAL 13091).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sajānā*
- *Say it: sajānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sajānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to ask for, then the Hindi for to give back, then say *sajānā* again

Before you move on

What does सजाना mean? (“To decorate”.) Say it once more.

174.3 सँभालना (sā̃bhālnā) — to look after, to handle

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to give back, then the Hindi for to decorate.

You’ll want to know: सँभालना

सँभालना — *sā̃bhālnā* — “to look after, to handle”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सँभालना (*sā̃bhālnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. CDIAL lists it in its entry for Sanskrit *saṁbharati*, “brings together, prepares” (CDIAL 12961), among a group of forms with *-l-* that it places under neither of its two numbered headwords. The same entry puts Hindi *sā̃bhārnā*, “to sustain”, under the causing form *saṁbhārayati*, “maintains”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sā̃bhālnā*
- *Say it: sā̃bhālnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sā̃bhālnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to give back, then the Hindi for to decorate, then say *sā̃bhālnā* again

Before you move on

What does सँभालना mean? (“To look after, to handle”.) Say it once more.

174.4 सुधारना (sudhārnā) — to improve, to correct

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to decorate, then the Hindi for to look after.

You’ll want to know: सुधारना

सुधारना — *sudhārnā* — “to improve, to correct”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुधारना (*sudhārnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **śuddhakāra*, “making clean”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 12521). It is built from *śuddha*, “pure”, and *kāra*, “making”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sudhārnā*
- *Say it: sudhārnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sudhārnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to decorate, then the Hindi for to look after, then say *sudhārnā* again

Before you move on

What does सुधारना mean? (“To improve, to correct”.) Say it once more.

174.5 तोलना (tolnā) — to weigh

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to look after, then the Hindi for to improve.

You'll want to know: तोलना

तोलना — *tolnā* — "to weigh".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तोलना (*tolnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *tolayati*, "lifts, weighs, considers" (CDIAL 5979).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tolnā*
- *Say it: tolnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tolnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to look after, then the Hindi for to improve, then say *tolnā* again

Before you move on

What does तोलना mean? ("To weigh".) Say it once more.

Chapter 175

To measure, To drop, To light, To burn (by itself), To put out (a fire or light)

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to measure, to drop, to light, to burn (by itself) and to put out (a fire or light).
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 175: I can say to measure, to drop, to light, to burn (by itself) and to put out (a fire or light).*

175.1 नापना (nāpnā) — to measure

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to improve, then the Hindi for to weigh.

You'll want to know: नापना

नापना — *nāpnā* — "to measure".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नापना (*nāpnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jñāpyate*, "is made known" (CDIAL 5283). The sense moved from "making known" to "measuring".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāpnā*
- *Say it: nāpnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāpnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to improve, then the Hindi for to weigh, then say *nāpnā* again

Before you move on

What does नापना mean? ("To measure".) Say it once more.

175.2 गिराना (girānā) — to drop

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to weigh, then the Hindi for to measure.

You'll want to know: गिराना

गिराना — *girānā* — "to drop".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गिराना (*girānā*) is the causing form of *girnā*, "to fall": to drop is to make something fall. CDIAL lists *girnā* under a reconstructed **girati*, "drips, falls" (CDIAL 4159).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: girānā*
- *Say it: girānā*, once more

- *Say it:* say *girānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to weigh, then the Hindi for to measure, then say *girānā* again

Before you move on

What does गिराना mean? (“To drop”.) Say it once more.

175.3 जलाना (jalānā) — to light, to burn

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to measure, then the Hindi for to drop.

You’ll want to know: जलाना

जलाना — *jalānā* — “to light, to burn”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जलाना (*jalānā*) is the causing form of *jalnā*, “to burn”: to light is to make something burn. CDIAL lists both under Sanskrit *jvalati*, “burns brightly” (CDIAL 5306).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jalānā*
- *Say it: jalānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jalānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to measure, then the Hindi for to drop, then say *jalānā* again

Before you move on

What does जलाना mean? (“To light, to burn”.) Say it once more.

175.4 जलना (jalnā) — to burn (by itself)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to drop, then the Hindi for to light.

You’ll want to know: जलना

जलना — *jalnā* — “to burn (by itself)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जलना (*jalnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jvalati*, “burns brightly” (CDIAL 5306).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jalnā*
- *Say it: jalnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jalnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to drop, then the Hindi for to light, then say *jalnā* again

Before you move on

What does जलना mean? (“To burn (by itself)”.) Say it once more.

175.5 बुझाना (bujhānā) — to put out (a fire or light)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to light, then the Hindi for to burn.

You'll want to know: बुझाना

बुझाना — *bujhānā* — "to put out (a fire or light)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बुझाना (*bujhānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **vijjhāpayati*, "extinguishes", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 11703). It is the causing form of **vijjhāyati*, "is burnt out"; it is a different word from *būjhnā*, "to understand" (CDIAL 9279).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bujhānā*
- *Say it: bujhānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bujhānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to light, then the Hindi for to burn, then say *bujhānā* again

Before you move on

What does बुझाना mean? ("To put out (a fire or light)".) Say it once more.

175.6 Verbs of change and movement — a first pass

Say the words for to burn and to put out.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to accept, to mix, to change, to drive, to leave

- to join, to reduce, to increase, to save, to escape
- to die, to live, to pass, to lift, to tell
- to show, to be seen, to hide, to hide, to stop

Before you move on

To accept? (मानना, *mānnā.*) To mix? (मिलाना, *milānā.*) To change? (बदलना, *badalnā.*) To drive? (चलाना, *calānā.*) To leave? (छोड़ना, *choṛnā.*) To join? (जोड़ना, *joṛnā.*) To reduce? (घटाना, *ghaṭānā.*) To increase? (बढ़ाना, *baṛhānā.*) To save? (बचाना, *bacānā.*) To escape? (बचना, *bacnā.*) To die? (मरना, *marnā.*) To live? (जीना, *jīnā.*) To pass? (बीतना, *bītnā.*) To lift? (उठाना, *uṭhānā.*) To tell? (सुनाना, *sunānā.*) To show? (दिखाना, *dikhānā.*) To be seen? (दिखना, *dikhnā.*) To hide? (छिपाना, *chipānā.*) To hide? (छिपना, *chipnā.*) To stop? (रुकना, *ruknā.*)

175.7 Verbs of the hands and the kitchen — a second pass

Say the words for to stop and to run away.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to stop, to run away, to climb, to get down, to stroll
- to cover, to fill, to share, to choose, to ask for
- to give back, to decorate, to look after, to improve, to weigh
- to measure, to drop, to light, to burn, to put out

Before you move on

To stop? (रोकना, *roknā.*) To run away? (भागना, *bhāgnā.*) To climb? (चढ़ना, *caṛhnā.*) To get down? (उतरना, *utarnā.*) To stroll? (घूमना, *ghūmnā.*) To cover? (ढकना, *ḍhaknā.*) To fill? (भरना, *bharnā.*) To share? (बाँटना, *bā̃ṭnā.*) To choose? (चुनना, *cunnā.*) To ask for? (माँगना,

mā̃gnā.) To give back? (लौटाना, *lauṭānā.*) To decorate? (सजाना, *sajānā.*) To look after? (सँभालना, *sā̃bhālnā.*) To improve? (सुधारना, *sudhārnā.*) To weigh? (तोलना, *tolnā.*) To measure? (नापना, *nāpnā.*) To drop? (गिराना, *girānā.*) To light? (जलाना, *jalānā.*) To burn? (जलना, *jalnā.*) To put out? (बुझाना, *bujhānā.*)

Chapter 176

To shake, To pull, To push, To throw, To taste

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to shake, to pull, to push, to throw and to taste.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 176: I can say to shake, to pull, to push, to throw and to taste.*

176.1 हिलाना (hilānā) — to shake

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to burn (by itself), then the Hindi for to put out (a fire or light).

You'll want to know: हिलाना

हिलाना — *hilānā* — "to shake".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हिलाना (*hilānā*) is the causing form of *hilnā*, "to shake, move", which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **hillati*, "moves, shakes" (CDIAL 14120).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hilānā*
- *Say it: hilānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hilānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to burn (by itself), then the Hindi for to put out (a fire or light), then say *hilānā* again

Before you move on

What does हिलाना mean? (“To shake”.) Say it once more.

176.2 खींचना (khī̃cnā) — to pull

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to put out (a fire or light), then the Hindi for to shake.

You’ll want to know: खींचना

खींचना — *khī̃cnā* — “to pull”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खींचना (*khīṁcnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **khiñc*, “drag, pull”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 3881).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khī̃cnā*
- *Say it: khī̃cnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khī̃cnā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to put out (a fire or light), then the Hindi for to shake, then say *khĩcnā* again

Before you move on

What does खींचना mean? (“To pull”.) Say it once more.

176.3 धकेलना (dhakelnā) — to push

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to shake, then the Hindi for to pull.

You’ll want to know: धकेलना

धकेलना — *dhakelnā* — “to push”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धकेलना (*dhakelnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dhakk*, “push, strike”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6701).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhakelnā*
- *Say it: dhakelnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhakelnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to shake, then the Hindi for to pull, then say *dhakelnā* again

Before you move on

What does धकेलना mean? (“To push”.) Say it once more.

176.4 फेंकना (phẽknā) — to throw

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to pull, then the Hindi for to push.

You'll want to know: फेंकना

फेंकना — *phẽknā* — "to throw".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फेंकना (*phẽknā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **phekk*, "throw", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9106).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: phẽknā*
- *Say it: phẽknā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phẽknā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to pull, then the Hindi for to push, then say *phẽknā* again

Before you move on

What does फेंकना mean? ("To throw".) Say it once more.

176.5 चखना (cakhnā) — to taste

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to push, then the Hindi for to throw.

You'll want to know: चखना

चखना — *cakhnā* — "to taste".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चखना (*cakhnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **cakṣati*, “tastes”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4557).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cakhnā*
- *Say it: cakhnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cakhnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to push, then the Hindi for to throw, then say *cakhnā* again

Before you move on

What does चखना mean? (“To taste”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 177

To smell, To celebrate, To grind, To boil, To fry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to smell, to celebrate, to grind, to boil and to fry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 177: I can say to smell, to celebrate, to grind, to boil and to fry.*

177.1 सूँघना (sū̃ghnā) — to smell

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to throw, then the Hindi for to taste.

You'll want to know: सूँघना

सूँघना — *sū̃ghnā* — "to smell".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सूँघना (*sūṁghnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *śiṅghati*, "smells" (CDIAL 12579). The Sanskrit verb is known only from a list of verb roots.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sū̃ghnā*
- *Say it: sū̃ghnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sū̃ghnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to throw, then the Hindi for to taste, then say *sū̃ghnā* again

Before you move on

What does सूँघना mean? (“To smell”.) Say it once more.

177.2 मनाना (manānā) — to celebrate, to persuade

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to taste, then the Hindi for to smell.

You’ll want to know: मनाना

मनाना — *manānā* — “to celebrate, to persuade”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मनाना (*manānā*) is the causing form of *mānnā*, “to accept, honour”: to persuade is to make someone accept, and to celebrate is to honour a day. CDIAL lists both under Sanskrit *manyate*, “thinks, honours” (CDIAL 9857).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: manānā*
- *Say it: manānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *manānā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to taste, then the Hindi for to smell, then say *manānā* again

Before you move on

What does मनाना mean? (“To celebrate, to persuade”.) Say it once more.

177.3 पीसना (pīsnā) — to grind

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to smell, then the Hindi for to celebrate.

You’ll want to know: पीसना

पीसना — *pīsnā* — “to grind”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पीसना (*pīsnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *piṁṣati*, “grinds” (CDIAL 8142).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pīsnā*
- *Say it: pīsnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pīsnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to smell, then the Hindi for to celebrate, then say *pīsnā* again

Before you move on

What does पीसना mean? (“To grind”.) Say it once more.

177.4 उबालना (ubālnā) — to boil

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to celebrate, then the Hindi for to grind.

You'll want to know: उबालना

उबालना — *ubālnā* — "to boil".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उबालना (*ubālnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ubbāl*, "make boil", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 2339). Morgenstierne traced it to *ud-*, "up", and an Indo-European root "to boil"; CDIAL finds the forms hard to fit and notes other possible sources.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ubālnā*
- *Say it: ubālnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ubālnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to celebrate, then the Hindi for to grind, then say *ubālnā* again

Before you move on

What does उबालना mean? ("To boil".) Say it once more.

177.5 तलना (talnā) — to fry

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to grind, then the Hindi for to boil.

You’ll want to know: तलना

तलना — *talnā* — “to fry”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तलना (*talnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **talati*, “fries”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5736).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: talnā*
- *Say it: talnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *talnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to grind, then the Hindi for to boil, then say *talnā* again

Before you move on

What does तलना mean? (“To fry”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 178

To weave, To hit, To fight, To be afraid, To shout

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to weave, to hit, to fight, to be afraid and to shout.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 178: I can say to weave, to hit, to fight, to be afraid and to shout.*

178.1 बुनना (bunnā) — to weave, to knit

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to boil, then the Hindi for to fry.

You'll want to know: बुनना

बुनना — *bunnā* — "to weave, to knit".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बुनना (*bunnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **vunāti*, "weaves", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 11773). CDIAL explains the *u* as taken from other forms of Sanskrit *vayati*, "weaves".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bunnā*
- *Say it: bunnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bunnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to boil, then the Hindi for to fry, then say *bunnā* again

Before you move on

What does बुनना mean? (“To weave, to knit”.) Say it once more.

178.2 मारना (mārnā) — to hit

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to fry, then the Hindi for to weave.

You’ll want to know: मारना

मारना — *mārnā* — “to hit”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मारना (*mārnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mārayati*, “kills” (CDIAL 10066). It is the causing form of the verb “to die”: to strike was “to make die”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mārnā*
- *Say it: mārnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mārnā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to fry, then the Hindi for to weave, then say *mārnā* again

Before you move on

What does मारना mean? ("To hit".) Say it once more.

178.3 लड़ना (laṛnā) — to fight

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to weave, then the Hindi for to hit.

You'll want to know: लड़ना

लड़ना — *laṛnā* — "to fight".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लड़ना (*laṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **laḍ*, "fight", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 10920).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laṛnā*
- *Say it: laṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *laṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to weave, then the Hindi for to hit, then say *laṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does लड़ना mean? ("To fight".) Say it once more.

178.4 डरना (ḍarnā) — to be afraid

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to hit, then the Hindi for to fight.

You’ll want to know: डरना

डरना — *ḍarnā* — “to be afraid”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डरना (*ḍarnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *darati*, “is frightened” (CDIAL 6190). The Sanskrit verb is known only from a list of verb roots.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ḍarnā*
- *Say it: ḍarnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍarnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to hit, then the Hindi for to fight, then say *ḍarnā* again

Before you move on

What does डरना mean? (“To be afraid”.) Say it once more.

178.5 चिल्लाना (cillānā) — to shout

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to fight, then the Hindi for to be afraid.

You’ll want to know: चिल्लाना

चिल्लाना — *cillānā* — “to shout”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of चिल्लाना (*cillānā*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cillānā*
- *Say it: cillānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cillānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to fight, then the Hindi for to be afraid, then say *cillānā* again

Before you move on

What does चिल्लाना mean? (“To shout”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 179

To get tired, To bear, To remove, To move aside, To pass by

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to get tired, to bear, to remove, to move aside and to pass by.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 179: I can say to get tired, to bear, to remove, to move aside and to pass by.*

179.1 थकना (thaknā) — to get tired

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to be afraid, then the Hindi for to shout.

You’ll want to know: थकना

थकना — *thaknā* — “to get tired”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

थकना (*thaknā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **sthakk*, “stop, halt”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 13737). CDIAL calls a link with *sthā-*, “to stand”, probable but not clear.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: thaknā*
- *Say it: thaknā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *thaknā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to be afraid, then the Hindi for to shout, then say *thaknā* again

Before you move on

What does थकना mean? ("To get tired".) Say it once more.

179.2 सहना (sahnā) — to bear, to put up with

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to shout, then the Hindi for to get tired.

You'll want to know: सहना

सहना — *sahnā* — "to bear, to put up with".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सहना (*sahnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *sahate*, "conquers; bears, suffers" (CDIAL 13304).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sahnā*
- *Say it: sahnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sahnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to shout, then the Hindi for to get tired, then say *sahnā* again

Before you move on

What does सहना mean? (“To bear, to put up with”.) Say it once more.

179.3 हटाना (haṭānā) — to remove

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to get tired, then the Hindi for to bear.

You’ll want to know: हटाना

हटाना — *haṭānā* — “to remove”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हटाना (*haṭānā*) is the causing form of *haṭnā*, “to move aside”: to remove is to make something move aside. CDIAL lists *haṭnā* under a reconstructed **haṭṭ*, “move” (CDIAL 13943).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: haṭānā*
- *Say it: haṭānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *haṭānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to get tired, then the Hindi for to bear, then say *haṭānā* again

Before you move on

What does हटाना mean? (“To remove”.) Say it once more.

179.4 हटना (haṭnā) — to move aside

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to bear, then the Hindi for to remove.

You'll want to know: हटना

हटना — *haṭnā* — "to move aside".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हटना (*haṭnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **haṭṭ*, "move", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 13943).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *haṭnā*
- *Say it:* *haṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *haṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to bear, then the Hindi for to remove, then say *haṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does हटना mean? ("To move aside".) Say it once more.

179.5 गुज़रना (guzarnā) — to pass by, to pass through

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to remove, then the Hindi for to move aside.

You’ll want to know: गुज़रना

गुज़रना — *guzarnā* — “to pass by, to pass through”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गुज़रना (*guzarnā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *guzar*, “a passing, a crossing”. Hindi made a verb of it with *-nā*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: guzarnā*
- *Say it: guzarnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *guzarnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to remove, then the Hindi for to move aside, then say *guzarnā* again

Before you move on

What does **गुज़रना** mean? (“To pass by, to pass through”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 180

Medicine, A patient, Treatment, A journey, Luggage

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say medicine, a patient, treatment, a journey and luggage.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 180: I can say medicine, a patient, treatment, a journey and luggage.*

180.1 दवा (davā) — medicine

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to move aside, then the Hindi for to pass by.

You’ll want to know: दवा

दवा — *davā* — “medicine”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दवा (*davā*) is a loan from Arabic *dawāʾ*, “remedy, medicine”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *d-w-y* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: davā*
- *Say it: davā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *davā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to move aside, then the Hindi for to pass by, then say *davā* again

Before you move on

What does दवा mean? (“Medicine”.) Say it once more.

180.2 मरीज़ (marīz) — a patient

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to pass by, then the Hindi for medicine.

You’ll want to know: मरीज़

मरीज़ — *marīz* — “a patient”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मरीज़ (*marīz*) is a loan from Arabic *marīḍ*, “sick”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *m-r-ḍ* (Lane). Hindi uses it for a patient.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: marīz*
- *Say it: marīz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *marīz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to pass by, then the Hindi for medicine, then say *marīz* again

Before you move on

What does मरीज़ mean? (“A patient”.) Say it once more.

180.3 इलाज (ilāj) — treatment, a cure

Before the new one: say the Hindi for medicine, then the Hindi for a patient.

You’ll want to know: इलाज

इलाज — *ilāj* — “treatment, a cure”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

इलाज (*ilāj*) is a loan from Arabic *ʿilāj*, “treatment, remedy”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ʿ-l-j* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ilāj*
- *Say it: ilāj*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ilāj*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for medicine, then the Hindi for a patient, then say *ilāj* again

Before you move on

What does इलाज mean? (“Treatment, a cure”.) Say it once more.

180.4 यात्रा (yātrā) — a journey

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a patient, then the Hindi for treatment.

You’ll want to know: यात्रा

यात्रा — *yātrā* — “a journey”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

यात्रा (*yātrā*) is Sanskrit *yātrā*, “journey, procession”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yātrā*
- *Say it: yātrā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yātrā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a patient, then the Hindi for treatment, then say *yātrā* again

Before you move on

What does यात्रा mean? (“A journey”.) Say it once more.

180.5 सामान (sāmān) — luggage, things

Before the new one: say the Hindi for treatment, then the Hindi for a journey.

You’ll want to know: सामान

सामान — *sāmān* — “luggage, things”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सामान (*sāmān*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sāmān*, “goods, equipment”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāmān*
- *Say it: sāmān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sāmān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for treatment, then the Hindi for a journey, then say *sāmān* again

Before you move on

What does **सामान** mean? ("Luggage, things".) Say it once more.

Chapter 181

A map, A way, A turn, A crossroads, A ship

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a map, a way, a turn, a crossroads and a ship.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 181: I can say a map, a way, a turn, a crossroads and a ship.*

181.1 नक़्शा (naqśā) — a map

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a journey, then the Hindi for luggage.

You'll want to know: नक़्शा

नक़्शा — *naqśā* — "a map".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नक़्शा (*naqśā*) is a loan from Arabic *naqsh*, "a painting, an engraving", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *n-q-sh* (Lane). Hindi *naqśā* came through Persian *naqsha*, "a drawing, a plan".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naqśā*
- *Say it: naqśā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naqśā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a journey, then the Hindi for luggage, then say *naqśā* again

Before you move on

What does **नक़्शा** mean? (“A map”.) Say it once more.

181.2 रास्ता (rāstā) — a way, a route

Before the new one: say the Hindi for luggage, then the Hindi for a map.

You’ll want to know: रास्ता

रास्ता — *rāstā* — “a way, a route”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रास्ता (*rāstā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *rāsta*, “straight; a road”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rāstā*
- *Say it: rāstā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rāstā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for luggage, then the Hindi for a map, then say *rāstā* again

Before you move on

What does रास्ता mean? (“A way, a route”.) Say it once more.

181.3 मोड़ (moṛ) — a turn, a bend

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a map, then the Hindi for a way.

You’ll want to know: मोड़

मोड़ — *moṛ* — “a turn, a bend”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मोड़ (*moṛ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. *moṛ*, “a turn”, is the noun of *moṛnā*, “to twist, bend”. CDIAL lists *moṛnā* under *mōṭati*, the second form in its entry for Sanskrit *muṭati*, “twists” (CDIAL 10186), and gives Panjabi *moṛ*, “a turn in a road”, from the same form.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: moṛ*
- *Say it: moṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *moṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a map, then the Hindi for a way, then say *moṛ* again

Before you move on

What does मोड़ mean? (“A turn, a bend”.) Say it once more.

181.4 चौराहा (caurāhā) — a crossroads

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a way, then the Hindi for a turn.

You'll want to know: चौराहा

चौराहा — *caurāhā* — "a crossroads".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चौराहा (*caurāhā*) is usually explained as *cau-*, "four", with Persian *rāh*, "road". CDIAL does not list it; it lists *cauhaṭṭā*, "a crossing of market streets", from *catur-*, "four" (CDIAL 4626).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caurāhā*
- *Say it: caurāhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caurāhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a way, then the Hindi for a turn, then say *caurāhā* again

Before you move on

What does चौराहा mean? ("A crossroads".) Say it once more.

181.5 जहाज़ (jahāz) — a ship, an aeroplane

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a turn, then the Hindi for a crossroads.

You'll want to know: जहाज़

जहाज़ — *jahāz* — "a ship, an aeroplane".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जहाज़ (*jahāz*) is a loan from Arabic *jahāz*, “equipment, gear”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *j-h-z* (Lane). In Persian and Hindi it came to mean a ship.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jahāz*
- *Say it: jahāz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jahāz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a turn, then the Hindi for a crossroads, then say *jahāz* again

Before you move on

What does जहाज़ mean? (“A ship, an aeroplane”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 182

A boat, A seat, A salary, An owner, A labourer

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5)   🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a boat, a seat, a salary, an owner and a labourer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 182: I can say a boat, a seat, a salary, an owner and a labourer.*

182.1 नाव (nāv) — a boat

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a crossroads, then the Hindi for a ship.

You'll want to know: नाव

नाव — *nāv* — "a boat".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाव (*nāv*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *nāvā*, "boat" (CDIAL 7081). CDIAL lists the Hindi form as *nāu*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāv*
- *Say it: nāv*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāv*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a crossroads, then the Hindi for a ship, then say *nāv* again

Before you move on

What does **नाव** mean? (“A boat”.) Say it once more.

182.2 सीट (sīṭ) — a seat

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a ship, then the Hindi for a boat.

You’ll want to know: सीट

सीट — *sīṭ* — “a seat”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सीट (*sīṭ*) is a loan from English *seat*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sīṭ*
- *Say it: sīṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sīṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a ship, then the Hindi for a boat, then say *sīṭ* again

Before you move on

What does सीट mean? (“A seat”.) Say it once more.

182.3 तनख़्वाह (tankhvāh) — a salary

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a boat, then the Hindi for a seat.

You’ll want to know: तनख़्वाह

तनख़्वाह — *tankhvāh* — “a salary”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तनख़्वाह (*tankhvāh*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *tankhwāh*, “salary”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tankhvāh*
- *Say it: tankhvāh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tankhvāh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a boat, then the Hindi for a seat, then say *tankhvāh* again

Before you move on

What does तनख़्वाह mean? (“A salary”.) Say it once more.

182.4 मालिक (mālik) — an owner, a boss

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a seat, then the Hindi for a salary.

You'll want to know: मालिक

मालिक — *mālik* — "an owner, a boss".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मालिक (*mālik*) is a loan from Arabic *mālik*, "owner", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *m-l-k* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mālik*
- *Say it:* *mālik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mālik*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a seat, then the Hindi for a salary, then say *mālik* again

Before you move on

What does मालिक mean? ("An owner, a boss".) Say it once more.

182.5 मज़दूर (mazdūr) — a labourer

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a salary, then the Hindi for an owner.

You'll want to know: मज़दूर

मज़दूर — *mazdūr* — "a labourer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मज़दूर (*mazdūr*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *muzdūr*, "a hired labourer". It is built on *muzd*, "wages".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mazdūr*
- *Say it: mazdūr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mazdūr*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a salary, then the Hindi for an owner, then say *mazdūr* again

Before you move on

What does **मज़दूर** mean? ("A labourer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 183

A factory, A shopkeeper, A customer, A meeting, A kitchen

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a factory, a shopkeeper, a customer, a meeting and a kitchen.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 183: I can say a factory, a shopkeeper, a customer, a meeting and a kitchen.*

183.1 कारख़ाना (kārkhānā) — a factory

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an owner, then the Hindi for a labourer.

You'll want to know: कारख़ाना

कारख़ाना — *kārkhānā* — "a factory".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कारख़ाना (*kārkhānā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kārkhāna*, "workshop". It is built from *kār*, "work", and *khāna*, "house".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kārkhānā*
- *Say it: kārkhānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kārkhānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an owner, then the Hindi for a labourer, then say *kārkhānā* again

Before you move on

What does कारख़ाना mean? (“A factory”.) Say it once more.

183.2 दुकानदार (dukāndār) — a shopkeeper

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a labourer, then the Hindi for a factory.

You’ll want to know: दुकानदार

दुकानदार — *dukāndār* — “a shopkeeper”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दुकानदार (*dukāndār*) is *dukān*, “shop”, from Arabic *dukkān* through Persian (Lane, root *d-k-n*), with the Persian ending *-dār*, “holder”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dukāndār*
- *Say it: dukāndār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dukāndār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a labourer, then the Hindi for a factory, then say *dukāndār* again

Before you move on

What does दुकानदार mean? (“A shopkeeper”.) Say it once more.

183.3 ग्राहक (grāhak) — a customer

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a factory, then the Hindi for a shopkeeper.

You’ll want to know: ग्राहक

ग्राहक — *grāhak* — “a customer”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ग्राहक (*grāhak*) is Sanskrit *grāhaka*, “one who takes”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *grah-*, “to take”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: grāhak*
- *Say it: grāhak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *grāhak*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a factory, then the Hindi for a shopkeeper, then say *grāhak* again

Before you move on

What does ग्राहक mean? (“A customer”.) Say it once more.

183.4 बैठक (baiṭhak) — a meeting, a sitting room

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a shopkeeper, then the Hindi for a customer.

You'll want to know: बैठक

बैठक — *baiṭhak* — "a meeting, a sitting room".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बैठक (*baiṭhak*) is the noun of बैठना, "to sit", with the ending *-ak*: a sitting, and a room to sit in. *baiṭhnā* comes from Sanskrit *upaviśati*, "sits down" (CDIAL 2245).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *baiṭhak*
- *Say it:* *baiṭhak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baiṭhak*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a shopkeeper, then the Hindi for a customer, then say *baiṭhak* again

Before you move on

What does बैठक mean? ("A meeting, a sitting room".) Say it once more.

183.5 रसोई (rasoī) — a kitchen

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a customer, then the Hindi for a meeting.

You'll want to know: रसोई

रसोई — *rasoī* — "a kitchen".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रसोई (*rasoī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *rasavatī*, "kitchen" (CDIAL

10656). It is built on *rasa*, “juice, flavour”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rasoī*
- *Say it: rasoī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rasoī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a customer, then the Hindi for a meeting, then say *rasoī* again

Before you move on

What does रसोई mean? (“A kitchen”.) Say it once more.

183.6 Verbs of feeling and conflict — a first pass

Say the words for a meeting and a kitchen.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to shake, to pull, to push, to throw, to taste
- to smell, to celebrate, to grind, to boil, to fry
- to weave, to hit, to fight, to be afraid, to shout
- to get tired, to bear, to remove, to move aside, to pass by

Before you move on

To shake? (हिलाना, *hilānā*.) To pull? (खींचना, *khı̃̄cnā*.) To push? (धकेलना, *dhakelnā*.) To throw? (फेंकना, *phĕknā*.) To taste? (चखना, *cakhnā*.) To smell? (सूँघना, *sū̃ghnā*.) To celebrate? (मनाना, *manānā*.)

To grind? (पीसना, *pīsnā.*) To boil? (उबालना, *ubālnā.*) To fry? (तलना, *talnā.*) To weave? (बुनना, *bunnā.*) To hit? (मारना, *mārnā.*) To fight? (लड़ना, *laṛnā.*) To be afraid? (डरना, *ḍarnā.*) To shout? (चिल्लाना, *cillānā.*) To get tired? (थकना, *thaknā.*) To bear? (सहना, *sahnā.*) To remove? (हटाना, *haṭānā.*) To move aside? (हटना, *haṭnā.*) To pass by? (गुज़रना, *guzarnā.*)

183.7 Health, travel and work — a second pass

Say the words for medicine and a patient.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- medicine, a patient, treatment, a journey, luggage
- a map, a way, a turn, a crossroads, a ship
- a boat, a seat, a salary, an owner, a labourer
- a factory, a shopkeeper, a customer, a meeting, a kitchen

Before you move on

Medicine? (दवा, *davā.*) A patient? (मरीज़, *marīz.*) Treatment? (इलाज, *ilāj.*) A journey? (यात्रा, *yātrā.*) Luggage? (सामान, *sāmān.*) A map? (नक़्शा, *naqśā.*) A way? (रास्ता, *rāstā.*) A turn? (मोड़, *moṛ.*) A crossroads? (चौराहा, *caurāhā.*) A ship? (जहाज़, *jahāz.*) A boat? (नाव, *nāv.*) A seat? (सीट, *sīṭ.*) A salary? (तनख़्वाह, *tankhvāh.*) An owner? (मालिक, *mālik.*) A labourer? (मज़दूर, *mazdūr.*) A factory? (कारख़ाना, *kārkhānā.*) A shopkeeper? (दुकानदार, *dukāndār.*) A customer? (ग्राहक, *grāhak.*) A meeting? (बैठक, *baiṭhak.*) A kitchen? (रसोई, *rasoī.*)

Chapter 184

A floor (surface), A key, A cupboard, A mirror, Rain

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a floor (surface), a key, a cupboard, a mirror and rain.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 184: I can say a floor (surface), a key, a cupboard, a mirror and rain.*

184.1 फ़र्श (farś) — a floor (surface)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a meeting, a sitting room, then the Hindi for a kitchen.

You'll want to know: फ़र्श

फ़र्श — *farś* — "a floor (surface)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फ़र्श (*farś*) is a loan from Arabic *farsh*, "anything spread, a carpet", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *f-r-sh* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: farś*
- *Say it: farś*, once more
- *Say it:* say *farś*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a meeting, a sitting room, then the Hindi for a kitchen, then say *farś* again

Before you move on

What does फ़र्श mean? (“A floor (surface)”.) Say it once more.

184.2 चाबी (cābī) — a key

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a kitchen, then the Hindi for a floor.

You’ll want to know: चाबी

चाबी — *cābī* — “a key”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चाबी (*cābī*) is usually traced to Portuguese *chave*, “key”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cābī*
- *Say it: cābī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cābī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a kitchen, then the Hindi for a floor, then say *cābī* again

Before you move on

What does **चाबी** mean? (“A key”.) Say it once more.

184.3 अलमारी (almārī) — a cupboard

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a floor, then the Hindi for a key.

You’ll want to know: अलमारी

अलमारी — *almārī* — “a cupboard”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अलमारी (*almārī*) is usually traced to Portuguese *armário*, “cupboard”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: almārī*
- *Say it: almārī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *almārī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a floor, then the Hindi for a key, then say *almārī* again

Before you move on

What does **अलमारी** mean? (“A cupboard”.) Say it once more.

184.4 आईना (āīnā) — a mirror

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a key, then the Hindi for a cupboard.

You’ll want to know: आईना

आईना — *āīnā* — “a mirror”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आईना (*āīnā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *āīna*, “mirror”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āīnā*
- *Say it: āīnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āīnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a key, then the Hindi for a cupboard, then say *āīnā* again

Before you move on

What does आईना mean? (“A mirror”.) Say it once more.

184.5 बारिश (bāriś) — rain

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cupboard, then the Hindi for a mirror.

You’ll want to know: बारिश

बारिश — *bāriś* — “rain”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बारिश (*bāriś*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *bārish*, “rain”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāriś*
- *Say it: bāriś*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bāriś*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cupboard, then the Hindi for a mirror, then say *bāriś* again

Before you move on

What does बारिश mean? ("Rain".) Say it once more.

Chapter 185

Sunshine, Cold, Heat, A storm, A leaf

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say sunshine, cold, heat, a storm and a leaf.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 185: I can say sunshine, cold, heat, a storm and a leaf.*

185.1 धूप (dhūp) — sunshine

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mirror, then the Hindi for rain.

You'll want to know: धूप

धूप — *dhūp* — "sunshine".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धूप (*dhūp*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dhuppā*, "sunshine", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6825).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhūp*
- *Say it: dhūp*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhūp*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mirror, then the Hindi for rain, then say *dhūp* again

Before you move on

What does धूप mean? (“Sunshine”.) Say it once more.

185.2 ठंड (ṭhaṇḍ) — cold, the cold

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for rain, then the Hindi for sunshine.

You’ll want to know: ठंड

ठंड — *ṭhaṇḍ* — “cold, the cold”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ठंड (*ṭhaṇḍ*) comes from a reconstructed **ṭhaṇḍha*, “cold”, which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *stabdha*, “stiff, solidified” (CDIAL 13676). DEDR compares Dravidian words for “cool”, such as Tamil *taṇ* (DEDR 3045).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭhaṇḍ*
- *Say it: ṭhaṇḍ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭhaṇḍ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for rain, then the Hindi for sunshine, then say *ṭhaṇḍ* again

Before you move on

What does ठंड mean? (“Cold, the cold”.) Say it once more.

185.3 गर्मी (garmī) — heat, summer

Before the new one: say the Hindi for sunshine, then the Hindi for cold.

You’ll want to know: गर्मी

गर्मी — *garmī* — “heat, summer”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गर्मी (*garmī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *garmī*, “heat”. It is built on *garm*, “warm”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: garmī*
- *Say it: garmī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *garmī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sunshine, then the Hindi for cold, then say *garmī* again

Before you move on

What does गर्मी mean? (“Heat, summer”.) Say it once more.

185.4 तूफ़ान (tūfān) — a storm

Before the new one: say the Hindi for cold, then the Hindi for heat.

You'll want to know: तूफ़ान

तूफ़ान — *tūfān* — "a storm".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तूफ़ान (*tūfān*) is a loan from Arabic *ṭūfān*, "a flood, a deluge", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṭ-w-f* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tūfān*
- *Say it: tūfān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tūfān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for cold, then the Hindi for heat, then say *tūfān* again

Before you move on

What does तूफ़ान mean? ("A storm".) Say it once more.

185.5 पत्ता (pattā) — a leaf

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for heat, then the Hindi for a storm.

You'll want to know: पत्ता

पत्ता — *pattā* — "a leaf".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पत्ता (*pattā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *pattra*, "wing-feather; leaf" (CDIAL 7733).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pattā*
- *Say it: pattā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pattā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for heat, then the Hindi for a storm, then say *pattā* again

Before you move on

What does पत्ता mean? ("A leaf".) Say it once more.

Chapter 186

Anger, Love, Shame, Hope, A memory

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say anger, love, shame, hope and a memory.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 186: I can say anger, love, shame, hope and a memory.*

186.1 ग़ुस्सा (ġussā) — anger

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a storm, then the Hindi for a leaf.

You'll want to know: ग़ुस्सा

ग़ुस्सा — *ġussā* — "anger".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ग़ुस्सा (*ġussā*) is a loan from Arabic *ghuṣṣa*, "a choking; grief", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *gh-ṣ-ṣ* (Lane). In Hindi it came to mean "anger".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ġussā*
- *Say it: ġussā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ġussā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a storm, then the Hindi for a leaf, then say *ġussā* again

Before you move on

What does ग़ुस्सा mean? (“Anger”.) Say it once more.

186.2 प्यार (pyār) — love

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a leaf, then the Hindi for anger.

You’ll want to know: प्यार

प्यार — *pyār* — “love”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

प्यार (*pyār*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *priyakāra*, “doing a kindness” (CDIAL 8975). It is built from *priya*, “dear”, and *kāra*, “doing”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pyār*
- *Say it: pyār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pyār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a leaf, then the Hindi for anger, then say *pyār* again

Before you move on

What does प्यार mean? (“Love”.) Say it once more.

186.3 शर्म (śarm) — shame, shyness

Before the new one: say the Hindi for anger, then the Hindi for love.

You’ll want to know: शर्म

शर्म — *śarm* — “shame, shyness”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शर्म (*śarm*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sharm*, “shame”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śarm*
- *Say it: śarm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śarm*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for anger, then the Hindi for love, then say *śarm* again

Before you move on

What does शर्म mean? (“Shame, shyness”.) Say it once more.

186.4 उम्मीद (ummīd) — hope

Before the new one: say the Hindi for love, then the Hindi for shame.

You'll want to know: उम्मीद

उम्मीद — *ummīd* — "hope".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उम्मीद (*ummīd*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *ummēd*, "hope".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ummīd*
- *Say it: ummīd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ummīd*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for love, then the Hindi for shame, then say *ummīd* again

Before you move on

What does उम्मीद mean? ("Hope".) Say it once more.

186.5 याद (yād) — a memory, remembering

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for shame, then the Hindi for hope.

You'll want to know: याद

याद — *yād* — "a memory, remembering".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

याद (*yād*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *yād*, "memory".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yād*
- *Say it: yād*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yād*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for shame, then the Hindi for hope, then say *yād* again

Before you move on

What does **याद** mean? (“A memory, remembering”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 187

A church, A police station, A postman, The cinema, A park

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a church, a police station, a postman, the cinema and a park.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 187: I can say a church, a police station, a postman, the cinema and a park.*

187.1 गिरजाघर (girjāghar) — a church

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for hope, then the Hindi for a memory.

You'll want to know: गिरजाघर

गिरजाघर — *girjāghar* — "a church".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गिरजाघर (*girjāghar*) is *girjā*, "church", usually traced to Portuguese *igreja*, with *ghar*, "house", from *ghara* (CDIAL 4428).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: girjāghar*
- *Say it: girjāghar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *girjāghar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for hope, then the Hindi for a memory, then say *girjāghar* again

Before you move on

What does **गिरजाघर** mean? (“A church”.) Say it once more.

187.2 थाना (thānā) — a police station

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a memory, then the Hindi for a church.

You’ll want to know: थाना

थाना — *thānā* — “a police station”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

थाना (*thānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *sthāna*, “firm stance; place of abode” (CDIAL 13753). CDIAL glosses the Hindi word “police station”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: thānā*
- *Say it: thānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *thānā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a memory, then the Hindi for a church, then say *thānā* again

Before you move on

What does थाना mean? (“A police station”.) Say it once more.

187.3 डाकिया (ḍākiyā) — a postman

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a church, then the Hindi for a police station.

You’ll want to know: डाकिया

डाकिया — *ḍākiyā* — “a postman”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डाकिया (*ḍākiyā*) is *ḍāk*, “the post”, with the ending *-iyā*, “one who deals with it”. CDIAL lists *ḍāk*, “relay, post”, under a reconstructed **ḍakka* (CDIAL 5519).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḍākiyā*
- *Say it:* *ḍākiyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍākiyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a church, then the Hindi for a police station, then say *ḍākiyā* again

Before you move on

What does डाकिया mean? (“A postman”.) Say it once more.

187.4 सिनेमा (sinemā) — the cinema

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a police station, then the Hindi for a postman.

You'll want to know: सिनेमा

सिनेमा — *sinemā* — "the cinema".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सिनेमा (*sinemā*) is a loan from English *cinema*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sinemā*
- *Say it: sinemā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sinemā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a police station, then the Hindi for a postman, then say *sinemā* again

Before you move on

What does सिनेमा mean? ("The cinema".) Say it once more.

187.5 पार्क (pārk) — a park

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a postman, then the Hindi for the cinema.

You'll want to know: पार्क

पार्क — *pārk* — "a park".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पार्क (*pārk*) is a loan from English *park*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pārk*
- *Say it: pārk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pārk*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a postman, then the Hindi for the cinema, then say *pārk* again

Before you move on

What does पार्क mean? ("A park".) Say it once more.

Chapter 188

A button, A pocket, An enemy, An aunt (father’s brother’s wife), A nephew (brother’s son)

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a button, a pocket, an enemy, an aunt (father’s brother’s wife) and a nephew (brother’s son).
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 188: I can say a button, a pocket, an enemy, an aunt (father’s brother’s wife) and a nephew (brother’s son).*

188.1 बटन (baṭan) — a button

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for the cinema, then the Hindi for a park.

You’ll want to know: बटन

बटन — *baṭan* — “a button”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बटन (*baṭan*) is a loan from English *button*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baṭan*
- *Say it: baṭan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baṭan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the cinema, then the Hindi for a park, then say *baṭan* again

Before you move on

What does बटन mean? (“A button”.) Say it once more.

188.2 जेब (jeb) — a pocket

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a park, then the Hindi for a button.

You’ll want to know: जेब

जेब — *jeb* — “a pocket”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जेब (*jeb*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *jēb*, “pocket”, which is Arabic *jayb*, “pocket, opening of a garment”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jeb*
- *Say it: jeb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jeb*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a park, then the Hindi for a button, then say *jeb* again

Before you move on

What does जेब mean? (“A pocket”.) Say it once more.

188.3 दुश्मन (duśman) — an enemy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a button, then the Hindi for a pocket.

You’ll want to know: दुश्मन

दुश्मन — *duśman* — “an enemy”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दुश्मन (*duśman*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *dushman*, “enemy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: duśman*
- *Say it: duśman*, once more
- *Say it:* say *duśman*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a button, then the Hindi for a pocket, then say *duśman* again

Before you move on

What does दुश्मन mean? (“An enemy”.) Say it once more.

188.4 चाची (cācī) — an aunt (father’s brother’s wife)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pocket, then the Hindi for an enemy.

You'll want to know: चाची

चाची — *cācī* — "an aunt (father's brother's wife)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चाची (*cācī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **cācca*, "uncle", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4734). *cācī* is its feminine. CDIAL suggests, with a query, a nursery word.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cācī*
- *Say it: cācī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cācī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pocket, then the Hindi for an enemy, then say *cācī* again

Before you move on

What does **चाची** mean? ("An aunt (father's brother's wife)".) Say it once more.

188.5 भतीजा (bhatījā) — a nephew (brother's son)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an enemy, then the Hindi for an aunt.

You'll want to know: भतीजा

भतीजा — *bhatījā* — "a nephew (brother's son)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भतीजा (*bhatījā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *bhrātrīya*, “brother’s son” (CDIAL 9672). It is built on *bhrātṛ*, “brother”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhatījā*
- *Say it: bhatījā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhatījā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an enemy, then the Hindi for an aunt, then say *bhatījā* again

Before you move on

What does **भतीजा** mean? (“A nephew (brother’s son)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 189

A letter, A story, A question, An answer, A mistake

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a letter, a story, a question, an answer and a mistake.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 189: I can say a letter, a story, a question, an answer and a mistake.*

189.1 चिट्ठी (ciṭṭhī) — a letter

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an aunt, then the Hindi for a nephew.

You'll want to know: चिट्ठी

चिट्ठी — *ciṭṭhī* — "a letter".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चिट्ठी (*ciṭṭhī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ciṣṭa*, "message", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4832). CDIAL compares Avestan *činasti*, "makes known".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ciṭṭhī*
- *Say it: ciṭṭhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ciṭṭhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an aunt, then the Hindi for a nephew, then say *ciṭṭhī* again

Before you move on

What does चिट्ठी mean? (“A letter”.) Say it once more.

189.2 कहानी (kahānī) — a story

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a nephew, then the Hindi for a letter.

You’ll want to know: कहानी

कहानी — *kahānī* — “a story”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कहानी (*kahānī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kathānaka*, “a little tale” (CDIAL 2705). It is built on *kathā*, “story”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kahānī*
- *Say it: kahānī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kahānī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a nephew, then the Hindi for a letter, then say *kahānī* again

Before you move on

What does **कहानी** mean? (“A story”.) Say it once more.

189.3 सवाल (savāl) — a question

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a letter, then the Hindi for a story.

You’ll want to know: सवाल

सवाल — *savāl* — “a question”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सवाल (*savāl*) is a loan from Arabic *suʾāl*, “a question”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *s-ʾ-l* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: savāl*
- *Say it: savāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *savāl*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a letter, then the Hindi for a story, then say *savāl* again

Before you move on

What does **सवाल** mean? (“A question”.) Say it once more.

189.4 जवाब (javāb) — an answer

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a story, then the Hindi for a question.

You'll want to know: जवाब

जवाब — *javāb* — "an answer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जवाब (*javāb*) is a loan from Arabic *jawāb*, "an answer", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *j-w-b* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: javāb*
- *Say it: javāb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *javāb*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a story, then the Hindi for a question, then say *javāb* again

Before you move on

What does जवाब mean? ("An answer".) Say it once more.

189.5 ग़लती (ġaltī) — a mistake

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a question, then the Hindi for an answer.

You'll want to know: ग़लती

ग़लती — *ġaltī* — "a mistake".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ग़लती (*ġaltī*) is *ġalat*, "wrong", with the ending *-ī* that makes a noun. *ġalat* comes from Arabic *ghalaṭ*, "an error", through Persian; its root is *gh-l-ṭ* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ġaltī*
- *Say it: ġaltī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ġaltī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a question, then the Hindi for an answer, then say *ġaltī* again

Before you move on

What does **ग़लती** mean? ("A mistake".) Say it once more.

Chapter 190

Help, News, A newspaper, A thing, A colour

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say help, news, a newspaper, a thing and a colour.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 190: I can say help, news, a newspaper, a thing and a colour.*

190.1 मदद (madad) — help

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an answer, then the Hindi for a mistake.

You’ll want to know: मदद

मदद — *madad* — “help”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मदद (*madad*) is a loan from Arabic *madad*, “help, reinforcement”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *m-d-d* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: madad*
- *Say it: madad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *madad*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an answer, then the Hindi for a mistake, then say *madad* again

Before you move on

What does मदद mean? ("Help".) Say it once more.

190.2 ख़बर (khabar) — news

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mistake, then the Hindi for help.

You'll want to know: ख़बर

ख़बर — *khabar* — "news".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ख़बर (*khabar*) is a loan from Arabic *khabar*, "news, report", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *kh-b-r* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khabar*
- *Say it: khabar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khabar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mistake, then the Hindi for help, then say *khabar* again

Before you move on

What does ख़बर mean? (“News”.) Say it once more.

190.3 अख़बार (akhbār) — a newspaper

Before the new one: say the Hindi for help, then the Hindi for news.

You’ll want to know: अख़बार

अख़बार — *akhbār* — “a newspaper”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अख़बार (*akhbār*) is a loan from Arabic *akhbār*, “reports, news”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *kh-b-r* (Lane). It is the plural of *khabar*, “news”; Hindi uses it for the newspaper that carries them.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: akhbār*
- *Say it: akhbār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *akhbār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for help, then the Hindi for news, then say *akhbār* again

Before you move on

What does अख़बार mean? (“A newspaper”.) Say it once more.

190.4 चीज़ (cīz) — a thing

Before the new one: say the Hindi for news, then the Hindi for a newspaper.

You'll want to know: चीज़

चीज़ — *cīz* — "a thing".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चीज़ (*cīz*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *chīz*, "thing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cīz*
- *Say it: cīz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cīz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for news, then the Hindi for a newspaper, then say *cīz* again

Before you move on

What does चीज़ mean? ("A thing".) Say it once more.

190.5 रंग (raṅg) — a colour

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a newspaper, then the Hindi for a thing.

You'll want to know: रंग

रंग — *raṅg* — "a colour".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रंग (*raṅg*) has two possible sources: Sanskrit *raṅga*, “dye, colour”, whose inherited Hindi form CDIAL gives as *rāṁg* (CDIAL 10560), and Persian *rang*, “colour”. The two may have merged.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: raṅg*
- *Say it: raṅg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *raṅg*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a newspaper, then the Hindi for a thing, then say *raṅg* again

Before you move on

What does रंग mean? (“A colour”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 191

A week, A year, A century, A moment, A minute

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a week, a year, a century, a moment and a minute.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 191: I can say a week, a year, a century, a moment and a minute.*

191.1 हफ़्ता (haftā) — a week

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a thing, then the Hindi for a colour.

You'll want to know: हफ़्ता

हफ़्ता — *haftā* — "a week".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हफ़्ता (*haftā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *hafta*, "week". It is built on *haft*, "seven".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: haftā*
- *Say it: haftā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *haftā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a thing, then the Hindi for a colour, then say *haftā* again

Before you move on

What does हफ़्ता mean? (“A week”.) Say it once more.

191.2 साल (sāl) — a year

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a colour, then the Hindi for a week.

You’ll want to know: साल

साल — *sāl* — “a year”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

साल (*sāl*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sāl*, “year”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāl*
- *Say it: sāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sāl*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a colour, then the Hindi for a week, then say *sāl* again

Before you move on

What does साल mean? (“A year”.) Say it once more.

191.3 सदी (sadī) — a century

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a week, then the Hindi for a year.

You’ll want to know: सदी

सदी — *sadī* — “a century”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सदी (*sadī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sadī*, “century”. It is built on *sad*, “hundred”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sadī*
- *Say it: sadī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sadī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a week, then the Hindi for a year, then say *sadī* again

Before you move on

What does सदी mean? (“A century”.) Say it once more.

191.4 पल (pal) — a moment

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a year, then the Hindi for a century.

You’ll want to know: पल

पल — *pal* — “a moment”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पल (*pal*) is inherited from Sanskrit *pala*, “a weight; a measure of time”, and has come down with almost no change (CDIAL 7952).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pal*
- *Say it: pal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pal*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a year, then the Hindi for a century, then say *pal* again

Before you move on

What does पल mean? (“A moment”.) Say it once more.

191.5 मिनट (miniṭ) — a minute

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a century, then the Hindi for a moment.

You’ll want to know: मिनट

मिनट — *miniṭ* — “a minute”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मिनट (*miniṭ*) is a loan from English *minute*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: miniṭ*
- *Say it: miniṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *miniṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a century, then the Hindi for a moment, then say *miniṭ* again

Before you move on

What does **मिनट** mean? ("A minute".) Say it once more.

Chapter 192

Every day, Sometimes, Always, Often, Never

Modes: **voice** (7) **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say every day, sometimes, always, often and never.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 192: I can say every day, sometimes, always, often and never.*

192.1 रोज़ (roz) — every day

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a moment, then the Hindi for a minute.

You'll want to know: रोज़

रोज़ — *roz* — "every day".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रोज़ (*roz*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *rōz*, "day".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: roz*
- *Say it: roz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *roz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a moment, then the Hindi for a minute, then say *roz* again

Before you move on

What does रोज़ mean? (“Every day”.) Say it once more.

192.2 कभी (kabhī) — sometimes, ever

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a minute, then the Hindi for every day.

You’ll want to know: कभी

कभी — *kabhī* — “sometimes, ever”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कभी (*kabhī*) is inherited. CDIAL lists it under Sanskrit *evam eva*, “exactly so”, crossed with the question stem *ka-* of *kyā* and *kaun* (CDIAL 2528).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kabhī*
- *Say it: kabhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kabhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a minute, then the Hindi for every day, then say *kabhī* again

Before you move on

What does कभी mean? (“Sometimes, ever”.) Say it once more.

192.3 हमेशा (hameśā) — always

Before the new one: say the Hindi for every day, then the Hindi for sometimes.

You’ll want to know: हमेशा

हमेशा — *hameśā* — “always”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हमेशा (*hameśā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *hamēsha*, “always”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hameśā*
- *Say it: hameśā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hameśā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for every day, then the Hindi for sometimes, then say *hameśā* again

Before you move on

What does हमेशा mean? (“Always”.) Say it once more.

192.4 अक्सर (aksar) — often

Before the new one: say the Hindi for sometimes, then the Hindi for always.

You'll want to know: अक्सर

अक्सर — *aksar* — "often".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अक्सर (*aksar*) is a loan from Arabic *akthar*, "more, most", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *k-th-r* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aksar*
- *Say it: aksar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aksar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sometimes, then the Hindi for always, then say *aksar* again

Before you move on

What does अक्सर mean? ("Often".) Say it once more.

192.5 कभी नहीं (kabhī nahī̃) — never

Before the new one: say the Hindi for always, then the Hindi for often.

You'll want to know: कभी नहीं

कभी नहीं — *kabhī nahī̃* — "never".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कभी नहीं (*kabhī nahīṁ*) is *kabhī*, "ever", which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *evam eva*, "exactly so", crossed with the question stem *ka-* (CDIAL 2528), and *nahīṁ*, from *nahi*, "surely not" (CDIAL 7035).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kabhī nahī̃*
- *Say it: kabhī nahī̃*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kabhī nahī̃*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for always, then the Hindi for often, then say *kabhī nahī̃* again

Before you move on

What does कभी नहीं mean? ("Never".) Say it once more.

192.6 The house, weather and feelings — a first pass

Say the words for often and never.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a floor, a key, a cupboard, a mirror, rain
- sunshine, cold, heat, a storm, a leaf
- anger, love, shame, hope, a memory
- a church, a police station, a postman, the cinema, a park

Before you move on

A floor? (फ़र्श, *farś.*) A key? (चाबी, *cābī.*) A cupboard? (अलमारी, *almārī.*) A mirror? (आईना, *āīnā.*) Rain? (बारिश, *bāriś.*) Sunshine? (धूप, *dhūp.*) Cold? (ठंड, *ṭhaṇḍ.*) Heat? (गर्मी, *garmī.*) A storm? (तूफ़ान, *tūfān.*) A leaf? (पत्ता, *pattā.*) Anger? (ग़ुस्सा, *ġussā.*) Love?

(प्यार, *pyār.*) Shame? (शर्म, *śarm.*) Hope? (उम्मीद, *ummīd.*) A memory? (याद, *yād.*) A church? (गिरजाघर, *girjāghar.*) A police station? (थाना, *thānā.*) A postman? (डाकिया, *ḍākiyā.*) The cinema? (सिनेमा, *sinemā.*) A park? (पार्क, *pārk.*)

192.7 Town, talk and time — a second pass

Say the words for a button and a pocket.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a button, a pocket, an enemy, an aunt, a nephew
- a letter, a story, a question, an answer, a mistake
- help, news, a newspaper, a thing, a colour
- a week, a year, a century, a moment, a minute
- every day, sometimes, always, often, never

Before you move on

A button? (बटन, *baṭan.*) A pocket? (जेब, *jeb.*) An enemy? (दुश्मन, *duśman.*) An aunt? (चाची, *cācī.*) A nephew? (भतीजा, *bhatījā.*) A letter? (चिट्ठी, *ciṭṭhī.*) A story? (कहानी, *kahānī.*) A question? (सवाल, *savāl.*) An answer? (जवाब, *javāb.*) A mistake? (ग़लती, *ġaltī.*) Help? (मदद, *madad.*) News? (ख़बर, *khabar.*) A newspaper? (अख़बार, *akhbār.*) A thing? (चीज़, *cīz.*) A colour? (रंग, *raṅg.*) A week? (हफ़्ता, *haftā.*) A year? (साल, *sāl.*) A century? (सदी, *sadī.*) A moment? (पल, *pal.*) A minute? (मिनट, *minaṭ.*) Every day? (रोज़, *roz.*) Sometimes? (कभी, *kabhī.*) Always? (हमेशा, *hameśā.*) Often? (अक्सर, *aksar.*) Never? (कभी नहीं, *kabhī nahī̃.*)

Chapter 193

A teacher, A lawyer, A soldier, A tailor, A barber

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a teacher, a lawyer, a soldier, a tailor and a barber.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 193: I can say a teacher, a lawyer, a soldier, a tailor and a barber.*

193.1 अध्यापक (adhyāpak) — a teacher

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for often, then the Hindi for never.

You'll want to know: अध्यापक

अध्यापक — *adhyāpak* — "a teacher".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अध्यापक (*adhyāpak*) is Sanskrit *adhyāpaka*, "teacher", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 278).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: adhyāpak*
- *Say it: adhyāpak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *adhyāpak*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for often, then the Hindi for never, then say *adhyāpak* again

Before you move on

What does अध्यापक mean? (“A teacher”.) Say it once more.

193.2 वकील (vakīl) — a lawyer

Before the new one: say the Hindi for never, then the Hindi for a teacher.

You’ll want to know: वकील

वकील — *vakīl* — “a lawyer”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वकील (*vakīl*) is a loan from Arabic *wakīl*, “an agent, a representative”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *w-k-l* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vakīl*
- *Say it: vakīl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vakīl*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for never, then the Hindi for a teacher, then say *vakīl* again

Before you move on

What does **वकील** mean? (“A lawyer”.) Say it once more.

193.3 सिपाही (sipāhī) — a soldier, a constable

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a teacher, then the Hindi for a lawyer.

You’ll want to know: सिपाही

सिपाही — *sipāhī* — “a soldier, a constable”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सिपाही (*sipāhī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sipāhī*, “soldier”. It is built on *sipāh*, “army”. English took the word as *sepoy*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sipāhī*
- *Say it: sipāhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sipāhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a teacher, then the Hindi for a lawyer, then say *sipāhī* again

Before you move on

What does **सिपाही** mean? (“A soldier, a constable”.) Say it once more.

193.4 दर्ज़ी (darzī) — a tailor

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lawyer, then the Hindi for a soldier.

You’ll want to know: दर्ज़ी

दर्ज़ी — *darzī* — “a tailor”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दर्ज़ी (*darzī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *darzī*, “tailor”. It is built on *darz*, “seam”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *darzī*
- *Say it:* *darzī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *darzī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lawyer, then the Hindi for a soldier, then say *darzī* again

Before you move on

What does दर्ज़ी mean? (“A tailor”.) Say it once more.

193.5 नाई (nāī) — a barber

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a soldier, then the Hindi for a tailor.

You’ll want to know: नाई

नाई — *nāī* — “a barber”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाई (*nāī*) is a tadbhava, inherited and reshaped by sound change. CDIAL lists it, as a dialect form, under Sanskrit *nāpita*, “barber”. The by-form *nāū*, “barber”, sits in the same entry under a second word, *snāpaka*, “bath attendant”, built on *snā-*, “to bathe” (CDIAL 13792).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nāī*
- *Say it: nāī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nāī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a soldier, then the Hindi for a tailor, then say *nāī* again

Before you move on

What does नाई mean? ("A barber".) Say it once more.

Chapter 194

A washerman, A cook, A driver, An engineer, A writer

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a washerman, a cook, a driver, an engineer and a writer.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 194: I can say a washerman, a cook, a driver, an engineer and a writer.*

194.1 धोबी (dhobī) — a washerman

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tailor, then the Hindi for a barber.

You'll want to know: धोबी

धोबी — *dhobī* — "a washerman".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धोबी (*dhobī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dhauvati*, "washes", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6886). CDIAL notes that the forms with *-b-* began in the east and spread into every language around.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhobī*
- *Say it: dhobī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhobī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tailor, then the Hindi for a barber, then say *dhobī* again

Before you move on

What does **धोबी** mean? (“A washerman”.) Say it once more.

194.2 बावर्ची (bāvarcī) — a cook

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a barber, then the Hindi for a washerman.

You’ll want to know: बावर्ची

बावर्ची — *bāvarcī* — “a cook”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बावर्ची (*bāvarcī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *bāwarchī*, “cook”, a word Persian itself took from Turkic.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāvarcī*
- *Say it: bāvarcī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bāvarcī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a barber, then the Hindi for a washerman, then say *bāvarcī* again

Before you move on

What does बावर्ची mean? ("A cook".) Say it once more.

194.3 ड्राइवर (ḍrāivar) — a driver

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a washerman, then the Hindi for a cook.

You'll want to know: ड्राइवर

ड्राइवर — *ḍrāivar* — "a driver".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ड्राइवर (*ḍrāivar*) is a loan from English *driver*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ḍrāivar*
- *Say it: ḍrāivar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍrāivar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a washerman, then the Hindi for a cook, then say *ḍrāivar* again

Before you move on

What does ड्राइवर mean? ("A driver".) Say it once more.

194.4 इंजीनियर (injīniyar) — an engineer

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cook, then the Hindi for a driver.

You'll want to know: इंजीनियर

इंजीनियर — *injīniyar* — "an engineer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

इंजीनियर (*injīniyar*) is a loan from English *engineer*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: injīniyar*
- *Say it: injīniyar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *injīniyar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cook, then the Hindi for a driver, then say *injīniyar* again

Before you move on

What does इंजीनियर mean? ("An engineer".) Say it once more.

194.5 लेखक (lekhak) — a writer

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a driver, then the Hindi for an engineer.

You'll want to know: लेखक

लेखक — *lekhak* — "a writer".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लेखक (*lekhak*) is Sanskrit *lekhaka*, "scribe", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 11102). It is built on *likh-*, "to write", the root of लिखना.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lekhak*
- *Say it: lekhak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lekhak*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a driver, then the Hindi for an engineer, then say *lekhak* again

Before you move on

What does **लेखक** mean? ("A writer".) Say it once more.

Chapter 195

A poet, A painter, A singer, A player, A leader

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a poet, a painter, a singer, a player and a leader.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 195: I can say a poet, a painter, a singer, a player and a leader.*

195.1 कवि (kavi) — a poet

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an engineer, then the Hindi for a writer.

You'll want to know: कवि

कवि — *kavi* — "a poet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कवि (*kavi*) is Sanskrit *kavi*, "wise; wise man, poet", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 2964).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kavi*
- *Say it: kavi*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kavi*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an engineer, then the Hindi for a writer, then say *kavi* again

Before you move on

What does कवि mean? (“A poet”.) Say it once more.

195.2 चित्रकार (citrakār) — a painter

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a writer, then the Hindi for a poet.

You’ll want to know: चित्रकार

चित्रकार — *citrakār* — “a painter”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चित्रकार (*citrakār*) is Sanskrit *citrakāra*, “painter”, from *citra*, “bright, a picture”, and *kāra*, “maker”, taken over whole as a tatsama. CDIAL lists the inherited form of the word as Hindi *citerā*, “painter” (CDIAL 4805).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: citrakār*
- *Say it: citrakār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *citrakār*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a writer, then the Hindi for a poet, then say *citrakār* again

Before you move on

What does चित्रकार mean? (“A painter”.) Say it once more.

195.3 गायक (gāyak) — a singer

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a poet, then the Hindi for a painter.

You’ll want to know: गायक

गायक — *gāyak* — “a singer”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गायक (*gāyak*) is Sanskrit *gāyaka*, “singer”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *gai-*, “to sing”, the root of गाना.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gāyak*
- *Say it: gāyak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gāyak*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a poet, then the Hindi for a painter, then say *gāyak* again

Before you move on

What does गायक mean? (“A singer”.) Say it once more.

195.4 खिलाड़ी (khilāṛī) — a player

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a painter, then the Hindi for a singer.

You'll want to know: खिलाड़ी

खिलाड़ी — *khilāṛī* — "a player".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खिलाड़ी (*khilāṛī*) is built on *khel-*, "play", with the ending *-āṛī*, "one who does it". CDIAL lists the verb under a reconstructed **khel-*, "play" (CDIAL 3918).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khilāṛī*
- *Say it: khilāṛī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khilāṛī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a painter, then the Hindi for a singer, then say *khilāṛī* again

Before you move on

What does खिलाड़ी mean? ("A player".) Say it once more.

195.5 नेता (netā) — a leader, a politician

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a singer, then the Hindi for a player.

You'll want to know: नेता

नेता — *netā* — "a leader, a politician".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नेता (*netā*) is Sanskrit *netṛ*, “leader”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. Hindi took its nominative, *netā*, “the leader”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: netā*
- *Say it: netā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *netā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a singer, then the Hindi for a player, then say *netā* again

Before you move on

What does नेता mean? (“A leader, a politician”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 196

A minister, A king, A queen, A servant, A thief

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a minister, a king, a queen, a servant and a thief.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 196: I can say a minister, a king, a queen, a servant and a thief.*

196.1 मंत्री (mantrī) — a minister

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a player, then the Hindi for a leader.

You'll want to know: मंत्री

मंत्री — *mantrī* — "a minister".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मंत्री (*mantrī*) is Sanskrit *mantrin*, "wise; counsellor", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 9838). Hindi took its nominative, *mantrī*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mantrī*
- *Say it: mantrī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mantrī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a player, then the Hindi for a leader, then say *mantrī* again

Before you move on

What does मंत्री mean? (“A minister”.) Say it once more.

196.2 राजा (rājā) — a king

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a leader, then the Hindi for a minister.

You’ll want to know: राजा

राजा — *rājā* — “a king”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

राजा (*rājā*) is Sanskrit *rājan*, “chieftain, king”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 10679). Hindi took its nominative, *rājā*; CDIAL lists the inherited forms as *rāy* and *rāo*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rājā*
- *Say it: rājā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rājā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a leader, then the Hindi for a minister, then say *rājā* again

Before you move on

What does राजा mean? (“A king”.) Say it once more.

196.3 रानी (rānī) — a queen

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a minister, then the Hindi for a king.

You’ll want to know: रानी

रानी — *rānī* — “a queen”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रानी (*rānī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *rājñī*, “queen” (CDIAL 10692).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rānī*
- *Say it: rānī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rānī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a minister, then the Hindi for a king, then say *rānī* again

Before you move on

What does रानी mean? (“A queen”.) Say it once more.

196.4 नौकर (naukar) — a servant

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a king, then the Hindi for a queen.

You’ll want to know: नौकर

नौकर — *naukar* — “a servant”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नौकर (*naukar*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *naukar*, “servant”, which Persian took from Mongolic *nökör*, “companion”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naukar*
- *Say it: naukar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naukar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a king, then the Hindi for a queen, then say *naukar* again

Before you move on

What does नौकर mean? (“A servant”.) Say it once more.

196.5 चोर (cor) — a thief

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a queen, then the Hindi for a servant.

You’ll want to know: चोर

चोर — *cor* — “a thief”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चोर (*cor*) is inherited from Sanskrit *cora*, “thief”, and has come down with almost no change (CDIAL 4931).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cor*
- *Say it: cor*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cor*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a queen, then the Hindi for a servant, then say *cor* again

Before you move on

What does चोर mean? ("A thief".) Say it once more.

Chapter 197

A class, An examination, A lesson, Practice, A mark

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a class, an examination, a lesson, practice and a mark.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 197: I can say a class, an examination, a lesson, practice and a mark.*

197.1 कक्षा (kakṣā) — a class, a classroom

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a servant, then the Hindi for a thief.

You’ll want to know: कक्षा

कक्षा — *kakṣā* — “a class, a classroom”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कक्षा (*kakṣā*) is Sanskrit *kakṣā*, “girdle”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 2592). Hindi uses it for a classroom, and so for a class; CDIAL does not trace that sense.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kakṣā*
- *Say it: kakṣā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kakṣā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a servant, then the Hindi for a thief, then say *kakṣā* again

Before you move on

What does कक्षा mean? (“A class, a classroom”.) Say it once more.

197.2 परीक्षा (parīkṣā) — an examination

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a thief, then the Hindi for a class.

You’ll want to know: परीक्षा

परीक्षा — *parīkṣā* — “an examination”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

परीक्षा (*parīkṣā*) is Sanskrit *parīkṣā*, “inspection, test”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 7904). CDIAL lists the inherited form of the same word as *parakh*, “examination”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: parīkṣā*
- *Say it: parīkṣā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *parīkṣā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a thief, then the Hindi for a class, then say *parīkṣā* again

Before you move on

What does **परीक्षा** mean? (“An examination”.) Say it once more.

197.3 पाठ (pāṭh) — a lesson

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a class, then the Hindi for an examination.

You’ll want to know: पाठ

पाठ — *pāṭh* — “a lesson”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पाठ (*pāṭh*) is Sanskrit *pāṭha*, “text of a book; study”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 8035).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāṭh*
- *Say it: pāṭh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāṭh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a class, then the Hindi for an examination, then say *pāṭh* again

Before you move on

What does **पाठ** mean? (“A lesson”.) Say it once more.

197.4 अभ्यास (abhyās) — practice, an exercise

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an examination, then the Hindi for a lesson.

You'll want to know: अभ्यास

अभ्यास — *abhyās* — "practice, an exercise".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अभ्यास (*abhyās*) is Sanskrit *abhyāsa*, "repetition, practice", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: abhyās*
- *Say it: abhyās*, once more
- *Say it:* say *abhyās*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an examination, then the Hindi for a lesson, then say *abhyās* again

Before you move on

What does **अभ्यास** mean? ("Practice, an exercise".) Say it once more.

197.5 अंक (aṅk) — a mark, a number

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lesson, then the Hindi for practice.

You'll want to know: अंक

अंक — *aṅk* — "a mark, a number".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अंक (*aṅk*) is Sanskrit *aṅka*, "hook; mark, sign", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 100). CDIAL lists the inherited form as *āṁk*, "mark, spot".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṅk*
- *Say it: aṅk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṅk*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lesson, then the Hindi for practice, then say *aṅk* again

Before you move on

What does **अंक** mean? ("A mark, a number".) Say it once more.

Chapter 198

A word, A sentence, A meaning, Knowledge, Science

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a word, a sentence, a meaning, knowledge and science.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 198: I can say a word, a sentence, a meaning, knowledge and science.*

198.1 शब्द (śabd) — a word

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for practice, then the Hindi for a mark.

You'll want to know: शब्द

शब्द — *śabd* — "a word".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शब्द (*śabd*) is Sanskrit *śabda*, "sound, word", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śabd*
- *Say it: śabd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śabd*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for practice, then the Hindi for a mark, then say *śabd* again

Before you move on

What does शब्द mean? ("A word".) Say it once more.

198.2 वाक्य (vākya) — a sentence

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mark, then the Hindi for a word.

You'll want to know: वाक्य

वाक्य — *vākya* — "a sentence".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वाक्य (*vākya*) is Sanskrit *vākya*, "speech, sentence", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *vac-*, "to speak".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vākya*
- *Say it: vākya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vākya*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mark, then the Hindi for a word, then say *vākya* again

Before you move on

What does वाक्य mean? (“A sentence”.) Say it once more.

198.3 अर्थ (arth) — a meaning

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a word, then the Hindi for a sentence.

You’ll want to know: अर्थ

अर्थ — *arth* — “a meaning”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अर्थ (*arth*) is Sanskrit *artha*, “aim; thing, wealth; meaning”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 638). CDIAL lists the inherited form as *āth*, “wealth”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: arth*
- *Say it: arth*, once more
- *Say it:* say *arth*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a word, then the Hindi for a sentence, then say *arth* again

Before you move on

What does अर्थ mean? (“A meaning”.) Say it once more.

198.4 ज्ञान (jñān) — knowledge

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sentence, then the Hindi for a meaning.

You’ll want to know: ज्ञान

ज्ञान — *jñān* — “knowledge”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ज्ञान (*jñān*) is Sanskrit *jñāna*, “knowledge”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 5281). CDIAL lists the inherited form as *jān*, “knowledge”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jñān*
- *Say it: jñān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jñān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sentence, then the Hindi for a meaning, then say *jñān* again

Before you move on

What does ज्ञान mean? (“Knowledge”.) Say it once more.

198.5 विज्ञान (vijñān) — science

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a meaning, then the Hindi for knowledge.

You’ll want to know: विज्ञान

विज्ञान — *vijñān* — “science”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

विज्ञान (*vijñān*) is Sanskrit *vijñāna*, “discernment, understanding”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is *jñāna*, “knowledge”, with *vi-*, “apart”: knowledge that tells things apart.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vijñān*
- *Say it: vijñān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vijñān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a meaning, then the Hindi for knowledge, then say *vijñān* again

Before you move on

What does **विज्ञान** mean? ("Science".) Say it once more.

Chapter 199

History, Mathematics, A crow, The heart, A bone

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say history, mathematics, a crow, the heart and a bone.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 199: I can say history, mathematics, a crow, the heart and a bone.*

199.1 इतिहास (itihās) — history

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for knowledge, then the Hindi for science.

You'll want to know: इतिहास

इतिहास — *itihās* — "history".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

इतिहास (*itihās*) is Sanskrit *itihāsa*, "tradition, history", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built from *iti ha āsa*, "so indeed it was".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: itihās*
- *Say it: itihās*, once more
- *Say it:* say *itihās*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for knowledge, then the Hindi for science, then say *itihās* again

Before you move on

What does इतिहास mean? (“History”.) Say it once more.

199.2 गणित (gaṇit) — mathematics

Before the new one: say the Hindi for science, then the Hindi for history.

You’ll want to know: गणित

गणित — *gaṇit* — “mathematics”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गणित (*gaṇit*) is Sanskrit *gaṇita*, “counted”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 3996). Counting became the name for mathematics.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gaṇit*
- *Say it: gaṇit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gaṇit*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for science, then the Hindi for history, then say *gaṇit* again

Before you move on

What does **गणित** mean? (“Mathematics”.) Say it once more.

199.3 कौवा (kauvā) — a crow

Before the new one: say the Hindi for history, then the Hindi for mathematics.

You’ll want to know: कौवा

कौवा — *kauvā* — “a crow”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कौवा (*kauvā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kāka*, “crow” (CDIAL 2993). CDIAL notes that the word imitates the bird’s call.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kauvā*
- *Say it: kauvā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kauvā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for history, then the Hindi for mathematics, then say *kauvā* again

Before you move on

What does **कौवा** mean? (“A crow”.) Say it once more.

199.4 दिल (dil) — the heart

Before the new one: say the Hindi for mathematics, then the Hindi for a crow.

You’ll want to know: दिल

दिल — *dil* — “the heart”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दिल (*dil*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *dil*, “heart”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dil*
- *Say it: dil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dil*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for mathematics, then the Hindi for a crow, then say *dil* again

Before you move on

What does दिल mean? (“The heart”.) Say it once more.

199.5 हड्डी (haḍḍī) — a bone

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a crow, then the Hindi for the heart.

You’ll want to know: हड्डी

हड्डी — *haḍḍī* — “a bone”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हड्डी (*haḍḍī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *haḍḍa*, “bone” (CDIAL 13952). The Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists; CDIAL calls a link with *asthi*, “bone”, very doubtful.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: haḍḍī*
- *Say it: haḍḍī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *haḍḍī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a crow, then the Hindi for the heart, then say *haḍḍī* again

Before you move on

What does हड्डी mean? (“A bone”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 200

Skin, A state, A capital city, A border, An island

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say skin, a state, a capital city, a border and an island.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 200: I can say skin, a state, a capital city, a border and an island.*

200.1 त्वचा (tvacā) — skin

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for the heart, then the Hindi for a bone.

You’ll want to know: त्वचा

त्वचा — *tvacā* — “skin”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

त्वचा (*tvacā*) is Sanskrit *tvacā*, “skin”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 6087).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tvacā*
- *Say it: tvacā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tvacā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the heart, then the Hindi for a bone, then say *tvacā* again

Before you move on

What does त्वचा mean? (“Skin”.) Say it once more.

200.2 राज्य (rājya) — a state

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bone, then the Hindi for skin.

You’ll want to know: राज्य

राज्य — *rājya* — “a state”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

राज्य (*rājya*) is Sanskrit *rājya*, “kingship, kingdom”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 10694). CDIAL lists the inherited form as *rāj*, “government”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rājya*
- *Say it: rājya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rājya*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bone, then the Hindi for skin, then say *rājya* again

Before you move on

What does राज्य mean? (“A state”.) Say it once more.

200.3 राजधानी (rājdhānī) — a capital city

Before the new one: say the Hindi for skin, then the Hindi for a state.

You’ll want to know: राजधानी

राजधानी — *rājdhānī* — “a capital city”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

राजधानी (*rājdhānī*) is Sanskrit *rājadhānī*, “a king’s seat”, from *rāja-*, “king”, and *dhānī*, “a holder, a seat”, taken over whole as a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rājdhānī*
- *Say it: rājdhānī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rājdhānī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for skin, then the Hindi for a state, then say *rājdhānī* again

Before you move on

What does राजधानी mean? (“A capital city”.) Say it once more.

200.4 सीमा (sīmā) — a border, a limit

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a state, then the Hindi for a capital city.

You'll want to know: सीमा

सीमा — *sīmā* — "a border, a limit".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सीमा (*sīmā*) is Sanskrit *sīmā*, "boundary", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 13435).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sīmā*
- *Say it:* *sīmā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sīmā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a state, then the Hindi for a capital city, then say *sīmā* again

Before you move on

What does सीमा mean? ("A border, a limit".) Say it once more.

200.5 द्वीप (dvīp) — an island

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a capital city, then the Hindi for a border.

You'll want to know: द्वीप

द्वीप — *dvīp* — "an island".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

द्वीप (*dvīp*) is Sanskrit *dvīpa*, "land, island", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 6691). It is built from *dvi-*, "two", and *ap*, "water": land with water on both sides.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dvīp*
- *Say it: dvīp*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dvīp*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a capital city, then the Hindi for a border, then say *dvīp* again

Before you move on

What does द्वीप mean? ("An island".) Say it once more.

Chapter 201

A desert, A valley, A waterfall, A pond, A mine

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7)   🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a desert, a valley, a waterfall, a pond and a mine.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 201: I can say a desert, a valley, a waterfall, a pond and a mine.*

201.1 रेगिस्तान (registān) — a desert

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a border, then the Hindi for an island.

You’ll want to know: रेगिस्तान

रेगिस्तान — *registān* — “a desert”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रेगिस्तान (*registān*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *rēgistān*, “desert”. It is built from *rēg*, “sand”, and *-stān*, “place”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: registān*
- *Say it: registān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *registān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a border, then the Hindi for an island, then say *registān* again

Before you move on

What does रेगिस्तान mean? (“A desert”.) Say it once more.

201.2 घाटी (ghāṭī) — a valley

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an island, then the Hindi for a desert.

You’ll want to know: घाटी

घाटी — *ghāṭī* — “a valley”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घाटी (*ghāṭī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ghaṭṭa*, “landing place; passage” (CDIAL 4414). CDIAL notes that a Dravidian origin is supported, though a link with *ghāṭā* is possible.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghāṭī*
- *Say it: ghāṭī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghāṭī*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an island, then the Hindi for a desert, then say *ghāṭī* again

Before you move on

What does घाटी mean? (“A valley”.) Say it once more.

201.3 झरना (jharnā) — a waterfall

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a desert, then the Hindi for a valley.

You’ll want to know: झरना

झरना — *jharnā* — “a waterfall”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झरना (*jharnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **jharati*, “flowing down”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5346).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jharnā*
- *Say it: jharnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jharnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a desert, then the Hindi for a valley, then say *jharnā* again

Before you move on

What does झरना mean? (“A waterfall”.) Say it once more.

201.4 तालाब (tālāb) — a pond

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a valley, then the Hindi for a waterfall.

You’ll want to know: तालाब

तालाब — *tālāb* — “a pond”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तालाब (*tālāb*) is usually explained as *tāl*, “pond”, which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *talla*, “pond”, a village word that may come from Munda (CDIAL 5742), with Persian *āb*, “water”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tālāb*
- *Say it: tālāb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tālāb*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a valley, then the Hindi for a waterfall, then say *tālāb* again

Before you move on

What does तालाब mean? (“A pond”.) Say it once more.

201.5 खदान (khadān) — a mine

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a waterfall, then the Hindi for a pond.

You’ll want to know: खदान

खदान — *khadān* — “a mine”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of खदान (*khadān*) is uncertain. CDIAL does not list it, though it lists Hindi *khān*, “mine, quarry”, under Sanskrit *khāni*, “mine” (CDIAL 3873).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khadān*
- *Say it: khadān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khadān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a waterfall, then the Hindi for a pond, then say *khadān* again

Before you move on

What does खदान mean? (“A mine”.) Say it once more.

201.6 Words from chapters 193-196 — a first pass

Say the words for a pond and a mine.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a teacher, a lawyer, a soldier, a tailor, a barber
- a washerman, a cook, a driver, an engineer, a writer
- a poet, a painter, a singer, a player, a leader
- a minister, a king, a queen, a servant, a thief

Before you move on

A teacher? (अध्यापक, *adhyāpak.*) A lawyer? (वकील, *vakīl.*) A soldier? (सिपाही, *sipāhī.*) A tailor? (दर्ज़ी, *darzī.*) A barber? (नाई, *nāī.*) A washerman? (धोबी, *dhobī.*) A cook? (बावर्ची, *bāvarcī.*) A driver? (ड्राइवर, *ḍrāivar.*) An engineer? (इंजीनियर, *injīniyar.*) A writer? (लेखक, *lekhak.*) A poet? (कवि, *kavi.*) A painter? (चित्रकार, *citrakār.*) A singer? (गायक, *gāyak.*) A player? (खिलाड़ी, *khilāṛī.*) A leader? (नेता, *netā.*) A minister? (मंत्री, *mantrī.*) A king? (राजा, *rājā.*) A queen? (रानी, *rānī.*) A servant? (नौकर, *naukar.*) A thief? (चोर, *cor.*)

201.7 Words from chapters 197-201 — a second pass

Say the words for a class and an examination.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a class, an examination, a lesson, practice, a mark
- a word, a sentence, a meaning, knowledge, science
- history, mathematics, a crow, the heart, a bone
- skin, a state, a capital city, a border, an island
- a desert, a valley, a waterfall, a pond, a mine

Before you move on

A class? (कक्षा, *kakṣā.*) An examination? (परीक्षा, *parīkṣā.*) A lesson? (पाठ, *pāṭh.*) Practice? (अभ्यास, *abhyās.*) A mark? (अंक, *aṅk.*) A word? (शब्द, *śabd.*) A sentence? (वाक्य, *vākya.*) A meaning? (अर्थ, *arth.*) Knowledge? (ज्ञान, *jñān.*) Science? (विज्ञान, *vijñān.*) History? (इतिहास, *itihās.*) Mathematics? (गणित, *gaṇit.*) A crow? (कौवा, *kauvā.*) The heart? (दिल, *dil.*) A bone? (हड्डी, *haḍḍī.*) Skin? (त्वचा, *tvacā.*) A state? (राज्य, *rājya.*) A capital city? (राजधानी, *rājdhānī.*) A border? (सीमा, *sīmā.*) An island? (द्वीप, *dvīp.*) A desert? (रेगिस्तान,

registān.) A valley? (घाटी, *ghāṭī.*) A waterfall? (झरना, *jharnā.*) A pond? (तालाब, *tālāb.*) A mine? (खदान, *khadān.*)

Chapter 202

A cave, A palace, A fort, A tower, A garden

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a cave, a palace, a fort, a tower and a garden.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 202: I can say a cave, a palace, a fort, a tower and a garden.*

202.1 गुफ़ा (gufā) — a cave

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pond, then the Hindi for a mine.

You'll want to know: गुफ़ा

गुफ़ा — *gufā* — "a cave".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गुफ़ा (*gufā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **guppha*, "cave", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4204). CDIAL's suggestion, Sanskrit *guhā*, "cave", crossed with *gup*-, "to hide", is marked very doubtful.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gufā*
- *Say it: gufā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gufā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pond, then the Hindi for a mine, then say *gufā* again

Before you move on

What does गुफ़ा mean? (“A cave”.) Say it once more.

202.2 महल (mahal) — a palace

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mine, then the Hindi for a cave.

You’ll want to know: महल

महल — *mahal* — “a palace”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

महल (*mahal*) is a loan from Arabic *maḥall*, “a place of alighting, a quarter”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ḥ-l-l* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mahal*
- *Say it: mahal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mahal*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mine, then the Hindi for a cave, then say *mahal* again

Before you move on

What does महल mean? (“A palace”.) Say it once more.

202.3 क़िला (qilā) — a fort

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cave, then the Hindi for a palace.

You’ll want to know: क़िला

क़िला — *qilā* — “a fort”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क़िला (*qilā*) is a loan from Arabic *qal^{c}a*, “fortress”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *q-l-^{c}* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: qilā*
- *Say it: qilā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qilā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cave, then the Hindi for a palace, then say *qilā* again

Before you move on

What does क़िला mean? (“A fort”.) Say it once more.

202.4 मीनार (mīnār) — a tower, a minaret

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a palace, then the Hindi for a fort.

You’ll want to know: मीनार

मीनार — *mīnār* — “a tower, a minaret”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मीनार (*mīnār*) is a loan from Arabic *manār*, “a lighthouse, a minaret”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *n-w-r* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mīnār*
- *Say it:* *mīnār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mīnār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a palace, then the Hindi for a fort, then say *mīnār* again

Before you move on

What does मीनार mean? (“A tower, a minaret”.) Say it once more.

202.5 बाग़ (bāg) — a garden

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a fort, then the Hindi for a tower.

You’ll want to know: बाग़

बाग़ — *bāg* — “a garden”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बाग़ (*bāg*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *bāgh*, “garden”. It is a different word from Hindi *bāg*, “rein”, from Sanskrit *valgā*, “bridle” (CDIAL 11420).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāg*
- *Say it: bāg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bāg*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a fort, then the Hindi for a tower, then say *bāg* again

Before you move on

What does बाग़ mean? (“A garden”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 203

A zoo, A museum, A tunnel, A bicycle, A scooter

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a zoo, a museum, a tunnel, a bicycle and a scooter.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 203: I can say a zoo, a museum, a tunnel, a bicycle and a scooter.*

203.1 चिड़ियाघर (ciṛiyāghar) — a zoo

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tower, then the Hindi for a garden.

You'll want to know: चिड़ियाघर

चिड़ियाघर — *ciṛiyāghar* — "a zoo".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चिड़ियाघर (*ciṛiyāghar*) is "bird-house": *ciṛiyā*, "bird", from Sanskrit *caṭaka*, "sparrow", a word imitating the call (CDIAL 4571), and *ghar*, "house", from *ghara* (CDIAL 4428).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ciṛiyāghar*
- *Say it: ciṛiyāghar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ciṛiyāghar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tower, then the Hindi for a garden, then say *ciṛiyāghar* again

Before you move on

What does **चिड़ियाघर** mean? (“A zoo”.) Say it once more.

203.2 संग्रहालय (saṅgrahālay) — a museum

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a garden, then the Hindi for a zoo.

You’ll want to know: संग्रहालय

संग्रहालय — *saṅgrahālay* — “a museum”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

संग्रहालय (*saṅgrahālay*) is a tatsama compound, taken over whole from Sanskrit: *saṅgraha*, “a collection”, and *ālaya*, “abode”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: saṅgrahālay*
- *Say it: saṅgrahālay*, once more
- *Say it:* say *saṅgrahālay*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a garden, then the Hindi for a zoo, then say *saṅgrahālay* again

Before you move on

What does संग्रहालय mean? (“A museum”.) Say it once more.

203.3 सुरंग (suraṅg) — a tunnel

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a zoo, then the Hindi for a museum.

You’ll want to know: सुरंग

सुरंग — *suraṅg* — “a tunnel”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुरंग (*suraṅg*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *suruṅgā*, “underground passage” (CDIAL 13506).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: suraṅg*
- *Say it: suraṅg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *suraṅg*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a zoo, then the Hindi for a museum, then say *suraṅg* again

Before you move on

What does सुरंग mean? (“A tunnel”.) Say it once more.

203.4 साइकिल (sāikil) — a bicycle

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a museum, then the Hindi for a tunnel.

You'll want to know: साइकिल

साइकिल — *sāikil* — "a bicycle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

साइकिल (*sāikil*) is a loan from English *cycle*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāikil*
- *Say it: sāikil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sāikil*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a museum, then the Hindi for a tunnel, then say *sāikil* again

Before you move on

What does साइकिल mean? ("A bicycle".) Say it once more.

203.5 स्कूटर (skūṭar) — a scooter

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tunnel, then the Hindi for a bicycle.

You'll want to know: स्कूटर

स्कूटर — *skūṭar* — "a scooter".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

स्कूटर (*skūṭar*) is a loan from English *scooter*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: skūṭar*
- *Say it: skūṭar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *skūṭar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tunnel, then the Hindi for a bicycle, then say *skūṭar* again

Before you move on

What does **स्कूटर** mean? (“A scooter”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 204

A lorry, A rickshaw, An aeroplane, Petrol, A telephone

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a lorry, a rickshaw, an aeroplane, petrol and a telephone.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 204: I can say a lorry, a rickshaw, an aeroplane, petrol and a telephone.*

204.1 ट्रक (ṭrak) — a lorry

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bicycle, then the Hindi for a scooter.

You'll want to know: ट्रक

ट्रक — *ṭrak* — "a lorry".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ट्रक (*ṭrak*) is a loan from English *truck*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭrak*
- *Say it: ṭrak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭrak*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bicycle, then the Hindi for a scooter, then say *ṭrak* again

Before you move on

What does ट्रक mean? (“A lorry”.) Say it once more.

204.2 रिक्शा (rikśā) — a rickshaw

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a scooter, then the Hindi for a lorry.

You’ll want to know: रिक्शा

रिक्शा — *rikśā* — “a rickshaw”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रिक्शा (*rikśā*) is a loan from English *rickshaw*. English shortened it from Japanese *jinrikisha*, “man-powered vehicle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rikśā*
- *Say it: rikśā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rikśā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a scooter, then the Hindi for a lorry, then say *rikśā* again

Before you move on

What does रिक्शा mean? (“A rickshaw”.) Say it once more.

204.3 हवाई जहाज़ (havāī jahāz) — an aeroplane

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lorry, then the Hindi for a rickshaw.

You’ll want to know: हवाई जहाज़

हवाई जहाज़ — *havāī jahāz* — “an aeroplane”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हवाई जहाज़ (*havāī jahāz*) is “air-ship”: *havāī*, “of the air”, from Arabic *hawāʾ*, and *jahāz*, “ship”, from Arabic *jahāz*, “equipment”, both through Persian (Lane, roots *h-w-y*, *j-h-z*).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: havāī jahāz*
- *Say it: havāī jahāz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *havāī jahāz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lorry, then the Hindi for a rickshaw, then say *havāī jahāz* again

Before you move on

What does हवाई जहाज़ mean? (“An aeroplane”.) Say it once more.

204.4 पेट्रोल (peṭrol) — petrol

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a rickshaw, then the Hindi for an aeroplane.

You'll want to know: पेट्रोल

पेट्रोल — *peṭrol* — "petrol".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पेट्रोल (*peṭrol*) is a loan from English *petrol*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *peṭrol*
- *Say it:* *peṭrol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *peṭrol*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a rickshaw, then the Hindi for an aeroplane, then say *peṭrol* again

Before you move on

What does पेट्रोल mean? ("Petrol".) Say it once more.

204.5 फ़ोन (phon) — a telephone

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an aeroplane, then the Hindi for petrol.

You'll want to know: फ़ोन

फ़ोन — *phon* — "a telephone".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फ़ोन (*phon*) is a loan from English *phone*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: phon*
- *Say it: phon*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phon*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an aeroplane, then the Hindi for petrol, then say *phon* again

Before you move on

What does फ़ोन mean? ("A telephone".) Say it once more.

Chapter 205

A letter, An envelope, A ticket office, A message, A conversation

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a letter, an envelope, a ticket office, a message and a conversation.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 205: I can say a letter, an envelope, a ticket office, a message and a conversation.*

205.1 पत्र (patra) — a letter (formal)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for petrol, then the Hindi for a telephone.

You'll want to know: पत्र

पत्र — *patra* — "a letter (formal)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पत्र (*patra*) is Sanskrit *pattra*, "wing-feather; leaf; leaf of a book", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 7733). A letter is a leaf of writing. CDIAL lists the inherited form as *pattā*, "leaf".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: patra*
- *Say it: patra*, once more
- *Say it:* say *patra*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for petrol, then the Hindi for a telephone, then say *patra* again

Before you move on

What does पत्र mean? (“A letter (formal)”.) Say it once more.

205.2 लिफ़ाफ़ा (lifāfā) — an envelope

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a telephone, then the Hindi for a letter.

You’ll want to know: लिफ़ाफ़ा

लिफ़ाफ़ा — *lifāfā* — “an envelope”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लिफ़ाफ़ा (*lifāfā*) is a loan from Arabic *lifāfa*, “a wrapper”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *l-f-f* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lifāfā*
- *Say it: lifāfā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lifāfā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a telephone, then the Hindi for a letter, then say *lifāfā* again

Before you move on

What does लिफ़ाफ़ा mean? (“An envelope”.) Say it once more.

205.3 टिकट घर (ṭikaṭ ghar) — a ticket office

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a letter, then the Hindi for an envelope.

You’ll want to know: टिकट घर

टिकट घर — *ṭikaṭ ghar* — “a ticket office”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टिकट घर (*ṭikaṭ ghar*) joins English *ticket* with *ghar*, “house”, from *ghara* (CDIAL 4428).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭikaṭ ghar*
- *Say it: ṭikaṭ ghar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭikaṭ ghar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a letter, then the Hindi for an envelope, then say *ṭikaṭ ghar* again

Before you move on

What does टिकट घर mean? (“A ticket office”.) Say it once more.

205.4 संदेसा (sandesā) — a message (everyday)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an envelope, then the Hindi for a ticket office.

You'll want to know: संदेसा

संदेसा — *sandesā* — "a message (everyday)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

संदेसा (*sandesā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *saṁdeśa*, "message, information" (CDIAL 12904). It is the inherited form of the word Hindi also has whole as *sandeś*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sandesā*
- *Say it: sandesā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sandesā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an envelope, then the Hindi for a ticket office, then say *sandesā* again

Before you move on

What does संदेसा mean? ("A message (everyday)".) Say it once more.

205.5 बातचीत (bātcīt) — a conversation

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a ticket office, then the Hindi for a message.

You'll want to know: बातचीत

बातचीत — *bātcīt* — "a conversation".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बातचीत (*bātcīt*) is a rhyming pair: *bāt*, "talk", from Sanskrit *vārttā* (CDIAL 11564), and *cīt*, which CDIAL lists in this very pair under *citti*, “thought” (CDIAL 4801).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bātcīt*
- *Say it: bātcīt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bātcīt*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a ticket office, then the Hindi for a message, then say *bātcīt* again

Before you move on

What does **बातचीत** mean? (“A conversation”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 206

Advice, An opinion, A thought, A lie, A promise

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say advice, an opinion, a thought, a lie and a promise.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 206: I can say advice, an opinion, a thought, a lie and a promise.*

206.1 सलाह (salāh) — advice

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a message, then the Hindi for a conversation.

You'll want to know: सलाह

सलाह — *salāh* — "advice".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सलाह (*salāh*) is a loan from Arabic *ṣalāḥ*, "soundness, what is right", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṣ-l-ḥ* (Lane). Hindi uses it for advice.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: salāh*
- *Say it: salāh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *salāh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a message, then the Hindi for a conversation, then say *salāh* again

Before you move on

What does सलाह mean? (“Advice”.) Say it once more.

206.2 राय (rāy) — an opinion

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a conversation, then the Hindi for advice.

You’ll want to know: राय

राय — *rāy* — “an opinion”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

राय (*rāy*) is a loan from Arabic *raʾy*, “opinion, view”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *r-ʾ-y* (Lane). It is a different word from the older Hindi *rāy*, “king”, from Sanskrit *rājan* (CDIAL 10679).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rāy*
- *Say it: rāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rāy*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a conversation, then the Hindi for advice, then say *rāy* again

Before you move on

What does राय mean? (“An opinion”.) Say it once more.

206.3 विचार (vicār) — a thought, an idea

Before the new one: say the Hindi for advice, then the Hindi for an opinion.

You’ll want to know: विचार

विचार — *vicār* — “a thought, an idea”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

विचार (*vicār*) is Sanskrit *vicāra*, “pondering”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 11683).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vicār*
- *Say it: vicār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vicār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for advice, then the Hindi for an opinion, then say *vicār* again

Before you move on

What does विचार mean? (“A thought, an idea”.) Say it once more.

206.4 झूठ (jhūṭh) — a lie

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an opinion, then the Hindi for a thought.

You'll want to know: झूठ

झूठ — *jhūṭh* — “a lie”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झूठ (*jhūṭh*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **jhūṭṭha*, “false”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5407).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhūṭh*
- *Say it: jhūṭh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhūṭh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an opinion, then the Hindi for a thought, then say *jhūṭh* again

Before you move on

What does झूठ mean? (“A lie”.) Say it once more.

206.5 वादा (vādā) — a promise

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a thought, then the Hindi for a lie.

You'll want to know: वादा

वादा — *vādā* — “a promise”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वादा (*vādā*) is a loan from Arabic *wa*^{c}*da*, “a promise”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *w-*^{c}*-d* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vādā*
- *Say it: vādā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vādā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a thought, then the Hindi for a lie, then say *vādā* again

Before you move on

What does वादा mean? (“A promise”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 207

A condition, A debt, Earnings, Savings, Expense

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a condition, a debt, earnings, savings and expense.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 207: I can say a condition, a debt, earnings, savings and expense.*

207.1 शर्त (śart) — a condition, a bet

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lie, then the Hindi for a promise.

You'll want to know: शर्त

शर्त — *śart* — "a condition, a bet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शर्त (*śart*) is a loan from Arabic *sharṭ*, "a condition", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *sh-r-ṭ* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śart*
- *Say it: śart*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śart*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lie, then the Hindi for a promise, then say *śart* again

Before you move on

What does शर्त mean? (“A condition, a bet”.) Say it once more.

207.2 क़र्ज़ (qarz) — a debt, a loan

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a promise, then the Hindi for a condition.

You’ll want to know: क़र्ज़

क़र्ज़ — *qarz* — “a debt, a loan”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क़र्ज़ (*qarz*) is a loan from Arabic *qarḍ*, “a loan”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *q-r-ḍ* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: qarz*
- *Say it: qarz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qarz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a promise, then the Hindi for a condition, then say *qarz* again

Before you move on

What does क़र्ज़ mean? (“A debt, a loan”.) Say it once more.

207.3 कमाई (kamāī) — earnings

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a condition, then the Hindi for a debt.

You’ll want to know: कमाई

कमाई — *kamāī* — “earnings”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कमाई (*kamāī*) is the noun of *kamānā*, “to earn”, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **karmāpayati*, “works, earns”, built on Sanskrit *karman*, “work” (CDIAL 2897).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kamāī*
- *Say it: kamāī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kamāī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a condition, then the Hindi for a debt, then say *kamāī* again

Before you move on

What does कमाई mean? (“Earnings”.) Say it once more.

207.4 बचत (bacat) — savings

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a debt, then the Hindi for earnings.

You'll want to know: बचत

बचत — *bacat* — "savings".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बचत (*bacat*) is the noun of *bacnā*, "to be saved": what you save. CDIAL lists *bacnā* under Sanskrit *vañcati*, "moves", whose forms meant "escapes from" (CDIAL 11208).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bacat*
- *Say it: bacat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bacat*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a debt, then the Hindi for earnings, then say *bacat* again

Before you move on

What does बचत mean? ("Savings".) Say it once more.

207.5 ख़र्च (kharc) — expense, spending

Before the new one: say the Hindi for earnings, then the Hindi for savings.

You'll want to know: ख़र्च

ख़र्च — *kharc* — "expense, spending".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ख़र्च (*kharc*) is a loan from Arabic *kharj*, “expenditure; tribute”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *kh-r-j* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kharc*
- *Say it: kharc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kharc*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for earnings, then the Hindi for savings, then say *kharc* again

Before you move on

What does ख़र्च mean? (“Expense, spending”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 208

A loss, A benefit, A price, A coin, A banknote

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a loss, a benefit, a price, a coin and a banknote.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 208: I can say a loss, a benefit, a price, a coin and a banknote.*

208.1 नुक़सान (nuqsān) — a loss, harm

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for savings, then the Hindi for expense.

You'll want to know: नुक़सान

नुक़सान — *nuqsān* — "a loss, harm".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नुक़सान (*nuqsān*) is a loan from Arabic *nuqṣān*, "a decrease, a loss", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *n-q-ṣ* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nuqsān*
- *Say it: nuqsān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nuqsān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for savings, then the Hindi for expense, then say *nuqsān* again

Before you move on

What does नुक़सान mean? ("A loss, harm".) Say it once more.

208.2 फ़ायदा (fāydā) — a benefit, a profit

Before the new one: say the Hindi for expense, then the Hindi for a loss.

You'll want to know: फ़ायदा

फ़ायदा — *fāydā* — "a benefit, a profit".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फ़ायदा (*fāydā*) is a loan from Arabic *fāʾida*, "a benefit, a gain", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *f-y-d* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāydā*
- *Say it: fāydā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fāydā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for expense, then the Hindi for a loss, then say *fāydā* again

Before you move on

What does फ़ायदा mean? (“A benefit, a profit”.) Say it once more.

208.3 क़ीमत (kīmat) — a price, value

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a loss, then the Hindi for a benefit.

You’ll want to know: क़ीमत

क़ीमत — *kīmat* — “a price, value”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क़ीमत (*kīmat*) is a loan from Arabic *qīma*, “value”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *q-w-m* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kīmat*
- *Say it: kīmat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kīmat*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a loss, then the Hindi for a benefit, then say *kīmat* again

Before you move on

What does क़ीमत mean? (“A price, value”.) Say it once more.

208.4 सिक्का (sikkā) — a coin

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a benefit, then the Hindi for a price.

You’ll want to know: सिक्का

सिक्का — *sikkā* — “a coin”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सिक्का (*sikkā*) is a loan from Arabic *sikka*, “a die for stamping coins”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *s-k-k* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sikkā*
- *Say it: sikkā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sikkā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a benefit, then the Hindi for a price, then say *sikkā* again

Before you move on

What does सिक्का mean? (“A coin”.) Say it once more.

208.5 नोट (noṭ) — a banknote

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a price, then the Hindi for a coin.

You’ll want to know: नोट

नोट — *noṭ* — “a banknote”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नोट (*noṭ*) is a loan from English *note*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: noṭ*
- *Say it: noṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *noṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a price, then the Hindi for a coin, then say *noṭ* again

Before you move on

What does नोट mean? ("A banknote".) Say it once more.

Chapter 209

A balcony, A cup, A needle, A lamp, Bread

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a balcony, a cup, a needle, a lamp and bread.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 209: I can say a balcony, a cup, a needle, a lamp and bread.*

209.1 छज्जा (chajjā) — a balcony, a ledge

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a coin, then the Hindi for a banknote.

You'll want to know: छज्जा

छज्जा — *chajjā* — "a balcony, a ledge".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छज्जा (*chajjā*) is inherited. CDIAL lists it under Sanskrit *chādya*, "to be sheltered", and marks the Hindi word as taken from Punjabi *chajjā*, "eaves, balcony" (CDIAL 5023).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chajjā*
- *Say it: chajjā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chajjā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a coin, then the Hindi for a banknote, then say *chajjā* again

Before you move on

What does छज्जा mean? (“A balcony, a ledge”.) Say it once more.

209.2 प्याला (pyālā) — a cup

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a banknote, then the Hindi for a balcony.

You’ll want to know: प्याला

प्याला — *pyālā* — “a cup”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

प्याला (*pyālā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *piyāla*, “cup”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pyālā*
- *Say it: pyālā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pyālā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a banknote, then the Hindi for a balcony, then say *pyālā* again

Before you move on

What does प्याला mean? (“A cup”.) Say it once more.

209.3 सुई (suī) — a needle

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a balcony, then the Hindi for a cup.

You’ll want to know: सुई

सुई — *suī* — “a needle”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुई (*suī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *sūcī*, “needle” (CDIAL 13551).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: suī*
- *Say it: suī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *suī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a balcony, then the Hindi for a cup, then say *suī* again

Before you move on

What does सुई mean? (“A needle”.) Say it once more.

209.4 बत्ती (battī) — a lamp, a light

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cup, then the Hindi for a needle.

You’ll want to know: बत्ती

बत्ती — *battī* — “a lamp, a light”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बत्ती (*battī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *varti*, “wick; lamp” (CDIAL 11359).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: battī*
- *Say it: battī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *battī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cup, then the Hindi for a needle, then say *battī* again

Before you move on

What does बत्ती mean? (“A lamp, a light”.) Say it once more.

209.5 रोटी (roṭī) — bread (flatbread)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a needle, then the Hindi for a lamp.

You’ll want to know: रोटी

रोटी — *roṭī* — “bread (flatbread)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रोटी (*roṭī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **roṭṭa*, “bread”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 10837).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: roṭī*
- *Say it: roṭī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *roṭī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a needle, then the Hindi for a lamp, then say *roṭī* again

Before you move on

What does **रोटी** mean? ("Bread (flatbread)".) Say it once more.

209.6 Words from chapters 202-205 — a first pass

Say the words for a lamp and bread.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a cave, a palace, a fort, a tower, a garden
- a zoo, a museum, a tunnel, a bicycle, a scooter
- a lorry, a rickshaw, an aeroplane, petrol, a telephone
- a letter, an envelope, a ticket office, a message, a conversation

Before you move on

A cave? (**गुफ़ा**, *gufā.*) A palace? (**महल**, *mahal.*) A fort? (**क़िला**, *qilā.*) A tower? (**मीनार**, *mīnār.*) A garden? (**बाग़**, *bāg.*) A zoo? (**चिड़ियाघर**, *ciṛiyāghar.*) A museum? (**संग्रहालय**, *saṅgrahālay.*) A tunnel? (**सुरंग**, *suraṅg.*) A bicycle? (**साइकिल**, *sāikil.*) A scooter? (**स्कूटर**, *skūṭar.*) A lorry? (**ट्रक**, *ṭrak.*) A rickshaw? (**रिक्शा**, *rikśā.*) An aeroplane? (**हवाई**

जहाज़, *havāī jahāz.*) Petrol? (पेट्रोल, *peṭrol.*) A telephone? (फ़ोन, *phon.*) A letter? (पत्र, *patra.*) An envelope? (लिफ़ाफ़ा, *lifāfā.*) A ticket office? (टिकट घर, *ṭikaṭ ghar.*) A message? (संदेसा, *sandesā.*) A conversation? (बातचीत, *bātcīt.*)

209.7 Words from chapters 206-209 — a second pass

Say the words for advice and an opinion.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- advice, an opinion, a thought, a lie, a promise
- a condition, a debt, earnings, savings, expense
- a loss, a benefit, a price, a coin, a banknote
- a balcony, a cup, a needle, a lamp, bread

Before you move on

Advice? (सलाह, *salāh.*) An opinion? (राय, *rāy.*) A thought? (विचार, *vicār.*) A lie? (झूठ, *jhūṭh.*) A promise? (वादा, *vādā.*) A condition? (शर्त, *śart.*) A debt? (क़र्ज़, *qarz.*) Earnings? (कमाई, *kamāī.*) Savings? (बचत, *bacat.*) Expense? (ख़र्च, *kharc.*) A loss? (नुक़सान, *nuqsān.*) A benefit? (फ़ायदा, *fāydā.*) A price? (क़ीमत, *kīmat.*) A coin? (सिक्का, *sikkā.*) A banknote? (नोट, *noṭ.*) A balcony? (छज्जा, *chajjā.*) A cup? (प्याला, *pyālā.*) A needle? (सुई, *suī.*) A lamp? (बत्ती, *battī.*) Bread? (रोटी, *roṭī.*)

Chapter 210

A paratha, Khichri, Halwa, A laddu, Pickle

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a paratha, khichri, halwa, a laddu and pickle.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 210: I can say a paratha, khichri, halwa, a laddu and pickle.*

210.1 पराठा (parāṭhā) — a paratha

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lamp, a light, then the Hindi for bread (flatbread).

You'll want to know: पराठा

पराठा — *parāṭhā* — "a paratha".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of पराठा (*parāṭhā*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: parāṭhā*
- *Say it: parāṭhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *parāṭhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lamp, a light, then the Hindi for bread (flatbread), then say *parāṭhā* again

Before you move on

What does पराठा mean? (“A paratha”.) Say it once more.

210.2 खिचड़ी (khicṛī) — khichri (rice and lentils)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for bread (flatbread), then the Hindi for a paratha.

You’ll want to know: खिचड़ी

खिचड़ी — *khicṛī* — “khichri (rice and lentils)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खिचड़ी (*khicṛī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *khiccā*, “dish of rice and peas” (CDIAL 3880). CDIAL notes an added -*ḍ*-.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khicṛī*
- *Say it: khicṛī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khicṛī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for bread (flatbread), then the Hindi for a paratha, then say *khicṛī* again

Before you move on

What does खिचड़ी mean? (“Khichri (rice and lentils)”.) Say it once more.

210.3 हलवा (halvā) — halwa (a sweet)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a paratha, then the Hindi for khichri.

You’ll want to know: हलवा

हलवा — *halvā* — “halwa (a sweet)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हलवा (*halvā*) is a loan from Arabic *ḥalwā*, “a sweetmeat”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ḥ-l-w* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: halvā*
- *Say it: halvā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *halvā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a paratha, then the Hindi for khichri, then say *halvā* again

Before you move on

What does हलवा mean? (“Halwa (a sweet)”.) Say it once more.

210.4 लड्डू (laḍḍū) — a laddu (a sweet)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for khichri, then the Hindi for halwa.

You'll want to know: लड्डू

लड्डू — *laḍḍū* — "a laddu (a sweet)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लड्डू (*laḍḍū*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *laḍḍu*, "a kind of sweetmeat" (CDIAL 10926). CDIAL thinks it the same as **laḍḍu*, "lump", and notes a suggested Munda link.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laḍḍū*
- *Say it: laḍḍū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *laḍḍū*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for khichri, then the Hindi for halwa, then say *laḍḍū* again

Before you move on

What does लड्डू mean? ("A laddu (a sweet)".) Say it once more.

210.5 अचार (achār) — pickle

Before the new one: say the Hindi for halwa, then the Hindi for a laddu.

You'll want to know: अचार

अचार — *achār* — "pickle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अचार (*achār*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *āchār*, "pickle".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: achār*
- *Say it: achār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *achār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for halwa, then the Hindi for a laddu, then say *achār* again

Before you move on

What does **अचार** mean? ("Pickle".) Say it once more.

Chapter 211

Chutney, Spice, Turmeric, Coriander, A lemon

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say chutney, spice, turmeric, coriander and a lemon.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 211: I can say chutney, spice, turmeric, coriander and a lemon.*

211.1 चटनी (caṭnī) — chutney

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a laddu, then the Hindi for pickle.

You'll want to know: चटनी

चटनी — *caṭnī* — "chutney".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of चटनी (*caṭnī*) is not settled. It is often tied to *cāṭnā*, "to lick", which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed *caṭṭ, "lick, taste" (CDIAL 4573), but CDIAL does not list *caṭnī* itself. English took the word as *chutney*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caṭnī*
- *Say it: caṭnī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caṭnī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a laddu, then the Hindi for pickle, then say *caṭnī* again

Before you move on

What does चटनी mean? (“Chutney”.) Say it once more.

211.2 मसाला (masālā) — spice, a spice mix

Before the new one: say the Hindi for pickle, then the Hindi for chutney.

You’ll want to know: मसाला

मसाला — *masālā* — “spice, a spice mix”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मसाला (*masālā*) is a loan from Arabic *maṣāliḥ*, “things that are needful”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṣ-l-ḥ* (Lane). Hindi took the plural through Persian and narrowed it to cooking.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: masālā*
- *Say it: masālā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *masālā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for pickle, then the Hindi for chutney, then say *masālā* again

Before you move on

What does मसाला mean? (“Spice, a spice mix”.) Say it once more.

211.3 हल्दी (haldī) — turmeric

Before the new one: say the Hindi for chutney, then the Hindi for spice.

You’ll want to know: हल्दी

हल्दी — *haldī* — “turmeric”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हल्दी (*haldī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *haridrā*, “turmeric” (CDIAL 13992).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: haldī*
- *Say it: haldī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *haldī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for chutney, then the Hindi for spice, then say *haldī* again

Before you move on

What does हल्दी mean? (“Turmeric”.) Say it once more.

211.4 धनिया (dhaniyā) — coriander

Before the new one: say the Hindi for spice, then the Hindi for turmeric.

You'll want to know: धनिया

धनिया — *dhaniyā* — "coriander".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धनिया (*dhaniyā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *dhāneyaka*, "coriander", which CDIAL lists beside *dhānaka* (CDIAL 6776).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhaniyā*
- *Say it: dhaniyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhaniyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for spice, then the Hindi for turmeric, then say *dhaniyā* again

Before you move on

What does धनिया mean? ("Coriander".) Say it once more.

211.5 नींबू (nı̃bū) — a lemon, a lime

Before the new one: say the Hindi for turmeric, then the Hindi for coriander.

You'll want to know: नींबू

नींबू — *nı̃bū* — "a lemon, a lime".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नींबू (*nīṁbū*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *nimbū*, “lime” (CDIAL 7247). CDIAL takes the Sanskrit word from an Austroasiatic language.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nī̃bū*
- *Say it: nī̃bū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nī̃bū*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for turmeric, then the Hindi for coriander, then say *nī̃bū* again

Before you move on

What does नींबू mean? (“A lemon, a lime”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 212

Ugly, Strong, Weak, Cheap, Hard

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say ugly, strong, weak, cheap and hard.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 212: I can say ugly, strong, weak, cheap and hard.*

212.1 भद्दा (bhaddā) — ugly, clumsy

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for coriander, then the Hindi for a lemon.

You'll want to know: भद्दा

भद्दा — *bhaddā* — "ugly, clumsy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भद्दा (*bhaddā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *bhadra*, "fortunate, delightful" (CDIAL 9377). Its sense turned round: CDIAL glosses the Hindi word "stupid, clumsy".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhaddā*
- *Say it: bhaddā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhaddā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for coriander, then the Hindi for a lemon, then say *bhaddā* again

Before you move on

What does भद्दा mean? (“Ugly, clumsy”.) Say it once more.

212.2 मज़बूत (mazbūt) — strong, sturdy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lemon, then the Hindi for ugly.

You’ll want to know: मज़बूत

मज़बूत — *mazbūt* — “strong, sturdy”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मज़बूत (*mazbūt*) is a loan from Arabic *maḍbūṭ*, “held firm, secured”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ḍ-b-ṭ* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mazbūt*
- *Say it: mazbūt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mazbūt*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lemon, then the Hindi for ugly, then say *mazbūt* again

Before you move on

What does मज़बूत mean? (“Strong, sturdy”.) Say it once more.

212.3 कमज़ोर (kamzor) — weak

Before the new one: say the Hindi for ugly, then the Hindi for strong.

You’ll want to know: कमज़ोर

कमज़ोर — *kamzor* — “weak”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कमज़ोर (*kamzor*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kamzōr*, “weak”. It is built from *kam*, “little”, and *zōr*, “strength”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kamzor*
- *Say it: kamzor*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kamzor*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for ugly, then the Hindi for strong, then say *kamzor* again

Before you move on

What does कमज़ोर mean? (“Weak”.) Say it once more.

212.4 सस्ता (sastā) — cheap

Before the new one: say the Hindi for strong, then the Hindi for weak.

You’ll want to know: सस्ता

सस्ता — *sastā* — “cheap”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of सस्ता (*sastā*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sastā*
- *Say it: sastā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sastā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for strong, then the Hindi for weak, then say *sastā* again

Before you move on

What does सस्ता mean? (“Cheap”.) Say it once more.

212.5 कठिन (kaṭhin) — hard, difficult

Before the new one: say the Hindi for weak, then the Hindi for cheap.

You’ll want to know: कठिन

कठिन — *kaṭhin* — “hard, difficult”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कठिन (*kaṭhin*) is Sanskrit *kaṭhina*, “hard, stiff”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 2650). CDIAL reports that this group of words has been traced to Dravidian.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṭhin*
- *Say it: kaṭhin*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṭhin*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for weak, then the Hindi for cheap, then say *kaṭhin* again

Before you move on

What does कठिन mean? (“Hard, difficult”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 213

Necessary, Dangerous, Safe, Sweet, Soft

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say necessary, dangerous, safe, sweet and soft.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 213: I can say necessary, dangerous, safe, sweet and soft.*

213.1 ज़रूरी (zarūrī) — necessary

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for cheap, then the Hindi for hard.

You'll want to know: ज़रूरी

ज़रूरी — *zarūrī* — "necessary".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ज़रूरी (*zarūrī*) is a loan from Arabic *ḍarūrī*, "necessary", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ḍ-r-r* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: zarūrī*
- *Say it: zarūrī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *zarūrī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for cheap, then the Hindi for hard, then say *zarūrī* again

Before you move on

What does ज़रूरी mean? (“Necessary”.) Say it once more.

213.2 ख़तरनाक (khatarnāk) — dangerous

Before the new one: say the Hindi for hard, then the Hindi for necessary.

You’ll want to know: ख़तरनाक

ख़तरनाक — *khatarnāk* — “dangerous”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ख़तरनाक (*khatarnāk*) is *khatar*, “danger”, from Arabic *khaṭar* through Persian (Lane, root *kh-ṭ-r*), with the Persian ending *-nāk*, “full of”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khatarnāk*
- *Say it: khatarnāk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khatarnāk*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for hard, then the Hindi for necessary, then say *khatarnāk* again

Before you move on

What does ख़तरनाक mean? (“Dangerous”.) Say it once more.

213.3 सुरक्षित (surakṣit) — safe

Before the new one: say the Hindi for necessary, then the Hindi for dangerous.

You’ll want to know: सुरक्षित

सुरक्षित — *surakṣit* — “safe”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुरक्षित (*surakṣit*) is Sanskrit *surakṣita*, “well protected”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built from *su-*, “well”, and *rakṣita*, “guarded”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: surakṣit*
- *Say it: surakṣit*, once more
- *Say it:* say *surakṣit*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for necessary, then the Hindi for dangerous, then say *surakṣit* again

Before you move on

What does सुरक्षित mean? (“Safe”.) Say it once more.

213.4 मीठा (mīṭhā) — sweet

Before the new one: say the Hindi for dangerous, then the Hindi for safe.

You'll want to know: मीठा

मीठा — *mīṭhā* — "sweet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मीठा (*mīṭhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *miṣṭa*, "dainty, sweet" (CDIAL 10299). CDIAL lists it under *mr̥ṣṭa*, "pure; prepared, savoury", of which *miṣṭa* is an early variant.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *mīṭhā*
- *Say it:* *mīṭhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mīṭhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for dangerous, then the Hindi for safe, then say *mīṭhā* again

Before you move on

What does मीठा mean? ("Sweet".) Say it once more.

213.5 नर्म (narm) — soft

Before the new one: say the Hindi for safe, then the Hindi for sweet.

You'll want to know: नर्म

नर्म — *narm* — "soft".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नर्म (*narm*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *narm*, "soft".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: narm*
- *Say it: narm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *narm*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for safe, then the Hindi for sweet, then say *narm* again

Before you move on

What does नर्म mean? ("Soft".) Say it once more.

Chapter 214

Smooth, Busy, Lazy, Honest, True

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say smooth, busy, lazy, honest and true.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 214: I can say smooth, busy, lazy, honest and true.*

214.1 चिकना (cikanā) — smooth, greasy

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for sweet, then the Hindi for soft.

You'll want to know: चिकना

चिकना — *cikanā* — "smooth, greasy".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चिकना (*cikanā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *cikkaṇa*, "slippery, unctuous" (CDIAL 4782).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cikanā*
- *Say it: cikanā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cikanā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sweet, then the Hindi for soft, then say *cikanā* again

Before you move on

What does चिकना mean? (“Smooth, greasy”.) Say it once more.

214.2 व्यस्त (vyast) — busy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for soft, then the Hindi for smooth.

You’ll want to know: व्यस्त

व्यस्त — *vyast* — “busy”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

व्यस्त (*vyast*) is Sanskrit *vyasta*, “scattered, distracted”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. Hindi uses it for “busy”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vyast*
- *Say it: vyast*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vyast*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for soft, then the Hindi for smooth, then say *vyast* again

Before you move on

What does व्यस्त mean? (“Busy”.) Say it once more.

214.3 आलसी (ālsī) — lazy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for smooth, then the Hindi for busy.

You’ll want to know: आलसी

आलसी — *ālsī* — “lazy”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आलसी (*ālsī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ālasya*, “sloth” (CDIAL 1371). It is built on *alasa*, “idle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ālsī*
- *Say it: ālsī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ālsī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for smooth, then the Hindi for busy, then say *ālsī* again

Before you move on

What does आलसी mean? (“Lazy”.) Say it once more.

214.4 ईमानदार (īmāndār) — honest

Before the new one: say the Hindi for busy, then the Hindi for lazy.

You’ll want to know: ईमानदार

ईमानदार — *īmāndār* — “honest”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ईमानदार (*īmāndār*) is *īmān*, “faith, good faith”, from Arabic *īmān* through Persian (Lane, root *ʾ-m-n*), with the Persian ending -*dār*, “holder”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *īmāndār*
- *Say it:* *īmāndār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *īmāndār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for busy, then the Hindi for lazy, then say *īmāndār* again

Before you move on

What does ईमानदार mean? (“Honest”.) Say it once more.

214.5 सच्चा (saccā) — true, genuine

Before the new one: say the Hindi for lazy, then the Hindi for honest.

You’ll want to know: सच्चा

सच्चा — *saccā* — “true, genuine”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सच्चा (*saccā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *satya*, “true” (CDIAL 13112).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: saccā*
- *Say it: saccā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *saccā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for lazy, then the Hindi for honest, then say *saccā* again

Before you move on

What does सच्चा mean? ("True, genuine".) Say it once more.

Chapter 215

False, Clever, Foolish, Brave, Kind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say false, clever, foolish, brave and kind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 215: I can say false, clever, foolish, brave and kind.*

215.1 झूठा (jhūṭhā) — false, lying

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for honest, then the Hindi for true.

You'll want to know: झूठा

झूठा — *jhūṭhā* — "false, lying".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झूठा (*jhūṭhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **jhūṭṭha*, "false", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5407).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhūṭhā*
- *Say it: jhūṭhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhūṭhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for honest, then the Hindi for true, then say *jhūṭhā* again

Before you move on

What does झूठा mean? (“False, lying”.) Say it once more.

215.2 बुद्धिमान (buddhimān) — clever, wise

Before the new one: say the Hindi for true, then the Hindi for false.

You’ll want to know: बुद्धिमान

बुद्धिमान — *buddhimān* — “clever, wise”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बुद्धिमान (*buddhimān*) is Sanskrit *buddhimat*, “having intelligence”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. Hindi took its nominative, *buddhimān*. It is built on *buddhi*, “intelligence”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: buddhimān*
- *Say it: buddhimān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *buddhimān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for true, then the Hindi for false, then say *buddhimān* again

Before you move on

What does बुद्धिमान mean? ("Clever, wise".) Say it once more.

215.3 मूर्ख (mūrkh) — foolish

Before the new one: say the Hindi for false, then the Hindi for clever.

You'll want to know: मूर्ख

मूर्ख — *mūrkh* — "foolish".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मूर्ख (*mūrkh*) is Sanskrit *mūrkha*, "foolish", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mūrkh*
- *Say it: mūrkh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mūrkh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for false, then the Hindi for clever, then say *mūrkh* again

Before you move on

What does मूर्ख mean? ("Foolish".) Say it once more.

215.4 बहादुर (bahādur) — brave

Before the new one: say the Hindi for clever, then the Hindi for foolish.

You'll want to know: बहादुर

बहादुर — *bahādur* — "brave".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बहादुर (*bahādur*) is usually traced, through Persian, to a Turkic or Mongol word for "hero".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bahādur*
- *Say it: bahādur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bahādur*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for clever, then the Hindi for foolish, then say *bahādur* again

Before you move on

What does बहादुर mean? ("Brave".) Say it once more.

215.5 दयालु (dayālu) — kind

Before the new one: say the Hindi for foolish, then the Hindi for brave.

You'll want to know: दयालु

दयालु — *dayālu* — "kind".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दयालु (*dayālu*) is Sanskrit *dayālu*, "compassionate", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *dayā*, "pity".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dayālu*
- *Say it: dayālu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dayālu*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for foolish, then the Hindi for brave, then say *dayālu* again

Before you move on

What does **दयालु** mean? ("Kind".) Say it once more.

Chapter 216

A peanut, A radish, An aubergine, Okra, A papaya

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a peanut, a radish, an aubergine, okra and a papaya.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 216: I can say a peanut, a radish, an aubergine, okra and a papaya.*

216.1 मूँगफली (mū̃gphalī) — a peanut

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for brave, then the Hindi for kind.

You'll want to know: मूँगफली

मूँगफली — *mū̃gphalī* — "a peanut".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मूँगफली (*mūṁgphalī*) is "mung-pod": *mūṁg*, "the mung bean", from Sanskrit *mudga* (CDIAL 10198), and *phalī*, "pod", from *phala*, "fruit".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mū̃gphalī*
- *Say it: mū̃gphalī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mū̃gphalī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for brave, then the Hindi for kind, then say *mū̃gphalī* again

Before you move on

What does मूँगफली mean? (“A peanut”.) Say it once more.

216.2 मूली (mūlī) — a radish

Before the new one: say the Hindi for kind, then the Hindi for a peanut.

You’ll want to know: मूली

मूली — *mūlī* — “a radish”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मूली (*mūlī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mūla*, “root; radish” (CDIAL 10250). CDIAL thinks a non-Aryan, perhaps Dravidian, origin likely, comparing Tamil *muḷḷaṅki*, “radish”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mūlī*
- *Say it: mūlī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mūlī*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for kind, then the Hindi for a peanut, then say *mūlī* again

Before you move on

What does मूली mean? (“A radish”.) Say it once more.

216.3 बैंगन (bãigan) — an aubergine

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a peanut, then the Hindi for a radish.

You’ll want to know: बैंगन

बैंगन — *bãigan* — “an aubergine”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बैंगन (*bãigan*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vātiṅgaṇa*, “the egg-plant” (CDIAL 11503). CDIAL thinks the names of this plant share one ultimate source, which Bloch took to be Dravidian; the word also passed into Persian as *bādingān*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bãigan*
- *Say it: bãigan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bãigan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a peanut, then the Hindi for a radish, then say *bãigan* again

Before you move on

What does बैंगन mean? (“An aubergine”.) Say it once more.

216.4 भिंडी (bhinḍī) — okra

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a radish, then the Hindi for an aubergine.

You’ll want to know: भिंडी

भिंडी — *bhinḍī* — “okra”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भिंडी (*bhinḍī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *bhiṇḍā*, “okra” (CDIAL 9492).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhinḍī*
- *Say it: bhinḍī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhinḍī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a radish, then the Hindi for an aubergine, then say *bhinḍī* again

Before you move on

What does भिंडी mean? (“Okra”.) Say it once more.

216.5 पपीता (papītā) — a papaya

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an aubergine, then the Hindi for okra.

You’ll want to know: पपीता

पपीता — *papītā* — “a papaya”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of पपीता (*papītā*) is uncertain. It is usually linked with *papaya*, a word from the Caribbean that Spanish and Portuguese sailors carried round the world, but CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: papītā*
- *Say it: papītā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *papītā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an aubergine, then the Hindi for okra, then say *papītā* again

Before you move on

What does पपीता mean? (“A papaya”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 217

A pomegranate, A guava, A festival, Worship, Religion

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a pomegranate, a guava, a festival, worship and religion.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 217: I can say a pomegranate, a guava, a festival, worship and religion.*

217.1 अनार (anār) — a pomegranate

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for okra, then the Hindi for a papaya.

You'll want to know: अनार

अनार — *anār* — "a pomegranate".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अनार (*anār*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *anār*, "pomegranate".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: anār*
- *Say it: anār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *anār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for okra, then the Hindi for a papaya, then say *anār* again

Before you move on

What does **अनार** mean? (“A pomegranate”.) Say it once more.

217.2 अमरूद (amrūd) — a guava

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a papaya, then the Hindi for a pomegranate.

You’ll want to know: अमरूद

अमरूद — *amrūd* — “a guava”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अमरूद (*amrūd*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *amrūd*, “pear”. In Hindi it names the guava.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: amrūd*
- *Say it: amrūd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *amrūd*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a papaya, then the Hindi for a pomegranate, then say *amrūd* again

Before you move on

What does अमरूद mean? (“A guava”.) Say it once more.

217.3 त्योहार (tyohār) — a festival

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pomegranate, then the Hindi for a guava.

You’ll want to know: त्योहार

त्योहार — *tyohār* — “a festival”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

त्योहार (*tyohār*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **tithivāra*, “a festival”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5811). It is built from *tithi*, “lunar day”, and *vāra*, “day”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tyohār*
- *Say it: tyohār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tyohār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pomegranate, then the Hindi for a guava, then say *tyohār* again

Before you move on

What does त्योहार mean? (“A festival”.) Say it once more.

217.4 पूजा (pūjā) — worship

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a guava, then the Hindi for a festival.

You'll want to know: पूजा

पूजा — *pūjā* — "worship".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पूजा (*pūjā*) is Sanskrit *pūjā*, "honour, worship", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 8317).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pūjā*
- *Say it: pūjā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pūjā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a guava, then the Hindi for a festival, then say *pūjā* again

Before you move on

What does पूजा mean? ("Worship".) Say it once more.

217.5 धर्म (dharm) — religion, duty

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a festival, then the Hindi for worship.

You'll want to know: धर्म

धर्म — *dharm* — "religion, duty".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धर्म (*dharm*) is Sanskrit *dharma*, “what is established; law, duty, right”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 6753).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dharm*
- *Say it: dharm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dharm*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a festival, then the Hindi for worship, then say *dharm* again

Before you move on

What does धर्म mean? (“Religion, duty”.) Say it once more.

217.6 Words from chapters 210-213 — a first pass

Say the words for worship and religion.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a paratha, khichri, halwa, a laddu, pickle
- chutney, spice, turmeric, coriander, a lemon
- ugly, strong, weak, cheap, hard
- necessary, dangerous, safe, sweet, soft

Before you move on

A paratha? (पराठा, *parāṭhā.*) Khichri? (खिचड़ी, *khicṛī.*) Halwa? (हलवा, *halvā.*) A laddu? (लड्डू, *laḍḍū.*) Pickle? (अचार, *achār.*) Chutney? (चटनी, *caṭnī.*) Spice? (मसाला, *masālā.*) Turmeric? (हल्दी, *haldī.*) Coriander? (धनिया, *dhaniyā.*) A lemon? (नींबू, *nī̃bū.*) Ugly? (भद्दा, *bhaddā.*) Strong? (मज़बूत, *mazbūt.*) Weak? (कमज़ोर, *kamzor.*) Cheap? (सस्ता, *sastā.*) Hard? (कठिन, *kaṭhin.*) Necessary? (ज़रूरी, *zarūrī.*) Dangerous? (ख़तरनाक, *khatarnāk.*) Safe? (सुरक्षित, *surakṣit.*) Sweet? (मीठा, *mīṭhā.*) Soft? (नर्म, *narm.*)

217.7 Words from chapters 214-217 — a second pass

Say the words for smooth and busy.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- smooth, busy, lazy, honest, true
- false, clever, foolish, brave, kind
- a peanut, a radish, an aubergine, okra, a papaya
- a pomegranate, a guava, a festival, worship, religion

Before you move on

Smooth? (चिकना, *cikanā.*) Busy? (व्यस्त, *vyast.*) Lazy? (आलसी, *ālsī.*) Honest? (ईमानदार, *īmāndār.*) True? (सच्चा, *saccā.*) False? (झूठा, *jhūṭhā.*) Clever? (बुद्धिमान, *buddhimān.*) Foolish? (मूर्ख, *mūrkh.*) Brave? (बहादुर, *bahādur.*) Kind? (दयालु, *dayālu.*) A peanut? (मूँगफली, *mū̃gphalī.*) A radish? (मूली, *mūlī.*) An aubergine? (बैंगन, *bā̃igan.*) Okra? (भिंडी, *bhinḍī.*) A papaya? (पपीता, *papītā.*) A pomegranate? (अनार, *anār.*) A guava? (अमरूद, *amrūd.*) A festival? (त्योहार, *tyohār.*) Worship? (पूजा, *pūjā.*) Religion? (धर्म, *dharm.*)

Chapter 218

Society, The government, A law, A court, An election

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5)   🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say society, the government, a law, a court and an election.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 218: I can say society, the government, a law, a court and an election.*

218.1 समाज (samāj) — society

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for worship, then the Hindi for religion, duty.

You'll want to know: समाज

समाज — *samāj* — "society".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समाज (*samāj*) is Sanskrit *samāja*, "festive gathering", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 13207).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samāj*
- *Say it: samāj*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samāj*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for worship, then the Hindi for religion, duty, then say *samāj* again

Before you move on

What does समाज mean? ("Society".) Say it once more.

218.2 सरकार (sarkār) — the government

Before the new one: say the Hindi for religion, duty, then the Hindi for society.

You'll want to know: सरकार

सरकार — *sarkār* — "the government".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सरकार (*sarkār*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sarkār*, "government; lordship".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sarkār*
- *Say it: sarkār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sarkār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for religion, duty, then the Hindi for society, then say *sarkār* again

Before you move on

What does सरकार mean? (“The government”.) Say it once more.

218.3 क़ानून (kānūn) — a law

Before the new one: say the Hindi for society, then the Hindi for the government.

You’ll want to know: क़ानून

क़ानून — *kānūn* — “a law”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क़ानून (*kānūn*) is usually traced, through Persian, to Arabic *qānūn*, “rule, canon”, a word Arabic itself took from Greek *kanōn*, “rule”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kānūn*
- *Say it: kānūn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kānūn*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for society, then the Hindi for the government, then say *kānūn* again

Before you move on

What does क़ानून mean? (“A law”.) Say it once more.

218.4 अदालत (adālat) — a court

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the government, then the Hindi for a law.

You’ll want to know: अदालत

अदालत — *adālat* — “a court”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अदालत (*adālat*) is a loan from Arabic *ʿadāla*, “justice, equity”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ʿ-d-l* (Lane). Hindi uses it for the court that gives it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: adālat*
- *Say it: adālat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *adālat*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the government, then the Hindi for a law, then say *adālat* again

Before you move on

What does अदालत mean? (“A court”.) Say it once more.

218.5 चुनाव (cunāv) — an election

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a law, then the Hindi for a court.

You’ll want to know: चुनाव

चुनाव — *cunāv* — “an election”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चुनाव (*cunāv*) is the noun of *cunnā*, “to choose, pick”, which comes from Sanskrit *cinoti*, “heaps up, collects” (CDIAL 4814).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cunāv*
- *Say it: cunāv*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cunāv*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a law, then the Hindi for a court, then say *cunāv* again

Before you move on

What does **चुनाव** mean? ("An election".) Say it once more.

Chapter 219

A prison, Freedom, Peace, A war, An army

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a prison, freedom, peace, a war and an army.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 219: I can say a prison, freedom, peace, a war and an army.*

219.1 जेल (jel) — a prison

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a court, then the Hindi for an election.

You'll want to know: जेल

जेल — *jel* — "a prison".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जेल (*jel*) is a loan from English *jail*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jel*
- *Say it: jel*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jel*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a court, then the Hindi for an election, then say *jel* again

Before you move on

What does जेल mean? (“A prison”.) Say it once more.

219.2 आज़ादी (āzādī) — freedom

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an election, then the Hindi for a prison.

You’ll want to know: आज़ादी

आज़ादी — *āzādī* — “freedom”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आज़ादी (*āzādī*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *āzādī*, “freedom”. It is built on *āzād*, “free”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āzādī*
- *Say it: āzādī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āzādī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an election, then the Hindi for a prison, then say *āzādī* again

Before you move on

What does आज़ादी mean? (“Freedom”.) Say it once more.

219.3 शांति (śānti) — peace

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a prison, then the Hindi for freedom.

You’ll want to know: शांति

शांति — *śānti* — “peace”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शांति (*śānti*) is Sanskrit *śānti*, “calm, peace”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śānti*
- *Say it: śānti*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śānti*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a prison, then the Hindi for freedom, then say *śānti* again

Before you move on

What does शांति mean? (“Peace”.) Say it once more.

219.4 युद्ध (yuddh) — a war

Before the new one: say the Hindi for freedom, then the Hindi for peace.

You’ll want to know: युद्ध

युद्ध — *yuddh* — “a war”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

युद्ध (*yuddh*) is Sanskrit *yuddha*, “fought; battle”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 10499).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *yuddh*
- *Say it:* *yuddh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yuddh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for freedom, then the Hindi for peace, then say *yuddh* again

Before you move on

What does युद्ध mean? (“A war”.) Say it once more.

219.5 सेना (senā) — an army

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for peace, then the Hindi for a war.

You’ll want to know: सेना

सेना — *senā* — “an army”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सेना (*senā*) is Sanskrit *senā*, “army”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 13587). CDIAL lists the inherited form as *sen*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: senā*
- *Say it: senā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *senā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for peace, then the Hindi for a war, then say *senā* again

Before you move on

What does सेना mean? ("An army".) Say it once more.

Chapter 220

A flag, Childhood, Youth, Old age, Life

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a flag, childhood, youth, old age and life.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 220: I can say a flag, childhood, youth, old age and life.*

220.1 झंडा (jhaṇḍā) — a flag

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a war, then the Hindi for an army.

You'll want to know: झंडा

झंडा — *jhaṇḍā* — "a flag".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झंडा (*jhaṇḍā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dhvajadaṇḍa*, "flagstaff", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6898). It is built from *dhvaja*, "flag", and *daṇḍa*, "staff".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhaṇḍā*
- *Say it: jhaṇḍā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhaṇḍā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a war, then the Hindi for an army, then say *jhaṇḍā* again

Before you move on

What does झंडा mean? ("A flag".) Say it once more.

220.2 बचपन (bacpan) — childhood

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an army, then the Hindi for a flag.

You'll want to know: बचपन

बचपन — *bacpan* — "childhood".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बचपन (*bacpan*) is *baccā*, "child", with *-pan*, "-hood". *Baccā* is the loan usually traced to Persian *bacca*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bacpan*
- *Say it: bacpan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bacpan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an army, then the Hindi for a flag, then say *bacpan* again

Before you move on

What does बचपन mean? (“Childhood”.) Say it once more.

220.3 जवानी (javānī) — youth

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a flag, then the Hindi for childhood.

You’ll want to know: जवानी

जवानी — *javānī* — “youth”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जवानी (*javānī*) is usually traced to Persian *javānī*, “youth”. It is built on *javān*, “young”, and that word may have reached Hindi by two roads: CDIAL lists a Hindi *juwān*, “a youth”, under the inherited **yuvāna*, “young” (CDIAL 10510).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: javānī*
- *Say it: javānī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *javānī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a flag, then the Hindi for childhood, then say *javānī* again

Before you move on

What does जवानी mean? (“Youth”.) Say it once more.

220.4 बुढ़ापा (buṛhāpā) — old age

Before the new one: say the Hindi for childhood, then the Hindi for youth.

You'll want to know: बुढ़ापा

बुढ़ापा — *buṛhāpā* — "old age".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बुढ़ापा (*buṛhāpā*) is *būṛhā*, "old", with the ending -*āpā*, "-ness". CDIAL lists *būṛhā* under a reconstructed **buḍḍha*, "old" (CDIAL 9271).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: buṛhāpā*
- *Say it: buṛhāpā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *buṛhāpā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for childhood, then the Hindi for youth, then say *buṛhāpā* again

Before you move on

What does बुढ़ापा mean? ("Old age".) Say it once more.

220.5 जीवन (jīvan) — life

Before the new one: say the Hindi for youth, then the Hindi for old age.

You'll want to know: जीवन

जीवन — *jīvan* — "life".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जीवन (*jīvan*) is Sanskrit *jīvana*, “life”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 5243). CDIAL lists the inherited form as *jīan*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīvan*
- *Say it: jīvan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jīvan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for youth, then the Hindi for old age, then say *jīvan* again

Before you move on

What does जीवन mean? (“Life”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 221

Death, The future, The past, The present, Spring

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say death, the future, the past, the present and spring.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 221: I can say death, the future, the past, the present and spring.*

221.1 मौत (maut) — death

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for old age, then the Hindi for life.

You'll want to know: मौत

मौत — *maut* — "death".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मौत (*maut*) is a loan from Arabic *mawt*, "death", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *m-w-t* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maut*
- *Say it: maut*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maut*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for old age, then the Hindi for life, then say *maut* again

Before you move on

What does मौत mean? (“Death”.) Say it once more.

221.2 भविष्य (bhaviṣya) — the future

Before the new one: say the Hindi for life, then the Hindi for death.

You’ll want to know: भविष्य

भविष्य — *bhaviṣya* — “the future”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भविष्य (*bhaviṣya*) is Sanskrit *bhaviṣya*, “about to be, future”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *bhū-*, “to be”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhaviṣya*
- *Say it: bhaviṣya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhaviṣya*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for life, then the Hindi for death, then say *bhaviṣya* again

Before you move on

What does भविष्य mean? (“The future”.) Say it once more.

221.3 अतीत (atīt) — the past

Before the new one: say the Hindi for death, then the Hindi for the future.

You’ll want to know: अतीत

अतीत — *atīt* — “the past”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अतीत (*atīt*) is Sanskrit *atīta*, “gone by, past”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 220).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: atīt*
- *Say it: atīt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *atīt*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for death, then the Hindi for the future, then say *atīt* again

Before you move on

What does अतीत mean? (“The past”.) Say it once more.

221.4 वर्तमान (vartamān) — the present

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the future, then the Hindi for the past.

You'll want to know: वर्तमान

वर्तमान — *vartamān* — "the present".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वर्तमान (*vartamān*) is Sanskrit *vartamāna*, "turning, existing, present", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *vṛt-*, "to turn, to exist".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vartamān*
- *Say it: vartamān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vartamān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the future, then the Hindi for the past, then say *vartamān* again

Before you move on

What does वर्तमान mean? ("The present".) Say it once more.

221.5 वसंत (vasant) — spring

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the past, then the Hindi for the present.

You'll want to know: वसंत

वसंत — *vasant* — "spring".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

वसंत (*vasant*) is Sanskrit *vasanta*, "spring season", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 11439).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: vasant*
- *Say it: vasant*, once more
- *Say it:* say *vasant*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the past, then the Hindi for the present, then say *vasant* again

Before you move on

What does वसंत mean? ("Spring".) Say it once more.

Chapter 222

Autumn, A reason, A result, A problem, A remedy

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say autumn, a reason, a result, a problem and a remedy.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 222: I can say autumn, a reason, a result, a problem and a remedy.*

222.1 पतझड़ (patjhaṛ) — autumn

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for the present, then the Hindi for spring.

You'll want to know: पतझड़

पतझड़ — *patjhaṛ* — "autumn".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पतझड़ (*patjhaṛ*) is "leaf-fall": *pat*, "leaf", from Sanskrit *pattra* (CDIAL 7733), and *jhaṛ*, from *jhaṛnā*, "to fall", which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **jhaṭati*, "falls" (CDIAL 5328).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: patjhaṛ*
- *Say it: patjhaṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *patjhaṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the present, then the Hindi for spring, then say *patjhaṛ* again

Before you move on

What does **पतझड़** mean? (“Autumn”.) Say it once more.

222.2 कारण (kāraṇ) — a reason, a cause

Before the new one: say the Hindi for spring, then the Hindi for autumn.

You’ll want to know: कारण

कारण — *kāraṇ* — “a reason, a cause”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कारण (*kāraṇ*) is Sanskrit *kāraṇa*, “cause”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 3057). CDIAL lists the inherited form as *kāran*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāraṇ*
- *Say it: kāraṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāraṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for spring, then the Hindi for autumn, then say *kāraṇ* again

Before you move on

What does कारण mean? (“A reason, a cause”.) Say it once more.

222.3 नतीजा (natījā) — a result

Before the new one: say the Hindi for autumn, then the Hindi for a reason.

You’ll want to know: नतीजा

नतीजा — *natījā* — “a result”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नतीजा (*natījā*) is a loan from Arabic *natīja*, “result, outcome”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *n-t-j* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: natījā*
- *Say it: natījā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *natījā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for autumn, then the Hindi for a reason, then say *natījā* again

Before you move on

What does नतीजा mean? (“A result”.) Say it once more.

222.4 समस्या (samasyā) — a problem

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a reason, then the Hindi for a result.

You’ll want to know: समस्या

समस्या — *samasyā* — “a problem”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समस्या (*samasyā*) is Sanskrit *samasyā*, “a puzzle set to be completed”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. Hindi uses it for any problem.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: samasyā*
- *Say it: samasyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *samasyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a reason, then the Hindi for a result, then say *samasyā* again

Before you move on

What does समस्या mean? (“A problem”.) Say it once more.

222.5 उपाय (upāy) — a remedy, a way out

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a result, then the Hindi for a problem.

You’ll want to know: उपाय

उपाय — *upāy* — “a remedy, a way out”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उपाय (*upāy*) is Sanskrit *upāya*, “approach; means”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: upāy*
- *Say it: upāy*, once more
- *Say it:* say *upāy*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a result, then the Hindi for a problem, then say *upāy* again

Before you move on

What does **उपाय** mean? ("A remedy, a way out".) Say it once more.

Chapter 223

A habit, A hobby, A dream, Sport, A ball

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a habit, a hobby, a dream, sport and a ball.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 223: I can say a habit, a hobby, a dream, sport and a ball.*

223.1 आदत (ādat) — a habit

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a problem, then the Hindi for a remedy.

You'll want to know: आदत

आदत — *ādat* — "a habit".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आदत (*ādat*) is a loan from Arabic ^{c}*āda*, "custom, habit", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is ^{c}-*w*-*d* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ādat*
- *Say it: ādat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ādat*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a problem, then the Hindi for a remedy, then say *ādat* again

Before you move on

What does आदत mean? (“A habit”.) Say it once more.

223.2 शौक़ (śauq) — a hobby, a liking

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a remedy, then the Hindi for a habit.

You’ll want to know: शौक़

शौक़ — *śauq* — “a hobby, a liking”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शौक़ (*śauq*) is a loan from Arabic *shawq*, “longing, desire”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *sh-w-q* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śauq*
- *Say it: śauq*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śauq*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a remedy, then the Hindi for a habit, then say *śauq* again

Before you move on

What does शौक़ mean? (“A hobby, a liking”.) Say it once more.

223.3 सपना (sapnā) — a dream

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a habit, then the Hindi for a hobby.

You’ll want to know: सपना

सपना — *sapnā* — “a dream”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सपना (*sapnā*) goes back to Sanskrit *svapna*, “sleep, dream” (CDIAL 13904), though CDIAL does not list the Hindi form. The dream-words of the sister languages, such as Gujarati *samṇũ*, sit under a separate form **supna*, “dream” (CDIAL 13481), and Hindi is not among them either.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sapnā*
- *Say it: sapnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sapnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a habit, then the Hindi for a hobby, then say *sapnā* again

Before you move on

What does सपना mean? (“A dream”.) Say it once more.

223.4 खेलकूद (khelkūd) — sport, games

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a hobby, then the Hindi for a dream.

You'll want to know: खेलकूद

खेलकूद — *khelkūd* — "sport, games".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खेलकूद (*khelkūd*) is "play-and-jump": *khel*, from a reconstructed **khel-*, "play" (CDIAL 3918), and *kūd*, from Sanskrit *kūrdati*, "leaps", which CDIAL takes, probably, from Dravidian (CDIAL 3412).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khelkūd*
- *Say it: khelkūd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khelkūd*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a hobby, then the Hindi for a dream, then say *khelkūd* again

Before you move on

What does खेलकूद mean? ("Sport, games".) Say it once more.

223.5 गेंद (gẽd) — a ball

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a dream, then the Hindi for sport.

You'll want to know: गेंद

गेंद — *gẽd* — "a ball".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गेंद (*gẽd*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *genduka*, “ball for play” (CDIAL 4248). CDIAL notes that the related *kanduka* has been traced to Dravidian.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gẽd*
- *Say it: gẽd*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gẽd*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a dream, then the Hindi for sport, then say *gẽd* again

Before you move on

What does गेंद mean? (“A ball”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 224

A bat, A win, A defeat, A team, A race

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a bat, a win, a defeat, a team and a race.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 224: I can say a bat, a win, a defeat, a team and a race.*

224.1 बल्ला (ballā) — a bat

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for sport, then the Hindi for a ball.

You'll want to know: बल्ला

बल्ला — *ballā* — “a bat”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बल्ला (*ballā*) is listed by CDIAL in the sense “large beam, pole”, under Sanskrit *vala*, “beam, pole” (CDIAL 11403). The sense “bat” probably grew from it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ballā*
- *Say it: ballā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ballā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sport, then the Hindi for a ball, then say *ballā* again

Before you move on

What does बल्ला mean? (“A bat”.) Say it once more.

224.2 जीत (jīt) — a win

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a ball, then the Hindi for a bat.

You’ll want to know: जीत

जीत — *jīt* — “a win”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जीत (*jīt*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jita*, “won, conquered” (CDIAL 5224). *jīt* is the noun of *jītnā*, “to win”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jīt*
- *Say it: jīt*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jīt*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a ball, then the Hindi for a bat, then say *jīt* again

Before you move on

What does जीत mean? (“A win”.) Say it once more.

224.3 हार (hār) — a defeat

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bat, then the Hindi for a win.

You’ll want to know: हार

हार — *hār* — “a defeat”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हार (*hār*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *hārayati*, “loses” (CDIAL 14061). *hār* is the noun of *hārnā*, “to lose”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hār*
- *Say it: hār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bat, then the Hindi for a win, then say *hār* again

Before you move on

What does हार mean? (“A defeat”.) Say it once more.

224.4 टीम (ṭīm) — a team

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a win, then the Hindi for a defeat.

You’ll want to know: टीम

टीम — *ṭīm* — “a team”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टीम (*ṭīm*) is a loan from English *team*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ṭīm*
- *Say it:* *ṭīm*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭīm*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a win, then the Hindi for a defeat, then say *ṭīm* again

Before you move on

What does टीम mean? (“A team”.) Say it once more.

224.5 दौड़ (dauṛ) — a race, running

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a defeat, then the Hindi for a team.

You’ll want to know: दौड़

दौड़ — *dauṛ* — “a race, running”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दौड़ (*dauṛ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *dravati*, “runs” (CDIAL 6624). *dauṛ* is the noun of *dauṛnā*, “to run”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dauṛ*
- *Say it: dauṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dauṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a defeat, then the Hindi for a team, then say *dauṛ* again

Before you move on

What does दौड़ mean? ("A race, running".) Say it once more.

224.6 Words from chapters 218-220 — a first pass

Say the words for a team and a race.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- society, the government, a law, a court, an election
- a prison, freedom, peace, a war, an army
- a flag, childhood, youth, old age, life

Before you move on

Society? (समाज, *samāj.*) The government? (सरकार, *sarkār.*) A law? (क़ानून, *kānūn.*) A court? (अदालत, *adālat.*) An election? (चुनाव, *cunāv.*) A prison? (जेल, *jel.*) Freedom? (आज़ादी, *āzādī.*) Peace? (शांति, *śānti.*) A war? (युद्ध, *yuddh.*) An army? (सेना, *senā.*) A flag? (झंडा, *jhaṇḍā.*) Childhood? (बचपन, *bacpan.*) Youth? (जवानी, *javānī.*) Old age? (बुढ़ापा, *buṛhāpā.*) Life? (जीवन, *jīvan.*)

224.7 Words from chapters 221-224 — a second pass

Say the words for death and the future.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- death, the future, the past, the present, spring
- autumn, a reason, a result, a problem, a remedy
- a habit, a hobby, a dream, sport, a ball
- a bat, a win, a defeat, a team, a race

Before you move on

Death? (मौत, *maut.*) The future? (भविष्य, *bhaviṣya.*) The past? (अतीत, *atīt.*) The present? (वर्तमान, *vartamān.*) Spring? (वसंत, *vasant.*) Autumn? (पतझड़, *patjhaṛ.*) A reason? (कारण, *kāraṇ.*) A result? (नतीजा, *natījā.*) A problem? (समस्या, *samasyā.*) A remedy? (उपाय, *upāy.*) A habit? (आदत, *ādat.*) A hobby? (शौक़, *śauq.*) A dream? (सपना, *sapnā.*) Sport? (खेलकूद, *khelkūd.*) A ball? (गेंद, *gẽd.*) A bat? (बल्ला, *ballā.*) A win? (जीत, *jīt.*) A defeat? (हार, *hār.*) A team? (टीम, *ṭīm.*) A race? (दौड़, *dauṛ.*)

Chapter 225

To clean, To dust, To wipe, To wring, To dry

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to clean, to dust, to wipe, to wring and to dry.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 225: I can say to clean, to dust, to wipe, to wring and to dry.*

225.1 साफ़ करना (sāf karnā) — to clean

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a team, then the Hindi for a race, running.

You'll want to know: साफ़ करना

साफ़ करना — *sāf karnā* — "to clean".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

साफ़ करना (*sāf karnā*) is *sāf*, "clean", from Arabic *ṣāfī*, "pure", through Persian (Lane, root *ṣ-f-w*), with the inherited *karnā*, "to do".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāf karnā*
- *Say it: sāf karnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sāf karnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a team, then the Hindi for a race, running, then say *sāf karnā* again

Before you move on

What does साफ़ करना mean? (“To clean”.) Say it once more.

225.2 झाड़ना (jhāṛnā) — to dust, to sweep

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a race, running, then the Hindi for to clean.

You’ll want to know: झाड़ना

झाड़ना — *jhāṛnā* — “to dust, to sweep”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झाड़ना (*jhāṛnā*) is inherited. CDIAL lists it under a reconstructed **jhāṭayati*, “shakes down”, and asks whether the root is the same as in *jharnā*, “to flow” (CDIAL 5328).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhāṛnā*
- *Say it: jhāṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhāṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a race, running, then the Hindi for to clean, then say *jhāṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does झाड़ना mean? (“To dust, to sweep”.) Say it once more.

225.3 पोंछना (põchnā) — to wipe

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to clean, then the Hindi for to dust.

You’ll want to know: पोंछना

पोंछना — *põchnā* — “to wipe”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पोंछना (*põchnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *proñchati*, “wipes off” (CDIAL 9011). CDIAL suggests that the Sanskrit word itself was made over from a Middle Indo-Aryan **poṁch-*, perhaps itself from Dravidian.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: põchnā*
- *Say it: põchnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *põchnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to clean, then the Hindi for to dust, then say *põchnā* again

Before you move on

What does पोंछना mean? (“To wipe”.) Say it once more.

225.4 निचोड़ना (nicoṛnā) — to wring

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to dust, then the Hindi for to wipe.

You'll want to know: निचोड़ना

निचोड़ना — *nicoṛnā* — "to wring".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

निचोड़ना (*nicoṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **niścoṭayati*, "presses out", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 7449).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nicoṛnā*
- *Say it: nicoṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nicoṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to dust, then the Hindi for to wipe, then say *nicoṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does निचोड़ना mean? ("To wring".) Say it once more.

225.5 सुखाना (sukhānā) — to dry (something)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to wipe, then the Hindi for to wring.

You'll want to know: सुखाना

सुखाना — *sukhānā* — "to dry (something)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुखाना (*sukhānā*) is the causing form of *sūkhnā*, “to dry”, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **śuṣkati*, “becomes dry”, built on Sanskrit *śuṣka*, “dried” (CDIAL 12552).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sukhānā*
- *Say it: sukhānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sukhānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to wipe, then the Hindi for to wring, then say *sukhānā* again

Before you move on

What does सुखाना mean? (“To dry (something)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 226

To dry, To go wrong, To make, To be made, To break

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to dry, to go wrong, to make, to be made and to break.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 226: I can say to dry, to go wrong, to make, to be made and to break.*

226.1 सूखना (sūkhnā) — to dry (by itself)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to wring, then the Hindi for to dry.

You'll want to know: सूखना

सूखना — *sūkhnā* — "to dry (by itself)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सूखना (*sūkhnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **śuṣkati*, "becomes dry", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 12552). It is built on Sanskrit *śuṣka*, "dried".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūkhnā*
- *Say it: sūkhnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sūkhnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to wring, then the Hindi for to dry, then say *sūkhnā* again

Before you move on

What does सूखना mean? (“To dry (by itself)”.) Say it once more.

226.2 बिगड़ना (bigaṛnā) — to go wrong, to spoil

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to dry, then the Hindi for to dry.

You’ll want to know: बिगड़ना

बिगड़ना — *bigaṛnā* — “to go wrong, to spoil”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बिगड़ना (*bigaṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vighaṭate*, “flies apart; is marred” (CDIAL 11673).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bigaṛnā*
- *Say it: bigaṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bigaṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to dry, then the Hindi for to dry, then say *bigaṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does बिगड़ना mean? (“To go wrong, to spoil”.) Say it once more.

226.3 बनाना (banānā) — to make

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to dry, then the Hindi for to go wrong.

You’ll want to know: बनाना

बनाना — *banānā* — “to make”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बनाना (*banānā*) is the causing form of *bannā*, “to be made”, which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *vanati*, “desires, gains, makes ready” (CDIAL 11260).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: banānā*
- *Say it: banānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *banānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to dry, then the Hindi for to go wrong, then say *banānā* again

Before you move on

What does बनाना mean? (“To make”.) Say it once more.

226.4 बनना (bannā) — to be made, to become

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to go wrong, then the Hindi for to make.

You'll want to know: बनना

बनना — *bannā* — "to be made, to become".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बनना (*bannā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vanati*, "desires, gains, makes ready" (CDIAL 11260).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bannā*
- *Say it: bannā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bannā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to go wrong, then the Hindi for to make, then say *bannā* again

Before you move on

What does बनना mean? ("To be made, to become".) Say it once more.

226.5 टूटना (ṭūṭnā) — to break (by itself)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to make, then the Hindi for to be made.

You'll want to know: टूटना

टूटना — *ṭūṭnā* — “to break (by itself)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टूटना (*ṭūṭnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *truṭyati*, “is broken” (CDIAL 6065).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ṭūṭnā*
- *Say it:* *ṭūṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭūṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to make, then the Hindi for to be made, then say *ṭūṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does टूटना mean? (“To break (by itself)”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 227

To tear, To tear, To bring up, To split, To sow

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to tear, to tear, to bring up, to split and to sow.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 227: I can say to tear, to tear, to bring up, to split and to sow.*

227.1 फटना (phaṭnā) — to tear, to burst

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to be made, then the Hindi for to break.

You'll want to know: फटना

फटना — *phaṭnā* — "to tear, to burst".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फटना (*phaṭnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *sphāṭayati*, "causes to split" (CDIAL 13825). *phaṭnā* is the self-acting form, with the short vowel such verbs take.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: phaṭnā*
- *Say it: phaṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phaṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to be made, then the Hindi for to break, then say *phaṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does फटना mean? ("To tear, to burst".) Say it once more.

227.2 फाड़ना (phāṛnā) — to tear (something)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to break, then the Hindi for to tear.

You'll want to know: फाड़ना

फाड़ना — *phāṛnā* — "to tear (something)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फाड़ना (*phāṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *sphāṭayati*, "causes to split" (CDIAL 13825).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: phāṛnā*
- *Say it: phāṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phāṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to break, then the Hindi for to tear, then say *phāṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does फाड़ना mean? (“To tear (something)”.) Say it once more.

227.3 पालना (pālnā) — to bring up, to keep (animals)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to tear, then the Hindi for to tear.

You’ll want to know: पालना

पालना — *pālnā* — “to bring up, to keep (animals)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पालना (*pālnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *pālayati*, “guards, protects” (CDIAL 8129).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pālnā*
- *Say it: pālnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pālnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to tear, then the Hindi for to tear, then say *pālnā* again

Before you move on

What does पालना mean? (“To bring up, to keep (animals)”.) Say it once more.

227.4 चीरना (cīrnā) — to split, to cut open

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to tear, then the Hindi for to bring up.

You'll want to know: चीरना

चीरना — *cīrnā* — "to split, to cut open".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चीरना (*cīrnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **cīrayati*, "splits", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4844). It is built on *cīra*, "strip of cloth".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *cīrnā*
- *Say it:* *cīrnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cīrnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to tear, then the Hindi for to bring up, then say *cīrnā* again

Before you move on

What does चीरना mean? ("To split, to cut open".) Say it once more.

227.5 बोना (bonā) — to sow

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to bring up, then the Hindi for to split.

You'll want to know: बोना

बोना — *bonā* — "to sow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बोना (*bonā*) goes back to Sanskrit *vapati*, “scatters, sows” (CDIAL 11282). CDIAL marks the Hindi form as taken over from Gujarati.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bonā*
- *Say it: bonā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bonā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to bring up, then the Hindi for to split, then say *bonā* again

Before you move on

What does **बोना** mean? (“To sow”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 228

To grow, To grow, To hand over, To press, To turn

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to grow, to grow, to hand over, to press and to turn.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 228: I can say to grow, to grow, to hand over, to press and to turn.*

228.1 उगना (ugnā) — to grow, to sprout

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to split, then the Hindi for to sow.

You’ll want to know: उगना

उगना — *ugnā* — “to grow, to sprout”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उगना (*ugnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **udgāti*, “rises, comes forth”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 1954).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ugnā*
- *Say it: ugnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ugnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to split, then the Hindi for to sow, then say *ugnā* again

Before you move on

What does उगना mean? (“To grow, to sprout”.) Say it once more.

228.2 उगाना (ugānā) — to grow (plants)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to sow, then the Hindi for to grow.

You’ll want to know: उगाना

उगाना — *ugānā* — “to grow (plants)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उगाना (*ugānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **udgāti*, “rises, comes forth”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 1954). *ugānā* is its causing form, “to make spring up”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ugānā*
- *Say it: ugānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ugānā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to sow, then the Hindi for to grow, then say *ugānā* again

Before you move on

What does उगाना mean? (“To grow (plants)”.) Say it once more.

228.3 पकड़ाना (pakṛānā) — to hand over

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to grow, then the Hindi for to grow.

You’ll want to know: पकड़ाना

पकड़ाना — *pakṛānā* — “to hand over”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पकड़ाना (*pakṛānā*) is the causing form of *pakaṛnā*, “to hold”: to hand over is to make someone hold. CDIAL lists *pakaṛnā* under a reconstructed **pakkaḍ*, “seize” (CDIAL 7619).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pakṛānā*
- *Say it: pakṛānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pakṛānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to grow, then the Hindi for to grow, then say *pakṛānā* again

Before you move on

What does पकड़ाना mean? (“To hand over”.) Say it once more.

228.4 दबाना (dabānā) — to press

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to grow, then the Hindi for to hand over.

You'll want to know: दबाना

दबाना — *dabānā* — "to press".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दबाना (*dabānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dabb*, "press", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6173). CDIAL notes Master's view that it comes from Dravidian.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dabānā*
- *Say it: dabānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dabānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to grow, then the Hindi for to hand over, then say *dabānā* again

Before you move on

What does दबाना mean? ("To press".) Say it once more.

228.5 घुमाना (ghumānā) — to turn, to show around

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to hand over, then the Hindi for to press.

You’ll want to know: घुमाना

घुमाना — *ghumānā* — “to turn, to show around”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घुमाना (*ghumānā*) is the causing form of *ghūmnā*, “to wander, revolve”, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **ghummati*, “revolves” (CDIAL 4485).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghumānā*
- *Say it: ghumānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghumānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to hand over, then the Hindi for to press, then say *ghumānā* again

Before you move on

What does घुमाना mean? (“To turn, to show around”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 229

To bend, To gather up, To spread, To spread, To be left behind

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to bend, to gather up, to spread, to spread and to be left behind.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 229: I can say to bend, to gather up, to spread, to spread and to be left behind.*

229.1 मोड़ना (moṛnā) — to bend, to turn

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to press, then the Hindi for to turn.

You'll want to know: मोड़ना

मोड़ना — *moṛnā* — "to bend, to turn".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मोड़ना (*moṛnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mōṭati*, a verb known from the Sanskrit grammarians' root-lists, which CDIAL gives as the second form in its entry for *muṭati*, "twists" (CDIAL 10186). The plain *muṭati* gave Hindi the intransitive *muṛnā*, "to be turned".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: moṛnā*
- *Say it: moṛnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *moṛnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to press, then the Hindi for to turn, then say *moṛnā* again

Before you move on

What does मोड़ना mean? ("To bend, to turn".) Say it once more.

229.2 समेटना (sameṭnā) — to gather up

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to turn, then the Hindi for to bend.

You'll want to know: समेटना

समेटना — *sameṭnā* — "to gather up".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

समेटना (*sameṭnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *saṁveṣṭayati*, "wraps up" (CDIAL 13026). CDIAL notes an unexplained loss of aspiration.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sameṭnā*

- *Say it: sameṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sameṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to turn, then the Hindi for to bend, then say *sameṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does समेटना mean? ("To gather up".) Say it once more.

229.3 फैलाना (phailānā) — to spread (something)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to bend, then the Hindi for to gather up.

You'll want to know: फैलाना

फैलाना — *phailānā* — "to spread (something)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फैलाना (*phailānā*) is the causing form of *phailnā*, "to spread". CDIAL lists *phailnā* in two places: under a reconstructed **praghirati*, "flows forth" (CDIAL 8486), and under Sanskrit *prathita*, "spread out" (CDIAL 8651).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: phailānā*
- *Say it: phailānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phailānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to bend, then the Hindi for to gather up, then say *phailānā* again

Before you move on

What does फैलाना mean? (“To spread (something)”.) Say it once more.

229.4 फैलना (phailnā) — to spread

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to gather up, then the Hindi for to spread.

You’ll want to know: फैलना

फैलना — *phailnā* — “to spread”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फैलना (*phailnā*) is inherited, but CDIAL lists it in two places: under a reconstructed **praghirati*, “flows forth” (CDIAL 8486), and under Sanskrit *prathita*, “spread out” (CDIAL 8651).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: phailnā*
- *Say it: phailnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phailnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to gather up, then the Hindi for to spread, then say *phailnā* again

Before you move on

What does फैलना mean? (“To spread”.) Say it once more.

229.5 छूटना (chūṭnā) — to be left behind, to be missed

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to spread, then the Hindi for to spread.

You'll want to know: छूटना

छूटना — *chūṭnā* — "to be left behind, to be missed".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छूटना (*chūṭnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **kṣuṭyate*, "is released", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 3707).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūṭnā*
- *Say it: chūṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chūṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to spread, then the Hindi for to spread, then say *chūṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does छूटना mean? ("To be left behind, to be missed".) Say it once more.

Chapter 230

To bend down, To hang, To hang, To float, To sink

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to bend down, to hang, to hang, to float and to sink.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 230: I can say to bend down, to hang, to hang, to float and to sink.*

230.1 झुकना (jhuknā) — to bend down, to bow

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to spread, then the Hindi for to be left behind.

You'll want to know: झुकना

झुकना — *jhuknā* — "to bend down, to bow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झुकना (*jhuknā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **jhukkati*, "stoops, breaks", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5399).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhuknā*
- *Say it: jhuknā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhuknā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to spread, then the Hindi for to be left behind, then say *jhuknā* again

Before you move on

What does झुकना mean? ("To bend down, to bow".) Say it once more.

230.2 लटकना (laṭaknā) — to hang

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to be left behind, then the Hindi for to bend down.

You'll want to know: लटकना

लटकना — *laṭaknā* — "to hang".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लटकना (*laṭaknā*) probably belongs with a reconstructed **laṭṭa*, "hanging, tangled" (CDIAL 10918). CDIAL lists Sindhi *laṭkaṇu*, "to hang, dangle", and Gujarati *laṭakvũ* there, but not the Hindi verb.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laṭaknā*
- *Say it: laṭaknā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *laṭaknā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to be left behind, then the Hindi for to bend down, then say *laṭaknā* again

Before you move on

What does लटकना mean? (“To hang”.) Say it once more.

230.3 लटकाना (laṭkānā) — to hang (something)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to bend down, then the Hindi for to hang.

You’ll want to know: लटकाना

लटकाना — *laṭkānā* — “to hang (something)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लटकाना (*laṭkānā*) is the causing form of *laṭaknā*, “to hang”. It probably belongs with a reconstructed **laṭṭa*, “hanging, tangled”, where CDIAL lists Sindhi *laṭkaṇu*, “to dangle” (CDIAL 10918), but not the Hindi verbs.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: laṭkānā*
- *Say it: laṭkānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *laṭkānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to bend down, then the Hindi for to hang, then say *laṭkānā* again

Before you move on

What does लटकाना mean? (“To hang (something)”.) Say it once more.

230.4 तैराना (tairānā) — to float (something)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to hang, then the Hindi for to hang.

You'll want to know: तैराना

तैराना — *tairānā* — "to float (something)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तैराना (*tairānā*) is the causing form of *tairnā*, "to swim, float", which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *tirate*, "crosses over, sails across" (CDIAL 5821).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tairānā*
- *Say it: tairānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tairānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to hang, then the Hindi for to hang, then say *tairānā* again

Before you move on

What does तैराना mean? ("To float (something)".) Say it once more.

230.5 डूबना (ḍūbnā) — to sink, to drown

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to hang, then the Hindi for to float.

You'll want to know: डूबना

डूबना — *ḍūbnā* — "to sink, to drown".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डूबना (*ḍūbnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ḍubb*, “sink”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5561). CDIAL explains it as a Middle Indo-Aryan *buḍḍaï* with its consonants swapped.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ḍūbnā*
- *Say it: ḍūbnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍūbnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to hang, then the Hindi for to float, then say *ḍūbnā* again

Before you move on

What does डूबना mean? (“To sink, to drown”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 231

To flow, To drip, To sneeze, To yawn, To cough

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to flow, to drip, to sneeze, to yawn and to cough.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 231: I can say to flow, to drip, to sneeze, to yawn and to cough.*

231.1 बहना (bahnā) — to flow

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to float, then the Hindi for to sink.

You'll want to know: बहना

बहना — *bahnā* — "to flow".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बहना (*bahnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vahati*, "carries, bears along" (CDIAL 11453).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bahnā*
- *Say it: bahnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bahnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to float, then the Hindi for to sink, then say *bahnā* again

Before you move on

What does बहना mean? (“To flow”.) Say it once more.

231.2 टपकना (ṭapaknā) — to drip

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to sink, then the Hindi for to flow.

You’ll want to know: टपकना

टपकना — *ṭapaknā* — “to drip”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टपकना (*ṭapaknā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ṭapp*, “drip, drop”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5444). CDIAL calls it imitative of the sound.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭapaknā*
- *Say it: ṭapaknā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭapaknā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to sink, then the Hindi for to flow, then say *ṭapaknā* again

Before you move on

What does टपकना mean? (“To drip”.) Say it once more.

231.3 छींकना (chīṅknā) — to sneeze

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to flow, then the Hindi for to drip.

You’ll want to know: छींकना

छींकना — *chīṅknā* — “to sneeze”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छींकना (*chīṅknā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *chikkā*, “sneeze” (CDIAL 5032). CDIAL calls it imitative of the sound.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chīṅknā*
- *Say it: chīṅknā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chīṅknā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to flow, then the Hindi for to drip, then say *chīṅknā* again

Before you move on

What does छींकना mean? (“To sneeze”.) Say it once more.

231.4 जम्हाई लेना (jamhāī lenā) — to yawn

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to drip, then the Hindi for to sneeze.

You'll want to know: जम्हाई लेना

जम्हाई लेना — *jamhāī lenā* — "to yawn".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जम्हाई लेना (*jamhāī lenā*) is "to take a yawn". *jamhāī*, "a yawn", comes from a reconstructed **jr̥mbhāyita*, "yawning" (CDIAL 5266), and *lenā*, "to take", from Sanskrit *labhate* (CDIAL 10948).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jamhāī lenā*
- *Say it: jamhāī lenā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jamhāī lenā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to drip, then the Hindi for to sneeze, then say *jamhāī lenā* again

Before you move on

What does जम्हाई लेना mean? ("To yawn".) Say it once more.

231.5 खाँसना (khā̃snā) — to cough

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to sneeze, then the Hindi for to yawn.

You'll want to know: खाँसना

खाँसना — *khā̃snā* — "to cough".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खाँसना (*khāṁsnā*) is the verb belonging to *khāṁsī*, “a cough”, which comes from Sanskrit *kāsa*, “cough” (CDIAL 3138). CDIAL notes the *kh-* as imitating the sound.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khā̃snā*
- *Say it: khā̃snā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khā̃snā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to sneeze, then the Hindi for to yawn, then say *khā̃snā* again

Before you move on

What does **खाँसना** mean? (“To cough”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 232

To shiver, To smile, To scream, To whisper, To scold

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say to shiver, to smile, to scream, to whisper and to scold.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 232: I can say to shiver, to smile, to scream, to whisper and to scold.*

232.1 काँपना (kā̃pnā) — to shiver, to tremble

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to yawn, then the Hindi for to cough.

You’ll want to know: काँपना

काँपना — *kā̃pnā* — “to shiver, to tremble”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

काँपना (*kāṁpnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kampate*, “trembles, shivers” (CDIAL 2767).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kā̃pnā*
- *Say it: kā̃pnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kā̃pnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to yawn, then the Hindi for to cough, then say *kā̃pnā* again

Before you move on

What does काँपना mean? (“To shiver, to tremble”.) Say it once more.

232.2 मुस्कुराना (muskurānā) — to smile

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to cough, then the Hindi for to shiver.

You’ll want to know: मुस्कुराना

मुस्कुराना — *muskurānā* — “to smile”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मुस्कुराना (*muskurānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **muss*, “smile, sob”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 10227). CDIAL notes an added -*k*-.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muskurānā*
- *Say it: muskurānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muskurānā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to cough, then the Hindi for to shiver, then say *muskurānā* again

Before you move on

What does मुस्कुराना mean? (“To smile”.) Say it once more.

232.3 चीखना (cīkhnā) — to scream

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to shiver, then the Hindi for to smile.

You’ll want to know: चीखना

चीखना — *cīkhnā* — “to scream”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of चीखना (*cīkhnā*) is uncertain. CDIAL lists a *cīkhnā* only in the sense “to taste” (CDIAL 4557), which is a different word. It may be imitative, like *cĩghāṛnā*, “to screech” (CDIAL 4787).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cīkhnā*
- *Say it: cīkhnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cīkhnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to shiver, then the Hindi for to smile, then say *cīkhnā* again

Before you move on

What does चीखना mean? (“To scream”.) Say it once more.

232.4 फुसफुसाना (phusphusānā) — to whisper

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to smile, then the Hindi for to scream.

You'll want to know: फुसफुसाना

फुसफुसाना — *phusphusānā* — "to whisper".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फुसफुसाना (*phusphusānā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **phuss*, "hissing, whispering", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9099). CDIAL lists Hindi *phusphus*, "hissing".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: phusphusānā*
- *Say it: phusphusānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phusphusānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to smile, then the Hindi for to scream, then say *phusphusānā* again

Before you move on

What does फुसफुसाना mean? ("To whisper".) Say it once more.

232.5 डाँटना (ḍā̃ṭnā) — to scold

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to scream, then the Hindi for to whisper.

You’ll want to know: डाँटना

डाँटना — *ḍā̃ṭnā* — “to scold”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डाँटना (*ḍāṁṭnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **draṭ*, “press”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6618). CDIAL glosses the Hindi word “to threaten, check”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *ḍā̃ṭnā*
- *Say it:* *ḍā̃ṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍā̃ṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to scream, then the Hindi for to whisper, then say *ḍā̃ṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does डाँटना mean? (“To scold”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 233

North, South, East, West, Right

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say north, south, east, west and right.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 233: I can say north, south, east, west and right.*

233.1 उत्तर (uttar) — north

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for to whisper, then the Hindi for to scold.

You'll want to know: उत्तर

उत्तर — *uttar* — "north".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उत्तर (*uttar*) is Sanskrit *uttara*, "upper; northern", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 1767). CDIAL lists the inherited form as *ūtar*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uttar*
- *Say it: uttar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uttar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to whisper, then the Hindi for to scold, then say *uttar* again

Before you move on

What does **उत्तर** mean? (“North”.) Say it once more.

233.2 दक्षिण (dakṣiṇ) — south

Before the new one: say the Hindi for to scold, then the Hindi for north.

You’ll want to know: दक्षिण

दक्षिण — *dakṣiṇ* — “south”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दक्षिण (*dakṣiṇ*) is Sanskrit *dakṣiṇa*, “right (hand); southern”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 6119). CDIAL lists the inherited forms as *dakkhin* and *dakhin*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dakṣiṇ*
- *Say it: dakṣiṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dakṣiṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for to scold, then the Hindi for north, then say *dakṣiṇ* again

Before you move on

What does दक्षिण mean? (“South”.) Say it once more.

233.3 पूर्व (pūrv) — east

Before the new one: say the Hindi for north, then the Hindi for south.

You’ll want to know: पूर्व

पूर्व — *pūrv* — “east”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पूर्व (*pūrv*) is Sanskrit *pūrva*, “fore, first, eastern”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 8343).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pūrv*
- *Say it: pūrv*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pūrv*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for north, then the Hindi for south, then say *pūrv* again

Before you move on

What does पूर्व mean? (“East”.) Say it once more.

233.4 पश्चिम (paścim) — west

Before the new one: say the Hindi for south, then the Hindi for east.

You’ll want to know: पश्चिम

पश्चिम — *paścim* — “west”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पश्चिम (*paścim*) is Sanskrit *paścima*, “hinder; western”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *paścim*
- *Say it:* *paścim*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paścim*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for south, then the Hindi for east, then say *paścim* again

Before you move on

What does पश्चिम mean? (“West”.) Say it once more.

233.5 दायाँ (dāyā̃) — right (side)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for east, then the Hindi for west.

You’ll want to know: दायाँ

दायाँ — *dāyā̃* — “right (side)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दायाँ (*dāyāṁ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *dākṣiṇa*, “relating to the right; southern” (CDIAL 6251). CDIAL notes that its form was crossed with *vāma*, “left”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāyā̃*
- *Say it: dāyā̃*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dāyā̃*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for east, then the Hindi for west, then say *dāyā̃* again

Before you move on

What does दायाँ mean? (“Right (side)”.) Say it once more.

233.6 Words from chapters 225-228 — a first pass

Say the words for west and right.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to clean, to dust, to wipe, to wring, to dry
- to dry, to go wrong, to make, to be made, to break
- to tear, to tear, to bring up, to split, to sow
- to grow, to grow, to hand over, to press, to turn

Before you move on

To clean? (साफ़ करना, *sāf karnā*.) To dust? (झाड़ना, *jhāṛnā*.) To wipe? (पोंछना, *põchnā*.) To wring? (निचोड़ना, *nicoṛnā*.) To dry? (सुखाना, *sukhānā*.) To dry? (सूखना, *sūkhnā*.) To go wrong? (बिगड़ना, *bigaṛnā*.) To make? (बनाना, *banānā*.) To be made? (बनना, *bannā*.)

To break? (टूटना, *ṭūṭnā.*) To tear? (फटना, *phaṭnā.*) To tear? (फाड़ना, *phāṛnā.*) To bring up? (पालना, *pālnā.*) To split? (चीरना, *cīrnā.*) To sow? (बोना, *bonā.*) To grow? (उगना, *ugnā.*) To grow? (उगाना, *ugānā.*) To hand over? (पकड़ाना, *pakṛānā.*) To press? (दबाना, *dabānā.*) To turn? (घुमाना, *ghumānā.*)

233.7 Words from chapters 229-233 — a second pass

Say the words for to bend and to gather up.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- to bend, to gather up, to spread, to spread, to be left behind
- to bend down, to hang, to hang, to float, to sink
- to flow, to drip, to sneeze, to yawn, to cough
- to shiver, to smile, to scream, to whisper, to scold
- north, south, east, west, right

Before you move on

To bend? (मोड़ना, *moṛnā.*) To gather up? (समेटना, *sameṭnā.*) To spread? (फैलाना, *phailānā.*) To spread? (फैलना, *phailnā.*) To be left behind? (छूटना, *chūṭnā.*) To bend down? (झुकना, *jhuknā.*) To hang? (लटकना, *laṭaknā.*) To hang? (लटकाना, *laṭkānā.*) To float? (तैराना, *tairānā.*) To sink? (डूबना, *ḍūbnā.*) To flow? (बहना, *bahnā.*) To drip? (टपकना, *ṭapaknā.*) To sneeze? (छींकना, *chīṅknā.*) To yawn? (जम्हाई लेना, *jamhāī lenā.*) To cough? (खाँसना, *khā̃snā.*) To shiver? (काँपना, *kā̃pnā.*) To smile? (मुस्कुराना, *muskurānā.*) To scream? (चीखना, *cīkhnā.*) To whisper? (फुसफुसाना, *phusphusānā.*) To scold? (डाँटना, *ḍā̃ṭnā.*) North? (उत्तर, *uttar.*) South? (दक्षिण, *dakṣiṇ.*) East? (पूर्व, *pūrv.*) West? (पश्चिम, *paścim.*) Right? (दायाँ, *dāyā̃.*)

Chapter 234

Left, Straight, Upside down, The middle, A corner

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say left, straight, upside down, the middle and a corner.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 234: I can say left, straight, upside down, the middle and a corner.*

234.1 बायाँ (bāyā̃) — left (side)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for west, then the Hindi for right (side).

You'll want to know: बायाँ

बायाँ — *bāyā̃* — "left (side)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बायाँ (*bāyāṁ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vāma*, "lefthand" (CDIAL 11533).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bāyā̃*
- *Say it:* *bāyā̃*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bāyā̃*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for west, then the Hindi for right (side), then say *bāyā̃* again

Before you move on

What does बायाँ mean? (“Left (side)”.) Say it once more.

234.2 सीधा (sīdhā) — straight, direct

Before the new one: say the Hindi for right (side), then the Hindi for left.

You’ll want to know: सीधा

सीधा — *sīdhā* — “straight, direct”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सीधा (*sīdhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *siddha*, “accomplished, perfected” (CDIAL 13401). CDIAL glosses the Hindi word “straight, honest”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *sīdhā*
- *Say it:* *sīdhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sīdhā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for right (side), then the Hindi for left, then say *sīdhā* again

Before you move on

What does सीधा mean? (“Straight, direct”.) Say it once more.

234.3 उल्टा (ulṭā) — upside down, reversed

Before the new one: say the Hindi for left, then the Hindi for straight.

You’ll want to know: उल्टा

उल्टा — *ulṭā* — “upside down, reversed”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उल्टा (*ulṭā*) belongs with *ulaṭnā*, “to be overturned”, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **ullaṭati*, “turns over” (CDIAL 2368).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ulṭā*
- *Say it: ulṭā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ulṭā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for left, then the Hindi for straight, then say *ulṭā* again

Before you move on

What does उल्टा mean? (“Upside down, reversed”.) Say it once more.

234.4 बीच (bīc) — the middle

Before the new one: say the Hindi for straight, then the Hindi for upside down.

You'll want to know: बीच

बीच — *bīc* — "the middle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बीच (*bīc*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **vīcya*, "middle", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 12042). CDIAL compares Vedic *vīcyā*, "among".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bīc*
- *Say it:* *bīc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bīc*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for straight, then the Hindi for upside down, then say *bīc* again

Before you move on

What does बीच mean? ("The middle".) Say it once more.

234.5 कोना (konā) — a corner

Before the new one: say the Hindi for upside down, then the Hindi for the middle.

You'll want to know: कोना

कोना — *konā* — "a corner".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कोना (*konā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *koṇa*, "corner, angle" (CDIAL 3504). CDIAL, after Burrow, takes the Sanskrit word from Dravidian.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: konā*
- *Say it: konā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *konā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for upside down, then the Hindi for the middle, then say *konā* again

Before you move on

What does कोना mean? ("A corner".) Say it once more.

Chapter 235

Up, Down, Ahead, Behind, Inside

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say up, down, ahead, behind and inside.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 235: I can say up, down, ahead, behind and inside.*

235.1 ऊपर (ūpar) — up, above

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for the middle, then the Hindi for a corner.

You'll want to know: ऊपर

ऊपर — *ūpar* — "up, above".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ऊपर (*ūpar*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **uppari*, "above", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 2333). It is Sanskrit *upari*, "above", with its consonant doubled for emphasis.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ūpar*
- *Say it: ūpar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ūpar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the middle, then the Hindi for a corner, then say *ūpar* again

Before you move on

What does ऊपर mean? (“Up, above”.) Say it once more.

235.2 नीचे (nīce) — down, below

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a corner, then the Hindi for up.

You’ll want to know: नीचे

नीचे — *nīce* — “down, below”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नीचे (*nīce*) is the adverb form of *nīcā*, “low”, which comes from Sanskrit *nīca*, “low” (CDIAL 7540).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nīce*
- *Say it: nīce*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nīce*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a corner, then the Hindi for up, then say *nīce* again

Before you move on

What does नीचे mean? (“Down, below”.) Say it once more.

235.3 आगे (āge) — ahead, in front

Before the new one: say the Hindi for up, then the Hindi for down.

You’ll want to know: आगे

आगे — *āge* — “ahead, in front”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आगे (*āge*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *agra*, “top, front” (CDIAL 68). *āge* continues the Sanskrit forms *agre*, *agreṇa*, “in front”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āge*
- *Say it: āge*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āge*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for up, then the Hindi for down, then say *āge* again

Before you move on

What does आगे mean? (“Ahead, in front”.) Say it once more.

235.4 पीछे (pīche) — behind

Before the new one: say the Hindi for down, then the Hindi for ahead.

You'll want to know: पीछे

पीछे — *pīche* — "behind".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पीछे (*pīche*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **paśca*, "hinder part", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 7990). *pīche* is an old case form that took the place of Sanskrit *paścāt*, "behind".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pīche*
- *Say it: pīche*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pīche*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for down, then the Hindi for ahead, then say *pīche* again

Before you move on

What does पीछे mean? ("Behind".) Say it once more.

235.5 अंदर (andar) — inside

Before the new one: say the Hindi for ahead, then the Hindi for behind.

You’ll want to know: अंदर

अंदर — *andar* — “inside”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अंदर (*andar*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *andar*, “inside”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: andar*
- *Say it: andar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *andar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for ahead, then the Hindi for behind, then say *andar* again

Before you move on

What does अंदर mean? (“Inside”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 236

Half, Whole, Double, Separate, Round

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say half, whole, double, separate and round.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 236: I can say half, whole, double, separate and round.*

236.1 आधा (ādhā) — half

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for behind, then the Hindi for inside.

You’ll want to know: आधा

आधा — *ādhā* — “half”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आधा (*ādhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ardha*, “half” (CDIAL 644).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ādhā*
- *Say it: ādhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ādhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for behind, then the Hindi for inside, then say *ādhā* again

Before you move on

What does आधा mean? ("Half".) Say it once more.

236.2 पूरा (pūrā) — whole, complete

Before the new one: say the Hindi for inside, then the Hindi for half.

You'll want to know: पूरा

पूरा — *pūrā* — "whole, complete".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पूरा (*pūrā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *pūra*, "filling" (CDIAL 8330). It is built on *pṛ*-, "to fill".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pūrā*
- *Say it: pūrā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pūrā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for inside, then the Hindi for half, then say *pūrā* again

Before you move on

What does पूरा mean? (“Whole, complete”.) Say it once more.

236.3 दुगना (dugnā) — double

Before the new one: say the Hindi for half, then the Hindi for whole.

You’ll want to know: दुगना

दुगना — *dugnā* — “double”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दुगना (*dugnā*) belongs with Hindi *dūnā*, “double”, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **duguṇa*, “double”, beside Sanskrit *dviguṇa* (CDIAL 6390).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dugnā*
- *Say it: dugnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dugnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for half, then the Hindi for whole, then say *dugnā* again

Before you move on

What does दुगना mean? (“Double”.) Say it once more.

236.4 अलग (alag) — separate, different

Before the new one: say the Hindi for whole, then the Hindi for double.

You'll want to know: अलग

अलग — *alag* — "separate, different".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अलग (*alag*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *alagna*, "unconnected" (CDIAL 700). It is *lagna*, "attached", with *a*-, "not".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: alag*
- *Say it: alag*, once more
- *Say it:* say *alag*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for whole, then the Hindi for double, then say *alag* again

Before you move on

What does अलग mean? ("Separate, different".) Say it once more.

236.5 गोल (gol) — round

Before the new one: say the Hindi for double, then the Hindi for separate.

You'll want to know: गोल

गोल — *gol* — "round".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गोल (*gol*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *gola*, "ball" (CDIAL 4321).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gol*
- *Say it: gol*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gol*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for double, then the Hindi for separate, then say *gol* again

Before you move on

What does **गोल** mean? ("Round".) Say it once more.

Chapter 237

Square, Triangular, Narrow, Shallow, Stale

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say square, triangular, narrow, shallow and stale.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 237: I can say square, triangular, narrow, shallow and stale.*

237.1 चौकोर (caukor) — square

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for separate, then the Hindi for round.

You’ll want to know: चौकोर

चौकोर — *caukor* — “square”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चौकोर (*caukor*) is “four-edged”: *cau-*, “four”, and *kor*, “edge, side”, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **korā*, “edge” (CDIAL 3531).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: caukor*
- *Say it: caukor*, once more
- *Say it:* say *caukor*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for separate, then the Hindi for round, then say *caukor* again

Before you move on

What does **चौकोर** mean? (“Square”.) Say it once more.

237.2 तिकोना (tikoṇā) — triangular

Before the new one: say the Hindi for round, then the Hindi for square.

You’ll want to know: तिकोना

तिकोना — *tikoṇā* — “triangular”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तिकोना (*tikoṇā*) is “three-cornered”: *ti-*, “three”, and *koṇ*, “corner”, from Sanskrit *koṇa*, which CDIAL takes from Dravidian (CDIAL 3504).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tikoṇā*
- *Say it: tikoṇā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tikoṇā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for round, then the Hindi for square, then say *tikoṇā* again

Before you move on

What does तिकोना mean? (“Triangular”.) Say it once more.

237.3 संकरा (saṅkarā) — narrow

Before the new one: say the Hindi for square, then the Hindi for triangular.

You’ll want to know: संकरा

संकरा — *saṅkarā* — “narrow”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

संकरा (*saṅkarā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *saṁkaṭa*, “contracted, narrow” (CDIAL 12817).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: saṅkarā*
- *Say it: saṅkarā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *saṅkarā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for square, then the Hindi for triangular, then say *saṅkarā* again

Before you move on

What does संकरा mean? (“Narrow”.) Say it once more.

237.4 उथला (uthlā) — shallow

Before the new one: say the Hindi for triangular, then the Hindi for narrow.

You’ll want to know: उथला

उथला — *uthlā* — “shallow”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उथला (*uthlā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ut-sthala*, “shallow”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 1899). It is built on *sthala*, “dry land”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: uthlā*
- *Say it: uthlā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *uthlā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for triangular, then the Hindi for narrow, then say *uthlā* again

Before you move on

What does उथला mean? (“Shallow”.) Say it once more.

237.5 बासी (bāsī) — stale

Before the new one: say the Hindi for narrow, then the Hindi for shallow.

You’ll want to know: बासी

बासी — *bāsī* — “stale”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बासी (*bāsī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vāsita*, “infused, scented” (CDIAL

11604). The sense turned from “scented” to “smelling, stale”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāsī*
- *Say it: bāsī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bāsī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for narrow, then the Hindi for shallow, then say *bāsī* again

Before you move on

What does बासी mean? (“Stale”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 238

Raw, Lukewarm, Dry, Sticky, Rough

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say raw, lukewarm, dry, sticky and rough.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 238: I can say raw, lukewarm, dry, sticky and rough.*

238.1 कच्चा (kaccā) — raw, unripe

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for shallow, then the Hindi for stale.

You'll want to know: कच्चा

कच्चा — *kaccā* — "raw, unripe".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कच्चा (*kaccā*) goes back to a reconstructed **kacca*, "raw, unripe" (CDIAL 2613). CDIAL lists Hindi *kācā* and marks *kaccā* as taken over from Punjabi.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaccā*
- *Say it: kaccā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaccā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for shallow, then the Hindi for stale, then say *kaccā* again

Before you move on

What does कच्चा mean? (“Raw, unripe”.) Say it once more.

238.2 गुनगुना (gunguna̅) — lukewarm

Before the new one: say the Hindi for stale, then the Hindi for raw.

You’ll want to know: गुनगुना

गुनगुना — *gungunā* — “lukewarm”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of गुनगुना (*gungunā*) is uncertain. CDIAL lists a *gungun* only in the sense “murmur” (CDIAL 4013).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gungunā*
- *Say it: gungunā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gungunā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for stale, then the Hindi for raw, then say *gungunā* again

Before you move on

What does गुनगुना mean? (“Lukewarm”.) Say it once more.

238.3 रूखा (rūkhā) — dry, rough

Before the new one: say the Hindi for raw, then the Hindi for lukewarm.

You’ll want to know: रूखा

रूखा — *rūkhā* — “dry, rough”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रूखा (*rūkhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *rūkṣa*, “dry, rough” (CDIAL 10799).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rūkhā*
- *Say it: rūkhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rūkhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for raw, then the Hindi for lukewarm, then say *rūkhā* again

Before you move on

What does रूखा mean? (“Dry, rough”.) Say it once more.

238.4 चिपचिपा (cipcipā) — sticky

Before the new one: say the Hindi for lukewarm, then the Hindi for dry.

You’ll want to know: चिपचिपा

चिपचिपा — *cipcipā* — “sticky”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चिपचिपा (*cipcipā*) doubles a syllable *cip-*, “sticky”. CDIAL lists a reconstructed **cippa*, “gummy matter”, and Hindi *cippī*, “a piece stuck on” (CDIAL 4819), but not *cipcipā* itself.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cipcipā*
- *Say it: cipcipā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cipcipā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for lukewarm, then the Hindi for dry, then say *cipcipā* again

Before you move on

What does चिपचिपा mean? (“Sticky”.) Say it once more.

238.5 खुरदुरा (khurdurā) — rough (to the touch)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for dry, then the Hindi for sticky.

You’ll want to know: खुरदुरा

खुरदुरा — *khurdurā* — “rough (to the touch)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of खुरदुरा (*khurdurā*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khurdurā*
- *Say it: khurdurā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khurdurā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for dry, then the Hindi for sticky, then say *khurdurā* again

Before you move on

What does **खुरदुरा** mean? ("Rough (to the touch)".) Say it once more.

Chapter 239

Shiny, Hazy, Deserted, Crowded, Inhabited

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say shiny, hazy, deserted, crowded and inhabited.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 239: I can say shiny, hazy, deserted, crowded and inhabited.*

239.1 चमकदार (camakdār) — shiny

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for sticky, then the Hindi for rough.

You’ll want to know: चमकदार

चमकदार — *camakdār* — “shiny”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चमकदार (*camakdār*) is *camak*, “shine”, from *camaknā*, “to glitter”, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **camakka*, “sudden movement” (CDIAL 4676), with the Persian ending -*dār*, “holder”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: camakdār*
- *Say it: camakdār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *camakdār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for sticky, then the Hindi for rough, then say *camakdār* again

Before you move on

What does चमकदार mean? (“Shiny”.) Say it once more.

239.2 धुंधला (dhũdhlā) — hazy, blurred

Before the new one: say the Hindi for rough, then the Hindi for shiny.

You’ll want to know: धुंधला

धुंधला — *dhũdhlā* — “hazy, blurred”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धुंधला (*dhũdhlā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dhūmāndha*, “dim-sighted”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6858). It is built from *dhūma*, “smoke”, and *andha*, “blind”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhũdhlā*
- *Say it: dhũdhlā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhũdhlā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for rough, then the Hindi for shiny, then say *dhũdhlā* again

Before you move on

What does धुंधला mean? (“Hazy, blurred”.) Say it once more.

239.3 सुनसान (sunsān) — deserted

Before the new one: say the Hindi for shiny, then the Hindi for hazy.

You’ll want to know: सुनसान

सुनसान — *sunsān* — “deserted”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of सुनसान (*sunsān*) is uncertain. It may be built on *sūn*, “empty”, which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *śūnya*, “empty” (CDIAL 12567), but CDIAL does not list *sunsān* itself.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sunsān*
- *Say it: sunsān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sunsān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for shiny, then the Hindi for hazy, then say *sunsān* again

Before you move on

What does सुनसान mean? (“Deserted”.) Say it once more.

239.4 भीड़भाड़ (bhīṛbhāṛ) — crowded, bustle

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for hazy, then the Hindi for deserted.

You'll want to know: भीड़भाड़

भीड़भाड़ — *bhīṛbhāṛ* — "crowded, bustle".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भीड़भाड़ (*bhīṛbhāṛ*) is *bhīṛ*, "crowd", which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **bhiṭ*, "meet, throng" (CDIAL 9490), with a rhyming partner *bhāṛ*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bhīṛbhāṛ*
- *Say it:* *bhīṛbhāṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhīṛbhāṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for hazy, then the Hindi for deserted, then say *bhīṛbhāṛ* again

Before you move on

What does भीड़भाड़ mean? ("Crowded, bustle".) Say it once more.

239.5 आबाद (ābād) — inhabited, lively

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for deserted, then the Hindi for crowded.

You'll want to know: आबाद

आबाद — *ābād* — "inhabited, lively".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आबाद (*ābād*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *ābād*, “inhabited, flourishing”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ābād*
- *Say it: ābād*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ābād*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for deserted, then the Hindi for crowded, then say *ābād* again

Before you move on

What does **आबाद** mean? (“Inhabited, lively”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 240

Modern, Ancient, Local, Foreign, Local

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say modern, ancient, local, foreign and local.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 240: I can say modern, ancient, local, foreign and local.*

240.1 आधुनिक (ādhunik) — modern

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for crowded, then the Hindi for inhabited.

You’ll want to know: आधुनिक

आधुनिक — *ādhunik* — “modern”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आधुनिक (*ādhunik*) is Sanskrit *ādhunika*, “recent”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *adhunā*, “now” (CDIAL 268).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ādhunik*
- *Say it: ādhunik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ādhunik*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for crowded, then the Hindi for inhabited, then say *ādhunik* again

Before you move on

What does आधुनिक mean? (“Modern”.) Say it once more.

240.2 प्राचीन (prācīn) — ancient

Before the new one: say the Hindi for inhabited, then the Hindi for modern.

You’ll want to know: प्राचीन

प्राचीन — *prācīn* — “ancient”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

प्राचीन (*prācīn*) is Sanskrit *prācīna*, “turned east; former, old”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: prācīn*
- *Say it: prācīn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *prācīn*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for inhabited, then the Hindi for modern, then say *prācīn* again

Before you move on

What does प्राचीन mean? (“Ancient”.) Say it once more.

240.3 स्थानीय (sthānīya) — local

Before the new one: say the Hindi for modern, then the Hindi for ancient.

You’ll want to know: स्थानीय

स्थानीय — *sthānīya* — “local”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

स्थानीय (*sthānīya*) is Sanskrit *sthānīya*, “of a place”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *sthāna*, “place” (CDIAL 13753).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sthānīya*
- *Say it: sthānīya*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sthānīya*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for modern, then the Hindi for ancient, then say *sthānīya* again

Before you move on

What does स्थानीय mean? (“Local”.) Say it once more.

240.4 विदेशी (videśī) — foreign

Before the new one: say the Hindi for ancient, then the Hindi for local.

You'll want to know: विदेशी

विदेशी — *videśī* — "foreign".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

विदेशी (*videśī*) is Sanskrit *videśa*, "a foreign land", taken over whole as a tatsama, with the ending -*ī*, "of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: videśī*
- *Say it: videśī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *videśī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for ancient, then the Hindi for local, then say *videśī* again

Before you move on

What does विदेशी mean? ("Foreign".) Say it once more.

240.5 देसी (desī) — local, homemade

Before the new one: say the Hindi for local, then the Hindi for foreign.

You'll want to know: देसी

देसी — *desī* — "local, homemade".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

देसी (*desī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *deśīya*, “belonging to a country, native” (CDIAL 6555).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: desī*
- *Say it: desī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *desī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for local, then the Hindi for foreign, then say *desī* again

Before you move on

What does देसी mean? (“Local, homemade”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 241

Government, Private, Free, Valuable, Unusual

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say government, private, free, valuable and unusual.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 241: I can say government, private, free, valuable and unusual.*

241.1 सरकारी (sarkārī) — government, official

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for foreign, then the Hindi for local.

You'll want to know: सरकारी

सरकारी — *sarkārī* — "government, official".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सरकारी (*sarkārī*) is *sarkār*, "government", usually traced to Persian *sarkār*, with the ending -*ī*, "of".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sarkārī*
- *Say it: sarkārī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sarkārī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for foreign, then the Hindi for local, then say *sarkārī* again

Before you move on

What does सरकारी mean? (“Government, official”.) Say it once more.

241.2 निजी (nijī) — private

Before the new one: say the Hindi for local, then the Hindi for government.

You’ll want to know: निजी

निजी — *nijī* — “private”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

निजी (*nijī*) is Sanskrit *nija*, “one’s own”, taken over whole as a tatsama, with the ending -*ī*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nijī*
- *Say it: nijī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nijī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for local, then the Hindi for government, then say *nijī* again

Before you move on

What does निजी mean? (“Private”.) Say it once more.

241.3 मुफ़्त (muft) — free (of charge)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for government, then the Hindi for private.

You’ll want to know: मुफ़्त

मुफ़्त — *muft* — “free (of charge)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मुफ़्त (*muft*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *muft*, “free, gratis”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: muft*
- *Say it: muft*, once more
- *Say it:* say *muft*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for government, then the Hindi for private, then say *muft* again

Before you move on

What does मुफ़्त mean? (“Free (of charge)”.) Say it once more.

241.4 क़ीमती (kīmtī) — valuable

Before the new one: say the Hindi for private, then the Hindi for free.

You'll want to know: क़ीमती

क़ीमती — *kīmtī* — “valuable”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क़ीमती (*kīmtī*) is *kīmat*, “price”, from Arabic *qīma*, “value”, through Persian (Lane, root *q-w-m*), with the ending -*ī*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kīmtī*
- *Say it: kīmtī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kīmtī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for private, then the Hindi for free, then say *kīmtī* again

Before you move on

What does क़ीमती mean? (“Valuable”.) Say it once more.

241.5 अनोखा (anokhā) — unusual, unique

Before the new one: say the Hindi for free, then the Hindi for valuable.

You'll want to know: अनोखा

अनोखा — *anokhā* — “unusual, unique”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अनोखा (*anokhā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *anapekṣa*, “careless, unconsidered” (CDIAL 289). Prakrit *ṇokkha* meant “unexpected, strange”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: anokhā*
- *Say it: anokhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *anokhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for free, then the Hindi for valuable, then say *anokhā* again

Before you move on

What does **अनोखा** mean? ("Unusual, unique".) Say it once more.

Chapter 242

Ordinary, Special, Famous, Useless, Successful

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say ordinary, special, famous, useless and successful.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 242: I can say ordinary, special, famous, useless and successful.*

242.1 साधारण (sādhāraṇ) — ordinary

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for valuable, then the Hindi for unusual.

You'll want to know: साधारण

साधारण — *sādhāraṇ* — "ordinary".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

साधारण (*sādhāraṇ*) is Sanskrit *sādhāraṇa*, "common, general", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sādhāraṇ*
- *Say it: sādhāraṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sādhāraṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for valuable, then the Hindi for unusual, then say *sādhāraṇ* again

Before you move on

What does साधारण mean? (“Ordinary”.) Say it once more.

242.2 ख़ास (khās) — special

Before the new one: say the Hindi for unusual, then the Hindi for ordinary.

You’ll want to know: ख़ास

ख़ास — *khās* — “special”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ख़ास (*khās*) is a loan from Arabic *khāṣṣ*, “particular, special”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *kh-ṣ-ṣ* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khās*
- *Say it: khās*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khās*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for unusual, then the Hindi for ordinary, then say *khās* again

Before you move on

What does ख़ास mean? (“Special”.) Say it once more.

242.3 मशहूर (maśhūr) — famous

Before the new one: say the Hindi for ordinary, then the Hindi for special.

You’ll want to know: मशहूर

मशहूर — *maśhūr* — “famous”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मशहूर (*maśhūr*) is a loan from Arabic *mashhūr*, “well known”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *sh-h-r* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maśhūr*
- *Say it: maśhūr*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maśhūr*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for ordinary, then the Hindi for special, then say *maśhūr* again

Before you move on

What does मशहूर mean? (“Famous”.) Say it once more.

242.4 बेकार (bekār) — useless

Before the new one: say the Hindi for special, then the Hindi for famous.

You’ll want to know: बेकार

बेकार — *bekār* — “useless”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बेकार (*bekār*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *bēkār*, “idle, useless”. It is built from *bē*-, “without”, and *kār*, “work”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *bekār*
- *Say it:* *bekār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bekār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for special, then the Hindi for famous, then say *bekār* again

Before you move on

What does बेकार mean? (“Useless”.) Say it once more.

242.5 कामयाब (kāmyāb) — successful

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for famous, then the Hindi for useless.

You’ll want to know: कामयाब

कामयाब — *kāmyāb* — “successful”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कामयाब (*kāmyāb*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kāmyāb*, “successful”. It is built from *kām*, “desire”, and *yāb*, “finding”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāmyāb*
- *Say it: kāmyāb*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāmyāb*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for famous, then the Hindi for useless, then say *kāmyāb* again

Before you move on

What does कामयाब mean? ("Successful".) Say it once more.

242.6 Words from chapters 234-237 — a first pass

Say the words for useless and successful.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- left, straight, upside down, the middle, a corner
- up, down, ahead, behind, inside
- half, whole, double, separate, round
- square, triangular, narrow, shallow, stale

Before you move on

Left? (बायाँ, *bāyā̃.*) Straight? (सीधा, *sīdhā.*) Upside down? (उल्टा, *ulṭā.*) The middle? (बीच, *bīc.*) A corner? (कोना, *konā.*) Up? (ऊपर, *ūpar.*) Down? (नीचे, *nīce.*) Ahead? (आगे, *āge.*) Behind? (पीछे, *pīche.*) Inside? (अंदर, *andar.*) Half? (आधा, *ādhā.*) Whole? (पूरा, *pūrā.*) Double? (दुगना, *dugnā.*) Separate? (अलग, *alag.*) Round? (गोल, *gol.*)

Square? (चौकोर, *caukor.*) Triangular? (तिकोना, *tikoṇā.*) Narrow? (संकरा, *saṅkarā.*) Shallow? (उथला, *uthlā.*) Stale? (बासी, *bāsī.*)

242.7 Words from chapters 238-242 — a second pass

Say the words for raw and lukewarm.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- raw, lukewarm, dry, sticky, rough
- shiny, hazy, deserted, crowded, inhabited
- modern, ancient, local, foreign, local
- government, private, free, valuable, unusual
- ordinary, special, famous, useless, successful

Before you move on

Raw? (कच्चा, *kaccā.*) Lukewarm? (गुनगुना, *gungunā.*) Dry? (रूखा, *rūkhā.*) Sticky? (चिपचिपा, *cipcipā.*) Rough? (खुरदुरा, *khurdurā.*) Shiny? (चमकदार, *camakdār.*) Hazy? (धुंधला, *dhũdhlā.*) Deserted? (सुनसान, *sunsān.*) Crowded? (भीड़भाड़, *bhīṛbhāṛ.*) Inhabited? (आबाद, *ābād.*) Modern? (आधुनिक, *ādhunik.*) Ancient? (प्राचीन, *prācīn.*) Local? (स्थानीय, *sthānīya.*) Foreign? (विदेशी, *videśī.*) Local? (देसी, *desī.*) Government? (सरकारी, *sarkārī.*) Private? (निजी, *nijī.*) Free? (मुफ़्त, *muft.*) Valuable? (क़ीमती, *kīmtī.*) Unusual? (अनोखा, *anokhā.*) Ordinary? (साधारण, *sādhāraṇ.*) Special? (ख़ास, *khās.*) Famous? (मशहूर, *maśhūr.*) Useless? (बेकार, *bekār.*) Successful? (कामयाब, *kāmyāb.*)

Chapter 243

Unsuccessful, Proud, Simple, Cunning, Quarrelsome

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say unsuccessful, proud, simple, cunning and quarrelsome.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 243: I can say unsuccessful, proud, simple, cunning and quarrelsome.*

243.1 नाकाम (nākām) — unsuccessful

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for useless, then the Hindi for successful.

You'll want to know: नाकाम

नाकाम — *nākām* — "unsuccessful".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाकाम (*nākām*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *nākām*, "unsuccessful". It is built from *nā*-, "not", and *kām*, "desire".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nākām*
- *Say it: nākām*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nākām*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for useless, then the Hindi for successful, then say *nākām* again

Before you move on

What does नाकाम mean? (“Unsuccessful”.) Say it once more.

243.2 घमंडी (ghamaṇḍī) — proud, arrogant

Before the new one: say the Hindi for successful, then the Hindi for unsuccessful.

You’ll want to know: घमंडी

घमंडी — *ghamaṇḍī* — “proud, arrogant”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घमंडी (*ghamaṇḍī*) is *ghamaṇḍ*, “pride”, with the ending -*ī*. The origin of *ghamaṇḍ* is uncertain, and CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghamaṇḍī*
- *Say it: ghamaṇḍī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghamaṇḍī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for successful, then the Hindi for unsuccessful, then say *ghamaṇḍī* again

Before you move on

What does घमंडी mean? (“Proud, arrogant”.) Say it once more.

243.3 सीधासादा (sīdhāsādā) — simple, unpretentious

Before the new one: say the Hindi for unsuccessful, then the Hindi for proud.

You’ll want to know: सीधासादा

सीधासादा — *sīdhāsādā* — “simple, unpretentious”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सीधासादा (*sīdhāsādā*) pairs *sīdhā*, “straight”, from Sanskrit *siddha* (CDIAL 13401), with *sādā*, “plain”, usually traced to Persian *sāda*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sīdhāsādā*
- *Say it: sīdhāsādā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sīdhāsādā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for unsuccessful, then the Hindi for proud, then say *sīdhāsādā* again

Before you move on

What does सीधासादा mean? (“Simple, unpretentious”.) Say it once more.

243.4 चालाक (cālāk) — cunning, clever

Before the new one: say the Hindi for proud, then the Hindi for simple.

You'll want to know: चालाक

चालाक — *cālāk* — "cunning, clever".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चालाक (*cālāk*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *chālāk*, "quick, clever".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cālāk*
- *Say it: cālāk*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cālāk*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for proud, then the Hindi for simple, then say *cālāk* again

Before you move on

What does चालाक mean? ("Cunning, clever".) Say it once more.

243.5 झगड़ालू (jhagṛālū) — quarrelsome

Before the new one: say the Hindi for simple, then the Hindi for cunning.

You'll want to know: झगड़ालू

झगड़ालू — *jhagṛālū* — "quarrelsome".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झगड़ालू (*jhagṛālū*) is *jhagṛā*, “quarrel”, with the ending -*ālū*, “given to”. CDIAL lists *jhagṛā* under a reconstructed **jhagaḍ*, “quarrel” (CDIAL 5321).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhagṛālū*
- *Say it: jhagṛālū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhagṛālū*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for simple, then the Hindi for cunning, then say *jhagṛālū* again

Before you move on

What does झगड़ालू mean? (“Quarrelsome”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 244

A thousand, A hundred thousand, Ten million, Several, Both

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a thousand, a hundred thousand, ten million, several and both.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 244: I can say a thousand, a hundred thousand, ten million, several and both.*

244.1 हज़ार (hazār) — a thousand

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for cunning, then the Hindi for quarrelsome.

You’ll want to know: हज़ार

हज़ार — *hazār* — “a thousand”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हज़ार (*hazār*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *hazār*, “thousand”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hazār*
- *Say it: hazār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hazār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for cunning, then the Hindi for quarrelsome, then say *hazār* again

Before you move on

What does हज़ार mean? ("A thousand".) Say it once more.

244.2 लाख (lākh) — a hundred thousand (lakh)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for quarrelsome, then the Hindi for a thousand.

You'll want to know: लाख

लाख — *lākh* — "a hundred thousand (lakh)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लाख (*lākh*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *lakṣa*, "stake; mark; 100,000" (CDIAL 10881).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lākh*
- *Say it: lākh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lākh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for quarrelsome, then the Hindi for a thousand, then say *lākh* again

Before you move on

What does लाख mean? (“A hundred thousand (lakh)”.) Say it once more.

244.3 करोड़ (karoṛ) — ten million (crore)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a thousand, then the Hindi for a hundred thousand.

You’ll want to know: करोड़

करोड़ — *karoṛ* — “ten million (crore)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

करोड़ (*karoṛ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *koṭi*, “ten million” (CDIAL 3498). CDIAL takes the word from an Austroasiatic language, and explains the *kr-* of some forms as an over-correction towards Sanskrit.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karoṛ*
- *Say it: karoṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karoṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a thousand, then the Hindi for a hundred thousand, then say *karoṛ* again

Before you move on

What does करोड़ mean? (“Ten million (crore)”.) Say it once more.

244.4 कई (kaī) — several

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a hundred thousand, then the Hindi for ten million.

You'll want to know: कई

कई — *kaī* — "several".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कई (*kaī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *katipaya*, "several" (CDIAL 2696).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaī*
- *Say it: kaī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a hundred thousand, then the Hindi for ten million, then say *kaī* again

Before you move on

What does कई mean? ("Several".) Say it once more.

244.5 दोनों (donõ) — both

Before the new one: say the Hindi for ten million, then the Hindi for several.

You'll want to know: दोनों

दोनों — *donõ* — "both".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दोनों (*donõ*) is *do*, “two”, with the ending -*õ*, which makes “both”. CDIAL lists *donõ*, “both”, beside *do* under Sanskrit *dva*, “two” (CDIAL 6648).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: donõ*
- *Say it: donõ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *donõ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for ten million, then the Hindi for several, then say *donõ* again

Before you move on

What does दोनों mean? (“Both”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 245

Every, All, Some, A dozen, A pair

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say every, all, some, a dozen and a pair.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 245: I can say every, all, some, a dozen and a pair.*

245.1 हर (har) — every, each

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for several, then the Hindi for both.

You'll want to know: हर

हर — *har* — "every, each".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हर (*har*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *har*, "every".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: har*

- *Say it: har*, once more
- *Say it:* say *har*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for several, then the Hindi for both, then say *har* again

Before you move on

What does हर mean? (“Every, each”.) Say it once more.

245.2 सब (sab) — all, everyone

Before the new one: say the Hindi for both, then the Hindi for every.

You’ll want to know: सब

सब — *sab* — “all, everyone”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सब (*sab*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *sarva*, “all, whole” (CDIAL 13276).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sab*
- *Say it: sab*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sab*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for both, then the Hindi for every, then say *sab* again

Before you move on

What does सब mean? (“All, everyone”.) Say it once more.

245.3 कुछ (kuch) — some, something

Before the new one: say the Hindi for every, then the Hindi for all.

You’ll want to know: कुछ

कुछ — *kuch* — “some, something”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कुछ (*kuch*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kiṁcid*, “anything” (CDIAL 3144). CDIAL notes that its -*ch*- comes from the masculine *kaścid*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kuch*
- *Say it: kuch*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kuch*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for every, then the Hindi for all, then say *kuch* again

Before you move on

What does कुछ mean? (“Some, something”.) Say it once more.

245.4 दर्जन (darjan) — a dozen

Before the new one: say the Hindi for all, then the Hindi for some.

You’ll want to know: दर्जन

दर्जन — *darjan* — “a dozen”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दर्जन (*darjan*) is a loan from English *dozen*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: darjan*
- *Say it: darjan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *darjan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for all, then the Hindi for some, then say *darjan* again

Before you move on

What does दर्जन mean? ("A dozen".) Say it once more.

245.5 जोड़ा (joṛā) — a pair

Before the new one: say the Hindi for some, then the Hindi for a dozen.

You'll want to know: जोड़ा

जोड़ा — *joṛā* — "a pair".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जोड़ा (*joṛā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It belongs with **yoṭa*, a noun CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants in the entry for **yuṭati*, "is joined" (CDIAL 10496). CDIAL lists Hindi *joṛ* and *joṛī*, "pair", there, and Gujarati *joṛā*, "a pair of shoes", but not the Hindi *joṛā* itself.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: joṛā*
- *Say it: joṛā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *joṛā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for some, then the Hindi for a dozen, then say *joṛā* again

Before you move on

What does जोड़ा mean? ("A pair".) Say it once more.

Chapter 246

Iron, Silver, Paper, Plastic, Cotton wool

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say iron, silver, paper, plastic and cotton wool.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 246: I can say iron, silver, paper, plastic and cotton wool.*

246.1 लोहा (lohā) — iron

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a dozen, then the Hindi for a pair.

You’ll want to know: लोहा

लोहा — *lohā* — “iron”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लोहा (*lohā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *loha*, “red; copper; iron” (CDIAL 11158).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lohā*
- *Say it: lohā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lohā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a dozen, then the Hindi for a pair, then say *lohā* again

Before you move on

What does लोहा mean? (“Iron”.) Say it once more.

246.2 चाँदी (cā̃dī) — silver

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pair, then the Hindi for iron.

You’ll want to know: चाँदी

चाँदी — *cā̃dī* — “silver”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चाँदी (*cāṁdī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *candrikā*, “moonlight” (CDIAL 4669). CDIAL reconstructs a sense “silver” for the Sanskrit word, beside “moonlight”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cā̃dī*
- *Say it: cā̃dī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cā̃dī*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pair, then the Hindi for iron, then say *cā̃dī* again

Before you move on

What does चाँदी mean? (“Silver”.) Say it once more.

246.3 काग़ज़ (kāgaz) — paper

Before the new one: say the Hindi for iron, then the Hindi for silver.

You’ll want to know: काग़ज़

काग़ज़ — *kāgaz* — “paper”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

काग़ज़ (*kāgaz*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *kāghaz*, “paper”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāgaz*
- *Say it: kāgaz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāgaz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for iron, then the Hindi for silver, then say *kāgaz* again

Before you move on

What does काग़ज़ mean? (“Paper”.) Say it once more.

246.4 प्लास्टिक (plāsṭik) — plastic

Before the new one: say the Hindi for silver, then the Hindi for paper.

You'll want to know: प्लास्टिक

प्लास्टिक — *plāsṭik* — "plastic".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

प्लास्टिक (*plāsṭik*) is a loan from English *plastic*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: plāsṭik*
- *Say it: plāsṭik*, once more
- *Say it:* say *plāsṭik*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for silver, then the Hindi for paper, then say *plāsṭik* again

Before you move on

What does प्लास्टिक mean? ("Plastic".) Say it once more.

246.5 रुई (rūī) — cotton wool

Before the new one: say the Hindi for paper, then the Hindi for plastic.

You'll want to know: रुई

रुई — *rūī* — "cotton wool".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रुई (*rūī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **rūa*, “cotton”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 10798).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rūī*
- *Say it: rūī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rūī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for paper, then the Hindi for plastic, then say *rūī* again

Before you move on

What does रुई mean? (“Cotton wool”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 247

Silk, Leather, So, If, Or

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say silk, leather, so, if and or.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 247: I can say silk, leather, so, if and or.*

247.1 रेशम (reśam) — silk

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for plastic, then the Hindi for cotton wool.

You'll want to know: रेशम

रेशम — *reśam* — "silk".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रेशम (*reśam*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *abrēsham*, "silk".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: reśam*
- *Say it: reśam*, once more

- *Say it:* say *reśam*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for plastic, then the Hindi for cotton wool, then say *reśam* again

Before you move on

What does रेशम mean? (“Silk”.) Say it once more.

247.2 चमड़ा (cāmṛā) — leather

Before the new one: say the Hindi for cotton wool, then the Hindi for silk.

You’ll want to know: चमड़ा

चमड़ा — *cāmṛā* — “leather”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चमड़ा (*cāmṛā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *carman*, “hide, skin” (CDIAL 4701). CDIAL notes an added *-ṛ-*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cāmṛā*
- *Say it: cāmṛā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cāmṛā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for cotton wool, then the Hindi for silk, then say *cāmṛā* again

Before you move on

What does चमड़ा mean? (“Leather”.) Say it once more.

247.3 इसलिए (isliye) — so, therefore

Before the new one: say the Hindi for silk, then the Hindi for leather.

You'll want to know: इसलिए

इसलिए — *isliye* — "so, therefore".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

इसलिए (*isliye*) is *is*, "this", with *liye*, "for": "for this". *liye* is usually explained as a form of *lenā*, "to take", from Sanskrit *labhate* (CDIAL 10948).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: isliye*
- *Say it: isliye*, once more
- *Say it:* say *isliye*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for silk, then the Hindi for leather, then say *isliye* again

Before you move on

What does इसलिए mean? ("So, therefore".) Say it once more.

247.4 अगर (agar) — if

Before the new one: say the Hindi for leather, then the Hindi for so.

You'll want to know: अगर

अगर — *agar* — "if".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अगर (*agar*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *agar*, “if”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: agar*
- *Say it: agar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *agar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for leather, then the Hindi for so, then say *agar* again

Before you move on

What does अगर mean? (“If”.) Say it once more.

247.5 या (yā) — or

Before the new one: say the Hindi for so, then the Hindi for if.

You’ll want to know: या

या — *yā* — “or”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

या (*yā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *yā*, “or”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: yā*
- *Say it: yā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *yā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for so, then the Hindi for if, then say *yā* again

Before you move on

What does या mean? (“Or”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 248

Only, About, Later, Soon, Suddenly

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say only, about, later, soon and suddenly.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 248: I can say only, about, later, soon and suddenly.*

248.1 सिर्फ़ (sirf) — only

Before the new one: say the Hindi for if, then the Hindi for or.

You'll want to know: सिर्फ़

सिर्फ़ — *sirf* — "only".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सिर्फ़ (*sirf*) is a loan from Arabic *ṣirf*, "pure, unmixed", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṣ-r-f* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sirf*
- *Say it: sirf*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sirf*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for if, then the Hindi for or, then say *sirf* again

Before you move on

What does सिर्फ़ mean? (“Only”.) Say it once more.

248.2 लगभग (lagbhag) — about, nearly

Before the new one: say the Hindi for or, then the Hindi for only.

You’ll want to know: लगभग

लगभग — *lagbhag* — “about, nearly”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लगभग (*lagbhag*) is *lag*, “touching, near”, which comes from Sanskrit *lagna*, “sticking to, touching” (CDIAL 10893), with a rhyming *bhag*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lagbhag*
- *Say it: lagbhag*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lagbhag*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for or, then the Hindi for only, then say *lagbhag* again

Before you move on

What does लगभग mean? (“About, nearly”.) Say it once more.

248.3 बाद में (bād mẽ) — later, afterwards

Before the new one: say the Hindi for only, then the Hindi for about.

You’ll want to know: बाद में

बाद में — *bād mẽ* — “later, afterwards”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बाद में (*bād mẽ*) is *bād*, “after”, from Arabic *baᶜd* through Persian (Lane, root *b-ᶜ-d*), with *meṁ*, “in”, from Sanskrit *madhye* (CDIAL 9804).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bād mẽ*
- *Say it: bād mẽ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bād mẽ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for only, then the Hindi for about, then say *bād mẽ* again

Before you move on

What does बाद में mean? (“Later, afterwards”.) Say it once more.

248.4 जल्द ही (jald hī) — soon

Before the new one: say the Hindi for about, then the Hindi for later.

You’ll want to know: जल्द ही

जल्द ही — *jald hī* — “soon”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जल्द ही (*jald hī*) is *jald*, “quick”, usually traced to Persian *jald*, with the Hindi emphatic *hī*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jald hī*
- *Say it: jald hī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jald hī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for about, then the Hindi for later, then say *jald hī* again

Before you move on

What does जल्द ही mean? (“Soon”.) Say it once more.

248.5 अचानक (acānak) — suddenly

Before the new one: say the Hindi for later, then the Hindi for soon.

You’ll want to know: अचानक

अचानक — *acānak* — “suddenly”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of अचानक (*acānak*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: acānak*
- *Say it: acānak*, once more
- *Say it:* say *acānak*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for later, then the Hindi for soon, then say *acānak* again

Before you move on

What does **अचानक** mean? ("Suddenly".) Say it once more.

Chapter 249

With, All together, A computer, A mobile phone, A document

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say with, all together, a computer, a mobile phone and a document.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 249: I can say with, all together, a computer, a mobile phone and a document.*

249.1 साथ (sāth) — with, together

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for soon, then the Hindi for suddenly.

You'll want to know: साथ

साथ — *sāth* — "with, together".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

साथ (*sāth*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *sārthena*, "in company with", the instrumental case of *sārtha*, "caravan, company". CDIAL lists Hindi *sāth*, "with", under *sārthena*, and the noun *sāth*, "company, train", under *sārtha* itself (CDIAL 13364).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāth*
- *Say it: sāth*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sāth*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for soon, then the Hindi for suddenly, then say *sāth* again

Before you move on

What does साथ mean? ("With, together".) Say it once more.

249.2 एक साथ (ek sāth) — all together

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for suddenly, then the Hindi for with.

You'll want to know: एक साथ

एक साथ — *ek sāth* — "all together".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

एक साथ (*ek sāth*) is *ek*, "one", from Sanskrit *eka* (CDIAL 2462), and *sāth*, "with", from *sārthena*, "in company with", a case form of *sārtha*, "company" (CDIAL 13364).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ek sāth*
- *Say it: ek sāth*, once more

- *Say it:* say *ek sāth*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for suddenly, then the Hindi for with, then say *ek sāth* again

Before you move on

What does एक साथ mean? (“All together”.) Say it once more.

249.3 कंप्यूटर (kampyūṭar) — a computer

Before the new one: say the Hindi for with, then the Hindi for all together.

You’ll want to know: कंप्यूटर

कंप्यूटर — *kampyūṭar* — “a computer”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कंप्यूटर (*kampyūṭar*) is a loan from English *computer*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kampyūṭar*
- *Say it: kampyūṭar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kampyūṭar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for with, then the Hindi for all together, then say *kampyūṭar* again

Before you move on

What does कंप्यूटर mean? (“A computer”.) Say it once more.

249.4 मोबाइल (mobāil) — a mobile phone

Before the new one: say the Hindi for all together, then the Hindi for a computer.

You'll want to know: मोबाइल

मोबाइल — *mobāil* — "a mobile phone".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मोबाइल (*mobāil*) is a loan from English *mobile*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mobāil*
- *Say it: mobāil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mobāil*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for all together, then the Hindi for a computer, then say *mobāil* again

Before you move on

What does **मोबाइल** mean? ("A mobile phone".) Say it once more.

249.5 दस्तावेज़ (dastāvez) — a document

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a computer, then the Hindi for a mobile phone.

You'll want to know: दस्तावेज़

दस्तावेज़ — *dastāvez* — "a document".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दस्तावेज़ (*dastāvez*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *dastāwēz*, “a document, a deed”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dastāvez*
- *Say it: dastāvez*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dastāvez*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a computer, then the Hindi for a mobile phone, then say *dastāvez* again

Before you move on

What does दस्तावेज़ mean? (“A document”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 250

A file, A safe, A stamp, A discount, Retail

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a file, a safe, a stamp, a discount and retail.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 250: I can say a file, a safe, a stamp, a discount and retail.*

250.1 फ़ाइल (fāil) — a file

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mobile phone, then the Hindi for a document.

You’ll want to know: फ़ाइल

फ़ाइल — *fāil* — “a file”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फ़ाइल (*fāil*) is a loan from English *file.*

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: fāil*
- *Say it: fāil*, once more
- *Say it:* say *fāil*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mobile phone, then the Hindi for a document, then say *fāil* again

Before you move on

What does फ़ाइल mean? (“A file”.) Say it once more.

250.2 तिजोरी (tijorī) — a safe, a strongbox

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a document, then the Hindi for a file.

You’ll want to know: तिजोरी

तिजोरी — *tijorī* — “a safe, a strongbox”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of तिजोरी (*tijorī*) is uncertain. It is sometimes traced to Portuguese *tesouro*, “treasure, treasury”, but no source settles it, and CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tijorī*
- *Say it: tijorī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tijorī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a document, then the Hindi for a file, then say *tijorī* again

Before you move on

What does तिजोरी mean? (“A safe, a strongbox”.) Say it once more.

250.3 मोहर (mohar) — a stamp, a seal

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a file, then the Hindi for a safe.

You’ll want to know: मोहर

मोहर — *mohar* — “a stamp, a seal”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मोहर (*mohar*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *muhr*, “seal, stamp”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mohar*
- *Say it: mohar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mohar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a file, then the Hindi for a safe, then say *mohar* again

Before you move on

What does मोहर mean? (“A stamp, a seal”.) Say it once more.

250.4 छूट (chūṭ) — a discount

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a safe, then the Hindi for a stamp.

You’ll want to know: छूट

छूट — *chūṭ* — “a discount”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छूट (*chūṭ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **kṣuṭyate*, “is released”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 3707). *chūṭ*, “a let-off”, is the noun of *chūṭnā*, “to be released”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chūṭ*
- *Say it: chūṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chūṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a safe, then the Hindi for a stamp, then say *chūṭ* again

Before you move on

What does छूट mean? (“A discount”.) Say it once more.

250.5 खुदरा (khuḍrā) — retail, small change

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a stamp, then the Hindi for a discount.

You’ll want to know: खुदरा

खुदरा — *khuḍrā* — “retail, small change”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खुदरा (*khudrā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *khurda*, “small, small change”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khuḍrā*
- *Say it: khuḍrā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khuḍrā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a stamp, then the Hindi for a discount, then say *khuḍrā* again

Before you move on

What does खुदरा mean? ("Retail, small change".) Say it once more.

Chapter 251

Wholesale, Scales, A kilo, A litre, A metre

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say wholesale, scales, a kilo, a litre and a metre.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 251: I can say wholesale, scales, a kilo, a litre and a metre.*

251.1 थोक (thok) — wholesale

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a discount, then the Hindi for retail.

You’ll want to know: थोक

थोक — *thok* — “wholesale”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

थोक (*thok*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *stabaka*, “cluster; quantity” (CDIAL 13675). CDIAL glosses the Hindi word “clump, mass, heap”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: thok*
- *Say it: thok*, once more
- *Say it:* say *thok*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a discount, then the Hindi for retail, then say *thok* again

Before you move on

What does थोक mean? (“Wholesale”.) Say it once more.

251.2 तराज़ू (tarāzū) — scales

Before the new one: say the Hindi for retail, then the Hindi for wholesale.

You’ll want to know: तराज़ू

तराज़ू — *tarāzū* — “scales”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तराज़ू (*tarāzū*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *tarāzū*, “scales”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tarāzū*
- *Say it: tarāzū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tarāzū*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for retail, then the Hindi for wholesale, then say *tarāzū* again

Before you move on

What does तराज़ू mean? (“Scales”.) Say it once more.

251.3 किलो (kilo) — a kilo

Before the new one: say the Hindi for wholesale, then the Hindi for scales.

You’ll want to know: किलो

किलो — *kilo* — “a kilo”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

किलो (*kilo*) is a loan from English *kilo*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kilo*
- *Say it: kilo*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kilo*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for wholesale, then the Hindi for scales, then say *kilo* again

Before you move on

What does किलो mean? (“A kilo”.) Say it once more.

251.4 लीटर (līṭar) — a litre

Before the new one: say the Hindi for scales, then the Hindi for a kilo.

You'll want to know: लीटर

लीटर — *līṭar* — "a litre".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लीटर (*līṭar*) is a loan from English *litre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: līṭar*
- *Say it: līṭar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *līṭar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for scales, then the Hindi for a kilo, then say *līṭar* again

Before you move on

What does **लीटर** mean? ("A litre".) Say it once more.

251.5 मीटर (mīṭar) — a metre

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a kilo, then the Hindi for a litre.

You'll want to know: मीटर

मीटर — *mīṭar* — "a metre".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मीटर (*mīṭar*) is a loan from English *metre*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mīṭar*
- *Say it: mīṭar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mīṭar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a kilo, then the Hindi for a litre, then say *mīṭar* again

Before you move on

What does मीटर mean? (“A metre”.) Say it once more.

251.6 Words from chapters 243-246 — a first pass

Say the words for a litre and a metre.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- unsuccessful, proud, simple, cunning, quarrelsome
- a thousand, a hundred thousand, ten million, several, both
- every, all, some, a dozen, a pair
- iron, silver, paper, plastic, cotton wool

Before you move on

Unsuccessful? (नाकाम, *nākām.*) Proud? (घमंडी, *ghamaṇḍī.*) Simple? (सीधासादा, *sīdhāsādā.*) Cunning? (चालाक, *cālāk.*) Quarrelsome? (झगड़ालू, *jhagṛālū.*) A thousand? (हज़ार, *hazār.*) A hundred thousand? (लाख, *lākh.*) Ten million? (करोड़, *karoṛ.*) Several? (कई, *kaī.*) Both? (दोनों, *donõ.*) Every? (हर, *har.*) All? (सब, *sab.*) Some? (कुछ, *kuch.*) A dozen? (दर्जन, *darjan.*) A pair? (जोड़ा, *joṛā.*) Iron? (लोहा, *lohā.*) Silver? (चाँदी, *cā̃dī.*) Paper? (काग़ज़, *kāgaz.*) Plastic? (प्लास्टिक, *plāsṭik.*) Cotton wool? (रुई, *rūī.*)

251.7 Words from chapters 247-251 — a second pass

Say the words for silk and leather.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- silk, leather, so, if, or
- only, about, later, soon, suddenly
- with, all together, a computer, a mobile phone, a document
- a file, a safe, a stamp, a discount, retail
- wholesale, scales, a kilo, a litre, a metre

Before you move on

Silk? (रेशम, *reśam.*) Leather? (चमड़ा, *cāmṛā.*) So? (इसलिए, *isliye.*) If? (अगर, *agar.*) Or? (या, *yā.*) Only? (सिर्फ़, *sirf.*) About? (लगभग, *lagbhag.*) Later? (बाद में, *bād mẽ.*) Soon? (जल्द ही, *jald hī.*) Suddenly? (अचानक, *acānak.*) With? (साथ, *sāth.*) All together? (एक साथ, *ek sāth.*) A computer? (कंप्यूटर, *kampyūṭar.*) A mobile phone? (मोबाइल, *mobāil.*) A document? (दस्तावेज़, *dastāvez.*) A file? (फ़ाइल, *fāil.*) A safe? (तिजोरी, *tijorī.*) A stamp? (मोहर, *mohar.*) A discount? (छूट, *chūṭ.*) Retail? (खुदरा, *khuḍrā.*) Wholesale? (थोक, *thok.*) Scales? (तराज़ू, *tarāzū.*) A kilo? (किलो, *kilo.*) A litre? (लीटर, *līṭar.*) A metre? (मीटर, *mīṭar.*)

Chapter 252

A sack, A branch, A bud, A thorn, Mud

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a sack, a branch, a bud, a thorn and mud.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 252: I can say a sack, a branch, a bud, a thorn and mud.*

252.1 बोरी (borī) — a sack

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a litre, then the Hindi for a metre.

You'll want to know: बोरी

बोरी — *borī* — "a sack".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बोरी (*borī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **bora*, "sacking, sack", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9320).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: borī*
- *Say it: borī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *borī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a litre, then the Hindi for a metre, then say *borī* again

Before you move on

What does बोरी mean? (“A sack”.) Say it once more.

252.2 डाली (ḍālī) — a branch

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a metre, then the Hindi for a sack.

You’ll want to know: डाली

डाली — *ḍālī* — “a branch”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

डाली (*ḍālī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ḍāla*, “branch” (CDIAL 5546). CDIAL notes that the variety of forms points to a Munda source.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ḍālī*
- *Say it: ḍālī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ḍālī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a metre, then the Hindi for a sack, then say *ḍālī* again

Before you move on

What does डाली mean? (“A branch”.) Say it once more.

252.3 कली (kalī) — a bud

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sack, then the Hindi for a branch.

You’ll want to know: कली

कली — *kalī* — “a bud”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कली (*kalī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kali*, “unblown bud” (CDIAL 2934).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kalī*
- *Say it: kalī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kalī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sack, then the Hindi for a branch, then say *kalī* again

Before you move on

What does कली mean? (“A bud”.) Say it once more.

252.4 काँटा (kā̃ṭā) — a thorn, a fork

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a branch, then the Hindi for a bud.

You'll want to know: काँटा

काँटा — *kā̃ṭā* — "a thorn, a fork".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

काँटा (*kāṁṭā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kaṇṭaka*, "thorn" (CDIAL 2668).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kā̃ṭā*
- *Say it: kā̃ṭā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kā̃ṭā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a branch, then the Hindi for a bud, then say *kā̃ṭā* again

Before you move on

What does काँटा mean? ("A thorn, a fork".) Say it once more.

252.5 कीचड़ (kīcaṛ) — mud

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bud, then the Hindi for a thorn.

You'll want to know: कीचड़

कीचड़ — *kīcaṛ* — "mud".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कीचड़ (*kīcaṛ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **kicca*, "mud, dirt", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 3153). CDIAL compares Dravidian words.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kīcaṛ*
- *Say it: kīcaṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kīcaṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bud, then the Hindi for a thorn, then say *kīcaṛ* again

Before you move on

What does कीचड़ mean? (“Mud”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 253

A rainbow, An earthquake, A flood, A man, A baby

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a rainbow, an earthquake, a flood, a man and a baby.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 253: I can say a rainbow, an earthquake, a flood, a man and a baby.*

253.1 इंद्रधनुष (indradhanuṣ) — a rainbow

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a thorn, then the Hindi for mud.

You’ll want to know: इंद्रधनुष

इंद्रधनुष — *indradhanuṣ* — “a rainbow”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

इंद्रधनुष (*indradhanuṣ*) is Sanskrit *indradhanus*, “Indra’s bow”, taken over whole as a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: indradhanuṣ*
- *Say it: indradhanuṣ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *indradhanuṣ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a thorn, then the Hindi for mud, then say *indradhanuṣ* again

Before you move on

What does **इंद्रधनुष** mean? (“A rainbow”.) Say it once more.

253.2 भूकंप (bhūkamp) — an earthquake

Before the new one: say the Hindi for mud, then the Hindi for a rainbow.

You’ll want to know: भूकंप

भूकंप — *bhūkamp* — “an earthquake”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भूकंप (*bhūkamp*) is a tatsama compound, taken over whole from Sanskrit: *bhū*, “earth”, and *kampa*, “trembling”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhūkamp*
- *Say it: bhūkamp*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhūkamp*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for mud, then the Hindi for a rainbow, then say *bhūkamp* again

Before you move on

What does भूकंप mean? (“An earthquake”.) Say it once more.

253.3 बाढ़ (bāṛh) — a flood

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a rainbow, then the Hindi for an earthquake.

You’ll want to know: बाढ़

बाढ़ — *bāṛh* — “a flood”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बाढ़ (*bāṛh*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vṛddhi*, “increase” (CDIAL 12076). CDIAL glosses the Hindi word “increase”; a flood is the rising of the water.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bāṛh*
- *Say it: bāṛh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bāṛh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a rainbow, then the Hindi for an earthquake, then say *bāṛh* again

Before you move on

What does बाढ़ mean? (“A flood”.) Say it once more.

253.4 पुरुष (puruṣ) — a man

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an earthquake, then the Hindi for a flood.

You’ll want to know: पुरुष

पुरुष — *puruṣ* — “a man”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पुरुष (*puruṣ*) is Sanskrit *puruṣa*, “man, male”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 8289). CDIAL lists the inherited form as *purus*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: puruṣ*
- *Say it: puruṣ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *puruṣ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an earthquake, then the Hindi for a flood, then say *puruṣ* again

Before you move on

What does पुरुष mean? (“A man”.) Say it once more.

253.5 शिशु (śiśu) — a baby, an infant

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a flood, then the Hindi for a man.

You’ll want to know: शिशु

शिशु — *śiśu* — “a baby, an infant”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

शिशु (*śiśu*) is Sanskrit *śiśu*, “young of an animal, child”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 12476). CDIAL lists the inherited forms as *sis* and *sisu*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: śiśu*
- *Say it: śiśu*, once more
- *Say it:* say *śiśu*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a flood, then the Hindi for a man, then say *śiśu* again

Before you move on

What does **शिशु** mean? (“A baby, an infant”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 254

A female friend, A companion, A relative, A mother-in-law, A father-in-law

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a female friend, a companion, a relative, a mother-in-law and a father-in-law.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 254: I can say a female friend, a companion, a relative, a mother-in-law and a father-in-law.*

254.1 सहेली (sahelī) — a female friend (of a girl)

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a man, then the Hindi for a baby.

You’ll want to know: सहेली

सहेली — *sahelī* — “a female friend (of a girl)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सहेली (*sahelī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *sakhī*, “woman’s confidante” (CDIAL 13074). CDIAL notes an added *-l-*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sahelī*
- *Say it: sahelī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sahelī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a man, then the Hindi for a baby, then say *sahelī* again

Before you move on

What does सहेली mean? ("A female friend (of a girl)".) Say it once more.

254.2 साथी (sāthī) — a companion

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a baby, then the Hindi for a female friend.

You'll want to know: साथी

साथी — *sāthī* — "a companion".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

साथी (*sāthī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **sārthin*, "having part in a company", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 13366). It is built on *sārtha*, "company".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sāthī*
- *Say it: sāthī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sāthī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a baby, then the Hindi for a female friend, then say *sāthī* again

Before you move on

What does साथी mean? (“A companion”.) Say it once more.

254.3 संबंधी (sambandhī) — a relative

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a female friend, then the Hindi for a companion.

You’ll want to know: संबंधी

संबंधी — *sambandhī* — “a relative”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

संबंधी (*sambandhī*) is Sanskrit *sambandhin*, “connected, related”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. Hindi took its nominative, *sambandhī*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sambandhī*
- *Say it: sambandhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sambandhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a female friend, then the Hindi for a companion, then say *sambandhī* again

Before you move on

What does संबंधी mean? (“A relative”.) Say it once more.

254.4 सास (sās) — a mother-in-law

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a companion, then the Hindi for a relative.

You’ll want to know: सास

सास — *sās* — “a mother-in-law”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सास (*sās*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *śvaśrū*, “husband’s or wife’s mother” (CDIAL 12759).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sās*
- *Say it: sās*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sās*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a companion, then the Hindi for a relative, then say *sās* again

Before you move on

What does सास mean? (“A mother-in-law”.) Say it once more.

254.5 ससुर (sasur) — a father-in-law

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a relative, then the Hindi for a mother-in-law.

You’ll want to know: ससुर

ससुर — *sasur* — “a father-in-law”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ससुर (*sasur*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *śvaśura*, “father-in-law” (CDIAL 12753).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sasur*
- *Say it: sasur*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sasur*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a relative, then the Hindi for a mother-in-law, then say *sasur* again

Before you move on

What does ससुर mean? (“A father-in-law”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 255

A daughter-in-law, A son-in-law, A husband’s younger brother, A husband’s sister, A sister’s husband

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a daughter-in-law, a son-in-law, a husband’s younger brother, a husband’s sister and a sister’s husband.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 255: I can say a daughter-in-law, a son-in-law, a husband’s younger brother, a husband’s sister and a sister’s husband.*

255.1 बहू (bahū) — a daughter-in-law

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mother-in-law, then the Hindi for a father-in-law.

You’ll want to know: बहू

बहू — *bahū* — “a daughter-in-law”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बहू (*bahū*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vadhū*, “bride, young wife” (CDIAL

11250).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bahū*
- *Say it: bahū*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bahū*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mother-in-law, then the Hindi for a father-in-law, then say *bahū* again

Before you move on

What does बहू mean? ("A daughter-in-law".) Say it once more.

255.2 दामाद (dāmād) — a son-in-law

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a father-in-law, then the Hindi for a daughter-in-law.

You'll want to know: दामाद

दामाद — *dāmād* — "a son-in-law".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दामाद (*dāmād*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *dāmād*, "son-in-law".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dāmād*

- *Say it: dāmād*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dāmād*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a father-in-law, then the Hindi for a daughter-in-law, then say *dāmād* again

Before you move on

What does दामाद mean? (“A son-in-law”.) Say it once more.

255.3 देवर (devar) — a husband’s younger brother

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a daughter-in-law, then the Hindi for a son-in-law.

You’ll want to know: देवर

देवर — *devar* — “a husband’s younger brother”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

देवर (*devar*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *devṛ*, “husband’s younger brother” (CDIAL 6546).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: devar*
- *Say it: devar*, once more
- *Say it:* say *devar*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a daughter-in-law, then the Hindi for a son-in-law, then say *devar* again

Before you move on

What does देवर mean? (“A husband’s younger brother”.) Say it once more.

255.4 ननद (nanad) — a husband’s sister

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a son-in-law, then the Hindi for a husband’s younger brother.

You’ll want to know: ननद

ननद — *nanad* — “a husband’s sister”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ननद (*nanad*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *nanāndṛ*, “husband’s sister” (CDIAL 6946).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nanad*
- *Say it: nanad*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nanad*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a son-in-law, then the Hindi for a husband’s younger brother, then say *nanad* again

Before you move on

What does ननद mean? (“A husband’s sister”.) Say it once more.

255.5 जीजा (jījā) — a sister’s husband

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a husband’s younger brother, then the Hindi for a husband’s sister.

You’ll want to know: जीजा

जीजा — *jījā* — “a sister’s husband”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जीजा (*jījā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **jījja*, “a nursery word for breast, mother, sister”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5232). CDIAL glosses Hindi *jījā* “sister’s husband”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jījā*
- *Say it: jījā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jījā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a husband’s younger brother, then the Hindi for a husband’s sister, then say *jījā* again

Before you move on

What does जीजा mean? (“A sister’s husband”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 256

Vomiting, A wound, A bandage, An injection, A pill

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say vomiting, a wound, a bandage, an injection and a pill.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 256: I can say vomiting, a wound, a bandage, an injection and a pill.*

256.1 उल्टी (ulṭī) — vomiting

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a husband's sister, then the Hindi for a sister's husband.

You'll want to know: उल्टी

उल्टी — *ulṭī* — "vomiting".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उल्टी (*ulṭī*) is "an overturning", from *ulaṭnā*, "to be overturned", which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **ullaṭati*, "turns over" (CDIAL 2368).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ulṭī*
- *Say it: ulṭī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ulṭī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a husband's sister, then the Hindi for a sister's husband, then say *ulṭī* again

Before you move on

What does उल्टी mean? ("Vomiting".) Say it once more.

256.2 घाव (ghāv) — a wound

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sister's husband, then the Hindi for vomiting.

You'll want to know: घाव

घाव — *ghāv* — "a wound".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घाव (*ghāv*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ghāta*, "killing; blow, bruise" (CDIAL 4460). CDIAL lists the Hindi forms as *ghāu* and *ghāy*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghāv*
- *Say it: ghāv*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghāv*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sister's husband, then the Hindi for vomiting, then say *ghāv* again

Before you move on

What does घाव mean? (“A wound”.) Say it once more.

256.3 पट्टी (paṭṭī) — a bandage

Before the new one: say the Hindi for vomiting, then the Hindi for a wound.

You’ll want to know: पट्टी

पट्टी — *paṭṭī* — “a bandage”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पट्टी (*paṭṭī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *paṭṭa*, “cloth; bandage, fillet” (CDIAL 7700). CDIAL thinks the word probably came from a non-Aryan source.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: paṭṭī*
- *Say it: paṭṭī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *paṭṭī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for vomiting, then the Hindi for a wound, then say *paṭṭī* again

Before you move on

What does पट्टी mean? (“A bandage”.) Say it once more.

256.4 टीका (ṭīkā) — an injection, a vaccination

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a wound, then the Hindi for a bandage.

You'll want to know: टीका

टीका — *ṭīkā* — "an injection, a vaccination".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टीका (*ṭīkā*) comes from a reconstructed **ṭikka*, "mark, spot", and CDIAL glosses the Hindi word "caste-mark" (CDIAL 5458). Hindi now also uses it for an injection.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭīkā*
- *Say it: ṭīkā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭīkā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a wound, then the Hindi for a bandage, then say *ṭīkā* again

Before you move on

What does टीका mean? ("An injection, a vaccination".) Say it once more.

256.5 गोली (golī) — a pill, a bullet

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bandage, then the Hindi for an injection.

You’ll want to know: गोली

गोली — *golī* — “a pill, a bullet”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गोली (*golī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *golikā*, “little ball” (CDIAL 4321). It is built on *gola*, “ball”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: golī*
- *Say it: golī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *golī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bandage, then the Hindi for an injection, then say *golī* again

Before you move on

What does गोली mean? (“A pill, a bullet”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 257

The pulse, Jealousy, Hatred, Respect, Pride

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the pulse, jealousy, hatred, respect and pride.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 257: I can say the pulse, jealousy, hatred, respect and pride.*

257.1 नब्ज़ (nabz) — the pulse

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an injection, then the Hindi for a pill.

You'll want to know: नब्ज़

नब्ज़ — *nabz* — "the pulse".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नब्ज़ (*nabz*) is a loan from Arabic *nabḍ*, "pulse, a throbbing", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *n-b-ḍ* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nabz*
- *Say it: nabz*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nabz*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an injection, then the Hindi for a pill, then say *nabz* again

Before you move on

What does **नब्ज़** mean? (“The pulse”.) Say it once more.

257.2 ईर्ष्या (irṣyā) — jealousy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pill, then the Hindi for the pulse.

You’ll want to know: ईर्ष्या

ईर्ष्या — *irṣyā* — “jealousy”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ईर्ष्या (*irṣyā*) is Sanskrit *īrṣyā*, “envy, jealousy”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: irṣyā*
- *Say it: irṣyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *irṣyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pill, then the Hindi for the pulse, then say *irṣyā* again

Before you move on

What does ईर्ष्या mean? (“Jealousy”.) Say it once more.

257.3 घृणा (ghṛṇā) — hatred

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the pulse, then the Hindi for jealousy.

You’ll want to know: घृणा

घृणा — *ghṛṇā* — “hatred”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घृणा (*ghṛṇā*) is Sanskrit *ghṛṇā*, “disgust, contempt”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghṛṇā*
- *Say it: ghṛṇā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghṛṇā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the pulse, then the Hindi for jealousy, then say *ghṛṇā* again

Before you move on

What does घृणा mean? (“Hatred”.) Say it once more.

257.4 सम्मान (sammān) — respect, honour

Before the new one: say the Hindi for jealousy, then the Hindi for hatred.

You’ll want to know: सम्मान

सम्मान — *sammān* — “respect, honour”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सम्मान (*sammān*) is Sanskrit *sammāna*, “honour, respect”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sammān*
- *Say it: sammān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sammān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for jealousy, then the Hindi for hatred, then say *sammān* again

Before you move on

What does सम्मान mean? (“Respect, honour”.) Say it once more.

257.5 गर्व (garv) — pride

Before the new one: say the Hindi for hatred, then the Hindi for respect.

You’ll want to know: गर्व

गर्व — *garv* — “pride”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गर्व (*garv*) is Sanskrit *garva*, “pride”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: garv*
- *Say it: garv*, once more
- *Say it:* say *garv*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for hatred, then the Hindi for respect, then say *garv* again

Before you move on

What does गर्व mean? ("Pride".) Say it once more.

Chapter 258

Arrogance, Patience, Courage, Faith, Loneliness

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5)   🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say arrogance, patience, courage, faith and loneliness.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 258: I can say arrogance, patience, courage, faith and loneliness.*

258.1 अहंकार (ahaṅkār) — arrogance

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for respect, then the Hindi for pride.

You'll want to know: अहंकार

अहंकार — *ahaṅkār* — “arrogance”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अहंकार (*ahaṅkār*) is Sanskrit *ahaṅkāra*, “self-regard, egotism”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built from *aham*, “I”, and *kāra*, “making”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ahaṅkār*
- *Say it: ahaṅkār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ahaṅkār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for respect, then the Hindi for pride, then say *ahaṅkār* again

Before you move on

What does अहंकार mean? (“Arrogance”.) Say it once more.

258.2 धीरज (dhīraj) — patience

Before the new one: say the Hindi for pride, then the Hindi for arrogance.

You’ll want to know: धीरज

धीरज — *dhīraj* — “patience”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धीरज (*dhīraj*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *dhairya*, “firmness, patience”, reshaped in Hindi, but CDIAL does not list it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhīraj*
- *Say it: dhīraj*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhīraj*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for pride, then the Hindi for arrogance, then say *dhīraj* again

Before you move on

What does धीरज mean? (“Patience”.) Say it once more.

258.3 हिम्मत (himmat) — courage

Before the new one: say the Hindi for arrogance, then the Hindi for patience.

You’ll want to know: हिम्मत

हिम्मत — *himmat* — “courage”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हिम्मत (*himmat*) is a loan from Arabic *himma*, “resolve, aspiration”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *h-m-m* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: himmat*
- *Say it: himmat*, once more
- *Say it:* say *himmat*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for arrogance, then the Hindi for patience, then say *himmat* again

Before you move on

What does हिम्मत mean? (“Courage”.) Say it once more.

258.4 विश्वास (viśvās) — faith, confidence

Before the new one: say the Hindi for patience, then the Hindi for courage.

You’ll want to know: विश्वास

विश्वास — *viśvās* — “faith, confidence”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

विश्वास (*viśvās*) is Sanskrit *viśvāsa*, “trust, confidence”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: viśvās*
- *Say it: viśvās*, once more
- *Say it:* say *viśvās*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for patience, then the Hindi for courage, then say *viśvās* again

Before you move on

What does विश्वास mean? (“Faith, confidence”.) Say it once more.

258.5 अकेलापन (akelāpan) — loneliness

Before the new one: say the Hindi for courage, then the Hindi for faith.

You’ll want to know: अकेलापन

अकेलापन — *akelāpan* — “loneliness”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अकेलापन (*akelāpan*) is *akelā*, “alone”, with *-pan*, “-ness”. CDIAL lists *akelā* under a reconstructed **ekkala*, “alone”, built on *eka*, “one” (CDIAL 2506).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: akelāpan*
- *Say it: akelāpan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *akelāpan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for courage, then the Hindi for faith, then say *akelāpan* again

Before you move on

What does अकेलापन mean? ("Loneliness".) Say it once more.

Chapter 259

Restlessness, A crowd, An event, An accident, Danger

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say restlessness, a crowd, an event, an accident and danger.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 259: I can say restlessness, a crowd, an event, an accident and danger.*

259.1 बेचैनी (becainī) — restlessness, unease

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for faith, then the Hindi for loneliness.

You’ll want to know: बेचैनी

बेचैनी — *becainī* — “restlessness, unease”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बेचैनी (*becainī*) is *becain*, “restless”, with the ending *-ī* that makes a noun. *be-* is the Persian “without”; *cain*, “ease”, is of uncertain origin, and CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: becainī*
- *Say it: becainī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *becainī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for faith, then the Hindi for loneliness, then say *becainī* again

Before you move on

What does बेचैनी mean? (“Restlessness, unease”.) Say it once more.

259.2 भीड़ (bhīṛ) — a crowd

Before the new one: say the Hindi for loneliness, then the Hindi for restlessness.

You’ll want to know: भीड़

भीड़ — *bhīṛ* — “a crowd”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भीड़ (*bhīṛ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **bhiṭ*, “meet, throng”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 9490).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhīṛ*
- *Say it: bhīṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhīṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for loneliness, then the Hindi for restlessness, then say *bhīṛ* again

Before you move on

What does भीड़ mean? (“A crowd”.) Say it once more.

259.3 घटना (ghaṭnā) — an event

Before the new one: say the Hindi for restlessness, then the Hindi for a crowd.

You’ll want to know: घटना

घटना — *ghaṭnā* — “an event”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घटना (*ghaṭnā*) is Sanskrit *ghaṭanā*, “a joining, a coming about”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is a different word from *ghaṭnā*, “to decrease” (CDIAL 4415).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghaṭnā*
- *Say it: ghaṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghaṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for restlessness, then the Hindi for a crowd, then say *ghaṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does **घटना** mean? (“An event”.) Say it once more.

259.4 दुर्घटना (durghaṭnā) — an accident

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a crowd, then the Hindi for an event.

You'll want to know: दुर्घटना

दुर्घटना — *durghaṭnā* — "an accident".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दुर्घटना (*durghaṭnā*) is Sanskrit *durghaṭanā*, "a bad occurrence", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is *ghaṭanā*, "event", with *dur-*, "bad".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: durghaṭnā*
- *Say it: durghaṭnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *durghaṭnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a crowd, then the Hindi for an event, then say *durghaṭnā* again

Before you move on

What does दुर्घटना mean? ("An accident".) Say it once more.

259.5 ख़तरा (khatrā) — danger

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an event, then the Hindi for an accident.

You'll want to know: ख़तरा

ख़तरा — *khatrā* — "danger".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ख़तरा (*khatrā*) is a loan from Arabic *khaṭar*, "danger, risk", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *kh-ṭ-r* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khatrā*
- *Say it: khatrā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khatrā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an event, then the Hindi for an accident, then say *khatrā* again

Before you move on

What does ख़तरा mean? ("Danger".) Say it once more.

Chapter 260

A convenience, An inconvenience, A rule, A list, A candidate

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a convenience, an inconvenience, a rule, a list and a candidate.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 260: I can say a convenience, an inconvenience, a rule, a list and a candidate.*

260.1 सुविधा (suvidhā) — a convenience, a facility

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an accident, then the Hindi for danger.

You’ll want to know: सुविधा

सुविधा — *suvidhā* — “a convenience, a facility”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुविधा (*suvidhā*) is Sanskrit *suvidhā*, “good arrangement”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built from *su-*, “well”, and *vidhā*, “arrangement”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: suvidhā*
- *Say it: suvidhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *suvidhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an accident, then the Hindi for danger, then say *suvidhā* again

Before you move on

What does सुविधा mean? (“A convenience, a facility”.) Say it once more.

260.2 असुविधा (asuvidhā) — an inconvenience

Before the new one: say the Hindi for danger, then the Hindi for a convenience.

You’ll want to know: असुविधा

असुविधा — *asuvidhā* — “an inconvenience”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

असुविधा (*asuvidhā*) is *suvidhā*, “convenience”, from Sanskrit *su*-, “well”, and *vidhā*, “arrangement”, with *a*-, “not”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: asuvidhā*
- *Say it: asuvidhā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *asuvidhā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for danger, then the Hindi for a convenience, then say *asuvidhā* again

Before you move on

What does असुविधा mean? (“An inconvenience”.) Say it once more.

260.3 नियम (niyam) — a rule

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a convenience, then the Hindi for an inconvenience.

You’ll want to know: नियम

नियम — *niyam* — “a rule”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नियम (*niyam*) is Sanskrit *niyama*, “restraint, rule”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: niyam*
- *Say it: niyam*, once more
- *Say it:* say *niyam*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a convenience, then the Hindi for an inconvenience, then say *niyam* again

Before you move on

What does नियम mean? (“A rule”.) Say it once more.

260.4 सूची (sūcī) — a list

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an inconvenience, then the Hindi for a rule.

You’ll want to know: सूची

सूची — *sūcī* — “a list”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सूची (*sūcī*) is Sanskrit *sūcī*, “needle, pointer”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 13551). Hindi uses it for a list. CDIAL lists the inherited form of the same word as *sūī*, “needle”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūcī*
- *Say it: sūcī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sūcī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an inconvenience, then the Hindi for a rule, then say *sūcī* again

Before you move on

What does सूची mean? (“A list”.) Say it once more.

260.5 उम्मीदवार (ummīdvār) — a candidate

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a rule, then the Hindi for a list.

You’ll want to know: उम्मीदवार

उम्मीदवार — *ummīdvār* — “a candidate”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

उम्मीदवार (*ummīdvār*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *ummēdwār*, “one who hopes; a candidate”. It is built on *ummēd*, “hope”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ummīdvār*
- *Say it: ummīdvār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ummīdvār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a rule, then the Hindi for a list, then say *ummīdvār* again

Before you move on

What does उम्मीदवार mean? (“A candidate”.) Say it once more.

260.6 Words from chapters 252-255 — a first pass

Say the words for a list and a candidate.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a sack, a branch, a bud, a thorn, mud
- a rainbow, an earthquake, a flood, a man, a baby
- a female friend, a companion, a relative, a mother-in-law, a father-in-law
- a daughter-in-law, a son-in-law, a husband's younger brother, a husband's sister, a sister's husband

Before you move on

A sack? (बोरी, *borī.*) A branch? (डाली, *ḍālī.*) A bud? (कली, *kalī.*) A thorn? (काँटा, *kā̃ṭā.*) Mud? (कीचड़, *kīcaṛ.*) A rainbow? (इंद्रधनुष, *indradhanuṣ.*) An earthquake? (भूकंप, *bhūkamp.*) A flood? (बाढ़,

bāṛh.) A man? (पुरुष, *puruṣ.*) A baby? (शिशु, *śiśu.*) A female friend? (सहेली, *sahelī.*) A companion? (साथी, *sāthī.*) A relative? (संबंधी, *sambandhī.*) A mother-in-law? (सास, *sās.*) A father-in-law? (ससुर, *sasur.*) A daughter-in-law? (बहू, *bahū.*) A son-in-law? (दामाद, *dāmād.*) A husband's younger brother? (देवर, *devar.*) A husband's sister? (ननद, *nanad.*) A sister's husband? (जीजा, *jījā.*)

260.7 Words from chapters 256-260 — a second pass

Say the words for vomiting and a wound.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- vomiting, a wound, a bandage, an injection, a pill
- the pulse, jealousy, hatred, respect, pride
- arrogance, patience, courage, faith, loneliness
- restlessness, a crowd, an event, an accident, danger
- a convenience, an inconvenience, a rule, a list, a candidate

Before you move on

Vomiting? (उल्टी, *ulṭī.*) A wound? (घाव, *ghāv.*) A bandage? (पट्टी, *paṭṭī.*) An injection? (टीका, *ṭīkā.*) A pill? (गोली, *golī.*) The pulse? (नब्ज़, *nabz.*) Jealousy? (ईर्ष्या, *irṣyā.*) Hatred? (घृणा, *ghṛṇā.*) Respect? (सम्मान, *sammān.*) Pride? (गर्व, *garv.*) Arrogance? (अहंकार, *ahaṅkār.*) Patience? (धीरज, *dhīraj.*) Courage? (हिम्मत, *himmat.*) Faith? (विश्वास, *viśvās.*) Loneliness? (अकेलापन, *akelāpan.*) Restlessness? (बेचैनी, *becainī.*) A crowd? (भीड़, *bhīṛ.*) An event? (घटना, *ghaṭnā.*) An accident? (दुर्घटना, *durghaṭnā.*) Danger? (ख़तरा, *khatrā.*) A convenience? (सुविधा, *suvidhā.*) An inconvenience? (असुविधा, *asuvidhā.*) A rule? (नियम, *niyam.*) A list? (सूची, *sūcī.*) A candidate? (उम्मीदवार, *ummīdvār.*)

Chapter 261

A maid, A gardener, A potter, A blacksmith, A goldsmith

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a maid, a gardener, a potter, a blacksmith and a goldsmith.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 261: I can say a maid, a gardener, a potter, a blacksmith and a goldsmith.*

261.1 नौकरानी (naukarānī) — a maid

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a list, then the Hindi for a candidate.

You’ll want to know: नौकरानी

नौकरानी — *naukarānī* — “a maid”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नौकरानी (*naukarānī*) is *naukar*, “servant”, usually traced to Persian *naukar*, with the ending -*ānī* that makes a feminine.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: naukarānī*
- *Say it: naukarānī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *naukarānī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a list, then the Hindi for a candidate, then say *naukarānī* again

Before you move on

What does नौकरानी mean? (“A maid”.) Say it once more.

261.2 माली (mālī) — a gardener

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a candidate, then the Hindi for a maid.

You’ll want to know: माली

माली — *mālī* — “a gardener”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

माली (*mālī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mālin*, “garlanded; gardener” (CDIAL 10094). It is built on *mālā*, “garland”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mālī*
- *Say it: mālī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mālī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a candidate, then the Hindi for a maid, then say *mālī* again

Before you move on

What does माली mean? (“A gardener”.) Say it once more.

261.3 कुम्हार (kumhār) — a potter

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a maid, then the Hindi for a gardener.

You’ll want to know: कुम्हार

कुम्हार — *kumhār* — “a potter”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कुम्हार (*kumhār*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kumbhakāra*, “potter” (CDIAL 3310). It is built from *kumbha*, “pot”, and *kāra*, “maker”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kumhār*
- *Say it: kumhār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kumhār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a maid, then the Hindi for a gardener, then say *kumhār* again

Before you move on

What does कुम्हार mean? (“A potter”.) Say it once more.

261.4 लोहार (lohār) — a blacksmith

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a gardener, then the Hindi for a potter.

You'll want to know: लोहार

लोहार — *lohār* — "a blacksmith".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

लोहार (*lohār*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *lohakāra*, "iron-worker" (CDIAL 11159). It is built from *loha*, "iron", and *kāra*, "maker".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: lohār*
- *Say it: lohār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *lohār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a gardener, then the Hindi for a potter, then say *lohār* again

Before you move on

What does लोहार mean? ("A blacksmith".) Say it once more.

261.5 सुनार (sunār) — a goldsmith

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a potter, then the Hindi for a blacksmith.

You'll want to know: सुनार

सुनार — *sunār* — "a goldsmith".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुनार (*sunār*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *suvarṇakāra*, "goldsmith" (CDIAL 13520). It is built from *suvarṇa*, "gold", and *kāra*, "maker".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sunār*
- *Say it: sunār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sunār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a potter, then the Hindi for a blacksmith, then say *sunār* again

Before you move on

What does **सुनार** mean? ("A goldsmith".) Say it once more.

Chapter 262

A carpenter, A cobbler, A priest, A piece of jewellery, A bangle

Modes: **voice** (5) **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a carpenter, a cobbler, a priest, a piece of jewellery and a bangle.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 262: I can say a carpenter, a cobbler, a priest, a piece of jewellery and a bangle.*

262.1 बढ़ई (baṛhaī) — a carpenter

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a blacksmith, then the Hindi for a goldsmith.

You'll want to know: बढ़ई

बढ़ई — *baṛhaī* — "a carpenter".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बढ़ई (*baṛhaī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vardhaki*, "carpenter" (CDIAL 11375).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: baṛhaī*
- *Say it: baṛhaī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *baṛhaī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a blacksmith, then the Hindi for a goldsmith, then say *baṛhaī* again

Before you move on

What does बढ़ई mean? (“A carpenter”.) Say it once more.

262.2 मोची (mochī) — a cobbler

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a goldsmith, then the Hindi for a carpenter.

You’ll want to know: मोची

मोची — *mochī* — “a cobbler”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मोची (*mochī*) goes back to Sanskrit *mocika*, “tanner and cobbler”, recorded in Buddhist Sanskrit and built on *moca*, “shoe” (CDIAL 10349). CDIAL takes *moca* from an Iranian source, comparing Pahlavi (Middle Persian) *mōč*, “shoe”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mochī*
- *Say it: mochī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mochī*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a goldsmith, then the Hindi for a carpenter, then say *mochī* again

Before you move on

What does मोची mean? (“A cobbler”.) Say it once more.

262.3 पुजारी (pujārī) — a priest

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a carpenter, then the Hindi for a cobbler.

You’ll want to know: पुजारी

पुजारी — *pujārī* — “a priest”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पुजारी (*pujārī*) is *pūjā*, “worship”, from Sanskrit *pūjā* (CDIAL 8317), with the ending -*ārī*, “one who does it”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pujārī*
- *Say it: pujārī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pujārī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a carpenter, then the Hindi for a cobbler, then say *pujārī* again

Before you move on

What does पुजारी mean? (“A priest”.) Say it once more.

262.4 गहना (gahnā) — a piece of jewellery

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cobbler, then the Hindi for a priest.

You'll want to know: गहना

गहना — *gahnā* — "a piece of jewellery".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गहना (*gahnā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *grahaṇa*, "seizing; putting on (clothes)" (CDIAL 4364). CDIAL glosses the Hindi word "jewel": a thing put on.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gahnā*
- *Say it: gahnā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gahnā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cobbler, then the Hindi for a priest, then say *gahnā* again

Before you move on

What does गहना mean? ("A piece of jewellery".) Say it once more.

262.5 कंगन (kaṅgan) — a bangle, a bracelet

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a priest, then the Hindi for a piece of jewellery.

You’ll want to know: कंगन

कंगन — *kaṅgan* — “a bangle, a bracelet”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कंगन (*kaṅgan*) goes back to Sanskrit *kaṅkaṇa*, “bracelet” (CDIAL 2597). CDIAL lists Hindi *kaknā* and *kaknī* under it, but not *kaṅgan* itself.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṅgan*
- *Say it: kaṅgan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṅgan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a priest, then the Hindi for a piece of jewellery, then say *kaṅgan* again

Before you move on

What does कंगन mean? (“A bangle, a bracelet”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 263

An earring, A bindi, A bangle, An anklet, A flute

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an earring, a bindi, a bangle, an anklet and a flute.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 263: I can say an earring, a bindi, a bangle, an anklet and a flute.*

263.1 झुमका (jhumkā) — an earring

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a piece of jewellery, then the Hindi for a bangle.

You’ll want to know: झुमका

झुमका — *jhumkā* — “an earring”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झुमका (*jhumkā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **jhumma*, “crowd, cluster”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5404). CDIAL notes an added -*k*-.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhumkā*
- *Say it: jhumkā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhumkā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a piece of jewellery, then the Hindi for a bangle, then say *jhumkā* again

Before you move on

What does झुमका mean? (“An earring”.) Say it once more.

263.2 बिंदी (bindī) — a bindi

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bangle, then the Hindi for an earring.

You’ll want to know: बिंदी

बिंदी — *bindī* — “a bindi”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बिंदी (*bindī*) is built on Sanskrit *bindu*, “drop, spot”, with the ending -*ī* (CDIAL 9240). CDIAL lists the inherited form of the word as *bū̃d*, “drop”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bindī*
- *Say it: bindī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bindī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bangle, then the Hindi for an earring, then say *bindī* again

Before you move on

What does बिंदी mean? (“A bindi”.) Say it once more.

263.3 चूड़ी (cūṛī) — a bangle

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an earring, then the Hindi for a bindi.

You’ll want to know: चूड़ी

चूड़ी — *cūṛī* — “a bangle”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चूड़ी (*cūṛī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *cūḍa*, “bracelet” (CDIAL 4884). The Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: cūṛī*
- *Say it: cūṛī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *cūṛī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an earring, then the Hindi for a bindi, then say *cūṛī* again

Before you move on

What does चूड़ी mean? (“A bangle”.) Say it once more.

263.4 पायल (pāyal) — an anklet

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bindi, then the Hindi for a bangle.

You'll want to know: पायल

पायल — *pāyal* — "an anklet".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पायल (*pāyal*) goes back to a reconstructed **pādala*, "belonging to the feet", built on *pāda*, "foot" (CDIAL 8066), though CDIAL glosses the Hindi word only as "sure-footed".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pāyal*
- *Say it: pāyal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pāyal*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bindi, then the Hindi for a bangle, then say *pāyal* again

Before you move on

What does पायल mean? ("An anklet".) Say it once more.

263.5 बाँसुरी (bā̃surī) — a flute

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bangle, then the Hindi for an anklet.

You'll want to know: बाँसुरी

बाँसुरी — *bā̃surī* — "a flute".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बाँसुरी (*bāṁsurī*) belongs with Hindi *bā̃sī*, “flute”, which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *vaṁśī*, “flute, pipe”, built on *vaṁśa*, “bamboo” (CDIAL 11180). CDIAL does not list *bāṁsurī* itself.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bā̃surī*
- *Say it: bā̃surī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bā̃surī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bangle, then the Hindi for an anklet, then say *bā̃surī* again

Before you move on

What does **बाँसुरी** mean? (“A flute”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 264

A sitar, A tabla, A bell, A toy, A doll

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a sitar, a tabla, a bell, a toy and a doll.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 264: I can say a sitar, a tabla, a bell, a toy and a doll.*

264.1 सितार (sitār) — a sitar

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for an anklet, then the Hindi for a flute.

You’ll want to know: सितार

सितार — *sitār* — “a sitar”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सितार (*sitār*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *sitār*, “three strings”. It is built from *sih*, “three”, and *tār*, “string”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sitār*
- *Say it: sitār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sitār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an anklet, then the Hindi for a flute, then say *sitār* again

Before you move on

What does सितार mean? (“A sitar”.) Say it once more.

264.2 तबला (tablā) — a tabla

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a flute, then the Hindi for a sitar.

You’ll want to know: तबला

तबला — *tablā* — “a tabla”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

तबला (*tablā*) is a loan from Arabic *ṭabl*, “a drum”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṭ-b-l* (Lane).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: tablā*
- *Say it: tablā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *tablā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a flute, then the Hindi for a sitar, then say *tablā* again

Before you move on

What does तबला mean? (“A tabla”.) Say it once more.

264.3 घंटी (ghaṇṭī) — a bell

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sitar, then the Hindi for a tabla.

You’ll want to know: घंटी

घंटी — *ghaṇṭī* — “a bell”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

घंटी (*ghaṇṭī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *ghaṇṭikā*, “small bell” (CDIAL 4421). It is built on *ghaṇṭā*, “bell”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ghaṇṭī*
- *Say it: ghaṇṭī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ghaṇṭī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sitar, then the Hindi for a tabla, then say *ghaṇṭī* again

Before you move on

What does घंटी mean? (“A bell”.) Say it once more.

264.4 खिलौना (khilaunā) — a toy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tabla, then the Hindi for a bell.

You’ll want to know: खिलौना

खिलौना — *khilaunā* — “a toy”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खिलौना (*khilaunā*) is built on *khel-*, “play”, with the ending *-aunā*: a thing to play with. CDIAL lists the verb under a reconstructed **khel-*, “play” (CDIAL 3918).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khilaunā*
- *Say it: khilaunā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khilaunā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tabla, then the Hindi for a bell, then say *khilaunā* again

Before you move on

What does खिलौना mean? (“A toy”.) Say it once more.

264.5 गुड़िया (guṛiyā) — a doll

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a bell, then the Hindi for a toy.

You’ll want to know: गुड़िया

गुड़िया — *guṛiyā* — “a doll”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गुड़िया (*guṛiyā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **guḍḍa*, “doll, effigy”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4189).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: guṛiyā*
- *Say it: guṛiyā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *guṛiyā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a bell, then the Hindi for a toy, then say *guṛiyā* again

Before you move on

What does **गुड़िया** mean? ("A doll".) Say it once more.

Chapter 265

A kite, A swing, A curtain, A cotton rug, A carpet

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a kite, a swing, a curtain, a cotton rug and a carpet.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 265: I can say a kite, a swing, a curtain, a cotton rug and a carpet.*

265.1 पतंग (patang) — a kite

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a toy, then the Hindi for a doll.

You’ll want to know: पतंग

पतंग — *patang* — “a kite”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पतंग (*patang*) is usually traced to Sanskrit *pataṅga*, “bird; winged insect”. CDIAL lists that word, with Hindi *patiṅgā*, “grasshopper”, as its inherited form (CDIAL 7721), but not *patang*, “kite”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: patang*
- *Say it: patang*, once more
- *Say it:* say *patang*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a toy, then the Hindi for a doll, then say *patang* again

Before you move on

What does पतंग mean? (“A kite”.) Say it once more.

265.2 झूला (jhūlā) — a swing

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a doll, then the Hindi for a kite.

You’ll want to know: झूला

झूला — *jhūlā* — “a swing”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

झूला (*jhūlā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **jhulyati*, “swings”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5406). *jhūlā* is the noun of *jhūlnā*, “to swing”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhūlā*
- *Say it: jhūlā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhūlā*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a doll, then the Hindi for a kite, then say *jhūlā* again

Before you move on

What does झूला mean? (“A swing”.) Say it once more.

265.3 पर्दा (pardā) — a curtain

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a kite, then the Hindi for a swing.

You’ll want to know: पर्दा

पर्दा — *pardā* — “a curtain”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पर्दा (*pardā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *parda*, “curtain, veil”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pardā*
- *Say it: pardā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pardā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a kite, then the Hindi for a swing, then say *pardā* again

Before you move on

What does पर्दा mean? (“A curtain”.) Say it once more.

265.4 दरी (darī) — a cotton rug

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a swing, then the Hindi for a curtain.

You'll want to know: दरी

दरी — *darī* — "a cotton rug".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दरी (*darī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **darikā*, "split cane, mat", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6194). CDIAL glosses the Hindi word "carpet".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: darī*
- *Say it: darī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *darī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a swing, then the Hindi for a curtain, then say *darī* again

Before you move on

What does दरी mean? ("A cotton rug".) Say it once more.

265.5 क़ालीन (qālīn) — a carpet

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a curtain, then the Hindi for a cotton rug.

You’ll want to know: क़ालीन

क़ालीन — *qālīn* — “a carpet”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

क़ालीन (*qālīn*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *qālī*, “carpet”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: qālīn*
- *Say it: qālīn*, once more
- *Say it:* say *qālīn*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a curtain, then the Hindi for a cotton rug, then say *qālīn* again

Before you move on

What does क़ालीन mean? (“A carpet”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 266

A latch, A saw, A pickaxe, A spade, A mattress

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a latch, a saw, a pickaxe, a spade and a mattress.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 266: I can say a latch, a saw, a pickaxe, a spade and a mattress.*

266.1 चिटकनी (ciṭkanī) — a latch

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a cotton rug, then the Hindi for a carpet.

You’ll want to know: चिटकनी

चिटकनी — *ciṭkanī* — “a latch”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

चिटकनी (*ciṭkanī*) is inherited: CDIAL lists it, as *chiṭkanī*, “bolt”, under a reconstructed **chaṭa*, “stick, cane”, in the variant **chiṭṭa* (CDIAL 4966). A bolt is a small stick across the door.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ciṭkanī*
- *Say it: ciṭkanī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ciṭkanī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a cotton rug, then the Hindi for a carpet, then say *ciṭkanī* again

Before you move on

What does चिटकनी mean? (“A latch”.) Say it once more.

266.2 आरी (ārī) — a saw

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a carpet, then the Hindi for a latch.

You’ll want to know: आरी

आरी — *ārī* — “a saw”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आरी (*ārī*) is listed by CDIAL in the sense “awl”, under Sanskrit *ārā*, “shoemaker’s awl” (CDIAL 1313). The sense “saw” is not recorded there.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ārī*
- *Say it: ārī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ārī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a carpet, then the Hindi for a latch, then say *ārī* again

Before you move on

What does आरी mean? (“A saw”.) Say it once more.

266.3 कुदाल (kudāl) — a pickaxe, a hoe

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a latch, then the Hindi for a saw.

You’ll want to know: कुदाल

कुदाल — *kudāl* — “a pickaxe, a hoe”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कुदाल (*kudāl*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kuddāla*, “a kind of spade or mattock” (CDIAL 3286). CDIAL takes the Sanskrit word, probably, from Dravidian.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kudāl*
- *Say it: kudāl*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kudāl*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a latch, then the Hindi for a saw, then say *kudāl* again

Before you move on

What does कुदाल mean? (“A pickaxe, a hoe”.) Say it once more.

266.4 फावड़ा (phāvṛā) — a spade

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a saw, then the Hindi for a pickaxe.

You'll want to know: फावड़ा

फावड़ा — *phāvṛā* — "a spade".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

फावड़ा (*phāvṛā*) is listed by CDIAL under Sanskrit *sphya*, "a flat wooden blade", but CDIAL calls the connexion possible yet obscure (CDIAL 13839).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: phāvṛā*
- *Say it: phāvṛā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *phāvṛā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a saw, then the Hindi for a pickaxe, then say *phāvṛā* again

Before you move on

What does फावड़ा mean? ("A spade".) Say it once more.

266.5 गद्दा (gaddā) — a mattress

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pickaxe, then the Hindi for a spade.

You'll want to know: गद्दा

गद्दा — *gaddā* — "a mattress".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गद्दा (*gaddā*) goes back to a reconstructed **garda*, "seat" (CDIAL 4053). CDIAL marks the Hindi form as taken over from Punjabi.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gaddā*
- *Say it: gaddā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gaddā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pickaxe, then the Hindi for a spade, then say *gaddā* again

Before you move on

What does गद्दा mean? ("A mattress".) Say it once more.

Chapter 267

A quilt, A mosquito net, A tap, A drain, A tank

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a quilt, a mosquito net, a tap, a drain and a tank.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 267: I can say a quilt, a mosquito net, a tap, a drain and a tank.*

267.1 रजाई (rajāī) — a quilt

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a spade, then the Hindi for a mattress.

You’ll want to know: रजाई

रजाई — *rajāī* — “a quilt”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of रजाई (*rajāī*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rajāī*
- *Say it: rajāī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rajāī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a spade, then the Hindi for a mattress, then say *rajāī* again

Before you move on

What does **रजाई** mean? (“A quilt”.) Say it once more.

267.2 मच्छरदानी (maccharadānī) — a mosquito net

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mattress, then the Hindi for a quilt.

You’ll want to know: मच्छरदानी

मच्छरदानी — *maccharadānī* — “a mosquito net”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मच्छरदानी (*maccharadānī*) is *macchar*, “mosquito”, from Sanskrit *matsara* (CDIAL 9757), with the Persian ending -*dānī*, “holder, container”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maccharadānī*
- *Say it: maccharadānī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maccharadānī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mattress, then the Hindi for a quilt, then say *maccharadānī* again

Before you move on

What does मच्छरदानी mean? ("A mosquito net".) Say it once more.

267.3 नल (nal) — a tap

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a quilt, then the Hindi for a mosquito net.

You'll want to know: नल

नल — *nal* — "a tap".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नल (*nal*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. CDIAL does not list *nal* itself. It puts Hindi *nalā*, "hollow reed, windpipe", under *naḍaka*, "hollow of a bone", a form beside Sanskrit *naḍa*, "a species of reed", which keeps the plain reed-word *naṛ* (CDIAL 6936). It notes possible Dravidian or Munda contact.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nal*
- *Say it: nal*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nal*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a quilt, then the Hindi for a mosquito net, then say *nal* again

Before you move on

What does नल mean? ("A tap".) Say it once more.

267.4 नाली (nālī) — a drain

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a mosquito net, then the Hindi for a tap.

You'll want to know: नाली

नाली — *nālī* — "a drain".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

नाली (*nālī*) belongs with Hindi *nāl*, "hollow stalk, tube", and *nārī*, "tube, vein", which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *nāḍī*, "tubular stalk, tube" (CDIAL 7047).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nālī*
- *Say it: nālī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nālī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a mosquito net, then the Hindi for a tap, then say *nālī* again

Before you move on

What does नाली mean? ("A drain".) Say it once more.

267.5 टंकी (ṭaṅkī) — a tank

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tap, then the Hindi for a drain.

You'll want to know: टंकी

टंकी — *ṭaṅkī* — "a tank".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

टंकी (*ṭaṅkī*) is a loan from English *tank*. The -*ī* makes a smaller one.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: ṭaṅkī*
- *Say it: ṭaṅkī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *ṭaṅkī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tap, then the Hindi for a drain, then say *ṭaṅkī* again

Before you move on

What does टंकी mean? ("A tank".) Say it once more.

Chapter 268

Rubbish, A dustbin, Smoke, Fire, Ash

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say rubbish, a dustbin, smoke, fire and ash.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 268: I can say rubbish, a dustbin, smoke, fire and ash.*

268.1 कूड़ा (kūṛā) — rubbish

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a drain, then the Hindi for a tank.

You'll want to know: कूड़ा

कूड़ा — *kūṛā* — "rubbish".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कूड़ा (*kūṛā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kūṭa*, "heap, multitude" (CDIAL 3392). CDIAL takes the Sanskrit word, probably, from Dravidian; it glosses the Hindi "dustheap".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kūṛā*
- *Say it: kūṛā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kūṛā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a drain, then the Hindi for a tank, then say *kūṛā* again

Before you move on

What does कूड़ा mean? ("Rubbish".) Say it once more.

268.2 कूड़ेदान (kūṛedān) — a dustbin

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tank, then the Hindi for rubbish.

You'll want to know: कूड़ेदान

कूड़ेदान — *kūṛedān* — "a dustbin".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कूड़ेदान (*kūṛedān*) is *kūṛā*, "rubbish", from Sanskrit *kūṭa*, "heap", which CDIAL takes as probably from Dravidian (CDIAL 3392), with the Persian ending -*dān*, "holder".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kūṛedān*
- *Say it: kūṛedān*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kūṛedān*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tank, then the Hindi for rubbish, then say *kūṛedān* again

Before you move on

What does कूड़ेदान mean? (“A dustbin”.) Say it once more.

268.3 धुआँ (dhuā̃) — smoke

Before the new one: say the Hindi for rubbish, then the Hindi for a dustbin.

You’ll want to know: धुआँ

धुआँ — *dhuā̃* — “smoke”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धुआँ (*dhuāṁ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *dhūma*, “smoke, vapour” (CDIAL 6849).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhuā̃*
- *Say it: dhuā̃*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhuā̃*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for rubbish, then the Hindi for a dustbin, then say *dhuā̃* again

Before you move on

What does धुआँ mean? (“Smoke”.) Say it once more.

268.4 आग (āg) — fire

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a dustbin, then the Hindi for smoke.

You'll want to know: आग

आग — *āg* — "fire".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

आग (*āg*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *agni*, "fire" (CDIAL 55).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: āg*
- *Say it: āg*, once more
- *Say it:* say *āg*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a dustbin, then the Hindi for smoke, then say *āg* again

Before you move on

What does आग mean? ("Fire".) Say it once more.

268.5 राख (rākh) — ash

Before the new one: say the Hindi for smoke, then the Hindi for fire.

You'll want to know: राख

राख — *rākh* — "ash".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

राख (*rākh*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *rakṣā*, “ashes” (CDIAL 10552). The Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rākh*
- *Say it: rākh*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rākh*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for smoke, then the Hindi for fire, then say *rākh* again

Before you move on

What does राख mean? (“Ash”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 269

Coal, Gas, A wok, A rolling pin, A sieve

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say coal, gas, a wok, a rolling pin and a sieve.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 269: I can say coal, gas, a wok, a rolling pin and a sieve.*

269.1 कोयला (koylā) — coal

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for fire, then the Hindi for ash.

You'll want to know: कोयला

कोयला — *koylā* — "coal".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कोयला (*koylā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kokila*, "lighted coal, charcoal" (CDIAL 3484). CDIAL notes that the Sanskrit word was made over from a Middle Indo-Aryan *koila*, which has been traced to Munda.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: koylā*
- *Say it: koylā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *koylā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for fire, then the Hindi for ash, then say *koylā* again

Before you move on

What does कोयला mean? ("Coal".) Say it once more.

269.2 गैस (gais) — gas

Before the new one: say the Hindi for ash, then the Hindi for coal.

You'll want to know: गैस

गैस — *gais* — "gas".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गैस (*gais*) is a loan from English *gas*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: gais*
- *Say it: gais*, once more
- *Say it:* say *gais*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for ash, then the Hindi for coal, then say *gais* again

Before you move on

What does गैस mean? (“Gas”.) Say it once more.

269.3 कड़ाही (kaṛāhī) — a wok

Before the new one: say the Hindi for coal, then the Hindi for gas.

You’ll want to know: कड़ाही

कड़ाही — *kaṛāhī* — “a wok”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कड़ाही (*kaṛāhī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kaṭāha*, “boiler, saucepan” (CDIAL 2638).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaṛāhī*
- *Say it: kaṛāhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaṛāhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for coal, then the Hindi for gas, then say *kaṛāhī* again

Before you move on

What does कड़ाही mean? (“A wok”.) Say it once more.

269.4 बेलन (belan) — a rolling pin

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for gas, then the Hindi for a wok.

You'll want to know: बेलन

बेलन — *belan* — "a rolling pin".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बेलन (*belan*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *vellana*, "shaking; rolling-pin" (CDIAL 12120).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: belan*
- *Say it: belan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *belan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for gas, then the Hindi for a wok, then say *belan* again

Before you move on

What does बेलन mean? ("A rolling pin".) Say it once more.

269.5 छलनी (chalnī) — a sieve

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a wok, then the Hindi for a rolling pin.

You'll want to know: छलनी

छलनी — *chalnī* — "a sieve".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

छलनी (*chalnī*) belongs with Hindi *cālnī*, “sieve”, which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *cālanī*, “strainer, sieve” (CDIAL 4771).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: chalnī*
- *Say it: chalnī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *chalnī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a wok, then the Hindi for a rolling pin, then say *chalnī* again

Before you move on

What does छलनी mean? (“A sieve”.) Say it once more.

269.6 Words from chapters 261-264 — a first pass

Say the words for a rolling pin and a sieve.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a maid, a gardener, a potter, a blacksmith, a goldsmith
- a carpenter, a cobbler, a priest, a piece of jewellery, a bangle
- an earring, a bindi, a bangle, an anklet, a flute
- a sitar, a tabla, a bell, a toy, a doll

Before you move on

A maid? (नौकरानी, *naukarānī.*) A gardener? (माली, *mālī.*) A potter? (कुम्हार, *kumhār.*) A blacksmith? (लोहार, *lohār.*) A goldsmith? (सुनार, *sunār.*) A carpenter? (बढ़ई, *baṛhaī.*) A cobbler? (मोची, *mochī.*) A priest? (पुजारी, *pujārī.*) A piece of jewellery? (गहना, *gahnā.*) A bangle? (कंगन, *kaṅgan.*) An earring? (झुमका, *jhumkā.*) A bindi? (बिंदी, *bindī.*) A bangle? (चूड़ी, *cūṛī.*) An anklet? (पायल, *pāyal.*) A flute? (बाँसुरी, *bā̃surī.*) A sitar? (सितार, *sitār.*) A tabla? (तबला, *tablā.*) A bell? (घंटी, *ghaṇṭī.*) A toy? (खिलौना, *khilaunā.*) A doll? (गुड़िया, *guṛiyā.*)

269.7 Words from chapters 265-269 — a second pass

Say the words for a kite and a swing.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a kite, a swing, a curtain, a cotton rug, a carpet
- a latch, a saw, a pickaxe, a spade, a mattress
- a quilt, a mosquito net, a tap, a drain, a tank
- rubbish, a dustbin, smoke, fire, ash
- coal, gas, a wok, a rolling pin, a sieve

Before you move on

A kite? (पतंग, *patang.*) A swing? (झूला, *jhūlā.*) A curtain? (पर्दा, *pardā.*) A cotton rug? (दरी, *darī.*) A carpet? (क़ालीन, *qālīn.*) A latch? (चिटकनी, *ciṭkanī.*) A saw? (आरी, *ārī.*) A pickaxe? (कुदाल, *kudāl.*) A spade? (फावड़ा, *phāvṛā.*) A mattress? (गद्दा, *gaddā.*) A quilt? (रजाई, *rajāī.*) A mosquito net? (मच्छरदानी, *maccharadānī.*) A tap? (नल, *nal.*) A drain? (नाली, *nālī.*) A tank? (टंकी, *ṭaṅkī.*) Rubbish? (कूड़ा, *kūṛā.*) A dustbin? (कूड़ेदान, *kūṛedān.*) Smoke? (धुआँ,

dhuā̃.) Fire? (आग, *āg.*) Ash? (राख, *rākh.*) Coal? (कोयला, *koylā.*) Gas? (गैस, *gais.*) A wok? (कड़ाही, *kaṛāhī.*) A rolling pin? (बेलन, *belan.*) A sieve? (छलनी, *chalnī.*)

Chapter 270

A grater, A lid, A jug, A water jar, A clay pot

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a grater, a lid, a jug, a water jar and a clay pot.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 270: I can say a grater, a lid, a jug, a water jar and a clay pot.*

270.1 कद्दूकस (kaddūkas) — a grater

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a rolling pin, then the Hindi for a sieve.

You'll want to know: कद्दूकस

कद्दूकस — *kaddūkas* — "a grater".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कद्दूकस (*kaddūkas*) is *kaddū*, "gourd", usually traced to Persian *kadū*, with *kas*, "scraping". CDIAL has no entry for the compound.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kaddūkas*
- *Say it: kaddūkas*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kaddūkas*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a rolling pin, then the Hindi for a sieve, then say *kaddūkas* again

Before you move on

What does कद्दूकस mean? (“A grater”.) Say it once more.

270.2 ढक्कन (dhakkan) — a lid

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sieve, then the Hindi for a grater.

You’ll want to know: ढक्कन

ढक्कन — *dhakkan* — “a lid”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

ढक्कन (*ḍhakkan*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **ḍhakk*, “cover”, a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 5574). CDIAL compares a Jain Sanskrit *ḍhakkana*, “shutting”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhakkan*
- *Say it: dhakkan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhakkan*

- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sieve, then the Hindi for a grater, then say *dhakkan* again

Before you move on

What does ढक्कन mean? (“A lid”.) Say it once more.

270.3 जग (jag) — a jug

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a grater, then the Hindi for a lid.

You’ll want to know: जग

जग — *jag* — “a jug”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जग (*jag*) is a loan from English *jug*.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jag*
- *Say it: jag*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jag*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a grater, then the Hindi for a lid, then say *jag* again

Before you move on

What does जग mean? (“A jug”.) Say it once more.

270.4 सुराही (surāhī) — a water jar

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lid, then the Hindi for a jug.

You'll want to know: सुराही

सुराही — *surāhī* — "a water jar".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सुराही (*surāhī*) is a loan from Arabic *ṣurāḥī*, "a long-necked flask", which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ṣ-r-ḥ* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: surāhī*
- *Say it: surāhī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *surāhī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lid, then the Hindi for a jug, then say *surāhī* again

Before you move on

What does सुराही mean? ("A water jar".) Say it once more.

270.5 मटका (maṭkā) — a clay pot

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a jug, then the Hindi for a water jar.

You'll want to know: मटका

मटका — *maṭkā* — "a clay pot".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मटका (*maṭkā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mṛdā*, “earth, clay” (CDIAL 10291). CDIAL notes an added -*k*-.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: maṭkā*
- *Say it: maṭkā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *maṭkā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a jug, then the Hindi for a water jar, then say *maṭkā* again

Before you move on

What does **मटका** mean? (“A clay pot”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 271

An office, Insurance, Interest, A tenant, A neighbourhood

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say an office, insurance, interest, a tenant and a neighbourhood.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 271: I can say an office, insurance, interest, a tenant and a neighbourhood.*

271.1 कार्यालय (kāryālay) — an office

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a water jar, then the Hindi for a clay pot.

You'll want to know: कार्यालय

कार्यालय — *kāryālay* — “an office”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

कार्यालय (*kāryālay*) is a tatsama compound, taken over whole from Sanskrit: *kārya*, “work, business”, and *ālaya*, “abode”.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: kāryālay*
- *Say it: kāryālay*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kāryālay*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a water jar, then the Hindi for a clay pot, then say *kāryālay* again

Before you move on

What does कार्यालय mean? (“An office”.) Say it once more.

271.2 बीमा (bīmā) — insurance

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a clay pot, then the Hindi for an office.

You’ll want to know: बीमा

बीमा — *bīmā* — “insurance”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बीमा (*bīmā*) is a loan, usually traced to Persian *bīma*, “insurance”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bīmā*
- *Say it: bīmā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bīmā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a clay pot, then the Hindi for an office, then say *bīmā* again

Before you move on

What does बीमा mean? (“Insurance”.) Say it once more.

271.3 ब्याज (byāj) — interest (on money)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an office, then the Hindi for insurance.

You’ll want to know: ब्याज

ब्याज — *byāj* — “interest (on money)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of ब्याज (*byāj*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: byāj*
- *Say it: byāj*, once more
- *Say it:* say *byāj*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an office, then the Hindi for insurance, then say *byāj* again

Before you move on

What does ब्याज mean? (“Interest (on money)”.) Say it once more.

271.4 किरायेदार (kirāyedār) — a tenant

Before the new one: say the Hindi for insurance, then the Hindi for interest.

You’ll want to know: किरायेदार

किरायेदार — *kirāyedār* — “a tenant”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

किरायेदार (*kirāyedār*) is *kirāyā*, “rent”, from Arabic *kirāʔ*, “hire”, through Persian (Lane, root *k-r-y*), with the Persian ending -*dār*, “holder”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it:* *kirāyedār*
- *Say it:* *kirāyedār*, once more
- *Say it:* say *kirāyedār*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for insurance, then the Hindi for interest, then say *kirāyedār* again

Before you move on

What does किरायेदार mean? (“A tenant”.) Say it once more.

271.5 मोहल्ला (mohallā) — a neighbourhood

Before the new one: say the Hindi for interest, then the Hindi for a tenant.

You’ll want to know: मोहल्ला

मोहल्ला — *mohallā* — “a neighbourhood”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मोहल्ला (*mohallā*) is a loan from Arabic *maḥalla*, “a quarter where people alight”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *ḥ-l-l* (Lane).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: mohallā*
- *Say it: mohallā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *mohallā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for interest, then the Hindi for a tenant, then say *mohallā* again

Before you move on

What does **मोहल्ला** mean? ("A neighbourhood".) Say it once more.

Chapter 272

A lane, A street corner, A fair, A procession, A speech

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a lane, a street corner, a fair, a procession and a speech.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 272: I can say a lane, a street corner, a fair, a procession and a speech.*

272.1 गली (galī) — a lane

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a tenant, then the Hindi for a neighbourhood.

You'll want to know: गली

गली — *galī* — "a lane".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

गली (*galī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **galī*, "defile, lane", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 4085).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: galī*
- *Say it: galī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *galī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a tenant, then the Hindi for a neighbourhood, then say *galī* again

Before you move on

What does **गली** mean? (“A lane”.) Say it once more.

272.2 नुक्कड़ (nukkaṛ) — a street corner

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a neighbourhood, then the Hindi for a lane.

You’ll want to know: नुक्कड़

नुक्कड़ — *nukkaṛ* — “a street corner”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of नुक्कड़ (*nukkaṛ*) is uncertain. CDIAL has no entry for it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: nukkaṛ*
- *Say it: nukkaṛ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *nukkaṛ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a neighbourhood, then the Hindi for a lane, then say *nukkaṛ* again

Before you move on

What does नुक्कड़ mean? ("A street corner".) Say it once more.

272.3 मेला (melā) — a fair

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a lane, then the Hindi for a street corner.

You'll want to know: मेला

मेला — *melā* — "a fair".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

मेला (*melā*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *mela*, "meeting" (CDIAL 10331). It is built on *mil-*, "to meet", the root of *milnā*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: melā*
- *Say it: melā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *melā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a lane, then the Hindi for a street corner, then say *melā* again

Before you move on

What does मेला mean? ("A fair".) Say it once more.

272.4 जुलूस (jalūs) — a procession

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a street corner, then the Hindi for a fair.

You’ll want to know: जुलूस

जुलूस — *jalūs* — “a procession”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जुलूस (*julūs*) is a loan from Arabic *julūs*, “a sitting; enthronement”, which reached Hindi through Persian. Its Arabic root is *j-l-s* (Lane). Hindi uses it for the procession that went with it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jalūs*
- *Say it: jalūs*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jalūs*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a street corner, then the Hindi for a fair, then say *jalūs* again

Before you move on

What does जुलूस mean? (“A procession”.) Say it once more.

272.5 भाषण (bhāṣaṇ) — a speech

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a fair, then the Hindi for a procession.

You’ll want to know: भाषण

भाषण — *bhāṣaṇ* — “a speech”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

भाषण (*bhāṣaṇ*) is Sanskrit *bhāṣaṇa*, “speaking, speech”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. It is built on *bhāṣ-*, “to speak”, the root of भाषा.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bhāṣaṇ*
- *Say it: bhāṣaṇ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bhāṣaṇ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a fair, then the Hindi for a procession, then say *bhāṣaṇ* again

Before you move on

What does **भाषण** mean? ("A speech".) Say it once more.

Chapter 273

The police, A pharmacy, A patient, A disease, An illness

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say the police, a pharmacy, a patient, a disease and an illness.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 273: I can say the police, a pharmacy, a patient, a disease and an illness.*

273.1 पुलिस (pulis) — the police

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a procession, then the Hindi for a speech.

You'll want to know: पुलिस

पुलिस — *pulis* — "the police".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

पुलिस (*pulis*) is a loan from English *police*.

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: pulis*
- *Say it: pulis*, once more
- *Say it:* say *pulis*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a procession, then the Hindi for a speech, then say *pulis* again

Before you move on

What does पुलिस mean? (“The police”.) Say it once more.

273.2 दवाख़ाना (davākhānā) — a pharmacy

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a speech, then the Hindi for the police.

You’ll want to know: दवाख़ाना

दवाख़ाना — *davākhānā* — “a pharmacy”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

दवाख़ाना (*davākhānā*) is *davā*, “medicine”, from Arabic *dawāʾ* through Persian (Lane, root *d-w-y*), with Persian *khāna*, “house”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: davākhānā*
- *Say it: davākhānā*, once more
- *Say it:* say *davākhānā*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a speech, then the Hindi for the police, then say *davākhānā* again

Before you move on

What does दवाख़ाना mean? (“A pharmacy”.) Say it once more.

273.3 रोगी (rogī) — a patient, a sick person

Before the new one: say the Hindi for the police, then the Hindi for a pharmacy.

You’ll want to know: रोगी

रोगी — *rogī* — “a patient, a sick person”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रोगी (*rogī*) is Sanskrit *rogin*, “sick”, taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama. Hindi took its nominative, *rogī*. It is built on *roga*, “disease”.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rogī*
- *Say it: rogī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rogī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for the police, then the Hindi for a pharmacy, then say *rogī* again

Before you move on

What does रोगी mean? (“A patient, a sick person”.) Say it once more.

273.4 रोग (rog) — a disease

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a pharmacy, then the Hindi for a patient.

You'll want to know: रोग

रोग — *rog* — "a disease".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

रोग (*rog*) is Sanskrit *roga*, "disease", taken over whole as a learned loan, a tatsama (CDIAL 10829).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: rog*
- *Say it: rog*, once more
- *Say it:* say *rog*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a pharmacy, then the Hindi for a patient, then say *rog* again

Before you move on

What does रोग mean? ("A disease".) Say it once more.

273.5 बीमारी (bīmārī) — an illness

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a patient, then the Hindi for a disease.

You'll want to know: बीमारी

बीमारी — *bīmārī* — "an illness".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

बीमारी (*bīmārī*) is *bīmār*, “sick”, usually traced to Persian *bīmār*, with the ending -*ī* that makes a noun.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: bīmārī*
- *Say it: bīmārī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *bīmārī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a patient, then the Hindi for a disease, then say *bīmārī* again

Before you move on

What does बीमारी mean? (“An illness”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 274

A heartbeat, Breath, An itch, A burning feeling, A swelling

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (5) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 5 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a heartbeat, breath, an itch, a burning feeling and a swelling.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 274: I can say a heartbeat, breath, an itch, a burning feeling and a swelling.*

274.1 धड़कन (dhaṛkan) — a heartbeat

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a disease, then the Hindi for an illness.

You'll want to know: धड़कन

धड़कन — *dhaṛkan* — "a heartbeat".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

धड़कन (*dhaṛkan*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **dhaḍ*, "throb, beat", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 6711). *dhaṛkan* is the noun of *dhaṛaknā*, "to throb".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: dhaṛkan*
- *Say it: dhaṛkan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *dhaṛkan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a disease, then the Hindi for an illness, then say *dhaṛkan* again

Before you move on

What does धड़कन mean? (“A heartbeat”.) Say it once more.

274.2 साँस (sā̃s) — breath

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an illness, then the Hindi for a heartbeat.

You’ll want to know: साँस

साँस — *sā̃s* — “breath”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

साँस (*sāṁs*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *śvāsa*, “breath, breathing” (CDIAL 12769).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sā̃s*
- *Say it: sā̃s*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sā̃s*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an illness, then the Hindi for a heartbeat, then say *sā̃s* again

Before you move on

What does साँस mean? (“Breath”.) Say it once more.

274.3 खुजली (khujlī) — an itch

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a heartbeat, then the Hindi for breath.

You’ll want to know: खुजली

खुजली — *khujlī* — “an itch”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

खुजली (*khujlī*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *kharju*, “itching, scab” (CDIAL 3827). CDIAL takes the word from Dravidian. The Sanskrit word is known only from the old word-lists.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: khujlī*
- *Say it: khujlī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *khujlī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a heartbeat, then the Hindi for breath, then say *khujlī* again

Before you move on

What does खुजली mean? (“An itch”.) Say it once more.

274.4 जलन (jalan) — a burning feeling

Before the new one: say the Hindi for breath, then the Hindi for an itch.

You'll want to know: जलन

जलन — *jalan* — "a burning feeling".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

जलन (*jalan*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited from Sanskrit and reshaped by sound change. It comes from *jvalana*, "burning" (CDIAL 5307).

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jalan*
- *Say it: jalan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jalan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for breath, then the Hindi for an itch, then say *jalan* again

Before you move on

What does जलन mean? ("A burning feeling".) Say it once more.

274.5 सूजन (sūjan) — a swelling

Before the new one: say the Hindi for an itch, then the Hindi for a burning feeling.

You'll want to know: सूजन

सूजन — *sūjan* — "a swelling".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

सूजन (*sūjan*) is the noun of *sūjnā*, “to swell”, which comes from Sanskrit *śūyate*, “is swollen” (CDIAL 12568).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: sūjan*
- *Say it: sūjan*, once more
- *Say it:* say *sūjan*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for an itch, then the Hindi for a burning feeling, then say *sūjan* again

Before you move on

What does **सूजन** mean? (“A swelling”.) Say it once more.

Chapter 275

A sprain, A hiccup, A nap, Turning over, A stretch

Modes: 🚗 **voice** (7) 🚗 **Hands-free start:** all 7 lessons.

> ***By the end of this chapter:*** I can say a sprain, a hiccup, a nap, turning over and a stretch.
>
> *Complete the last lesson of chapter 275: I can say a sprain, a hiccup, a nap, turning over and a stretch.*

275.1 मोच (moc) — a sprain

> Before the new one: say the Hindi for a burning feeling, then the Hindi for a swelling.

You’ll want to know: मोच

मोच — *moc* — “a sprain”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of **मोच** (*moc*) is uncertain. CDIAL has a reconstructed **mocc*, “twist, wring” (CDIAL 10351), but lists no Hindi form under it.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: moc*
- *Say it: moc*, once more
- *Say it:* say *moc*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a burning feeling, then the Hindi for a swelling, then say *moc* again

Before you move on

What does **मोच** mean? (“A sprain”.) Say it once more.

275.2 हिचकी (hickī) — a hiccup

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a swelling, then the Hindi for a sprain.

You’ll want to know: हिचकी

हिचकी — *hickī* — “a hiccup”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

हिचकी (*hickī*) belongs with Hindi *hīk*, “hiccup”, which CDIAL lists under Sanskrit *hikkā*, “hiccup” (CDIAL 14075). The word imitates the sound.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: hickī*
- *Say it: hickī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *hickī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a swelling, then the Hindi for a sprain, then say *hickī* again

Before you move on

What does हिचकी mean? (“A hiccup”.) Say it once more.

275.3 झपकी (jhapkī) — a nap

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a sprain, then the Hindi for a hiccup.

You’ll want to know: झपकी

झपकी — *jhapkī* — “a nap”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

The origin of झपकी (*jhapkī*) is uncertain. It may belong with *jhapaknā*, which CDIAL lists under a reconstructed **jhapp*, “sudden movement” (CDIAL 5336).

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: jhapkī*
- *Say it: jhapkī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *jhapkī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a sprain, then the Hindi for a hiccup, then say *jhapkī* again

Before you move on

What does झपकी mean? (“A nap”.) Say it once more.

275.4 करवट (karvaṭ) — turning over (in bed)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a hiccup, then the Hindi for a nap.

You'll want to know: करवट

करवट — *karvaṭ* — "turning over (in bed)".

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

करवट (*karvaṭ*) is a tadbhava, a word inherited and reshaped by sound change. It comes from **kaṭavṛtti*, "turning on one's side", a form CDIAL reconstructs from its descendants (CDIAL 2635). It is built from *kaṭi*, "hip", and *vṛtti*, "turning".

What you've built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: karvaṭ*
- *Say it: karvaṭ*, once more
- *Say it:* say *karvaṭ*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a hiccup, then the Hindi for a nap, then say *karvaṭ* again

Before you move on

What does करवट mean? ("Turning over (in bed)".) Say it once more.

275.5 अंगड़ाई (aṅgṛāī) — a stretch (of the body)

Before the new one: say the Hindi for a nap, then the Hindi for turning over.

You’ll want to know: अंगड़ाई

अंगड़ाई — *aṅgṛāī* — “a stretch (of the body)”.

The word, taken apart — its roots and family

अंगड़ाई (*aṅgṛāī*) is built on *aṅg*, “limb, body”, from Sanskrit *aṅga* (CDIAL 114), but CDIAL does not list the word itself, so its exact path is uncertain.

What you’ve built

One more word for this chapter.

Your turn

- *Say it: aṅgṛāī*
- *Say it: aṅgṛāī*, once more
- *Say it:* say *aṅgṛāī*
- *Recall:* say the Hindi for a nap, then the Hindi for turning over, then say *aṅgṛāī* again

Before you move on

What does अंगड़ाई mean? (“A stretch (of the body)”.) Say it once more.

275.6 Words from chapters 270-272 — a first pass

Say the words for turning over and a stretch.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- a grater, a lid, a jug, a water jar, a clay pot
- an office, insurance, interest, a tenant, a neighbourhood
- a lane, a street corner, a fair, a procession, a speech

Before you move on

A grater? (कद्दूकस, *kaddūkas.*) A lid? (ढक्कन, *dhakkan.*) A jug? (जग, *jag.*) A water jar? (सुराही, *surāhī.*) A clay pot? (मटका, *maṭkā.*) An office? (कार्यालय, *kāryālay.*) Insurance? (बीमा, *bīmā.*) Interest? (ब्याज, *byāj.*) A tenant? (किरायेदार, *kirāyedār.*) A neighbourhood? (मोहल्ला, *mohallā.*) A lane? (गली, *galī.*) A street corner? (नुक्कड़, *nukkaṛ.*) A fair? (मेला, *melā.*) A procession? (जुलूस, *jalūs.*) A speech? (भाषण, *bhāṣaṇ.*)

275.7 Words from chapters 273-275 — a second pass

Say the words for the police and a pharmacy.

Your turn

Say these aloud:

- the police, a pharmacy, a patient, a disease, an illness
- a heartbeat, breath, an itch, a burning feeling, a swelling
- a sprain, a hiccup, a nap, turning over, a stretch

Before you move on

The police? (पुलिस, *pulis.*) A pharmacy? (दवाख़ाना, *davākhānā.*) A patient? (रोगी, *rogī.*) A disease? (रोग, *rog.*) An illness? (बीमारी, *bīmārī.*) A heartbeat? (धड़कन, *dhaṛkan.*) Breath? (साँस, *sā̃s.*) An itch? (खुजली, *khujlī.*) A burning feeling? (जलन, *jalan.*) A swelling? (सूजन, *sūjan.*) A sprain? (मोच, *moc.*) A hiccup? (हिचकी, *hickī.*) A nap? (झपकी, *jhapkī.*) Turning over? (करवट, *karvaṭ.*) A stretch? (अंगड़ाई, *aṅgṛāī.*)

Devanagari — a reference

A **reference**, not a chapter — a place to look things up. You are *not* meant to read this before the lessons: the lessons teach reading through real words, introducing each letter as a word needs it. This page just gathers the system in one spot.

How Devanagari works (the three facts the lessons teach)

1. **Consonants carry a built-in “a”.** क = “ka,” न = “na,” म = “ma.” You never write the short *a* — it’s already there.
2. **A vowel sign (*mātrā*) changes that built-in vowel.** Attached to a consonant, it swaps the *a* for another vowel: ा = ā (का = kā) · ि = i (कि = ki, written *before*, read *after*) · ी = ī · ु = u · ू = ū · े = e (के = ke) · ै = ai · ो = o · ौ = au.
3. **A *halant* (्) removes the built-in vowel.** क् = bare “k.” A vowel-less consonant leans onto the next, forming a **conjunct**: स् + त → स्त (“st”), न् + य → न्य (“ny”), क् + र → क्र (“kr”).

Independent vowels (word-initial)

When a word *starts* with a vowel (no consonant to attach to), a full vowel letter is used: अ a · आ ā · इ i · ई ī · उ u · ऊ ū · ए e · ऐ ai · ओ o · औ au.

Sounds worth flagging

- **Aspirated vs. plain** consonants are different letters and change meaning: क k / ख kh, ग g / घ gh, त t / थ th, द d / ध dh, प p / फ ph, etc. The “h” is a real puff of breath.

- **Retroflex** consonants (ट ṭ, ड ḍ, ण ṇ, etc.) are made with the tongue curled back — distinct from the dental त/द (tongue on the teeth).
- **Nasalization**: a dot (anusvāra ◌ं) or moon-dot (candrabindu ◌ँ) nasalizes the vowel.
- **Nukta letters** (a dot under a letter) mark sounds borrowed mostly from Persian/Arabic/English: क़ q, ख़ x/kh, ग़ ġ, ज़ z, फ़ f, ड़/ढ़ retroflex flaps.

The two vocabularies

Not pronunciation, but the key to Hindi: many everyday ideas have **two** words — a **Sanskrit** (*tatsama*) one, often formal/literary, and a **Perso-Arabic** one, often everyday: *dhanyavād* / *shukriyā* (“thanks”), *namaste* / *alvidā*. The lessons trace which is which.

Glossary

This glossary collects every word and phrase taught in the book. Pronunciation appears when it differs from the written form; chapter numbers show where each entry is introduced.

... या ... *... yā ...*
or — two letters you already own, and the word every offered choice is made of
Introduced in Chapter 68.

अब *ab*
now, from this point on
Introduced in Chapter 64.

आबाद *ābād*
inhabited, lively
Introduced in Chapter 239.

आभार *ābhār*
gratitude
Introduced in Chapter 50.

अभी *abhī*
right now
Introduced in Chapter 49.

अभी नहीं *abhī nahīṁ*
not yet, not now
Introduced in Chapter 113.

अभ्यास *abhyās*
practice, an exercise
Introduced in Chapter 197.

अचानक *acānak*
suddenly
Introduced in Chapter 248.

अच्छा *acchā*
good
Introduced in Chapter 41.

अच्छा / बुरा *acchā / burā*
well and badly — two adjectives you already have, doing a job English needs different words for
Introduced in Chapter 100.

अच्छा जी *acchā jī*
is that so?; all right then
Introduced in Chapter 127.

अचार *achār*
pickle
Introduced in Chapter 210.

अदब *adab*
good manners
Introduced in Chapter 65.

अदालत *adālat*
a court
Introduced in Chapter 218.

आदर *ādar*
respect
Introduced in Chapter 50.

आदत *ādat*
a habit
Introduced in Chapter 223.

आधा *ādhā*
half
Introduced in Chapter 236.

आँधी *ā̃dhī*
a storm
Introduced in Chapter 145.

आधुनिक *ādhunik*
modern
Introduced in Chapter 240.

अध्यापक *adhyāpak*
a teacher
Introduced in Chapter 193.

आदमी *ādmī*
man, person — masculine despite its -ī ending, and literally “of Adam”
Introduced in Chapter 39.

अदरक *adrak*
ginger
Introduced in Chapter 138.

आएगा *āegā*
he will come, she will come — the third-person future, and the ending changes for who rather than for you
Introduced in Chapter 96.

आएँगे *āeṅge*
we will come, they will come, and the form आप takes — the ending the farewell had all along
Introduced in Chapter 96.

आग *āg*
fire
Introduced in Chapter 268.

अगर *agar*
if
Introduced in Chapter 247.

आगे *āge*
ahead, in front
Introduced in Chapter 235.

अहंकार *ahaṅkār*
arrogance
Introduced in Chapter 258.

आइए *āie*
please come (in)
Introduced in Chapter 115.

आईना *āīnā*
a mirror
Introduced in Chapter 184.

आज *āj*
today
Introduced in Chapter 78.

अकेला *akelā*
alone
Introduced in Chapter 109.

अकेलापन *akelāpan*
loneliness
Introduced in Chapter 258.

अख़बार *akhbār*
a newspaper
Introduced in Chapter 190.

अक्सर *aksar*
often
Introduced in Chapter 192.

अलग *alag*
separate, different
Introduced in Chapter 236.

अलमारी *almārī*
a cupboard
Introduced in Chapter 184.

आलसी *ālsī*
lazy
Introduced in Chapter 214.

आलू *ālū*
a potato
Introduced in Chapter 137.

अलविदा *alvidā*
goodbye (alvidā — a final farewell, Persian/Arabic-derived)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

आम *ām*
a mango
Introduced in Chapter 139.

आँगन *āṁgan*
a courtyard
Introduced in Chapter 51.

अमीर *amīr*
rich
Introduced in Chapter 157.

आँख *āṁkh*
eye — feminine, and a word-for-word cousin of English “eye” and Latin “oculus”
Introduced in Chapter 38.

अमरूद *amrūd*
a guava
Introduced in Chapter 217.

आना / आता / आती / आते *ānā / ātā / ātī / āte*
to come / come — infinitive / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural
Introduced in Chapter 42.

अनाज *anāj*
grain
Introduced in Chapter 66.

अनार *anār*
a pomegranate
Introduced in Chapter 217.

अंडा *aṇḍā*
an egg
Introduced in Chapter 137.

अंदर *andar*
inside
Introduced in Chapter 235.

अंगड़ाई *aṅgṛāī*
a stretch (of the body)
Introduced in Chapter 275.

अंग्रेज़ी *angrezī*
English, the language
Introduced in Chapter 75.

अंगूर *aṅgūr*
grapes
Introduced in Chapter 140.

अंगूठा *aṅgūṭhā*
a thumb
Introduced in Chapter 150.

अंगूठी *aṅgūṭhī*
a ring
Introduced in Chapter 134.

अंक *aṅk*
a mark, a number
Introduced in Chapter 197.

अनोखा *anokhā*
unusual, unique
Introduced in Chapter 241.

अनुमति *anumati*
permission
Introduced in Chapter 65.

आओगे *āoge*
you will come, at the tum level — the one row of the grid that has its own vowel
Introduced in Chapter 96.

आप / तुम *āp / tum*
you (respectful / familiar)
Introduced in Chapter 2.

आप कैसे हैं? *āp kaise haiṁ?*
how are you? (respectful)
Introduced in Chapter 3.

आपका नाम क्या है? *āpkā nām kyā hai?*
what's your name?
Introduced in Chapter 2.

आपका स्वागत है *āpkā svāgat hai*
you’re welcome (also “welcome!”)
Introduced in Chapter 3.

आपको / उसे *āpko / use*
to you, to him or her — the two obliques built with ko, which completes a paradigm the track had one corner of
Introduced in Chapter 94.

अपना *apnā*
one’s own — the possessive that takes over whenever the owner is the subject of the sentence, which is not optional
Introduced in Chapter 92.

आपसे मिलकर ख़ुशी हुई / ख़ुशी *āpse milkar khushī huī / khushī*
pleased to meet you / happiness
Introduced in Chapter 2.

आराम *ārām*
rest, ease
Introduced in Chapter 77.

आराम से *ārām se*
take it easy; comfortably
Introduced in Chapter 122.

अरे *are*
oh!, hey!
Introduced in Chapter 112.

आरी *ārī*
a saw
Introduced in Chapter 266.

अर्थ *arth*
a meaning
Introduced in Chapter 198.

आसान / मुश्किल *āsān / mushkil*
easy and difficult — two loanwords, and neither of them bends
Introduced in Chapter 88.

आशीर्वाद *āśīrvād*
a blessing
Introduced in Chapter 50.

आसमान *āsmān*
the sky
Introduced in Chapter 55.

अस्पताल *aspatāl*
a hospital
Introduced in Chapter 107.

आँसू *ā̃sū*
tears
Introduced in Chapter 109.

असुविधा *asuvidhā*
an inconvenience
Introduced in Chapter 260.

आटा *āṭā*
flour
Introduced in Chapter 141.

आठवाँ / आठवीं *āṭhvā̃ / āṭhvī̃*
eighth / feminine eighth — the ending on a number that ends in a consonant cluster
Introduced in Chapter 83.

अतीत *atīt*
the past
Introduced in Chapter 221.

आऊँगा *āūṅgā*
I will come — the same ending on a stem that ends in a vowel, which is where the long independent ū finally appears
Introduced in Chapter 96.

और *aur*
and — the commonest word in Hindi that this book had never taught, and the one that turns two sentences into one
Introduced in Chapter 68.

औरत / महिला / स्त्री *aurat / mahilā / strī*
woman — everyday औरत, respectful public महिला, and literary स्त्री form a three-register set
Introduced in Chapter 39.

आज़ादी *āzādī*
freedom
Introduced in Chapter 219.

बचाना *bacānā*
to save, to rescue
Introduced in Chapter 169.

बचत *bacat*
savings
Introduced in Chapter 207.

बच्चे *bacce*
children — the plural of an -aa noun, and the same ending you have been bending adjectives with
Introduced in Chapter 99.

बच्चे को *bacce ko*
to the child — one child, in the shape a postposition forces on the noun in front of it
Introduced in Chapter 99.

बच्चा / बच्ची / बछड़ा *bacchā / bacchī / bachṛā*
boy child / girl child / calf — usually traced to Persian, beside an inherited Sanskrit cousin
Introduced in Chapter 39.

बचना *bacnā*
to escape, to be saved
Introduced in Chapter 169.

बचपन *bacpan*
childhood
Introduced in Chapter 220.

बाद में *bād mẽ*
later, afterwards
Introduced in Chapter 248.

बादल *bādal*
a cloud
Introduced in Chapter 55.

बदलना *badalnā*
to change
Introduced in Chapter 168.

बधाई *badhāī*
congratulations
Introduced in Chapter 114.

बाग़ *bāg*
a garden
Introduced in Chapter 202.

बगीचा *bagīcā*
a garden
Introduced in Chapter 153.

बहादुर *bahādur*
brave
Introduced in Chapter 215.

बहना *bahnā*
to flow
Introduced in Chapter 231.

बहू *bahū*
a daughter-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 255.

बहुत *bahut*
very, a lot
Introduced in Chapter 78.

बहुत दिन हो गए *bahut din ho gae*
it's been a long time
Introduced in Chapter 123.

बैंगन *bãigan*
an aubergine
Introduced in Chapter 216.

बैंक *baiṅk*
a bank
Introduced in Chapter 153.

बैठक *baiṭhak*
a meeting, a sitting room
Introduced in Chapter 183.

बैठना *baiṭhnā*
to sit
Introduced in Chapter 42.

बजाना *bajānā*
to play (an instrument), to ring
Introduced in Chapter 165.

बकरी *bakrī*
a goat
Introduced in Chapter 54.

बाल *bāl*
hair
Introduced in Chapter 46.

बल्ला *ballā*
a bat
Introduced in Chapter 224.

बाल्टी *bālṭī*
a bucket
Introduced in Chapter 129.

बनाना *banānā*
to make
Introduced in Chapter 226.

बंद *band*
closed
Introduced in Chapter 81.

बंदर *bandar*
a monkey
Introduced in Chapter 60.

बनना *bannā*
to be made, to become
Introduced in Chapter 226.

बड़ा *baṛā*
big
Introduced in Chapter 41.

बर्फ़ *barf*
snow, ice
Introduced in Chapter 145.

बाढ़ *bāṛh*
a flood
Introduced in Chapter 253.

बढ़ई *baṛhaī*
a carpenter
Introduced in Chapter 262.

बढ़ाना *baṛhānā*
to increase, to raise
Introduced in Chapter 169.

बारिश *bāriś*
rain
Introduced in Chapter 184.

बर्तन *bartan*
a cooking vessel
Introduced in Chapter 61.

बस *bas*
enough, that's all
Introduced in Chapter 48.

बस से *bas se*
by bus — three letters you already read as enough, and a second word that happens to be spelled the same
Introduced in Chapter 98.

बासी *bāsī*
stale
Introduced in Chapter 237.

बाँसुरी *bā̃surī*
a flute
Introduced in Chapter 263.

बटन *baṭan*
a button
Introduced in Chapter 188.

बातचीत *bātcīt*
a conversation
Introduced in Chapter 205.

बाँटना *bā̃ṭnā*
to share, to divide
Introduced in Chapter 173.

बत्ती *battī*
a lamp, a light
Introduced in Chapter 209.

बटुआ *baṭuā*
a wallet, a purse
Introduced in Chapter 133.

बावर्ची *bāvarcī*
a cook
Introduced in Chapter 194.

बायाँ *bāyā̃*
left (side)
Introduced in Chapter 234.

बाज़ार *bāzār*
a market
Introduced in Chapter 56.

बेचैन *becain*
restless, uneasy
Introduced in Chapter 125.

बेचैनी *becainī*
restlessness, unease
Introduced in Chapter 259.

बेचना *becnā*
to sell
Introduced in Chapter 163.

बेकार *bekār*
useless
Introduced in Chapter 242.

बेलन *belan*
a rolling pin
Introduced in Chapter 269.

बेटा *beṭā*
son
Introduced in Chapter 44.

बेटी *beṭī*
daughter
Introduced in Chapter 44.

भाभी *bhābhī*
sister-in-law, a brother's wife
Introduced in Chapter 117.

भद्दा *bhaddā*
ugly, clumsy
Introduced in Chapter 212.

भागना *bhāgnā*
to run away
Introduced in Chapter 172.

भाई बहन *bhāī bahin*
brother (a PIE cousin of English "brother") and sister (a DIFFERENT Sanskrit word entirely, not the PIE cousin of "sister")
Introduced in Chapter 12.

भैंस *bhaĩs*
a buffalo
Introduced in Chapter 60.

भालू *bhālū*
a bear
Introduced in Chapter 146.

भरा *bharā*
full
Introduced in Chapter 159.

भारत *Bhārat*
India
Introduced in Chapter 75.

भारी *bhārī*
heavy
Introduced in Chapter 154.

भरना *bharnā*
to fill
Introduced in Chapter 173.

भरोसा *bharosā*
trust
Introduced in Chapter 65.

भाषाएँ *bhāṣāẽ*
languages — a feminine noun in -aa, which behaves like the consonant ones rather than like baccha
Introduced in Chapter 99.

भाषण *bhāṣaṇ*
a speech
Introduced in Chapter 272.

भाषा *bhāshā*
a language
Introduced in Chapter 75.

भतीजा *bhatījā*
a nephew (brother's son)
Introduced in Chapter 188.

भविष्य *bhaviṣya*
the future
Introduced in Chapter 221.

भेजना *bhejnā*
to send
Introduced in Chapter 160.

भेड़ *bheṛ*
a sheep
Introduced in Chapter 146.

भेड़िया *bheṛiyā*
a wolf
Introduced in Chapter 147.

भी *bhī*
also, too
Introduced in Chapter 78.

भिंडी *bhinḍī*
okra
Introduced in Chapter 216.

भीड़ *bhīṛ*
a crowd
Introduced in Chapter 259.

भीड़भाड़ *bhīṛbhāṛ*
crowded, bustle
Introduced in Chapter 239.

भूकंप *bhūkamp*
an earthquake
Introduced in Chapter 253.

भूख *bhūkh*
hunger
Introduced in Chapter 63.

भूखा *bhūkhā*
hungry
Introduced in Chapter 124.

भूलना *bhūlnā*
to forget
Introduced in Chapter 162.

बीच *bīc*
the middle
Introduced in Chapter 234.

बिगड़ना *bigaṛnā*
to go wrong, to spoil
Introduced in Chapter 226.

बीज *bīj*
a seed
Introduced in Chapter 66.

बिजली *bijlī*
electricity; lightning
Introduced in Chapter 144.

बिल *bil*
the bill
Introduced in Chapter 80.

बिलकुल *bilkul*
absolutely
Introduced in Chapter 48.

बिलकुल नहीं *bilkul nahīṁ*
not at all
Introduced in Chapter 127.

बीमा *bīmā*
insurance
Introduced in Chapter 271.

बीमार *bīmār*
ill, sick
Introduced in Chapter 106.

बीमारी *bīmārī*
an illness
Introduced in Chapter 273.

बिना आर्टिकल *binā ārṭikal*
without an article — Hindi has no the and no a, and this lesson says what carries the work instead
Introduced in Chapter 94.

बिंदी *bindī*
a bindi
Introduced in Chapter 263.

बिस्तर *bistar*
bedding, a bed
Introduced in Chapter 133.

बीतना *bītnā*
to pass (of time)
Introduced in Chapter 170.

बोलिए *boliye*
please speak — the respectful command, and the ending the track has been using inside two fixed phrases without ever taking it apart
Introduced in Chapter 93.

बोलना *bolnā*
to speak
Introduced in Chapter 43.

बोलना / बोल *bolnā / bol*
to speak / speak — infinitive / stem
Introduced in Chapter 5.

बोलो *bolo*
speak — the command you give somebody you would call tum, and the middle of three levels the track already has for you
Introduced in Chapter 93.

बोलता हूँ, बोलती हूँ, बोलते हैं *boltā hūṁ, boltī hūṁ, bolte haiṁ*
the present-habitual template — stem + -tā/-tī/-te + honā
Introduced in Chapter 5.

बोलता था *boltā thā*
used to speak — the habit you already build, with the time word swapped
Introduced in Chapter 95.

बोना *bonā*
to sow
Introduced in Chapter 227.

बोरी *borī*
a sack
Introduced in Chapter 252.

बोतल *botal*
a bottle
Introduced in Chapter 134.

बुआ *buā*
aunt, the father’s sister
Introduced in Chapter 117.

बुद्धिमान *buddhimān*
clever, wise
Introduced in Chapter 215.

बुझाना *bujhānā*
to put out (a fire or light)
Introduced in Chapter 175.

बुख़ार *bukhār*
a fever
Introduced in Chapter 63.

बुलाना *bulānā*
to call
Introduced in Chapter 164.

बुनना *bunnā*
to weave, to knit
Introduced in Chapter 178.

बुरा *burā*
bad — the opposite of achhaa, and a word that lives inside one of the commonest apologies in Hindi
Introduced in Chapter 91.

बूढ़ा *būṛhā*
old (of people)
Introduced in Chapter 157.

बुढ़ापा *buṛhāpā*
old age
Introduced in Chapter 220.

ब्याज *byāj*
interest (on money)
Introduced in Chapter 271.

चाबी *cābī*
a key
Introduced in Chapter 184.

चाचा *cācā*
uncle, the father’s younger brother
Introduced in Chapter 116.

चाची *cācī*
an aunt (father’s brother’s wife)
Introduced in Chapter 188.

चाँदी *cā̃dī*
silver
Introduced in Chapter 246.

चाहिए *cāhiye*
is needed, is wanted — a form of the wanting verb that takes a thing rather than an action, and never changes for the person who wants it
Introduced in Chapter 103.

चखना *cakhnā*
to taste
Introduced in Chapter 176.

चालाक *cālāk*
cunning, clever
Introduced in Chapter 243.

चलाना *calānā*
to drive, to run (a machine)
Introduced in Chapter 168.

चलेगा *calegā*
that’ll do, that works
Introduced in Chapter 127.

चलिए *calie*
let’s go, shall we
Introduced in Chapter 121.

चमकदार *camakdār*
shiny
Introduced in Chapter 239.

चमड़ा *cāmṛā*
leather
Introduced in Chapter 247.

चप्पल *cappal*
a sandal, a slipper
Introduced in Chapter 135.

चढ़ना *caṛhnā*
to climb, to board
Introduced in Chapter 172.

चश्मा *caśmā*
glasses, spectacles
Introduced in Chapter 133.

चटनी *caṭnī*
chutney
Introduced in Chapter 211.

चौकोर *caukor*
square
Introduced in Chapter 237.

चौड़ा *cauṛā*
wide
Introduced in Chapter 158.

चौराहा *caurāhā*
a crossroads
Introduced in Chapter 181.

चौथा / चौथी *cauthā / cauthī*
fourth / feminine fourth — a fourth shape, and the last of the four you must learn as words
Introduced in Chapter 82.

चाँद *chā̃d*
the moon
Introduced in Chapter 55.

चादर *chādar*
a sheet
Introduced in Chapter 58.

चाहना / चाह / चाहता *chāhnā / chāh / chāhtā*
to want / longing / want — infinitive / noun / masculine singular
Introduced in Chapter 70.

छज्जा *chajjā*
a balcony, a ledge
Introduced in Chapter 209.

छलनी *chalnī*
a sieve
Introduced in Chapter 269.

चलता हूँ / चलती हूँ / चलना *chaltā hūṁ / chaltī hūṁ / chalnā*
I'll be off (masculine / feminine) / to move, walk, or go
Introduced in Chapter 4.

चम्मच *chammach*
a spoon
Introduced in Chapter 61.

छत *chat*
a roof
Introduced in Chapter 58.

छाता *chātā*
an umbrella
Introduced in Chapter 133.

छठा / छठी *chaṭhā / chaṭhī*
sixth / feminine sixth — the one number that will not take the rule
Introduced in Chapter 83.

छाती *chātī*
the chest
Introduced in Chapter 151.

छात्र *chātra*
a student
Introduced in Chapter 47.

चावल *chāval*
rice
Introduced in Chapter 52.

छह सात आठ नौ दस *chhah sāt āṭh nau das*
six to ten, with seven and eight repeating the same Prakrit weight trade as three
Introduced in Chapter 21.

चीनी *chīnī*
sugar
Introduced in Chapter 52.

छींकना *chīṅknā*
to sneeze
Introduced in Chapter 231.

छिपाना *chipānā*
to hide (something)
Introduced in Chapter 171.

छिपना *chipnā*
to hide (oneself)
Introduced in Chapter 171.

चिड़िया *chiṛiyā*
a small bird
Introduced in Chapter 54.

छोड़ना *choṛnā*
to leave, to let go
Introduced in Chapter 168.

छोटा *choṭā*
small
Introduced in Chapter 41.

चूल्हा *chūlhā*
a cooking fire
Introduced in Chapter 61.

छूना *chūnā*
to touch
Introduced in Chapter 165.

छुरी *churī*
a knife
Introduced in Chapter 132.

छूट *chūṭ*
a discount
Introduced in Chapter 250.

छूटना *chūṭnā*
to be left behind, to be missed
Introduced in Chapter 229.

छुट्टी *chuṭṭī*
a holiday, a day off, leave
Introduced in Chapter 122.

चिकना *cikanā*
smooth, greasy
Introduced in Chapter 214.

चीखना *cīkhnā*
to scream
Introduced in Chapter 232.

चिल्लाना *cillānā*
to shout
Introduced in Chapter 178.

चिंता *cintā*
worry
Introduced in Chapter 108.

चींटी *cīṇṭī*
an ant
Introduced in Chapter 149.

चिपचिपा *cipcipā*
sticky
Introduced in Chapter 238.

चिड़ियाघर *ciṛiyāghar*
a zoo
Introduced in Chapter 203.

चीरना *cīrnā*
to split, to cut open
Introduced in Chapter 227.

चिटकनी *ciṭkanī*
a latch
Introduced in Chapter 266.

चित्रकार *citrakār*
a painter
Introduced in Chapter 195.

चिट्ठी *ciṭṭhī*
a letter
Introduced in Chapter 189.

चीज़ *cīz*
a thing
Introduced in Chapter 190.

चोर *cor*
a thief
Introduced in Chapter 196.

चोट *coṭ*
an injury, a hurt
Introduced in Chapter 107.

चूहा *cūhā*
a mouse
Introduced in Chapter 149.

चुनाव *cunāv*
an election
Introduced in Chapter 218.

चुनना *cunnā*
to choose
Introduced in Chapter 173.

चूड़ी *cūṛī*
a bangle
Introduced in Chapter 263.

दबाना *dabānā*
to press
Introduced in Chapter 228.

दादा *dādā*
grandfather, the father's father
Introduced in Chapter 116.

दादी *dādī*
grandmother, the father's mother
Introduced in Chapter 116.

दफ़्तर *daftar*
an office
Introduced in Chapter 153.

दही *dahī*
yoghurt
Introduced in Chapter 140.

डाकघर *ḍākghar*
a post office
Introduced in Chapter 152.

डाकिया *ḍākiyā*
a postman
Introduced in Chapter 187.

दक्षिण *dakṣiṇ*
south
Introduced in Chapter 233.

डाक्टर *ḍākṭar*
a doctor
Introduced in Chapter 107.

दाल *dāl*
lentils, split pulses
Introduced in Chapter 52.

डाली *ḍālī*
a branch
Introduced in Chapter 252.

दाम *dām*
a price
Introduced in Chapter 79.

दामाद *dāmād*
a son-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 255.

दाँत *danta*
tooth — masculine, though it is built exactly like the feminine आँख, and a cousin of Latin dēns and English tooth
Introduced in Chapter 38.

डर *ḍar*
fear
Introduced in Chapter 108.

दर्द *dard*
pain
Introduced in Chapter 63.

दरी *darī*
a cotton rug
Introduced in Chapter 265.

दर्जन *darjan*
a dozen
Introduced in Chapter 245.

डरना *ḍarnā*
to be afraid
Introduced in Chapter 178.

दरवाज़ा *darvāzā*
door — masculine, a Persian loan whose first syllable is the same ancient word as English “door”
Introduced in Chapter 36.

दर्ज़ी *darzī*
a tailor
Introduced in Chapter 193.

दस्तावेज़ *dastāvez*
a document
Introduced in Chapter 249.

दसवाँ / दसवीं *dasvā̃ / dasvī̃*
tenth / feminine tenth — the ten closed, and the ending carrying on past it
Introduced in Chapter 83.

डाँटना *ḍā̃ṭnā*
to scold
Introduced in Chapter 232.

दौड़ *dauṛ*
a race, running
Introduced in Chapter 224.

दौड़ना *dauṛnā*
to run
Introduced in Chapter 159.

दवा *davā*
medicine
Introduced in Chapter 180.

दवाख़ाना *davākhānā*
a pharmacy
Introduced in Chapter 273.

दावत *dāvat*
a feast, an invitation
Introduced in Chapter 57.

दायाँ *dāyā̃*
right (side)
Introduced in Chapter 233.

दयालु *dayālu*
kind
Introduced in Chapter 215.

देखना / देख / देखता / देखती / देखते *dekhnā / dekh / dekhtā / dekhtī / dekhte*
to look or see / look or see — infinitive / stem / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural
Introduced in Chapter 43.

देना *denā*
to give
Introduced in Chapter 42.

देर *der*
lateness, a delay
Introduced in Chapter 81.

देर हो गई *der ho gaī*
it has got late
Introduced in Chapter 122.

देश *desh*
a country
Introduced in Chapter 75.

देसी *desī*
local, homemade
Introduced in Chapter 240.

देवर *devar*
a husband's younger brother
Introduced in Chapter 255.

धागा *dhāgā*
thread
Introduced in Chapter 130.

धकेलना *dhakelnā*
to push
Introduced in Chapter 176.

ढक्कन *dhakkan*
a lid
Introduced in Chapter 270.

ढकना *ḍhaknā*
to cover
Introduced in Chapter 173.

धनिया *dhaniyā*
coriander
Introduced in Chapter 211.

धन्यवाद *dhanyavād*
thank you (dhanyavād — formal, Sanskritic)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

धड़कन *dhaṛkan*
a heartbeat
Introduced in Chapter 274.

धर्म *dharm*
religion, duty
Introduced in Chapter 217.

धीमा *dhīmā*
slow, low
Introduced in Chapter 156.

धीरज *dhīraj*
patience
Introduced in Chapter 258.

धीरे *dhīre*
slowly
Introduced in Chapter 64.

धोबी *dhobī*
a washerman
Introduced in Chapter 194.

ढोल *ḍhol*
a drum
Introduced in Chapter 15.

धोना *dhonā*
to wash
Introduced in Chapter 160.

धुआँ *dhuā̃*
smoke
Introduced in Chapter 268.

धुंधला *dhũdhlā*
hazy, blurred
Introduced in Chapter 239.

ढूँढना *ḍhū̃ḍhnā*
to look for
Introduced in Chapter 163.

धूप *dhūp*
sunshine
Introduced in Chapter 185.

ध्यान रखिए *dhyān rakhie*
take care
Introduced in Chapter 121.

डिब्बा *ḍibbā*
a box
Introduced in Chapter 131.

दिखाइए *dikhāie*
please show me
Introduced in Chapter 111.

दिखाना *dikhānā*
to show
Introduced in Chapter 171.

दिखना *dikhnā*
to be seen, to appear
Introduced in Chapter 171.

दिल *dil*
the heart
Introduced in Chapter 199.

दिन *din*
"day" — shares its ultimate PIE root with Latin's diēs, but through a separate derivational branch (din patterns with Baltic/Slavic "day"-words); Sanskrit's own दिव्/द्यु are actually the closer, more direct cousins of diēs
Introduced in Chapter 25.

दीवार *dīvār*
a wall
Introduced in Chapter 58.

दीया *dīyā*
an oil lamp
Introduced in Chapter 45.

दो आदमी *do ādmī*
two men — the plural that does nothing at all, and why the sentence still tells you
Introduced in Chapter 99.

दो वर्तमान *do vartamān*
what I do against what I am doing — the distinction English keeps and most languages do not
Introduced in Chapter 97.

दोबारा *dobārā*
again, a second time
Introduced in Chapter 110.

दोनों *donõ*
both
Introduced in Chapter 244.

दोपहर *dopahar*
"afternoon" — the same word already met meaning precisely "noon" (two pahars after sunrise, HI-C17), now widened in modern everyday usage to cover the whole afternoon stretch, not just the exact midday moment
Introduced in Chapter 30.

दोपहर आधी रात *dopahar ādhī rāt*
noon (literally "two pahars," a traditional ~3-hour time unit) and midnight ("half night," fully transparent)
Introduced in Chapter 17.

दोपहर का खाना / रात का खाना *dopahar kā khānā / rāt kā khānā*
lunch and dinner — literally the afternoon's food and the night's food
Introduced in Chapter 87.

दोस्त *dost*
friend — a Persian word for "the one chosen", masculine by default but taking either possessive depending on who the friend is
Introduced in Chapter 39.

ड्राइवर *ḍrāivar*
a driver
Introduced in Chapter 194.

डूबना *ḍūbnā*
to sink, to drown
Introduced in Chapter 230.

दूध *dūdh*
milk — masculine, and literally "the milked thing", a past participle that hardened into a noun
Introduced in Chapter 37.

दुगना *dugnā*
double
Introduced in Chapter 236.

दुकान *dukān*
a shop
Introduced in Chapter 56.

दुकानदार *dukāndār*
a shopkeeper
Introduced in Chapter 183.

दुख *dukh*
sorrow, grief
Introduced in Chapter 109.

दुपट्टा *dupaṭṭā*
a scarf, a dupatta
Introduced in Chapter 136.

दुर्घटना *durghaṭnā*
an accident
Introduced in Chapter 259.

दुश्मन *duśman*
an enemy
Introduced in Chapter 188.

दूसरा / दूसरी *dūsrā / dūsrī*
second or other / feminine second or other
Introduced in Chapter 82.

द्वीप *dvīp*
an island
Introduced in Chapter 200.

एहसान *ehsān*
a favour
Introduced in Chapter 50.

एक बार और *ek bār aur*
one more time
Introduced in Chapter 126.

एक चाय दीजिए *ek chāy dījie*
tea — feminine, and one of the two names the world uses for the same leaf
Introduced in Chapter 37.

एक दो तीन चार पाँच *ek do tīn chār pāṁch*
one to five, with familiar Devanagari pieces and the chandrabindu in पाँच
Introduced in Chapter 6.

एक मिनट *ek minaṭ*
one minute, a moment
Introduced in Chapter 110.

एक साथ *ek sāth*
all together
Introduced in Chapter 249.

फ़ाइल *fāil*
a file
Introduced in Chapter 250.

फ़र्श *farś*
a floor (surface)
Introduced in Chapter 184.

फ़सल *fasal*
a crop
Introduced in Chapter 66.

फ़ायदा *fāydā*
a benefit, a profit
Introduced in Chapter 208.

गद्दा *gaddā*
a mattress
Introduced in Chapter 266.

गधा *gadhā*
a donkey
Introduced in Chapter 146.

गहना *gahnā*
a piece of jewellery
Introduced in Chapter 262.

गहरा *gahrā*
deep, dark (of colour)
Introduced in Chapter 158.

गैस *gais*
gas
Introduced in Chapter 269.

गाजर *gājar*
a carrot
Introduced in Chapter 138.

गाल *gāl*
a cheek
Introduced in Chapter 150.

गला *galā*
the throat
Introduced in Chapter 46.

ग़लत *ġalat*
wrong, incorrect
Introduced in Chapter 112.

गली *galī*
a lane
Introduced in Chapter 272.

ग़लती *ġaltī*
a mistake
Introduced in Chapter 189.

गंभीर *gambhīr*
serious, grave — Sanskrit for deep, which is the same metaphor Latin reached for with gravis
Introduced in Chapter 91.

गाना *gānā*
a song
Introduced in Chapter 77.

गंदा *gandā*
dirty
Introduced in Chapter 155.

गणित *gaṇit*
mathematics
Introduced in Chapter 199.

गरम *garam*
hot, warm
Introduced in Chapter 154.

गर्दन *gardan*
the neck
Introduced in Chapter 151.

गाड़ी *gāṛī*
a vehicle; a train
Introduced in Chapter 76.

ग़रीब *ġarīb*
poor
Introduced in Chapter 157.

गर्मी *garmī*
heat, summer
Introduced in Chapter 185.

गर्व *garv*
pride
Introduced in Chapter 257.

गाँव *gā̃v*
a village
Introduced in Chapter 56.

गाय *gāy*
a cow
Introduced in Chapter 54.

गायक *gāyak*
a singer
Introduced in Chapter 195.

गेंद *gẽd*
a ball
Introduced in Chapter 223.

घबराहट *ghabrāhaṭ*
nervousness, panic
Introduced in Chapter 125.

घमंडी *ghamaṇḍī*
proud, arrogant
Introduced in Chapter 243.

घंटा / बजना / बज रहा है / बज रहे हैं *ghaṇṭā / bajnā / baj rahā hai / baj rahe haiṁ*
hour or bell / to strike or toll / singular time frame / plural time frame
Introduced in Chapter 18.

घंटी *ghaṇṭī*
a bell
Introduced in Chapter 264.

घर *ghar*
house, home — masculine, and probably from a Sanskrit word that meant a fenced enclosure before it meant a building
Introduced in Chapter 36.

घर के पास *ghar ke pās*
near the house — and the reason the phrase for having something has looked so strange since the possessive chapter
Introduced in Chapter 101.

घड़ी *ghaṛī*
a watch, a clock
Introduced in Chapter 132.

घास *ghās*
grass
Introduced in Chapter 66.

घटाना *ghaṭānā*
to reduce, to subtract
Introduced in Chapter 169.

घाटी *ghāṭī*
a valley
Introduced in Chapter 201.

घटना *ghaṭnā*
an event
Introduced in Chapter 259.

घाव *ghāv*
a wound
Introduced in Chapter 256.

घी *ghī*
ghee, clarified butter
Introduced in Chapter 14.

घोड़ा *ghoṛā*
a horse
Introduced in Chapter 54.

घृणा *ghṛṇā*
hatred
Introduced in Chapter 257.

घुमाना *ghumānā*
to turn, to show around
Introduced in Chapter 228.

घूमना *ghūmnā*
to stroll, to wander
Introduced in Chapter 172.

घुटना *ghuṭnā*
a knee
Introduced in Chapter 53.

गीला *gīlā*
wet
Introduced in Chapter 154.

गिलास *gilās*
a tumbler
Introduced in Chapter 61.

गिनना *ginnā*
to count
Introduced in Chapter 165.

गिराना *girānā*
to drop
Introduced in Chapter 175.

गिरजाघर *girjāghar*
a church
Introduced in Chapter 187.

गिरना *girnā*
to fall
Introduced in Chapter 161.

गोभी *gobhī*
a cauliflower
Introduced in Chapter 138.

गोल *gol*
round
Introduced in Chapter 236.

गोली *golī*
a pill, a bullet
Introduced in Chapter 256.

गोश्त *gośt*
meat
Introduced in Chapter 137.

ग्राहक *grāhak*
a customer
Introduced in Chapter 183.

गुफ़ा *gufā*
a cave
Introduced in Chapter 202.

गुनगुना *gungunā*
lukewarm
Introduced in Chapter 238.

गुड़िया *guṛiyā*
a doll
Introduced in Chapter 264.

ग़ुस्सा *ġussā*
anger
Introduced in Chapter 186.

गुस्सा *gussā*
anger
Introduced in Chapter 108.

गुज़रना *guzarnā*
to pass by, to pass through
Introduced in Chapter 179.

ग्यारह बारह तेरह चौदह पंद्रह सोलह सत्रह अठारह उन्नीस बीस *gyārah — bīs*
11-20 — genuinely irregular, must be memorized individually; but उन्नीस (19) most likely preserves Sanskrit's OWN subtractive naming, the same logic as Latin's ūndēvīgintī
Introduced in Chapter 22.

हड्डी *haḍḍī*
a bone
Introduced in Chapter 199.

हफ़्ता *haftā*
a week
Introduced in Chapter 191.

है *hai*
is
Introduced in Chapter 2.

हल्दी *haldī*
turmeric
Introduced in Chapter 211.

हल्का *halkā*
light (in weight)
Introduced in Chapter 154.

हलवा *halvā*
halwa (a sweet)
Introduced in Chapter 210.

हम *ham*
we — the pronoun a mock reading item needs, and the one Hindi also reaches for when an English speaker would say I
Introduced in Chapter 94.

हाँ / जी हाँ / जी *hāṃ*
yes / polite yes (hāṃ / jī hāṃ / jī)
Introduced in Chapter 7.

हमारा *hamārā*
our — and a word Hindi reaches for where English would say my, because a family and a home are spoken of as shared
Introduced in Chapter 92.

हमें / तुम्हें *hamẽ / tumhẽ*
to us, to you — the oblique pronouns, which is what mujhe has quietly been all along
Introduced in Chapter 94.

हमेशा *hameśā*
always
Introduced in Chapter 192.

हर *har*
every, each
Introduced in Chapter 245.

हार *hār*
a defeat
Introduced in Chapter 224.

हरा *harā*
green — a deep cousin of German gelb and English yellow from an ancient shining-color root
Introduced in Chapter 24.

हारना *hārnā*
to lose (a game)
Introduced in Chapter 163.

हँसी *hãsī*
laughter
Introduced in Chapter 109.

हँसना *hãsnā*
to laugh
Introduced in Chapter 162.

हस्ताक्षर *hastākṣar*
a signature
Introduced in Chapter 120.

हटाना *haṭānā*
to remove
Introduced in Chapter 179.

हाथ *hāth*
the hand — from Sanskrit hasta, with a real (if non-obvious) sound-change story
Introduced in Chapter 13.

हथौड़ा *hathauṛā*
a hammer
Introduced in Chapter 130.

हाथी *hāthī*
an elephant
Introduced in Chapter 146.

हटना *haṭnā*
to move aside
Introduced in Chapter 179.

हवा *havā*
wind, air
Introduced in Chapter 145.

हवाई जहाज़ *havāī jahāz*
an aeroplane
Introduced in Chapter 204.

हज़ार *hazār*
a thousand
Introduced in Chapter 244.

हिचकी *hickī*
a hiccup
Introduced in Chapter 275.

हिलाना *hilānā*
to shake
Introduced in Chapter 176.

हिम्मत *himmat*
courage
Introduced in Chapter 258.

हिंदी में *hindī meṁ*
in Hindi
Introduced in Chapter 111.

हिरन *hiran*
a deer
Introduced in Chapter 147.

हो सकता है *ho saktā hai*
maybe, it could be
Introduced in Chapter 113.

होंठ *hoṇṭh*
a lip
Introduced in Chapter 53.

होशियार *hośiyār*
clever, alert — Persian for one who holds their wits, and a word that is a warning as often as a compliment
Introduced in Chapter 91.

होटल *hoṭal*
an eating house
Introduced in Chapter 80.

हूँ *hūṁ*
am (1st-person of होना, "to be")
Introduced in Chapter 3.

इजाज़त *ijāzat*
permission, leave to go
Introduced in Chapter 122.

इलाज *ilāj*
treatment, a cure
Introduced in Chapter 180.

ईमानदार *īmāndār*
honest
Introduced in Chapter 214.

इंद्रधनुष *indradhanuṣ*
a rainbow
Introduced in Chapter 253.

इंजीनियर *injīniyar*
an engineer
Introduced in Chapter 194.

इंसान *insān*
a human being, a person
Introduced in Chapter 120.

ईर्ष्या *irṣyā*
jealousy
Introduced in Chapter 257.

इसलिए *isliye*
so, therefore
Introduced in Chapter 247.

इतिहास *itihās*
history
Introduced in Chapter 199.

जग *jag*
a jug
Introduced in Chapter 270.

जागना *jāgnā*
to wake up, to stay awake
Introduced in Chapter 159.

जहाज़ *jahāz*
a ship, an aeroplane
Introduced in Chapter 181.

जलन *jalan*
a burning feeling
Introduced in Chapter 274.

जलाना *jalānā*
to light, to burn
Introduced in Chapter 175.

जल्द ही *jald hī*
soon
Introduced in Chapter 248.

जल्दी *jaldī*
quickly, soon
Introduced in Chapter 64.

जलना *jalnā*
to burn (by itself)
Introduced in Chapter 175.

जुलूस *jalūs*
a procession
Introduced in Chapter 272.

जम्हाई लेना *jamhāī lenā*
to yawn
Introduced in Chapter 231.

जाना / जाता *jānā / jātā*
to go / masculine present form
Introduced in Chapter 76.

जाना है *jānā hai*
(I) have to go
Introduced in Chapter 122.

जंगल *jaṅgal*
a forest
Introduced in Chapter 143.

जन्मदिन *janmdin*
a birthday
Introduced in Chapter 119.

जनवरी फ़रवरी मार्च अप्रैल मई जून जुलाई अगस्त सितंबर अक्टूबर नवंबर दिसंबर *janvarī farvarī mārc aprail maī jūn julāī agast sitambar aktūbar navambar disambar*
the Gregorian months — borrowed English/international names, running ALONGSIDE the traditional Vikram Samvat calendar's own six-ritu-linked months
Introduced in Chapter 16.

जड़ *jaṛ*
a root
Introduced in Chapter 143.

जवाब *javāb*
an answer
Introduced in Chapter 189.

जवान *javān*
young
Introduced in Chapter 157.

जवानी *javānī*
youth
Introduced in Chapter 220.

जेब *jeb*
a pocket
Introduced in Chapter 188.

जेल *jel*
a prison
Introduced in Chapter 219.

झगड़ालू *jhagṛālū*
quarrelsome
Introduced in Chapter 243.

झंडा *jhaṇḍā*
a flag
Introduced in Chapter 220.

झपकी *jhapkī*
a nap
Introduced in Chapter 275.

झरना *jharnā*
a waterfall
Introduced in Chapter 201.

झाड़ना *jhāṛnā*
to dust, to sweep
Introduced in Chapter 225.

झाड़ू *jhāṛū*
a broom
Introduced in Chapter 131.

झील *jhīl*
a lake
Introduced in Chapter 143.

झुकना *jhuknā*
to bend down, to bow
Introduced in Chapter 230.

झूला *jhūlā*
a swing
Introduced in Chapter 265.

झुमका *jhumkā*
an earring
Introduced in Chapter 263.

झूठ *jhūṭh*
a lie
Introduced in Chapter 206.

झूठा *jhūṭhā*
false, lying
Introduced in Chapter 215.

जी नहीं *jī nahīṁ*
no, politely
Introduced in Chapter 115.

जीभ *jībh*
the tongue
Introduced in Chapter 151.

जीजा *jījā*
a sister's husband
Introduced in Chapter 255.

जीना *jīnā*
to live
Introduced in Chapter 170.

जीत *jīt*
a win
Introduced in Chapter 224.

जीतना *jītnā*
to win
Introduced in Chapter 163.

जीवन *jīvan*
life
Introduced in Chapter 220.

ज्ञान *jñān*
knowledge
Introduced in Chapter 198.

जोड़ा *joṛā*
a pair
Introduced in Chapter 245.

जोड़ना *joṛnā*
to join, to add
Introduced in Chapter 169.

जूस *jūs*
juice
Introduced in Chapter 142.

जूता *jūtā*
a shoe
Introduced in Chapter 135.

कब *kab*
when, as a question — the fourth k- word, and the one a timetable is read with
Introduced in Chapter 72.

कभी *kabhī*
sometimes, ever
Introduced in Chapter 192.

कभी नहीं *kabhī nahī̃*
never
Introduced in Chapter 192.

कबूतर *kabūtar*
a pigeon
Introduced in Chapter 148.

कच्चा *kaccā*
raw, unripe
Introduced in Chapter 238.

कछुआ *kachuā*
a tortoise
Introduced in Chapter 149.

कद्दूकस *kaddūkas*
a grater
Introduced in Chapter 270.

काफ़ी *kāfī*
enough; quite
Introduced in Chapter 113.

काग़ज़ *kāgaz*
paper
Introduced in Chapter 246.

कहाँ *kahā̃*
where? — asking about a place
Introduced in Chapter 40.

कहानी *kahānī*
a story
Introduced in Chapter 189.

कई *kaī*
several
Introduced in Chapter 244.

कैंची *kaĩcī*
scissors
Introduced in Chapter 130.

कैसा / कैसी / कैसे *kaisā / kaisī / kaise*
what kind / how — masculine / feminine / respectful or masculine plural
Introduced in Chapter 3.

कैसे कहते हैं? *kaise kahte haiṁ?*
how do you say it?
Introduced in Chapter 111.

कक्षा *kakṣā*
a class, a classroom
Introduced in Chapter 197.

कल मिलते हैं *kal milte haiṁ*
see you tomorrow (and the कल puzzle)
Introduced in Chapter 4.

काला सफ़ेद *kālā safed*
black and white — black has a Sanskrit look-alike meaning time; white is a Persian loan
Introduced in Chapter 11.

कलाई *kalāī*
a wrist
Introduced in Chapter 150.

कली *kalī*
a bud
Introduced in Chapter 252.

कम *kam*
little, not much
Introduced in Chapter 64.

काम *kām*
work, as a noun and as a place — the word that has been hiding inside kaam karnaa since the very first verb
Introduced in Chapter 98.

कमाई *kamāī*
earnings
Introduced in Chapter 207.

कमर *kamar*
the waist
Introduced in Chapter 151.

कंबल *kambal*
a blanket
Introduced in Chapter 129.

कमीज़ *kamīz*
a shirt
Introduced in Chapter 135.

कंप्यूटर *kampyūṭar*
a computer
Introduced in Chapter 249.

कमरा *kamrā*
room — masculine, and the same Latin word as English “camera”, brought to India by Portuguese ships
Introduced in Chapter 36.

कामयाब *kāmyāb*
successful
Introduced in Chapter 242.

कमज़ोर *kamzor*
weak
Introduced in Chapter 212.

कमज़ोरी *kamzorī*
weakness
Introduced in Chapter 107.

कान *kān*
an ear
Introduced in Chapter 46.

कंधा *kandhā*
a shoulder
Introduced in Chapter 53.

कंगन *kaṅgan*
a bangle, a bracelet
Introduced in Chapter 262.

कंघी *kaṅghī*
a comb
Introduced in Chapter 130.

क़ानून *kānūn*
a law
Introduced in Chapter 218.

काँपना *kā̃pnā*
to shiver, to tremble
Introduced in Chapter 232.

कपड़ा *kapṛā*
cloth
Introduced in Chapter 45.

कर रहा है *kar rahā hai*
he is doing, she is doing — the last word changes for who, the middle one for what they are
Introduced in Chapter 97.

कर रहा हूँ *kar rahā hū̃*
I am doing, right now — three words, and the middle one is the only new thing
Introduced in Chapter 97.

कर रहे हैं *kar rahe haiṁ*
we are doing, they are doing, and the form आप takes — the plural, in both dials at once
Introduced in Chapter 97.

कर रही हूँ *kar rahī hū̃*
I am doing, said by a woman — the middle word bends and the other two do not
Introduced in Chapter 97.

कड़ाही *kaṛāhī*
a wok
Introduced in Chapter 269.

कारण *kāraṇ*
a reason, a cause
Introduced in Chapter 222.

कारख़ाना *kārkhānā*
a factory
Introduced in Chapter 183.

करना / काम करना / करता / करती *karnā / kām karnā / kartā / kartī*
to do or make / to work / do — infinitives / masculine / feminine
Introduced in Chapter 5.

करने के लिए *karne ke liye*
in order to do — the fifth kind of word to wear the oblique ending, and the first one that is a verb
Introduced in Chapter 101.

करोड़ *karoṛ*
ten million (crore)
Introduced in Chapter 244.

करूँगा *karūṅgā*
I will do — the future is an ending on the stem, and Hindi has no word for will
Introduced in Chapter 96.

कड़वा *kaṛvā*
bitter
Introduced in Chapter 156.

करवट *karvaṭ*
turning over (in bed)
Introduced in Chapter 275.

कार्यालय *kāryālay*
an office
Introduced in Chapter 271.

काँटा *kā̃ṭā*
a thorn, a fork
Introduced in Chapter 252.

कठिन *kaṭhin*
hard, difficult
Introduced in Chapter 212.

काटना *kāṭnā*
to cut
Introduced in Chapter 161.

कटोरी *kaṭorī*
a small bowl
Introduced in Chapter 132.

कौआ *kauā*
a crow
Introduced in Chapter 147.

कौन *kaun*
who? — asking about a person
Introduced in Chapter 40.

कौवा *kauvā*
a crow
Introduced in Chapter 199.

कवि *kavi*
a poet
Introduced in Chapter 195.

के बाद *ke bād*
after — the other end of the pair, and it needs a small word in front of it
Introduced in Chapter 98.

के बिना *ke binā*
without — the same shape as the last phrase with one word swapped, and the cheapest new meaning in the chapter
Introduced in Chapter 101.

के पीछे *ke pīche*
behind — the third of the three place words, and the pair that finishes the axis
Introduced in Chapter 101.

के सामने *ke sāmne*
in front of — the slot-three word a station announcement reaches for, and it does not bend
Introduced in Chapter 101.

के साथ *ke sāth*
with — two words where English has one, and the first of the two is a word you have had since the possessive chapter
Introduced in Chapter 101.

केला *kelā*
a banana
Introduced in Chapter 139.

ख़बर *khabar*
news
Introduced in Chapter 190.

खदान *khadān*
a mine
Introduced in Chapter 201.

ख़ाली *khālī*
empty
Introduced in Chapter 158.

खाना / ख़ाना *khānā / khāna*
food / house or compartment — Sanskrit-derived khānā versus Persian-derived khāna
Introduced in Chapter 37.

खाना खाया? *khānā khāyā?*
have you eaten?
Introduced in Chapter 123.

खड़ा होना *khaṛā honā*
to stand
Introduced in Chapter 42.

ख़र्च *kharc*
expense, spending
Introduced in Chapter 207.

खरगोश *khargoś*
a rabbit
Introduced in Chapter 147.

ख़रीदना *kharīdnā*
to buy
Introduced in Chapter 79.

ख़ास *khās*
special
Introduced in Chapter 242.

खाँसी *khā̃sī*
a cough
Introduced in Chapter 106.

खाँसना *khā̃snā*
to cough
Introduced in Chapter 231.

ख़तरनाक *khatarnāk*
dangerous
Introduced in Chapter 213.

ख़तरा *khatrā*
danger
Introduced in Chapter 259.

खट्टा *khaṭṭā*
sour
Introduced in Chapter 156.

खेल *khel*
a game
Introduced in Chapter 77.

खेलकूद *khelkūd*
sport, games
Introduced in Chapter 223.

खेलना / खेलता / खेलती / खेलते *khelnā / kheltā / kheltī / khelte*
to play / plays — infinitive / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural
Introduced in Chapter 77.

खेत *khet*
a field
Introduced in Chapter 56.

खींचना *khī̃cnā*
to pull
Introduced in Chapter 176.

खिचड़ी *khicṛī*
khichri (rice and lentils)
Introduced in Chapter 210.

खिलाड़ी *khilāṛī*
a player
Introduced in Chapter 195.

खिलौना *khilaunā*
a toy
Introduced in Chapter 264.

खीरा *khīrā*
a cucumber
Introduced in Chapter 139.

खिड़की *khiṛkī*
a window
Introduced in Chapter 58.

खोलना *kholnā*
to open
Introduced in Chapter 160.

खुदरा *khuḍrā*
retail, small change
Introduced in Chapter 250.

खुजली *khujlī*
an itch
Introduced in Chapter 274.

खुला / खुलना *khulā / khulnā*
open / to open
Introduced in Chapter 81.

ख़ून *khūn*
blood
Introduced in Chapter 152.

खुरदुरा *khurdurā*
rough (to the touch)
Introduced in Chapter 238.

ख़ुशबू *khushbū*
fragrance
Introduced in Chapter 57.

कीचड़ *kīcaṛ*
mud
Introduced in Chapter 252.

कील *kīl*
a nail (to hammer)
Introduced in Chapter 130.

किलो *kilo*
a kilo
Introduced in Chapter 251.

क़ीमत *kīmat*
a price, value
Introduced in Chapter 208.

क़ीमती *kīmtī*
valuable
Introduced in Chapter 241.

किनारा *kinārā*
a shore, a bank
Introduced in Chapter 144.

किराया *kirāyā*
rent, a fare
Introduced in Chapter 167.

किरायेदार *kirāyedār*
a tenant
Introduced in Chapter 271.

किसान *kisān*
a farmer
Introduced in Chapter 47.

किताब / पुस्तक / पोथा *kitāb / pustak / pothā*
book — ordinary किताब, formal पुस्तक, and old or homely पोथा form a three-register set
Introduced in Chapter 37.

किताबें *kitābeṁ*
books — a noun that ends in a consonant grows a syllable instead of changing one
Introduced in Chapter 99.

कितना *kitnā*
how much, how many — the word that has been locked inside the age question and used nowhere else
Introduced in Chapter 100.

कितना अच्छा! *kitnā acchā!*
how good! — the same question word with the question taken out of it
Introduced in Chapter 100.

को *ko*
to, and the marker a definite or human object takes — the postposition that was hiding inside mujhe all along
Introduced in Chapter 99.

कोहनी *kohnī*
an elbow
Introduced in Chapter 150.

कोहरा *kohrā*
fog
Introduced in Chapter 145.

कोई बात नहीं *koī bāt nahīṁ*
no problem, never mind
Introduced in Chapter 114.

कोना *konā*
a corner
Introduced in Chapter 234.

कोट *koṭ*
a coat
Introduced in Chapter 136.

कोयला *koylā*
coal
Introduced in Chapter 269.

क्रिकेट *kriket̤*
cricket, the game
Introduced in Chapter 77.

कृपया *kṛpayā*
please (kṛpayā — “kindly,” from kṛpā “grace/compassion”)
Introduced in Chapter 8.

कुआँ *kuā̃*
a well
Introduced in Chapter 66.

कुछ *kuch*
some, something
Introduced in Chapter 245.

कुछ नहीं *kuch nahīṁ*
nothing
Introduced in Chapter 113.

कुदाल *kudāl*
a pickaxe, a hoe
Introduced in Chapter 266.

कुम्हार *kumhār*
a potter
Introduced in Chapter 261.

कूड़ा *kūṛā*
rubbish
Introduced in Chapter 268.

कूड़ेदान *kūṛedān*
a dustbin
Introduced in Chapter 268.

कुर्सी *kursī*
chair — your first feminine noun, and a word that has been passing between Middle Eastern languages for four thousand years
Introduced in Chapter 36.

कुर्ता *kurtā*
a kurta
Introduced in Chapter 136.

कुत्ता *kuttā*
dog — a third uncertain-origin everyday word displacing an inherited PIE dog-word
Introduced in Chapter 23.

क्या *kyā*
what
Introduced in Chapter 2.

क्या आप जानते हैं? *kyā āp jānte haiṁ?*
do you know? — the question a traveller actually asks, built from the marker and the respectful plural you already have
Introduced in Chapter 103.

क्या चल रहा है? *kyā cal rahā hai?*
what's going on?
Introduced in Chapter 123.

क्या हाल है? *kyā hāl hai?*
how's it going?
Introduced in Chapter 123.

क्या कहा? *kyā kahā?*
what did you say?
Introduced in Chapter 126.

क्यों *kyoṁ*
why — the k- word the deixis lesson listed and never taught
Introduced in Chapter 71.

लड्डू *laḍḍū*
a laddu (a sweet)
Introduced in Chapter 210.

लगभग *lagbhag*
about, nearly
Introduced in Chapter 248.

लहर *lahar*
a wave
Introduced in Chapter 144.

लहसुन *lahsun*
garlic
Introduced in Chapter 138.

लाख *lākh*
a hundred thousand (lakh)
Introduced in Chapter 244.

लकड़ी *lakṛī*
wood, a stick of firewood
Introduced in Chapter 62.

लाल नीला *lāl nīlā*
red and blue — a Persian gemstone-name, and the Sanskrit word behind the world's word for "indigo"
Introduced in Chapter 11.

लंबा *lambā*
tall, long — one word for both, because Hindi measures the same distance whether it stands up or lies down
Introduced in Chapter 90.

लाना *lānā*
to bring
Introduced in Chapter 160.

लड़का *laṛkā*
a boy; a son
Introduced in Chapter 118.

लड़की *laṛkī*
a girl; a daughter
Introduced in Chapter 118.

लड़ना *laṛnā*
to fight
Introduced in Chapter 178.

लस्सी *lassī*
lassi, a yoghurt drink
Introduced in Chapter 142.

लटकना *laṭaknā*
to hang
Introduced in Chapter 230.

लटकाना *laṭkānā*
to hang (something)
Introduced in Chapter 230.

लौटाना *lauṭānā*
to give back
Introduced in Chapter 174.

लौटना *lauṭnā*
to come back
Introduced in Chapter 164.

लेखक *lekhak*
a writer
Introduced in Chapter 194.

लेकिन *lekin*
but — an Arabic word Hindi took through Persian, and the first word in this book that can contradict something
Introduced in Chapter 68.

लेना / ले / लेता / लेती / लेते / लाभ *lenā / le / letā / letī / lete / lābh*
to take / take / profit or gain — infinitive / stem / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural / noun
Introduced in Chapter 35.

लिफ़ाफ़ा *lifāfā*
an envelope
Introduced in Chapter 205.

लीजिए *lījie*
please take; here you are
Introduced in Chapter 115.

लिख दीजिए *likh dījie*
please write it down
Introduced in Chapter 111.

लिखना *likhnā*
to write
Introduced in Chapter 43.

लिखना / लिख / लिखता / लिखती / लिखते *likhnā / likh / likhtā / likhtī / likhte*
to write / stem / masculine, feminine, and respectful-plural present forms — from a Sanskrit verb meaning "to scratch", the same picture five language families reached independently
Introduced in Chapter 34.

लीटर *līṭar*
a litre
Introduced in Chapter 251.

लोग *log*
people
Introduced in Chapter 44.

लोहा *lohā*
iron
Introduced in Chapter 246.

लोहार *lohār*
a blacksmith
Introduced in Chapter 261.

लोमड़ी *lomṛī*
a fox
Introduced in Chapter 147.

मच्छर *macchar*
a mosquito
Introduced in Chapter 149.

मच्छरदानी *maccharadānī*
a mosquito net
Introduced in Chapter 267.

मछली *machhlī*
a fish
Introduced in Chapter 54.

माचिस *māchis*
matches
Introduced in Chapter 132.

मदद *madad*
help
Introduced in Chapter 190.

मदद करना / मदद करता / मदद करती / मदद करते *madad karnā / madad kartā / madad kartī / madad karte*
to help / masculine, feminine, and respectful-plural present forms — a noun plus **करना**, which is how Hindi turns almost anything into a verb
Introduced in Chapter 35.

माफ़ कीजिए / क्षमा करें *māf kījiye*
please forgive me / sorry (māf kījiye — “please do forgiveness”)
Introduced in Chapter 9.

माफ़ी *māfī*
an apology, pardon
Introduced in Chapter 114.

माँगना *mā̃gnā*
to ask for
Introduced in Chapter 173.

महँगा *mahãgā*
expensive
Introduced in Chapter 79.

महल *mahal*
a palace
Introduced in Chapter 202.

मैदान *maidān*
a field, a ground
Introduced in Chapter 153.

मैं *maiṁ*
I
Introduced in Chapter 3.

मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ *maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ*
I speak Hindi (gendered)
Introduced in Chapter 5.

मैं जानता हूँ *maiṁ jāntā hūṁ*
I know — the affirmative half of a verb the track has only ever used to deny something
Introduced in Chapter 103.

मक्खन *makkhan*
butter
Introduced in Chapter 141.

मक्खी *makkhī*
a fly
Introduced in Chapter 148.

माला *mālā*
a garland
Introduced in Chapter 51.

माली *mālī*
a gardener
Introduced in Chapter 261.

मालिक *mālik*
an owner, a boss
Introduced in Chapter 182.

मालूम नहीं *mālūm nahīṁ*
don't know
Introduced in Chapter 127.

मामा *māmā*
uncle, the mother's brother
Introduced in Chapter 117.

मन नहीं है *man nahīṁ hai*
I don't feel like it
Introduced in Chapter 125.

मनाना *manānā*
to celebrate, to persuade
Introduced in Chapter 177.

मंदिर *mandir*
a temple
Introduced in Chapter 152.

मानना *mānnā*
to accept, to agree, to believe
Introduced in Chapter 168.

मंत्री *mantrī*
a minister
Introduced in Chapter 196.

मंज़िल *manzil*
a floor, a storey
Introduced in Chapter 167.

मरम्मत *marammat*
a repair
Introduced in Chapter 166.

मरीज़ *marīz*
a patient
Introduced in Chapter 180.

मरना *marnā*
to die
Introduced in Chapter 170.

मारना *mārnā*
to hit
Introduced in Chapter 178.

मसाला *masālā*
spice, a spice mix
Introduced in Chapter 211.

मशहूर *maśhūr*
famous
Introduced in Chapter 242.

मस्जिद *masjid*
a mosque
Introduced in Chapter 152.

मत *mat*
don't — the negative reserved for commands, which is not the nahin the track already has
Introduced in Chapter 93.

मटर *maṭar*
peas
Introduced in Chapter 139.

माथा *māthā*
a forehead
Introduced in Chapter 53.

मटका *maṭkā*
a clay pot
Introduced in Chapter 270.

मतलब *matlab*
meaning
Introduced in Chapter 110.

मौसम / गर्मी है / ठंड है / बारिश हो रही है *mausam / garmī hai / ṭhanḍ hai / baarish ho rahī hai*
weather — the SAME root as English "monsoon"; rain has TWO words that sound alike but are NOT related, a real false-friend trap
Introduced in Chapter 20.

मौसी *mausī*
aunt, the mother's sister
Introduced in Chapter 117.

मौत *maut*
death
Introduced in Chapter 221.

मज़ा *mazā*
fun, enjoyment
Introduced in Chapter 125.

मज़बूत *mazbūt*
strong, sturdy
Introduced in Chapter 212.

मज़दूर *mazdūr*
a labourer
Introduced in Chapter 182.

मेहमान *mehmān*
a guest
Introduced in Chapter 47.

मेहनती *mehnatī*
hard-working — mehnat, Arabic for toil, plus the -i that turns a noun into the person who has it
Introduced in Chapter 91.

मेहरबानी *mehrabānī*
kindness
Introduced in Chapter 65.

मेला *melā*
a fair
Introduced in Chapter 272.

मेंढक *meṇḍhak*
a frog
Introduced in Chapter 149.

मेरा / मेरी / मेरे *merā / merī / mere*
my — masculine / feminine / plural
Introduced in Chapter 2.

मेरा नाम ... है *merā nām ... hai*
my name is...
Introduced in Chapter 2.

मेरे लिए *mere liye*
for me — and the pattern behind it, where a two-word postposition takes the same oblique possessive as paas
Introduced in Chapter 92.

मेरे पास *mere pās*
I have — literally near me, because Hindi has no verb for having, and the possessive goes oblique in front of the postposition
Introduced in Chapter 92.

मेज़ *mez*
a table
Introduced in Chapter 51.

मिलाना *milānā*
to mix, to introduce
Introduced in Chapter 168.

मिलनसार *milansār*
sociable — built on milnaa, to meet, which the track has had since its farewell lesson
Introduced in Chapter 91.

मिलेंगे / मिलना / मिल् / मिले / -एंगे / -गे *mileṅge / milnā / mil / mile / -eṅge / -ge*
(we or they) will meet / to meet / stem / future base / plural future ending and its final syllable
Introduced in Chapter 4.

मिलकर अच्छा लगा *milkar acchā lagā*
nice to meet you
Introduced in Chapter 120.

मीनार *mīnār*
a tower, a minaret
Introduced in Chapter 202.

मिनट *miniṭ*
a minute
Introduced in Chapter 191.

मीरा जी *Mīrā jī*
a name with **जी** after it — how you address somebody you are speaking or writing to
Introduced in Chapter 105.

मिर्च *mirc*
a chilli
Introduced in Chapter 141.

मीटर *mīṭar*
a metre
Introduced in Chapter 251.

मीठा *mīṭhā*
sweet
Introduced in Chapter 213.

मिठाई *miṭhāī*
a sweet
Introduced in Chapter 51.

मिठास *miṭhās*
sweetness
Introduced in Chapter 57.

मिट्टी *miṭṭī*
clay, earth
Introduced in Chapter 62.

मोबाइल *mobāil*
a mobile phone
Introduced in Chapter 249.

मोच *moc*
a sprain
Introduced in Chapter 275.

मोची *mochī*
a cobbler
Introduced in Chapter 262.

मोहल्ला *mohallā*
a neighbourhood
Introduced in Chapter 271.

मोहर *mohar*
a stamp, a seal
Introduced in Chapter 250.

मोमबत्ती *mombattī*
a candle
Introduced in Chapter 131.

मोड़ *moṛ*
a turn, a bend
Introduced in Chapter 181.

मोर *mor*
a peacock
Introduced in Chapter 60.

मोड़ना *moṛnā*
to bend, to turn
Introduced in Chapter 229.

मोटा *moṭā*
thick, heavy, stout — the opposite of patlaa across the whole range, from a person to a rope to a book
Introduced in Chapter 90.

मोज़ा *mozā*
a sock
Introduced in Chapter 135.

मुफ़्त *muft*
free (of charge)
Introduced in Chapter 241.

मूँगफली *mū̃gphalī*
a peanut
Introduced in Chapter 216.

मुझे ... पसंद है *mujhe ... pasand hai*
liked, pleasing — a Persian noun, not a verb, in a sentence where the thing you like is the subject and you are only the person it happens to
Introduced in Chapter 35.

मुझे चाय चाहिए *mujhe cāy cāhiye*
I want tea — the wanter goes in the dative, exactly as the liker does, because both are things that happen to a person
Introduced in Chapter 103.

मुझे नहीं पता *mujhe nahīṁ patā*
I don't know
Introduced in Chapter 126.

मुलाक़ात *mulāqāt*
a meeting
Introduced in Chapter 49.

मूली *mūlī*
a radish
Introduced in Chapter 216.

मुर्गी *murgī*
a hen
Introduced in Chapter 60.

मूर्ख *mūrkh*
foolish
Introduced in Chapter 215.

मुस्कुराना *muskurānā*
to smile
Introduced in Chapter 232.

नब्ज़ *nabz*
the pulse
Introduced in Chapter 257.

नाचना *nācnā*
to dance
Introduced in Chapter 162.

नदी *nadī*
a river
Introduced in Chapter 142.

नहाना *nahānā*
to bathe
Introduced in Chapter 160.

नहीं / जानता *nahīṃ / jāntā*
no / not / masculine present form of to know
Introduced in Chapter 7.

नहीं की जगह *nahīṁ kī jagah*
where the negative stands — the position of nahiin decides how much of a sentence is being taken back, and in a correction it denies only the option in front of it
Introduced in Chapter 102.

नहीं था *nahīṃ thā*
was not — the negative you already have, standing in the one slot it has always stood in
Introduced in Chapter 95.

नाई *nāī*
a barber
Introduced in Chapter 193.

नाक *nāk*
a nose
Introduced in Chapter 46.

नाकाम *nākām*
unsuccessful
Introduced in Chapter 243.

नाखून *nākhūn*
a fingernail
Introduced in Chapter 150.

नल *nal*
a tap
Introduced in Chapter 267.

नाली *nālī*
a drain
Introduced in Chapter 267.

नाम *nām*
name
Introduced in Chapter 2.

नमक *namak*
salt
Introduced in Chapter 45.

नमस्कार *namaskār*
hello (namaskār — more formal)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

नमस्ते *namaste*
hello / goodbye (namaste — “I bow to you”)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

नंबर *nambar*
a number
Introduced in Chapter 167.

नमकीन *namkīn*
salty
Introduced in Chapter 156.

नाना *nānā*
grandfather, the mother's father
Introduced in Chapter 116.

ननद *nanad*
a husband's sister
Introduced in Chapter 255.

नानी *nānī*
grandmother, the mother's mother
Introduced in Chapter 116.

नापना *nāpnā*
to measure
Introduced in Chapter 175.

नक़्शा *naqśā*
a map
Introduced in Chapter 181.

नरम *naram*
soft
Introduced in Chapter 155.

नारियल *nāriyal*
a coconut
Introduced in Chapter 140.

नर्म *narm*
soft
Introduced in Chapter 213.

नाश्ता *nāshtā*
breakfast
Introduced in Chapter 80.

नाटा *nāṭā*
short of stature — the word chhotaa cannot do, because chhotaa about a person means younger
Introduced in Chapter 90.

नतीजा *natījā*
a result
Introduced in Chapter 222.

नौकर *naukar*
a servant
Introduced in Chapter 196.

नौकरानी *naukarānī*
a maid
Introduced in Chapter 261.

नौकरी *naukrī*
a job
Introduced in Chapter 119.

नौवाँ / नौवीं *nauvā̃ / nauvī̃*
ninth / feminine ninth — a cardinal ending in a vowel, and the ending still just follows
Introduced in Chapter 83.

नाव *nāv*
a boat
Introduced in Chapter 182.

नया *nayā*
new
Introduced in Chapter 41.

नेता *netā*
a leader, a politician
Introduced in Chapter 195.

नींबू *nī̃bū*
a lemon, a lime
Introduced in Chapter 211.

नीचा *nīcā*
low
Introduced in Chapter 158.

नीचे *nīce*
down, below
Introduced in Chapter 235.

निचोड़ना *nicoṛnā*
to wring
Introduced in Chapter 225.

निजी *nijī*
private
Introduced in Chapter 241.

निकलना *nikalnā*
to set out, to leave
Introduced in Chapter 49.

निकास *nikās*
exit
Introduced in Chapter 81.

निमंत्रण *nimantraṇ*
an invitation
Introduced in Chapter 114.

नींद *nīnd*
sleep
Introduced in Chapter 63.

नींद आ रही है *nīnd ā rahī hai*
I'm sleepy
Introduced in Chapter 124.

नियम *niyam*
a rule
Introduced in Chapter 260.

नोट *noṭ*
a banknote
Introduced in Chapter 208.

नुक्कड़ *nukkaṛ*
a street corner
Introduced in Chapter 272.

नुक़सान *nuqsān*
a loss, harm
Introduced in Chapter 208.

ओस *os*
dew
Introduced in Chapter 22.

पाँच बजे *pā̃c baje*
at five o'clock — the bell already taught as a statement, now used to arrange a time
Introduced in Chapter 96.

पचास साठ *pacās sāṭh*
fifty and sixty — the last of the shared ending, and the first word that goes its own way
Introduced in Chapter 104.

पाँचवाँ / पाँचवीं / बीसवाँ / सौवाँ *pā̃cvā̃ / pā̃cvī̃ / bīsvā̃ / sauvā̃*
fifth / feminine fifth / twentieth / hundredth — where the rule finally arrives: number plus -वाँ
Introduced in Chapter 82.

पधारिए *padhārie*
please come (formal)
Introduced in Chapter 115.

पहनना *pahannā*
to wear
Introduced in Chapter 163.

पहाड़ *pahāṛ*
a mountain
Introduced in Chapter 142.

पहचान *pahcān*
identity; recognition
Introduced in Chapter 120.

पहला / पहली / पहले *pahlā / pahlī / pahle*
first / feminine first / before or earlier
Introduced in Chapter 82.

पहले *pahle*
first, and before — the word that lets two events be put in an order
Introduced in Chapter 98.

पहुँचना *pahũcnā*
to arrive
Introduced in Chapter 164.

पैंट *paiṇṭ*
trousers
Introduced in Chapter 135.

पैर / पाँव *pair / pāṁv*
foot — the two everyday forms descend from different Sanskrit stems, पैर from pad- and पाँव from pāda
Introduced in Chapter 38.

पैसा *paisā*
money
Introduced in Chapter 79.

पकाना *pakānā*
to cook
Introduced in Chapter 161.

पकड़ना *pakaṛnā*
to catch, to hold
Introduced in Chapter 165.

पक्का *pakkā*
sure, certain; firm
Introduced in Chapter 112.

पकड़ाना *pakṛānā*
to hand over
Introduced in Chapter 228.

पल *pal*
a moment
Introduced in Chapter 191.

पलंग *palaṅg*
a bed frame
Introduced in Chapter 133.

पालना *pālnā*
to bring up, to keep (animals)
Introduced in Chapter 227.

पानी रोटी *pānī roṭī*
water (literally "the drinkable one," not the ancient Sanskrit word for water) and bread/flatbread
Introduced in Chapter 15.

पनीर *panīr*
paneer, cottage cheese
Introduced in Chapter 141.

पंखा *pankhā*
a fan
Introduced in Chapter 132.

पपीता *papītā*
a papaya
Introduced in Chapter 216.

पर *par*
at a point — the postposition that pins you to a house or a platform, and sits after the place rather than before it
Introduced in Chapter 95.

पराठा *parāṭhā*
a paratha
Introduced in Chapter 210.

परदा *pardā*
a curtain
Introduced in Chapter 129.

पर्दा *pardā*
a curtain
Introduced in Chapter 265.

परेशान *pareśān*
troubled, bothered
Introduced in Chapter 108.

पढ़ना / पढ़ / पढ़ता / पढ़ती / पढ़ते / पढ़ाई / पढ़ाना *paṛhnā / paṛh / paṛhtā / paṛhtī / paṛhte / paṛhāī / paṛhānā*
to read or study / stem / masculine, feminine, and respectful-plural present forms / studies / to teach
Introduced in Chapter 34.

परिचय *paricay*
an introduction
Introduced in Chapter 120.

परीक्षा *parīkṣā*
an examination
Introduced in Chapter 197.

परिवार *parivār*
family
Introduced in Chapter 44.

परिवार के लिए *parivār ke liye*
for the family — the slot-three word you already met with a pronoun, now with a noun in front of it
Introduced in Chapter 101.

पार्क *pārk*
a park
Introduced in Chapter 187.

पड़ोसी *paṛosī*
a neighbour
Introduced in Chapter 47.

परसों *parsoṁ*
the day after tomorrow
Introduced in Chapter 49.

पश्चिम *paścim*
west
Introduced in Chapter 233.

पसीना *pasīnā*
sweat
Introduced in Chapter 124.

पतंग *patang*
a kite
Introduced in Chapter 265.

पाठ *pāṭh*
a lesson
Introduced in Chapter 197.

पति *pati*
a husband
Introduced in Chapter 118.

पतझड़ *patjhaṛ*
autumn
Introduced in Chapter 222.

पतला *patlā*
thin — Sanskrit for leaf-like, and the word Hindi uses for a thin person, a thin sheet and a thin soup alike
Introduced in Chapter 90.

पत्नी *patnī*
a wife
Introduced in Chapter 118.

पत्र *patra*
a letter (formal)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

पत्ता *pattā*
a leaf
Introduced in Chapter 185.

पत्थर *patthar*
a stone
Introduced in Chapter 144.

पट्टी *paṭṭī*
a bandage
Introduced in Chapter 256.

पायल *pāyal*
an anklet
Introduced in Chapter 263.

पेंसिल *pensil*
a pencil
Introduced in Chapter 134.

पेड़ *peṛ*
a tree
Introduced in Chapter 143.

पेशा *peśā*
a profession
Introduced in Chapter 119.

पेट *peṭ*
stomach, belly — masculine, and the one word in this chapter with no clean ancestry at all
Introduced in Chapter 38.

पेट्रोल *peṭrol*
petrol
Introduced in Chapter 204.

फैलाना *phailānā*
to spread (something)
Introduced in Chapter 229.

फैलना *phailnā*
to spread
Introduced in Chapter 229.

फल *phal*
a fruit
Introduced in Chapter 45.

फाड़ना *phāṛnā*
to tear (something)
Introduced in Chapter 227.

फटना *phaṭnā*
to tear, to burst
Introduced in Chapter 227.

फावड़ा *phāvṛā*
a spade
Introduced in Chapter 266.

फेंकना *phẽknā*
to throw
Introduced in Chapter 176.

फिर *phir*
again, then
Introduced in Chapter 4.

फिर आइएगा *phir āiegā*
do come again
Introduced in Chapter 121.

फिर मिलेंगे *phir milenge*
we'll meet again (goodbye)
Introduced in Chapter 4.

फिर से *phir se*
once more, over again
Introduced in Chapter 126.

फ़ोन *phon*
a telephone
Introduced in Chapter 204.

फूल *phūl*
a flower
Introduced in Chapter 51.

फुसफुसाना *phusphusānā*
to whisper
Introduced in Chapter 232.

पीछे *pīche*
behind
Introduced in Chapter 235.

पीना / पीता / खाना / खाता *pīnā / pītā / khānā / khātā*
to drink / masculine present form / to eat / masculine present form
Introduced in Chapter 80.

पीसना *pīsnā*
to grind
Introduced in Chapter 177.

पिता / माता / बाप / माँ *pitā / mātā / bāp / māṁ*
father and mother — respectable पिता and माता, everyday spoken बाप and माँ
Introduced in Chapter 12.

पीठ *pīṭh*
the back
Introduced in Chapter 53.

प्लास्टिक *plāsṭik*
plastic
Introduced in Chapter 246.

पोंछना *põchnā*
to wipe
Introduced in Chapter 225.

प्राचीन *prācīn*
ancient
Introduced in Chapter 240.

प्रणाम *praṇām*
a bow, a salutation
Introduced in Chapter 50.

प्रवेश *pravesh*
entrance
Introduced in Chapter 81.

प्रिय *priya*
dear — the word a written message opens with, before the name
Introduced in Chapter 105.

पूछना / पूछ / पूछता / पूछती / पूछते *pūchnā / pūch / pūchtā / pūchtī / pūchte*
to ask / ask — infinitive / stem / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural; the same inherited verb as English “pray”
Introduced in Chapter 35.

पूजा *pūjā*
worship
Introduced in Chapter 217.

पुजारी *pujārī*
a priest
Introduced in Chapter 262.

पुल *pul*
a bridge
Introduced in Chapter 153.

पुलिस *pulis*
the police
Introduced in Chapter 273.

पूरा *pūrā*
whole, complete
Introduced in Chapter 236.

पुराना *purānā*
old — of a thing, not of a person
Introduced in Chapter 41.

पुरुष *puruṣ*
a man
Introduced in Chapter 253.

पूर्व *pūrv*
east
Introduced in Chapter 233.

पुस्तकालय *pustakālay*
a library
Introduced in Chapter 152.

प्याला *pyālā*
a cup
Introduced in Chapter 209.

प्यार *pyār*
love
Introduced in Chapter 186.

प्यास *pyās*
thirst
Introduced in Chapter 63.

प्यासा *pyāsā*
thirsty
Introduced in Chapter 124.

प्याज़ *pyāz*
an onion
Introduced in Chapter 137.

क़ालीन *qālīn*
a carpet
Introduced in Chapter 265.

क़र्ज़ *qarz*
a debt, a loan
Introduced in Chapter 207.

क़िला *qilā*
a fort
Introduced in Chapter 202.

रात *raat*
“night” — already met inside aadhi raat (“midnight”); despite meaning the same thing as Latin’s nox, in a related Indo-European language, it comes from a COMPLETELY DIFFERENT PIE root — a genuine false cousin
Introduced in Chapter 26.

रहना / रहता / में *rahnā / rahtā / meṁ*
to live or stay / masculine present form / in
Introduced in Chapter 5.

राजा *rājā*
a king
Introduced in Chapter 196.

रजाई *rajāī*
a quilt
Introduced in Chapter 267.

राजधानी *rājdhānī*
a capital city
Introduced in Chapter 200.

राज्य *rājya*
a state
Introduced in Chapter 200.

राख *rākh*
ash
Introduced in Chapter 268.

रखना *rakhnā*
to put, to keep
Introduced in Chapter 159.

रंग *raṅg*
a colour
Introduced in Chapter 190.

रानी *rānī*
a queen
Introduced in Chapter 196.

रसीद *rasīd*
a receipt
Introduced in Chapter 167.

रसोई *rasoī*
a kitchen
Introduced in Chapter 183.

रस्सी *rassī*
a rope
Introduced in Chapter 62.

रास्ता *rāstā*
a way, a route
Introduced in Chapter 181.

राय *rāy*
an opinion
Introduced in Chapter 206.

रेगिस्तान *registān*
a desert
Introduced in Chapter 201.

रेल *rel*
the railway
Introduced in Chapter 76.

रेशम *reśam*
silk
Introduced in Chapter 247.

रेत *ret*
sand
Introduced in Chapter 144.

रिक्शा *rikśā*
a rickshaw
Introduced in Chapter 204.

रिश्तेदार *riśtedār*
a relative
Introduced in Chapter 118.

रोग *rog*
a disease
Introduced in Chapter 273.

रोगी *rogī*
a patient, a sick person
Introduced in Chapter 273.

रोकना *roknā*
to stop (someone or something)
Introduced in Chapter 172.

रोना *ronā*
to cry
Introduced in Chapter 162.

रोटी *roṭī*
bread (flatbread)
Introduced in Chapter 209.

रोज़ *roz*
every day
Introduced in Chapter 192.

ऋतु / वसंत ग्रीष्म वर्षा शरद् हेमंत शिशिर *ṛtu / vasant grīṣma varṣā śarad hemant śiśir*
ऋतु and the SIX traditional seasons — India's own system, which the Western four-season frame doesn't map onto cleanly
Introduced in Chapter 14.

रुई *rūī*
cotton wool
Introduced in Chapter 246.

रूखा *rūkhā*
dry, rough
Introduced in Chapter 238.

रुकिए *rukie*
please wait, please stop
Introduced in Chapter 110.

रुकना *ruknā*
to stop, to wait
Introduced in Chapter 171.

रुपया *rupayā*
a rupee
Introduced in Chapter 79.

सब *sab*
all, everyone
Introduced in Chapter 245.

सब ठीक? *sab ṭhīk?*
all well?
Introduced in Chapter 123.

शब्द *śabd*
a word
Introduced in Chapter 198.

सँभालना *sãbhālnā*
to look after, to handle
Introduced in Chapter 174.

साबुन *sābun*
soap
Introduced in Chapter 45.

सब्ज़ी *sabzī*
a vegetable, vegetables
Introduced in Chapter 52.

सच *sac*
true
Introduced in Chapter 48.

सच में? *sac meṁ?*
really?
Introduced in Chapter 112.

सच्चा *saccā*
true, genuine
Introduced in Chapter 214.

सचमुच *sacmuc*
truly, really
Introduced in Chapter 127.

साधारण *sādhāraṇ*
ordinary
Introduced in Chapter 242.

शादी *śādī*
a wedding, marriage
Introduced in Chapter 119.

सदी *sadī*
a century
Introduced in Chapter 191.

शादीशुदा *śādīśudā*
married
Introduced in Chapter 119.

साफ़ *sāf*
clean
Introduced in Chapter 155.

साफ़ करना *sāf karnā*
to clean
Introduced in Chapter 225.

सफ़र *safar*
a journey
Introduced in Chapter 49.

शहद *śahad*
honey
Introduced in Chapter 141.

सहेली *sahelī*
a female friend (of a girl)
Introduced in Chapter 254.

सही *sahī*
right, correct
Introduced in Chapter 112.

सहना *sahnā*
to bear, to put up with
Introduced in Chapter 179.

साइकिल *sāikil*
a bicycle
Introduced in Chapter 203.

सजाना *sajānā*
to decorate
Introduced in Chapter 174.

सख़्त *sakht*
hard
Introduced in Chapter 155.

सकना / सकता *saknā / saktā*
to be able to / can — infinitive / masculine singular
Introduced in Chapter 70.

साल *sāl*
a year
Introduced in Chapter 191.

सलाह *salāh*
advice
Introduced in Chapter 206.

समाज *samāj*
society
Introduced in Chapter 218.

समझ नहीं आया *samajh nahīṁ āyā*
I didn't understand
Introduced in Chapter 126.

समझना / समझ / समझता / समझती / समझते / समुझना *samajhnā / samajh / samajhtā / samajhtī / samajhte / samujhnā*
to understand / understanding or sense / masculine, feminine, and respectful-plural present forms / older Hindi form
Introduced in Chapter 34.

सामान *sāmān*
luggage, things
Introduced in Chapter 180.

समस्या *samasyā*
a problem
Introduced in Chapter 222.

समय *samay*
time, opening hours
Introduced in Chapter 166.

संबंधी *sambandhī*
a relative
Introduced in Chapter 254.

संभलकर *sambhalkar*
carefully
Introduced in Chapter 121.

समेटना *sameṭnā*
to gather up
Introduced in Chapter 229.

समझाना *samjhānā*
to explain
Introduced in Chapter 165.

सम्मान *sammān*
respect, honour
Introduced in Chapter 257.

समोसा *samosā*
a samosa
Introduced in Chapter 142.

समुद्र *samudra*
the sea
Introduced in Chapter 143.

संदेश *sandeś*
a message
Introduced in Chapter 166.

संदेसा *sandesā*
a message (everyday)
Introduced in Chapter 205.

संग्रहालय *saṅgrahālay*
a museum
Introduced in Chapter 203.

शनिवार रविवार *śanivār ravivār*
Saturday and Sunday — completing Hindi's planet-week
Introduced in Chapter 10.

संकरा *saṅkarā*
narrow
Introduced in Chapter 237.

शांत *śānt*
calm, peaceful
Introduced in Chapter 125.

संतरा *santarā*
an orange
Introduced in Chapter 140.

शांति *śānti*
peace
Introduced in Chapter 219.

साँप *sā̃p*
a snake
Introduced in Chapter 60.

सपना *sapnā*
a dream
Introduced in Chapter 223.

सड़क *saṛak*
a road
Introduced in Chapter 56.

साड़ी *sāṛī*
a sari
Introduced in Chapter 136.

सरकार *sarkār*
the government
Introduced in Chapter 218.

सरकारी *sarkārī*
government, official
Introduced in Chapter 241.

शर्म *śarm*
shame, shyness
Introduced in Chapter 186.

शर्मीला *śarmīlā*
shy — sharm, shame, plus the -ila that makes a settled disposition rather than a passing feeling
Introduced in Chapter 91.

शर्त *śart*
a condition, a bet
Introduced in Chapter 207.

साँस *sā̃s*
breath
Introduced in Chapter 274.

सास *sās*
a mother-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 254.

सस्ता *sastā*
cheap
Introduced in Chapter 212.

ससुर *sasur*
a father-in-law
Introduced in Chapter 254.

ससुराल *sasurāl*
the in-laws' home
Introduced in Chapter 117.

साथ *sāth*
with, together
Introduced in Chapter 249.

साथी *sāthī*
a companion
Introduced in Chapter 254.

सत्तर अस्सी नब्बे *sattar assī nabbe*
seventy, eighty and ninety — three words that lean on the small numbers and keep almost nothing else
Introduced in Chapter 104.

सातवाँ / सातवीं *sātvā̃ / sātvī̃*
seventh / feminine seventh — the rule restored, and the cardinal untouched
Introduced in Chapter 83.

सौ *sau*
a hundred — two letters, and the round figure every price reaches for
Introduced in Chapter 79.

शौक़ *śauq*
a hobby, a liking
Introduced in Chapter 223.

शौक़ से *śauq se*
by all means, gladly
Introduced in Chapter 115.

सवाल *savāl*
a question
Introduced in Chapter 189.

शायद *śāyad*
perhaps
Introduced in Chapter 48.

से *se*
from, and by — one small word doing two jobs English needs two words for
Introduced in Chapter 98.

से बड़ा *se baṛā*
bigger than — Hindi has no comparative ending, and the postposition you already have does the whole job
Introduced in Chapter 100.

सेब *seb*
an apple
Introduced in Chapter 139.

सेहत *sehat*
health, fitness
Introduced in Chapter 107.

सेना *senā*
an army
Introduced in Chapter 219.

शेर *śer*
a lion
Introduced in Chapter 145.

शाम *shaam*
"evening" (shaam) — another genuine Persian loanword, like subah; looks tempting to connect to Sanskrit श्यामा (śyāmā, "night/dark"), but that's a false cognate — different root entirely, despite the resemblance
Introduced in Chapter 29.

शहर *shahar*
a city, a town
Introduced in Chapter 75.

शुभ दोपहर *shubh dopahar*
"good afternoon" (shubh dopahar) — uses दोपहर in its modern, widened "afternoon" sense (HI-C30), not the narrow etymological "noon"; the rarest of this arc's three शुभ+noun greetings in actual casual use, with नमस्ते/नमस्कार covering the afternoon in practice
Introduced in Chapter 33.

शुभ संध्या / साँझ *shubh sandhyā / sāñjh*
"good evening" — sandhyā is the Sanskrit junction of day and night, with the register-crossing doublet sāñjh
Introduced in Chapter 32.

शुक्रिया *shukriyā*
thanks (shukriyā — everyday, Persian/Arabic-derived)
Introduced in Chapter 1.

सीधा *sīdhā*
straight, direct
Introduced in Chapter 234.

सीधासादा *sīdhāsādā*
simple, unpretentious
Introduced in Chapter 243.

सिखाना *sikhānā*
to teach
Introduced in Chapter 164.

सीखना *sīkhnā*
to learn
Introduced in Chapter 164.

सिक्का *sikkā*
a coin
Introduced in Chapter 208.

शिक्षक *śikṣak*
a teacher
Introduced in Chapter 47.

सीमा *sīmā*
a border, a limit
Introduced in Chapter 200.

सिनेमा *sinemā*
the cinema
Introduced in Chapter 187.

सिपाही *sipāhī*
a soldier, a constable
Introduced in Chapter 193.

सिर *sir*
the head — from Sanskrit śiras, worn down through a thousand years of everyday speech
Introduced in Chapter 13.

सिरदर्द *sirdard*
a headache
Introduced in Chapter 124.

सिर्फ़ *sirf*
only
Introduced in Chapter 248.

सीढ़ी *sīṛhī*
a staircase, a ladder
Introduced in Chapter 58.

शीशा *śīśā*
a mirror, glass
Introduced in Chapter 134.

शिशु *śiśu*
a baby, an infant
Introduced in Chapter 253.

सीट *sīṭ*
a seat
Introduced in Chapter 182.

सितार *sitār*
a sitar
Introduced in Chapter 264.

स्कूल *skūl*
school — borrowed whole from English, whose own word began as the Greek for leisure
Introduced in Chapter 89.

स्कूटर *skūṭar*
a scooter
Introduced in Chapter 203.

सोचना / सोच / सोचता / सोचती / सोचते *sochnā / soch / sochtā / sochtī / sochte*
to think / thought or worry / think — infinitive / noun / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural
Introduced in Chapter 34.

सोमवार मंगलवार बुधवार गुरुवार शुक्रवार / वार *somavār maṅgalvār budhvār guruvār śukravār*
Monday–Friday — Hindi's own planet-week, independent of Rome's
Introduced in Chapter 10.

सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक *somvār se śukravār tak*
Monday to Friday — a span with a marker on each end, which is how the working week is named in a written account
Introduced in Chapter 102.

सोना *sonā*
to sleep
Introduced in Chapter 159.

स्टेशन *sṭeshan*
a station
Introduced in Chapter 76.

स्थानीय *sthānīya*
local
Introduced in Chapter 240.

सुबह *subah*
“morning” (subah) — a Persian/Arabic loanword, NOT Sanskrit tatsama like din/raat; shares the Arabic root ح-ب-ص with ṣabāḥ (“morning”) and with the tuṣbiḥ inside the Arabic “good night” phrase
Introduced in Chapter 28.

सुबह से शाम तक *subah se śām tak*
from morning until evening — the same span frame filled with hours instead of days, and the reason one frame is enough
Introduced in Chapter 102.

शुभ रात्रि *śubh rātri*
“good night” — literally “auspicious night,” using the formal literary raatri, not the everyday raat just taught, plus shubh, an “auspicious” word that started life meaning “shining”
Introduced in Chapter 27.

शुभ यात्रा *śubh yātrā*
have a good journey
Introduced in Chapter 121.

शुभकामनाएँ *śubhkāmnāẽ*
good wishes
Introduced in Chapter 114.

सूची *sūcī*
a list
Introduced in Chapter 260.

सूचना *sūcnā*
a notice, information
Introduced in Chapter 166.

सुधारना *sudhārnā*
to improve, to correct
Introduced in Chapter 174.

सूँघना *sū̃ghnā*
to smell
Introduced in Chapter 177.

सुई *suī*
a needle
Introduced in Chapter 209.

सूई *sūī*
a needle
Introduced in Chapter 62.

सूजन *sūjan*
a swelling
Introduced in Chapter 274.

सूखा *sūkhā*
dry
Introduced in Chapter 154.

सुखाना *sukhānā*
to dry (something)
Introduced in Chapter 225.

सूखना *sūkhnā*
to dry (by itself)
Introduced in Chapter 226.

सुनाई नहीं दिया *sunāī nahīṁ diyā*
I could not hear it
Introduced in Chapter 111.

सुनाना *sunānā*
to tell (a story), to recite
Introduced in Chapter 170.

सुनार *sunār*
a goldsmith
Introduced in Chapter 261.

सुंदर / बदसूरत *sundar / badsūrat*
beautiful and ugly — a prefix you have already met, and a face
Introduced in Chapter 88.

सुनना / सुन / सुनता / सुनती / सुनते *sunnā / sun / suntā / suntī / sunte*
to listen or hear / listen or hear — infinitive / stem / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural
Introduced in Chapter 43.

सुनसान *sunsān*
deserted
Introduced in Chapter 239.

सुप्रभात / प्रभात *suprabhāt / prabhāt*
good morning / dawn or daybreak — formal greeting / Sanskrit-derived noun; **सुप्रभात** is completely different from **सुबह**, the Persian-loan everyday noun, and skews formal or written rather than casual spoken Hindi
Introduced in Chapter 31.

सुराही *surāhī*
a water jar
Introduced in Chapter 270.

सूरज *sūraj*
the sun
Introduced in Chapter 55.

सुरक्षित *surakṣit*
safe
Introduced in Chapter 213.

सुरंग *suraṅg*
a tunnel
Introduced in Chapter 203.

सुविधा *suvidhā*
a convenience, a facility
Introduced in Chapter 260.

स्वेटर *sveṭar*
a jumper
Introduced in Chapter 137.

तबीयत *tabīyat*
health, how one is feeling
Introduced in Chapter 106.

तबला *tablā*
a tabla
Introduced in Chapter 264.

तैराना *tairānā*
to float (something)
Introduced in Chapter 230.

तैरना *tairnā*
to swim
Introduced in Chapter 162.

तक *tak*
until, as far as — the postposition that marks where something stops, and the partner se has been waiting for
Introduced in Chapter 102.

तकिया *takiyā*
a pillow
Introduced in Chapter 129.

ताला *tālā*
a lock
Introduced in Chapter 129.

तालाब *tālāb*
a pond
Introduced in Chapter 201.

तलना *talnā*
to fry
Introduced in Chapter 177.

टमाटर *ṭamāṭar*
a tomato
Introduced in Chapter 138.

तनख़्वाह *tankhvāh*
a salary
Introduced in Chapter 182.

टंकी *ṭaṅkī*
a tank
Introduced in Chapter 267.

टपकना *ṭapaknā*
to drip
Introduced in Chapter 231.

तारा *tārā*
a star
Introduced in Chapter 55.

तराज़ू *tarāzū*
scales
Introduced in Chapter 251.

तरबूज़ *tarbūz*
a watermelon
Introduced in Chapter 140.

तारीख़ *tārīkh*
a date
Introduced in Chapter 167.

तस्वीर *tasvīr*
a picture
Introduced in Chapter 134.

तौलिया *tauliyā*
a towel
Introduced in Chapter 131.

तवा *tavā*
a flat iron griddle
Introduced in Chapter 61.

ताज़ा *tāzā*
fresh
Introduced in Chapter 157.

तेल *tel*
oil
Introduced in Chapter 52.

तेज़ *tez*
fast, sharp
Introduced in Chapter 155.

था *thā*
was — the single word that moves a sentence you can already build into the past
Introduced in Chapter 95.

थैला *thailā*
a bag
Introduced in Chapter 131.

थकान *thakān*
tiredness
Introduced in Chapter 106.

थकना *thaknā*
to get tired
Introduced in Chapter 179.

थाली *thālī*
a metal platter
Introduced in Chapter 57.

थाना *thānā*
a police station
Introduced in Chapter 187.

ठंड *ṭhaṇḍ*
cold, the cold
Introduced in Chapter 185.

ठंडा *ṭhaṇḍā*
cold, cool
Introduced in Chapter 109.

थे *the*
were — the plural past, and the form **आप** takes even for one person
Introduced in Chapter 95.

थी *thī*
was, said by or about a woman — the past copula bends where the present one refused to
Introduced in Chapter 95.

ठीक *ṭhīk*
fine, well, correct — and the reply “**मैं ठीक हूँ**”
Introduced in Chapter 3.

थोक *thok*
wholesale
Introduced in Chapter 251.

थोड़ा *thoṛā*
a little — the hedge that turns a yes into an honest one, and an answer a listening paper keys on
Introduced in Chapter 100.

ठोड़ी *ṭhoṛī*
the chin
Introduced in Chapter 151.

तिजोरी *tijorī*
a safe, a strongbox
Introduced in Chapter 250.

टीका *ṭīkā*
an injection, a vaccination
Introduced in Chapter 256.

टिकट *ṭikaṭ*
a ticket
Introduced in Chapter 76.

टिकट घर *ṭikaṭ ghar*
a ticket office
Introduced in Chapter 205.

तीखा *tīkhā*
spicy
Introduced in Chapter 156.

तिकोना *tikoṇā*
triangular
Introduced in Chapter 237.

टीम *ṭīm*
a team
Introduced in Chapter 224.

तीस चालीस *tīs cālīs*
thirty and forty — the first two rungs past the twenty the counting stopped at
Introduced in Chapter 104.

तीसरा / तीसरी *tīsrā / tīsrī*
third / feminine third — the third word to end in **-सरा**, and the last one that will
Introduced in Chapter 82.

तितली *titlī*
a butterfly
Introduced in Chapter 148.

तोहफ़ा *tohfā*
a present
Introduced in Chapter 57.

टोकरी *ṭokrī*
a basket
Introduced in Chapter 62.

तोलना *tolnā*
to weigh
Introduced in Chapter 174.

टोपी *ṭopī*
a cap, a hat
Introduced in Chapter 136.

तोड़ना *toṛnā*
to break
Introduced in Chapter 161.

तोता *totā*
a parrot
Introduced in Chapter 148.

ट्रक *ṭrak*
a lorry
Introduced in Chapter 204.

ट्रेन *ṭren*
train — an English word Hindi took whole, and the second vehicle you can travel by
Introduced in Chapter 102.

तूफ़ान *tūfān*
a storm
Introduced in Chapter 185.

तुम हो *tum ho*
you are, at the tum level — the copula form the track has only ever said inside one memorised question
Introduced in Chapter 93.

तुम्हारा *tumhārā*
your, to someone you are familiar with — the third of three levels, and choosing the wrong one is heard
Introduced in Chapter 92.

टूटना *ṭūṭnā*
to break (by itself)
Introduced in Chapter 226.

त्वचा *tvacā*
skin
Introduced in Chapter 200.

त्योहार *tyohār*
a festival
Introduced in Chapter 217.

उबालना *ubālnā*
to boil
Introduced in Chapter 177.

ऊँचा *ū̃cā*
high, tall
Introduced in Chapter 158.

उदास *udās*
sad
Introduced in Chapter 108.

उगाना *ugānā*
to grow (plants)
Introduced in Chapter 228.

उगना *ugnā*
to grow, to sprout
Introduced in Chapter 228.

उल्लू *ullū*
an owl
Introduced in Chapter 148.

उल्टा *ulṭā*
upside down, reversed
Introduced in Chapter 234.

उल्टी *ulṭī*
vomiting
Introduced in Chapter 256.

उम्मीद *ummīd*
hope
Introduced in Chapter 186.

उम्मीदवार *ummīdvār*
a candidate
Introduced in Chapter 260.

उम्र / आयु *umr / āyu*
age — everyday Perso-Arabic umr beside formal Sanskrit āyu
Introduced in Chapter 19.

ऊन *ūn*
wool
Introduced in Chapter 22.

उँगली *uṅglī*
a finger
Introduced in Chapter 46.

ऊपर *ūpar*
up, above
Introduced in Chapter 235.

उपाय *upāy*
a remedy, a way out
Introduced in Chapter 222.

उड़ना *uṛnā*
to fly
Introduced in Chapter 161.

उसका *uskā*
his, her, its — one Hindi word for all three, because the possessive agrees with the thing owned and never with the owner
Introduced in Chapter 92.

ऊँट *ū̃ṭ*
a camel
Introduced in Chapter 146.

उतरना *utarnā*
to get down, to get off
Introduced in Chapter 172.

उठाना *uṭhānā*
to lift, to pick up
Introduced in Chapter 170.

उथला *uthlā*
shallow
Introduced in Chapter 237.

उठना *uṭhnā*
to get up — the verb every routine starts with, and the first word in the track to open with the letter u
Introduced in Chapter 98.

उत्तर *uttar*
north
Introduced in Chapter 233.

वादा *vādā*
a promise
Introduced in Chapter 206.

वह *vah*
that one — the thing over there
Introduced in Chapter 40.

वहाँ *vahā̃*
there — where I am not
Introduced in Chapter 40.

वही *vahī*
that very one, the same
Introduced in Chapter 113.

वकील *vakīl*
a lawyer
Introduced in Chapter 193.

वाक्य *vākya*
a sentence
Introduced in Chapter 198.

वर्तमान *vartamān*
the present
Introduced in Chapter 221.

वसंत *vasant*
spring
Introduced in Chapter 221.

वे *ve*
they — the plural of vah, and the form a speaker also uses about one person they wish to honour
Introduced in Chapter 94.

वेटर *veṭar*
a waiter
Introduced in Chapter 80.

विचार *vicār*
a thought, an idea
Introduced in Chapter 206.

विदेशी *videśī*
foreign
Introduced in Chapter 240.

विद्यालय *vidyālay*
school — Sanskrit vidya knowledge plus alaya abode, an abode of knowledge; the vid- is cousin to English wit
Introduced in Chapter 89.

विज्ञान *vijñān*
science
Introduced in Chapter 198.

विज्ञापन *vijñāpan*
an advertisement
Introduced in Chapter 166.

विनती *vintī*
an entreaty
Introduced in Chapter 65.

विश्वास *viśvās*
faith, confidence
Introduced in Chapter 258.

व्यस्त *vyast*
busy
Introduced in Chapter 214.

या *yā*
or
Introduced in Chapter 247.

याद *yād*
a memory, remembering
Introduced in Chapter 186.

यह *yah*
this one — the thing near me
Introduced in Chapter 40.

यह किताब *yah kitāb*
this book — the demonstrative you know as a pronoun, standing in front of a noun instead
Introduced in Chapter 99.

यहाँ *yahā̃*
here — where I am
Introduced in Chapter 40.

यात्रा *yātrā*
a journey
Introduced in Chapter 180.

युद्ध *yuddh*
a war
Introduced in Chapter 219.

ज़रूर *zarūr*
certainly
Introduced in Chapter 48.

ज़रूरी *zarūrī*
necessary
Introduced in Chapter 213.

ज़ोर से *zor se*
loudly
Introduced in Chapter 110.

ज़ुकाम *zukām*
a cold, a runny nose
Introduced in Chapter 106.

ज़्यादा *zyādā*
a lot, more
Introduced in Chapter 64.

Review Questions

Try these without looking ahead. Every prompt comes from the same canonical lesson data as its chapter. Answers begin in the next section.

Chapter 1

1.1 *The line on top — Devanagari's head-line*
Keep नमस्ते visible and trace its head-line once from left to right. What is that line called?

1.2 *The line on top — Devanagari's head-line*
When is the shirorekha usually drawn?

1.3 न *and* म *— two bodies under one head-line*
Keep न म visible, copy each once, and name the shared frame.

Chapter 2

2.1 नमस्ते *— look, hide, write, compare*
After hiding the model for five seconds, write the familiar Hindi greeting and then compare it.

2.2 *One heard greeting — write what you know*
From the heard cue namaste alone, write the familiar Hindi greeting.

2.3 *One frame, one small choice*
Use the visible frame to write that the practice name is Mira. Do not add punctuation yet.

2.4 *One sentence, one stop*
Write the visible Mira sentence and close it with the Hindi sentence stop.

2.5 *Hide the sentence; keep the order*
After the ten-second delay and with the model hidden, write: My name is Mira.

2.6 *Hear one known sentence; write it*
From the heard cue alone, write: mera naam Arun hai.

2.7 *A two-sentence card for a new classmate*
Using the visible pieces, write a two-sentence card that greets a new classmate and gives the practice name Mira.

2.8 *No model — greet and give the name*
With no model, greet a new classmate and give the practice name Mira in two Hindi sentences.

Chapter 14

14.1 ऋ — *the independent vowel waiting inside* ऋतु
With no model or character bank, write the independent vowel at the start of ritu.

Chapter 67

67.1 नाम — *the first A1 form label*
A Hindi form shows नाम. What information belongs on that line?

67.2 *Two people, two known practice names*
In this practice bank, select the Devanagari name paired with B.

67.3 *Fill one field with the bank visible*
With the two-value bank visible, complete the Hindi name field for A.

67.4 *Hide the bank, then fill one line*
After hiding the bank for ten seconds, complete नाम for B. Do not reveal the bank until the attempt is finished.

67.5 *One no-model Hindi name field*
With no bank, romanization, or copyable answer, complete the Hindi name field for A.

Chapter 68

68.1 aur — *"and", and the letter this book owed you*
Say that you like tea and milk.

68.2 … या … *(*yā*) — "or"*
Offer a guest a choice between tea and milk, then offer them both.

68.3 लेकिन *(*lekin*) — "but"*
Fill the same slot three ways with chay and dudh: add, offer, contradict.

68.4 *The same gap, three ways*
Run chay and dudh three ways: added, offered as a choice, and contradicted.

Chapter 69

69.1 *The verb goes last*
Name the last word of each of the three sentences, and say what all three have in common.

69.2 कि *(*ki*) — "that"*
Say the tea is fine, then say that you think the tea is fine.

69.3 *Two clauses, two verbs, two ends*
Say that you think the tea is fine, then name the last word of each of its two halves.

Chapter 70

70.1 सकना / सकता *(*saknā / saktā*) — to be able to / can*
Say that you can speak Hindi, then that you cannot come tomorrow.

70.2 चाहना / चाह / चाहता *— to want, longing, and "want"*
Say that you can speak Hindi and then that you want to speak Hindi, and name the difference.

70.3 *One verb inside another*
Put a noun and then a verb in the same object slot: say that you look at the book, and that you want to speak.

70.4 *Can, want, and cannot*
Say three things: that you can come, that you want to come, and that you cannot come tomorrow.

Chapter 71

71.1 क्यों *(*kyoṁ*) — why*
Ask why the listener cannot come.

71.2 क्योंकि *(*kyoṁki*) — because*
Ask why the listener cannot come, then answer it: you cannot come tomorrow because you work.

71.3 *Two turns: why, and because*
Take both turns: ask why the listener cannot come, then answer with a reason.

Chapter 72

72.1 **कब** *(*kab*) — when?*
Ask when the listener can come.

72.2 **जब ... तब ...** *(*jab ... tab ...*) — when, then*
Say the three time words in order — question, when-clause, then-clause — and then use the frame in one sentence.

72.3 *One letter tells you the job*
Ask when the listener can come, then say when the listener listens, then give a reason you cannot come.

Chapter 73

73.1 **-कर / देखकर / करके** *— chaining actions in sequence*
Chain two actions: look at the book, then come.

73.2 *One clause or two*
Say the same two actions twice: joined with aur, then chained with -kar.

Chapter 74

74.1 **क्या** *...? — the yes-or-no question*
Say the two kya questions back to back: what can you do, and can you come.

74.2 *The question that is only a voice*
Say the same four words twice — as a statement, then as a question — and name what changed.

74.3 **... है ना***? — "isn't it?"*
Ask whether the tea is fine two ways: not knowing, then expecting agreement.

74.4 *Everything that joins, and everything that asks*
Say four sentences with a clause underneath: a reported thought, a reason, a when-frame, and a chained pair.

Chapter 85

85.1 *(reading) — six signs*
Which sign sends you IN?

85.2 *(reading) — six signs*
The shop is shut. Which word is on the door?

85.3 *(reading) — six notices*
Is the shop open or shut?

85.4 *(reading) — six notices*
And the station?

85.5 *(reading) — six notices*
Which line has no verb?

85.6 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Where does Arun live?

85.7 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Why does he go to the market today?

85.8 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
The man in the shop — what does Arun call him?

Chapter 105

105.1 *No model — a whole message to a named reader*
With no model, write the opening line of a short Hindi message to a reader called Arun.

Answer Key

The first response is the canonical display answer. When a question accepts other authored forms, they appear underneath.

Chapter 1

1.1 *The line on top — Devanagari's head-line*
Answer: शिरोरेखा
Also accepted: shirorekha; head-line; headline

1.2 *The line on top — Devanagari's head-line*
Answer: last
Also accepted: at the end; after the letter bodies

1.3 न *and* म *— two bodies under one head-line*
Answer: right spine and top bar
Also accepted: spine on the right and a top bar; right-hand spine and headline; right spine, top bar

Chapter 2

2.1 नमस्ते *— look, hide, write, compare*
Answer: नमस्ते

2.2 *One heard greeting — write what you know*
Answer: नमस्ते

2.3 *One frame, one small choice*
Answer: मेरा नाम मीरा है
Also accepted: मेरा नाम अरुण है

2.4 *One sentence, one stop*
Answer: मेरा नाम मीरा है।
Also accepted: मेरा नाम अरुण है।

2.5 *Hide the sentence; keep the order*
Answer: मेरा नाम मीरा है।

2.6 *Hear one known sentence; write it*
Answer: मेरा नाम अरुण है।

2.7 *A two-sentence card for a new classmate*
Answer: नमस्ते। मेरा नाम मीरा है।

2.8 *No model — greet and give the name*
Answer: नमस्ते। मेरा नाम मीरा है।

Chapter 14

14.1 ऋ *— the independent vowel waiting inside* ऋतु
Answer: ऋ

Chapter 67

67.1 नाम *— the first A1 form label*
Answer: name

67.2 *Two people, two known practice names*
Answer: अरुण

67.3 *Fill one field with the bank visible*
Answer: मीरा
Also accepted: नाम: मीरा; नाम:मीरा

67.4 *Hide the bank, then fill one line*
Answer: अरुण
Also accepted: नाम: अरुण; नाम:अरुण

67.5 *One no-model Hindi name field*
Answer: मीरा
Also accepted: नाम: मीरा; नाम:मीरा

Chapter 68

68.1 aur *— "and", and the letter this book owed you*
Answer: mujhe chāy aur dūdh pasand hai
Also accepted: mujhe chay aur dudh pasand hai

68.2 ... या ... *(*yā*) — "or"*
Answer: chāy yā dūdh? — chāy aur dūdh
Also accepted: चाय या दूध?; chay ya dudh, chay aur dudh

68.3 लेकिन *(*lekin*) — "but"*
Answer: chāy aur dūdh; chāy yā dūdh; chāy hai lekin dūdh nahīṁ hai
Also accepted: चाय या दूध, चाय है लेकिन दूध नहीं है

68.4 *The same gap, three ways*
Answer: chāy aur dūdh; chāy yā dūdh; chāy hai lekin dūdh nahīṁ hai
Also accepted: चाय या दूध, चाय है लेकिन दूध नहीं है

Chapter 69

69.1 *The verb goes last*
Answer: hai; hūṁ; hai — every one ends on its verb
Also accepted: है हूँ है the verb comes last

69.2 कि *(*ki*) — “that”*
Answer: chāy ṭhīk hai; maiṁ sochtā hūṁ ki chāy ṭhīk hai
Also accepted: चाय ठीक है, मैं सोचता हूँ कि चाय ठीक है

69.3 *Two clauses, two verbs, two ends*
Answer: maiṁ sochtā hūṁ ki chāy ṭhīk hai — hūṁ, then hai
Also accepted: मैं सोचता हूँ कि चाय ठीक है; हूँ, है

Chapter 70

70.1 सकना / सकता *(*saknā / saktā*) — to be able to / can*
Answer: maiṁ hindī bol saktā hūṁ; maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā
Also accepted: मैं हिंदी बोल सकता हूँ मैं कल नहीं आ सकता

70.2 चाहना / चाह / चाहता *— to want, longing, and “want”*
Answer: maiṁ hindī bol saktā hūṁ; maiṁ hindī bolnā chāhtā hūṁ — saknā takes the bare stem, chāhnā the full -nā
Also accepted: मैं हिंदी बोल सकता हूँ मैं हिंदी बोलना चाहता हूँ

70.3 *One verb inside another*
Answer: maiṁ kitāb dekhtā hūṁ; maiṁ bolnā chāhtā hūṁ
Also accepted: मैं किताब देखता हूँ, मैं बोलना चाहता हूँ

70.4 *Can, want, and cannot*
Answer: maiṁ ā saktā hūṁ; maiṁ ānā chāhtā hūṁ; maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā
Also accepted: मैं आ सकता हूँ मैं आना चाहता हूँ मैं कल नहीं आ सकता

Chapter 71

71.1 क्यों *(*kyoṁ*) — why*
Answer: āp kyoṁ nahīṁ ā sakte?
Also accepted: आप क्यों नहीं आ सकते?

71.2 क्योंकि (kyoṁki) — *because*

Answer: āp kyoṁ nahīṁ ā sakte? — maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā kyoṁki maiṁ kām kartā hūṁ
Also accepted: आप क्यों नहीं आ सकते? मैं कल नहीं आ सकता क्योंकि मैं काम करता हूँ

71.3 *Two turns: why, and because*

Answer: āp kyoṁ nahīṁ ā sakte? — maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā kyoṁki maiṁ kām kartā hūṁ
Also accepted: आप क्यों नहीं आ सकते? मैं कल नहीं आ सकता क्योंकि मैं काम करता हूँ

Chapter 72

72.1 कब (kab) — *when?*

Answer: āp kab ā sakte haiṁ?
Also accepted: आप कब आ सकते हैं?

72.2 जब ... तब ... (jab ... tab ...) — *when, then*

Answer: kab, jab, tab — jab maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ, tab āp sunte haiṁ
Also accepted: कब, जब, तब; जब मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ, तब आप सुनते हैं

72.3 *One letter tells you the job*

Answer: āp kab ā sakte haiṁ? — jab maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ, tab āp sunte haiṁ — maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā kyoṁki maiṁ kām kartā hūṁ
Also accepted: आप कब आ सकते हैं? जब मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ, तब आप सुनते हैं. मैं कल नहीं आ सकता क्योंकि मैं काम करता हूँ

Chapter 73

73.1 -कर / देखकर / करके — *chaining actions in sequence*

Answer: maiṁ kitāb dekhkar ātā hūṁ
Also accepted: मैं किताब देखकर आता हूँ

73.2 *One clause or two*

Answer: maiṁ kitāb dekhtā hūṁ aur ātā hūṁ; maiṁ kitāb dekhkar ātā hūṁ
Also accepted: मैं किताब देखकर आता हूँ

Chapter 74

74.1 क्या ...? — *the yes-or-no question*

Answer: āp kyā kar sakte haiṁ? — kyā āp ā sakte haiṁ?
Also accepted: आप क्या कर सकते हैं? क्या आप आ सकते हैं?

74.2 *The question that is only a voice*

Answer: āp ā sakte haiṁ. / āp ā sakte haiṁ? — only the pitch at the end
Also accepted: आप आ सकते हैं. आप आ सकते हैं? the rise

74.3 … है ना*? — "isn't it?"*
Answer: kyā chāy ṭhīk hai? — chāy ṭhīk hai nā?
Also accepted: क्या चाय ठीक है? चाय ठीक है ना?

74.4 *Everything that joins, and everything that asks*
Answer: maiṁ sochtā hūṁ ki chāy ṭhīk hai; maiṁ kal nahīṁ ā saktā kyoṁki maiṁ kām kartā hūṁ; jab maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ, tab āp sunte haiṁ; maiṁ kitāb dekhkar ātā hūṁ
Also accepted: मैं सोचता हूँ कि चाय ठीक है. मैं कल नहीं आ सकता क्योंकि मैं काम करता हूँ. जब मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ, तब आप सुनते हैं. मैं किताब देखकर आता हूँ

Chapter 85

85.1 *(reading) — six signs*
Answer: entrance
Also accepted: प्रवेश; pravesh

85.2 *(reading) — six signs*
Answer: closed
Also accepted: बंद; band

85.3 *(reading) — six notices*
Answer: shut
Also accepted: बंद; band; closed

85.4 *(reading) — six notices*
Answer: open
Also accepted: खुला; khula

85.5 *(reading) — six notices*
Answer: kripya dhire
Also accepted: कृपया धीरे; please slowly; the last one

85.6 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Answer: india
Also accepted: भारत; bharat

85.7 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Answer: because he likes fruit
Also accepted: क्योंकि मुझे फल पसंद हैं; he likes fruit; fruit

85.8 *(reading) — the first paragraph*
Answer: my friend
Also accepted: मेरा दोस्त; दोस्त; friend

Chapter 105

105.1 *No model — a whole message to a named reader*
Answer: प्रिय अरुण,
Also accepted: प्रिय अरुण

Index

Look up an English meaning, a dedicated language topic, or a chapter topic. Each linked reference opens the chapter where the material is introduced; the focus labels name only explicitly typed lesson sections.

0–9

11-20 — genuinely irregular, must be memorized individually; but उन्नीस (19) most likely preserves Sanskrit's OWN subtractive naming, the same logic as Latin's ūndēvīgintī ग्यारह बारह तेरह चौदह पंद्रह सोलह सत्रह अठारह उन्नीस बीस (gyārah — bīs)
explicit focus: script; Chapter 22, p. 187

A

a baby, an infant शिशु (śiśu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1683

a bag थैला (thailā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 945

A balcony, A cup, A needle, A lamp, Bread
chapter topic; Chapter 209, p. 1419

a balcony, a ledge छज्जा (chajjā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1419

a ball गेंद (gẽd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1503

a banana केला (kelā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 995

a bandage पट्टी (paṭṭī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1701

a bangle चूड़ी (cūṛī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1743

a bangle, a bracelet कंगन (kaṅgan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1737

a bank बैंक (baiṅk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1079

a banknote नोट (noṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1413

◌ो — a bar and a stroke
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 18, p. 161

a barber नाई (nāī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1321

a basket टोकरी (ṭokrī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 447

a bat बल्ला (ballā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1509

A bat, A win, A defeat, A team, A race
chapter topic; Chapter 224, p. 1509

a bear भालू (bhālū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1037

a bed frame पलंग (palaṅg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 957

a bell घंटी (ghaṇṭī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1749

a benefit, a profit फ़ायदा (fāydā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1413

a bicycle साइकिल (sāikil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1383

a bindi बिंदी (bindī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1743

a birthday जन्मदिन (janmdin)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 871

a blacksmith लोहार (lohār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1731

a blanket कंबल (kambal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 933

a blessing आशीर्वाद (āśīrvād)
Chapter 50, p. 359

a boat नाव (nāv)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1255

A boat, A seat, A salary, An owner, A labourer
chapter topic; Chapter 182, p. 1255

a bone हड्डी (haḍḍī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1357

a border, a limit सीमा (sīmā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1363

a bottle बोतल (botal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 963

a bow, a salutation प्रणाम (praṇām)
Chapter 50, p. 359

a box डिब्बा (ḍibbā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 945

a boy; a son लड़का (laṛkā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 865

a branch डाली (ḍālī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1677

a bridge पुल (pul)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1079

a broom झाड़ू (jhāṛū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 945

a bucket बाल्टी (bālṭī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 933

a bud कली (kalī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1677

a buffalo भैंस (bhaĩs)
Chapter 60, p. 431

a burning feeling जलन (jalan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1811

a butterfly तितली (titlī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1049

a button बटन (baṭan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1291

A button, A pocket, An enemy, An aunt (father's brother's wife), A nephew (brother's son)
chapter topic; Chapter 188, p. 1291

a camel ऊँट (ū̃ṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1037

a candidate उम्मीदवार (ummīdvār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1725

a candle मोमबत्ती (mombattī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 945

a cap, a hat टोपी (ṭopī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 975

a capital city राजधानी (rājdhānī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1363

a carpenter बढ़ई (baṛhaī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1737

A carpenter, A cobbler, A priest, A piece of jewellery, A bangle
chapter topic; Chapter 262, p. 1737

a carpet क़ालीन (qālīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1755

a carrot गाजर (gājar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 987

a cauliflower गोभी (gobhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 987

a cave गुफ़ा (gufā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1377

A cave, A palace, A fort, A tower, A garden
chapter topic; Chapter 202, p. 1377

a century सदी (sadī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1309

a cheek गाल (gāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1061

a chilli मिर्च (mirc)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1007

a church गिरजाघर (girjāghar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1285

A church, A police station, A postman, The cinema, A park
chapter topic; Chapter 187, p. 1285

a city, a town शहर (shahar)
Chapter 75, p. 517

a class, a classroom कक्षा (kakṣā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1345

A class, An examination, A lesson, Practice, A mark
chapter topic; Chapter 197, p. 1345

a clay pot मटका (maṭkā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1787

a cloud बादल (bādal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 391

a coat कोट (koṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 975

a cobbler मोची (mochī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1737

a coconut नारियल (nāriyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1001

a coin सिक्का (sikkā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1413

a cold, a runny nose ज़ुकाम (zukām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 791

a colour रंग (raṅg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1303

a comb कंघी (kaṅghī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 939

a companion साथी (sāthī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1689

a computer कंप्यूटर (kampyūṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1659

a condition, a bet शर्त (śart)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1407

A condition, A debt, Earnings, Savings, Expense
chapter topic; Chapter 207, p. 1407

a convenience, a facility सुविधा (suvidhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1725

A convenience, An inconvenience, A rule, A list, A candidate
chapter topic; Chapter 260, p. 1725

a conversation बातचीत (bātcīt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1395

a cook बावर्ची (bāvarcī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1327

a cooking fire चूल्हा (chūlhā)
Chapter 61, p. 439

a cooking vessel बर्तन (bartan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 439

a corner कोना (konā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1569

a cotton rug दरी (darī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1755

a cough खाँसी (khā̃sī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 791

a country देश (desh)
Chapter 75, p. 517

a court अदालत (adālat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1473

a courtyard आँगन (āṁgan)
Chapter 51, p. 367

a cow गाय (gāy)
Chapter 54, p. 385

a crop फ़सल (fasal)
Chapter 66, p. 471

a crossroads चौराहा (caurāhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1249

a crow कौआ (kauā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1043

a crow कौवा (kauvā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1357

a crowd भीड़ (bhīṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1719

a cucumber खीरा (khīrā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 995

a cup प्याला (pyālā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1419

a cupboard अलमारी (almārī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1267

a curtain परदा (pardā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 933

a curtain पर्दा (pardā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1755

a customer ग्राहक (grāhak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1261

a date तारीख़ (tārīkh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1163

a daughter-in-law बहू (bahū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1695

A daughter-in-law, A son-in-law, A husband's younger brother, A husband's sister, A sister's husband
chapter topic; Chapter 255, p. 1695

A Day, In The Order It Happens
chapter topic; Chapter 98, p. 699

a debt, a loan क़र्ज़ (qarz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1407

a deer हिरन (hiran)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1043

a defeat हार (hār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1509

a desert रेगिस्तान (registān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1369

A desert, A valley, A waterfall, A pond, A mine
chapter topic; Chapter 201, p. 1369

a discount छूट (chūṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1665

a disease रोग (rog)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1805

a doctor डाक्टर (ḍākṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 797

a document दस्तावेज़ (dastāvez)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1659

a doll गुड़िया (guṛiyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1749

a donkey गधा (gadhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1037

a dozen दर्जन (darjan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1635

a drain नाली (nālī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1767

a dream सपना (sapnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1503

a driver ड्राइवर (ḍrāivar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1327

a drum ढोल (ḍhol)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 15, p. 143

a dustbin कूड़ेदान (kūṛedān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1773

a factory कारख़ाना (kārkhānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1261

A factory, A shopkeeper, A customer, A meeting, A kitchen
chapter topic; Chapter 183, p. 1261

a fair मेला (melā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1799

a fan पंखा (pankhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 951

a farmer किसान (kisān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 341

a father-in-law ससुर (sasur)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1689

a favour एहसान (ehsān)
Chapter 50, p. 359

a feast, an invitation दावत (dāvat)
Chapter 57, p. 403

A female friend, A companion, A relative, A mother-in-law, A father-in-law
chapter topic; Chapter 254, p. 1689

a female friend (of a girl) सहेली (sahelī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1689

a festival त्योहार (tyohār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1467

a fever बुख़ार (bukhār)
Chapter 63, p. 453

a field खेत (khet)
Chapter 56, p. 397

a field, a ground मैदान (maidān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1079

a file फ़ाइल (fāil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1665

A file, A safe, A stamp, A discount, Retail
chapter topic; Chapter 250, p. 1665

a finger उँगली (uṅglī)
Chapter 46, p. 335

a fingernail नाखून (nākhūn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1061

a fish मछली (machhlī)
Chapter 54, p. 385

a flag झंडा (jhaṇḍā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1485

A flag, Childhood, Youth, Old age, Life
chapter topic; Chapter 220, p. 1485

a flat iron griddle तवा (tavā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 439

a flood बाढ़ (bāṛh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1683

a floor, a storey मंज़िल (manzil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1163

a floor (surface) फ़र्श (farś)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1267

A floor (surface), A key, A cupboard, A mirror, Rain
chapter topic; Chapter 184, p. 1267

a flower फूल (phūl)
Chapter 51, p. 367

a flute बाँसुरी (bā̃surī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1743

a fly मक्खी (makkhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1049

a forehead माथा (māthā)
Chapter 53, p. 379

a forest जंगल (jaṅgal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1019

a fort क़िला (qilā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1377

a fox लोमड़ी (lomṛī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1043

a frog मेंढक (meṇḍhak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1055

a fruit फल (phal)
Chapter 45, p. 329

a game खेल (khel)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 529

a garden बाग़ (bāg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1377

a garden बगीचा (bagīcā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1079

a gardener माली (mālī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1731

a garland माला (mālā)
Chapter 51, p. 367

A Gift and a Feast
chapter topic; Chapter 57, p. 403

a girl; a daughter लड़की (laṛkī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 865

a goat बकरी (bakrī)
Chapter 54, p. 385

a goldsmith सुनार (sunār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1731

a grater कद्दूकस (kaddūkas)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1787

A grater, A lid, A jug, A water jar, A clay pot
chapter topic; Chapter 270, p. 1787

a guava अमरूद (amrūd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1467

a guest मेहमान (mehmān)
Chapter 47, p. 341

a habit आदत (ādat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1503

A habit, A hobby, A dream, Sport, A ball
chapter topic; Chapter 223, p. 1503

a hammer हथौड़ा (hathauṛā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 939

a headache सिरदर्द (sirdard)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 901

a heartbeat धड़कन (dhaṛkan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1811

A heartbeat, Breath, An itch, A burning feeling, A swelling
chapter topic; Chapter 274, p. 1811

a hen मुर्गी (murgī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 60, p. 431

a hiccup हिचकी (hickī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1817

a hobby, a liking शौक़ (śauq)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1503

a holiday, a day off, leave छुट्टी (chuṭṭī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 889

a horse घोड़ा (ghoṛā)
Chapter 54, p. 385

a hospital अस्पताल (aspatāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 797

a human being, a person इंसान (insān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 877

a hundred thousand (lakh) लाख (lākh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1629

a hundred — two letters, and the round figure every price reaches for सौ (sau)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 79, p. 539

a husband पति (pati)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 865

a husband's sister ननद (nanad)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1695

a husband's younger brother देवर (devar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1695

a job नौकरी (naukrī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 871

a journey यात्रा (yātrā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1243

a journey सफ़र (safar)
Chapter 49, p. 353

a jug जग (jag)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1787

a jumper स्वेटर (sveṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 981

a key चाबी (cābī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1267

a kilo किलो (kilo)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1671

a king राजा (rājā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1339

a kitchen रसोई (rasoī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1261

a kite पतंग (patang)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1755

A kite, A swing, A curtain, A cotton rug, A carpet
chapter topic; Chapter 265, p. 1755

a knee घुटना (ghuṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 53, p. 379

a knife छुरी (churī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 951

a kurta कुर्ता (kurtā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 975

a labourer मज़दूर (mazdūr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1255

a laddu (a sweet) लड्डू (laḍḍū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1425

a lake झील (jhīl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1019

a lamp, a light बत्ती (battī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1419

a lane गली (galī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1799

A lane, A street corner, A fair, A procession, A speech
chapter topic; Chapter 272, p. 1799

a language भाषा (bhāshā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 517

a latch चिटकनी (ciṭkanī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1761

A latch, A saw, A pickaxe, A spade, A mattress
chapter topic; Chapter 266, p. 1761

a law क़ानून (kānūn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1473

a lawyer वकील (vakīl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1321

a leader, a politician नेता (netā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1333

a leaf पत्ता (pattā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1273

a lemon, a lime नींबू (nī̃bū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1431

a lesson पाठ (pāṭh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1345

a letter चिट्ठी (ciṭṭhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1297

A letter, A story, A question, An answer, A mistake
chapter topic; Chapter 189, p. 1297

A letter, An envelope, A ticket office, A message, A conversation
chapter topic; Chapter 205, p. 1395

a letter (formal) पत्र (patra)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1395

a library पुस्तकालय (pustakālay)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1073

a lid ढक्कन (dhakkan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1787

a lie झूठ (jhūṭh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1401

a lion शेर (śer)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1031

a lip होंठ (hoṇṭh)
Chapter 53, p. 379

a list सूची (sūcī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1725

a litre लीटर (līṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1671

a little — the hedge that turns a yes into an honest one, and an answer a listening paper keys on थोड़ा (thoṛā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 100, p. 727

a lock ताला (tālā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 933

a lorry ट्रक (ṭrak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1389

A lorry, A rickshaw, An aeroplane, Petrol, A telephone
chapter topic; Chapter 204, p. 1389

A loss, A benefit, A price, A coin, A banknote
chapter topic; Chapter 208, p. 1413

a loss, harm नुक़सान (nuqsān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1413

a lot, more ज़्यादा (zyādā)
Chapter 64, p. 459

a maid नौकरानी (naukarānī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1731

A maid, A gardener, A potter, A blacksmith, A goldsmith
chapter topic; Chapter 261, p. 1731

a man पुरुष (puruṣ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1683

a mango आम (ām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 995

a map नक़्शा (naqśā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1249

A map, A way, A turn, A crossroads, A ship
chapter topic; Chapter 181, p. 1249

a mark, a number अंक (aṅk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1345

a market बाज़ार (bāzār)
Chapter 56, p. 397

ु — a mātrā that hangs BELOW the letter
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415

a mattress गद्दा (gaddā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1761

a meaning अर्थ (arth)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1351

a meeting मुलाक़ात (mulāqāt)
Chapter 49, p. 353

a meeting, a sitting room बैठक (baiṭhak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1261

a memory, remembering याद (yād)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1279

a message संदेश (sandeś)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1157

a message (everyday) संदेसा (sandesā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1395

a metal platter थाली (thālī)
Chapter 57, p. 403

a metre मीटर (mīṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1671

a mine खदान (khadān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1369

a minister मंत्री (mantrī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1339

A minister, A king, A queen, A servant, A thief
chapter topic; Chapter 196, p. 1339

a minute मिनट (miniṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1309

a mirror आईना (āīnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1267

a mirror, glass शीशा (śīśā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 963

a mistake ग़लती (ġaltī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1297

a mobile phone मोबाइल (mobāil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1659

a moment पल (pal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1309

a monkey बंदर (bandar)
Chapter 60, p. 431

◌ँ — a moon and a dot that send the vowel through the nose
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415

a mosque मस्जिद (masjid)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1073

a mosquito मच्छर (macchar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1055

a mosquito net मच्छरदानी (maccharadānī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1767

a mother-in-law सास (sās)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1689

a mountain पहाड़ (pahāṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1013

a mouse चूहा (cūhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1055

a museum संग्रहालय (saṅgrahālay)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1383

a nail (to hammer) कील (kīl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 939

a name with जी after it — how you address somebody you are speaking or writing to मीरा जी (Mīrā jī)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 105, p. 783

a nap झपकी (jhapkī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1817

a needle सूई (sūī)
Chapter 62, p. 447

a needle सुई (suī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1419

a neighbour पड़ोसी (paṛosī)
Chapter 47, p. 341

a neighbourhood मोहल्ला (mohallā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1793

a nephew (brother's son) भतीजा (bhatījā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1291

a newspaper अख़बार (akhbār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1303

a nose नाक (nāk)
Chapter 46, p. 335

A Notice, a Message, Opening Times, an Advert, a Repair
chapter topic; Chapter 166, p. 1157

a notice, information सूचना (sūcnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1157

a number नंबर (nambar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1163

a painter चित्रकार (citrakār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1333

a pair जोड़ा (joṛā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1635

a palace महल (mahal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1377

a papaya पपीता (papītā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1461

a paratha पराठा (parāṭhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1425

A paratha, Khichri, Halwa, A laddu, Pickle
chapter topic; Chapter 210, p. 1425

a park पार्क (pārk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1285

a parrot तोता (totā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1049

a patient मरीज़ (marīz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1243

a patient, a sick person रोगी (rogī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1805

a peacock मोर (mor)
Chapter 60, p. 431

a peanut मूँगफली (mū̃gphalī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1461

A peanut, A radish, An aubergine, Okra, A papaya
chapter topic; Chapter 216, p. 1461

a pencil पेंसिल (pensil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 963

a pharmacy दवाख़ाना (davākhānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1805

a pickaxe, a hoe कुदाल (kudāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1761

a picture तस्वीर (tasvīr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 963

a piece of jewellery गहना (gahnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1737

a pigeon कबूतर (kabūtar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1049

a pill, a bullet गोली (golī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1701

a pillow तकिया (takiyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 129, p. 933

a player खिलाड़ी (khilāṛī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1333

a pocket जेब (jeb)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1291

a poet कवि (kavi)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1333

A poet, A painter, A singer, A player, A leader
chapter topic; Chapter 195, p. 1333

a police station थाना (thānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1285

a pomegranate अनार (anār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1467

A pomegranate, A guava, A festival, Worship, Religion
chapter topic; Chapter 217, p. 1467

a pond तालाब (tālāb)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1369

a post office डाकघर (ḍākghar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1073

a postman डाकिया (ḍākiyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1285

a potato आलू (ālū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 981

a potter कुम्हार (kumhār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 261, p. 1731

a present तोहफ़ा (tohfā)
Chapter 57, p. 403

a price दाम (dām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 539

a price, value क़ीमत (kīmat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 208, p. 1413

a priest पुजारी (pujārī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 262, p. 1737

a prison जेल (jel)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1479

A prison, Freedom, Peace, A war, An army
chapter topic; Chapter 219, p. 1479

a problem समस्या (samasyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1497

a procession जुलूस (jalūs)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1799

a profession पेशा (peśā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 871

a promise वादा (vādā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1401

a queen रानी (rānī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1339

a question सवाल (savāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1297

a quilt रजाई (rajāī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1767

A quilt, A mosquito net, A tap, A drain, A tank
chapter topic; Chapter 267, p. 1767

a rabbit खरगोश (khargoś)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1043

a race, running दौड़ (dauṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1509

a radish मूली (mūlī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1461

a rainbow इंद्रधनुष (indradhanuṣ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1683

A rainbow, An earthquake, A flood, A man, A baby
chapter topic; Chapter 253, p. 1683

a reason, a cause कारण (kāraṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1497

a receipt रसीद (rasīd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1163

a relative रिश्तेदार (riśtedār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 865

a relative संबंधी (sambandhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 254, p. 1689

a remedy, a way out उपाय (upāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1497

a repair मरम्मत (marammat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1157

a result नतीजा (natījā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1497

a rickshaw रिक्शा (rikśā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1389

a ring अंगूठी (aṅgūṭhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 134, p. 963

a river नदी (nadī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1013

a road सड़क (saṛak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 56, p. 397

a rolling pin बेलन (belan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1779

a roof छत (chat)
Chapter 58, p. 409

a root जड़ (jaṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1019

a rope रस्सी (rassī)
Chapter 62, p. 447

a rule नियम (niyam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1725

a rupee रुपया (rupayā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 539

a sack बोरी (borī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1677

A sack, A branch, A bud, A thorn, Mud
chapter topic; Chapter 252, p. 1677

a safe, a strongbox तिजोरी (tijorī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1665

a salary तनख़्वाह (tankhvāh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1255

a samosa समोसा (samosā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1013

a sandal, a slipper चप्पल (cappal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 969

a sari साड़ी (sāṛī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 975

a saw आरी (ārī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1761

a scarf, a dupatta दुपट्टा (dupaṭṭā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 136, p. 975

a scooter स्कूटर (skūṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1383

a seat सीट (sīṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1255

a seed बीज (bīj)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 471

a sentence वाक्य (vākya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1351

a servant नौकर (naukar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1339

a sheep भेड़ (bheṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1037

a sheet चादर (chādar)
Chapter 58, p. 409

a ship, an aeroplane जहाज़ (jahāz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1249

a shirt कमीज़ (kamīz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 969

a shoe जूता (jūtā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 969

a shop दुकान (dukān)
Chapter 56, p. 397

a shopkeeper दुकानदार (dukāndār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 183, p. 1261

a shore, a bank किनारा (kinārā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1025

a shoulder कंधा (kandhā)
Chapter 53, p. 379

a sieve छलनी (chalnī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1779

a signature हस्ताक्षर (hastākṣar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 877

a singer गायक (gāyak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 195, p. 1333

a sister's husband जीजा (jījā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1695

a sitar सितार (sitār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1749

A sitar, A tabla, A bell, A toy, A doll
chapter topic; Chapter 264, p. 1749

a small bird चिड़िया (chiṛiyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 54, p. 385

a small bowl कटोरी (kaṭorī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 951

a snake साँप (sā̃p)
Chapter 60, p. 431

a sock मोज़ा (mozā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 969

a soldier, a constable सिपाही (sipāhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1321

a son-in-law दामाद (dāmād)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 255, p. 1695

a song गाना (gānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 529

a spade फावड़ा (phāvṛā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 266, p. 1761

a speech भाषण (bhāṣaṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1799

a spoon चम्मच (chammach)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 439

a sprain मोच (moc)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1817

A sprain, A hiccup, A nap, Turning over, A stretch
chapter topic; Chapter 275, p. 1817

a staircase, a ladder सीढ़ी (sīṛhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 409

a stamp, a seal मोहर (mohar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1665

a star तारा (tārā)
Chapter 55, p. 391

a state राज्य (rājya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1363

a station स्टेशन (sṭeshan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 523

a stone पत्थर (patthar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1025

a storm आँधी (ā̃dhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1031

a storm तूफ़ान (tūfān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1273

a story कहानी (kahānī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1297

a street corner नुक्कड़ (nukkaṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 272, p. 1799

a stretch (of the body) अंगड़ाई (aṅgṛāī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1817

a student छात्र (chātra)
Chapter 47, p. 341

a sweet मिठाई (miṭhāī)
Chapter 51, p. 367

a swelling सूजन (sūjan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1811

a swing झूला (jhūlā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 265, p. 1755

a tabla तबला (tablā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1749

a table मेज़ (mez)
Chapter 51, p. 367

a tailor दर्ज़ी (darzī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1321

a tank टंकी (ṭaṅkī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1767

a tap नल (nal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 267, p. 1767

a teacher अध्यापक (adhyāpak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 193, p. 1321

a teacher शिक्षक (śikṣak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 47, p. 341

A teacher, A lawyer, A soldier, A tailor, A barber
chapter topic; Chapter 193, p. 1321

a team टीम (ṭīm)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1509

a telephone फ़ोन (phon)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1389

a temple मंदिर (mandir)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1073

a tenant किरायेदार (kirāyedār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1793

a thief चोर (cor)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 196, p. 1339

a thing चीज़ (cīz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1303

a thorn, a fork काँटा (kā̃ṭā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1677

a thought, an idea विचार (vicār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1401

a thousand हज़ार (hazār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1629

A thousand, A hundred thousand, Ten million, Several, Both
chapter topic; Chapter 244, p. 1629

a thumb अंगूठा (aṅgūṭhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1061

a ticket टिकट (ṭikaṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 523

a ticket office टिकट घर (ṭikaṭ ghar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1395

a tomato टमाटर (ṭamāṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 987

a tortoise कछुआ (kachuā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1055

a towel तौलिया (tauliyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 131, p. 945

a tower, a minaret मीनार (mīnār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 202, p. 1377

a toy खिलौना (khilaunā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 264, p. 1749

a tree पेड़ (peṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1019

a tumbler गिलास (gilās)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 61, p. 439

a tunnel सुरंग (suraṅg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1383

a turn, a bend मोड़ (moṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1249

A two-sentence card for a new classmate
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 2, p. 17

a valley घाटी (ghāṭī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1369

a vegetable, vegetables सब्ज़ी (sabzī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 373

a vehicle; a train गाड़ी (gāṛī)
Chapter 76, p. 523

a village गाँव (gā̃v)
Chapter 56, p. 397

a waiter वेटर (veṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 547

a wall दीवार (dīvār)
Chapter 58, p. 409

a wallet, a purse बटुआ (baṭuā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 957

a war युद्ध (yuddh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1479

a washerman धोबी (dhobī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1327

A washerman, A cook, A driver, An engineer, A writer
chapter topic; Chapter 194, p. 1327

a watch, a clock घड़ी (ghaṛī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 951

a water jar सुराही (surāhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 270, p. 1787

a waterfall झरना (jharnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 201, p. 1369

a watermelon तरबूज़ (tarbūz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1001

a wave लहर (lahar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1025

a way, a route रास्ता (rāstā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 181, p. 1249

a wedding, marriage शादी (śādī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 871

a week हफ़्ता (haftā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1309

A week, A year, A century, A moment, A minute
chapter topic; Chapter 191, p. 1309

a well कुआँ (kuā̃)
Chapter 66, p. 471

a wife पत्नी (patnī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 118, p. 865

a win जीत (jīt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 224, p. 1509

a window खिड़की (khiṛkī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 58, p. 409

a wok कड़ाही (kaṛāhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1779

a wolf भेड़िया (bheṛiyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 147, p. 1043

a word शब्द (śabd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1351

A word, A sentence, A meaning, Knowledge, Science
chapter topic; Chapter 198, p. 1351

a wound घाव (ghāv)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1701

a wrist कलाई (kalāī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1061

a writer लेखक (lekhak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1327

a year साल (sāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 191, p. 1309

a zoo चिड़ियाघर (ciṛiyāghar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 203, p. 1383

A zoo, A museum, A tunnel, A bicycle, A scooter
chapter topic; Chapter 203, p. 1383

Able, and Willing
chapter topic; Chapter 70, p. 493

about, nearly लगभग (lagbhag)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1653

absolutely बिलकुल (bilkul)
Chapter 48, p. 347

advice सलाह (salāh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1401

Advice, An opinion, A thought, A lie, A promise
chapter topic; Chapter 206, p. 1401

after — the other end of the pair, and it needs a small word in front of it के बाद (ke bād)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 98, p. 699

After the Work Is Done
chapter topic; Chapter 77, p. 529

Afternoon
chapter topic; Chapter 30, p. 231

"afternoon" — the same word already met meaning precisely "noon" (two pahars after sunrise, HI-C17), now widened in modern everyday usage to cover the whole afternoon stretch, not just the exact midday moment दोपहर (dopahar)
Chapter 30, p. 231

again, a second time दोबारा (dobārā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 815

again, then फिर (phir)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 51

age — everyday Perso-Arabic umr beside formal Sanskrit āyu उम्र / आयु (umr / āyu)
Chapter 19, p. 167

ahead, in front आगे (āge)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1575

all, everyone सब (sab)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1635

all together एक साथ (ek sāth)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1659

all well? सब ठीक? (sab ṭhīk?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 895

alone अकेला (akelā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 809

also, too भी (bhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 535

always हमेशा (hameśā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1315

am (1st-person of होना, “to be”) हूँ (hūṁ)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 41

an accident दुर्घटना (durghaṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1719

an advertisement विज्ञापन (vijñāpan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1157

an aeroplane हवाई जहाज़ (havāī jahāz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1389

an anklet पायल (pāyal)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1743

an answer जवाब (javāb)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 189, p. 1297

an ant चींटी (cīṇṭī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 149, p. 1055

an apology, pardon माफ़ी (māfī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 839

an apple सेब (seb)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 995

an army सेना (senā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1479

an aubergine बैंगन (bãigan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1461

an aunt (father’s brother’s wife) चाची (cācī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1291

an ear कान (kān)
Chapter 46, p. 335

an earring झुमका (jhumkā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 263, p. 1743

An earring, A bindi, A bangle, An anklet, A flute
chapter topic; Chapter 263, p. 1743

an earthquake भूकंप (bhūkamp)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 253, p. 1683

an eating house होटल (hoṭal)
Chapter 80, p. 547

an egg अंडा (aṇḍā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 981

an elbow कोहनी (kohnī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 150, p. 1061

an election चुनाव (cunāv)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1473

an elephant हाथी (hāthī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 146, p. 1037

an enemy दुश्मन (duśman)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 188, p. 1291

an engineer इंजीनियर (injīniyar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 194, p. 1327

an entreaty विनती (vintī)
Chapter 65, p. 465

an envelope लिफ़ाफ़ा (lifāfā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 205, p. 1395

an event घटना (ghaṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1719

an examination परीक्षा (parīkṣā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1345

an illness बीमारी (bīmārī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1805

an inconvenience असुविधा (asuvidhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 260, p. 1725

an injection, a vaccination टीका (ṭīkā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1701

an injury, a hurt चोट (coṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 797

an introduction परिचय (paricay)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 877

an invitation निमंत्रण (nimantraṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 839

an island द्वीप (dvīp)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1363

an itch खुजली (khujlī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1811

an office कार्यालय (kāryālay)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1793

an office दफ़्तर (daftar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 153, p. 1079

An office, Insurance, Interest, A tenant, A neighbourhood
chapter topic; Chapter 271, p. 1793

an oil lamp दीया (dīyā)
Chapter 45, p. 329

an onion प्याज़ (pyāz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 981

an opinion राय (rāy)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 206, p. 1401

an orange संतरा (santarā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1001

an owl उल्लू (ullū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 148, p. 1049

an owner, a boss मालिक (mālik)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 182, p. 1255

an umbrella छाता (chātā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 957

ancient प्राचीन (prācīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1605

And, Or, But
chapter topic; Chapter 68, p. 483

and — the commonest word in Hindi that this book had never taught, and the one that turns two sentences into one और (aur)
explicit focus: script; Chapter 68, p. 483

anger गुस्सा (gussā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 803

anger ग़ुस्सा (ġussā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1279

Anger, Love, Shame, Hope, A memory
chapter topic; Chapter 186, p. 1279

Animals
chapter topic; Chapter 54, p. 385

Animals in the Yard
chapter topic; Chapter 60, p. 431

arrogance अहंकार (ahaṅkār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1713

Arrogance, Patience, Courage, Faith, Loneliness
chapter topic; Chapter 258, p. 1713

ash राख (rākh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1773

Asking Nicely
chapter topic; Chapter 65, p. 465

Asking Someone's Age
chapter topic; Chapter 19, p. 167

Asking Without a Question Word
chapter topic; Chapter 74, p. 511

at a point — the postposition that pins you to a house or a platform, and sits after the place rather than before it पर (par)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 95, p. 661

at five o'clock — the bell already taught as a statement, now used to arrange a time पाँच बजे (pā̃c baje)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 96, p. 673

At the Cooking Fire
chapter topic; Chapter 61, p. 439

At the Doctor
chapter topic; Chapter 107, p. 797

aunt, the father's sister बुआ (buā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 859

aunt, the mother's sister मौसी (mausī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 859

Aunts, Uncles, In-Laws
chapter topic; Chapter 117, p. 859

autumn पतझड़ (patjhaṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 222, p. 1497

Autumn, A reason, A result, A problem, A remedy
chapter topic; Chapter 222, p. 1497

B

bad — the opposite of achhaa, and a word that lives inside one of the commonest apologies in Hindi बुरा (burā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 91, p. 613

Bear, Elephant, Camel, Donkey, Sheep
chapter topic; Chapter 146, p. 1037

beautiful and ugly — a prefix you have already met, and a face सुंदर / बदसूरत (sundar / badsūrat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 88, p. 591

bedding, a bed बिस्तर (bistar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 957

before the noun, and it AGREES — five words, one rule
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 41, p. 309

behind पीछे (pīche)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1575

behind — the third of the three place words, and the pair that finishes the axis के पीछे (ke pīche)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 101, p. 739
big बड़ा (baṛā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 309
bigger than — Hindi has no comparative ending, and the postposition you already have does the whole job से बड़ा (se baṛā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 100, p. 727
bitter कड़वा (kaṛvā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1097
black and white — black has a Sanskrit look-alike meaning time; white is a Persian loan काला सफ़ेद (kālā safed)
Chapter 11, p. 109
blood ख़ून (khūn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 152, p. 1073
Blood, Post office, Library, Temple, Mosque
chapter topic; Chapter 152, p. 1073
book — ordinary किताब, formal पुस्तक, and old or homely पोथा form a three-register set किताब / पुस्तक / पोथा (kitāb / pustak / pothā)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 275
books — a noun that ends in a consonant grows a syllable instead of changing one किताबें (kitābeṁ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 99, p. 711
both दोनों (donõ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1629
Bottle, Pencil, Picture, Mirror, Ring
chapter topic; Chapter 134, p. 963
boy child / girl child / calf — usually traced to Persian, beside an inherited Sanskrit cousin बच्चा / बच्ची / बछड़ा (bacchā / bacchī / bachṛā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 291
Boys, Girls, Husbands, Wives
chapter topic; Chapter 118, p. 865
brave बहादुर (bahādur)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1455
bread (flatbread) रोटी (roṭī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 209, p. 1419
breakfast नाश्ता (nāshtā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 80, p. 547
breath साँस (sā̃s)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 274, p. 1811

brother (a PIE cousin of English “brother”) and sister (a DIFFERENT Sanskrit word entirely, not the PIE cousin of “sister”) भाई बहन (bhāī bahin)
Chapter 12, p. 117

busy व्यस्त (vyast)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1449

but — an Arabic word Hindi took through Persian, and the first word in this book that can contradict something लेकिन (lekin)
Chapter 68, p. 483

butter मक्खन (makkhan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1007

Butter, Paneer, Honey, Chilli, Flour
chapter topic; Chapter 141, p. 1007

by all means, gladly शौक़ से (śauq se)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 845

by bus — three letters you already read as enough, and a second word that happens to be spelled the same बस से (bas se)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 98, p. 699

C

Calm and Restless
chapter topic; Chapter 125, p. 907

calm, peaceful शांत (śānt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 907

carefully संभलकर (sambhalkar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 883

certainly ज़रूर (zarūr)
Chapter 48, p. 347

chair — your first feminine noun, and a word that has been passing between Middle Eastern languages for four thousand years कुर्सी (kursī)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 267

Character, Not Mood
chapter topic; Chapter 91, p. 613

cheap सस्ता (sastā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1437

childhood बचपन (bacpan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1485

children — the plural of an -aa noun, and the same ending you have been bending adjectives with बच्चे (bacce)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 99, p. 711

Chin, Tongue, Neck, Chest, Waist
chapter topic; Chapter 151, p. 1067

chutney चटनी (caṭnī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1431

Chutney, Spice, Turmeric, Coriander, A lemon
chapter topic; Chapter 211, p. 1431

clay, earth मिट्टी (miṭṭī)
Chapter 62, p. 447

clean साफ़ (sāf)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1091

clever, alert — Persian for one who holds their wits, and a word that is a warning as often as a compliment होशियार (hośiyār)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 91, p. 613

clever, wise बुद्धिमान (buddhimān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1455

closed बंद (band)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 553

cloth कपड़ा (kapṛā)
Chapter 45, p. 329

coal कोयला (koylā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1779

Coal, Gas, A wok, A rolling pin, A sieve
chapter topic; Chapter 269, p. 1779

cold, cool ठंडा (ṭhaṇḍā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 809

cold, the cold ठंड (ṭhaṇḍ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1273

Come In, Here You Are
chapter topic; Chapter 115, p. 845

congratulations बधाई (badhāī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 839

coriander धनिया (dhaniyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1431

cotton wool रुई (rūī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1641

Counting Past Twenty
chapter topic; Chapter 104, p. 775

courage हिम्मत (himmat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1713

Courtesy Words
chapter topic; Chapter 50, p. 359

cricket, the game क्रिकेट (krikeṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 529

crowded, bustle भीड़भाड़ (bhīṛbhāṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1599

cunning, clever चालाक (cālāk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1623

D

danger ख़तरा (khatrā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1719

dangerous ख़तरनाक (khatarnāk)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1443

daughter बेटी (beṭī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 325

Day
chapter topic; Chapter 25, p. 207

"day" — shares its ultimate PIE root with Latin's diēs, but through a separate derivational branch (din patterns with Baltic/Slavic "day"-words); Sanskrit's own दिव्/द्यु are actually the closer, more direct cousins of diēs दिन (din)
Chapter 25, p. 207

Days of the Week
chapter topic; Chapter 10, p. 101

dear — the word a written message opens with, before the name प्रिय (priya)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 105, p. 783

death मौत (maut)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1491

Death, The future, The past, The present, Spring
chapter topic; Chapter 221, p. 1491

deep, dark (of colour) गहरा (gahrā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1109

Describing Things
chapter topic; Chapter 41, p. 309

deserted सुनसान (sunsān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1599

dew ओस (os)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 22, p. 187

dirty गंदा (gandā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1091

do come again फिर आइएगा (phir āiegā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 883

do you know? — the question a traveller actually asks, built from the marker and the respectful plural you already have क्या आप जानते हैं? (kyā āp jānte haiṁ?)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 103, p. 765

dog — a third uncertain-origin everyday word displacing an inherited PIE dog-word कुत्ता (kuttā)
Chapter 23, p. 199

Dog and Cat
chapter topic; Chapter 23, p. 199

don't know मालूम नहीं (mālūm nahīṁ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 919

don't — the negative reserved for commands, which is not the nahin the track already has मत (mat)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 93, p. 639

door — masculine, a Persian loan whose first syllable is the same ancient word as English "door" दरवाज़ा (darvāzā)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 267

double दुगना (dugnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1581

down, below नीचे (nīce)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1575

dry सूखा (sūkhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1085

dry, rough रूखा (rūkhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1593

E

earnings कमाई (kamāī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1407

east पूर्व (pūrv)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1563

easy and difficult — two loanwords, and neither of them bends आसान / मुश्किल (āsān / mushkil)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 88, p. 591

eighth / feminine eighth — the ending on a number that ends in a consonant cluster आठवाँ / आठवीं (āṭhvā̃ / āṭhvī̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 567

Elbow, Wrist, Thumb, Fingernail, Cheek
chapter topic; Chapter 150, p. 1061

electricity; lightning बिजली (bijlī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1025

empty ख़ाली (khālī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1109

English, the language अंग्रेज़ी (angrezī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 75, p. 517

enough; quite काफ़ी (kāfī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 833

enough, that's all बस (bas)
Chapter 48, p. 347

entrance प्रवेश (pravesh)
Chapter 81, p. 553

Evening
chapter topic; Chapter 29, p. 227

"evening" (shaam) — another genuine Persian loanword, like subah; looks tempting to connect to Sanskrit श्यामा (śyāmā, "night/dark"), but that's a false cognate — different root entirely, despite the resemblance शाम (shaam)
Chapter 29, p. 227

Every, All, Some, A dozen, A pair
chapter topic; Chapter 245, p. 1635

every day रोज़ (roz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1315

Every day, Sometimes, Always, Often, Never
chapter topic; Chapter 192, p. 1315

every, each हर (har)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1635

exit निकास (nikās)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 553

expense, spending ख़र्च (kharc)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1407

expensive महँगा (mahãgā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 539

eye — feminine, and a word-for-word cousin of English "eye" and Latin "oculus" आँख (āṁkh)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 283

F

faith, confidence विश्वास (viśvās)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1713

False, Clever, Foolish, Brave, Kind
chapter topic; Chapter 215, p. 1455

false, lying झूठा (jhūṭhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1455

Family
chapter topic; Chapter 12, p. 117

family परिवार (parivār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 44, p. 325

famous मशहूर (maśhūr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1617

Farewells
chapter topic; Chapter 4, p. 51

fast, sharp तेज़ (tez)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1091

father and mother — respectable पिता and माता, everyday spoken बाप and माँ पिता / माता / बाप / माँ (pitā / mātā / bāp / māṁ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 12, p. 117

fear डर (ḍar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 803

Fear, Anger, Sadness
chapter topic; Chapter 108, p. 803

fifth / feminine fifth / twentieth / hundredth — where the rule finally arrives: number plus -वाँ पाँचवाँ / पाँचवीं / बीसवाँ / सौवाँ (pā̃cvā̃ / pā̃cvī̃ / bīsvā̃ / sauvā̃)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 82, p. 559

fifty and sixty — the last of the shared ending, and the first word that goes its own way पचास साठ (pacās sāṭh)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 104, p. 775

Fill one field with the bank visible
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 67, p. 477

fine, well, correct — and the reply "मैं ठीक हूँ" ठीक (ṭhīk)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 41

fire आग (āg)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1773

first, and before — the word that lets two events be put in an order पहले (pahle)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 98, p. 699

first / feminine first / before or earlier पहला / पहली / पहले (pahlā / pahlī / pahle)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 559

First, Second, Third
chapter topic; Chapter 82, p. 559

flour आटा (āṭā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1007

fog कोहरा (kohrā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1031

food / house or compartment — Sanskrit-derived khānā versus Persian-derived khāna खाना / ख़ाना (khānā / khāna)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 275

foolish मूर्ख (mūrkh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1455

foot — the two everyday forms descend from different Sanskrit stems, पैर from pad- and पाँव from pāda पैर / पाँव (pair / pāṁv)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 283

for me — and the pattern behind it, where a two-word postposition takes the same oblique possessive as paas मेरे लिए (mere liye)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 92, p. 627

for the family — the slot-three word you already met with a pronoun, now with a noun in front of it परिवार के लिए (parivār ke liye)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 101, p. 739

foreign विदेशी (videśī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1605

Forms and Introductions
chapter topic; Chapter 120, p. 877

Four Adjectives That Always Agree
chapter topic; Chapter 90, p. 603

Four Adjectives That Do Not Agree
chapter topic; Chapter 88, p. 591

Four Core Colours
chapter topic; Chapter 11, p. 109

Four Verbs of the Mind
chapter topic; Chapter 34, p. 249

fourth / feminine fourth — a fourth shape, and the last of the four you must learn as words चौथा / चौथी (cauthā / cauthī)
Chapter 82, p. 559

fragrance ख़ुशबू (khushbū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 57, p. 403

free (of charge) मुफ़्त (muft)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1611

freedom आज़ादी (āzādī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1479

fresh ताज़ा (tāzā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1103

Fresh, Rich, Poor, Young, Old
chapter topic; Chapter 157, p. 1103

friend — a Persian word for "the one chosen", masculine by default but taking either possessive depending on who the friend is दोस्त (dost)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 291
from, and by — one small word doing two jobs English needs two words for से (se)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 98, p. 699
from morning until evening — the same span frame filled with hours instead of days, and the reason one frame is enough सुबह से शाम तक (subah se śām tak)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753
From, Until, and Instead
chapter topic; Chapter 102, p. 753
full भरा (bharā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1115
Full, To sleep, To wake up, To run, To put
chapter topic; Chapter 159, p. 1115
fun, enjoyment मज़ा (mazā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 907

G

Garden, Field, Bridge, Office, Bank
chapter topic; Chapter 153, p. 1079
garlic लहसुन (lahsun)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 987
Garlic, Ginger, Tomato, Carrot, Cauliflower
chapter topic; Chapter 138, p. 987
gas गैस (gais)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 269, p. 1779
ghee, clarified butter घी (ghī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 14, p. 133
ginger अदरक (adrak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 138, p. 987
glasses, spectacles चश्मा (caśmā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 133, p. 957
Glasses, Umbrella, Wallet, Bed frame, Bedding
chapter topic; Chapter 133, p. 957
good अच्छा (acchā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 309
Good Afternoon
chapter topic; Chapter 33, p. 245

“good afternoon” (shubh dopahar) — uses दोपहर in its modern, widened “afternoon” sense (HI-C30), not the narrow etymological “noon”; the rarest of this arc’s three शुभ+noun greetings in actual casual use, with नमस्ते/नमस्कार covering the afternoon in practice शुभ दोपहर (shubh dopahar)
Chapter 33, p. 245

Good Evening
chapter topic; Chapter 32, p. 237

“good evening” — sandhyā is the Sanskrit junction of day and night, with the register-crossing doublet sāñjh शुभ संध्या / साँझ (shubh sandhyā / sāñjh)
Chapter 32, p. 237

good manners अदब (adab)
Chapter 65, p. 465

Good Morning
chapter topic; Chapter 31, p. 235

good morning / dawn or daybreak — formal greeting / Sanskrit-derived noun; सुप्रभात is completely different from सुबह, the Persian-loan everyday noun, and skews formal or written rather than casual spoken Hindi सुप्रभात / प्रभात (suprabhāt / prabhāt)
Chapter 31, p. 235

Good Night
chapter topic; Chapter 27, p. 215

“good night” — literally “auspicious night,” using the formal literary raatri, not the everyday raat just taught, plus shubh, an “auspicious” word that started life meaning “shining” शुभ रात्रि (śubh rātri)
Chapter 27, p. 215

good wishes शुभकामनाएँ (śubhkāmnāẽ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 839

goodbye (alvidā — a final farewell, Persian/Arabic-derived) अलविदा (alvidā)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

government, official सरकारी (sarkārī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1611

Government, Private, Free, Valuable, Unusual
chapter topic; Chapter 241, p. 1611

grain अनाज (anāj)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 471

grandfather, the father’s father दादा (dādā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 853

grandfather, the mother’s father नाना (nānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 853

grandmother, the father's mother दादी (dādī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 853

grandmother, the mother's mother नानी (nānī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 853

Grandparents, and Which Side
chapter topic; Chapter 116, p. 853

grapes अंगूर (aṅgūr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1001

Grapes, Orange, Watermelon, Coconut, Yoghurt
chapter topic; Chapter 140, p. 1001

grass घास (ghās)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 66, p. 471

gratitude आभार (ābhār)
Chapter 50, p. 359

green — a deep cousin of German gelb and English yellow from an ancient shining-color root हरा (harā)
Chapter 24, p. 203

Green and Yellow
chapter topic; Chapter 24, p. 203

Greetings
chapter topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

H

hair बाल (bāl)
Chapter 46, p. 335

Hair, Ear, and Throat
chapter topic; Chapter 46, p. 335

half आधा (ādhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1581

Half, Whole, Double, Separate, Round
chapter topic; Chapter 236, p. 1581

halwa (a sweet) हलवा (halvā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1425

Hammer, Nail, Scissors, Thread, Comb
chapter topic; Chapter 130, p. 939

hard सख़्त (sakht)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1091

hard, difficult कठिन (kaṭhin)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1437

hard-working — mehnat, Arabic for toil, plus the -i that turns a noun into the person who has it मेहनती (mehnatī)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 91, p. 613

hatred घृणा (ghṛṇā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1707

have a good journey शुभ यात्रा (śubh yātrā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 883

have you eaten? खाना खाया? (khānā khāyā?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 895

hazy, blurred धुंधला (dhũdhlā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1599

he is doing, she is doing — the last word changes for who, the middle one for what they are कर रहा है (kar rahā hai)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 97, p. 687

he will come, she will come — the third-person future, and the ending changes for who rather than for you आएगा (āegā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 96, p. 673

Head and Hand
chapter topic; Chapter 13, p. 125

health, fitness सेहत (sehat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 797

health, how one is feeling तबीयत (tabīyat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 791

Hear one known sentence; write it
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 2, p. 17

heat, summer गर्मी (garmī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1273

heavy भारी (bhārī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1085

hello / goodbye (namaste — "I bow to you") नमस्ते (namaste)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

hello (namaskār — more formal) नमस्कार (namaskār)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

help मदद (madad)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1303

Help, News, A newspaper, A thing, A colour
chapter topic; Chapter 190, p. 1303

here — where I am यहाँ (yahā̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 301

Hide the bank, then fill one line
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 67, p. 477

Hide the sentence; keep the order
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 2, p. 17

high, tall ऊँचा (ū̃cā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1109

his, her, its — one Hindi word for all three, because the possessive agrees with the thing owned and never with the owner उसका (uskā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 92, p. 627

history इतिहास (itihās)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1357

History, Mathematics, A crow, The heart, A bone
chapter topic; Chapter 199, p. 1357

honest ईमानदार (īmāndār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1449

honey शहद (śahad)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1007

hope उम्मीद (ummīd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1279

hot, warm गरम (garam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1085

Hot, Wet, Dry, Heavy, Light
chapter topic; Chapter 154, p. 1085

hour or bell / to strike or toll / singular time frame / plural time frame घंटा / बजना / बज रहा है / बज रहे हैं (ghaṇṭā / bajnā / baj rahā hai / baj rahe haiṁ)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 18, p. 161

house, home — masculine, and probably from a Sanskrit word that meant a fenced enclosure before it meant a building घर (ghar)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 267

How Are You?
chapter topic; Chapter 3, p. 41

how are you? (respectful) आप कैसे हैं? (āp kaise haiṁ?)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 41

How Do You Say It?
chapter topic; Chapter 111, p. 821

how do you say it? कैसे कहते हैं? (kaise kahte haiṁ?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 821

how good! — the same question word with the question taken out of it कितना अच्छा! (kitnā acchā!)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 100, p. 727

How Much and How Fast
chapter topic; Chapter 64, p. 459

how much, how many — the word that has been locked inside the age question and used nowhere else कितना (kitnā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 100, p. 727

How Much, How Well, How Big
chapter topic; Chapter 100, p. 727

How's It Going?
chapter topic; Chapter 123, p. 895

how's it going? क्या हाल है*?* (kyā hāl hai?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 895

hunger भूख (bhūkh)
Chapter 63, p. 453

hungry भूखा (bhūkhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 901

Hungry, Thirsty, Sleepy
chapter topic; Chapter 124, p. 901

I

I मैं (maiṁ)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 41

I am doing, right now — three words, and the middle one is the only new thing कर रहा हूँ (kar rahā hū̃)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 97, p. 687

I am doing, said by a woman — the middle word bends and the other two do not कर रही हूँ (kar rahī hū̃)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 97, p. 687

I could not hear it सुनाई नहीं दिया (sunāī nahīṁ diyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 821

I didn't understand समझ नहीं आया (samajh nahīṁ āyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 913

I don't feel like it मन नहीं है (man nahīṁ hai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 907

I don't know मुझे नहीं पता (mujhe nahīṁ patā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 913

I have — literally near me, because Hindi has no verb for having, and the possessive goes oblique in front of the postposition मेरे पास (mere pās)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 92, p. 627

(I) have to go जाना है (jānā hai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 889

ि (i kī mātrā) — the short i sign in शुक्रिया
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 128, p. 927

I know — the affirmative half of a verb the track has only ever used to deny something मैं जानता हूँ (maiṁ jāntā hūṁ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 103, p. 765

I'll be off (masculine / feminine) / to move, walk, or go चलता हूँ / चलती हूँ / चलना (chaltā hūṁ / chaltī hūṁ / chalnā)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 51

I'm sleepy नींद आ रही है (nīnd ā rahī hai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 901

I speak Hindi (gendered) मैं हिंदी बोलता हूँ (maiṁ hindī boltā hūṁ)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 59

I want tea — the wanter goes in the dative, exactly as the liker does, because both are things that happen to a person मुझे चाय चाहिए (mujhe cāy cāhiye)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 103, p. 765

I will come — the same ending on a stem that ends in a vowel, which is where the long independent ū finally appears आऊँगा (āūṅgā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 96, p. 673

I will do — the future is an ending on the stem, and Hindi has no word for will करूँगा (karūṅgā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 96, p. 673

identity; recognition पहचान (pahcān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 877

if अगर (agar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1647

ill, sick बीमार (bīmār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 791

in front of — the slot-three word a station announcement reaches for, and it does not bend के सामने (ke sāmne)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 101, p. 739

in Hindi हिंदी में (hindī meṁ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 821

in order to do — the fifth kind of word to wear the oblique ending, and the first one that is a verb करने के लिए (karne ke liye)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 101, p. 739

In the Kitchen
chapter topic; Chapter 52, p. 373

India भारत (Bhārat)
Chapter 75, p. 517

inhabited, lively आबाद (ābād)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1599

inside अंदर (andar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1575

Inside the House
chapter topic; Chapter 58, p. 409

insurance बीमा (bīmā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1793

interest (on money) ब्याज (byāj)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 271, p. 1793

Introducing Yourself
chapter topic; Chapter 2, p. 17

iron लोहा (lohā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1641

Iron, Silver, Paper, Plastic, Cotton wool
chapter topic; Chapter 246, p. 1641

is है (hai)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

is needed, is wanted — a form of the wanting verb that takes a thing rather than an action, and never changes for the person who wants it चाहिए (cāhiye)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 103, p. 765

is that so?; all right then अच्छा जी (acchā jī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 919

it has got late देर हो गई (der ho gaī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 889

it's been a long time बहुत दिन हो गए (bahut din ho gae)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 895

It's Getting Late
chapter topic; Chapter 122, p. 889

J

jealousy ईर्ष्या (irṣyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1707

juice जूस (jūs)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1013

Jumper, Egg, Meat, Potato, Onion
chapter topic; Chapter 137, p. 981

K

khichri (rice and lentils) खिचड़ी (khicṛī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1425

kind दयालु (dayālu)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 215, p. 1455

kindness मेहरबानी (mehrabānī)
Chapter 65, p. 465

knowledge ज्ञान (jñān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1351

Kurta, Sari, Scarf, Cap, Coat
chapter topic; Chapter 136, p. 975

L

Lake, Sea, Forest, Tree, Root
chapter topic; Chapter 143, p. 1019

languages — a feminine noun in -aa, which behaves like the consonant ones rather than like baccha भाषाएँ (bhāṣāẽ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 99, p. 711

lassi, a yoghurt drink लस्सी (lassī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 142, p. 1013

lateness, a delay देर (der)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 553

later, afterwards बाद में (bād mẽ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1653

laughter हँसी (hãsī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 809

Laughter and Tears
chapter topic; Chapter 109, p. 809

lazy आलसी (ālsī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1449

leather चमड़ा (cāmṛā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1647

ि — left on the page, right in the mouth
script and writing topic; Chapter 2, p. 17

left (side) बायाँ (bāyā̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1569

Left, Straight, Upside down, The middle, A corner
chapter topic; Chapter 234, p. 1569

lentils, split pulses दाल (dāl)
Chapter 52, p. 373

let's go, shall we चलिए (calie)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 883

Letters You Have Read All Along
chapter topic; Chapter 128, p. 927

life जीवन (jīvan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1485

light (in weight) हल्का (halkā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1085

liked, pleasing — a Persian noun, not a verb, in a sentence where the thing you like is the subject and you are only the person it happens to मुझे … पसंद है (mujhe … pasand hai)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 35, p. 257

little, not much कम (kam)
Chapter 64, p. 459

local स्थानीय (sthānīya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1605

local, homemade देसी (desī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1605

Lock, Pillow, Blanket, Curtain, Bucket
chapter topic; Chapter 129, p. 933

loneliness अकेलापन (akelāpan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1713

loudly ज़ोर से (zor se)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 815

love प्यार (pyār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1279

low नीचा (nīcā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1109

luggage, things सामान (sāmān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1243

lukewarm गुनगुना (gungunā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1593

Lunch and Dinner
chapter topic; Chapter 87, p. 587

lunch and dinner — literally the afternoon's food and the night's food दोपहर का खाना / रात का खाना (dopahar kā khānā / rāt kā khānā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 87, p. 587

M

man, person — masculine despite its -ī ending, and literally "of Adam" आदमी (ādmī)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 291

married शादीशुदा (śādīśudā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 119, p. 871

matches माचिस (māchis)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 132, p. 951

Matches, Small bowl, Knife, Fan, Watch
chapter topic; Chapter 132, p. 951

mathematics गणित (gaṇit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1357

Mātrās — swapping the built-in vowel
script and writing topic; Chapter 2, p. 17

maybe, it could be हो सकता है (ho saktā hai)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 833

meaning मतलब (matlab)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 815

meat गोश्त (gośt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 137, p. 981

medicine दवा (davā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1243

Medicine, A patient, Treatment, A journey, Luggage
chapter topic; Chapter 180, p. 1243

milk — masculine, and literally “the milked thing”, a past participle that hardened into a noun दूध (dūdh)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 275

modern आधुनिक (ādhunik)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 240, p. 1605

Modern, Ancient, Local, Foreign, Local
chapter topic; Chapter 240, p. 1605

Monday–Friday — Hindi’s own planet-week, independent of Rome’s सोमवार मंगलवार बुधवार गुरुवार शुक्रवार / वार (somavār maṅgalvār budhvār guruvār śukravār)
Chapter 10, p. 101

Monday to Friday — a span with a marker on each end, which is how the working week is named in a written account सोमवार से शुक्रवार तक (somvār se śukravār tak)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753

money पैसा (paisā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 539

Months
chapter topic; Chapter 16, p. 149

More Everyday Verbs
chapter topic; Chapter 42, p. 315

More of the Body
chapter topic; Chapter 53, p. 379

Morning
chapter topic; Chapter 28, p. 221

“morning” (subah) — a Persian/Arabic loanword, NOT Sanskrit tatsama like din/raat; shares the Arabic root ح-ب-ص with ṣabāḥ (“morning”) and with the tuṣbiḥ inside the Arabic “good night” phrase सुबह (subah)
Chapter 28, p. 221

Mosquito, Ant, Frog, Tortoise, Mouse
chapter topic; Chapter 149, p. 1055

mud कीचड़ (kīcaṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 252, p. 1677

my — masculine / feminine / plural मेरा / मेरी / मेरे (merā / merī / mere)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

my name is... मेरा नाम ... है (merā nām ... hai)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 2, p. 17

N

name नाम (nām)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

narrow संकरा (saṅkarā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1587

near the house — and the reason the phrase for having something has looked so strange since the possessive chapter घर के पास (ghar ke pās)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 101, p. 739

necessary ज़रूरी (zarūrī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1443

Necessary, Dangerous, Safe, Sweet, Soft
chapter topic; Chapter 213, p. 1443

nervousness, panic घबराहट (ghabrāhaṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 907

never कभी नहीं (kabhī nahī̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1315

new नया (nayā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 309

news ख़बर (khabar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 190, p. 1303

nice to meet you मिलकर अच्छा लगा (milkar acchā lagā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 120, p. 877

Night
chapter topic; Chapter 26, p. 211

“night” — already met inside aadhi raat (“midnight”); despite meaning the same thing as Latin’s nox, in a related Indo-European language, it comes from a COMPLETELY DIFFERENT PIE root — a genuine false cousin रात (raat)
Chapter 26, p. 211

ninth / feminine ninth — a cardinal ending in a vowel, and the ending still just follows नौवाँ / नौवीं (nauvā̃ / nauvī̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 567
No model — a whole message to a named reader
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 105, p. 783
No model — greet and give the name
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 2, p. 17
no / not / masculine present form of to know नहीं / जानता (nahīṃ / jāntā)
Chapter 7, p. 75
no, politely जी नहीं (jī nahīṁ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 845
no problem, never mind कोई बात नहीं (koī bāt nahīṁ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 114, p. 839
Noon and Midnight
chapter topic; Chapter 17, p. 155
noon (literally "two pahars," a traditional ~3-hour time unit) and midnight ("half night," fully transparent) दोपहर आधी रात (dopahar ādhī rāt)
Chapter 17, p. 155
north उत्तर (uttar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1563
North, South, East, West, Right
chapter topic; Chapter 233, p. 1563
Not at All
chapter topic; Chapter 127, p. 919
not at all बिलकुल नहीं (bilkul nahīṁ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 919
Not Feeling Well
chapter topic; Chapter 106, p. 791
not yet, not now अभी नहीं (abhī nahīṁ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 833
nothing कुछ नहीं (kuch nahīṁ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 833
Nothing, Not Yet, Maybe
chapter topic; Chapter 113, p. 833
now, from this point on अब (ab)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 64, p. 459
Numbers Eleven to Twenty
chapter topic; Chapter 22, p. 187
Numbers One to Five
chapter topic; Chapter 6, p. 67
Numbers Six to Ten
chapter topic; Chapter 21, p. 181

O

often अक्सर (aksar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1315

oh!, hey! अरे (are)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 827

oil तेल (tel)
Chapter 52, p. 373

okra भिंडी (bhiṇḍī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 216, p. 1461

old age बुढ़ापा (buṛhāpā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1485

old — of a thing, not of a person पुराना (purānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 309

old (of people) बूढ़ा (būṛhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1103

once more, over again फिर से (phir se)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 913

Once More, Please
chapter topic; Chapter 110, p. 815

One and the Other
chapter topic; Chapter 84, p. 575

◌े — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 83

◌् — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 10, p. 101

◌ा — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 11, p. 109

◌ी — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 12, p. 117

◌ँ — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 14, p. 133

◌ु — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 16, p. 149

One frame, one small choice
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 2, p. 17

One heard greeting — write what you know
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 2, p. 17

One House, Four Languages
chapter topic; Chapter 36, p. 267

one minute, a moment एक मिनट (ek minaṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 815

one more time एक बार और (ek bār aur)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 913

One no-model Hindi name field
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 67, p. 477

one's own — the possessive that takes over whenever the owner is the subject of the sentence, which is not optional अपना (apnā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 92, p. 627

One sentence, one stop
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 2, p. 17

One Tea, Please
chapter topic; Chapter 37, p. 275

one to five, with familiar Devanagari pieces and the chandrabindu in पाँच एक दो तीन चार पाँच (ek do tīn chār pāṁch)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 6, p. 67

One verb inside another
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 70, p. 493

only सिर्फ़ (sirf)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1653

Only, About, Later, Soon, Suddenly
chapter topic; Chapter 248, p. 1653

open / to open खुला / खुलना (khulā / khulnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 81, p. 553

or या (yā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1647

or — two letters you already own, and the word every offered choice is made of … या … (… yā …)
Chapter 68, p. 483

ordinary साधारण (sādhāraṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1617

Ordinary, Special, Famous, Useless, Successful
chapter topic; Chapter 242, p. 1617

our — and a word Hindi reaches for where English would say my, because a family and a home are spoken of as shared हमारा (hamārā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 92, p. 627

P

pain दर्द (dard)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 63, p. 453

paneer, cottage cheese पनीर (panīr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 141, p. 1007

paper काग़ज़ (kāgaz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1641
patience धीरज (dhīraj)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 258, p. 1713
peace शांति (śānti)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 219, p. 1479
peas मटर (maṭar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 139, p. 995
Peas, Cucumber, Mango, Banana, Apple
chapter topic; Chapter 139, p. 995
people लोग (log)
Chapter 44, p. 325
perhaps शायद (śāyad)
Chapter 48, p. 347
permission अनुमति (anumati)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 465
permission, leave to go इजाज़त (ijāzat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 889
petrol पेट्रोल (peṭrol)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 204, p. 1389
pickle अचार (achār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 210, p. 1425
Pigeon, Parrot, Owl, Butterfly, Fly
chapter topic; Chapter 148, p. 1049
plastic प्लास्टिक (plāsṭik)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1641
Please
chapter topic; Chapter 8, p. 83
please come (formal) पधारिए (padhārie)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 845
please come (in) आइए (āie)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 845
please forgive me / sorry (māf kījiye — "please do forgiveness") माफ़ कीजिए / क्षमा करें (māf kījiye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 9, p. 93
please (kṛpayā — "kindly," from kṛpā "grace/ compassion") कृपया (kṛpayā)
Chapter 8, p. 83
please show me दिखाइए (dikhāie)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 821
please speak — the respectful command, and the ending the track has been using inside two fixed phrases without ever taking it apart बोलिए (boliye)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 93, p. 639

please take; here you are लीजिए (lījie)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 115, p. 845

please wait, please stop रुकिए (rukie)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 110, p. 815

please write it down लिख दीजिए (likh dījie)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 111, p. 821

pleased to meet you / happiness आपसे मिलकर ख़ुशी हुई / ख़ुशी (āpse milkar khushī huī / khushī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

Pointing, and Asking
chapter topic; Chapter 40, p. 301

poor ग़रीब (ġarīb)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1103

practice, an exercise अभ्यास (abhyās)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 197, p. 1345

pride गर्व (garv)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1707

private निजी (nijī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1611

proud, arrogant घमंडी (ghamaṇḍī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1623

Q

quarrelsome झगड़ालू (jhagṛālū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1623

quickly, soon जल्दी (jaldī)
Chapter 64, p. 459

R

Rabbit, Deer, Fox, Wolf, Crow
chapter topic; Chapter 147, p. 1043

rain बारिश (bāriś)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 184, p. 1267

Raw, Lukewarm, Dry, Sticky, Rough
chapter topic; Chapter 238, p. 1593

raw, unripe कच्चा (kaccā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1593

Reading — Signs, Notices, and a First Paragraph
chapter topic; Chapter 85, p. 579

really? सच में? (sac meṁ?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 827

red and blue — a Persian gemstone-name, and the Sanskrit word behind the world's word for "indigo" लाल नीला (lāl nīlā)
Chapter 11, p. 109

religion, duty धर्म (dharm)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1467

Rent, a Date, a Number, a Floor, a Receipt
chapter topic; Chapter 167, p. 1163

rent, a fare किराया (kirāyā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 167, p. 1163

respect आदर (ādar)
Chapter 50, p. 359

respect, honour सम्मान (sammān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1707

rest, ease आराम (ārām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 529

restless, uneasy बेचैन (becain)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 125, p. 907

Restlessness, A crowd, An event, An accident, Danger
chapter topic; Chapter 259, p. 1719

restlessness, unease बेचैनी (becainī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 259, p. 1719

retail, small change खुदरा (khuḍrā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 250, p. 1665

rice चावल (chāval)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 52, p. 373

rich अमीर (amīr)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1103

right, correct सही (sahī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 827

right now अभी (abhī)
Chapter 49, p. 353

right (side) दायाँ (dāyā̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1563

Right, Wrong, Sure
chapter topic; Chapter 112, p. 827

room — masculine, and the same Latin word as English "camera", brought to India by Portuguese ships कमरा (kamrā)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 36, p. 267

rough (to the touch) खुरदुरा (khurdurā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1593

round **गोल** (gol)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1581

rubbish **कूड़ा** (kūṛā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1773

Rubbish, A dustbin, Smoke, Fire, Ash
chapter topic; Chapter 268, p. 1773

S

sad **उदास** (udās)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 803

safe **सुरक्षित** (surakṣit)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1443

salt **नमक** (namak)
Chapter 45, p. 329

salty **नमकीन** (namkīn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1097

Samosa, Lassi, Juice, Mountain, River
chapter topic; Chapter 142, p. 1013

sand **रेत** (ret)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 144, p. 1025

Sandal, Shoe, Sock, Shirt, Trousers
chapter topic; Chapter 135, p. 969

Saturday and Sunday — completing Hindi's planet-week **शनिवार रविवार** (śanivār ravivār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 10, p. 101

savings **बचत** (bacat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 207, p. 1407

scales **तराज़ू** (tarāzū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1671

school — borrowed whole from English, whose own word began as the Greek for leisure **स्कूल** (skūl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 595

school — Sanskrit vidya knowledge plus alaya abode, an abode of knowledge; the vid- is cousin to English wit **विद्यालय** (vidyālay)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 89, p. 595

School: The Borrowed Word and the Built One
chapter topic; Chapter 89, p. 595

science **विज्ञान** (vijñān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 198, p. 1351

scissors **कैंची** (kaĩcī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 939

Seasons
chapter topic; Chapter 14, p. 133

second or other / feminine second or other दूसरा / दूसरी (dūsrā / dūsrī)
Chapter 82, p. 559

see you tomorrow (and the कल puzzle) कल मिलते हैं (kal milte haiṁ)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 51

separate, different अलग (alag)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1581

serious, grave — Sanskrit for deep, which is the same metaphor Latin reached for with gravis गंभीर (gambhīr)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 91, p. 613

seventh / feminine seventh — the rule restored, and the cardinal untouched सातवाँ / सातवीं (sātvā̃ / sātvī̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 567

seventy, eighty and ninety — three words that lean on the small numbers and keep almost nothing else सत्तर अस्सी नब्बे (sattar assī nabbe)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 104, p. 775

several कई (kaī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1629

shallow उथला (uthlā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1587

shame, shyness शर्म (śarm)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 186, p. 1279

shiny चमकदार (camakdār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 239, p. 1599

Shiny, Hazy, Deserted, Crowded, Inhabited
chapter topic; Chapter 239, p. 1599

short of stature — the word chhotaa cannot do, because chhotaa about a person means younger नाटा (nāṭā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 90, p. 603

Short Replies
chapter topic; Chapter 48, p. 347

shy — sharm, shame, plus the -ila that makes a settled disposition rather than a passing feeling शर्मीला (śarmīlā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 91, p. 613

silk रेशम (reśam)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1647

Silk, Leather, So, If, Or
chapter topic; Chapter 247, p. 1647

silver चाँदी (cā̃dī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 246, p. 1641

simple, unpretentious सीधासादा (sīdhāsādā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1623

sister-in-law, a brother's wife भाभी (bhābhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 859

six to ten, with seven and eight repeating the same Prakrit weight trade as three छह सात आठ नौ दस (chhah sāt āṭh nau das)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 21, p. 181

Six Words for Where It Hurts
chapter topic; Chapter 38, p. 283

sixth / feminine sixth — the one number that will not take the rule छठा / छठी (chaṭhā / chaṭhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 567

Sixth to Tenth
chapter topic; Chapter 83, p. 567

skin त्वचा (tvacā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 200, p. 1363

Skin, A state, A capital city, A border, An island
chapter topic; Chapter 200, p. 1363

sleep नींद (nīnd)
Chapter 63, p. 453

slow, low धीमा (dhīmā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1097

Slow, Sour, Bitter, Salty, Spicy
chapter topic; Chapter 156, p. 1097

slowly धीरे (dhīre)
Chapter 64, p. 459

small छोटा (choṭā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 41, p. 309

smoke धुआँ (dhuā̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 268, p. 1773

Smooth, Busy, Lazy, Honest, True
chapter topic; Chapter 214, p. 1449

smooth, greasy चिकना (cikanā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1449

snow, ice बर्फ़ (barf)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1031

so, therefore इसलिए (isliye)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 247, p. 1647

soap साबुन (sābun)
Chapter 45, p. 329

sociable — built on milnaa, to meet, which the track has had since its farewell lesson मिलनसार (milansār)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 91, p. 613

society समाज (samāj)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1473

Society, The government, A law, A court, An election
chapter topic; Chapter 218, p. 1473

soft नरम (naram)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 155, p. 1091

soft नर्म (narm)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1443

Soft, Hard, Clean, Dirty, Fast
chapter topic; Chapter 155, p. 1091

some, something कुछ (kuch)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 245, p. 1635

sometimes, ever कभी (kabhī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 192, p. 1315

son बेटा (beṭā)
Chapter 44, p. 325

Sons, Daughters, and Everyone Else
chapter topic; Chapter 44, p. 325

soon जल्द ही (jald hī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1653

sorrow, grief दुख (dukh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 809

Sorry
chapter topic; Chapter 9, p. 93

Sorry, No Problem, Congratulations
chapter topic; Chapter 114, p. 839

sour खट्टा (khaṭṭā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1097

south दक्षिण (dakṣiṇ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1563

speak — the command you give somebody you would call tum, and the middle of three levels the track already has for you बोलो (bolo)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 93, p. 639

Speaking to Somebody
chapter topic; Chapter 105, p. 783

special ख़ास (khās)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1617

spice, a spice mix मसाला (masālā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1431

spicy तीखा (tīkhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 156, p. 1097

sport, games खेलकूद (khelkūd)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 223, p. 1503

spring वसंत (vasant)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1491

square चौकोर (caukor)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1587

Square, Triangular, Narrow, Shallow, Stale
chapter topic; Chapter 237, p. 1587

stale बासी (bāsī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1587

sticky चिपचिपा (cipcipā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 238, p. 1593

stomach, belly — masculine, and the one word in this chapter with no clean ancestry at all पेट (peṭ)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 283

Stone, Sand, Wave, Shore, Electricity
chapter topic; Chapter 144, p. 1025

Storm, Fog, Snow, Wind, Lion
chapter topic; Chapter 145, p. 1031

straight, direct सीधा (sīdhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1569

strong, sturdy मज़बूत (mazbūt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1437

successful कामयाब (kāmyāb)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1617

suddenly अचानक (acānak)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 248, p. 1653

sugar चीनी (chīnī)
Chapter 52, p. 373

sunshine धूप (dhūp)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 185, p. 1273

Sunshine, Cold, Heat, A storm, A leaf
chapter topic; Chapter 185, p. 1273

sure, certain; firm पक्का (pakkā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 827

sweat पसीना (pasīnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 901

sweet मीठा (mīṭhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 213, p. 1443

sweetness मिठास (miṭhās)
Chapter 57, p. 403

T

Take Care
chapter topic; Chapter 121, p. 883

take care ध्यान रखिए (dhyān rakhie)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 121, p. 883

take it easy; comfortably आराम से (ārām se)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 122, p. 889

Taking, Asking, Helping — and Liking
chapter topic; Chapter 35, p. 257

Taking Your Leave
chapter topic; Chapter 49, p. 353

tall, long — one word for both, because Hindi measures the same distance whether it stands up or lies down लंबा (lambā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 90, p. 603

tea — feminine, and one of the two names the world uses for the same leaf एक चाय दीजिए (ek chāy dījie)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 37, p. 275

tears आँसू (ā̃sū)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 109, p. 809

Telling Somebody To Do Something
chapter topic; Chapter 93, p. 639

Telling Time
chapter topic; Chapter 18, p. 161

ten million (crore) करोड़ (karoṛ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 244, p. 1629

tenth / feminine tenth — the ten closed, and the ending carrying on past it दसवाँ / दसवीं (dasvā̃ / dasvī̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 83, p. 567

thank you (dhanyavād — formal, Sanskritic) धन्यवाद (dhanyavād)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

thanks (shukriyā — everyday, Persian/Arabic-derived) शुक्रिया (shukriyā)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology, usage and culture; Chapter 1, p. 1

that'll do, that works चलेगा (calegā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 919

that one — the thing over there वह (vah)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 301

that very one, the same वही (vahī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 113, p. 833

the back पीठ (pīṭh)
Chapter 53, p. 379

the bill बिल (bil)
Chapter 80, p. 547

the chest छाती (chātī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1067

the chin ठोड़ी (ṭhoṛī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1067

the cinema सिनेमा (sinemā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 187, p. 1285

the day after tomorrow परसों (parsoṁ)
Chapter 49, p. 353

ं — the dot above the line
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 16, p. 149

़ — the dot you have been reading and nobody named
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 60, p. 431

The Eating House
chapter topic; Chapter 80, p. 547

The Field and the Well
chapter topic; Chapter 66, p. 471

The First Form Line: Name
chapter topic; Chapter 67, p. 477

The First Verbs
chapter topic; Chapter 5, p. 59

the future भविष्य (bhaviṣya)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1491

The Future, And The Two Letters It Needed
chapter topic; Chapter 96, p. 673

the government सरकार (sarkār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 218, p. 1473

the Gregorian months — borrowed English/international names, running ALONGSIDE the traditional Vikram Samvat calendar's own six-ritu-linked months जनवरी फ़रवरी मार्च अप्रैल मई जून जुलाई अगस्त सितंबर अक्टूबर नवंबर दिसंबर (janvarī farvarī mārc aprail maī jūn julāī agast sitambar aktūbar navambar disambar)
Chapter 16, p. 149

the hand — from Sanskrit hasta, with a real (if non-obvious) sound-change story हाथ (hāth)
Chapter 13, p. 125

the head — from Sanskrit śiras, worn down through a thousand years of everyday speech सिर (sir)
Chapter 13, p. 125

the heart दिल (dil)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 199, p. 1357

the in-laws' home ससुराल (sasurāl)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 859

The line on top — Devanagari's head-line
script and writing topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

ी — the long ee, and the mātrā that blocks more words than any other
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415

the middle बीच (bīc)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1569

the moon चाँद (chā̃d)
Chapter 55, p. 391

the neck गर्दन (gardan)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1067

The Noun, And The Ending That Means Two Things
chapter topic; Chapter 99, p. 711

the past अतीत (atīt)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1491

The Past, And Where You Were
chapter topic; Chapter 95, p. 661

The People Around You
chapter topic; Chapter 39, p. 291

the police पुलिस (pulis)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 273, p. 1805

The police, A pharmacy, A patient, A disease, An illness
chapter topic; Chapter 273, p. 1805

the present वर्तमान (vartamān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 221, p. 1491

the present-habitual template — stem + -tā/-tī/-te + honā बोलता हूँ, बोलती हूँ, बोलते हैं (boltā hūṁ, boltī hūṁ, bolte haiṁ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 59

The Pronouns, And The Article Hindi Does Not Have
chapter topic; Chapter 94, p. 649

the pulse नब्ज़ (nabz)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 257, p. 1707

The pulse, Jealousy, Hatred, Respect, Pride
chapter topic; Chapter 257, p. 1707

The question that is only a voice
grammar topic; explicit focus: pronunciation; Chapter 74, p. 511

the railway रेल (rel)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 523

The Road
chapter topic; Chapter 56, p. 397

The same form, with a clock
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 86, p. 585

◌ू **— the same hook, held longer**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 17, p. 155

◌ौ **— the same mark, one stroke more**
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 33, p. 245

the sea समुद्र (samudra)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 143, p. 1019

The Sky
chapter topic; Chapter 55, p. 391

the sky आसमान (āsmān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 55, p. 391

the sun सूरज (sūraj)
Chapter 55, p. 391

the throat गला (galā)
Chapter 46, p. 335

the tongue जीभ (jībh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1067

The verb goes last
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 69, p. 489

The vowel killer — virama and halant
script and writing topic; Chapter 2, p. 17

The vowel that is already there — the abugida
script and writing topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

The Vowel You Write and Do Not Say
chapter topic; Chapter 59, p. 415

the waist कमर (kamar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 151, p. 1067

there — where I am not वहाँ (vahā̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 301

they — the plural of vah, and the form a speaker also uses about one person they wish to honour वे (ve)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 94, p. 649

thick, heavy, stout — the opposite of patlaa across the whole range, from a person to a rope to a book मोटा (moṭā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 90, p. 603

thin — Sanskrit for leaf-like, and the word Hindi uses for a thin person, a thin sheet and a thin soup alike पतला (patlā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 90, p. 603

Things You Ask For
chapter topic; Chapter 45, p. 329

third / feminine third — the third word to end in -सरा, and the last one that will तीसरा / तीसरी (tīsrā / tīsrī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 82, p. 559

thirst प्यास (pyās)
Chapter 63, p. 453

thirsty प्यासा (pyāsā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 124, p. 901

thirty and forty — the first two rungs past the twenty the counting stopped at तीस चालीस (tīs cālīs)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 104, p. 775

this book — the demonstrative you know as a pronoun, standing in front of a noun instead यह किताब (yah kitāb)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 99, p. 711

this one — the thing near me यह (yah)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 301

thread धागा (dhāgā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 130, p. 939

time, opening hours समय (samay)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 166, p. 1157

tiredness थकान (thakān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 106, p. 791

to accept, to agree, to believe मानना (mānnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1169

To accept, To mix, To change, To drive, To leave
chapter topic; Chapter 168, p. 1169

to, and the marker a definite or human object takes — the postposition that was hiding inside mujhe all along को (ko)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 99, p. 711

to arrive पहुँचना (pahũcnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1145

to ask / ask — infinitive / stem / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural; the same inherited verb as English "pray" पूछना / पूछ / पूछता / पूछती / पूछते (pūchnā / pūch / pūchtā / pūchtī / pūchte)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 35, p. 257

to ask for माँगना (mā̃gnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1199

to bathe नहाना (nahānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1121

to be able to / can — infinitive / masculine singular सकना / सकता (saknā / saktā)
explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 70, p. 493

to be afraid डरना (ḍarnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1231

to be left behind, to be missed छूटना (chūṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1539

to be made, to become बनना (bannā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1521

to be seen, to appear दिखना (dikhnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1187

to bear, to put up with सहना (sahnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1237

to bend down, to bow झुकना (jhuknā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1545

To bend down, To hang, To hang, To float, To sink
chapter topic; Chapter 230, p. 1545

To bend, To gather up, To spread, To spread, To be left behind
chapter topic; Chapter 229, p. 1539

to bend, to turn मोड़ना (moṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1539

to boil उबालना (ubālnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1225

to break तोड़ना (toṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1127

to break (by itself) टूटना (ṭūṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1521

to bring लाना (lānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1121

to bring up, to keep (animals) पालना (pālnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1527

to burn (by itself) जलना (jalnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1211

to buy ख़रीदना (kharīdnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 79, p. 539

to call बुलाना (bulānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1145

To call, To teach, To learn, To arrive, To come back
chapter topic; Chapter 164, p. 1145

to catch, to hold पकड़ना (pakaṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1151

To catch, To touch, To explain, To play, To count
chapter topic; Chapter 165, p. 1151

to celebrate, to persuade मनाना (manānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1225

to change बदलना (badalnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1169

to choose चुनना (cunnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1199

to clean साफ़ करना (sāf karnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1515

To clean, To dust, To wipe, To wring, To dry
chapter topic; Chapter 225, p. 1515

to climb, to board चढ़ना (caṛhnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1193

to come back लौटना (lauṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1145

to come / come — infinitive / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural आना / आता / आती / आते (ānā / ātā / ātī / āte)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 315

to cook पकाना (pakānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1127

To cook, To cut, To break, To fall, To fly
chapter topic; Chapter 161, p. 1127

to cough खाँसना (khā̃snā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1551

to count गिनना (ginnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1151

to cover ढकना (ḍhaknā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1199

To cover, To fill, To share, To choose, To ask for
chapter topic; Chapter 173, p. 1199

to cry रोना (ronā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1133

to cut काटना (kāṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1127

to dance नाचना (nācnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1133

to decorate सजाना (sajānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1205

to die मरना (marnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1181

To die, To live, To pass (of time), To lift, To tell (a story)
chapter topic; Chapter 170, p. 1181

to do or make / to work / do — infinitives / masculine / feminine करना / काम करना / करता / करती (karnā / kām karnā / kartā / kartī)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 59

to drink / masculine present form / to eat / masculine present form पीना / पीता / खाना / खाता (pīnā / pītā / khānā / khātā)
Chapter 80, p. 547

to drip टपकना (ṭapaknā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1551

to drive, to run (a machine) चलाना (calānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1169

to drop गिराना (girānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1211

to dry (by itself) सूखना (sūkhnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1521

to dry (something) सुखाना (sukhānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1515

To dry, To go wrong, To make, To be made, To break
chapter topic; Chapter 226, p. 1521

to dust, to sweep झाड़ना (jhāṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1515

to escape, to be saved बचना (bacnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1175

to explain समझाना (samjhānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1151

to fall गिरना (girnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1127

to fight लड़ना (laṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1231

to fill भरना (bharnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1199

to float (something) तैराना (tairānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1545

to flow बहना (bahnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1551

To flow, To drip, To sneeze, To yawn, To cough
chapter topic; Chapter 231, p. 1551

to fly उड़ना (uṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 161, p. 1127

to forget भूलना (bhūlnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1133

to fry तलना (talnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1225

to gather up समेटना (sameṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1539

to get down, to get off उतरना (utarnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1193

to get tired थकना (thaknā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1237

To get tired, To bear, To remove, To move aside, To pass by
chapter topic; Chapter 179, p. 1237

to get up — the verb every routine starts with, and the first word in the track to open with the letter u उठना (uṭhnā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 98, p. 699

to give देना (denā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 315

to give back लौटाना (lauṭānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1205

To give back, To decorate, To look after, To improve, To weigh
chapter topic; Chapter 174, p. 1205

to go / masculine present form जाना / जाता (jānā / jātā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 76, p. 523

to go wrong, to spoil बिगड़ना (bigaṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1521

to grind पीसना (pīsnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1225

to grow (plants) उगाना (ugānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1533

To grow, To grow, To hand over, To press, To turn
chapter topic; Chapter 228, p. 1533

to grow, to sprout उगना (ugnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1533

to hand over पकड़ाना (pakṛānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1533

to hang लटकना (laṭaknā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1545

to hang (something) लटकाना (laṭkānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1545

to help / masculine, feminine, and respectful-plural present forms — a noun plus करना, which is how Hindi turns almost anything into a verb मदद करना / मदद करता / मदद करती / मदद करते (madad karnā / madad kartā / madad kartī / madad karte)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 257

to hide (oneself) छिपना (chipnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1187

to hide (something) छिपाना (chipānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1187

to hit मारना (mārnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1231

to improve, to correct सुधारना (sudhārnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1205

to increase, to raise बढ़ाना (baṛhānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1175

to join, to add जोड़ना (joṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1175

To join, To reduce, To increase, To save, To escape
chapter topic; Chapter 169, p. 1175

to laugh हँसना (hãsnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1133

to learn सीखना (sīkhnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1145

to leave, to let go छोड़ना (choṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1169

to lift, to pick up उठाना (uṭhānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1181

to light, to burn जलाना (jalānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1211

to listen or hear / listen or hear — infinitive / stem / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural सुनना / सुन / सुनता / सुनती / सुनते (sunnā / sun / suntā / suntī / sunte)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 321

to live जीना (jīnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1181

to live or stay / masculine present form / in रहना / रहता / में (rahnā / rahtā / meṁ)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 59

to look after, to handle सँभालना (sãbhālnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1205

to look for ढूँढना (ḍhū̃ḍhnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1139

to look or see / look or see — infinitive / stem / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural देखना / देख / देखता / देखती / देखते (dekhnā / dekh / dekhtā / dekhtī / dekhte)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 321

to lose (a game) हारना (hārnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1139

to make बनाना (banānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 226, p. 1521

to measure नापना (nāpnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1211

To measure, To drop, To light, To burn (by itself), To put out (a fire or light)
chapter topic; Chapter 175, p. 1211

to mix, to introduce मिलाना (milānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 168, p. 1169

to move aside हटना (haṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1237

to open खोलना (kholnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1121

to pass by, to pass through गुज़रना (guzarnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1237

to pass (of time) बीतना (bītnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1181

to play (an instrument), to ring बजाना (bajānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1151

to play / plays — infinitive / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural खेलना / खेलता / खेलती / खेलते (khelnā / kheltā / kheltī / khelte)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 77, p. 529

to press दबाना (dabānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1533

to pull खींचना (khī̃cnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1219

to push धकेलना (dhakelnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1219

to put out (a fire or light) बुझाना (bujhānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 175, p. 1211

to put, to keep रखना (rakhnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1115

to read or study / stem / masculine, feminine, and respectful-plural present forms / studies / to teach पढ़ना / पढ़ / पढ़ता / पढ़ती / पढ़ते / पढ़ाई / पढ़ाना (paṛhnā / paṛh / paṛhtā / paṛhtī / paṛhte / paṛhāī / paṛhānā)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 249

to reduce, to subtract घटाना (ghaṭānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1175

to remove हटाना (haṭānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 179, p. 1237

to run दौड़ना (dauṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1115

to run away भागना (bhāgnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1193

to save, to rescue बचाना (bacānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 169, p. 1175

to scold डाँटना (ḍā̃ṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1557

to scream चीखना (cīkhnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1557

to sell बेचना (becnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1139

to send भेजना (bhejnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1121

To send, To bring, To open, To wash, To bathe
chapter topic; Chapter 160, p. 1121

to set out, to leave निकलना (nikalnā)
Chapter 49, p. 353

to shake हिलाना (hilānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1219

To shake, To pull, To push, To throw, To taste
chapter topic; Chapter 176, p. 1219

to share, to divide बाँटना (bā̃ṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 173, p. 1199

To shiver, To smile, To scream, To whisper, To scold
chapter topic; Chapter 232, p. 1557

to shiver, to tremble काँपना (kā̃pnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1557

to shout चिल्लाना (cillānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1231

to show दिखाना (dikhānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1187

To show, To be seen, To hide (something), To hide (oneself), To stop
chapter topic; Chapter 171, p. 1187

to sink, to drown डूबना (ḍūbnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 230, p. 1545

to sit बैठना (baiṭhnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 315

to sleep सोना (sonā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1115

to smell सूँघना (sū̃ghnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 177, p. 1225

To smell, To celebrate, To grind, To boil, To fry
chapter topic; Chapter 177, p. 1225

to smile मुस्कुराना (muskurānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1557

to sneeze छींकना (chīṅknā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1551

to sow बोना (bonā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1527

to speak बोलना (bolnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 43, p. 321

to speak / speak — infinitive / stem बोलना / बोल (bolnā / bol)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 5, p. 59

to split, to cut open चीरना (cīrnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1527

to spread फैलना (phailnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1539

to spread (something) फैलाना (phailānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 229, p. 1539

to stand खड़ा होना (kharā honā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 42, p. 315

to stop (someone or something) रोकना (roknā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1193

To stop (someone or something), To run away, To climb, To get down, To stroll
chapter topic; Chapter 172, p. 1193

to stop, to wait रुकना (ruknā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 171, p. 1187

to stroll, to wander घूमना (ghūmnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 172, p. 1193

to swim तैरना (tairnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 162, p. 1133

To swim, To dance, To laugh, To cry, To forget
chapter topic; Chapter 162, p. 1133

to take / take / profit or gain — infinitive / stem / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural / noun लेना / ले / लेता / लेती / लेते / लाभ (lenā / le / letā / letī / lete / lābh)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 35, p. 257

to taste चखना (cakhnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1219

to teach सिखाना (sikhānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 164, p. 1145

to tear (something) फाड़ना (phāṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1527

to tear, to burst फटना (phaṭnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 227, p. 1527

To tear, To tear, To bring up, To split, To sow
chapter topic; Chapter 227, p. 1527

to tell (a story), to recite सुनाना (sunānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 170, p. 1181

to the child — one child, in the shape a postposition forces on the noun in front of it बच्चे को (bacce ko)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 99, p. 711

to think / thought or worry / think — infinitive / noun / masculine / feminine / respectful or plural सोचना / सोच / सोचता / सोचती / सोचते (sochnā / soch / sochtā / sochtī / sochte)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 34, p. 249

to throw फेंकना (phẽknā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 176, p. 1219

to touch छूना (chūnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 165, p. 1151

to turn, to show around घुमाना (ghumānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 228, p. 1533

to understand / understanding or sense / masculine, feminine, and respectful-plural present forms / older Hindi form समझना / समझ / समझता / समझती / समझते / समुझना (samajhnā / samajh / samajhtā / samajhtī / samajhte / samujhnā)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 249

to us, to you — the oblique pronouns, which is what mujhe has quietly been all along हमें / तुम्हें (hamẽ / tumhẽ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 94, p. 649

to wake up, to stay awake जागना (jāgnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 159, p. 1115

to want / longing / want — infinitive / noun / masculine singular चाहना / चाह / चाहता (chāhnā / chāh / chāhtā)
Chapter 70, p. 493

to wash धोना (dhonā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 160, p. 1121

to wear पहनना (pahannā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1139

To weave, To hit, To fight, To be afraid, To shout
chapter topic; Chapter 178, p. 1231

to weave, to knit बुनना (bunnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 178, p. 1231

to weigh तोलना (tolnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 174, p. 1205

to whisper फुसफुसाना (phusphusānā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 232, p. 1557

to win जीतना (jītnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 163, p. 1139

To win, To lose, To sell, To look for, To wear
chapter topic; Chapter 163, p. 1139

to wipe पोंछना (põchnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1515

to wring निचोड़ना (nicoṛnā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 225, p. 1515

to write लिखना (likhnā)
Chapter 43, p. 321

to write / stem / masculine, feminine, and respectful-plural present forms — from a Sanskrit verb meaning "to scratch", the same picture five language families reached independently लिखना / लिख / लिखता / लिखती / लिखते (likhnā / likh / likhtā / likhtī / likhte)
explicit focus: script, etymology; Chapter 34, p. 249

to yawn जम्हाई लेना (jamhāī lenā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 231, p. 1551

to you, to him or her — the two obliques built with ko, which completes a paradigm the track had one corner of आपको / उसे (āpko / use)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 94, p. 649

today आज (āj)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 78, p. 535

Today, and How Much
chapter topic; Chapter 78, p. 535

tooth — masculine, though it is built exactly like the feminine आँख, and a cousin of Latin dēns and English tooth दाँत (danta)
explicit focus: script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 38, p. 283

Towel, Broom, Box, Bag, Candle
chapter topic; Chapter 131, p. 945

train — an English word Hindi took whole, and the second vehicle you can travel by ट्रेन (ṭren)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753

treatment, a cure इलाज (ilāj)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 180, p. 1243

triangular तिकोना (tikoṇā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 237, p. 1587

troubled, bothered परेशान (pareśān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 803

trousers पैंट (paiṇṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 135, p. 969

true सच (sac)
Chapter 48, p. 347

true, genuine सच्चा (saccā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 214, p. 1449

truly, really सचमुच (sacmuc)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 127, p. 919

trust भरोसा (bharosā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 65, p. 465

turmeric हल्दी (haldī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 211, p. 1431

turning over (in bed) करवट (karvaṭ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 275, p. 1817

Two Actions, One Clause
chapter topic; Chapter 73, p. 507

two men — the plural that does nothing at all, and why the sentence still tells you दो आदमी (do ādmī)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 99, p. 711

Two people, two known practice names
script and writing topic; Chapter 67, p. 477

◌ै — two strokes above the head-line, and one of the commonest endings in the language
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415

Two Words Where English Has One
chapter topic; Chapter 101, p. 739

U

ugly, clumsy भद्दा (bhaddā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1437

Ugly, Strong, Weak, Cheap, Hard
chapter topic; Chapter 212, p. 1437

uncle, the father's younger brother चाचा (cācā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 116, p. 853

uncle, the mother's brother मामा (māmā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 117, p. 859

unsuccessful नाकाम (nākām)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 243, p. 1623

Unsuccessful, Proud, Simple, Cunning, Quarrelsome
chapter topic; Chapter 243, p. 1623

until, as far as — the postposition that marks where something stops, and the partner se has been waiting for तक (tak)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753

unusual, unique अनोखा (anokhā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1611

up, above ऊपर (ūpar)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 235, p. 1575

Up, Down, Ahead, Behind, Inside
chapter topic; Chapter 235, p. 1575

upside down, reversed उल्टा (ulṭā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 234, p. 1569

used to speak — the habit you already build, with the time word swapped बोलता था (boltā thā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 95, p. 661

useless बेकार (bekār)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 242, p. 1617

V

valuable क़ीमती (kīmtī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 241, p. 1611

Verbs of Seeing and Saying
chapter topic; Chapter 43, p. 321

very, a lot बहुत (bahut)
Chapter 78, p. 535

vomiting उल्टी (ulṭī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 256, p. 1701

Vomiting, A wound, A bandage, An injection, A pill
chapter topic; Chapter 256, p. 1701

W

was not — the negative you already have, standing in the one slot it has always stood in नहीं था (nahīṃ thā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 95, p. 661

was, said by or about a woman — the past copula bends where the present one refused to थी (thī)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 95, p. 661

was — the single word that moves a sentence you can already build into the past था (thā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 95, p. 661

Water and Bread
chapter topic; Chapter 15, p. 143

water (literally "the drinkable one," not the ancient Sanskrit word for water) and bread/flatbread पानी रोटी (pānī roṭī)
Chapter 15, p. 143

Ways of Going
chapter topic; Chapter 76, p. 523

we are doing, they are doing, and the form आप takes — the plural, in both dials at once कर रहे हैं (kar rahe haiṁ)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 97, p. 687

we'll meet again (goodbye) फिर मिलेंगे (phir milenge)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 51

(we or they) will meet / to meet / stem / future base / plural future ending and its final syllable मिलेंगे / मिलना / मिल् / मिले / -एंगे / -गे (mileṅge / milnā / mil / mile / -eṅge / -ge)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 4, p. 51

we — the pronoun a mock reading item needs, and the one Hindi also reaches for when an English speaker would say I हम (ham)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 94, p. 649

we will come, they will come, and the form आप takes — the ending the farewell had all along आएँगे (āeṅge)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 96, p. 673

weak कमज़ोर (kamzor)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 212, p. 1437

weakness कमज़ोरी (kamzorī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 107, p. 797

Weather
chapter topic; Chapter 20, p. 173

weather — the SAME root as English "monsoon"; rain has TWO words that sound alike but are NOT related, a real false-friend trap मौसम / गर्मी है / ठंड है / बारिश हो रही है (mausam / garmī hai / ṭhanḍ hai / baarish ho rahī hai)
Chapter 20, p. 173

Welcoming a Guest
chapter topic; Chapter 51, p. 367

well and badly — two adjectives you already have, doing a job English needs different words for अच्छा / बुरा (acchā / burā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 100, p. 727

were — the plural past, and the form आप takes even for one person थे (the)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 95, p. 661

west पश्चिम (paścim)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 233, p. 1563

wet गीला (gīlā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 154, p. 1085

what क्या (kyā)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

What Did You Say?
chapter topic; Chapter 126, p. 913

what did you say? क्या कहा? (kyā kahā?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 126, p. 913

What Hands Work With
chapter topic; Chapter 62, p. 447

what I do against what I am doing — the distinction English keeps and most languages do not दो वर्तमान (do vartamān)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 97, p. 687

What I Know and What I Want
chapter topic; Chapter 103, p. 765

What Is Going On Right Now
chapter topic; Chapter 97, p. 687

What It Costs
chapter topic; Chapter 79, p. 539

what kind / how — masculine / feminine / respectful or masculine plural कैसा / कैसी / कैसे (kaisā / kaisī / kaise)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 41

what's going on? क्या चल रहा है? (kyā cal rahā hai?)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 123, p. 895

what's your name? आपका नाम क्या है? (āpkā nām kyā hai?)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

What the Body Tells You
chapter topic; Chapter 63, p. 453

When, and Then
chapter topic; Chapter 72, p. 503

when, as a question — the fourth k- word, and the one a timetable is read with कब (kab)
Chapter 72, p. 503

Where a Clause Ends, and What Goes Inside One
chapter topic; Chapter 69, p. 489

where? — asking about a place कहाँ (kahā̃)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 301

where the negative stands — the position of nahiin decides how much of a sentence is being taken back, and in a correction it denies only the option in front of it नहीं की जगह (nahīṁ kī jagah)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 102, p. 753

Where You Come From
chapter topic; Chapter 75, p. 517

who? — asking about a person कौन (kaun)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 40, p. 301

Who Someone Is
chapter topic; Chapter 47, p. 341

whole, complete पूरा (pūrā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 236, p. 1581

wholesale थोक (thok)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 251, p. 1671

Wholesale, Scales, A kilo, A litre, A metre
chapter topic; Chapter 251, p. 1671

Whose, And What A Postposition Does To It
chapter topic; Chapter 92, p. 627

Why, and Because
chapter topic; Chapter 71, p. 499

why — the k- word the deixis lesson listed and never taught क्यों (kyoṁ)
Chapter 71, p. 499

wide चौड़ा (cauṛā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 158, p. 1109

Wide, Deep, High, Low, Empty
chapter topic; Chapter 158, p. 1109

wind, air हवा (havā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 145, p. 1031

With, All together, A computer, A mobile phone, A document
chapter topic; Chapter 249, p. 1659

with, together साथ (sāth)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 249, p. 1659

with — two words where English has one, and the first of the two is a word you have had since the possessive chapter के साथ (ke sāth)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 101, p. 739

without an article — Hindi has no the and no a, and this lesson says what carries the work instead बिना आर्टिकल (binā ārṭikal)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 94, p. 649

without — the same shape as the last phrase with one word swapped, and the cheapest new meaning in the chapter के बिना (ke binā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 101, p. 739

woman — everyday औरत, respectful public महिला, and literary स्त्री form a three-register set औरत / महिला / स्त्री (aurat / mahilā / strī)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 39, p. 291

wood, a stick of firewood लकड़ी (lakṛī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 62, p. 447

wool ऊन (ūn)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 22, p. 187

Words on the Door
chapter topic; Chapter 81, p. 553

Work and Marriage
chapter topic; Chapter 119, p. 871

work, as a noun and as a place — the word that has been hiding inside kaam karnaa since the very first verb काम (kām)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 98, p. 699

worry चिंता (cintā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 108, p. 803

worship पूजा (pūjā)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 217, p. 1467

Writing — With A Clock
chapter topic; Chapter 86, p. 585

◌ृ — written as one vowel, said as another
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 83

wrong, incorrect ग़लत (ġalat)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 112, p. 827

Y

y- / v- / k- — six words, one machine
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 40, p. 301

Yes and No
chapter topic; Chapter 7, p. 75

yes / polite yes (hāṃ / jī hāṃ / jī) हाँ / जी हाँ / जी (hāṃ)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 7, p. 75

yoghurt दही (dahī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 140, p. 1001

you are, at the tum level — the copula form the track has only ever said inside one memorised question तुम हो (tum ho)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 93, p. 639

you're welcome (also "welcome!") आपका स्वागत है (āpkā svāgat hai)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, etymology; Chapter 3, p. 41

you (respectful / familiar) आप / तुम (āp / tum)
explicit focus: pronunciation, script, grammar, etymology; Chapter 2, p. 17

you will come, at the tum level — the one row of the grid that has its own vowel आओगे (āoge)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 96, p. 673

young जवान (javān)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 157, p. 1103

your, to someone you are familiar with — the third of three levels, and choosing the wrong one is heard तुम्हारा (tumhārā)
explicit focus: grammar, etymology; Chapter 92, p. 627

youth जवानी (javānī)
explicit focus: etymology; Chapter 220, p. 1485

Other

अ — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 8, p. 83

आ — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 9, p. 93

आ — the independent vowel, for when a word begins with it
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415

इ (i) — the letter inside दिखाइए
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 128, p. 927

ई — the independent form of the long ee
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415

उ — the same vowel, standing on its own feet
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 22, p. 187

ऊ — the same letter, holding the note longer
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 22, p. 187

ऋ — the independent vowel waiting inside ऋतु
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 14, p. 133

ऋतु and the SIX traditional seasons — India's own system, which the Western four-season frame doesn't map onto cleanly ऋतु / वसंत ग्रीष्म वर्षा शरद् हेमंत शिशिर (ṛtu / vasant grīṣma varṣā śarad hemant śiśir)
Chapter 14, p. 133

ए — the vowel that had only ever been a mark
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 29, p. 227

एक ... दूसरा (ek ... dūsrā) — one and the other
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 84, p. 575

ओ — a letter you can already draw most of
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 22, p. 187

औ — the standing form, and the longest build
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 39, p. 291

क and त — two letters on a map of the mouth
script and writing topic; Chapter 1, p. 1

कि (*ki*) — "that"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 69, p. 489

क — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 75

कितने साल के हो? — belonging to so many years
grammar topic; Chapter 19, p. 167

क्या ...? — the yes-or-no question
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 74, p. 511

क्योंकि (*kyoṁki*) — because
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 71, p. 499

-कर / देखकर / करके — chaining actions in sequence
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 73, p. 507

ख — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 18, p. 161

ग — the other way round
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 25, p. 207

घ — a letter arriving before its words
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 14, p. 133

च — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 13, p. 125

छ — the puff again, on a letter you already have
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 21, p. 181

छह, नौ, दस — three different paths
etymology topic; Chapter 21, p. 181

ज — a letter you have been reading without being taught
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 30, p. 231

ज़ फ़ ख़ क़ — the same dot, a different job
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 61, p. 439

जब ... तब ... (*jab ... tab ...*) — when, then
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 72, p. 503

झ — the puff, on the letter you drew last
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 32, p. 237

ञ (ña) — the letter hidden inside ज्ञ
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 128, p. 927

ट — one run, then the headline
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 27, p. 215

ठ — the gap closed
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 28, p. 221

ड — a consonant made with the tongue curled back
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415

ढ — one lift, and the last one to come early
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 15, p. 143

ण — the last one
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 50, p. 359

त — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 12, p. 117

तीन and चार — weight moves from consonants to vowels
etymology topic; Chapter 6, p. 67

थ — the last empty seat in a row you have nearly filled
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 20, p. 173

द — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 19, p. 167

ध — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 20, p. 173

न and म — two bodies under one head-line
script and writing topic; Chapter 1, p. 1
न — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 7, p. 75
नाम — the first A1 form label
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 67, p. 477
नाम — the vowel at the end of a word that you write and do not say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415
नमस्ते — assemble the greeting at last
script and writing topic; Chapter 2, p. 17
नमस्ते — look, hide, write, compare
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing; Chapter 2, p. 17
प — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 9, p. 93
पाँच — the nasal moved into the vowel
etymology topic; Chapter 6, p. 67
प्रिय मीरा — a page with somebody at the top of it
script and writing topic; explicit focus: writing, grammar; Chapter 105, p. 783
पीला — clear sounds, and a look-alike to keep apart
etymology topic; Chapter 24, p. 203
फ — the fourth breath pair
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 26, p. 211
ब — the plain twin of an aspirated letter you already know
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415
बिल्ली — a probable fourth cat-word family
etymology topic; Chapter 23, p. 199
भ — an aspirated consonant
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415
म — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 67
मेरा नाम — two words, two head-lines
script and writing topic; Chapter 2, p. 17
य — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 11, p. 109
य — the consonant ya
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 59, p. 415
र and स — a spineless letter and a possible cousin
script and writing topic; Chapter 2, p. 17
र — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 6, p. 67
ल — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 17, p. 155

व — the loop you have drawn before
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 35, p. 257

श — the letter you have been thanking people with
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 32, p. 237

शुभ संध्या or नमस्ते? — choose by setting
grammar topic; explicit focus: script; Chapter 32, p. 237

ष — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 15, p. 143

स — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 13, p. 125

स्त — two consonants squeezed together
script and writing topic; Chapter 2, p. 17

ह — one character, met inside words you already say
script and writing topic; explicit focus: script, writing; Chapter 10, p. 101

… है ना? — "isn't it?"
grammar topic; explicit focus: grammar; Chapter 74, p. 511